

THE COMPLETE WORKS
OF
JOHN GOWER

*EDITED FROM THE MANUSCRIPTS
WITH INTRODUCTIONS, NOTES, AND GLOSSARIES*

BY
G. C. MACAULAY, M.A.
FORMERLY FELLOW OF TRINITY COLLEGE, CAMBRIDGE

* * * *

THE LATIN WORKS

De modicis igitur modicum dabo pauper, et inde
Malo valere parum quam valuisse nichil.

Oxford
AT THE CLARENDON PRESS

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THE COMPLETE WORKS OF JOHN GOWER

G. C. MACAULAY

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INTRODUCTION

LIFE OF GOWER.

To write anything like a biography of Gower, with the materials that exist, is an impossibility. Almost the only authentic records of him, apart from his writings, are his marriage-licence, his will, and his tomb in St. Saviour's Church; and it was this last which furnished most of the material out of which the early accounts of the poet were composed. A succession of writers from Leland down to Todd contribute hardly anything except guesswork, and this is copied by each from his predecessors with little or no pretence of criticism. Some of them, as Berthelette and Stow, describe from their own observation the tomb with its effigy and inscriptions, as it actually was in their time, and these descriptions supply us with positive information of some value, but the rest is almost entirely worthless.

Gower's will was printed in Gough's *Sepulchral Monuments* (1796), and in 1828 Sir Harris Nicolas, roused by the uncritical spirit of Todd, published the article in the *Retrospective Review*¹ which has ever since been regarded as the one source of authentic information on the subject. It does not appear that Nicolas undertook any very extensive searching of records, indeed he seems to have practically confined his attention to the British Museum; for wherever he cites the Close Rolls or other documents now in the Record Office, it is either from the abstract of the Close Rolls given in MS. Harl. 1176 or as communicated to him by some other person: but he was able to produce several more or less interesting documents connected either with the poet or with somebody who bore the same name and belonged to the same family, and he placed the discussion for the first time upon a sound critical basis. Pauli simply recapitulated the results arrived at by Nicolas with some slight elucidations from the Close Rolls of 6 Ric. II on a matter which had been already mentioned by Nicolas on the authority of Mr. Petrie. As the result of a further examination of the Close Rolls and other records I am able to place some of the transactions referred to in a clearer light, while at the same time I find myself obliged to cast serious doubt on the theory that all the documents in question relate to the poet. In

short, the conclusions at which I arrive, so far as regards the records, are mostly of a negative character.

It may be taken as proved that the family to which John Gower the poet belonged was of Kent. Caxton indeed says of him that he was born in Wales, but this remark was probably suggested by the name of the 'land of Gower' in Wales, and is as little to be trusted as the further statement that his birth was in the reign of Richard II. There was a natural tendency in the sixteenth century to connect him with the well-known Gowers of Stitenham in Yorkshire, whence the present noble family of Gower derives its origin, and Leland says definitely that the poet was of Stitenham². It is probable, however, that Leland had no very certain information; for when we examine his autograph manuscript, we find that he first wrote, following Caxton, 'ex Cambria, ut ego accepi, originem duxit,' and afterwards altered this to 'ex Stitenhamo, villa Eboracensis prouinciae, originem ducens.' It is probable that the credit of connexion with the poet had been claimed by the Yorkshire family, whose 'proud tradition,' as Todd says, 'has been and still is that he was of Stitenham,' and we find reason to think that they had identified him with a certain distinguished lawyer of their house. This family tradition appears in Leland's *Itinerarium*, vi. 13, 'The house of Gower the poete sumtyme chief iuge of the commune place' (i.e. Common Pleas) 'yet remaineth at Stitenham yn Yorkshire, and diuerse of them syns have been knights.' He adds that there are Gowers also in Richmondshire and Worcestershire ('Wicestreshire,' MS.). The statement that this supposed judge was identical with the poet is afterwards withdrawn; for on a later page Leland inserts a note, 'Mr. Ferrares told me that Gower the iuge could not be the man that write the booke yn Englisch, for he said that Gower the iuge was about Edward the secundes tyme.'³

All this seems to suggest that Leland had no very trustworthy evidence on the matter. He continued to assert, however, as we have seen, that the poet derived his origin from Stitenham, and to this he adds that he was brought up and practised as a lawyer, 'Coluit forum et patrias leges lucrī causa⁴.' It has not been noticed that the author's manuscript has here in the margin what is probably a reference to authority for this statement: we find there a note in a contemporary hand, 'Goverus seruiens ad legem 30 Ed. 3.' From this it is probable that Leland is relying on the Year-book of 30 Ed. III, where we find the name Gower, apparently as that of a serjeant-at-law

who took part in the proceedings. It is not likely that Leland had any good reasons for identifying this Gower, who was in a fairly high position at the bar in the year 1356, with John Gower the poet, who died in 1408⁵.

Leland's statements were copied by Bale and so became public property. They did not, however, long pass unchallenged. Thynne in his *Animadversions* acutely criticises the suggestion of Yorkshire origin, on the ground of the difference of arms:—‘Bale hath much mistaken it, as he hath done infinite things in that book, being for the most part the collections of Leland. For in truth the arms of Sir John Gower being argent, on a cheveron azure three leopards’ heads or, do prove that he came of a contrary house to the Gowers of Stytenham in Yorkshire, who bare barruly of argent and gules, a cross paty flory sable. Which difference of arms seemeth a difference of families, unless you can prove that being of one family they altered their arms upon some just occasion.’ The arms to which Thynne refers as those of Gower the poet are those which are to be seen upon his tomb⁶; and the argument is undoubtedly sound. Thynne proceeds to criticise Speght’s statement that Chaucer and Gower were both lawyers of the Inner Temple: ‘You say, It seemeth that these learned men were of the Inner Temple, for that many years since Master Buckley did see a record in the same house, where Geffrey Chaucer was fined two shillings for beating a Franciscan Friar in Fleet Street. This is a hard collection to prove Gower of the Inner Temple, although he studied the law, for thus you frame your argument: Mr. Buckley found a record in the Temple that Chaucer was fined for beating the friar; ergo Gower and Chaucer were of the Temple.’

A ‘hard collection’ it may be, but no harder than many others that have been made by biographers, and Leland’s ‘*vir equestris ordinis*’⁷ must certainly go the way of his other statements, being sufficiently refuted, as Stow remarks, by the ‘Armiger’ of Gower’s epitaph. Leland in calling him a knight was probably misled by the gilt collar of SS upon his recumbent effigy, and Fuller afterwards, on the strength of the same decoration, fancifully revives the old theory that he was a judge, and is copied of course by succeeding writers⁸. On the whole it may be doubted whether there is anything but guesswork in the statements made by Leland about our author, except so far as they are derived from his writings or from his tomb.

That John Gower the poet was of a Kentish family is proved by definite and positive evidence. The presumption raised by the fact that his English writings certainly have some traces of the Kentish dialect, is confirmed, first by the identity of the arms upon his tomb with those of Sir Robert Gower, who had a tomb in Brabourne Church in Kent, and with reference to whom Weever, writing in 1631, says, 'From this family John Gower the poet was descended⁹,' secondly, by the fact that in the year 1382 a manor which we know to have been eventually in the possession of the poet was granted to John Gower, who is expressly called 'Esquier de Kent,' and thirdly, by the names of the executors of the poet's will, who are of Kentish families. It may be added that several other persons of the name of Gower are mentioned in the records of the time in connexion with the county of Kent. Referring only to cases in which the Christian name also is the same as that of the poet, we may note a John Gower among those complained of by the Earl of Arundel in 1377, as having broken his closes at High Rothing and elsewhere, fished in his fishery and assaulted his servants¹⁰; John Gower mentioned in connexion with the parishes of Throwley and Stalesfield, Kent, in 1381-2¹¹; John Gower who was killed by Elias Taillour, apparently in 1385¹²; John Gower who was appointed with others in 1386 to receive and distribute the stores at Dover Castle¹³; none of whom can reasonably be identified with the poet. Therefore it cannot be truly said, as it is said by Pauli, that the surname Gower, or even the combination John Gower, is a very uncommon one in the records of the county of Kent¹⁴.

Before proceeding further, it may be well to set forth in order certain business transactions recorded in the reign of Edward III, in which a certain John Gower was concerned, who is identified by Nicolas with the poet¹⁵.

They are as follows:—

39 Ed. III (1365). An inquiry whether it will be to the prejudice of the king to put John Gower in possession of half the manor of Aldyngton in Kent, acquired by him without licence of the king from William de Septvans, and if so, 'ad quod damnum.' This half of Aldyngton is held of the king by the service of paying fourteen shillings a year to the Warden of Rochester Castle on St. Andrew's day¹⁶.

Under date Feb. 15 of the same year it was reported that this would not be to the prejudice of the king, and accordingly on March 9 John Gower pays 53 shillings, which appears to be the annual value of the property, and is pardoned for the offence committed by acquiring it without licence¹⁷.

39 Ed. III (June 23). William Sepvanus, son of William Sepvanus knight, grants to John Gower ten pounds rent from the manor of Wygebergh (Wigborough) in Essex and from other lands held by him in the county of Essex¹⁸.

By another deed, acknowledged in Chancery on June 25 of the same year, the same William Sepvanus makes over to John Gower all his claims upon the manor of Aldyngton, and also a rent of 14s. 6d., with one cock, thirteen hens and 140 eggs from Maplecomb¹⁹.

42 Ed. III (1368). Thomas Syward, pewterer and citizen of London, and Joanna his wife, daughter of Sir Robert Gower, grant to John Gower and his heirs the manor of Kentwell. Dated at Melford, Wednesday before the Nativity of St. John Baptist²⁰.

43 Ed. III. Fine between John Gower on the one hand, and John Spenythorn with Joan his wife on the other, by which they give up all right to the Manor of Kentwell, Suffolk, except £10 rent, John Gower paying 200 marks²¹.

This was confirmed in the king's court, 3 Ric. II.

By documents of previous date²² it may be shown that the manor of Kentwell had been held by Sir Rob. Gower, doubtless the same who is buried in Brabourne Church, who died apparently in 1349; that it was ultimately divided, with other property, between his heirs, two daughters named Katherine and Joanna, of whom one, Katherine, died in 1366. Her moiety was then combined with the other in the possession of her sister Joanna, '23 years old and upwards,' then married to William Neve of Wetyng, but apparently soon afterwards to Thomas Syward. As to the transaction between John Gower and John Spenythorn with Joanna his wife, we must be content to remain rather in the dark. John Gower had in the year before acquired Kentwell in full possession for himself and his heirs, and he must in the mean time have alienated it, and now apparently acquired it again. It is hardly likely that the Joan who is here mentioned is the same as

Joan daughter of Sir Robert Gower, who was married successively to William Neve and Thomas Syward. On the other hand it must be regarded as probable that the John Gower of this document is identical with the John Gower who acquired Kentwell from Thomas Syward and his wife in 1368. The confirmation in the king's court, 3 Ric. II, was perhaps by way of verifying the title before the grant of Kentwell by Sir J. Cobham to Sir T. Clopton, 4 Ric. II.

47 Ed. III (1373). John Gower grants his manor of Kentwell in Suffolk to Sir John Cobham and his heirs; a deed executed at Otford in Kent, Thurs. Sept. 29²³.

48 Ed. III (1374). Payment of 12 marks by Sir J. Cobham on acquisition of Kentwell and half of Aldyngton from John Gower²⁴.

By this last document it seems pretty certain that the John Gower from whom Sir J. Cobham received Kentwell was the same person as the John Gower who acquired Aldyngton from William Septvans; and he is proved to be a relation of the poet, as well as of Sir Robert Gower, by the fact that the arms on the seal of John Gower, attached to the deed by which Kentwell was alienated, are apparently the same as those which were placed upon Sir Rob. Gower's tomb at Brabourne, and those which we see on the poet's tomb in Southwark²⁵. These persons, then, belonged to the same family, so far as we can judge; but evidently it is not proved merely by this fact that the John Gower mentioned in the above document was identical with the poet. We have seen already that the name was not uncommon in Kent, and there are some further considerations which may lead us to hesitate before we identify John Gower the poet with the John Gower who acquired land from William Septvans. This latter transaction in fact had another side, to which attention has not hitherto been called, though Sir H. Nicolas must have been to some extent aware of it, since he has given a reference to the Rolls of Parliament, where the affair is recorded.

It must be noted then in connexion with the deeds of 39 Ed. III, by which John Gower acquired Aldyngton from William Septvans, son of Sir William Septvans, that in the next year, 40 Ed. III, there is record of a commission issued to Sir J. Cobham and others to inquire into the circumstances of this alienation, it having been alleged that William Septvans was not yet of age, and that he had obtained release of his father's

property from the king's hands by fraudulent misrepresentation. The commission, having sat at Canterbury on the Tuesday before St. George's day, 1366, reported that this was so, that William Septvans was in fact under twenty years old, and would not attain the age of twenty till the feast of St. Augustine the Doctor next to come (i.e. Aug. 28); that the alienations to John Gower and others had been improperly made by means of a fraudulent proof of age, and that his property ought to be resealed into the king's hands till he was of age. Moreover the report stated that John Gower had given 24 marks only for property worth £12 a year, with a wood of the value of £100, that after his enfeoffment the said John Gower was in the company of William Septvans at Canterbury and elsewhere, until Sept. 29, inducing him to part with land and other property to various persons²⁶.

The property remained in the king's hands till the year 1369, when an order was issued to the escheator of the county of Essex to put William Septvans in possession of his father's lands, which had been confiscated to the Crown, 'since two years and more have elapsed from the festival of St. Augustine, when he was twenty years old' (Westm. 21 Feb.)²⁷. Presumably John Gower then entered into possession of the property which he had irregularly acquired in 1365, and possibly with this may be connected a payment by John Gower of £20 at Michaelmas in the year 1368 to Richard de Ravensere²⁸, who seems to have been keeper of the hanaper in Chancery.

It is impossible without further proof to assume that the villainous misleader of youth who is described to us in the report of the above commission, as encouraging a young man to defraud the Crown by means of perjury, in order that he may purchase his lands from him at a nominal price, can be identical with the grave moralist of the *Speculum Hominis* and the *Vox Clamantis*. Gower humbly confesses that he has been a great sinner, but he does not speak in the tone of a converted libertine: we cannot reconcile our idea of him with the proceedings of the disreputable character who for his own ends encouraged the young William Septvans in his dishonesty and extravagance. The two men apparently bore the same arms, and therefore they belonged to the same family, but beyond this we cannot go. It may be observed moreover that the picture suggested to Prof. Morley by the deed of 1373, executed at Otford, of the poet's residence in the pleasant valley of the Darent, which he describes at some length²⁹, must in any case be dismissed as baseless. Otford was a manor held by Sir John

Cobham³⁰, and whether the John Gower of this deed be the poet or no, it is pretty clear that the deed in question was executed there principally for this reason, and not because it was the residence of John Gower.

Dismissing all the above records as of doubtful relevancy to our subject³¹, we proceed to take note of some which seem actually to refer to the poet. Of these none are earlier than the reign of Richard II. They are as follows:

1 Ric. II. (May, 1378). A record that Geoffrey Chaucer has given general power of attorney to John Gower and Richard Forester, to be used during his absence abroad by licence of the king.³² Considering that Chaucer and Gower are known to have been personally acquainted with one another, we may fairly suppose that this appointment relates to John Gower the poet.³³

6 Ric. II (Aug. 1382). Grant of the manors of Feltwell in Norfolk and Multon in Suffolk to John Gower, Esquire, of Kent, and to his heirs, by Guy de Rouclyf, clerk (Aug. 1), and release of warranty on the above (Aug. 3)³⁴.

6 Ric. II (Aug. 1382). Grant of the manors of Feltwell and Multon by John Gower to Thomas Blakelake, parson of St. Nicholas, Feltwell, and others, for his life, at a rent of £40, to be paid quarterly in the Abbey Church of Westminster³⁵. This grant was repeated 7 Ric. II (Feb. 1384)³⁶.

The mention of Multon in the will of John Gower the poet makes it practically certain that the above documents have to do with him.

17 Ric. II (1393). Henry of Lancaster presented John Gower, Esquire, with a collar. This was mentioned by Nicolas as communicated to him by Mr. G. F. Beltz from a record in the Duchy of Lancaster Office. No further reference was given, and I have had some difficulty in finding the record. It is, however, among the accounts of the wardrobe of Henry of Lancaster for the year mentioned³⁷, and though not dated, it probably belongs to some time in the autumn of 1393, the neighbouring documents in the same bundle being dated October or November. It proves to be in fact an order, directed no doubt to William Loveney, clerk of the Wardrobe to the earl of Derby, for delivery of 26s. 8d. to one Richard Dancaster, for a collar, on account of another collar given by the earl of Derby to 'an Esquire John Gower'³⁸. So

elsewhere in the household accounts of the earl of Derby we find a charge of 56s. 8d. for a silver collar for John Payne, butler, 'because my lord had given his collar to another esquire beyond sea'³⁹. This particular collar given to John Gower was a comparatively cheap one, worth apparently only 26s. 8d., while the silver collar to be given to John Payne is valued at 56s. 8d., and a gold collar of SS for Henry himself costs no less than £26 8s. 11d. The fact that Gower wears a collar of SS on his tomb makes it probable enough that he is the esquire mentioned in this document. It will afterwards be seen that we cannot base any argument upon the fact that the collar upon the effigy is now gilt, and apparently was so also in Leland's time.

25 Jan. 1397-8. A licence from the bishop of Winchester for solemnizing the marriage between John Gower and Agnes Groundolf, both parishioners of St. Mary Magdalene, Southwark, without further publication of banns and in a place outside their parish church, that is to say, in the oratory of the said John Gower, within his lodging in the Priory of Saint Mary Overey in Southwark. Dated at Highclere, 25 Jan. 1397⁴⁰. At this time then Gower was living in the Priory of St. Mary Overey, and no doubt he continued to do so until his death.

Finally, Aug. 15, 1408, the Will of John Gower, which was proved Oct. 24 of the same year⁴¹. His death therefore may be presumed to have taken place in October, 1408.

This will has been printed more than once, in Gough's *Sepulchral Monuments*, by Todd in his *Illustrations of Gower and Chaucer* and in the *Retrospective Review*.

The testator bequeathes his soul to the Creator, and his body to be buried in the church of the Canons of St. Mary Overes, in the place specially appointed for this purpose ('in loco ad hoc specialiter deputato'). To the Prior of the said church he bequeathes 40s., to the subprior 20s., to each Canon who is a priest 13s. 4d., and to each of the other Canons 6s. 8d., that they may all severally pray for him the more devoutly at his funeral. To the servants of the Priory 2s. or 1s. each according to their position; to the church of St. Mary Magdalene 40s. for lights and ornaments, to the parish priest of that church 10s., 'vt oret et orari faciat pro me'; to the chief clerk of the same church 3s. and to the sub-clerk 2s. To the following four parish churches of Southwark, viz. St. Margaret's, St. George's, St. Olave's, and St. Mary Magdalene's near Bermondsey, 13s. 4d. each for ornaments and lights, and to each parish priest or rector in charge of those churches 6s. 8d., 'vt orent et orari pro me in suis parochiis faciant et procurent.' To the master of the hospital of St. Thomas in Southwark 40s., to each priest serving there 6s. 8d. for their prayers; to each sister professed in the said

hospital 3s. 4d., to each attendant on the sick 20d., and to each sick person in the hospital 12d., and the same to the sisters (where there are sisters), nurses and patients in the hospitals of St. Anthony, Elsingspitell, Bedlem without Bishopsgate, and St. Maryspitell near Westminster; to every house for lepers in the suburbs of London 10s., to be distributed amongst the lepers, for their prayers: to the Prior of Elsingspitell 40s., and to each Canon priest there 6s. 8d.

For the service of the altar in the chapel of St. John the Baptist, 'in qua corpus meum sepeliendum est,' two vestments of silk, one of blue and white baudkin and the other of white silk, also a large new missal and a new chalice, all which are to be kept for ever for the service of the said altar. Moreover to the Prior and Convent the testator leaves a large book, 'sumptibus meis nouiter compositum,' called *Martilogium*, on the understanding that the testator shall have a special mention of himself recorded in it every day ('sic quod in eodem specialem memoriam scriptam secundum eorum promissa cotidie habere debeo,' not 'debes,' as printed).

He leaves to his wife Agnes, £100 of lawful money, also three cups, one 'cooperculum,' two salt-cellars and twelve spoons of silver, all the testator's beds and chests, with the furniture of hall, pantry and kitchen and all their vessels and utensils. One chalice and one vestment are left to the altar of the oratory belonging to his apartments ('pro altare quod est infra oratorium hospicii mei'). He desires also that his wife Agnes, if she survive him, shall have all rents due for his manors of Southwell in the county of Northampton (?) and of Multoun in the county of Suffolk, as he has more fully determined in certain other writings given under his seal.

The executors of this will are to be as follows:—Agnes his wife, Arnold Savage, knight, Roger, esquire, William Denne, Canon of the king's chapel, and John Burton, clerk. Dated in the Priory of St. Mary Overes in Southwark, on the feast of the Assumption of the Virgin, MCCCCviii.

The will was proved, Oct. 24, 1408, at Lambeth before the Archbishop of Canterbury (because the testator had property in more than one diocese of the province of Canterbury), by Agnes the testator's wife, and administration of the property was granted to her on Nov. 7 of the same year.

It may be observed with reference to this will that the testator evidently stands already in the position of a considerable benefactor to the Priory of St. Mary Overey, in virtue of which position he has his apartments in the Priory and a place of honour assigned for his tomb in the church. He must also have established by previous arrangement the daily mass and the yearly obituary service which Berthelette speaks of as still celebrated in his time. It is evident that his benefactions were made chiefly in his life-time. There is some slight difficulty as regards the manors which are mentioned in the will. Multon in Suffolk we know already to have been in the poet's possession; but what is this 'Southwell'? Certainly not the well-known Southwell in Nottinghamshire, which cannot possibly have been in the

possession of a private person, belonging, as it did, to the archiepiscopal see of York. Moreover, though 'in Comitatu Nott.' has been hitherto printed as the reading of the will, the manuscript has not this, but either 'Notth.' or 'North.,' more probably the latter. There were apparently other manors of Southwell or Suthwell in the county of Nottingham, and a manor of Suwell in Northamptonshire, but there seems to be no connexion with the name of Gower in the case of any of these. It is possible, but not very readily to be assumed, that the scribe who made the copy of the will in the register carelessly wrote 'Southwell in Com. North.' (or 'Com. Notth.') for 'Feltwell in Com. Norff.,' the name which is found coupled with Multon in the other records⁴².

The one remaining record is the tomb in St. Saviour's church. This originally stood in the chapel of St. John the Baptist, on the north side of the church, but in 1832, the nave and north aisle being in ruins, the monument was removed to the south transept and restored at the expense of Earl Gower. After the restoration of the church this tomb was moved back to the north aisle in October 1894, and was placed on the supposed site of the chapel of St. John the Baptist, where it now stands⁴³.

In the course of nearly five centuries the tomb has undergone many changes, and the present colouring and inscription are not original. What we have now is a canopy of three arches over an altar tomb, on which lies an effigy of the poet, habited in a long dark-coloured gown, with a standing cape and buttoned down to his feet, wearing a gold collar of SS, fastened in front with a device of a chained swan between two portcullises. His head rests on a pile of three folio volumes marked with the names of his three principal works, *Vox Clamantis*, *Speculum Meditantis*, *Confessio Amantis*. He has a rather round face with high cheek-bones, a moustache and a slightly forked beard, hair long and curling upwards⁴⁴, and round his head a chaplet of four red roses at intervals upon a band⁴⁵, with the words 'merci ihs⁴⁶' (repeated) in the intervals between the roses: the hands are put together and raised in prayer: at the feet there is a lion or mastiff lying. The upper ledge of the tomb has this inscription, 'Hic iacet I. Gower Arm. Angl. poeta celeberrimus ac huic sacro edificio benefac. insignis. Vixit temporibus Edw. III et Ric. II et Henr. IV.' In front of the tomb there are seven arched niches. Against the wall at the end of the recess, above the feet of the figure, a shield is suspended bearing arms, argent, on a chevron azure

three leopards' faces or, crest a talbot (or lion) upon a chapeau. The wall behind the tomb under the canopy is at present blank; the original painting of female figures with scrolls has disappeared and has not been renewed, nor has the inscription 'Armigeri scutum,' &c., been replaced.

This tomb has attracted much attention, and descriptions of it exist from early times. Leland's account may be thus translated: 'He was honourably buried in London in the church of the Marian canons on the bank of the Thames, and his wife also is buried in the same place, but in a lower tomb. He has here an effigy adorned with a gold chain and a chaplet of ivy interspersed with roses, the first marking him as a knight and the second as a poet. The reason why he established his place of burial here, was, I believe, as follows. A large part of the suburb adjacent to London Bridge was burnt down in the year 1212⁴⁷, in the reign of King John. The monastery of the Marian canons was much damaged in this fire and was not fully restored till the first year of Richard II. At that time Gower, moved by the calamity, partly through his friends, who were numerous and powerful, and partly at his own expense, repaired the church and restored its ornaments, and the Marian canons even now acknowledge the liberality of Gower towards them, though not to such an extent as I declare it to have been. For this reason it was, in my judgement, that he left his body for burial to the canons of this house⁴⁸.' Berthelette in the Preface to his edition of the *Confessio Amantis*, 1532, gives an interesting account of the tomb: 'John Gower prepared for his bones a resting-place in the monastery of St. Mary Overes, where somewhat after the old fashion he lieth right sumptuously buried, with a garland on his head in token that he in his life days flourished freshly in literature and science. And the same moniment, in remembrance of him erected, is on the North side of the foresaid church, in the chapel of St. John, where he hath of his own foundation a mass daily sung: and moreover he hath an obit yearly done for him within the same church on the Friday after the feast of the blessed pope St. Gregory.

'Beside on the wall, whereas he lieth, there be painted three virgins with crowns on their heads, one of the which is written Charitie, and she holdeth this device in her hand,

En toy qui es fitz de dieu le pere⁴⁹
Sauvé soit que gist souz cest pierre.

‘The second is written Mercye, which holdeth in her hand this device,

O bone Jesu, fait ta mercy
Al alme dont le corps gist icy⁵⁰.

‘The third of them is written Pite, which holdeth in her hand this device following,

Pur ta pitié, Jesu, regarde,
Et met cest alme in sauve garde.

‘And thereby hangeth a table, wherein appeareth that who so ever prayeth for the soul of John Gower, he shall, so oft as he so doth, have a thousand and five hundred days of pardon.’

Stow, writing about 1598, says, ‘This church was again newly rebuilt in the reign of Richard II and king Henry IV. John Gower, a learned gentleman and a famous poet, but no knight, as some have mistaken it, was then an especial benefactor to that work, and was there buried in the north side of the said church, in the chapel of St. John, where he founded a chantry. He lieth under a tomb of stone with his image also of stone being over him. The hair of his head brown, long to his shoulders but curling up, collar of esses of gold about his neck; under his head,’ &c.⁵¹ The tomb is then further described as by Berthelette, with addition of the epitaph in four Latin hexameters, ‘Armigeri scutum,’ &c. (see p. 367 of this volume).

In the *Annals of England* (date about 1600) he again describes the tomb, adding to his description of the painting of the three virgins the important note, ‘All which is now washed out and the image defaced by cutting off the nose and striking off the hands⁵²,’ from which it would appear that we cannot depend even upon the features of the effigy which now exists, as original.

The figures of the virgins were repainted in the course of the seventeenth century apparently, for in Hatton’s *New View of London* (date 1708) they are described as appearing with ‘ducal coronets⁵³.’ In Rawlinson’s *Natural History and Antiquities of Surrey* (published 1719) the effigy is spoken of as having a ‘scarlet gown,’ the older descriptions, e.g. Stow, giving it as ‘an habit of purple damasked,’ and it is said that there is

upon the head ‘a chaplet or diadem of gold about an inch broad, on which are set at equal distances four white quaterfoyles.’⁵⁴ The writer argues also that the chain should be of silver rather than of gold⁵⁵. The arms are said to be ‘supported by two angels,’ and ‘underneath is this inscription, “Hic iacet Iohannes Gower Armiger Anglorum poeta celeberrimus ac huic sacro Edificio Benefactor insignis temporibus Edw. III et Ric. II. Armigeri scutum,”’ &c. The following remark is added: ‘Our author Mr. John Aubrey gives us an inscription which he says he saw on a limb of this monument, something different from the foregoing, and therefore not unworthy a place here, viz.

Johannes Gower, Princeps
Poetarum Angliae, vixit
temporibus Edwardi tertii
et Richardi secundi.’

Later, in 1765, Tyler describes the gown as purple and the arms as pendent by the dexter corner. The figures of women have ducal coronets and scrolls of gold, and below them is the epitaph ‘Armigeri scutum.’ Under the statue the inscription ‘Hic iacet,’ &c.⁵⁶ The monument, as here described, is engraved in Gough’s *Sepulchral Monuments* (date 1796), where there is a full description of it⁵⁷. Blore, under whose direction the position of the monument was changed, says in 1826 that the inscription on the ledge of the tomb ‘Hic iacet,’ &c., was then entirely gone.

Dollman says that there was a fire which injured the nave of the church in the reign of Richard II, and that the windows of the nave and aisles, which were finally removed in 1833, were of the time of Richard II and Henry IV⁵⁸. It is certain, however, that the church remained long in an unfinished state during the period between 1207 (or 1212), the date of the early fire, and the latter part of the fourteenth century. Dollman observes that the remains which may have been contained in the tomb ‘disappeared when the tomb was removed from the north aisle in 1832.’⁵⁹ From what has been said it will be perceived that the tomb has undergone a series of alterations and renovations which have to some extent at least destroyed its original character.

A word must be said finally about Prof. Morley's theory that Gower was in holy orders and held the living of Great Braxted in Essex from 1390-7. This is founded on the fact that the parson of Great Braxted for the period named was one John Gower, as Professor Morley learns from Newcourt's *Repertorium Parochiale*⁶⁰. The original record referred to by Newcourt is to be found in the Registry of the diocese of London⁶¹, and is to the effect that on February 23, 1390-1, the bishop of London admitted and instituted John Gower, clerk, to the parochial church of Great Braksted, vacant by the resignation of John Broun, the late rector, the said John Gower having been duly presented by the king, who at this time was patron of the living, the heir of the late earl of Pembroke being under his wardship. Then later, under date March 31, 1397, there is record of a new institution to the benefice, which is vacant by the resignation of John Gower, late rector⁶².

Professor Morley thought that the expression 'John Gower, clerk' might indicate that the person referred to was in minor orders only, some of the rectors inducted being called 'priest' (while others have no title at all). He conceived that this John Gower held the rectory for six or seven years without being admitted to priest's orders at all, and that he then resigned on his marriage⁶³, and he found confirmation of the theory that this was Gower the poet from the fact that Great Braxted is near to Wigborough, where, as we have seen, a person of this name, supposed by Professor Morley to be the poet, had some claim to rent. We have already seen reason to think that the John Gower who had a rent of £10 from Wigborough was not the poet, and in any case it is evident that the fact could have nothing to do with a presentation by the king five and twenty years afterwards to the rectory of Great Braxted. As to resignation with a view to marriage, it is very unlikely, if not altogether out of the question, that a clergyman who had held an important rectory for six or seven years should not only have been permitted to marry, but should have had his marriage celebrated in the Priory of St. Mary Overy and with the particular sanction of the bishop of Winchester. Add to this the fact that John Gower the poet was undoubtedly 'Esquire,' being called so not only on his tomb but also in the documents of 1382 and 1393, the latter belonging to the period when, according to this theory, he was holding the living of Great Braxted. On the whole, the 'minor orders' theory must be dismissed as entirely baseless, and the John Gower who was rector of Great Braxted must be set down as another of the

rather numerous persons of this name who were to be found in Kent and Essex at this time. There is nothing in Gower's writings to suggest the idea that he was an ecclesiastic. He distinctly calls himself a layman in the *Mirour de l'Omme*, and the expression 'borel clerk' in the Prologue of the *Confessio Amantis* must be taken to mean the same thing. The language which in the *Vox Clamantis* he uses about rectors who fail to perform the duties of their office, makes it almost inconceivable that he should himself have held a rectory without qualifying himself for the performance of the service of the Church even by taking priest's orders. Evidently Professor Morley's idea of the poet as an Essex rector must go the way of his previous attempt to establish him as a country gentleman at Otford. It is probable that he passed a considerable part of his literary life in those lodgings within the Priory of St. Mary Overey which are mentioned in his marriage licence and in his will⁶⁴.

To the information which we derive from records must be added that which is to be drawn from the poet's own writings. From the *Speculum Meditantis* we learn that in early life he composed love poems, which he calls 'fols ditz d' amour' (27340), and from two other passages (ll. 8794 and 17649) we may perhaps assume that he was already married at the time when this work was composed. In the former, speaking of those who tell tales to husbands about their wives' misconduct, he says in effect, 'I for my part declare ('Je di pour moi') that I wish to hear no such tales of my wife:' in the second he speaks of those wives who dislike servants and other persons simply because their husbands like them, and he adds, 'I do not say that mine does so' ('Ne di pas q'ensi fait la moie'). If the inference be correct, his union with Agnes Groundolf in his old age was a second marriage. We cannot come to any definite conclusion from this poem about any profession or occupation which he may have had besides literature. The statement of Leland that he practised as a lawyer seems rather improbable, in view of the way in which he here speaks of lawyers and their profession. Of all the secular estates that of the law seems to him to be the worst (24085 ff.), and he condemns both advocates and judges in a more unqualified manner than the members of any other calling. Especially the suggestion of a special tax to be levied on lawyers' gains (24337 ff.) is one that could hardly have come from one who was himself a lawyer⁶⁵.

Again the way in which he speaks of physicians (24301, 25621 ff.) seems almost equally to exclude him from the profession of medicine.

Of all the various ranks of society which he reviews, that of which he speaks with most respect is the estate of Merchants. He takes pains to point out, both in this poem and in the *Vox Clamantis*, the utility of their occupation, and the justice of their claim to reasonably large profits on successful ventures in consideration of the risks they run (*Mirour*, 25177 ff.; *Vox Clam. Lib. v. Cap. xi, Heading*). He makes a special apology to the honest members of the class for exposing the abuses to which the occupation is liable, pleading that to blame the bad is in effect to praise the good (25213 ff., 25975 ff.), and he is more careful here than elsewhere to point out the fact that honest members of the class exist. He speaks of 'our City,' and has strong feelings about the interests of the city of London, and about the proceedings of a certain bad citizen who stirs up strife and aims at giving privileges in trade to strangers (*Mirour*, 26380 ff.; cp. *Vox Clamantis*, v. 835 ff.): moreover, the jealousy of Lombards which he expresses has every appearance of being a prejudice connected with rivalry in commerce (25429 ff.). He has a special enthusiasm about the wool-trade, as a national concern of the first importance, and he has very definite opinions about the abuses of the staple (25360 ff.). At the same time there is no definite evidence that Gower was a merchant, and his interest in trade and in the affairs of the city of London may well have arisen from his residence in or near the city and his personal acquaintance with merchants (cp. *Mir.* 25915 ff.). His references to the dearness of labour and the unreasonable demands of the labourer (24625 ff.) are what we might expect from a man who had property in land; but again we have no sufficient evidence that Gower was a land-owner in the ordinary sense of the word, for, though he acquired the manors of Feltwell and Multon, he did not reside upon either of them, but gave a lease of them at once.

He tells us that he is a man of simple tastes (26293 ff.), and we know from the whole tone of his writings that he is a just and upright man, who believes in the subordination of the various members of society to one another, and who will not allow himself to be ruled in his own household either by his wife or his servants. But, though a thorough believer in the principle of gradation in human society, he constantly emphasizes the equality of all men before God, and refuses absolutely to admit the accident

of birth as constituting any claim to 'gentilesce.' The common descent of all from Adam is as conclusive on this point for him as it was for John Ball. Considering that his views on society are essentially the same as those of Wycliff, and considering also his strong opinions about the corruption of the Church and the misdeeds of the friars, it is curious to find how strongly he denounces the Lollards in his later writings.

He has a just abhorrence of war, and draws a very clear distinction between the debased chivalry of his own day and the true ideal of knighthood. Above all he has a deep sense of religion, and is very familiar with the Bible. He strongly believes in the moral government of the world by Providence, and he feels sure, as others of his age did also, that the final stage of corruption has almost come. Whatever others may do, he at least intends to repent of his sins and prepare himself to render a good account of his stewardship. In both his French and his Latin work he shows himself a fearless rebuker of evil, even in the highest places. The charge of time-serving timidity has been sufficiently dealt with in the Introduction to the English Works.

From the *Vox Clamantis* it is evident that the rising of the Peasants produced a very powerful, indeed almost an overwhelming, impression upon his mind. He describes the terror inspired by it among those of his social standing in the most impressive manner. The progress of his political development during the reign of Richard II is clearly seen in his Latin works, with their successive revisions. He began, it is evident, with full hope and confidence that the youthful king would be a worthy representative of his father the Black Prince, both in war and in peace. As time goes on, and the boy develops into an ill-regulated young man, under evil influences of various kinds, the poet begins to have doubts, and these gradually increase until they amount to certainty, and rebuke and denunciation take the place of the former favourable anticipations. In the latest version of the *Confessio Amantis*, which is, no doubt, contemporary with some of these changes in the text of the *Vox Clamantis*, we see the author's confidence transferred from the king to his cousin, not as yet regarded as a successor to the throne, but thought of as representing a fair ideal of chivalry and honesty. Finally, in the *Cronica Tripertita*, he accepts the fall of Richard as the fatal consequence of a course of evil government

and treachery, and rejoices in the prospect of a new order of things under his predestined hero.

We see here the picture of one who is not devoted to a particular party, but looks to what he conceives as the common good, deeply impressed with the sense that things are out of joint, and hoping against hope that a saviour of society may arise, either in the person of the young king, or of his vigorous and chivalrous cousin. There is no sign of any liking for John of Gaunt or of any attachment to the Lancastrian party generally; but he is stirred to very genuine indignation at the unfair treatment of men whom he regards as honest patriots, such as Gloucester, the Arundels, and Cobham. He himself was evidently a most patriotic Englishman, loving his country and proud of its former greatness. For this we may refer especially to *Vox Clamantis*, vii. 1289 ff., but the same feeling is visible also in many other passages. He is a citizen of the world no doubt, but an Englishman first, and he cares intensely for the prosperity of his native land. Even when he writes in French it is for England's sake,

‘O gentile Engleterre, a toi j’escrits.’

When he decides that the *Confessio Amantis* could no longer go forth with Richard as its patron, it is to England that he dedicates his poem, and for his country that he offers up the prayers which he can no longer utter with sincerity on behalf of the worthless king (*Conf. Am.* Prol. 24 and viii. 2987).

From the *Confessio Amantis* we learn the circumstances under which that work was undertaken, owing in part at least to a suggestion from the king himself, who, meeting Gower upon the river, made him come into his own barge and conversed with him familiarly on his literary projects, urging him apparently to the composition of a poem in English, and perhaps suggesting Love as the subject. We gather also that in the year 1390 the author considered himself already an old man, and that he had then suffered for some time from ill-health (Prol. 79*, viii. 3042*), and from the Epistle to Archbishop Arundel prefixed later to the *Vox Clamantis*, as well as from the Latin lines beginning ‘Henrici Regis’ (or ‘Henrici quarti’) we learn that he was blind during the last years of his life, probably from the year 1400. We may reasonably suppose that he was born about the year 1330, or

possibly somewhat later. From the Latin statement about his books we learn, what is tolerably obvious from their tenour, that his chief aim in writing was edification, while at the same time we gather from the opening of the first book of the *Confessio Amantis* that he then despaired of effecting anything by direct admonition, and preferred finally to mingle amusement with instruction. The Latin lines at the end of this volume, beginning 'Dicunt scripture,' express a principle which he seems to have followed himself, namely that a man should give away money for good purposes during his own life, rather than leave such business to be attended to by his executors.

The literary side of his activity is sufficiently dealt with in the introductions to his several works, and there also it is noted what were the books with which he was acquainted. It is enough to say here that he was a man of fairly wide general reading, and thoroughly familiar with certain particular books, especially the Bible, all the works of Ovid, and the *Aurora* of Peter de Riga.

THE LATIN WORKS.

Of the works which are included in the present volume the *Vox Clamantis* is the most important. It is written in elegiac verse, more or less after the model of Ovid, and consists of 10,265 lines, arranged in seven books, of which the first, second and third have separate prologues, and each is divided into a series of chapters with prose headings. As to the date of composition, all that we can say is that the work in its present form is later than the Peasants' rising in the summer of 1381, and yet it was evidently composed while the memory of that event was fresh, and also before the young king had grown beyond boyhood. The advice to the king with regard to fidelity in marriage need not be taken to have special reference to the king's actual marriage at the end of the year 1382, but perhaps it is more natural to suppose that it was written after that event than before.

The general plan of the author is to describe the condition of society and of the various degrees of men, much as in the latter portion of the *Speculum Meditantis*. This, however, is made subordinate to the detailed account, given at the beginning, of the Peasants' rising, and that is in fact set down as

the main subject of the work in the Latin account of it given by the author: 'Secundus enim liber sermone Latino versibus exametri et pentametri compositus tractat super illo mirabili euentu, qui in Anglia tempore domini Regis Ricardi secundi anno regni sui quarto contigit, quando seruiles rustici impetuose contra nobiles et ingenuos regni insurrexerunt. Innocenciam tamen dicti domini Regis tunc minoris etatis causa inde excusabilem pronuncians, culpas aliunde, ex quibus et non a fortuna talia inter homines contingunt enormia, euidencius declarat. Titulusque voluminis huius, cuius ordo septem continet paginas, Vox Clamantis nominatur.'

So the statement of contents ran in its earlier form. Afterwards the excuses made for the king on the ground of his youth were withdrawn, and in the final form of the statement the events of the *Cronica Tripertita* are brought into the reckoning, and the fall of Richard seems to be represented as a moral consequence of the earlier misfortunes of his reign.

Evidently what is quoted above is a very insufficient summary of the *Vox Clamantis*, which in fact deals with the Peasants' rising only in its first book; and notwithstanding the fact that this event so much overshadows the other subjects of the poem that the author in describing his work afterwards treated it as the only theme, there is some reason to question whether what we have is really the original form of the poem, and even to conclude that the work may have been originally composed altogether without this detailed narrative of the insurrection. For this idea there is some manuscript authority. It has not hitherto been noted that in one copy (MS. Laud 719) the *Vox Clamantis* appears with the omission of the whole of the first book after the Prologue and first chapter⁶⁶. At the same time the text of this manuscript seems to be complete in itself, and the books are numbered in accordance with the omission, so that there are six books only, our second book being numbered as the first⁶⁷. There is really something to be said for this arrangement, apart from the fact that it occurs in a single manuscript. The first book, with its detailed account of the Peasants' revolt, though in itself the most interesting part of the work, has certainly something of the character of an insertion. The plan of the remainder seems to be independent of it, though the date, June, 1381, which is found also in the Laud MS.,

'Contigit vt quarto Ricardi regis in anno,

Dum clamat mensem Iunius esse suum,'

was doubtless intended to suggest that portentous event as the occasion of the review of society which the work contains. The prologue of the second book, which introduces the teachings of the vision with an invocation of God's assistance, an apology for the deficiencies of the work, and an appeal to the goodwill of the reader, and concludes with a first announcement of the name of the succeeding poem, *Vox Clamantis*, would certainly be much more in place at the beginning of the whole work than here, after more than two thousand lines, and there is no difficulty in supposing that the author may have introduced his account of the Peasants' revolt as an afterthought. The chief reason for hesitating to accept the Laud MS. as representing an authentic form of the poem, lies in the fact that the text of this MS. is rather closely related to that of another copy, MS. Digby 138, which contains the first book in its usual place; and it is perhaps more likely that the original archetype of these two MSS. was one which included the first book, and that this was omitted for some reason by the scribe of the Laud MS., than that the copyist of the Digby MS. perceived the absence of this book and supplied it from some other quarter.

One other matter affecting our estimate of the style of the composition generally has perhaps been sufficiently illustrated in the Notes of this edition, that is to say, the extent to which the author borrows in the *Vox Clamantis* from other writers. It is sufficiently obvious to a casual reader that he has appropriated a good many lines from Ovid, though the extent of this schoolboy plagiarism is hardly to be realised without careful examination; but his very extensive obligations to other writers have not hitherto been pointed out. He repeatedly takes not lines or couplets only, but passages of eight, ten or even twenty lines from the *Aurora* of Peter Riga, from the poem of Alexander Neckam *De Vita Monachorum*, from the *Speculum Stultorum*, or from the *Pantheon*, so that in many places the composition is entirely made up of such borrowed matter variously arranged and combined. This is evidently a thing to be noted, because if the author, when describing (for example) the vices of monasteries, is found to be merely quoting from Alexander Neckam, we cannot attach much value to his account as a picture of the manners of his own time. His knowledge of Ovid seems to have been pretty complete, for he borrows from almost every section of his works with the air of one who knows perfectly well

where to turn for what he wants; quite a large portion of Neckam's poem is appropriated without the smallest acknowledgement, and many long passages are taken from the *Aurora*, with only one slight mention of this source (iii. 1853). Most of the good Latin lines for which Gower has got credit with critics are plagiarisms of this kind, and if Professor Morley had realized to what extent the *Vox Clamantis* is a compilation, he would hardly have estimated the work so highly as he has done. The extracts from medieval authors are to some extent tolerable, because they are usually given in a connected and intelligible shape, but the perpetual borrowing of isolated lines or couplets from Ovid, often without regard to their appropriateness or their original meaning, often makes the style, of the first book especially, nearly as bad as it can be. I have taken the pains to point out a considerable number of plagiarisms, but it is certain that there must be many instances which have escaped my notice. In his later Latin verse the author is very much less dependent upon others, and the *Cronica Tripertita*, from the nature of the subject, is necessarily original.

Gower's own style of versification in Latin is somewhat less elegant than that of Alexander Neckam or Peter Riga, but it stands upon much the same level of correctness. If we take into account the fact that the Latin is not classical but medieval, and that certain licences of prosody were regularly admitted by medieval writers of Latin verse, we shall not find the performance very bad. Such licences are, for example, the lengthening of a short syllable at the caesura, the position of final short vowels before 'st,' 'sp,' 'sc' at the beginning of the succeeding word, and the use of polysyllabic words, or of two dissyllables, at the end of the hexameter, so that lines such as these are not to be taken as irregular:

'Omnis et inde gradus a presule sanctificatus;'
'Quo minor est culpa, si cadat inde rea;'
'Et quia preuisa sic vota facit, puto culpa;'
'Si bene conseruet ordinis ipse statum.'

In any case it is certain that Gower expressed himself in Latin with great facility and with tolerable correctness. He may have imitated the style of Ovid 'studiosius quam felicius,' as Leland observes, but the comparison with other Latin verse-writers of his time sets his performance in a fairly favourable light.

VOX CLAMANTIS. ANALYSIS.

PROLOGUS LIBRI PRIMI.

From the records of the past we derive examples; and though credit be not commonly given to dreams, yet the writers of past time instruct us otherwise. Daniel and Joseph were taught by visions, and a man's guardian angel often warns him in his sleep. Hence, as it seems to me, my dreams should be recorded as signs of the times; and what my vision was and at what time it came, ye may learn from this book.

If ye desire to know the writer's name, add to *John* the beginning of *Godfrey*, the first letter of *Wales* and the word *ter* without its head. But give no praise to the author, for I write not with a view to fame. I shall write of strange things which my country has experienced, and as my matter is woful, so also shall be my song. My pen is wet with tears, and both my heart and my hand tremble; nor am I sufficient to write all the troubles that belong to the time. I ask for indulgence rather than praise: my will is good, though my powers fall short. I pray that while I sing of those true visions which disturb my heart with terror, he whose name I bear, to whom visions were revealed in Patmos, may control my work.

LIBER PRIMUS.

CAP. I. It was in the fourth year of king Richard, when the month was June: the moon had set and the morning-star had risen, when from the West a strange light sprang, the dawn came from the region of the setting sun and brought forth the day. The sun shone and all the earth was bright; Phebus went forth in his glorious car, attended by the four Seasons, Summer being nearest to him then and honoured by all creatures. The meadows were bright with flowers and the flocks sported in the fields, a perfect paradise of flowers and fruits was there, with the songs of multitudinous birds. Such was the day on which I wandered forth for my pleasure.

All things have an end, and at length that calm day had completed its appointed hours; evening came and I lay down to rest. The night came on, dark and gloomy as the day had been bright, and sleep did not visit my eyes. My hair stood on end, my flesh and my heart trembled and my senses were disturbed like water. I reflected what the cause might be of my sudden terror, and my mind wandered by various paths. The night went on, yet no

sleep came, and terror of a coming evil oppressed me. Thus I spent the hours of darkness, not knowing what was approaching, seeing the past and fearing for the future; but at length, towards dawn, sleep came upon my weary eyes, and I began to dream.

CAP. II. Methought I went out upon a Tuesday to gather flowers, and I saw people in bands going abroad over the fields. Suddenly the curse of God fell like lightning upon them, and they were changed into the forms of beasts, various bands into various forms.

One band was changed into asses rebellious against the halter and the burden, careering over the fields and demanding to be as horses; and these had also horns in the middle of their foreheads, which were stained with blood; they were swift as leopards in their leap, and had tails like that of a lion, yet the stolid asinine mind was in them still. I stood in terror and could advance no further.

CAP. III. With them came oxen, who refused any longer to be subject to the yoke and who would no longer eat straw. These too were in monstrous shape with feet like those of a bear and with the tails of dragons; they breathed forth fire and smoke like the bulls of Colchos. They devastated the fields and slew men: the plough, the rake and the mattock lay idle. 'Ah me!' I said, 'the cultivation of the fields will cease and famine will come upon us.'

CAP. IV. A third band I saw transformed into swine, furious and possessed by the devil. They followed one another, hog and hogling, boar and little pig, the sow and her companion, and there was no swine-herd to keep them away from the corn-fields. They wandered where they would, and the pig ravaged like a wolf.

One boar there was, whom Kent produced, such as the whole earth might not match. Flame came from his mouth and eyes, his tusks were like those of an elephant; foam mixed with human blood flowed over his flanks. He strikes down all those whom he meets and none can prevail against him: no place except heaven is safe from his rage. From the North comes another boar to meet him and to plan destruction.

These boars were greater and more furious than that of Tegea or that which Meleager hunted. They are not content with acorns for their food or

water for their drink; they devour rich food in the city and drink good wine, so that they lie in drunkenness as dead. They despise the pig-stye and defile kings' palaces with their filth: their grunting is like the roaring of a lion.

CAP. V. A fourth band was turned into dogs, who are not content with the food from their master's table, but range in search of better, who do not hunt hares or stags, but bark at the heels of men. Here are Cut and Cur from their wretched kennels, the sheep-dog and the watch-dog, the baker's, the butcher's, and the miller's dog. The one-eyed is there and the three-legged dog limps behind barking. These cannot be soothed by stroking, but bare their teeth in anger against you. They tear all whom they meet, and the more they devour the less they are satisfied. Cerberus in hell hears their howl, and breaking away from his chains he joins himself to their company and becomes their leader. More savage were these than the hounds which tore Acteon or the beast which Diana sent to destroy the Athenians. All trembled before them.

CAP. VI. Another band took the form of foxes and cats. They ran about and searched every cavern and every hiding-place, and made their way into secret chambers. There was venom in their bite. The caves of the wood send forth the foxes, who rob by day without fear, and have a treaty of peace with the dogs. The cats leave the barns and cease to catch mice, and these do damage more than ever did the mice of Ekron.

CAP. VII. A sixth took the form of domestic fowls, but they claimed to be birds of prey. The cock had the beak and claws of a falcon, and the goose soared up to the heaven. Suddenly the cock becomes a carrion-crow and the goose a kite, and they prey upon the carcasses of men. The cock crows horribly and the hen follows him and moves him to evil. The goose which formerly frightened only children with its hissing, now terrifies grown men and threatens to tear them to pieces.

Owls join themselves to these and do by day the deeds of darkness, sharpening their feathers with iron, in order that they may slay men.

CAP. VIII. The dream continued, and I saw another band in the form of flies and of frogs. These were like those that plagued Egypt: the frogs came into houses and shed their poison everywhere; the flies pursued with their stings all those of gentle blood, and nothing could keep them out. Their prince Belzebub was the leader of the host. The heat of the summer

produced them suddenly in swarms: the fly was more rapacious than the hawk and prouder than the peacock; he contended with the lark, the crane and the eagle in flight.

This was a day on which horses were overcome by asses, and lions by oxen, a day in which the dog was stronger than the bear and the cat than the leopard, a day in which the weak confounded the strong, a day in which slaves were raised on high and nobles brought to the ground, a day in which the terror of God's wrath came upon all, such a day as no chronicle records in time past. May such a day never come again in our age!

CAP. IX. When all this multitude was gathered together like the sand of the sea, one, a Jay skilled in speech, took the first place among them and addressed them thus: 'O wretched slaves, now comes the day in which the peasant shall drive out the lord; let honour, law and virtue perish, and let our court rule.' They listen and approve, and though they know not what 'our court' means, what he says has for them the force of law: if he says 'strike,' they strike, if he says 'kill,' they kill. Their sound was as the sound of the sea, and from terror I could scarcely move my feet. They strike a mutual compact and declare that all those of gentle blood who remain in the world shall be overthrown.

Then they advance all together; a dark cloud mingled with the furies of hell rains down evil into their hearts; the earth is wetted with the dew of the pit, so that no virtue can grow, but every vice increases. Satan is loose and among them, the princes of Erebus draw the world after them, and the more I gaze, the more I am terrified, not knowing what the end will be.

CAP. X. Furious rage there was, they were greedy for slaughter like hungry wolves. The seven races derived from Cain were added to them. The prophets spoke of them, Gog and Magog is their name, they neither fear man nor worship God. Moreover those companions of Ulysses, whom Circe transformed, are associated with them: some have the heads of men and others of brute beasts.

CAP. XI. There is Wat, Tom and Sim, Bet and Gib followed by Hick; Coll, Geff and Will, Grigge, Dawe, Hobbe and Lorkin, Hudd, Judd, Tebb and Jack, such are their names;⁶⁸ and Ball teaches them as a prophet, himself having been taught by the devil.

Some bray like asses, others bellow like bulls, they grunt, they bark, they howl, the geese cackle, the wasps buzz; the earth is terrified with their sound and trembles at the name of the Jay.

CAP. XII. They appoint heralds and leaders, and they order that all who do not favour them shall suffer death. They are armed with stakes and poles, old bows and arrows, rusty sickles, mattocks and forks; some have only clods and stones and branches of trees. They wet the earth with the blood of their betters.

CAP. XIII. These come in their fury to the city of new Troy, which opens its gates to them, and they surge in and invade the streets and houses. It was Thursday, the festival of Corpus Christi, when this fury attacked the city on all sides; they burnt the houses and slew the citizens. The Savoy burns, and the house of the Baptist falls to ruin in the flames. They rob and carry away the spoil, and that day is closed with drunkenness everywhere.

The next day, Friday, is yet worse; no wisdom or courage avails against them, they rage like a lioness robbed of her young. O, how degenerate is the city which allows this, how disgraceful that armed knights should give place to an unarmed mob! There is no Capaneus or Tydeus, no Ajax or Agamemnon, no Hector or Achilles, to make defence or attack. Ilion with its towers cannot keep men safe from the furies.

CAP. XIV. Helenus the chief priest, who kept the palladium of Troy, was slain in spite of his exhortations. These were deeds worthy rather of demons than of men. Piety and virtue perished and vice ran riot. They said 'Let his blood be upon our heads,' and slew him without pity: the curse of Christ shall fall upon them for this deed.

Simon had the same death as Thomas, but at the hands of greater numbers and for a different cause. Vengeance came for the death of Thomas; for Simon it daily threatens. It was midday when this blood was shed, the shepherd was slain by his flock, the father by his children. He died untimely; but though taken away from us, he lives in heaven. This is the foulest of all the deeds done: these men are worse than Cain, who only slew his brother. O cursed hand that struck the severed head! Wail for this, all ye old and young, the evils prophesied by Cassandra come down on this city. The king could not rescue Helenus, but he mourned for him in his heart.

CAP. XV. The chief citizens also perished, there was death and sorrow everywhere. If a son pleaded for his father, both were slain. No place of safety can be found by those of gentle condition; they flee to the forests in vain, and move vaguely hither and thither, neither city nor field affords them protection. Death is everywhere, and spares not even the women and the children. There is no remedy, and neither lamentation nor prayers are of any avail.

CAP. XVI. When I saw all this, horror seized me and I fled. I left my own house and wandered over the fields, I went from place to place in search of safety; the enemy pressed after me; I hid in caves of the woods, and was without hope at evening of what the morrow might bring. My dreams terrified me and my heart melted like wax in the fire. I lay hid during the day and trembled at every sound, the tears that I shed were my sole subsistence. I was alone and in terror of the wrath of God, my mind was sick and my body was wasted. Hardly ever did I meet a companion, and those friends whom I had trusted in prosperity failed me now. I dared scarcely speak a word, lest I should betray myself to an enemy.

Then, when I saw nothing but death about me, I desired to die, and yet I was unwilling to perish in so desolate a state. While I wept, lo, Wisdom came to me and bade me stop my tears, for grief would at some time cease. I stood amazed and in doubt; death was life to me and life was death, and wondrous visions passed before me.

CAP. XVII. I saw not far off a Ship, and I ran towards it and climbed up its side. In it were almost all those of gentle birth, crowded together and terrified, seeking refuge from the furies. I prayed that we might have a favourable voyage. The ship left the shore, but my hopes were vain: the sky grew dark and the winds lashed the waves into storm, the ship was driven before them amid thunder and rain. There was confusion among the sailors, and the captain in vain endeavoured to direct the ship's course.

CAP. XVIII. At length the storm so increased that all were in despair of safety. A huge monster of the sea, Scylla and Charybdis both in one, appeared as if to destroy the ship and all who were in it. We prayed to heaven for help.

(The Tower of London was like this ship, shaken by the storm, its walls giving way to the fury of the mob. In vain it offered hopes of safety; it was

stained with foul parricide, and the den of the leopard was captured by assault.)

When I saw these things I was terrified in my sleep, and I prayed to God for help. 'Thou Creator and Redeemer of the human race, thou who didst save Paul from the sea, Peter from prison and Jonah from the whale's belly, hear my prayer, I entreat thee. Help me and grant that I may be cast up on a favourable shore!'

As I prayed, the monster struck the ship, and it was almost swallowed up by the fury of Scylla.

CAP. XIX. Yet our cries and tears were not unheard. When the storm raged most furiously, there was one William, a Mayor, who was moved to high deeds: he struck down that proud Jay, and with his death the storm abated, Scylla restored its prey, and the ship once more rode upright upon the water. The sailors regained their courage and hoisted a little sail, peace returned and the sky became clear. I then with all the rest gave thanks to Christ.

CAP. XX. Still my dream went on, and still I seemed to see that ship, which now with broken oars was drifting in search of a landing-place. It was driven to that port where all this evil raged; it had escaped Scylla, but it came to an Island more dangerous than Scylla. I landed, and asked one of those whom I met, 'What island is this, and why is there so great a concourse of people here?' He replied: 'This is called the Island of Brute, and the men who dwell here are of fair form but of savage condition. This people lays law and justice low by violence; strife and bloodshed reign here ever. Yet if they could love one another, no better people would there be from the rising to the setting of the sun.'

I was saddened and terrified by his answer, I knew not whether sea or land were more to be feared. The heavenly voice which I had heard before said to me, 'Lament not, but take heed to thyself. Thou hast come to a place where wars abound, but do thou seek peace within by God's assistance. Be cautious and silent; but when thou hast leisure, record these dreams of thine, for dreams often give a presage of the future.' The voice was heard no more, and at that moment the cock crew and I awoke from my sleep, scarce knowing whether what I had seen was within me or without.

CAP. XXI. Then I returned thanks to God for having preserved me upon the sea and from the jaws of Scylla. The rustic goes back to his labours, but in his heart there remains hatred of his lords; therefore let us be forewarned and provide against future evils. As for me, God has set me free from the danger, and for this I thank him; and I would that my country, preserved from destruction, might render due thanks to God. While the memory of these things is fresh in me, I will write that which I experienced in my sleep, that waking slumber which brought to me no mere vision but a dream of reality.

PROLOGUS LIBRI SECUNDI.

Many things did I see and note, which my pen shall write, but first I invoke, not the Muses, but the true Spirit of God, and I will let down my nets in the name of Christ and for his glory. The style and the verses are poor, but the meaning is good. I will give that which my poor faculties can attain to; and may he be my helper who produced speech from the mouth of an ass. I prefer to do a little good than none.

The words which follow are not spoken from myself; they are gathered from various sources, as honey from various flowers or bright shells from various shores. The name of the book is *Vox Clamantis*, because it is the utterance of a fresh sorrow.

LIBER SECUNDUS.

CAP. I. Tears shall be the ink with which I write. All is vanity except the love of God, and man has cause for lamentation from his birth.

Yet if any people in the world could be happy, God granted this boon to us; we were blessed above all other nations. Now our former glory is extinguished and our prosperity is destroyed.

Why is our condition thus changed? Nothing on earth happens without a cause, yet all deny that they are the cause of this and find fault with Fortune, who turns all things upside down.

CAP. II. O thou who art called Fortune, why dost thou thus depress those whom thou didst once exalt? Once our country was everywhere honoured, all desired to be at peace with it: now our glory has departed and enemies attack us from all quarters. Reply, Fortune, and say if thou art the cause of

this change. I think not, for I believe in God and not in Fortune; yet I will describe thee, as men think that thou art.

CAP. III. Fortune, hear what men say of thee, that thou hast a double face, and goest by double paths, that nothing in thee is stable or secure. No gifts may keep thee faithful, thou art lighter than the dead leaves which fly before the wind: now thou art bright and fair, now dark and lowering; thy love is more treacherous than that of a harlot, the prosperity which thou givest is very near to disaster.

CAP. IV. Fortune gives no honey without gall, she changes like the sphere of the moon. Her wheel is ever turning, and no tears or prayers will move her. Citizen and husbandman, king and rustic, rich and poor, all are alike to her. Ah! why was so much power given to such a one as she is?

Thus men say, believing that Fortune can overthrow the decrees of God, but in fact she is nothing, fate is nothing, chance has nothing to do with the affairs of men. Each one makes for himself his own lot: if the will is good, good fortune follows, if evil, it makes the fortune bad. Virtue will lead you to the summit of the wheel, and vice will bring you and your fortune down to the bottom.

CAP. V. God has said that the man who obeys his commands shall prosper in wealth and peace: the very elements are subject to the righteous man. Joshua caused the sun to stand still, Gregory stayed the plague, Moses divided the sea, Elisha caused iron to swim, the three children were unhurt by the fire, the earth rose to give a seat to Hilarius. Wild animals, too, serve the just man, witness Daniel, Silvester, Moses and Jonah.

CAP. VI. Again, the elements war against sinners: so it was in the case of the plague caused by David's sin, in the case of the Sodomites, Korah, Dathan and Abiram, Lysias and others. The wicked man cannot enjoy good fortune, nor can the good man be deprived of it. It was guilt that caused the fall of Pharaoh and of Saul, the death of Ahab and of Eli with his sons. The Jews always conquered while they were obedient to God's law, and were overcome when they transgressed it.

CAP. VII. It is God Omnipotent, the Three in One, who governs all things here. As fire, heat and motion are three things combined in one, so the Father, Son and Holy Spirit are three persons but one Godhead.

CAP. VIII. Christ, the Son of the Father, became incarnate in man, and yet remained what he was before, being less than the Father and yet equal to him, perfect Man and perfect God. As the frailty of the first Adam brought evil upon us all, so the strength of the second Adam healed our wound and restored our fallen state.

CAP. IX. We must submit our mind to the faith, for man cannot understand the things of God, and we must not examine too closely the mystery which we cannot penetrate. This we know, that life is given to all through the name of Jesus Christ.

CAP. X. The heathen bows down to figures of wood and stone, asking help from that which his hands have made. Was not the world made for man and all things placed in subjection to him? How then can these idols be of any avail?

As for us, we use images differently, not giving to them the worship that belongs to God, but by them assisting devotion; especially the sign of the Cross is to be adored, by means of which we conquer the powers of evil. Great is the virtue of the Cross, by which Christ despoiled hell of its prey and ascended into heaven.

CAP. XI. God created the heaven and the earth, and all created things ought to serve him. As he creates all things, so also he rules them continually, and he gives his gifts according to men's merit. Whatever comes to pass in the world, whether it be good or evil, we are the cause of it.

PROLOGUS LIBRI TERCII.

Since good and bad fortune are due to the merits and demerits of men, I shall examine the various conditions of men and find out where the fault lies. I shall utter not so much my own words as the common report of others, and it must be remembered that he who finds fault with the bad is in effect praising the good. May God assist me to carry out my task! My abilities are small, and I do not affect high themes, but I speak of the evils which the common voice of humanity bewails. Let no envy or calumny attack my work; and do thou, O Christ, grant that I may avoid falsehood and flattery. With this prayer I enter on my voyage.

LIBER TERCIVS.

CAP. I. The order of the world is in three degrees,—Clergy, Knighthood and Peasantry. I shall deal first with the prelates of the Church, whose practice is very far removed from the example of Christ. Riches alone are valued by them, and the poor man is despised, whatever may be his merits.

CAP. II. Prelates of the Church are now hirelings, whose desire is to live in luxury and to indulge their appetites. Gluttony and lust everywhere prevail.

CAP. III. The prelates of the Church aim at earthly honours instead of heavenly: they desire rather to have the pre-eminence than to do good. Powerful men escape without rebuke for their sins, and penance is avoided by payment.

CAP. IV. As regards the ‘positive law,’ for breach of which dispensations are granted, I ask first whether Christ gives indulgence beforehand for sin, or prohibits that which is not sin. If these things are sins, how can I be free to commit them on consideration of a money payment; if not, why does the Church forbid them? This is merely a device for bringing in money to the clergy.

CAP. V. The poison of temporal possessions is still working in the Church. They no longer war on the pagan, but turn their swords against their own brother Christians.

CAP. VI. Christ left peace with his disciples, but in our time avarice and ambition cause prelates to take part in intestine strife, with swords in their hands and the cross as their ensign. It is not the part of a soldier to offer incense at the altar or of a priest to bear arms in war.

CAP. VII. The priest should fight with other than material arms. David was not permitted to build a house for the Lord, because he had been a shedder of blood; and those who are stained with the slaughter of their brethren cannot be the true servants of the altar. Brotherly love should prevail, and this is opposed to strife and self-seeking ambition.

CAP. VIII. Worldly men may make wars, but the clergy should not take part in them; their strength is in their words and prayers, and they have no need of material arms. Too great prosperity and wealth is the cause of these evils: they do not see what the end will be.

CAP. IX. The ring and the pastoral staff belong to the Pope, the sceptre to the Emperor; the one must not usurp the rights of the other. The Emperor should not claim spiritual power, nor the Pope temporal. Christ is a lover of peace and his ministers must not appeal to the sword, but must keep the command, 'Thou shalt not kill.' Let Christ himself lay claim to what is his. Pride is the root of all evil.

The apostles conquered by prayers and by patience; Peter had neither silver nor gold, but he healed the lame man; our clergy abound in wealth, but do no works of healing, either spiritual or bodily. O thou who art head of the Church, remember that forgiveness should be until seventy times seven, and that Peter was commanded by Christ to put up his sword.

CAP. X. The teaching and the writings of the clergy are in favour of peace and love, and when I wondered why they waged wars, one answered me in the person of the supreme pontiff and said: 'Rule on earth is given to us by divine decree and it pleases us to enjoy all the good things of this world. Our way is different from that of Christ and his apostles; we set up the cross as a sign of hatred and vengeance, we put to death those who will not acknowledge our rule; the pastoral staff is turned into a spear and the mitre into a helmet, we can slay with sword as well as with word, and whereas Peter cut off the ears, we cut off the head.'

CAP. XI. These claim the worship and honour which belong to God alone, and the goods which they unjustly seize are never restored. The shepherd preys like a wolf upon his own sheep.

CAP. XII. He who is promoted to dignity in the Church by simony is like the thief who enters not by the door into the sheepfold. The Church is a congregation of faithful men, and the clergy are no better than the laity, except so far as they lead better lives. Yet they lay burdens upon us which they will not bear themselves, and do not follow their own precepts. They bear the keys of heaven, but they neither enter themselves nor allow us to enter: they set no good example to their flocks.

CAP. XIII. A prelate should be a light to guide his people by example, and he should encourage them by his voice, and also reprove and restrain. The oil with which he is anointed is a type of the qualities that he ought to display.

CAP. XIV. At the Court of Rome nothing can be done without gifts: the poor man is everywhere rejected. The spirit of Antichrist is opposite to that of Christ, and there are many signs that he has already come.

CAP. XV. Our prelates aim at the mere outward show of sanctity and refuse to bear the burden of Christ. O God, in thy mercy restore them to the state which they have lost!

CAP. XVI. Rectors of parishes, too, err after the example of the prelates. They are luxurious in their lives, and many desert their spiritual cures, in order to frequent courts and great households, with a view to promotion.

CAP. XVII. Another gets leave from the bishop to leave his parish on the plea of study at the universities; but there he learns and teaches only lessons of unchastity. The Church, which is his true bride, is neglected, and harlots receive the tithe which belongs to God.

CAP. XVIII. A third rector resides in his parish, but spends his time in sports, keeps well-fed horses and dogs, while the poor are not relieved or the sick visited, makes his voice heard more in the fields and woods than in the church. He lays snares too for the women of his parish, and if their bodies be fair, he cares not how their souls are defiled.

CAP. XIX. Another neglects his cure of souls and makes money by buying and selling. He is liberal of his wealth to none but women; and if benefices were inherited by the children of those who hold them, the succession would seldom fail.

CAP. XX. The priests without benefices, who get their living by 'annuals,' are equally bad: the harlot and the tavern consume their gains. Let none admit these to his house, who desires to keep his wife chaste, anymore than he would admit pigeons to his bed-chamber, if he wished to keep it clean.

CAP. XXI. These infect the laity by their bad example. The bishop ought not to ordain such men; and he who might prevent an evil and does not, is equally guilty with him who causes it.

CAP. XXII. The clergy deny the right of laymen to judge and punish them; yet the sins of the clergy deeply affect the laity. We are all brethren in Christ and we are bidden to rebuke our brethren, if they do wrong, and to cast them out of the Church, if they will not amend.

CAP. XXIII. Priests say that in committing fornication they do not sin more than other men who are guilty of this vice. But their sacred condition and their vow of chastity makes the evil worse in them than in a cobbler or a shepherd.

CAP. XXIV. If we consider the office of the priesthood, we shall find that the vestments and ornaments of priests are all symbolical of the virtues which they ought to possess.

CAP. XXV. The ceremonies of sacrifices under the old law were symbols of the virtues required in priests under the new, and as under the old dispensation the ministers of the altar ought to be without defect and deformity of body, so the priests of the new law should be spiritually free from blemish. Uzzah touched the ark with unclean hands and was punished with death: so he who comes polluted to the service of the altar is worthy of punishment.

CAP. XXVI. A man must be of mature age before he assumes the priesthood; for youth is apt to yield to the temptations of the flesh. The evil impulses cannot be wholly expelled, but they may be kept in check, as is symbolized by the tonsure of the priest. Let the priest avoid idleness, whence so many vices spring.

CAP. XXVII. The honour of priests is great, if they live worthily. They administer to us the sacraments during our lives, they give us burial when we are dead, they are the salt of the earth and the light of the world. So much the worse is it when they are ignorant and bad; the distinction between the good and the bad priest is like that between the dove and the raven sent out of the ark.

CAP. XXVIII. The young scholars who are being trained for the priesthood are in these days too often indolent and vicious. If they are so in youth, they will hardly be good in their later age.

CAP. XXIX. They are induced to undertake the priesthood by desire to escape from the control of the ordinary law, by dislike of labour, and by love of good living, seldom by the higher motive, which once prevailed, of contempt for worldly things and longing after the highest good. Thus, since the clergy is without the light of virtue, we laymen wander in the dark.

LIBER QUARTUS.

CAP. I. Men of Religious Orders are also of various conditions, some good and others bad. Let each bear his own burden of blame: I write only what common report tells me.

There are first those who hold temporal possessions, and some of these live in gluttony and luxury.

CAP. II. Those who leave the world should give up worldly things; but in these days the monk is known only by his garb. He indulges himself with the richest food and the choicest drink, he makes haste when the bell rings for a meal, but he rises very slowly and reluctantly for midnight prayer. The monks of old were different; they dwelt in caves and had no luxurious halls or kitchens, they were clothed in skins, fed on herbs and drank water, and abstained from fleshly lusts. These men truly renounced the world, but that blessed state has now perished.

CAP. III. The old monastic rule has given place to gluttony and drunkenness, and those who live so can hardly be chaste. Pride, anger and envy prevail among these men, in spite of the restrictions of their rule.

CAP. IV. There is no brotherly love among them, and the vow of individual poverty is also broken. They make money in various ways and spend it on their pleasures and in enriching their children, whom they call their nephews.

CAP. V. A monk wandering abroad from his cloister is like a fish out of water; nor are those much better who stay within the walls and allow their minds to dwell on worldly things.

CAP. VI. Some seek honour and dignity under the cover of the monastic profession, even though they be of poor and low birth.

CAP. VII. Patience, Chastity and the rest who were once brothers of religious orders, are now dead or departed, and their contrary vices have taken their places.

CAP. VIII. So also the regular Canons for the most part neglect their monastic rule and have only a show of sanctity.

CAP. IX. Monks who are untrue to their profession are of all men the most unhappy. They have no real enjoyment of this world and they lose also the joys of heaven.

CAP. X. Let all members of religious orders perform their vows and repent of their past sins, of their pride, luxury, avarice, ambition, gluttony, wrath, envy and strife.

CAP. XI. Above all let them avoid intercourse with women, who bring death to their souls. Let them labour and study; for idleness is the great incentive to evil.

CAP. XII. The monk who sets himself to observe his rule will live hardily and fast often, praying continually and doing penance for sin. He will submit himself humbly to his prior, and he will not grudge to perform duties that are irksome. The prior should be gentle with his younger brethren and not make the yoke too heavy for them.

CAP. XIII. As regards nuns, they too are under the rule of chastity; but as women are more frail by nature than men, they must not be so severely punished if they break it. They require meat often on Fridays for their stomachs' sake, and this is prepared for them by Genius the priest of Venus.

CAP. XIV. Where Genius is the confessor of a convent, the laws of the flesh prevail. The priest who visits nuns too often corrupts them, and the woman very easily yields to temptation. A wife may deceive her husband, but the bride of Christ cannot conceal her unfaithfulness from him: therefore she above all others should be chaste.

CAP. XV. True virginity is above all praise, and this surpasses every other condition, as a rose surpasses the thorns from which it springs. The best kind of virginity is that which is vowed to God.

CAP. XVI. Not all whom Christ chose were faithful, and everywhere bad and good are mingled together; but the fault of the bad is not a reason for condemning the good. So when I speak of the evil deeds of Friars, I condemn the bad only and absolve the good.

The number of mendicant friars is too great and their primitive rule has been forgotten. They pretend to be poor, but in fact they possess all things, and have power over the pope himself. Both life and death bring in gains to them.

CAP. XVII. They preach hypocritically against sin in public, but in private they encourage it by flattery and indulgence. They know that their gains depend upon the sins which their penitents commit. Friars do not

often visit places where gain is not to be got. They have an outward appearance of poverty and sanctity, without the reality. I do not desire that they should be altogether suppressed, but that they should be kept under due discipline.

CAP. XVIII. Some friars aim at dignity as masters in the schools, and then they are exempted from their rule and obtain entry into great houses. The influence of the friar is everywhere felt, and often he supplies the place of the absent husband and is the father of his children. Bees, when they wound, lose their stings and are afterwards helpless: would it were so with the adulterous friar!

CAP. XIX. The order of friars is not necessary to the Church. Friars appropriate spiritual rights which belong to others; and though this may be by dispensation of the pope, yet we know that the pope does not grant such dispensations of his own motion, and he may be deceived. They ask for the cure of souls, but in fact they are demanding worldly wealth: not so did Francis make petition, but he left all and endured poverty.

CAP. XX. This multitude of friars is not necessary for the good of society. David says of them that they neither take part in the labours of men nor endure the rule of the law: they toil not, neither do they spin, and yet the world feeds them. It is vain for them to plead the merits of Francis, when they do not follow his example. All honour to those who do as he did.

CAP. XXI. They draw into their order not grown men but mere boys. Francis was not a boy when he assumed his work; but in these days mere children are enrolled, caught like birds in a snare: and as they are deceived themselves, so afterwards they deceive others.

CAP. XXII. The friar who transgresses the rule of his order is an apostate and a follower of the apostate fiend. He finds entrance everywhere, and everywhere he lays snares, encourages hatred, and fosters impurity. Under a veil of virtuous simplicity he conceals a treacherous heart. These are ministers of the Synagogue rather than of the Church, children of Hagar, not of Sara.

CAP. XXIII. They are dispersed over the world like the Jews, and everywhere they find ease and abundance. Their churches and their houses are built in the most costly style and adorned with the richest ornaments. No

king has chambers more magnificent than theirs, and their buildings are a mark of their worldly pride. Unless their souls are fair within, this outward pomp of religion is of no avail.

CAP. XXIV. Friars differ from one another in the garb of their order, but all equally neglect their rule. Only the order founded by brother Burnel still maintains its former state. Two rules of this order I will set forth, which are almost everywhere received. The first is that what the flesh desires, that you may have; and the second that whatever the flesh shrinks from, that you should avoid. So the new order of Burnel is thought better than those of Benedict or Bernard.

Thus, if bad times come, I shall hold that the error of the Clergy is the cause. The body is nothing without the spirit: we have darkness instead of light, death instead of life, and the flock is scattered abroad without a shepherd.

LIBER QUINTUS.

CAP. I. I will speak in the second place of the order of Knighthood. This was established first to defend the Church, then for the good of the community, and thirdly to support the cause of the widow and orphan. If a knight performs these duties, he should have praise, but not if he makes war merely for the sake of glory.

If a knight overcomes his enemies, but is overcome by the love of a woman, he has no true glory, for he makes himself a slave instead of free.

CAP. II. If the knight would reflect on the variety and uncertainty of love, he would not allow himself so easily to be made captive.

CAP. III. But when he sees beauty in woman decked out with all its charms, he thinks it divine and marvellous, and he can offer no effectual resistance. Lovers are blind and are driven by every kind of unreasonable impulse. Women deceive men, and men also deceive and betray women.

CAP. IV. The knight has little need to fear bodily wounds, which may easily be healed; but love is not to be cured by physicians, and this deprives him both of reason and of honour.

CAP. V. Those who seek fame and worldly honours only, are hardly better than those who are conquered by women.

CAP. VI. The good woman is one whose praise is above all things. The bad is a subtle snare for the destruction of men. She paints her face and uses every art to deceive. The world is treacherous, but woman is more treacherous still.

CAP. VII. The good knight, who labours neither for gain nor for glory, and is not conquered by love, obtains the victory over the enemies of the Church and of his country, and gives us the blessing of peace.

CAP. VIII. The bad knight is the causer of many evils in the other orders of society. He deserves to have Leah, not Rachel, as his bride. Those who follow wars for the sake of the spoils are like vultures that prey upon the corpses of the dead. Alas, in these days gold is preferred to honour and the world to God.

CAP. IX. Another estate remains, that of the cultivators of the soil, who provide sustenance for the human race in accordance with the divine ordinance laid down for Adam. These at the present time are lazy and grasping, as well as few in number; one peasant now asks more wages than two did in past time, and one formerly did as much work as three do now. We know from recent experience what evil the peasant is capable of doing. God has ordained, however, that nothing is to be had without toil; therefore the peasant must labour, and if he will not, he must be compelled.

CAP. X. There are also the casual labourers, who go from one employment to another and always find fault with the food that they get from their masters. These are irrational like beasts, and they should be disciplined by fear of punishment.

CAP. XI. In cities there are chiefly two classes, the merchants and the craftsmen. The former sin by not regarding festivals and holy days.

CAP. XII. Usury and Fraud are two sisters, daughters of Avarice, to whom the dwellers in cities pay honour. Usury is forbidden of old, but by a gloss on the text it is now approved.

CAP. XIII. Fraud is worse, because it is common to all places. From the young apprentice to the master all practise it in selling.

CAP. XIV. Craftsmen, who make things, follow the laws of Fraud, and so do those who sell articles of food, as meat, fish, bread, beer and so on.

CAP. XV. It is an ill bird that fouls its own nest, and it is shameful for a citizen to benefit strangers at the expense of his fellow-citizens. It is an evil thing when one of low condition is exalted to the highest place in the city. The evil man is a common scourge; but though he be mounted on high, he shall fall and perish.

CAP. XVI. The man whose tongue is unrestrained is as a pestilence among the people. The tongue causes strife and many evils; it breaks through every guard and devours like a flame. None can say how many evils the tongue of the talkative man brings about in the city: it causes discord and hatred instead of peace and love; and where peace and love are not, there God is not. The citizen who thus plagues his fellows should be put to death or banished: it is expedient that one should die, lest the whole people should perish.

Thou ruler of the city, labour to bring about harmony and peace, and above all deal prudently. Great consequences often follow from small things, and the fire which seems to be extinguished may blaze up again. Justice and peace, which formerly reigned, must be restored, so that the ruin which overtook Rome and Athens may be averted from our city.

LIBER SEXTUS.

CAP. I. Besides the three degrees of society above described, there are those who are called ministers of the Law. Of these some labour for true law and justice, and these I praise; but most practise an art under the name of law which perverts justice. The advocate will plead the cause of any man who pays him, and compels his rich neighbours to give him gifts, for fear that evil should befall them. He has a thousand ways of making his gains; the great and powerful break through his snares, but the weak and defenceless are caught in them. Like the bat or the owl he loves darkness rather than light: yet sometimes the biter is bitten.

CAP. II. The advocate oppresses and plunders the poor, and rejoices in discord as a physician in disease. He contrives every device to enrich himself and his offspring; he joins house to house and field to field. But his heir dissipates that which he has gathered together, and a curse comes upon him at the last.

CAP. III. The land is ruined by the excessive number of lawyers. As a straight stick appears crooked when plunged in water, so does straightforward and simple law become distorted in the mind of the lawyer. As clouds conceal the sun, so do advocates obscure the clear light of the law. Conspiracy, they say, is unlawful, but they themselves conspire to protect one another, and the law has no power over these.

CAP. IV. They ascend by degrees from the rank of apprentice to that of serjeant and so to the office of judge. The administration of justice is disturbed chiefly by three things, gifts, favour, and fear. Those who make friends with the judge will hardly lose their case.

CAP. V. O ye who sell justice for gain, learn what end awaits you. The higher you rise, the greater will be your fall: the more wealth you gather, the greater will be your misery. O thou judge who seekest after wealth, why dost thou attend to all things else and neglect thyself? Thou wilt gain the world, but lose heaven. All worldly power comes to an end, and so, be sure, will thine.

CAP. VI. As regards the sheriffs, the bailiffs, and the jurymen at assizes, they are ready to accept bribes and pervert justice. As the toad cursed the harrow, so I curse these many masters, who are all unjust.

CAP. VII. Laws, nevertheless, there must be, to punish the transgressor; and if there are laws there must also be judges. The worst of evils is when justice is not to be had, and this causes a land to be divided against itself. Much depends upon the ruler: for the sins of a bad king the people are punished as well as the king himself. The higher a man's place is, the worse is the effect of his evil-doing. A law is nothing without people, or people without a king, or a king without good counsel. ⁶⁹ Complaints are everywhere heard now of the injustice of the high court, and the limbs suffer because the head is diseased. The king is an undisciplined youth, who neglects all good habits, and chooses unworthy companions, by whose influence he is made worse. At the same time older men give way to him for gain and pervert the justice of the king's court. None can tell what the end will be: I can only mourn over these evils and offer my counsel to the youthful king.

CAP. VIII. Every subject is bound to serve his king, and the king to govern his people justly. Hence I shall endeavour to set forth a rule of

conduct for the honour of my king.

First then, I say, govern thyself according to the law, and enforce on thyself the precepts that are fitting for others. A king is above all others; he should endeavour to overcome and rise above himself. If thou art above the laws, live the more justly. Be gentle in thy acts, for thy wrath is death. Endeavour to practise virtue in thy youth and to avoid evil communications.

CAP. IX. Avoid false friends and those who stir up war for the sake of their own profit. Resist those who will tempt thee to evil, O king. Take vengeance on wrong, and let justice be done without fear or favour.

CAP. X. Show mercy also, where mercy is fitting, and listen to the prayer of the poor and helpless. Let fit men of proper age and sufficient wisdom be appointed to administer justice.

CAP. XI. Be not exalted with vain glory, O king, or moved by sudden wrath to violence. Be liberal to those who need thy help, and give alms to the poor of that which God has given thee. Avoid gluttony and sloth.

CAP. XII. Above all things, O king, flee from the enticements of fleshly lusts. Take example by the sin of David, and by that of the Hebrews who were tempted by the counsel of Balaam. One consort is sufficient for thee: be faithful to her.

CAP. XIII. O king, thou art the defender in arms of thy people. Remember the deeds of thy father, whose praise is sounded everywhere and whose prowess was above that of Hector. He was just and liberal; he made prey of foreign lands, but he protected his own. France and Spain both felt his might, and he broke through the ranks of his enemies like a lion. The land was at rest under that great prince: the nation was secure from its enemies. O king, endeavour to deserve the praise which thy father won. Peace is the best of all things, but it must sometimes give way to war.

CAP. XIV. A king must not prey upon his people; their love is his chief glory. He should remember that true nobility does not come from noble descent but from virtue. Study to know thyself and to love God.

CAP. XV. O young king, remember how Solomon in his youth asked for wisdom to rule well, rather than wealth or long life, and how God granted his prayer and added also the other blessings. Wisdom is above everything for a king, and this makes him acceptable to God.

CAP. XVI. Whatever thou hast, O king, comes from God. He has given thee beauty of body, and thou must see to it that there be virtue of the soul corresponding to this. Worship and fear God, for earthly kingdoms are as nothing compared with his.

CAP. XVII. Death makes all equal; rich and poor, king and subject, all go one way. Prepare thyself, therefore, for thy journey, and adorn thyself betimes with virtue. May God direct thee in the right way.

CAP. XVIII. ⁷⁰The king is honoured above all, so long as his acts are good, but if the king be avaricious and proud, the people is grieved. Not all that a king desires is expedient for him: he has a charge laid upon him and must maintain law and do justice.

O king, do away the evils of thy reign, restore the laws and banish crime: let thy people be subject to thee for love and not for fear.

CAP. XIX. All things change and die, the gems that were bright are now dimmed, the Church herself has lost her virtue, and the Synagogue becomes the spouse of Christ. The good men of old have passed away, and the bad of old live again. Noah, Japhet, Abraham, Isaac, Joseph, Moses, Aaron, Elijah, Micaiah, Elisha are gone; Nimrod, Ham, Belus, Ishmael, Abiram, Korah, Dathan, Zedekiah, and Gehazi survive. Peter is dead, but Tiberius lives; Paul is reconverted into Saul; the examples of Gregory, Martin, Tobit, and Job are neglected. Benedict is dead, but Julian lives: there is a new Arius, a new Jovinian, who spread their heresy.

CAP. XX. As the good men in the Church of God have passed away, so also the men who were famed for prowess in the world are gone, as Trajan, Justinian, Alexander, Constantine, Theodosius, Julius, Hannibal, while the bad still survive, as Nero, Dionysius, Tarquin, Leo, and Constantius. Solomon is dead and Rehoboam survives. The love of David and Jonathan is gone, but the hatred of Saul still lives; the counsel of Achitophel is followed and that of Hushai rejected; Cato is banished and Pilate is made judge in his stead; Mordecai is hanged and Haman is delivered; Christ is crucified and Barabbas is let go free.

CAP. XXI. Temperance and chastity also have disappeared. Socrates and Diogenes are dead, Epicurus and Aristippus still live; Phirinus is dead and Agladius survives; Troilus and Medea are dead, while Jason and Criseida

remain; Penelope and Lucretia have passed away, Circe and Calipso still live. The laws of marriage are no longer kept in these days, chaste love is all but unknown, and adultery everywhere prevails. Women have no modesty, no chastity, and no patience: vice blooms and flourishes, while the flower of virtue is trodden under foot.

LIBER SEPTIMUS.

CAP. I. Now the golden head of Nebuchadnezzar's statue is gone, and the feet of iron and clay remain: the world is in its final stage of deterioration. There are principally two causes, lechery, which leads to sloth, and avarice, which is ever unsatisfied.

CAP. II. The avaricious are merciless to the poor, and their hard hearts are typified by the iron of the statue. He is wretched who is ever desiring more, not he who has little and is content.

CAP. III. The fragile clay signifies the frailty of our flesh, which shows itself in fornication and adultery. There is also hypocrisy everywhere, which conceals the foulness within by a fair show without. Yet it will not escape detection.

CAP. IV. Things that were good are now changed into the opposite forms, truth into falsehood, wisdom into folly, love into lust, learned into ignorant; servants are become masters and masters servants. Nothing pleases now but flattery. Courts do not keep their former honour: knights there are in plenty, but little valour. Weakness grows and strength is depressed, there is much talk but little action, the burdens of war without the advantages. Justice has departed and fraud has taken its place; even those of one family feel envy and hatred one against another. Friendship is treacherous and seeks gain like a harlot: hatred is everywhere common, but love is as the phenix. There is no faith anywhere, and the right hand cannot trust the left. All cry out against the world and say that it is growing worse and worse.

CAP. V. The world is indeed full of evil and impurity, and this life is a perpetual warfare, in which all that is good perishes and all that is evil prevails. Even the elements of the world change and pass away, and much more human things. No degree is exempted: the hearts of kings are

disturbed by fear of change, and terrors prevail in spite of royal banquets and bodyguards.

CAP. VI. Man was created for the service of God, and the world was given for his use. He was made in the image of God, and he learnt gradually the purpose of his creation and to love his Creator.

CAP. VII. All things were put under his feet, and were made to minister to him. He ought therefore to remember whence he is and who gave him these things. Again, when by man's sin the race of man was corrupted, the Creator himself restored and redeemed it, taking the form of a servant. Man ought therefore to confess him as Lord and follow his precepts with a devout mind.

CAP. VIII. Man is a microcosm or lesser world, and according as he does ill or well, the greater world is good or bad. Man ought therefore to aim at high things, and not to submit himself to the rule of sin.

CAP. IX. When death comes, when the throat is dry and the face bloodless, when the eyes are fixed and the tongue silent, when the pulse beats no more and the feet can no longer move, what then will the proud man say? The body in which he prided himself is now food for worms, his strength is less than that of a fly, and his beauty is turned into loathing. His wealth and his pomp avail him no longer, the serpent is his attendant and the charnel-house is his bed-chamber.

CAP. X. The envious man, who once gnawed upon others, is now himself devoured: he who laughed at the misfortunes of others, laughs now no more; the heart that so much murmured now suffers putrefaction; the sting of envy can pierce no more.

CAP. XI. He who was full of anger, now cannot move his head; he who uttered furious words, now cannot make a sound; he who terrified others by his threats, now does not scare away the worm which eats his heart.

CAP. XII. What can avarice do for him who has served her? He has no chest but his coffin, no land but the seven feet of earth in which he lies. He who preyed upon others, is himself the prey of death; he who closed his purse against the poor, is now himself in want.

CAP. XIII. The slothful man who was given to sleep, has now abundance of it, with the cold earth instead of his soft bed-coverings. He who seldom

came to the church, now never leaves it, but his time for prayer is past.

CAP. XIV. Gluttony is no longer a pleasure; the body which delighted in choice food and drink is now full of vileness and horror, the abode of foul reptiles.

CAP. XV. The man who took pleasure in lechery, delights in it now no more. His members are preyed upon by the serpent, and he can no longer use his hands, his eyes, or his tongue in the service of lust. No longer can he commit incest or violate the honour of virginity.

CAP. XVI. Answer, thou sinful man, what will thy pride do for thee then, thy envy, thy anger, thy sloth, thy gluttony, thy lechery, or thy avarice? All the glory of this world perishes and passes away.

CAP. XVII. Everything passes away, wealth, honour, beauty, power, learning, and pleasure. Our flesh grows old as a garment and we perish. He is happy and a true king who rules himself, he is a slave (though called a king) who is subject to his own vices. Our life is so short and death comes so soon, that we ought all to prepare for our journey hence. Death comes when we least expect it, and takes away our wealth and strength, nor can any man redeem himself with gold, or move with gifts the Judge who judges all things justly.

CAP. XVIII. Death is common to all, but to the good it is a cause of joy, to the evil of sorrow. The good will pass by means of death to a place of perfect peace and perfect joy, such as cannot be described or imagined.

CAP. XIX. The evil-doer has a twofold death, the death of the body and the death of the soul. No words can tell the torment of that second death, which is eternal. How terrible will the Judgement be and how direful the sentence! Happy are they who shall escape such punishment.

CAP. XX. Let each man remember what his condition is, and let him repent in time, turning himself to the service of his Creator. Let him submit to punishment in this life, that he may escape that which is eternal: for it is the property of God to forgive and to have mercy.

CAP. XXI. Almost everyone, however, follows the lusts of his flesh and neglects the cause of his soul. The unrighteous have power everywhere, and all vices flourish.

CAP. XXII. The days are coming which Christ foretold, and the signs which he predicted are visible now. God's sentence is still delayed, in order that the sinner may have room for repentance. Hardly even a few just men are found to save the world from destruction.

CAP. XXIII. Each one of the various degrees of society has departed from its true virtue, and the deadly vices have rule over the whole. Prelates are worldly, priests unchaste, scholars lazy, monks envious and self-indulgent, knights are evil liver, merchants defraud, peasants are disobedient and proud. The enticements of the world have overcome them all.

CAP. XXIV. I love all the realms of Christendom, but most of all I love this land in which I was born. From other lands I stand apart and am not involved in their calamities; but this country of mine, which brought me up from childhood and in which I dwell, cannot suffer evil without affecting me: by its burdens I am weighed down; if it stands, I stand, if it falls, I fall. Therefore it is that I bewail its present divisions.

One thing above all things is needful, and that is justice, with which is associated peace. If in other lands the sins of the flesh prevail, yet there they are to some extent compensated; for there justice prevails and all are equal before the law. Among us, however, not only is there carnal vice, but justice is absent; so that a terrible vengeance is being prepared for us by God.

We, who have always been favoured by fortune, are now brought low; this land, which was once reputed so wealthy, is now poor both in virtue and in possessions; my country, which was so strong, is made feeble by unjust judgements; she who was so fertile, is now sown with salt; she who had Fame for her sister, is now infamous, all her praise is taken away and her glory is departed. Her lords are sunk in sloth, her clergy is dissolute, her cities full of discord, her laws oppressive and without justice, her people discontented.

O land barren of virtue, where is thy past fortune? omens appear which presage thy fate, and all point to thee as an example. It is not by fortune or by chance that this comes about, but by our sins; and the grace of God even now may be found by repentance. I pray that God may show us his mercy and accept our tears. We know that thou, O God, art alone to be

worshipped, that thou art the ruler of all things, and not fortune. Show pity therefore, O God!

CAP. XXV. Such were the verses which came to me by inspiration in my sleep. It is not I who speak them, but the common voice of all. Let him who feels himself in fault amend his ways, and he who feels himself free from fault may pass untouched. I accuse no man; let each examine his own conscience.

The world is neither evil nor good: each man may make of it what he will by his own life. ⁷¹But this I say, that sin committed and not purged by repentance receives at length its due reward.

The conclusion of the *Vox Clamantis*, as altered from the first version, is doubtless intended as a fitting form of introduction for the *Cronica Tripertita*, which comes in as an appendix added in later years. It will be noted as regards the prose which forms a transition to this, that Gower has in the end brought himself to think that the misfortunes of the earlier part of Richard's reign were intended as a special warning to the youthful king, whom he formerly relieved from responsibility on account of his tender age, and that the tyranny of his later time sprang naturally out of his disregard of this preliminary chastisement. This change of view is also to be traced in the successive forms assumed by the paragraph relating to the *Vox Clamantis* in the author's account of his books ('Quia vnusquisque,' &c.).

Of the contents of the *Cronica Tripertita* it is unnecessary that more should be said than is contained in the Notes to this edition. Of the remaining pieces the *Carmen super multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia* is dated by the author as belonging to the twentieth year of Richard II. The *Tractatus de Lucis Scrutinio* is probably somewhat later, and the poem 'O deus immense,' &c., is said in one of the titles prefixed to have been composed near the end of Richard's reign. Besides these there is a group of Latin poems referring to the accession of Henry IV, 'Rex celi, deus,' &c. adapted from the *Vox Clamantis*, 'H. aquile pullus,' and 'O recolende, bone,' with several short occasional pieces belonging to the last years of the author's life. One of these has reference to his blindness and to the end of his activity as an author which was caused by it, and in connexion with this we have also the epistle to Archbishop Arundel prefixed to the All Souls MS. of

the *Vox Clamantis* and other Latin poems, and apparently meant to accompany the presentation of this particular copy. To Arundel also is addressed the short piece referring to the comet of March 1402, and finally we have the lines in which allusion is made to the short-comings of executors. It is probable also that the four lines which afterwards appeared upon the poet's tomb, 'Armigeri scutum,' &c., and which are given by the Glasgow MS., were written by Gower himself.

Some reference ought perhaps to be made in conclusion to the list of Gower's works given by Bale and copied by others, with a view to the question whether he was acquainted with any works of Gower which are not known to us. In his *Scriptorum Illustrium Catalogus*, p. 524 (ed. 1559) he says that Gower wrote

'Speculum Meditantis, Gallice, Lib. 10.
'Confessionem Amantis, Anglice, Lib. 8, "Eorum qui ante nos scripserunt."
'Vocem Clamantis, Latine, Lib. 7, "Scripture veteris capiunt exempla."
'De compunctione cordis, Lib. 1.
'Chronicon Ricardi Secundi, Lib. 3, "Opus humanum est inquirere."
'Chronicon tripartitum, Lib. 3, "Tolle caput mundi C. ter et sex."
'Ad Henricum quartum, Lib. 1, "Nobilis ac digne rex Henrice."
'De eodem rege Henrico, Lib. 1, "Rex celi deus et dominus."
'De peste vitiorum, Lib. 1, "Non excusatur qui verum non fateatur."
'Scrutinium lucis, Lib. 1, "Heu quia per crebras humus est."
'De coniugii dignitate, Lib. 1, "Qualiter creator omnium rerum Deus."
'De regimine principum, "O deus immense, sub quo dominatur."
'Epigrammata quaedam, Lib. 1, "Alta petens aquila volat alitque."
'De amoris varietate, Lib. 1, "Est amor in glosa pax bellica."
'Carmina diuersa, Lib. 1, et alia plura.'

In regard to this list it may be observed first that in the two cases where the beginning of the book or piece in question is not cited, we may safely assume that Bale had not seen it. This applies to the *Speculum Meditantis* and the supposed piece *De compunctione cordis*, of which I can give no account. It will be observed that he makes the short prose preface to the *Cronica Tripartita*, 'Opus humanum est inquirere' &c., into a separate work in three books. The other items are all recognizable, except 'Epigrammata quaedam, Lib. 1, "Alta petens aquila volat alitque."' Here we may observe that the quotation is from *Vox Clamantis* vi. 985, 'Alta petens aquila volat alite celsius omni,' &c. (a passage taken from the *Aurora*); and on referring to Bale's unpublished papers⁷² we find the description of this supposed book of epigrams in the following form, 'Ex suo libro et sanctifidensi chron. Epigrammata edidit, li. 1, "Alta petens aquila volat alite,"' whence we should gather that the book referred to was a collection of quotations. It is probable that Bale may have seen in some Gower MS. a selection of sententious passages from the *Vox Clamantis* and other places, such as we actually have on one of the blank leaves of the Digby MS. (f. 160), beginning 'Vulturis est hominum natura cadauera velle,' again one of those allegories of bird nature which were borrowed by Gower from the *Aurora*.

It may be noted here that in the same passage of Bale's unpublished papers we have the following statement:

‘De triplici opere hoc carmen est super eius tumbam
editum,
Quos viuens legi libro nunc offero regi,
Cuius habent legi secula cuncta regi.’

Also the following is given as the epitaph of his wife,

‘Quam bonitas, pietas, elemosina, casta voluntas,
Sobrietas que fides coluerunt, hic iacet Agnes.
Vxor amans, humilis Gower fuit illa Ioannis:
Donet ei summus celica regna Deus.’

These statements seem to be given by Bale on the authority of Nicholas Brigham, to whom we owe the tomb of Chaucer in Westminster Abbey.

THE TEXT AND THE MANUSCRIPTS.

Gower's principal Latin work, the *Vox Clamantis*, is found in ten manuscripts altogether. Of these four are evidently contemporary with the author and contain also the *Cronica Tripertita* and most of the other Latin poems printed in this volume. Some of these last are found also in other MSS. of the *Vox Clamantis*, some Latin pieces are contained in the Trentham MS. of the *Praise of Peace* and the *Cinkante Balades* (described in vol. i. p. lxxix), and the *Cronica Tripertita* occurs separately in the Bodleian MS. Hatton 92. Copies of the *Carmen de multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia* are contained in some MSS. of the *Confessio Amantis*, viz. TBAP₂ of the second recension, and FH₂K of the third, and with regard to these the reader is referred to the account given of the manuscripts in the Introduction to the second volume of this edition.

Of the four manuscripts of the *Vox Clamantis* with other Latin poems, which have been referred to as contemporary with the author, one is at Oxford, in the library of All Souls College, one at Glasgow in the Hunterian Museum, and two in London. They are proved to be original copies, not only by the handwriting of the text, which in each case is distinctly of the fourteenth century, but also by the fact that they all have author's

corrections written over erasure, and in several cases the same hand is recognizable throughout. The original text of the *Vox Clamantis* seems to be written in one and the same hand in the All Souls and Glasgow MSS. and this hand is also that of the lines supplied occasionally in the margin of the Harleian: the hand in which the text of the *Cronica Tripertita* is written in the All Souls MS. appears also in all the other three, and the same is the case with some of the correctors' hands, as will be seen in the detailed accounts which follow. Of the other manuscripts of the *Vox Clamantis* two, which are not themselves original copies, give the text in its first (unrevised) form, the rest are more or less in agreement with the revised text, but give it at second or third hand, with no alterations made over erasure.

S. ALL SOULS COLLEGE, OXF. 98. Contains, f. 1 v^o, Epistle to Archbishop Arundel, ff. 2-116, *Vox Clamantis*, ff. 116-126 v^o, *Cronica Tripertita*, ff. 126 v^o-127 v^o, 'Rex celi deus,' 'H. aquile pullus,' 'O recolende bone,' ff. 127 v^o-131, *Carmen super multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia*, f. 131, *Tractatus de Lucis Scrutinio* (imperfect at the end owing to the loss of a leaf), ff. 132-135, *Traitié pour ensampler les Amantz marietz*, (imperfect at the beginning), f. 135 v^o, 'Quia vnusquisque,' ff. 136, 137, 'Eneidos Bucolis,' 'O deus immense,' 'Quicquid homo scribat' (f. 137 v^o blank). Parchment, ff. 137 as numbered (and in addition several blank at the beginning and end) measuring 12½ x 8¼ in. Well and regularly written in single column, the *Vox Clamantis* 48 lines on a page and the succeeding poems 52. The original first quire begins with f. 2, but before this a quire of four leaves (probably) was inserted, of which the first two are blank, the third is cut away, and the fourth has on its verso the Epistle to the Archbishop. The quire which ends with f. 116 has seven leaves only, and that ending with f. 137 six. After this several leaves have been inserted, which remain blank. The book has on f. 1 an ornamental initial S containing a miniature of Abp. Arundel in his robes and mitre, and there are large coloured and gilt capitals at the beginning of each book of the *Vox Clamantis*, and coloured initials of various sizes for chapters and paragraphs. Original oak binding.

Five leaves are lost (apart from blanks at the beginning and end), as follows.

After f. 2 one leaf containing chapter-headings of *Vox Clamantis* Lib. ii. cap. ii-Lib. iii. cap. xxii. After f. 5 two leaves, containing chapter-headings Lib. vii. cap. xix to the end, the lines 'Ad mundum mitto,' probably with a picture of the author, and *Vox Clamantis* Lib. i. Prologus, ll. 1-18. After f. 13 one leaf (*Vox Clamantis* i. 766-856). After f. 131 one leaf (*De Lucis Scrutinio* 93-103; probably some other short piece, and the French *Traitié*, to iii. 3).

This MS. was certainly written and corrected under the direction of the author, and remained for some time in his hands, receiving addition from time to time. From the *Epistola* at the beginning, which occurs here only and seems to relate to this volume in particular, we may gather that it was eventually presented to Abp. Arundel. It is possible that it passed from him to his successor Chichele, and so to the College of All Souls, where it now is, but there seems to be no definite evidence to confirm this suggestion.

The text of S in the *Vox Clamantis* agrees in the main as regards revised passages with that of the other original manuscripts C, H and G, but in some respects it is peculiar. In Lib. iii. cap. i. S has a rewritten version which differs from that of the other revised copies, and the same is the case with regard to the lines 'Quicquid homo scribat' (p. 365). There are also some places, as iv. 1072, 1197-1232, v. 450, where S retains the original text in company with TH₂ or even with H₂ alone. A few possibly right readings are peculiar to S, as in i. 1788, 2073, ii. 300, iii. 380 (margin), 1642, v. 325, vi. 555, while some others are common to S with G alone, some few small mistakes remain uncorrected, as in i. 106, 953, 1212, 1591, 1662, iii. 176, 989, 1214, 1541, 1695, iv. 273, 336 &c., and in some cases, where the headings of chapters have been rewritten, as vi. cap. xviii, xix, the original headings are left standing in the Table of Chapters at the beginning.

At least five hands are distinguishable, as follows:

(1) the original text of the *Vox Clamantis*.

(2) the original text of the succeeding poems, French and Latin, and the rewritten text or corrections on ff. 15 v⁰ (i. 1019), 90 v⁰ (vi. 545), 97 (vi. 1159), 115 v⁰ (vii. 1454 f., 1469 f.), 116 (last lines of *Vox Clamantis*).

(3) the original text and (probably) the corrections of the *Epistola*, f. i, and the corrections or rewritten text on ff. 36 v⁰ (iii. 2 ff.), 39 (iii. cap. iv. heading), 97 v⁰ (vi. 1189), 98 (vi. 1219 ff.), 115 r⁰ (vii. 1409 ff.), 116 (first lines of *Cron. Trip.*), 126 v⁰, 127 v⁰, and the text of 'Quicquid homo scribat.'

(4) marginal note on f. 40 v⁰, 'Nota de bello Cleri' &c. (iii. 375).

(5) marginal note on f. 66, 'Nota quod Genius' &c. (iv. 587).

In addition there are some marginal notes which are not quite contemporary, as those on ff. 51 v⁰, 52, 76 v⁰, 77 ('Contra rectores Oxon.' &c., 'Nota de muliere bona'

&c.), and the heading of the last piece on f. 137 seems to have been rewritten over a hand different from any of the above, of which some words remain. A few corrections are in doubtful hands, as vi. 1208.

Of the above hands the first, very regularly written in a fourteenth century character, in brown ink, probably the same as that of the *Vox Clamantis* in G, and the same scribe apparently wrote the lines which are supplied sometimes in the margin of H, having been dropped out of the text by the first copyist. The second (2) is also a very neat and regular hand, but of a somewhat later type. It appears in the French and Latin poems of MS. Fairfax 3, as well as in the substituted leaf at the beginning of the *Confessio Amantis* in that manuscript. It is also used for the *Cronica Tripertita*, *Traitié* and other pieces in the Glasgow MS. (G), for the *Cron. Tripertita* and other Latin pieces in H, and for some of the rewritten passages of the *Vox Clamantis* in G, H, and C. The third (3) is a rather rough hand, found also occasionally in corrections of G and H. The fourth (4) is that in which the same marginal note is written also in C, H and G.

G. GLASGOW HUNTERIAN MUSEUM T. 2, 17. Contains, ff. 1-108, *Vox Clamantis* preceded by the Table of Chapters, ff. 109-119, *Cronica Tripertita*, ff. 119, 120, 'H. aquile pullus,' 'O recolende,' 'Quia vnusquisque,' 'Eneidos Bucolis,' ff. 120 v^o-122, *Carmen super multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia*, ff. 123, 124, *Tractatus de Lucis Scrutinio*, f. 124 v^o, *Traitié pour ensampler les Amantz marietz* followed by *Carmen de variis in amore passionibus*, f. 129, 'Orantibus pro anima,' with shield of arms and the lines 'Armigeri scutum,' and below this a bier with candle at head and foot, f. 129 v^o, 'Epistola quam Iohannes Gower in laudem ... Henrici quarti statim post coronacionem ... deuote composuit,' f. 130 v^o, 'O deus immense,' f. 131 v^o, 'Henrici regis,' 'Vnanimes esse,' f. 132, 'Presul, ouile regis,' 'Cultor in ecclesia,' 'Dicunt scripture,' f. 132 v^o blank.

Parchment, ff. 132 in quires of eight leaves (except the first, which has six) with catchwords, measuring 11¾ x 7¾ in., 53 lines to the page in the *Vox Clamantis*, then 52 or 51, regularly and well written with passages erased and rewritten as in CH. On f. 6 v^o is a painting like that in the Cotton MS. of a man in a brown hat, a blue coat with brown lining, and with three arrows in his belt, shooting an arrow at the globe (which has a threefold division corresponding to the three elements of air, earth, and water), with the lines 'Ad mundum mitto mea iacula' &c. There is a floreated page at the beginning of Lib. i. (after the Prologue) and illuminated initials with decoration at the beginning of the other books; large and small coloured capitals for chapters and paragraphs.

I have to thank Dr. Young the Librarian of the Hunterian Museum, for facilities given to me in using this MS. and for his kind help in collating and describing it.

The text of G has, as might be expected, a close affinity with that of S, but the peculiarities of S as regards revision in certain passages, e.g. iii. 1 ff., iv. 1197 ff., are not shared by this MS., which goes here with the other revised copies, C and H. In one place at least G has a further touch of revision, viz. in the heading of vi. cap. vii., where its reading is shared by D. In a good many instances, however, G stands with S (sometimes in company with D or L) in support of a probably true reading which is not given by other MSS., as i. 465, 468, 979, 1454, iv. 72, v. 789, vii. 684, 1342, or of an error, as i. 1525, 1870, iii. 1863, iv. 799. It may be noted that sometimes in G an erasure has been made without the correction being supplied.

The following are some of the hands that may be distinguished in this manuscript:

(1) Text of the *Vox Clamantis*. This seems to be the same as S (1), H (2).

(2) Text of the *Cronica Tripertita* and succeeding pieces to f. 131 r⁰., passages rewritten over erasure in vi. 545 ff., 1159 ff. and in the conclusion of the *Vox Clamantis*. This is the same as S (2), C (3), H (3).

(3) Corrections in vi. cap. xix., vii. cap. iii. and xxiv, rewritten lines at the beginning and near the end of the *Cronica Tripertita*, text of the poem 'Henrici Regis' with its heading, f. 131. Perhaps the same as S (3).

(4) The marginal note at iii. 375: the same as S (4), C (6), H (6).

(5) The text of 'Vnanimes esse' and the succeeding poems on ff. 131 v⁰, 132.

C.COTTON. TIB. A. iv, British Museum. Contains, ff. 2-152v⁰, *Vox Clamantis*, ff. 153-167 r⁰, 'Explicit libellus' &c. and *Cronica Tripertita*, f. 167, 'Rex celi deus,' 'H. aquile pullus,' 'O recolende bone,' ff. 168-172, *Carmen super multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia*, ff. 172 v⁰-174, *Tractatus de Lucis Scrutinio*, ff. 174 v⁰, 175, 'Quia vnusquisque,' 'Eneidos Bucolis,' 'Orate pro anima,' 'O deus immense,' ff. 176, 177, 'Henrici regis,' 'Vnanimes esse,' 'Presul, ouile regis,' 'Cultor in ecclesia,' 'Dicunt scripture.' Ends on 177 r⁰. Parchment, ff. 178, that is, 176 leaves of original text, preceded by two blanks, on the second of which is Sir Robert Cotton's Table of Contents, ending 'Liber vt videtur ipsius autoris,' the first leaf of the text being now numbered f. 2. In quires of eight with catchwords, signed *a*, *b*, *c*, &c. from f. 10 (where the text of the *Vox Clamantis* begins) the first quire, containing the chapter-headings &c., written in a hand different from that of the main part of the text. Leaves measure about 10 x 6½ in. Written in single column, 38 lines to the page in the *Vox Clamantis*,

40 or more in the *Cronica Tripertita*. The MS. has been carefully corrected, and revised passages appear written over erasure as in SGH. Capitals coloured and gilded at the beginning of the books, coloured blue and red at the beginning of chapters and paragraphs. On f. 9, the last of the first quire, a picture like that in the Glasgow MS., of the author shooting at the world, as shown in the frontispiece of this volume.

On f. 2 is written 'Roberti Cotton liber ex dono doctissimi Patricii Youngi generosi.' The book suffered somewhat in the fire of 1731, but it has been carefully and skilfully repaired, and though the writing at the top of each page shows traces of the heat, no part of it is illegible. The effect produced is clearly visible on the page of which a facsimile is given.

The text of C is a very good one and unquestionably independent. In regard to spelling it may be observed that the copyist of the *Vox Clamantis* frequently gives 'u' for 'v' at the beginning of words, he writes 'sed' almost always for 'set,' and often 'ti' for 'ci' in words like 'etiam,' 'ratio,' 'patiens' and even 'fatie' (ii. 57), but also 'eciam,' 'ambicio,' 'precium,' &c.

The following are the hands, so far as they can be distinguished:

(1) Text of the *Vox Clamantis*, a small and somewhat irregular but clear hand, of the fourteenth century.

(2) The eight leaves preceding this (containing the chapter-headings), and also ff. 96, 97 and part of 140. This hand has made corrections throughout, not revising the text, as the author might, but setting right the mistakes of the scribe.

The (3) following passages as rewritten over erasure: i. 1019 ff., vi. 545-554, and also the prose heading of the first part of the *Cronica Tripertita*. This is the 'second hand' of the Fairfax MS., the same as S (2), G (2), H (3).

(4) The passage rewritten over erasure in iii. 1 ff., also the heading of iii, cap. iv., corrections in iv. 1198 ff., and iv. 1221*-1232* rewritten over erasure. This is a neat round hand used also in the same places of the Harleian MS.

(5) The passage 'Rex puer,' &c., vi. 555-580, and vi. cap. xviii, with the heading of cap. xix., over erasure, a hand which resembles (3), but does not seem to be identical with it.

(6) The marginal note at iii. 375 and perhaps also iv. 587, and the marginal note at the end of the *Cronica Tripertita*; also f. 176 'Nota hic in fine—intendo,' and the lines 'Henrici regis,' &c. This is the same as S (4), G (4), H (6).

(7) Corrections in vi. 1208, 1210: the same as H (7), and the correction of vi. 1210 in S.

(8) Corrections in vi. 1219 ff., and vii. 187 ff.

(9) Text of *Cronica Tripertita* and the succeeding pieces to f. 168: a rather rough and irregular hand in faded ink.

(10) Marginal notes of *Cronica Tripertita* and text of *Carmen super multiplici* &c. from f. 169, 'Ad fidei dampnum' to the end of 'O deus immense,' f. 176.

(11) The four smaller poems at the end (possibly with the exception of 'Cultor in ecclesia'). The same as H (9).

(12) The lines at the beginning and near the end of the *Cronica Tripertita* (over erasure).

Some other corrections are doubtful, as the concluding lines of the *Vox Clamantis*.

H. HARLEIAN 6291, British Museum. Contains the same as C, except where deficient from loss of leaves, with the addition of a second copy of the last three poems. Parchment ff. 164, measuring 9 x 6 in., in quires of eight with catchwords, 37 lines to the page, regularly and neatly written. No decoration except coloured initials. Has lost probably two whole quires, 16 leaves, at the beginning, and begins with *Vox Clamantis*, i. 502. The first existing quire is lettered 'b,' and this is also the lettering of the third quire of the Cotton MS., the first, which has the Table of Chapters, not being counted in the lettering. In addition to these, one leaf is lost after f. 1 (containing *Vox Clamantis*, i. 571-644), two after f. 58 (iii. 1716-1854), one after f. 108 (vi. 951-1021), one after f. 133 (vii. 1399-1466). This last leaf formed part of a quire of 12, which followed f. 124, at the end of the *Vox Clamantis*. Of these the last three have been cut away, but only one leaf of text is lost, f. 134 continuing at 1467, and the concluding lines of the *Vox Clamantis* being here given in the hand which copied the *Cronica Tripertita*, &c. The last quire of that book, ff. 158-164 (one leaf lost at the end), has several blanks (162, 163, 164 v^o).

In a good many instances passages of from two to six lines are omitted in the text and inserted in the margin, either across or at the bottom of the page, in a hand which seems not to be that of the text, though very similar, and is probably identical with S (1). This occurs on ff. 41, 74, 76, 78, &c.

The text of H is very correct, and in forms of spelling, &c. it closely resembles that of S. There is little punctuation at first, but more afterwards. In form of text it agrees nearly with C, but (1) the marginal note at iv. 587 is omitted, (2) as regards revision H parts company with C at vi. 1219, from which point H has the unrevised text in agreement with EDTH₂ except in the concluding lines of the *Vox Clamantis* on f. 134, which, as already remarked, are rewritten in a new hand.

The hands of H may be thus distinguished:

(1) Text of the *Vox Clamantis*, a good and regular fourteenth-century hand.

(2) Passages added in the margin, probably the same as S (1).

(3) Rewritten text of i. 1019 ff., vi. 545-580, vi. cap. xviii and heading of xix, last lines of *Vox Clamantis*, text of *Cronica Tripertita* and succeeding pieces to the end of 'O deus immense' f. 159 v⁰. This is the same as S (2), G (2), C (3).

(4) Rewritten text of iii. 1 ff., corrections of iv. 1212, 1214, and rewritten text of 1221*-1232*; also f. 160, 'Nota hic in fine' &c. to end of f. 161 r⁰. This is the same as C (4).

(5) Correction of the heading of iii. cap. iv, the same as S (3).

(6) Marginal note at iii. 375, the same as S (4), G (4), C (6).

(7) Corrections of vi. 1208, 1210, and of *Cronica Tripertita* i. 55 f. and some other places: the same as C (7).

(8) Rewritten passages at the beginning and near the end of the *Cronica Tripertita*, the same as C (12).

(9) Second copy of the last poems (on f. 164), the same hand as C (11).

E. At ECTON, near Northampton, in the possession of General Sotheby, who very kindly sent it to the Bodleian Library for my use. Contains *Vox Clamantis*, *Carmen super multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia*, *Tractatus de Lucis Scrutinio*, 'O deus immense,' 'Cultor in ecclesia,' 'Vnanimes esse,' 'Dicunt scripture.' Parchment, ff. 191, measuring about 9 x 6¼ in., in quires of eight with catch-words, the last quire of seven leaves only (two blank). Neatly written in a good hand of the end of the fourteenth century, in single column, 32 lines to a page. On f. 10 a brightly coloured picture of an archer drawing a bow to shoot at the world, with the lines 'Ad mundum mitto,' &c., as in the Cotton and Glasgow MSS., but the figure and features are different, and evidently the picture has less claim to be considered an authentic portrait than those of the two MSS. above named. The headings of pages and chapters are in red, and there are coloured initials and other decorations throughout. The whole is written in one hand, and there are no corrections or erasures such as might indicate that the book had been in the hands of the author.

The manuscript seems to have been in the possession of the Sotheby family since 1702, when it was 'bought at Lord Burgley's sale for £1 2s. 0d.' No leaves are lost, but two are transposed at the end of the fourth and beginning of the fifth books.

The text is very fairly correct, and the MS. is closely related to C both in text and spelling (for which see i. Prol. 37 f., i. 21, 95, 447, 1706, 1776, 2017, ii. 174, 311 &c.), but not derived from it (see i. 41, 1626, 2094, iii. 1760 f., v. 785 f.). The

passages which in C and the other original copies are rewritten over erasure, as iii. 1 ff., vi. 1161 ff., are usually given by E in the revised form, but the marginal notes at iii. 375 and iv. 587 are omitted. Occasionally too, where C has a correction, E gives the original reading in company with H, as iii. 840, v. 785 f., and especially in the passages vi. 1219 ff. and vii. 182 ff., where H no longer agrees with SCG in corrections, we find that E goes with H. In the final poems E shows some independence as regards marginal notes, e.g. in the last piece, where instead of 'Nota contra mortuorum executores,' we find the much more pointed, though doubtfully grammatical, remark, 'Nota quod bonum est unicuique esse executor sui ipsius.' This is the only MS. except CHG which contains the short pieces at the end, and the omission from these of 'Presul, ouile regis' may be an indication that the MS. was written before 1402.

As regards the picture in this MS., the features of the archer are quite different from those represented in the Cotton MS. He has a prominent pointed nose and a light-coloured moustache and beard; the arrow, held between the fore-finger and the second and aimed upwards, covers the mouth. The dress consists of a grey fur cap with a hood under it of light crimson, covering also the upper part of the body: below this a blue surcoat with brown lining and wide sleeves thrown back so as to leave the arms bare: a red belt with buckle and pendant, and red hose. The globe is at a higher level and smaller in proportion than in the other pictures. Like them it is divided into three, the left hand upper division having a crescent moon and four stars: a red cross with a banner stands at the summit of the globe.

D. DIGBY 138, Bodleian Library, Oxford. Contains *Vox Clamantis* only, preceded by the Table of Chapter-headings. Parchment and paper, ff. 158 originally, with other leaves inserted at the beginning and end in the sixteenth century; about 10½ x 7¼ in., in quires of eight with catchwords; neat writing of the second quarter of the fifteenth century, about 37 lines to the page. No decoration except red and blue initials, numbering of chapters in red, &c. The rubricator has introduced some corrections here and there, but there are no passages rewritten over erasure. There is some transposition of leaves in the fourteenth quire, dating from before the rubricator's numbering of chapters. The name of a sixteenth-century owner, Roger Waller, occurs on f. 158 v^o. and Kenelm Digby's device, 'Vindica te tibi, Kenelme Digby,' on f. 1.

The text of D is of a mixed character. Sometimes, in company with TH₂ it reproduces the original form of a passage, as i. 1029 ff., vi. cap. xviii and xix, vii. 189 f., 1409 ff., 1454 ff., 1479 ff. In other places, as iii. 1 ff., vi. 545, and elsewhere, the readings of D are those of the revised MSS. It is peculiar in the addition after vi. 522, where eight lines are introduced from the original text of the altered passage which follows at the end of the chapter. The text of D generally is much less correct than that of the older copies, and it is derived from a MS. which had lines missing here and there, as indicated by the 'deficit versus in copia,' which occurs sometimes in the margin. In the numbering of the chapters the Prologues of Libb. ii. and iii. are

reckoned as cap. i. in each case. The corrections and notes of the rubricator are not always sound, and sometimes we find in the margin attempts to improve the author's metre, in a seventeenth-century hand, as 'Et qui pauca tenet' for 'Qui tenet et pauca' (ii. 70), 'Causa tamen credo' for 'Credo tamen causa' (ii. 84). Some of these late alterations have been admitted (strange to say) into Mr. Coxe's text (e.g. ii. 70).

The book is made up of parchment and paper in equal proportions, the outer and inner leaves of each quire being of parchment. Sixteen leaves of paper have been inserted at the beginning and twelve at the end of the book, easily distinguished by the water-mark and chain-lines from the paper originally used in the book itself. Most of these are blank, but some have writing, mostly in sixteenth-century hands. There are medical prescriptions and cooking recipes in English, selections of gnomic and other passages from the *Vox Clamantis*, among which are the lines 'Ad mundum mitto,' &c., which do not occur in the Digby text, four Latin lines on the merits of the papal court beginning 'Pauperibus sua dat gratis,' which when read backwards convey an opposite sense, the stanzas by Queen Elizabeth 'The dowte of future force (*corr.* foes) Exiles my presente ioye, And wytt me warnes to shonne suche snares As threten myne annoye' (eight four-line stanzas).

With regard to the connexion between D and L see below on the Laud MS.

L. LAUD 719, Bodleian Library, Oxford. Contains *Vox Clamantis* (without Table of Chapters and with omission of Lib. i. 165-2150), *Carmen super multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia*, *Tractatus de Lucis Scrutinio*, *Carmen de variis in amore passionibus*, 'Lex docet auctorum,' 'Quis sit vel qualis,' 'H. aquile pullus,' and seven more Latin lines of obscure meaning ('Inter saxosum montem,' &c.), which are not found in other Gower MSS. Parchment and paper, ff. 170 (not including four original blank leaves at the beginning and several miscellaneous leaves at the end), in quires usually of fourteen leaves, but the first of twelve and the second of six, measuring about 8½ x 5¾ in., about 27 lines to the page, moderately well written with a good many contractions, in the same hand throughout with no corrections, of the second quarter of the fifteenth century. There is a roughly drawn picture of an archer aiming at the globe on f. 21, and the chapters have red initial letters. Original oak binding.

The names 'Thomas Eymis' and 'William Turner' occur as those of sixteenth-century owners. The note on the inside of the binding, 'Henry Beauchamp lyeing in St. John strete at the iii. Cuppes,' can hardly be taken to indicate ownership.

The most noticeable fact about the text of this MS. is one to which no attention has hitherto been called, viz. the omission of the whole history of the Peasants' Revolt. After Lib. i. cap. i. the whole of the remainder of the first book (nearly 2,000 lines) is omitted without any note of deficiency, and we pass on to the Prologue of

Lib. ii, not so named here, but standing as the second chapter of Lib. i. (the chapters not being numbered however in this MS.). After what we commonly call the second book follows the heading of the Prologue of Lib. iii, but without any indication that a new book is begun. Lib. iv. is marked by the rubricator as 'liber iii^{us},' Lib. v. as 'liber iii^{us},' and so on to the end, making six books instead of seven; but there are traces of another numbering, apparently by the scribe who wrote the text, according to which Lib. v. was reckoned as 'liber iii^{us},' Lib. iv. as 'liber iii^{us},' and Lib. vii. as 'liber v^{us}.' It has been already observed that there is internal evidence to show that this arrangement in five (or six) books may have been the original form of the text of the *Vox Clamantis*. At the same time it must be noted that this form is given by no other MS. except the Lincoln book, which is certainly copied from L, and that the nature of the connexion between L and D seems to indicate that these two MSS. are ultimately derived from the same source. This connexion, established by a complete collation of the two MSS., extends apparently throughout the whole of the text of L. We have, for example, in both, i. Prol. 27, laudes, 58 Huius ergo, ii. 94 et ibi, 312 causat, 614 Ingenuitque, iii. 4 mundus, 296 ei, 407 amor (*for maior*), 536 Hec, 750 timidus, 758 curremus, 882 iuris, 1026 Nil, 1223 mundus, 1228 bona, 1491 egras, 1584 racio, 1655 Inde vola, 1777 ibi, 1868 timet, 1906 seruet, 2075, 2080 qui, iv. 52 vrbe, 99 tegit, and so on. The common source was not an immediate one, for words omitted by D with a blank or 'deficit' as iii. 641, vii. 487 are found in L, and the words 'nescit,' 'deus,' which are omitted with a blank left in L at iii. 1574 and vi. 349 are found in D. If we suppose a common source, we must assume either that the first book was found in it entire and deliberately omitted, with alteration of the numbering of the books, by the copyist of the MS. from which L is more immediately derived, or that it was not found, and that the copyist of the original of D supplied it from another source.

It should be noted that the MS. from which L is ultimately derived must have had alternative versions of some of the revised passages, for in vi. cap. xviii. and also vi. l. 1208 L gives both the revised and the unrevised form. As a rule in the matter of revision L agrees with D, but not in the corrections of vi. 1208-1226, where D has the uncorrected form and L the other. We may note especially the reading of L in vi. 1224.

The following are the Latin lines which occur on f. 170 after '[H.] Aquile pullus,' &c.

'Inter saxosum montem campumque nodosum
Periit Anglica gens fraude sua propria.
Homo dicitur, Cristus, virgo, Sathan, non iniustus fragilisque,
Est peccator homo simpliciterque notat.
Vlcio, mandatum, cetus, tutela, potestas,
Pars incarnatus, presencia, vis memorandi,
Ista manus seruat infallax voce sub vna.'

The second of the parchment blanks at the beginning has a note in the original hand of the MS. on the marriage of the devil and the birth of his nine daughters, who were assigned to various classes of human society, Simony to the prelates, Hypocrisy to the religious orders, and so on. At the end of the book there are two leaves with theological and other notes in the same hand, and two cut for purposes of binding from leaves of an older MS. of Latin hymns, &c. with music.

L₂. LINCOLN CATHEDRAL LIBRARY, A. 72, very obligingly placed at my disposal in the Bodleian by the Librarian, with authority from the Dean and Chapter. Contains the same as L, including the enigmatical lines above quoted. Paper, ff. 184, measuring about 8 x 6 in. neatly written in an early sixteenth-century hand, about 26 lines to the page. No coloured initials, but space left for them and on f. 21 for a picture corresponding to that on f. 21 of the Laud MS. Neither books nor chapters numbered. Marked in pencil as 'one of Dean Honywood's, No. 53.'

Certainly copied from L, giving a precisely similar form of text and agreeing almost always in the minutest details.

T. TRINITY COLLEGE, DUBLIN, D. 4, 6, kindly sent to the Bodleian for my use by the Librarian, with the authority of the Provost and Fellows. Contains *Vox Clamantis* without Table of Chapters, followed by the account of the author's books, 'Quia vnusquisque,' &c. Parchment, ff. 144 (two blank) in seventeen quires, usually of eight leaves, but the first and sixteenth of ten and the last of twelve; written in an early fifteenth-century hand, 36-39 lines to the page, no passages erased or rewritten. Coloured initials.

This, in agreement with the Hatfield book (H₂), gives the original form of all the passages which were revised or rewritten. It is apparently a careless copy of a good text, with many mistakes, some of which are corrected. The scribe either did not understand what he was writing or did not attend to the meaning, and a good many lines and couplets have been carelessly dropped out, as i. 873, 1360, 1749, 1800, ii. Prol. 24 f., ii. 561 f., iii. 281, 394 f., 943 f., 1154, 1767-1770, 1830, iv. 516 f., 684, v. 142-145, 528-530, vi. 829 f., vii. 688 f., 1099 f.

The blank leaf at the beginning, which is partly cut away, has in an early hand the lines

'In Kent alle car by gan, ibi pauci sunt sapientes,
In a Route thise Rebaudis ran sua trepida arma gerentes,'

for which cp. Wright's *Political Poems*, Rolls Series, 14, vol. i. p. 225.

H₂. HATFIELD HALL, in the possession of the Marquess of Salisbury, by whose kind permission I was allowed to examine it. Contains the *Vox Clamantis*, preceded by the Table of Chapters. Parchment, ff. 144 (not counting blanks), about 9½ x 6¼ in., in eighteen quires of eight with catchwords; neatly written in a hand of the first half of the fifteenth century,

40 lines to the page. There is a richly illuminated border round three sides of the page where the Prologue of the *Vox Clamantis* begins, and also on the next, at the beginning of the first book, and floreated decorations at the beginning of each succeeding book, with illuminated capitals throughout. The catchwords are sometimes ornamented with neat drawings.

The book has a certain additional interest derived from the fact that it belonged to the celebrated Lord Burleigh, and was evidently read by him with some interest, as is indicated by various notes.

This MS., of which the text is fairly correct, is written in one hand throughout, and with T it represents, so far as we can judge, the original form of the text in all the revised passages. In some few cases, as iv. 1073, v. 450, H₂ seems to give the original reading, where T agrees with the revised MSS.

On the last leaf we find an interesting note about the decoration of the book and the parchment used, written small in red below the 'Explicit,' which I read as follows: '100 and li. 51 blew letteris, 4 co. smale letteris and more, gold letteris 8: 18 quayers. price velom v s. vi d.' There are in fact about 150 of the larger blue initials with red lines round them, the smaller letters, of which I understand the account reckons 400 and more, being those at the beginning of paragraphs, blue and red alternately. The eight gold letters are those at the beginning of the first prologue and the seven books.

The following notes are in the hand of Lord Burleigh, as I am informed by Mr. R. T. Gunton: 'Vox Clamantis' on the first page, 'nomine Authoris' and 'Anno 4 Regis Ricardi' in the margin of the prologue to the first book, 'Thomas arch., Simon arch.,' opposite i. 1055 f., 'Amoris effectus' near the beginning of Lib. v, 'Laus Edw. princ. patris Ricardi 2' at Lib. vi. cap. xiii, and a few more.

C₂. COTTON, TITUS, A, 13, British Museum. Contains on ff. 105-137 a part of the *Vox Clamantis*, beginning with the Prologue of Lib. i. and continuing to Lib. iii. l. 116, where it is left unfinished. Paper, leaves measuring 8¼ x 6 in. written in a current sixteenth-century hand with an irregular number of lines (about 38-70) to the page. Headed, 'De populari tumultu et rebellione. Anno quarto Ricardi secundi.'

Text copied from D, as is shown by minute agreement in almost every particular.

H₃. HATTON 92, Bodleian Library, Oxford. This contains, among other things of a miscellaneous kind, Gower's *Cronica Tripertita*, followed by '[H.] aquile pullus,' 'O recolende,' and 'Rex celi deus,' altogether occupying 21½ leaves of parchment, measuring 7¾ x 5½ in. Neatly written

in hands of the first half of the fifteenth century about 28-30 lines to the page, the text in one hand and the margin in another.

Begins, 'Prologus. Opus humanum est—constituit.'

Then the seven lines, 'Ista tripartita—vincit amor,' followed by 'Explicit prologus.' After this,

'Incipit cronica iohannis Gower de tempore Regis Ricardi secundi vsque ad secundum annum Henrici quarti.

Incipit prohemium Cronice Iohannis Gower.

Postquam in quodam libello, qui vox clamantis dicitur, quem Iohannes Gower nuper versificatum composuit super hoc quod tempore Regis Ricardi secundi anno Regni sui quarto vulgaris in anglia populus contra ipsum Regem quasi ex virga dei notabiliter insurrexit manifestius tractatum existit, iam in hoc presenti Cronica, que tripartita est, super quibusdam aliis infortuniis,' &c.

Ends (after 'sint tibi regna poli'), 'Expliciunt carmina Iohannis Gower, que scripta sunt vsque nunc, quod est in anno domini Regis prenotati secundo, et quia confractus ego tam senectute quam aliis infirmitatibus vltius scribere discrete non sufficio, Scribat qui veniet post me discreciore Alter, Amodo namque manus et mea penna silent. Hoc tamen infine verborum queso meorum, prospera quod statuatur regna futura deus. Amen. Ihesus esto michi ihesus.'

This conclusion seems to be made up out of the piece beginning 'Henrici quarti' in the Trentham MS. (see p. 365 of this volume) combined with the prose heading of the corresponding lines as given by CHG. It may be observed here that the Trentham version of this piece is also given in MS. Cotton, Julius F. vii, f. 167, with the heading 'Epitaphium siue dictum Iohannis Gower Armigeri et per ipsum compositum.' It is followed by the lines 'Electus Cristi—sponte data,' which are the heading of the *Praise of Peace*.

FORMER EDITIONS. The *Vox Clamantis* was printed for the Roxburghe Club in the year 1850, edited by H. O. Coxe, Bodley's Librarian. In the same volume were included the *Cronica Tripartita*, the lines 'Quicquid homo scribat,' &c., the complimentary verses of the 'philosopher,' 'Eneidos Bucolis,' &c., and (in a note to the Introduction) the poem 'O deus immense,' &c. In T. Wright's *Political Poems*, Rolls Series, 14, vol. i. the following pieces were printed: *Carmen super multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia*, *De Lucis Scrutinio*, 'O deus immense,' &c., *Cronica Tripartita*. In the Roxburghe edition of Gower's *Cinkante Balades* (1818) were printed also the pieces 'Rex celi deus,' and 'Ecce patet tensus,' the lines 'Henrici quarti,' a variation of 'Quicquid homo scribat,' &c. (see p. 365 of this edition). Finally the last poems 'Vnanimes esse,' 'Presul, ouile regis,'

‘Cultor in ecclesia,’ and ‘Dicunt scripture’ were printed by Karl Meyer in his dissertation *John Gower’s Beziehungen zu Chaucer &c.* pp. 67, 68.

Of Coxe’s edition I wish to speak with all due respect. It has served a very useful purpose, and it was perhaps on a level with the critical requirements of the time when it was published. At the same time it cannot be regarded as satisfactory. The editor tells us that his text is that of the All Souls MS. ‘collated throughout word for word with a MS. preserved among the Digby MSS. in the Bodleian, and here and there with the Cotton MS. [Tib. A. iv.] sufficiently to show the superiority of the All Souls MS.’ The inferior and late Digby MS. was thus uncritically placed on a level with those of first authority, and even preferred to the Cotton MS. It would require a great deal of very careful collation to convince an editor that the text of the All Souls MS. is superior in correctness to that of the Cotton MS., and it is doubtful whether after all he would come to any such conclusion. As regards correctness they stand in fact very nearly on the same level: each might set the other right in a few trifling points. It is not, however, from the Cotton MS. that the Roxburghe editor takes his corrections, when he thinks that any are needed. In such cases he silently adopts readings from the Digby MS., and in a much larger number of instances he gives the text of the All Souls MS. incorrectly, from insufficient care in copying or correcting. The most serious results of the undue appreciation of the Digby MS. are seen in those passages where S is defective, as in the Prologue of the first book, and in the well-known passage i. 783 ff., where the text of D is taken as the sole authority, and accordingly errors abound, which might have been avoided by reference to C or any other good copy⁷³. The editor seems not to have been acquainted with the Harleian MS., and he makes no mention even of the second copy of the *Vox Clamantis* which he had in his own library, MS. Laud 719.

The same uncritical spirit which we have noted in this editor’s choice of manuscripts for collation appears also in his manner of dealing with the revised passages. When he prints variations, it is only because he happens to find them in the Digby MS., and he makes only one definite statement about the differences of handwriting in his authority, which moreover is grossly incorrect. Not being acquainted with Dublin or the Hatfield MSS., he could not give the original text of such passages as *Vox Clamantis*, iii. 1-28 or vi. 545-80, but he might at least have indicated the lines which he

found written over erasure, and in different hands from the original text, in the All Souls and Cotton MSS. Dr. Karl Meyer again, who afterwards paid some attention to the handwriting and called attention to Coxe's misstatement on the subject, was preoccupied with the theory that the revision took place altogether after the accession of Henry IV, and failed to note the evidence afforded by the differences of handwriting for the conclusion that the revision was a gradual one, made in accordance with the development of political events.

I think it well to indicate the chief differences of text between the Roxburghe edition of the *Vox Clamantis* and the present. The readings in the following list are those of the Roxburghe edition. In cases where the Roxburghe editor has followed the All Souls or Digby MS. that fact is noted by the letters S or D; but the variations are for the most part mere mistakes. It should be noted also that the sense is very often obscured in the Roxburghe edition by bad punctuation, and that the medieval spelling is usually not preserved.

Epistola 37 orgine *Heading to Prol.* 3 somnum *Prologus* 21 Godefri, des
atque D 25 ascribens D 27 nil ut laudes D 32 Sicque D 36 sentiat D
37 Sæpeque sunt lachrymis de D 38 Humida fit lachrymis sæpeque penna meis D
44 favent D 49 confracto D 50 At 58 Hujus ergo D

Heading to LIB. I. 1 *om.* eciam D 3 continebant D 4 terræ illius D 7 etiam
(*for et*) D LIB. I. 12. quisque 26 celsitonantes 40 Fertilis occultam invenit SD
61 Horta 88 sorte 92 et (*for ex*) Cap. ii. *Heading* dicet prima
199 geminatis 209 possint D 280 crabs 326 elephantinus 359 segistram
395 Culteque Currae 396 Linquendo S 455 Thalia D 474 arces 479 nemora
551 pertenui 585 Hæc 603 Tormis bruchiis 743 Cumque 763 alitrixque D
771 dominos superos nec D 784 Recteque D 789 Cebbe D 797 Sæpe
799 Quidem 803 Frenet perspumanns D 811 earum D 817 sonitum quoque
verberat 821 Congestat D 822 Obstrepere 824 in (*for a*) D 827 stupefactus
835 eorum non fortificet 837 furorum D 846 conchos D *om.* sibi D 855 roserat
atra rubedo D 863 romphæa 873 gerunt 947 rapit (*for stetit*) D 953 igne S
1173 viris (*for iuris*) 1174 aut (*for siue*) 1241 et (*for vt*) S 1302 sibi tuta
1312 scit SD 1334 Cantus 1338 ipse 1361 internis D 1390 Reddidit
1425 mutantia 1431 fuit 1440 Poenis 1461 deprimere 1525 statim S
1531 subito D 1587 per longum 1654 in medio 1656 nimis 1662 patebit S
1695 rubens pingit gemmis 1792 dixi (*for dedi*) 1794 nichil (*for nil vel*)
1855 coniuncta 1870 imbuet S 1910 tempore 1927 et (*for vt*) 1941 Claudit
1974 parat 1985 *om.* numen 2009 tunc 2017 inde 2118 ulla

LIB. II. *Prol.* 10 ora 39 ore 40 fugam iste

LIB. II. 9 obstat D 65 Desuper D 70 Et qui pauca tenet 84 Causa tamen
credo 175 continuo 191 migratrix 205 Et (*for Atque*) 253 cum 271 Jonah

303 jam (*for* tam) 352 ut 401 lecto 461 monent 545 morte (*for* monte)
570 prædicat 608 fæcundari 628 Dicit

LIB. III. *Prol.* 9 sed et increpo 77 oro 90 potuit (*for* ponit)

LIB. III. 4* exempla D mundus (*for* humus) D 18* ei D 27* poterint D
41 sensus 59 cum (*for* eum) 76 Dicunt 141 possit (*for* poscit) 176 onus (*for*
ouis) S 191 magnates 207 nimium (*for* nummi) 209 luxuriatio D
225 expugnareque 333 capiunt 382 ad (*for* in) 383 teli (*for* tali) 469 *om.* est
after amor 535 Quem (*for* Quam) 595 terram SD 701 Sublime 845 manu
891 Sic (*for* Sicque) 933 vertatur 954 nostra 969 portamus nomen 971 nobis
data D 976 renovare 989 sic (*for* sit) S 1214 et 1234 attulerat 1265 fallit S
1357 mundus habet 1376 et (*for* vt) S 1454 *om.* est 1455 Est; (*for* Et)
1487 intendit 1538 ibi est 1541 Durius 1546 crebro 1695 sua (*for* si) S
1747 vovit SD 1759 et sutorem 1863 vulnere SD 1936 intrat 1960 de se
1962 Nam 2049 ese 2085 agunt

LIB. IV. 26 callidis 67 vivens (*for* niueus) 72 esse (*for* ipse) S 259 Sæpe (*for*
Sepeque) 273 et (*for* vt) S 294 perdant 295 bona qui sibi D 336 non (*for* iam)
S 435 quid tibi 451 Ac 453 cupiensque 531 at (*for* et) 565 ex (*for* hee)
567 Simpliciter 583 teneræ 588 præparat 593 ibi S 600 thalamus
610 claustra 662 patet SD 675 Credo 769 In terra 785 ut 799 putabat S
811 et (*for* ad) S 863 sed nec (*for* non set) 865 quem fur quasi 958 possit
1000 fratris (*for* patris) 1038 Livorem 1081 adoptio S 1127 fallat 1214 vanis
1222* Usurpet ipsa

LIB. V. 1 sic D 18 ei (*for* ita) D 101 cernis 104 atque 159 par est 178 fuit
(*for* sitit) 217 senos (*for* seus) 262 Carnis 281 si S 290 sonet 321 valet (*for*
deceat) 338 vanis 375 ille 420 Pretia (*for* Recia) 461 At 486 redemit (*for*
redeunt) 501 non (*for* nos) S 508 geret 668 Si 672 Maxime 745 foras (*for*
foris) 805 etenim (*for* eciam) S 928 est (*for* et) 936 semine 937 pacis (*for*
piscis) 955 ubi (*for* sibi) S

LIB. VI. 54 renuere 132 ipsa 133 locuples 212 ocius (*for* cicius) 245 ibi
(*for* sibi) 319 Sæpe (*for* Sepius) 405 in 'æque' (*for* ineque) 411 descendat
476 quem S 488 Cesset 530 populus, væ (*for* populus ve) 548 ipse D
646 ruat 679 legit S 746 Num 755 Nam (*for* Dum) 789 majus (*for* inanis)
816 Credo 971 Rex (*for* Pax) 1016 gemmes 1033 quid (*for* quod) 1041 Hæc
(*for* Hic) 1132 fide (*for* fine) 1156 minuat D 1171* detangere (*for* te tangere)
D 1172* hæc D 1182* foras D 1197 veteris (*for* verteris) 1210* Subditus
1224 *om.* carnem 1225* decens (*for* docens) D lega 1241 Hic (*for* Dic)
1251 defunctus D 1260 ab hoc 1281 est ille pius (*for* ille pius est) 1327 nunc
moritur

LIB. VII. 9 magnatum S 93 magnates D 96 nummis (*for* minimis)
109 Antea 149 sic sunt 185 Virtutem 290 Aucta (*for* Acta) 339 honorifica
350 credit S 409 servus cap. vi. *heading* l. 4 sinit (*for* sunt) 555 vultum 562 ff.
Quid (*for* Quod) 601 quam 602 adesse (*for* ad esse) 635 Præceptum (*for*
Preceptumque) 665 agnoscit 707 enim (*for* eum) cap. ix. *heading om.* postea
736 decus (*for* pecus) 750 ille (*for* ipse) cap. xi. *heading* dicitur (*for* loquitur)
798 capit (*for* rapit) 828 etiam (*for* iam) 903 *om.* nil 918 est (*for* et) S
977 benefecit D 1043 frigor 1129 qui non iussa Dei servat 1178 eam
1278 opes S 1310 Vix (*for* Vis) 1369 digna 1454 hic (*for* hinc) 1474 bona
1479* ipsa

It will be seen that most of the above variants are due to mere oversight. It is surprising, however, that so many mistakes seriously affecting sense and metre should have escaped the correction of the editor.

In the matter of spelling the variation is considerable, but all that need be said is that the Roxburghe editor preferred the classical to the medieval forms. On the other hand it is to be regretted that no attempt is made by him to mark the paragraph divisions of the original. A minor inconvenience, which is felt by all readers who have to refer to the Roxburghe text, arises from the fact that the book-numbering is not set at the head of the page.

In the case of the *Cronica Tripertita* we have the text printed by Wright in the Rolls Series as well as that of the Roxburghe edition. The latter is from the All Souls MS., while the former professes to be based upon the Cotton MS., so that the two texts ought to be quite independent. As a matter of fact, however, several of the mistakes or misprints of the Roxburghe text are reproduced in the Rolls edition, which was printed probably from a copy of the Roxburghe text collated with the Cotton MS.

The following are the variations of the Roxburghe text from that of the present edition.

Introduction, margin 2 prosequi (*for* persequi).

I. 1 *om.* et per (*for* fer) 7 bene non 15 consilium sibi 71 fraudis 93 cum (*for* dum) 132 hos (*for* os) 161 *marg. om.* qui S 173 ausam S 182 Sic (*for* Hic) 199 clientem 204 cepit (*for* cessat) 209 Regem (*for* Legem) 219 Qui est (*for* est qui)

II. 9 sociatus (*for* associatus) 61 manu tentum 85 *marg.* quia (*for* qui) 114 de pondere 156 sepulchrum 180 maledictum 220 Transulit 223 omne scelus 237 ipsum 266 Pontifice 271 malefecit 315 *marg.* derisu 330 *marg.* Consulat 333 adeo.

III. 109 prius S 131 viles S 177 conjunctus 188 sceleris 235 mane 239 nunc S 242 freta (*for* fata) 250 ponere 263 Exilia 285 *marg.* præter (*for* personaliter) 287 Nec 288 stanno 333 conquescat 341 auget 372 eo (*for* et) 422 *marg.* fidelissime 428 prius S

Of the above errors several, as we have said, are reproduced by Wright with no authority from his MS.⁷⁴, but otherwise his text is a tolerably correct representation of that given by the Cotton MS., and the same may be said with regard to the other poems *Carmen super multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia*, *De Lucis Scrutinio*⁷⁵, &c.

THE PRESENT EDITION. The text is in the main that of S, which is supplemented, where it is defective, by C. The Cotton MS. is also the leading authority for those pieces which are not contained in S, as the four last poems.

For the *Vox Clamantis* four manuscripts have been collated with S word for word throughout, viz. CHDL, and two more, viz. GE, have been collated generally and examined for every doubtful passage. TH₂ have been carefully examined and taken as authorities for the original text of some of the revised passages.

As regards the record of the results of these rather extensive collations, it may be stated generally that all material variations of C and H from the text of S have been recorded in the critical notes⁷⁶. The readings of E, D and L have been printed regularly for those passages in which material variations of other MSS. are recorded, and in such cases, if they are not mentioned, it may be assumed that they agree with S; but otherwise they are mentioned only when they seem to deserve attention. The readings of G are recorded in a large number of instances, but they must not be assumed *ex silentio*, and those of T and H₂ are as a rule only given in passages where they have a different version of the text.

A trifling liberty has been taken with the text of the MSS. in regard to the position of the conjunction 'que' (and). This is frequently used by our author like 'et,' standing at the beginning of a clause or between the words which it combines, as

'Sic lecto vigilans meditabar plura, que mentem
Effudi,'

or

'Cutte que Curre simul rapidi per deuia currunt,'

but it is also very often used in the correct classical manner. The MSS. make no distinction between these two uses, but sometimes join the conjunction to the preceding word and sometimes separate it, apparently in a quite arbitrary manner. For the sake of clearness the conjunction is separated in this edition regularly when the sense requires that it should be

taken independently of the preceding word, and the variations of the manuscripts with regard to this are not recorded.

Again, some freedom has been used in the matter of capital letters, which have been supplied, where they were wanting, in the case of proper names and at the beginning of sentences.

The spelling is in every particular the same as that of the MS. The practice of altering the medieval orthography, which is fairly consistent and intelligible, so as to make it accord with classical or conventional usage, has little or nothing to be said for it, and conceals the evidence which the forms of spelling might give with regard to the prevalent pronunciation.

The principal differences in our text from the classical orthography are as follows:

e regularly for the diphthongs *ae*, *oe*.

i for *e* in *periunt*, *rediat*, *nequio*, &c. (but also *pereunt*, &c.).

y for *i* in *ymus*, *ymago*, &c.

i for *y*, e.g. *mirrha*, *ciclus*, *limpha*.

v for *u* or *v* regularly as initial letter of words, elsewhere *u*.

vowels doubled in *hii*, *hee*, *hiis* (monosyllables).

u for *uu* after *q*, e.g. *equus*, *iniquus*, *sequuntur*.

initial *h* omitted in *ara* (*hāra*), *edus* (*haedus*), *ortus*, *yemps*, &c.

initial *h* added in *habundat*, *heremus*, *Herebus*, &c.

ch for *h* in *michi*, *nichil*.

ch for *c* in *archa*, *archanum*, *inchola*, *choruscat*, &c. (but *Cristus*, when fully written, for 'Christus').

ci for *ti* regularly before a vowel e.g. *accio*, *alcus*, *cercus*, *distincio*, *gracia*, *sentencia*, *viciu*.

c for *s* or *sc*, in *ancer*, *cerpo*, *ceptrum*, *rocidus*, *Cilla*.

s for *c* or *sc*, in *secus* (occasionally for 'caecus'), *sintilla*, &c.

single for double consonants in *apropriat*, *suplet*, *agredior*, *resurexit*, &c. (also *appropriat*, &c.).

ph for *f* in *scroph*, *nephas*, *nephandus*, *prophanus*, &c.

p inserted in *dampnum*, *sompnus*, &c.

set usually in the best MSS. for *sed* (conjunction), but in the Cotton MS. usually 'sed.'

It has been thought better to print the elegiac couplet without indentation for the pentameter, partly because that is the regular usage in the

MSS. and must of course have been the practice of the author, but still more in order to mark more clearly the division into paragraphs, to which the author evidently attached some importance. Spaces of varying width are used to show the larger divisions. It is impossible that there should not be some errors in the printed text, but the editor can at least claim to have taken great pains to ensure correctness, and all the proof-sheets have been carefully compared with the text of the manuscripts.

For convenience of reference the lines are numbered as in the Roxburghe edition, though perhaps it would be more satisfactory to combine the prologues, as regards numbering, with the books to which they belong.

In regard to the Notes there are no doubt many deficiencies. The chief objects aimed at have been to explain difficulties of language, to illustrate the matter or the style by reference to the works of the author in French and in English, and to trace as far as possible the origin of those parts of his work which are borrowed. In addition to this, the historical record contained in the *Cronica Tripertita* has been carefully compared with the evidence given by others with regard to the events described, and possibly this part of the editor's work, being based entirely upon the original authorities, may be thought to have some small value as a contribution to the history of a singularly perplexing political situation.

FOOTNOTES:

¹ 2nd Series, vol. ii. pp. 103-117.

² *Script. Brit.* i. 414.

³ *Itin.* vi. 55. From Foss, *Tabulae Curiales*, it would seem that there was no judge named Gower in the 14th century.

⁴ *Script. Brit.* i. 414. This statement also appears as a later addition in the manuscript.

⁵ 'Gower' appears in Tottill's publication of the Year-books (1585) both in 29 and 30 Ed. III, e.g. 29 Ed. III, Easter term, ff. 20, 27, 33, 46, and 30 Ed. III, Michaelmas term, ff. 16, 18, 20 v^o. He appears usually as counsel, but on some occasions he speaks apparently as a judge. The Year-books of the succeeding years, 31-36 Ed. III, have not been published.

⁶ These arms appear also in the Glasgow MS. of the *Vox Clamantis*.

⁷ *Worthies*, ed. 1662, pt. 3, p. 207.

⁸ e.g. Winstanley, Jacob, Cibber and others.

- ⁹ *Ancient Funeral Monuments*, p. 270. This Sir Rob. Gower had property in Suffolk, as we shall see, but the fact that his tomb was at Brabourne shows that he resided in Kent. The arms which were upon his tomb are pictured (without colours) in MS. Harl. 3917, f. 77.
- ¹⁰ *Rot. Pat.* dated Nov. 27, 1377.
- ¹¹ *Rot. Claus.* 4 Ric. II. m. 15 d.
- ¹² *Rot. Pat.* dated Dec. 23, 1385.
- ¹³ *Rot. Pat.* dated Aug. 12, Dec. 23, 1386.
- ¹⁴ It may here be noted that the poet apparently pronounced his name 'Gowér,' in two syllables with accent on the second, as in the Dedication to the *Balades*, i. 3, 'Vostre Gower, q'est trestout vos soubgitz.' The final syllable bears the rhyme in two passages of the *Confessio Amantis* (viii. 2320, 2908), rhyming with the latter syllables of 'pouer' and 'reposer'. (The rhyme in viii. 2320, 'Gower: pouer,' is not a dissyllabic one, as is assumed in the *Dict. of Nat. Biogr.* and elsewhere, but of the final syllables only.) In the *Praise of Peace*, 373, 'I, Gower, which am al the liege man,' an almost literal translation of the French above quoted, the accent is thrown rather on the first syllable.
- ¹⁵ See *Retrospective Review*, 2nd Series, vol. ii, pp. 103-117 (1828). Sir H. Nicolas cites the Close Rolls always at second hand and the *Inquisitiones Post Mortem* only from the Calendar. Hence the purport of the documents is sometimes incorrectly or insufficiently given by him. In the statement here following every document is cited from the original, and the inaccuracies of previous writers are corrected, but for the most part silently.
- ¹⁶ *Inquis. Post Mortem*, &c. 39 Ed. III. 36 (2nd number). This is in fact an 'Inquisitio ad quod damnum.' The two classes of Inquisitions are given without distinction in the Calendar, and the fact leads to such statements as that 'John Gower died seized of half the manor of Aldyngton, 39 Ed. III,' or 'John Gower died seized of the manor of Kentwell, 42 Ed. III.'
- ¹⁷ *Rot. Orig.* 39 Ed. III. 27.
- ¹⁸ *Rot. Claus.* 39 Ed. III. m. 21 d.
- ¹⁹ *Rot. Claus.* 39 Ed. III. m. 21 d.
- ²⁰ *Harl. Charters*, 56 G. 42. See also *Rot. Orig.* 42 Ed. III. 33 and *Harl. Charters*, 56 G. 41.
- ²¹ *Harl. Charters*, 50 I. 13.
- ²² See *Rot. Orig.* 23 Ed. III. 22, 40 Ed. III. 10, 20, *Inquis. Post Mortem*, 40 Ed. III. 13, *Rot. Claus.* 40 Ed. III. m. 21.
- ²³ *Harl. Charters*, 50 I. 14. The deed is given in full by Nicolas in the *Retrospective Review*.
- ²⁴ *Rot. Orig.* 48 Ed. III. 31.
- ²⁵ The tinctures are not indicated either upon the drawing of Sir R. Gower's coat of arms in MS. Harl. 3917 or on the seal, but the coat seems to be the same, three leopards' faces upon a chevron. The seal has a diaper pattern on the shield that bears the chevron, but this is probably only ornamental.
- ²⁶ 'Et dicunt quod post predictum feoffamentum, factum predicto Iohanni Gower, dictus Willelmus filius Willelmi continue morabatur in comitiva Ricardi de Hurst et eiusdem Iohannis Gower apud Cantuar, et alibi usque ad festum Sancti Michaelis ultimo preteritum, et per totum tempus predictum idem Willelmus fil. Will. ibidem per ipsos deductus fuit et consiliatus ad alienationem de terris et tenementis suis faciendam.' *Rot. Parl.* ii. 292.

- [27](#) *Rot. Claus.* 43 Ed. III. m. 30.
- [28](#) *Rot. Claus.* 42 Ed. III. m. 13 d.
- [29](#) *English Writers*, vol. iv. pp. 150 ff.
- [30](#) See *Calendar of Post Mortem Inquisitions*, vol. ii. pp. 300, 302.
- [31](#) So also the deeds of 1 Ric. II releasing lands to Sir J. Frebody and John Gower (Hasted's *History of Kent*, iii. 425), and of 4 Ric. II in which Isabella daughter of Walter de Huntyngfeld gives up to John Gower and John Bowland all her rights in the parishes of Throwley and Stalesfield, Kent (*Rot. Claus.* 4 Ric. II. m. 15 d), and again another in which the same lady remits to John Gower all actions, complaints, &c., which may have arisen between them (*Rot. Claus.* 8 Ric. II. m. 5 d).
- [32](#) *Rot. Franc.* 1 Ric. II. pt. 2, m. 6.
- [33](#) See also Sir N. Harris Nicolas, *Life of Chaucer*, pp. 27, 125.
- [34](#) *Rot. Claus.* 6 Ric. II. m. 27 d, and 24 d.
- [35](#) *Rot. Claus.* 6 Ric. II. pt. 1, m. 23 d.
- [36](#) *Rot. Claus.* 7 Ric. II. m. 17 d.
- [37](#) *Duchy of Lancaster, Miscellanea*, Bundle X, No. 43 (now in the Record Office).
- [38](#) 'Liverez a Richard Dancastre pour un Coler a luy doné par monseigneur le Conte de Derby par cause d'une autre Coler doné par monditseigneur a un Esquier John Gower, vynt et sys soldz oyt deniers.'
- [39](#) *Duchy of Lancaster, Household Accounts*, 17 Ric. II (July to Feb.).
- [40](#) *Register of William of Wykeham*, ii. f. 299b. The record was kindly verified for me by the Registrar of the diocese of Winchester. The expression used about the place is 'in Oratorio ipsius Iohannis Gower infra hospicium suum' (not 'cum' as previously printed) 'in Prioratu Beate Marie de Overee in Southwerke predicta situatum.' It should be noted that 'infra' in these documents means not 'below,' as translated by Prof. Morley, but 'within.' So also in Gower's will.
- [41](#) Lambeth Library, *Register of Abp. Arundel*, ff. 256-7.
- [42](#) The remark of Nicolas about the omission of Kentwell from the will is hardly appropriate. Even if Gower the poet were identical with the John Gower who possessed Kentwell, this manor could not have been mentioned in his will, because it was disposed of absolutely to Sir J. Cobham in the year 1373. Hence there is no reason to conclude from this that there was other landed property besides that which is dealt with by the will.
- [43](#) I am indebted for some of the facts to Canon Thompson of St. Saviour's, Southwark, who has been kind enough to answer several questions which I addressed to him.
- [44](#) The features are quite different, it seems to me, from those represented in the Cotton and Glasgow MSS., and I think it more likely that the latter give us a true contemporary portrait. Gower certainly died in advanced age, yet the effigy on his tomb shows us a man in the flower of life. This then is either an ideal representation or must have been executed from rather distant memory, whereas the miniatures in the MSS., which closely resemble each other, were probably from life, and also preserve their original colouring. The miniatures in MSS. of the *Confessio Amantis*, which represent the Confession, show the penitent usually as a conventional young lover. The picture in the Fairfax MS. is too much damaged to give us much guidance, but it does not seem to be a portrait, in spite of the collar of SS added later. The miniature in MS.

Bodley 902, however, represents an aged man, while that of the Cambridge MS. Mm. 2. 21 rather recalls the effigy on the tomb and may have been suggested by it.

- [45](#) We may note that the effigy of Sir Robert Gower in brass above his tomb in Brabourne church is represented as having a similar chaplet round his helmet. See the drawing in MS. Harl. 3917, f. 77.
- [46](#) So I read them. They are given by Gough and others as ‘merci ihi.’
- [47](#) Perhaps rather 1207 or 1208.
- [48](#) *Script. Brit.* i. 415; so also *Ant. Coll.* iv. 79, where the three books are mentioned. The statement that the chaplet was partly of ivy must be a mistake, as is pointed out by Stow and others.
- [49](#) Read rather ‘En toy qu’es fitz de dieu le pere.’
- [50](#) Read ‘O bon Jesu, fai ta mercy’ and in the second line ‘dont le corps gist cy.’
- [51](#) *Survey of London*, p. 450 (ed. 1633). In the margin there is the note, ‘John Gower no knight, neither had he any garland of ivy and roses, but a chaplet of four roses only,’ referring to Bale, who repeats Leland’s description.
- [52](#) p. 326 (ed. 1615). Stow does not say that the inscription ‘Armigeri scutum,’ &c.; was defaced in his time.
- [53](#) vol. ii. p. 542.
- [54](#) vol. v. pp. 202-4. The description is no doubt from Aubrey.
- [55](#) On this subject the reader may be referred to Selden, *Titles of Honour*, p. 835 f. (ed. 1631).
- [56](#) *Antiquities of St. Saviour’s, Southwark*, 1765.
- [57](#) vol. ii. p. 24.
- [58](#) *Priory Church of St. Mary Overie*, 1881.
- [59](#) Canon Thompson writes to me, ‘The old sexton used to show visitors a bone, which he said was taken from the tomb in 1832. I tried to have this buried in the tomb on the occasion of the last removal, but I was told it had disappeared.’
- [60](#) vol. ii. p. 91.
- [61](#) *Bp. Braybrooke’s Register*, f. 84.
- [62](#) *Braybrooke Register*, f. 151.
- [63](#) The date of the resignation by John Gower of the rectory of Great Braxted is nearly a year earlier than the marriage of Gower the poet.
- [64](#) I do not know on what authority Rendle states that ‘His apartment seems to have been in what was afterwards known as Montague Close, between the church of St. Mary Overey and the river,’ *Old Southwark*, p. 182.
- [65](#) At the same time I am disposed to attach some weight to the expression in *Mir.* 21774, where the author says that some may blame him for handling sacred subjects, because he is no ‘clerk,’

‘Ainz ai vestu la raye manche.’

This may possibly mean only to indicate the dress of a layman, but on the other hand it seems clear that some lawyers, perhaps especially the ‘apprenticii ad legem,’ were distinguished by stripes upon their sleeves; see for example the painting reproduced in Pulling’s *Order of the Coif* (ed. 1897); and serjeants-at-law are referred to in *Piers Plowman*, A text, Pass. iii. 277, as wearing a ‘ray robe with rich pelure.’ We must admit, therefore, the possibility that Gower was bred to the law, though he may not have practised it for a living.

[66](#) The Lincoln MS. has the same feature, but it is evidently copied from Laud 719.

[67](#) There seems also to have been an alternative numbering, which proceeded on the principle of making five books, beginning with the third, the second being treated as a general prologue to the whole poem. In connexion with this we may take the special invocation of divine assistance in the prologue of the third book, which ends with the couplet,

‘His tibi libatis nouus intro nauta profundum,
Sacrum pneuma rogans vt mea vela regas.’

[68](#) Fuller’s spirited translation of these lines is well known, but may here be quoted again:

‘Tom comes thereat, when called by Wat, and Simm as
forward we find,
Bet calls as quick to Gibb and to Hykk, that neither
would tarry behind.
Gibb, a good whelp of that litter, doth help mad Coll
more mischief to do,
And Will he does vow, the time is come now, he’ll join
in their company too.
Davie complains, whiles Grigg gets the gains, and Hobb
with them does partake,
Lorkin aloud in the midst of the crowd conceiveth as
deep is his stake.
Hudde doth spoil whom Judde doth foil, and Tebb lends
his helping hand,
But Jack the mad patch men and houses does snatch, and
kills all at his command.’

Church History, Book iv. (p. 139).

[69](#) In the first version, ‘Complaints are heard now of the injustice of the high court: flatterers have power over it, and those who speak the truth are not permitted to come near to the king’s side. The boy himself is blameless, but his councillors are in fault. If the king were of mature age, he would redress the balance of justice, but he is too young as yet to be held responsible for choice of advisers: it is not from the boy but from his elders that the evil springs which overruns the world.’

[70](#) In the first version as follows, ‘O king of heaven, who didst create all things, I pray thee preserve my young king, and let him live long and see good days. O king, mayest thou ever hold thy sceptre with honour and triumph, as Augustus did at Rome. May he who gave thee the power confirm it to thee in the future.

For the glory of thy rule I have written these lines with humble heart. O
flower of boyhood, according to thy worthiness I wish thee prosperity.’

[71](#) In the first version, ‘I am myself the worst of sinners, but may God grant me relief by his Spirit.’

[72](#) Communicated to me by Miss Bateson.

- [73](#) It is even the case in one instance (i. 846) that a blank is left in the line for a word omitted in D which might have been supplied by reference to any other MS. which contained the passage. So difficult was communication between Oxford and London in those days.
- [74](#) e.g. i. 209 Regem 219 Qui est ii. 9 sociatus 114 de pondere 266 Pontifice.
- [75](#) A few errors may be noted in the poem *De Lucis Scrutinio*, viz. l. 15 manifestus 36 oculis 66 similatam 89 Ominis (*for* O nimis); also in 'O deus immense,' l. 28 se (*for* te) 104 sub (*for* sue).
- [76](#) Trifling differences of spelling are as a rule not recorded. Examples of such variations are the following in C: i. 1 ut 11 uidet 23 choruschat 120 talamum 137 sydera 139 themone 141 &c. sed (*for* set) 196 &c. amodo 234 prohdolor 311 Immundos 586 Egiptus 1056 Symonis 1219 Ocupat 1295 suppressis 1505 loquturus 1514 Obstetit 1755 opprobrium 1832 littora 1947 litora 2094 patiens ii. *Prol.* 11 etiam ii. 57 fatie 261 Moise 494 synagoga iii. 291 redditus, &c. Variation in the use of capital letters or in regard to the separation of 'que,' 've,' &c. from the words which they follow is usually not recorded. The spelling of H and G is almost identical with that of S.

EPISTOLA⁷⁷

Hanc Epistolam subscriptam corde deuoto misit senex et cecus Iohannes Gower Reuerendissimo in Cristo Patri ac domino suo precipuo, domino Thome de Arundell, Cantuariensi Archiepiscopo, tocius Anglie Primati et apostolice sedis legato. Cuius statum ad ecclesie sue regimen dirigat et feliciter conseruet filius virginis gloriose, dominus noster Ihesus Cristus, qui cum deo patre et spiritu sancto viuuit et regnat deus per omnia secula seculorum. Amen.

Successor Thome, Thomas, humilem tibi do me,
Hunc et presentem librum tibi scribo sequentem:
Qu o d tibi presento s c r i p t u m⁷⁸ retinere memento,
Vt contempletur super hoc quo m e n s s t i m u l e t u r.
Curia diuisa que Rome stat modo visa,
Dum se peruertit, in luctum gaudia vertit:
Et quia lex Cristi dolet isto tempore tristi,
Hoc ad p l a n g e n d u m librum tibi mitto legendum.
S e t t u , diuine qui lumen habes
 medicine,
Gaudeat vt tristis, confer medicamen
10 in istis:
Dummodo lux cessit, alibique fides
 tenebrescit,
Tu noster Phebus nostris da lumina rebus,
Et quod splendas, virtute tuaque calescas,
Hoc magis ad lumen tibi scriptum dono volumen.
I n s p e c u l o tali de pectore iudiciali
Si videas plane, puto non erit illud inane.
Cecus ego m e r e, nequo licet acta videre,

Te tamen in mente memorabor corde vidente.
 Corpore defectus, quamuis michi curua se nectus
 Torquet, adhuc mentem studio sinit
 20 esse manentem,
 Et sic cum Cristo persto studiosus in isto,
 Quo mundi gesta tibi scribam iam manifesta.
 Hinc, pater, exoro, scripturis dumque laboro,
 Ad requiem mentis animam dispone studentis;
 Semper speraui, que patrem te semper amaui,
 Quo michi finalis tua gracia sit
 specialis.
 Nunc quia diuisus meus est a corpore
 visus,
 Lux tua que lucet anime vestigia
 ducet,
 Corpus et egrotum, vetus et
 miserabile totum,
 30 Ne conturbetur, te defensore iuuetur;
 Et sic viuentem custos simul et
 morientem
 Suscipe me cecum tua per suffragia
 tecum.
 Lux tua morosa de stirpe micans
 generosa
 Condita sub cinere non debet in orbe
 latere.
 Claret Arundella quasi Sol de luce nouella,
 Que te produxit, que te prius vbere succit.
 Es quia totus Mas vocitaris origine Thomas,
 Vnde deo totus sis ab omni labe remotus;
 Et sic prelatus nunc Cristi lege sacratus
 40 Legem conseruas, qua te sine labe reseruas.
 Stat modo segura tua lux, sine crimine pura,
 Claraque lucescit, quod eam nil turpe
 repressit:
 Anglia letetur, lumen quia tale meretur,
 Quo bene viuentes tua sint exempla sequentes.

Per te succedet amor omnis, et ira recedet,
Subque tua cura sunt prospera cuncta futura:
Et quia sic creuit tua lux, terramque repleuit,
Det deus vt talis tibi lux sit perpetualis.
Hec Gower querit, qui tuus est et erit.

FOOTNOTES:

[77](#) *This Epistle is found in the All Souls MS. only.*

[78](#) *Words written over erasure in the MS. are printed in spaced type.*

VOX CLAMANTIS⁷⁹

In huius opusculi principio intendit compositor describere qualiter serviles rustici impetuose contra ingenuos et nobiles regni insurrexerunt. Et quia res huiusmodi velut⁸⁰ monstrum detestabilis fuit et horribilis, fingit⁸¹ se per sompnum vidisse diuersas vulgi turmas in diuersas species bestiarum domesticarum transmutatas: dicit tamen quod ille bestie domestice, a sua deuiantes natura, crudelitates ferarum sibi presumpserunt. De causis vero, ex quibus inter homines talia contingunt enormia, tractat vltius secundum distinciones libelli istius, qui in septem diuiditur partes, prout inferius locis suis euidentius apparebit.

Sequitur prologus.

Capitula libri Primi.

Cap^m. i. Hic declarat in primis sub cuius Regis imperio, in quibus eciam⁸² mense et anno, ista sibi accidencia, cuius tenor subsequitur, continebat. Commendat insuper, secundum illud quod esse solebat, fertilitatem terre illius vbi ipse tunc fuerat, in qua, vt dicit, omnium quasi rerum delicie pariter conveniunt, et loquitur vltius de amenitate temporis, necnon et de diei serenitate, que tunc tamen⁸³ sompnum nimis horribile precedebant.

Cap^m. ii. Hic incipit sompnum, vbi quodam die Martis dicit se varias vulgi turmas vidisse, quarum primam in similitudinem asinorum mutari subito speculabatur.

Cap^m. iii. Hic dicit se per sompnum quandam vulgi turmam in boues vidisse mutatam.

Cap^m. iiii. Hic dicit se per sompnum quandam vulgi turmam in porcos vidisse mutatam.

Cap^m. v. Hic dicit se per sompnum quandam vulgi turmam in canes vidisse mutatam.

- Cap^m. vi. Hic dicit se per sompnum quandam vulgi turmam in murelegos et vulpes vidisse mutata: dicit murelegos vt seruos domesticos; dicit vulpes, quia fures ruptis vbique Gaiolis liberi tunc eos comitabantur.⁸⁴
- Cap^m. vii. Hic dicit se per sompnum quandam vulgi turmam in aues domesticas vidisse mutata, quibus dicit quod bubones quasi predones commixti associebantur.⁸⁵
- Cap^m. viii. Hic dicit se per sompnum quandam vulgi turmam in muscas et ranas vidisse mutata.
- Cap^m. ix. Hic dicit se per sompnum vidisse quod, quando omnes predictae furie in vnum extiterant congregatae, quidam Graculus auis, Anglice Gay,⁸⁶ qui vulgariter vocatur Watte, presumpsit sibi statum regiminis aliorum, et in rei veritate ille Watte fuit dux eorum.
- Cap^m. x. Hic dicit se per sompnum vidisse progenies Chaym maledictas vna cum multitudine seruorum nuper Regis Vlaxis, quos Circes in bestias mutauit, furiis supradictis associari.
- Cap^m. xi. Hic dicit secundum visionem sompni qualiter audiuit nomina et eorum voces diuersas et horribiles. Dicit etiam de Iohanne Balle presbitero, qui eos ad omne scelus instigabat, et quasi propheta inter eos reputabatur.
- Cap^m. xii. Hic dicit secundum visionem sompni qualiter furie supradictae precones sibi et tribunos constituebant, et quomodo senes et iuuenes eorum fuerunt armati.
- Cap^m. xiii. Hic dicit secundum visionem sompni qualiter et quando dictae furie, instigante diabolo, Nouam Troiam, id est ciuitatem Londoniarum, ingresse sunt: nam sicut Troia nuper desolata extitit, ita ista Ciuitas protunc quasi omni consolatione destituta pre dolore penitus ignominiosa permansit.
- Cap^m. xiiii. Hic tractat secundum visionem sompni quasi per figuram de morte Cantuariensis Archiepiscopi.

- Cap^m. xv. Hic tractat vltcrius secundum visionem sompnii de diuersa persecucione et occisione, quas in dicta Ciuitate quodammodo absque vlla pro tunc defensione furie supradicte, prodolor! faciebant, et qualiter huiusmodi fama vicinas perterruit ciuitates.
- Cap^m. xvi. Hic plangit secundum visionem sompnii quasi in propria persona dolores eorum, qui in siluis et speluncis pre timore temporis illius latitando se munierunt.
- Cap^m. xvii. Hic eciam secundum visionem sompnii describit quasi in persona propria angustias varias que contingebant hiis qui tunc pro securitate optinenda in Turrim Londoniarum se miserunt, et de ruptura eiusdem turris; figurat enim dictam turrim similem esse naui prope voraginem Cille periclitanti.
- Cap^m. xviii. Hic dicit secundum visionem sompnii qualiter tanta superhabundauit tempestas quod de certo remedio absque manu diuina omnes in dicta naui hesitarunt, et deum super hoc precipue quilibet sexus ingenui deuocius exorabat.
- Cap^m. xix. Hic dicit secundum visionem sompnii de quadam voce diuina in excelsis clamante, et quomodo deus placatus tandem precibus tempestates sedauit, et quomodo quasi in holocaustum pro delicto occisus fuit ille Graculus, id est Walterus, furiarum dictarum Capitaneus.
- Cap^m. xx. Hic loquitur adhuc de naui visa in sompnis, id est de mente sua adhuc turbata, vt si ipse mentaliter sompniando, quasi per nauem variis ventis sine gubernaculo agitatam, omnes mundi partes pro pace mentis scrutanda inuestigasset, et tandem in partes Britannie Maioris, vbi raro pax est, dicit se applicuisse. Dicit eciam qualiter vox in sompnis sibi iniunxit quod ipse omnino scriberet ea que de mundo in illo scrutinio vidisset et audisset; et ita terminatur sompnum.
- Cap^m. xxi. Hic reddit vigilans gracias deo, qui eum in sompnis a pelago liberauit.

Expliciunt Capitula libri primi.

Incipiunt Capitula libri Secundi.

Prologus. Hic dicit quod ipse iam vigilans, secundum vocem quam in sompnis acceperat, intendit scribere ea que de mundo vidit et audiuit, et vocat libellum istum Vox Clamantis, quia de voce et clamore quasi omnium conceptus est; vnde in huius operis auxilium spiritum sanctum inuocat.

Cap^m. i. Hic dicit, secundum quod de clamore communi audiuit, qualiter status et ordo mundi precipue in partibus istis multipliciter in peius variatur, et quomodo vnusquisque super hoc fortunam accusat.

Cap^m. ii. Hic corripit fortunam et sui euentus inconstanciam deplangit.

Cap^m. iii. Hic describit fortunam secundum aliquos, qui sortem fortune dicunt esse et⁸⁷ casum.

Cap^m. iiij.⁸⁸ Hic tractat vlterius de mutacione fortune secundum quod dicunt: concludit tamen in fine, quod neque sorte aut casu, set ex meritis vel demeritis, sunt ea que hominibus contingunt.

Cap^m. v.⁸⁹ Hic dicit secundum scripturas et allegat, qualiter omnes creature homini iusto seruientes obediunt.

Cap^m. vi. Hic tractat secundum scripturas et allegat, qualiter omnes creature homini peccatori aduersantes inobediunt.

Cap^m. vii. Hic loquitur de deo summo Creatore, qui est trinus et vnus, in cuius scientia et disposicione omnia creata reguntur.

Cap^m. viii. Hic loquitur de filio dei incarnato domino nostro Ihesu Cristo, per quem de malo in bonum reformamur.

Cap^m. ix. Hic dicit quod quilibet debet firmiter credere, nec vltra quam decet argumenta fidei inuestigare.

Cap^m. x. Hic tractat quod in re sculptili vel conflatili non est confidendum, nec eciam talia adorari debent, set quod ex illis in ecclesia visis mens remorsa ad solum deum contemplandum cicius commoueatur.

Cap^m. xi. Hic dicit quod exquo solus deus omnia creauit, solus est a creaturis adorandus, et est eciam magne rationis vt ipse omnia gubernet, et secundum merita et demerita hominum solus in sua voluntate iudicet.

Expliciunt Capitula libri secundi.

Incipiunt Capitula libri Tercii.

Prologus. Hic dicit quod, exquo non a fortuna set meritis et demeritis ea que nos in mundo prospera et aduersa vocamus digno dei iudicio hominibus contingunt, intendit consequenter scribere de statu hominum, qualiter se ad presens habent, secundum hoc quod per sompnium superius dictum vidit et audiuit.

Cap^m. i. Hic tractat qualiter status et ordo mundi in tribus consistit gradibus: sunt enim, vt dicit, Clerus, Milicies, et Agricultores, de quorum errore mundi infortunia nobis contingunt. Vnde pre aliis videndum est de errore Cleri, precipue in ordine prelatorum, qui potenciores aliis existunt; et primo dicet de illis qui Cristi scolam dogmatizant et eius contrarium operantur.

Cap^m. ii. Hic loquitur de prelatis illis, qui carnalia appetentes vltra modum delicate viuunt.

Cap^m. iii. Hic loquitur de prelatis illis, qui lucris terrenis inhiant, honore prelacie gaudent, et non vt prosint sed vt presint episcopatum desiderant.

Cap^m. iiii. Hic loquitur de legibus eorum positiuis, que quamuis ad cultum anime necessarie non sunt, infinitas tamen constituciones quasi cotidie ad eorum lucrum nobis grauiter imponunt.⁹⁰

Cap^m. v. Hic loquitur de prelatis illis,⁹¹ qui bona mundi temporalia possidentes spiritualia omittunt.

Cap^m. vi. Hic loquitur⁹² qualiter Cristus pacem suis discipulis dedit et reliquit: dicit⁹³ tamen quod modo propter bona terrena guerras saltem contra Cristianos prelati legibus suis positiuis instituunt et prosequuntur.

Cap^m. vii. Hic loquitur⁹⁴ qualiter clerus in amore dei et proximi deberet pius et paciens existere, et non bellicosus.

Cap^m. viii. Hic tractat eciam⁹⁵ qualiter non decet prelatos ex impaciencia contra populum Cristianum aliquialiter⁹⁶ bella mouere; set tantum ex precibus absque impetu ire omnem deo adiuuante mundi deuincant maliciam.

Cap^m. ix. Hic tractat quod, sicut non decet dominos temporales usurpare sibi regimen in spiritualibus, ita nec decet cleri prelatos attemptare sibi guerras et huiusmodi temporalia, que mundi superbia et auaricia inducunt.

Cap^m. x. Hic querit quod, exquo prelati scribunt et docent ea que sunt pacis, quomodo in contrarium ea que sunt belli procurant et operantur. Ad quam tamen questionem ipse subsequenter respondet.

Cap^m. xi. Hic loquitur de prelatis illis, qui nomen sanctum sibi presumunt, apropiant tamen sibi terrena, nec aliis inde participando ex caritate subueniunt.

Cap^m. xii. Hic loquitur de Simonia prelatorum, et qualiter hii delicati, dicentes se esse ecclesiam, aliis grauiora imponunt, et multociens de censura horribili laicos pro modico impetuose torquent et infestant.

Cap^m. xiii. Hic loquitur qualiter prelatus non solum doctrina set etiam bonis actibus populo sibi commisso lucere deberet.

Cap^m. xiiii. Hic loquitur qualiter signa Anticristi in Curia Romana precipue ex auaricia secundum quosdam apparuerunt.

Cap^m. xv. Hic loquitur secundum commune dictum, qualiter⁹⁷ honores et non onera prelaie plures affectant, quo magis in ecclesia cessant virtutes, et vicia multipliciter accrescunt.

Cap^m. xvi. Postquam dictum est de illis qui errant in statu prelaie, dicendum est de errore curatorum, qui sub prelatis constituti, parochiarum curas sub animarum suarum periculo admittentes, negligenter omittunt: et primo intendit dicere de curatis illis qui suas curas omittentes ad seruiendum magnatum curiis adherent.

Cap^m. xvii. Hic loquitur de rectoribus illis, qui ab episcopo licentiati se fingunt ire scholas, vt sub nomine virtutis vicia corporalia frequentent.

Cap^m. xviii. Hic loquitur de rectoribus illis, qui in curis residentes, curas tamen negligentes, venacionibus precipue et voluptatibus penitus intendunt.

Cap^m. xix. Hic loquitur de rectoribus in curis residentibus, qui tamen curas animarum omittentes, quasi seculi mercatores singula de die in diem temporalia ementes et vendentes, mundi huius diuicias adquirunt.

Cap^m. xx. Postquam dictum est de errore illorum qui in ecclesia beneficiati existunt, iam dicendum est de presbiteris stipendiariis; de talibus saltem, qui non propter mundiciam et ordinis honestatem, set propter mundi oia gradum presbiteratus appetunt et assumunt. Et primo dicit de illis qui pro diuinis celebrandis excessiue se vendunt.

Cap^m. xxi. Hic loquitur de consueta presbiterorum voluptate, et qualiter hii stipendia plebis ex conuencione sumentes, indeuote pro mortuis orando non se debite ad suffragia mortuorum exonerant.

Cap^m. xxii. Hic tractat causam, quare accidit quod laici, quasi iuris amici, luxurie [98](#)presbiterorum consuetudinem abhorrentes, eam multociens castigantes grauiter affligunt.

Cap^m. xxiii. Hic scribit contra hoc quod aliqui presbiteri dicunt, qualiter ipsi in carnis luxuriam committendo non grauius hominibus laicis deum offendunt.

Cap^m. xxiiii. Hic describit qualiter omnia et singula que sacerdocii concernunt officium magne virtutis misteria designant. Et primo dicit de vestibis sacerdotalibus ex vtraque lege ob diuinam reuerenciam competenter dispositis.

Cap^m. xxv. Hic loquitur qualiter sacrificia de veteri lege altari debita fuerunt in figura ad exemplum nunc noue legis presbiterorum: dicit

vlterius qualiter eciam ex vtraque lege sacrificantes altari debent esse sine macula.

Cap^m. xxvi. Hic loquitur quod etas sufficiens, priusquam gradum sacerdocii sibi assumat, in homine requiritur: loquitur eciam de suorum rasura pilorum, et dicit quod talia in signum mundicie et sanctitatis specialiter presbiteris conveniunt. Dicit vlterius quod presbiteri a bonis non debent esse operibus ociosi.

Cap^m. xxvii.⁹⁹ Hic loquitur de presbiterorum dignitate spirituali, et qualiter hii, si bene agant sua officia, plus aliis proficiunt; sinautem, de suis malis exemplis delinquendi magis ministrant occasiones.

Cap^m. xxviii. Postquam dixit de errore illorum qui inter seculares sacerdocii ministerium sibi assumpserunt, intendit dicere secundum tempus nunc de errore scolarium, qui ecclesie plantule dicuntur.

Cap^m. xxix. Hic querit causam, que scolarium animos ad ordinem presbiteratus suscipiendum inducit: tres enim causas precipue allegat; tractat eciam de quarta causa, que raro ad presens contingit.

Expliciunt Capitula libri tercii.

Incipiunt Capitula libri Quarti.

Cap^m. i. Exquo tractauit de errore Cleri, ad quem precipue nostrarum spectat regimen animarum, iam intendit tractare de errore virorum Religiosorum. Et primo dicet de Monachis et aliis bonorum temporalium possessionem optinentibus: ordinis vero illorum sanctitatem commendans, illos precipue qui contraria faciunt opera redarguit.

Cap^m. ii. Hic loquitur de Monachis illis, qui contra primi ordinis statuta abstinence virtutem linquentes delicacias sibi corporales multipliciter assumunt.

Cap^m. iii. Hic loquitur qualiter modus¹⁰⁰ et regula, qui a fundatoribus ordinis primitus fuerant constituti, iam nouiter a viciorum

consuetudine in quampluribus s u b u e r t u n t u r.

Cap^m. iiii. Hic loquitur de Monachis illis, qui contra primitiua ordinis sui statuta mundi diuicias ad vsus malos, suo nesciente preposito, apropiare sibi clanculo presumunt.

Cap^m. v. Hic loquitur qualiter monachi extra claustrum vagare non debent.

Cap^m. vi. Hic loquitur de monachis illis, qui non pro diuino seruicio, sel magis pro huius mundi honore et voluptate, habitum sibi religionis assumunt.

Cap^m. vii. Hic loquitur qualiter paciencia vna cum ceteris virtutibus a quibusdam claustris, viciis supervenientibus, se transtulerunt.

Cap^m. viii. Hic loquitur quod sicut monachi ita et errantes canonici a suis sunt excessibus culpandi.

Cap^m. ix. Hic loquitur qualiter religiosi male viuentes omnibus aliis infelicissimi existunt.

Cap^m. x. Hic loquitur qualiter vnusquisque qui religionis ingredi voluerit professionem, cuncta mundi vicia penitus abnegare et anime virtutes adquirere et obseruare tenetur.

Cap^m. xi. Hic loquitur qualiter religiosi consorcia mulierum specialiter euitare debent.

Cap^m. xii. Hic tractat quasi sub compendio super hiis que in religionis professione secundum fundatorum sancciones districcius obseruanda finaliter existunt.

Cap^m. xiii. Hic loquitur vlterius de mulieribus illis, que in habitu Moniali sub sacre religionis velo professionem suscipientes ordinis sui continenciam non obseruant.

Cap^m. xiiii. Hic loquitur qualiter ordinarii ex sua visitacione, qua mulieres religione velatas se dicunt corrigere, ipsas multociens efficiunt deteriores.

Cap^m. xv.¹⁰¹ Hic loquitur de castitatis commendacione, que maxime in religione mulieribus convenit professis.

Cap^m. xvi. Postquam tractauit de illis qui in religione possessoria sui ordinis professionem offendunt, dicendum est iam de illis qui errant in ordine fratrum mendicantium; et primo dicet de hiis qui sub ficta paupertatis vmbra terrena lucra conspirantes quasi totius mundi dominium subiugarunt.

Cap^m. xvii. Hic loquitur de fratribus illis, qui per ypocrisim predicando populi peccata publice redarguentes, blandiciis tamen et voluptatibus clanculo deseruiunt.

Cap^m. xviii. Hic loquitur de fratribus illis, qui propter huius mundi famam, et quod ipsi eciam, quasi ab ordinis sui iugo exempti, ad confessiones audiendas digniores efficiantur, summas in studio scole cathedras affectant.

Cap^m. xix. Hic loquitur qualiter isti fratres inordinate viuentes ad ecclesie Cristi regimen non sunt aliqualiter necessarii.

Cap^m. xx. Hic loquitur qualiter isti fratres inordinate viuentes¹⁰² ad commune bonum vtiles aliqualiter¹⁰³ non existunt.

Cap^m. xxi. Hic loquitur de fratribus illis, qui incautos pueros etatis discrecionem non habentes in sui ordinis professionem attractando colloquiis blandis multipliciter illaqueant.

Cap^m. xxii. Hic loquitur de Apostazia fratrum ordinis mendicantium, precipue de his qui sub ficta ypocrisis simplicitate quasi vniuersorum Curias magnatum subuertunt, et inestimabiles suis ficticiis sepissime causant errores.

Cap^m. xxiii. Hic loquitur qualiter isti fratres mendicantes mundum circuiendo¹⁰⁴ amplioresque querendo delicias de loco in locum cum ocio se transferunt. Loquitur eciam de superfluis eorum edificiis, que quasi ab huius seculi potencioribus vltra modum delicate construuntur.

Cap^m. xxiiii. Hic loquitur qualiter, non solum in ordine fratrum mendicantium set eciam in singulis cleri gradibus, ea que virtutis esse solebant a viciis quasi generaliter subuertuntur. Dicit tamen

quod secundum quasdam Burnelli constitutiones istis precipue diebus modus et regula specialius obseruantur.

Expliciunt Capitula libri quarti.

Incipiunt Capitula libri Quinti.

- Cap^m. i. Postquam dictum est de illis qui in statu Cleri regere spiritualia deberent, dicendum est iam de hiis qui in statu Milicie temporalia defendere et supportare tenentur. Et primo distinguit causas, ex quibus ordo Militaris cepit originem.
- Cap^m. ii. Hic loquitur qualiter miles, qui in mulieris amorem exardescens ex concupiscencia armorum se implicat exercicio, vere laudis honorem ob hoc nullatenus meretur. Describit eciam infirmitates amoris illius, cuius passionis variis adinuicem motibus maxime contrariantur.
- Cap^m. iii. Hic describit formam mulieris speciose, ex cuius concupiscencia illaqueata militum corda rationis iudicio sepiissime destituuntur.
- Cap^m. ii. Hic loquitur quod, vbi in milite mulierum dominatur amoris voluptas, omnem in eo vere probitatis miliciam extinguit.
- Cap^m. v. Hic loquitur de militibus illis, quorum vnus propter mulieris amorem, alter propter inanem mundi famam, armorum labores exercet; finis tamen vtriusque absque diuine laudis merito vacuus pertransit.
- Cap^m. vi. Hic loquitur interim de commendacione mulieris bone, cuius condicionis virtus approbata omnes mundi delicias transcendit: loquitur eciam de muliere mala, cuius cautelis vix sapiens resistit.
- Cap^m. vii. Hic loquitur qualiter milicia bene disposita omnibus aliis gradibus quibuscumque commune securitatis prestat emolumentum.
- Cap^m. viii. [105](#) Hic loquitur qualiter milicie improbitas alios gradus quoscumque sua ledit importunitate et offendit.

Cap^m. ix. Postquam dictum est de illis qui in statu militari rem publicam¹⁰⁶ seruare debent illesam, dicendum est iam de istis qui ad cibos et potus pro generis humani sustentacione perquirendos agriculture labores subire tenentur.

Cap^m. x.¹⁰⁷ Hic loquitur vlterius de diuersis vulgi laborariis, qui sub aliorum regimine conducti, variis debent pro bono communi operibus subiugari.

Cap^m. xi. Quia varias rerum proprietates vsui humano necessarias nulla de se prouincia sola parturit vniuersas, inter alios mundi coadiutores Ciuium Mercatores instituuntur, per quos singularum bona regionum alternatim communicantur, de quorum iam actibus scribere consequenter intendit. Et primo dicit quod in mutuo conciuum amore policia magis gaudet, quam omnium malorum radix auaricia ad presens, prodolor! extirpare presumpsit.

Cap^m. xii. Hic loquitur de duabus auaricie filiabus, scilicet vsura et fraude, que in ciuitate orientes ad ciuium negociaciones secretum prestant obsequium. Set primo dicet de condicione vsure, que vrbis potencioribus sua iura specialius ministrat.

Cap^m. xiii. Postquam dixit de potencia vsure, iam de fraudis subtilitate dicere intendit, que de communi consilio quasi omnibus et singulis in emendo et vendendo ea que sunt agenda procurat et subtiliter disponit.

Cap^m. xiiii. Hic loquitur vlterius quomodo fraus singula artificia necnon et vrbis victualia vbicumque sua subtili diposicione gubernat.

Cap^m. xv. Hic loquitur de Ciue illo maliuolo et impetuoso, qui Maioris ministerium sibi adoptans in conciues suam accendit maliciam, quo magis sanum ciuitatis regimen sua importunitate perturbat et extinguit.

Cap^m. xvi. Hic loquitur eciam de ciue illo, qui linguosus et Susurro inter conciues seminator discordiarum existit. Loquitur de variis eciam periculis occasione male lingue contingentibus.

Expliciunt Capitula libri quinti.

Incipiunt Capitula libri Sexti.

- Cap^m. i. Exquo de errore in singulis temporalium gradibus existente tractatum est, iam quia vnumquemque sub legis iusticia gubernari oportet, tractare vltius intendit de illis qui iuris ministri dicuntur, quamuis tamen ipsi omnem suis cautelis iusticiam confundunt, et propter mundi lucrum multipliciter eneruant.^{[108](#)} Set primo dicet de illis qui magis practicam cum fallaciis in iuris confusionem exercent.
- Cap^m. ii. Hic loquitur de causidicis et aduocatis illis, qui vicinum populum depredantes, ex bonisque alienis ditati, largissimas sibi possessiones adquirunt: de quibus tamen, vt dicitur, vix gaudet tercius heres.
- Cap^m. iii. Hic loquitur de causidicis et Aduocatis illis, qui quanto plures sunt in numero, tanto magis lucra sicientes patriam deuorant, et iuris colore^{[109](#)} subtilia plectentes, suis cautelis innocentem populum formidantem illaqueant.
- Cap^m. iiii. Hic loquitur qualiter isti causidici et iuris Aduocati in sua gradatim ascendentes facultate, Iudicisque aspirantes officium, iudicialis solii tandem cacumen attingunt; vbi quasi in Cathedra pestelencie sedentes, maioris auaricie cecitate percussi, peioris quam antea condicionis existunt.
- Cap^m. v. Hic loquitur quasi per epistolam Iudicibus illis directam, qui in caduca suarum diuiciarum multitudine sperantes deum adiutorem suum ponere nullatenus dignantur.
- Cap^m. vi. Hic loquitur de errore Vicecomitum, Balliuorum, necnon et in assisis iuratorum, qui singuli auro conducti diuitum causas iniustas supportantes, pauperes absque iusticia calumpniantur et opprimunt.
- Cap^m. vii.^{[110](#)} Hic loquitur quod sicut homines esse super terram necessario expedit, ita leges ad eorum regimen institui oportet, dummodo

tamen legis custodes verum a falso discernentes vnique quod suum est equo pondere distribuunt. De erroribus tamen et iniuriis modo contingentibus innocentiam Regis nostri, minoris etatis causa, quantum ad presens excusat.¹¹¹

Cap^m. viii. Hic loquitur quod, ex quo omnes quicumque mundi status sub regie maiestatis iusticia moderantur, intendit ad presens excellentissimo iam Regi nostro quandam epistolam in eius honore¹¹² editam scribere consequenter, ex qua ille rex noster, qui modo in sua puerili constituitur etate, cum vberiores postea sumpserit annos, gracia mediante diuina, in suis regalibus exercendis euidentius instruatur. Et primo dicit quod, quamuis regalis potencia quodammodo supra leges extollatur, regiam tamen decet clemenciam, quod ipse bonis moribus inherendo, quasi liber sub iusticie legibus se et suos in aspectu Regis altissimi assidue gubernet.

Cap^m. ix. Hic loquitur qualiter rex sibi male consulentes caucius euitare, proditoresque regni sui penitus extinguere, suorum eciam condiciones ministrorum diligencius inuestigare, et quos extra iusticiam errantes inuenerit, debita pena corrigere debet et districcius castigare.

Cap^m. x. Hic dicit quod rex sano consilio adhereat, ecclesie iura supportet et erigat, equus in iudiciis et pius existat, suamque famam cunctis mundi opibus preponat.

Cap^m. xi. Hic loquitur qualiter regiam libertatem in viciorum nullatenus decet incidere seruitutem, set sicut coram populo alios excellit potencia, ita coram deo pre ceteris ampliori virtutum clarescat habundancia.

Cap^m. xii. Hic loquitur qualiter rex a sue carnis voluptate illicebra¹¹³ specialiter se debet abstinere, et sub sacre legis constitutione propter diuinam offensam sue coniugis tantum licito fruatur consorcio.

Cap^m. xiii. Hic loquitur et ponit magnifico iam Regi nostro Iuueni nuper serenissimi Principis patris sui exempla, dicens quod, vbi et

quando necessitatis illud exigit facultas, rex contra suos hostes armorum probitates audacter exerceat, et quod ille nulla aduersitate sui vultus constanciam videntibus aliis amittat.

Cap^m. xiiii. Hic loquitur quod absque iusticie experta causa rex bellare non debet. Dicit insuper quod regie congruit dignitati, discreto tamen prouiso regimine, magis amore quam austeritatis rigore suos subditos tractare.

Cap^m. xv. Hic loquitur secundum Salomonis experientiam, quod ceteris virtutibus ad regni gubernaculum preualet sapientia, que deo et hominibus regem magis reddit acceptabilem.

Cap^m. xvi. Hic loquitur qualiter celi deus, qui est rex regum et dominus dominancium, a regibus terre pura mente precipue colendus est et super omnia metuendus.

Cap^m. xvii. Hic loquitur qualiter rex in caritate dei et proximi viuens, contra superuenientem mortem, que nullo parcit regi, omni se debet diligencia prouidere.

Cap^m. xviii. Hic loquitur in fine istius epistole, vbi pro statu regis deuocius exorat, vt deus ipsius etatem iam floridam in omni prosperitate conseruet, et ad laudem dei suique et sibi commisse plebis vtilitatem feliciter perducatur in eum.

Cap^m. xix. Hic recapitulat quodammodo sub figuris et exemplis tam veteris quam noui testamenti, in quibus pretendit quod eorum loco qui in omni sanctitate legem dei et fidem Cristi primitus augmentantes ecclesiam colebant, et a diu¹¹⁴ mortui sunt, iam resurgunt alii precipue de clero, qui illam omnium viciorum multitudine suffocantes corrumpunt.

Cap^m. xx. Hic tractat vlterius quod, sicut virtuosus nuper in ecclesia existentibus succedunt viciosi, sic et mundi proceribus omnis milicie nuper de probitate famosis succedunt modo alii, qui neque diuine neque humane laudis digni efficiuntur.

Cap^m. xxi. Hic loquitur adhuc vlterius super eodem, qualiter loco eorum qui nuper casti fuerunt et constantes, surrexerunt modo alii, qui huius

seculi vanitatem concupiscentes pudoris constanciam penitus amiserunt.

Expliciunt Capitula libri sexti.

Incipiunt Capitula libri Septimi.

- Cap^m. i. Postquam de singulis gradibus, per quos tam in spiritualibus quam in temporalibus error quasi vbique diffunditur, tractatum hactenus existit, iam secundum quorundam opiniones tractare intendit de pedibus statue quam Nabugodonosor¹¹⁵ viderat in sompnis, quorum videlicet pedum quedam pars ferrea, quedam fictilis, in figura deterioracionis huius mundi extiterat, in quam nos ad presens tempus, quod est quodammodo in fine seculi, euidencius deuenimus. Et primo ferri significacionem¹¹⁶ declarabit.
- Cap^m. ii. Hic loquitur contra istos auaros omni ferro in hoc saltem tempore duriores, quorum diuicie nisi participentur, nullius, vt dicit, possunt esse valoris.
- Cap^m. iii. Hic loquitur de statue secunda parte pedum, que fictilis et fragilis erat, et de eiusdem partis significacione.
- Cap^m. iiii. Hic loquitur adhuc vlterius de miseriis que in pedum statue diuersitate nouissimo iam tempore eueniendis figurabantur: dicit enim quod ea que nuper condicionis humane virtuosa fuerant, in suum modo contrarium singula diuertuntur.
- Cap^m. v. Quia vnusquisque ad presens de mundi conqueritur fallaciis, intendit hic de statu et condicione mundi, necnon et de miseria condicionis humane, tractare consequenter.
- Cap^m. vi. Hic loquitur de principio creacionis humane: declarat eciam qualiter mundus ad vsum hominis, et homo ad cultum dei creatus extitit; ita quod, si homo deum suum¹¹⁷ debite non colat, mundus que sua sunt homini debita officia vlterius reddere non teneatur.
- Cap^m. vii. Hic loquitur quod, exquo creator omnium deus singulas huius mundi delicias vsui subdidit humano, dignum est quod, sicut homo deliciis secundum corpus fruitur, ita secundum spiritum deo

creatori suo gratum obsequium¹¹⁸ cum gracularum accione toto corde rependat.

Cap^m. viii. Hic tractat qualiter homo dicitur minor mundus; ita quod secundum hoc quod homo bene vel male agit, mundus bonus vel malus per consequens existit.

Cap^m. ix. Hic loquitur qualiter homo, qui minor mundus dicitur, a mundo secundum corpus in mortem transibit; et sicut ipse corporis sui peccato huius mundi corrupcionis, dum viuit, causat euentum, ita in corpore mortuo postea putredinis subire corrupcionem cogetur. Et primo dicet de mortui corporis corrupcione secundum Superbiam.

Cap^m. x. Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corrupcione secundum Inuidiam.

Cap^m. xi. Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corrupcione secundum Iram.

Cap^m. xii. Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corrupcione secundum Auariciam.

Cap^m. xiii. Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corrupcione secundum Accidiam.

Cap^m. xiiii. Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corrupcione secundum Gulam.

Cap^m. xv. Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corrupcione secundum Luxuriam.

Cap^m. xvi. Exquo tractauit qualiter variis peccati deliciis humanum corpus in hoc mundo¹¹⁹ putredine consumitur, interrogat vlterius de homine peccatore, quomodo mundi voluptates tam fallibiles in sui preiudicium ita ardentem sibi appetit et conspirat.

Cap^m. xvii. Hic loquitur qualiter omnia et singula mundi huius sicut vestimentum veterascunt, et quasi sompnifera in ictu oculi clauduntur: loquitur eciam¹²⁰ de mortis memoria et eiusdem nominis significacione.

Cap^m. xviii. Hic loquitur quod, quamuis¹²¹ iustis et iniustis vnus sit naturaliter interitus, mors tamen iusti omnes exsoluens miserias eius spiritum glorie reddit sempiterne.

- Cap^m. xix. Hic loquitur de duplici morte peccatoris, vna ex qua corpus hic [122](#)resoluitur, alia ex qua digno dei iudicio penis perpetuis anima cruciatur.
- Cap^m. xx. Postquam de gaudiis et penis que bonis et malis debentur tractauit, consulit vltius quod vnusquisque ad bonos mores se conuertat, et de hiis que negligenter omisit, absque desperatione contritus indulgentiam a deo confidenter imploret.
- Cap^m. xxi. Hic loquitur quod sunt modo pauci, qui aut propter celi affectum aut gehenne metum huius vite voluptatibus renunciant; set quecunque caro concupiscit, omni postposita ratione ardencius perficere conantur.
- Cap^m. xxii. Hic loquitur de variis vindictis occasione peccati in hoc seculo iam quasi cotidie contingentibus, que absque iustorum virorum meritis et oracionibus nullatenus sedari poterunt.
- Cap^m. xxiii. Hic loquitur sub compendio recapitulando finaliter de singulis mundi gradibus, qui singillatim a debito deuiantes ordine virtutes diminuendo extinguunt, et ea que viciorum sunt augmentando multipliciter exercent. [123](#)
- Cap^m. xxiiii. Iam in fine libri loquitur magis in speciali de patria illa in qua ipse [124](#) natus fuerat, vbi quasi plangendo conqueritur qualiter honores et virtutes veteres a variis ibidem erroribus superuenientibus, vt dicitur, ad presens multipliciter eneruantur. [125](#)
- Cap^m. xxv. Hic loquitur qualiter ea que in hoc presenti libello quasi sompniando de mundi scripsit erroribus, non ex se tantum, set ex plebis voce communi concepit. Consulit tamen finaliter quod, siquis inde se culpabilem senciat, priusquam nobis peiora succedant tempora, suam ex humili corde culpam penitens [126](#) emendet.

AD MUNDUM MITTO MEA IACULA, DUMQUE SAGITTO;
AT VBI IUSTUS ERIT, NULLA SAGITTA FERIT.
SED MALE VIUENTES HOS VULNERO TRANSGREDIENTES;

FOOTNOTES:

[79](#) *The MSS. used for the Vox Clamantis are the following:—*

S (*All Souls College, Oxford*, 98), C (*Cotton, Tiberius*, A. iv), E (*Ecton Hall*), H (*Harleian* 6291), G (*Glasgow, Hunterian Museum*, T. 2. 17), D (*Bodleian Library, Digby* 138), L (*Bodleian Library, Laud* 719), T (*Trinity College, Dublin*, D. 4. 6), H₂ (*Hatfield Hall*), L₂ (*Lincoln Cathedral Library* A. 7. 2). *The text is based on S.*

Table of Contents not found in HLTL₂ (H defective)

[80](#) 3 velud C

[81](#) 4 fingit SGD narrat CE

[82](#) Lib. I i. 2 eciam om. D

[83](#) i. 7 tamen om. D

[84](#) vi. 4 comitabantur E comitebantur SCG committebantur D

[85](#) vii. 3 associabantur E

[86](#) ix. 3 Geay D Iay E

[87](#) iii. 2 et om. D

[88](#) iii. S has lost a leaf (Lib. II. iii-Lib. III. xxii, luxurie). Text follows C

[89](#) v. This heading om. D

[90](#) iii. Hic loquitur quomodo diligentibus posituiis quasi quotidie noua instituuntur nobis peccata quibus tamen prius fiunt prelati propter lucrum dispensant et ea fieri liberi propter aurum permittunt D

[91](#) v. 1 illis om. D

[92](#) vi. 1 loquitur om. D

[93](#) vi. 2 dicit E dicitur CGD

[94](#) vii. 1 loquitur om. D

[95](#) viii. 1 eciam om. D

[96](#) viii. 2 aqualiter om. D

[97](#) xv. 1 qualiter] finaliter quod ED

[98](#) xxii. 2 S resumes

[99](#) After Cap. xxvii no space CEGD

[100](#) iii. 1 qualiter modus] de modo D

[101](#) After Cap. xv no space CEGD

[102](#) xix. f. ad ecclesie—viuentes om. D

[103](#) xx. 2 aqualiter S

[104](#) xxiii. 1 circueundo C circumeundo D

[105](#) After Cap. viii no space CEGD

[106](#) ix. 1 rem publicam S

[107](#) After Cap. x no space CEGD

[108](#) i. 6 enaruant C

[109](#) iii. 3 colore *om.* C
[110](#) After Cap. vii *no space* CEGD
[111](#) vii. 5 f. innocenciam—excusat *nearly erased* G
[112](#) viii. 3 f. in *and* honore *partly erased* G
[113](#) xii. 1 illecebra CED
[114](#) xix. 4 adiu C
[115](#) Lib. VII. i. 4 Nabugonosor C
[116](#) i. 8 significacionem ferri D
[117](#) vi. 3 suum CEGD sum S
[118](#) vii. 4 gratum] congruum D
[119](#) xvi. 3 mundi *om.* C
[120](#) xvii. 3 eciam S eciam in speciali CED
[121](#) xviii. 1 quod quamuis] quomodo D
[122](#) xix. 2 S *has lost two leaves* (resoluitur—Lib. I. i. 18). *Text follows* C
[123](#) xxiii. 4 excercent CE
[124](#) xxiiii. 2 ipse] ille D
[125](#) xxiiii. 4 enaruantur C
[126](#) xxv. 5 penitus CE
[126a](#) These four lines (with picture below) are found here in CEG. L has them later, Lib. III. cap. i.

Incipit Cronica que Vox Clamantis dicitur.¹²⁷

In huius opusculi principio intendit compositor describere qualiter seruiles rustici impetuose contra ingenuos et nobiles regni insurrexerunt. Et quia res huiusmodi velut monstrum detestabilis fuit et horribilis, n a r r a t¹²⁸ se per sompnum vidisse diuersas vulgi turmas in diuersas species bestiarum¹²⁹ domesticarum transmutatas: dicit tamen quod ille bestie domestice, a sua deuiantes natura, crudelitates ferarum sibi presumpserunt.¹³⁰ De causis vero, ex quibus inter homines talia contingunt enormia, tractat vltcrius secundum distinciones libelli istius, qui in septem diuiditur partes, prout inferius locis suis euidencius apparebit.

Incipit prologus libri Primi.¹³¹

Scripture veteris capiunt exempla futuri,
Nam dabit experta res magis esse fidem.
Vox licet hoc teneat vulgaris, quod sibi nullum
Sompnia propositum credulitatis habent,
Nos tamen econtra de tempore preteritorum
Cercius instructos littera scripta facit.
Ex Daniele patet quid sompna significarunt,
Nec fuit in sompnis visio vana Ioseph:
Angelus immo bonus, qui custos interioris
10 Est hominis, vigili semper amore fauet;
Et licet exterius corpus sopor occupet, ille
Visitat interius mentis et auget opem;
Sepeque sompnifero monstrat prenostica visu,
Quo magis in causis tempora noscat homo.
Hinc puto que vidi quod sompna tempore noctis
Signa rei certe commemoranda ferunt.
Visio qualis erat, quo tempore, cuius et anno
Regis, in hiis scriptis singula scire potes.
Scribentis nomen si queras, ecce loquela

20 Sub tribus implicita versibus inde latet.
Primos sume pedes Godefridi desque Nota de nomine
Iohanni, [133](#) Iohannis Gower. [132](#)

Principiumque sui Wallia iungat eis:
Ter caput amittens det cetera membra, que tali
Carminis compositi nominis ordo patet.
Tu tamen ad scribe laudem nil pone, sed illam [134](#)
Concipe materiam quam tibi scripta dabunt.
Nam nichil ut lauder scribam, curamque futuri [135](#)
Nominis ut queram non meus actus habet.
Quos mea terra dedit casus nouitatis adibo,
30 Nam pius est patrie facta referre labor.
Quod michi flere licet scribam lacrimabile tempus,
Sic quod in exemplum posteritatis eat. [136](#)
Flebilis ut noster status est, ita flebile carmen,
Materie scripto conueniente sue.
Omne quod est huius operis lacrimabile, lector
Scriptum de lacrimis censeat esse meis. [137](#)
Penna madet lacrimis hec me scribente profusis, [138](#)
Dumque feror studiis, cor tremit
atque manus. [139](#)

Scribere cumque volo, michi pondere pressa laboris
40 Est manus, et vires subtrahit inde timor.
Qui magis inspiciet opus istud, tempus et instans,
Inueniet toto carmine dulce nichil.
Si vox in fragili michi pectore firmior esset,
Pluraque cum linguis pluribus ora forent, [140](#)
Hec tamen ad presens mala, que sunt temporis huius,
Non michi possibile dicere cuncta foret.
Pectora sic mea sunt limo viciata malorum,
Quod carmen vena pauperiore fluet.
Poplice contracto restat grandis via Rome, [141](#)
50 Et modico sensu grande libellus opus.
Sic veniam pro laude peto, mea namque voluntas
Est bona, sit quamuis sensus ad acta minor.
Adde recollectis seriem, mea musa, Latinis,

Daque magistra tuo congrua verba libro.
Sompnia vera quidem, quorum sententia cordis
Intima conturbat, plena timore canam:¹⁴²
Insula quem Pathmos suscepit in Apocalipsi,
Cuius ego nomen gesto, gubernet opus.¹⁴³

FOOTNOTES:

- ¹²⁷ *Title* Incipit—dicitur CE *om.* GDL
¹²⁸ 4 narrat CE fingit GD
¹²⁹ 5 bestiarum species GD
¹³⁰ 7 sumpserunt E
¹³¹ Prol. *Heading om.* L
¹³² *margin* Nota de nomine Iohannis Gower CE Nota nomen L Nomen
compilatoris est Iohannes Gower vt patet in his tribus versibus T *om.* GD
¹³³ 21 Godefri des atque D
¹³⁴ 25 adscribe EL ascribens D
¹³⁵ 27 nil vt laudes D nichil vt laudes L
¹³⁶ 32 Sicque DL
¹³⁷ 36 censeat C sensiat GEH₂ senceat T senciati D(*p. m.*)L
¹³⁸ 37 Penna madet C (*ras.*) E Sepeque sunt GDLTH₂ hec] de D
¹³⁹ 38 *Text* C (*ras.*) E Humida fit lacrimis sepeque penna meis GDLTH₂
¹⁴⁰ 44 fauent DH₂
¹⁴¹ 49 confracto DLH₂
¹⁴² 56 conturbat D conturbant CEGLT
¹⁴³ 58 Huius ergo DL

Hic declarat in primis sub cuius regis imperio, in quibus etiam¹⁴⁴
mense et anno, ista sibi accidencia, cuius tenor subsequitur,
contingebat.¹⁴⁵ Commendat insuper, secundum illud quod esse solebat,
fertilitatem illius terre¹⁴⁶ vbi ipse tunc fuerat, in qua, vt dicit, omnium
quasi¹⁴⁷ rerum delicie pariter conueniunt. Et loquitur vlterius de
amenitate temporis, necnon et de diei serenitate, que tunc tamen
sompnium nimis¹⁴⁸ horribile precedebant.

Incipit liber Primus.

Cap^m. i. Contigit vt quarto Ricardi regis in anno,
Dum clamat mensem Iunius esse suum,

Luna polum linquens sub humo sua lumina condit,
Sponsus et Aurore Lucifer ortus erat;
Surgit ab occasu noua lux, Aurora refulget
Orbis ab occidua parte, paritque diem;
Luce diem reparat mirandaque lumina prebet,
Dum fuga dat noctem, luxque reuersa diem.
Clara repercusso radiabant lumina Phebo,
10 Et facies celi leta refulsit humo:
Splendida mane videt pulsus Aurora tenebris,
Quam spectans hilarem quisquis in orbe colit:¹⁴⁹
Purpureas splendore fores et plena rosarum
Atria glorificat de nouitate sua.
In curru Phebus claris rutilante smaragdis
Estuat in Cancro feruidus igne nouo.
Omnia fecundat, nutrit, fouet, auget, habundat,
Cunctaque viuificat, que mare, terra creat.
Que melius poterant ornant redolencia currum,¹⁵⁰
20 Gloria, lux renitens, splendor et omne decus.
Aureus axis erat, nec temo fit alter ab auro,¹⁵¹
Splendet et in curuis aurea pompa rotis.
Per iuga gemmatus argenteus ordo choruscat,
Crisolitis radios prebuit vnde suos;
Ignitique suum currum post terga vehentes
Aera discurrunt celsitonantis equi.
Purpurea residens velatus veste refulsit,
Cuius in aspectu secula cuncta patent.
Ante suum solium gradiuntur quatuor anni
30 Tempora, que variis compta diebus erant:
Tunc tamen a dextris stetit alba propinquior estas
Serta gerens, et eam cuncta creata colunt.
Omnia tunc florent, tunc est noua temporis etas,
Ludit et in pratis luxuriando pecus.
Tunc fecundus ager, pecorum tunc hora creandi,
Tunc renouatque suos reptile quodque iocos;
Prataque pubescunt variorum flore colorum,
Indocilique loquax gutture cantat auis;
Queque diu latuit tunc se qua tollat in auras

40 Inuenit occultam fertilis herba viam;¹⁵²
Tuncque pruinosos mollitur Lucifer agros,¹⁵³
Inque suos pullos concitat ales opus.
Tunc glacialis yemps canos hirsuta capillos
Deserit, et placidi redditus orbis erat:
Quicquid yemps operit gelido de frigore cedit,
Et periunt lapse sole tepente niues.
Arboribus redeunt detonse frigore frondes,
Regnat et estatis pompa per omne nemus:
Rore refudit humum, dat terre gramina, siluis
50 Frondes, arboribus pomaque grata satis:
Mille fuit variis florum renouata coronis,
Herbifer in cuius lege virescit ager.
Flos sua regna petit, florumque coloribus amplius
Ludit ager, que suus gaudia vultus habet.
Iam legit ingenua violas sibi compta puella
Rustica, quas nullo terra serente vehit.
Tot fuerant illuc quot habet natura colores,
Pictaque dissimili flore superbit humus:
O quia digestos volui numerare colores,
60 Nec potui, numero copia maior erat.
Orta fragrant clausis sicut paradisus in ortis
Candida cum rubeis lilia mixta rosis:
Deforis in campis stat primula cincta ligustris,
Omnis et hec herba quam medicina probat:
Herbarum vires fuerant, que semine, succo,
Seu radice queunt ferre salutis opem:
Purpureum viridi genuit de cespite florem,
Quam natura suis legibus ornat, humus:
Balsama, pigmentum, cum nardo cassia, mirra
70 Cum gutta sedes hic statuere suas.
Purpuree viole, rosa rocida, candida semper
Lilia certabant hunc habitare locum.
Ille locus solus sibi vendicat omne quod aer,
Quod mare, quod tellus, nutrit habetque bonum:
Hic decus est orbis, flos mundi, gloria rerum,
Delicias omnes, quas petit vsus, habet;

Insitus arboribus, herbis plantatus, et omni
Munere prepollens, que sibi poscit homo.

Est alter paradisos ibi, nam quicquid habere¹⁵⁴

- 80 Mens humana cupit, terra beata parit,
Fontibus irriguis fecundus, semine plenus,¹⁵⁵
Floribus insignis fructiferisque bonis;
Terraque cum rore dulces commixta vigores
Concipit, et varia gramina nata fouet.
Frondebis inde nemus vestitur, floribus ortus,
Graminibus campus, seminibusque solum;
Siluaque fronde suo renouatur, et omne virescit
Pratum, quod lutea sorde subegit yemps.
Mulcebant zephyri natos sine semine flores,
90 Et calor a superis lucidus ornat humum.
Tempus et in volucres cantum fundebat, et altis
Vocibus ex variis personat omne nemus:
Semper idem repetens cuculus de gutture plano
Clamat, et est testis temporis ipse noui:
Nuncius Aurore modulans volutabat Alauda¹⁵⁶
Desuper, et summi cantat in aure dei;
Turtur et ex viridi congaudens tempore fidum
In maris obsequium cor vouet ipsa suum;
Amissamque sue supplet Philomena loquela
100 Naturam, que suis predicat acta notis:¹⁵⁷
Concinit et Progne de virginitate sororis¹⁵⁸
Lesam, dum tanti sunt in amore doli.
Milia mille sonant volucrum velut organa cantus,
Et totidem flores lata per arua fragrant:
Inter eos certant, ferat vtrum cantus ad aures
Aut odor ad nares de bonitate magis:¹⁵⁹
Lis tamen ipsa pia fuit et discordia
c o n c o r s,
Dum meriti parilis fulsit vterque status.
Cum natura sue legis dulcedine siluas
110 Replet, et ex omni parte resultat auis;
Cum decus et florum vastos sic induit agros,

Ac herbosa coma florida prata colit;
 Flat leuis in ramis resonans quam dulciter Eurus, [160](#)
 Dulcis et in ripa murmure plaudit aqua;
 Omneque sic animal placido de tempore gaudet,
 Piscis et ob solem fluminis alta petit;
 Non fuit hoc viuens, cui non renouata voluptas [161](#)
 Temporis ex aura dulciter huius erat.
 Talia cumque videns oculus letatur, et illa
 120 In thalamum cordis ducit ad yma viri;
 Auris et auditu cordis suspiria pulsat,
 Quo Venus in iuvene poscit amoris opem.
 Ecce dies talis fuit, in qua tempus amenum
 Me dabat in lusum girouagare meum. [162](#)
 Omnia finis habet: aderat sic vespere tandem
 Cum solet occasus intitulare diem:
 Illa quieta dies solitas compleuerat horas,
 Dulcibus atque silent organa clausa notis:
 Merserat in tenebris nox feruida lumina solis,
 130 Et sopor ad lectum strinxerat ire virum:
 Deficiente die tunc flexi corpus ad ymum,
 Quo lassata solet membra fouere quies.
 Tristia post leta, post Phebum nebula, morbi
 Tempora post sana sepe venire solent:
 Non ita clara dies fuerat transacta per ante,
 Quin magis obscura noctis ymago venit.
 Ecce tegunt nigre latitancia sidera nubes,
 Aurea luna fugit, nox caret igne suo.
 Flexerat obliquo plastrum temone Boetes,
 140 Nec via directa tunc fuit acta poli;
 Infortunata set constellacio centrum
 Dissoluens rabide tartara misit humo.
 Prima quies aberat, nec adhuc mea lumina mulcet
 Sompnus, quem timide mentis origo fugat:
 En coma sponte riget, tremit et caro, cordis et antrum [163](#)
 Soluitur, et sensus fertur ad instar aque;
 Sic magis assidua iactatus mente reuolui,
 Quid michi tam subiti causa timoris erat:

Sic lecto vigilans meditabar plura, que mentem
 150 Effudi, variis corde vagante modis.
 Tempus erat quo cuncta silent, quo mente sopita
 In vaga nonnulla sompnia corda ruunt;
 Set neque sompnus adhuc neque sompnia me
 laquearunt,
 Dum pauor ex subito spondet adesse malum.
 Noctis erat medium, grauis et palpebra querelas
 Ponderat ex oculis, set mora tardat opem.
 Sic vigil in curis consumpsi tempora noctis,
 Nescius ex quali sorte propinquat opus:
 Tempora preterita vidi, metuique futura;
 160 Tandem sic oculos clauserat vmbra meos.
 Sic, vbi decepte pars est michi maxima noctis
 Acta, subit subito lumina fessa s o p o r:
 Exiguam subii requiem, dum Lucifer ignem¹⁶⁴
 Prouocat Aurore, sompnia tuncque fero.

**Hic incipit sompnium, vbi quodam die Martis
 dicit se varias vulgi turmas vidisse, quarum primam
 in similitudinem asinorum mutari subito
 speculabatur.**

Cap^m. ii. ¹⁶⁵Dumque piger sompnus inmotos fixerat artus,¹⁶⁶
 Iam fuerat raptus spiritus ipse meus:
 Vt flores legerem me campis ire putabam,
 Quando suam propriam Mars colit ipse diem.
 Nec michi longa via fuerat, dum proxima vidi
 170 Innumerabilia monstra timenda nimis,
 Diuersas plebis sortes vulgaris iniquas
 Innumeris turmis ire per arua vagas:
 Dumque mei turbas oculi sic intuerentur,
 Miror et in tanta rusticitate magis,
 Ecce dei subito malediccio fulsit in illos,
 Et mutans formas fecerat esse feras.
 Qui fuerant homines prius innate rationis,

Brutorum species irrationis habent:
 Diuersas turmas diuersaque forma figurat,
 180 Quamlibet et propria condicione notat.
 Sompnia pondus habent, hinc est quod mira reuoluam,
 Vnde magis vigilans sum timefactus adhuc.
 Elatos asinos subita nouitate rebelles
 Vidi, nec frenis quis moderauit eos;
 Viscera namque sua repleta furore leonum
 Extiterant predas in repetendo suas.
 Perdidit officium capitis sine lege capistrum,
 Dum saltant asini cuncta per arua vagi;
 Terruit en cunctos sua sternutacio ciues,
 190 Dum geminant solita voce frequenter yha.
 Sunt onagrique rudes asini violenter, et omnis
 Que fuit vtilitas vtilitate caret.
 Amplius ad villam saccos portare recusant,
 Nec curuare sua pondere dorsa volunt;
 Set neque rurales curant in montibus herbas,
 Ammodo set querunt deliciosa magis;
 A domibus alios expellunt, ius et equorum
 Iniuste cupiunt appropriare sibi.
 Presumunt asini gemmatis ammodo fungi
 200 Sellis, et comptas semper habere comas:
 Vt vetus ipse suam curtam Burnellus inepte
 Caudam longari de nouitate cupit,
 Sic isti miseri noua tergaque longa requirunt,
 Vt leo de cauda sint et Asellus idem.
 Pelle leonina tectum se pinxit Asellus,
 Et sua transcendit gloria vana modum:
 Cauda suo capiti quia se conferre nequibat,
 Contra naturam sorte requirit opem.
 Attemptant igitur fatui, poterint vt aselli¹⁶⁷
 210 Quod natura vetat amplificare sibi:
 Quam sibi plantauit caudam qui contulit aures
 Non curant, set eam vilius esse putant.
 Vluere plura solet animi meditacio stulta,
 Que magis impediunt quam sua vota ferunt:

Omnes stulticia stultis innata dolores
 Parturit, et finem prestat habere malum.
 Magnos magna decent et paruos parua, set illi,
 Qui sunt de minimis, grandia ferre volunt.
 Mens oritur subito, diuturnos que parat actus,
 220 Incipit et leuiter que sine fine grauant:
 Sic asini fatui, quos fastus concitat, omni
 Postposita lege condita iura negant.
 Hos intemperies sic aeris inficiebat,
 Quod transformati sunt quasi monstra michi:
 Auribus in longis potui quos noscere dudum
 In frontis medio cornua longa gerunt.
 Ille biceps gladius non scindit forcius illis,
 Vulneris atque noui fusa cruore madent.
 Qui de natura pigri tardare solebant,
 230 Precurrunt ceruis de leuitate magis.
 Nonne leui saltu vincit Leopardus Asellum?¹⁶⁸
 Tunc tamen ad saltum vicit Asellus eum.¹⁶⁹
 Longior in cauda fuerat tunc vilis Asellus
 Quam fuit insignis, prodolor! ipse leo.
 Quicquid velle iubet asinorum legis habebat
 Vires, et nouitas ius vetus omne fugat.
 Vt stolidos tamen atque rudes hos mos asininus
 Signabat, quod eis nil rationis erat:
 Et quia sic fatuos vidi timui magis ipsos,
 240 Nec dabat vlterius pes michi fidus iter.

**Hic dicit se per sompnum secundam vulgi
turmam in boues vidisse mutatam.**

Cap^m. iii. Cum quibus ecce boues veniunt quos cuspide nullus
 Pungere tunc ausit, immo timebat eos:
 Contra iura bouis bos spernit habere bubulcum,
 Ammodo nec duci de nouitate sinit.
 Cornutando furit hodie bos qui fuit heri
 Per cornu leuiter ductus vt arua colat:

Qui fuerant domiti nuper, modo fronte minaci
 Cornibus elatis debita iura negant:
 Amplius ex aratro se dicunt nolle iugari,
 250 Colla set erecta libera ferre volunt:
 Ammodo non comedunt paleas neque stramina grossa,
 Est vbi set granum de meliore petunt.
 Sic transformatas formas natura reliquit,
 Et monstris similes fecerat esse boues;
 Vrsinosque pedes caudas similesque draconum
 Gestant, quo pauidus omnis abhorret eos:
 Sulphureas flammās emittunt oris ab antro,
 Quas, vbi disperse sunt, aqua nulla fugat:
 Sit lapis aut lignum, fuerit set quicquid ab estu¹⁷⁰
 260 Tactum, comminuens ignea flamma vorat.
 Hec armenta nequit aliquis defendere pastor,
 Quin magis in dampnum ruris et vrbis agunt.
 In Colchos thauri, quos vicit dextra Iasonis,¹⁷¹
 Non ita sulphureis ignibus ora fremunt,
 Quin magis igne boues isti crepitancia tecta
 Incendunt, que suis flatibus illa cremant.
 Non Minos taurus, quem Neptunus dedit illi,
 Sic nocuit campis, dum furibundus erat,
 Quin magis arua boues isti vastant, et in vrbe
 270 Horrida rite suo dampna furore parant.
 Nessus et in tauri specimen mutatus et armis
 Victus ab Eacide, dum sibi bella mouet,
 Tam neque Centauri nec et ipse ferox Minotaurus
 Hoc metuenda viris tempore bella dabant,
 Quin magis ecce boues isti violenter aratra
 Linqentes, hominum constituere necem.
 Arma sui vacuos operis dispersa per agros
 Linqunt, nec solitum ius sibi vomer habet;
 Ecce iacent rastri, sic sarcula sicque ligones,
 280 Buris, trabs, crapulus sunt neque restis eis;¹⁷²
 Nil iuga, nil torquis, nichil aut retinacula prosunt,
 Nil sibi paxillus, temo vel ansa iuuant:
 Vsus abest aratri, vacat et dentale relictum,

Nec sua tunc crates debita ferre sinunt:
Currus et auriga cessant, cessatque carecta,
Que nichil vltcrius vtilitatis habent:
Agricoleque bonis iter vnum legibus absque
Restat, et indomiti sunt rationis idem.
Sic, vbicumque vides, campi cultore carentes,
290 Vastaque, que nemo vendicat, arua iacent:
Expectant frustra promissas horrea messes,
Annua si talis regula seruet agros.
Bos leo, bos pardus, bos vrsus, set bouis ipsum
Constat naturam non meminisse suam.
Sic ego pestiferos errare boues quia vidi
Indomitos sulco, mens mea mota fuit.
Prodolor! o! dixi, cessabit cultus agrorum,
Quo michi temporibus est metuenda fames.

**Hic dicit se per sompnum terciam vulgi turmam
in porcos vidisse transmutatam.**

Cap^m. iiii. Sompnus adhuc creuit, et lassos occupat artus,
300 Auget et vltcrius sompnia plura michi.
Cristatos porcos, furiosos, demone plenos,
Post ea percepi stare frequenter ibi: [173](#)
Associata simul fuit horum concio multa,
Aera stercoribus inficiendo suis.
Porculus en porcum furiens et aperculus aprum
Consequitur, nec eos amplius artat ara.
Federa cum socio dat verres iuncta nefrendo,
Vt magis euertant congradiuntur humum;
Scropha que Sus sociam porcā sibi consociarunt,
310 Que magis vt noceant, plura maligna mouent.
Inmundos porcos sic vidi ledere mundum,
Vix quod erat mundus tutus vt obstet eis:
Non erat aque bladis hominum porcarius vllus,
Qui tunc de solito more fugauit eos;
Non erat in nares torques qui posset eorum

Ponere, quin faciunt fossa timenda nimis;
 Nullus et hirsuta nexus constringere colla
 Tunc potuit, set eis omne licebat iter.
 Deuia natura sic errat ab ordine, mores
 320 Porcus quod porci non habet, immo lupi.
 Inter eos aper vnus erat quem Kancia duxit; ¹⁷⁴
 Terra sibi similem ducere nulla potest.
 Emicat ex oculis, spirat quoque pectore flammam,
 Cuius ab igne procul vix fuit vna domus:
 Fulmen ab ore volat, vrbis afflatibus ardet, ¹⁷⁵
 Ac elephantinis dentibus arma parat:
 Feruida cum rauco latos stridore per armos
 Spuma, set humano sanguine mixta, fluit;
 Stridentemque nouo spumam cum sanguine fundit,
 330 Quem fera de iugulo plebis in arua ruit:
 Que ferit ex capite fortissima subruit ipse,
 Preualet insultus vincere nemo suos:
 Erigit ad bellum se signifer horrida ceruix,
 Inque furore suo tigridis instar habet;
 Et sete rigidis similes hastilibus horrent,
 Que magis inferni noxia signa gerunt.
 Sicut onusta carecta fremit, seu frendet aquarum
 Cursus, sicque suus murmura passus habet:
 Hec fera crescentes segetes proculcat in herba,
 340 Et cererem paleas triuerat inque leues.
 Creuit aper quod eo maiores herbida monstro
 Educat agrestes pascua nulla feras.
 Non locus est tutus in quem fera tanta minatur,
 Sit nisi celestis, quo mala ferre nequit.
 Ira fere mota furias excedit abissi,
 Cuius in aduentu patria tota fremit:
 Ex aquilone tamen verres venit alter, et apro
 Conuenit, vt pariter fossa parare queant.
 Tegia silua ferum talem non protulit aprum, ¹⁷⁶
 350 Quamuis in Archadia maximus ille fuit:
 Non ita commouit in montibus Herculis iram,
 Gentibus aut aliis obstitit ipse viis,

Quin magis hii porci, per sompnia quos ego vidi,
Dampna ferunt variis milia mille modis.
Non aper ille ferox, agitabat quem Meleager
In nemorum latebris, tam violentus erat,
Quin magis in porcis furit et violencius istis
Ira nocet, que suis dentibus arma parat.
Nil sedimen vel amurca placet, nichil atque segistrum
360 Confert, vt dictis sint alimenta feris;
Non siliquas silue quercinas aut sibi glandes
Querunt, set rapiunt que meliora vident;
Spisse nil feces, aqua nec communis eorum
Sufficit ad potum, set bona vina vorant.
Rustica natura, dum fert incognita vina,
Mortuus vt truncus ebrietate iacet:
Sic gula porcorum viguit, quod in vrbe quietos
Vix poterat proprios diues habere cibos.
Amplius hospicium porcorum non ara fertur,
370 Sordidus aut puluis lectus habendus eis:
Immo sua sorde calcarunt regia tecta,
Vrbis et in medio nobiliora petunt.
Nuper deformes modo transformantur, et illos
Qui fuerant porci forma superba colit:
Vt leo qui rugit fuerat grunnius eorum,
Ad quorum sonitus concutit Eccho nemus.
Hii fuerant porci, maledictus spiritus in quos
Intravit, sicut leccio sancta refert.

**Hic dicit se per sompnium quartam vulgi turmam
in canes vidisse mutatam.**

Cap^m. v. Post vidique canes stantes quasi millia dena¹⁷⁷
380 Latrantes, que suis vocibus arua tremunt.
En dederat cantus lucis prenuncius ales,
Aera iam furiens verberat ira canum.
Mica set a mensa dominorum que cadit esca
Non fuit hiis canibus, ossa nec ulla placent;

Faucibus immo suis meliora cibaria poscunt,
 Ac vbi perueniunt singula crassa vorant.
 Gentiles tamen ecce canes hiis associati
 Non sunt, set viles quos scola nulla docet:
 Hii neque venatu spaciantur, set neque gaudent
 390 De cornu, nec eis quid nisi vile manet:
 Non nemo vt leporem capiant transcurrere querunt,
 Nec ceruos agitant de leuitate sua;
 Set magis ad talos retro latrare virorum
 Affectant, et eis tedia multa ferunt.
 Cutte que Curre simul rapidi per deuia currunt,
 Linquentes miseras degenerando casas:¹⁷⁸
 En pastoris adest canis, et qui nocte latrando
 Atria conseruat, hii duo sepe grauant:
 Omnis pistrine proprium pariterque coquine
 400 Rupta cathena suum laxat abire canem:
 Carnificum grandes vidique venire molosos,
 Atque molendini nec manet ipse domi;
 Nec stabulum veteres poterat retinere latrantes,
 Quin veniunt sociis et sociantur eis.
 Est ibi monoculus, set et ille tripes quasi furtim
 Claudicat a retro, latrat et ipse comes:
 Voce sua rauca tunc rinx ringendo fimumque
 Deserit, atque loca spirat habere noua.
 Hii sunt quos dorsa nullus planare valebit,
 410 Tangere nec caudas, nec retinere caput;
 Irati semper denudant nam tibi dentes,
 Nec sua rusticitas quicquid amoris habet.
 Omnes conueniunt iuuenes que senes, et in vnum
 Concurrunt, que sua morsibus ora parant:
 Erectis caudis gradiuntur more superbo,
 Est nichil hiis sanum quod lacerare queunt.
 Aprini dentes deformant ora canina,
 Est quorum morsus pestifer atque grauis:
 Quanto plus escas sumunt minus hii saturantur,
 420 Insaciata fames semper inheret eis.
 Hii quibus in nocte solito fimus extitit hospes,

Mollibus in lectis sordida membra fouent.
Copia tanta fuit, quod eorum nullus habebat
Respectum proprii quomodocumque status.
O tunc si quis eos audisset, quomodo mundus
Vocibus attonitus hic et vbique fremit,
Dicere tunc posset similes quod eis vlulatus
Auribus audiuit nullus ab ante status.

430 Cumque canum strepitus Sathane descendit in aures,
Gaudet et infernus de nouitate soni,
Cerberus ecce canis baratri custosque gehenne¹⁷⁹
Prebuit auditum letus et inde furit;
Aque suo collo, quibus extitit ipse ligatus,
Ignea dirupit vincla furore suo;
Exiliensque statim centri penetrauit abissos,
Promptus et in terras accelerauit iter.
Sic socius sociis, sic par paribus sociatur,
Prefuit et canibus dux malus ipse malis;
Dux ita tartareus violens violencius omne
440 Vertit, et ex homine conficit ipse canem.

Dumque canis rabidi sumpsit mutata figuram,
Ipsa dolens Hecuba non ita seua fuit,
Quin magis in canibus istis furit ira, que morsus
Figere quo poterant singula membra terunt.
Tale canes, Cadmi qui dilaniare nepotem
Acteon instabant, non coluere nephas.
Ille gigas Gereon ingens, Hispannia dudum¹⁸⁰
Quem genuit, capita trina canina gerens,
Non ita sanguineos dentes de morte virorum
450 Exacuit, nec ita pestifer ille fuit,
Quin magis humana strages madefacta cruore
Fertur ab hiis canibus de quibus ipse loquor.
Bestia pestifera, nuper quam misit Athenas,
Destruat vt ciues, mota Diana palam
Vrbis in exilium, neque talia bella parauit,
Nec sub ea tanti procubuere viri:
Nec Cephali canis ipse, feram qui prorsus ab vrbe
Depulit, in nullo robore talis erat,

460 Sicut erant isti, de quorum morsibus omnis
Ciuis et ingenuus contremuere magis.

**Hic dicit se per sompnium quintam vulgi turmam
in murelegos et vulpes vidisse mutatam: dicit
murelegos, vt seruos domesticos; dicit vulpes, quia
fures ruptis vbique Gaiolis liberi tunc eos
comitabantur.**

Cap^m vi. Taliter in sompnis cum me vidisse putassem,
Visio discurrens en noua monstra dabat.
Vulpes, murelegos, numero sine post venientes
Vidi, qui canibus se tribuere pares.
Quod super est terram nichil aut quod subtus eisdem¹⁸¹
Occultum latuit, set magis omne vident:
Discurrunt campis, scrutantur et inde cauernas,
Et nemus et pratum quid sit vbique petunt:¹⁸²
Vrbs neque castellum lapidum nec in ordine murus
470 Denegat introitum, quando venire volunt:
Hii penetrant cameras fortes, sine claqueque cistas
Intrant, vt preda stet patefacta sua.
Dentibus ex ferro longis que ferocibus omnes
Corrodunt artes, quod nichil obstat eis.
Hoc tamen in morsu viuens quod virus eorum
Leserat, ad vitam non medicina iuuat:
Mortis habent morsum, nec scorpio plus grauat illis;
Quo veniunt tales, mors venit ipsa comes.
En statuunt cani nemoris dimittere vulpes¹⁸³
480 Antra, que gentiles vrbis adire domos:
Que nocturna solent latitanter furta parari,
Illa dies clara tunc manifesta parat.
Ammodo quid sibi sunt nec ouis nec p a u p e r ouile,
Nec sibi de predis pullus et agna placent,
Que tamen existunt maioris in vrbe valoris,
Hec rapiunt, nec eis lex aliqualis obest.
Qui suberat terra seruilis vulpis in aulas

Scandit, et hospicium liber vbique petit:
Qui prius extiterant canibus vulpes inimici,
490 Mutua concordēs federa pacis habent:
Fit lupus, atque fere rapidus vestigia seruat,
Qui solet ante magis esse bidente pius.
Hiis quoque murelegus sociatur, et horrea linquens
Nititur in vetitum rusticus ipse malum.
Ammodo murelegus desistit prendere mures,
Nec natura suum curat habere modum:
Qui solet a domibus expellere rite nociua,
Tunc nocet, et nocuas prouocat esse domos.
Non ita mordebant mures, qui nuper in urbem
500 Acchāron intrarunt, quo fuit archa dei,
Illa nec hos rabies sic terruit Acchāronitas,
Hoc neque vindicta tempore talis erat, [184](#)
Quin furor ex istis que vidi lurida monstris,
Plus grauat et ciues terret vbique magis.

**Hic dicit se per sompnum sextam vulgi turmam
in aues domesticas vidisse mutatam, quibus dicit
quod bubones, id est [185](#) predones, commixti
associebantur. [186](#)**

Cap^m. vii. Res michi mira fuit, dum talia prospiciebam,
Et stupor in mente cordis ad yma ruit.
Non erat ex brutis animal quodcunque creatum,
Quod de seruili condicione fuit,
Quin genus in campis vidi de talibus omne,
510 Mixtaque sic pariter sunt metuenda magis.
Per iuga, per colles, per deuia queque locorum
Diruptis stabulis soluitur omne pecus:
Ex omni genere venit incola rusticitatis,
Maior et est subito quam seges orta solo.
Nunc huc nunc illuc trepidus dum lumina volui,
Aspiciendo suis singula monstra locis,
Affuit en auium mutata domestica turba,

Quorum ductores gallus et ancer erant.
 Qui residere domi que fimum calcare solebant,
 520 Presumunt aquile sumere iura sibi:
 Falconis rostrum rapuit sibi gallus et vngues,
 Ancer et ex alis sidera tacta cupit:
 Et sic de bassis succumbunt alta, que cara
 Vilibus ex causis exule lege cadunt:
 Nam quo non poterant animalia figere gressus,
 Vt predas capiant, h i i s u p e r omne volant.
 Mutatos subito vidi variare colores
 Anceris et galli, quos noua forma rapit:
 Transformat c o r u i noua penna nigredine gallum,
 530 Ancer et in Miluum vertitur ecce statim.
 Non tantum pennas sibi sumunt sic alienas,
 Immo modos similes condicione pares:
 Quos natura prius pascebat ad horrea granis
 Contentos minimis, alterat error eos;
 Nam magis vt comedant sibi grossa cadauera poscunt
 Corporis humani, que sibi sola placent.
 Qui patuere pii dudum cuicumque vocanti,
 Spectabantque manus que tribuere cibos,
 Hii magis ecce feri falconibus atque rapaces
 540 Pretendunt predas vi rapuisse suas.
 Qui solet in nocte gallus cantare, quod omnes
 Eius in auditu gaudia ferre solent,
 Clamat vt infernus, superatque tonitrua vocis
 Horrida terribilis eius ab ore sonus;
 Multociensque suum fera Coppa pediseca gallum
 Prouocat ad varia que putat esse mala;
 Quod nequit in factis ex dictis garrula suplet,
 Ad commune nephas milleque sola mouet.
 Ancer et ipse suam, cum qua se miscuit, aucam
 550 Linquit, et in predam spirat vbique nouam:
 Sibula per tenua nuper qui terruit ancer
 Infantes tantum simplicitate sua,
 Nunc nimis horribili sonitu perterret adultos,
 Atque magis fortes dilacerare cupit.

Nuper et hec volucrum bubones que solet ira
Spernere, cessat, et est tunc amor inter eos.
Esse dies licitos statuunt, quibus atra frequenter
Furtiuas dederat noctis ymago vias:
Conuolat vt socius auium de carcere bubo,
560 Liber et in campis associatur eis.
Hoc fuerat tempus, quo bubo per aera pennas
Colligat, vt predas tuta mouere potest:
Ista tamen turma pennata suas acuebat
Pennas cum ferro, quo moreretur homo.

**Hic dicit se per sompnum septimam vulgi
turmam in muscas et ranas vidisse mutatam.**

Cap^m. viii. Sompnus continuus mea sompna continuauit,
Et dabat vlterius plura videre noua.
Amplior vt rabies monstrorum multiplicetur,
Et quod iniqua magis sit manus aucta malis,
En venit omne genus muscarum, que lacerare
570 Morsibus et stimulis omne salubre vouent;
En redeunt vaspe que nuper Vaspasianum
Torquebant, varia dantque nouata mala.
Horrida muscarum furiens tunc copia tanta
Creuit, vt a stimulo vix latitauit homo:
Vt furit infernus, agitant hinc inde dolores,
Omnia prestimulant, omnia lesa dolent.¹⁸⁷
Rana quidem musce plures sociata perriget,
Hec volat ad facinus, saltat et illa sequens.
Verterat in ranas quos Latona turba colonum
580 Ecce redit, que nouo dampna furore parat.
Vlcio ranarum fuit horrida valde nouarum,
Omnibus in domibus non nocuere parum:
Omnia fercula, cuncta cibaria rana comedit,
Fudit et in variis dira venena locis.
Hee fuerant rane, sterilis quas nuper abhorret
Egiptus, que pari iam grauitate nocent:

Non erat in terra sapiens illesus ab istis,
 Plangunt philosophi vulnera facta sibi.
 Rana grauat, set musca magis, violencia cuius
 590 Spergitur et cuncta torquet vbique loca.
 O vindicta grauis, grauior q u a n u l l a perante
 Contigit, vnde viri plus doluere boni!
 Non fuit horridior Egipti musca nociua,
 Nec magis ingenuos terruit ipsa viros,
 Quin magis hee furie penetralia cuncta volantes
 Scrutantur que viris dant nocumenta probis.
 Nil seruile tamen ledunt, set ledere querunt¹⁸⁸
 Quos magis ingenuus ornat in orbe status:
 Sic similis similem, sic rustica rusticitatem
 600 Turba iuuat, quod eis sint mala mixta malis.
 Conueniunt musce, vaspe glomerantur in vnum,
 Aera conturbant improbitate sua.
 Toruus oester adest, ciniphesque, cynomia, bruchus,
 Est quibus vt noceat ipsa locusta comes.
 Urbibus et villis volutant sine lege vagantes,
 Obstabantque suis recia nulla viis:
 A musca carnes tunc servans non fuit olla,
 Vas ita nec clausum, quin noua rima patet,
 Muscarum veniens princeps excercitus huius¹⁸⁹
 610 Belzebub accessit, heeque sequuntur eum:¹⁹⁰
 Ex vario genere muscarum tunc variatur
 Pena, que diuersis dant nocumenta modis:
 Hec ferit, illa rapit, hec mordet et altera pungit,
 Hec saltat que sua de pugione nocet.
 Musca grauis pestis, qua nulla nociuior vnquam
 Extitit, aut mundo plus violenta lues:
 Tanta fuit rabies tantus feruorque diei,
 Tutus vt in nullo quis valet esse loco.
 Ex nimio musce subito feruore calescunt,
 620 Quas prius oppressit cana pruina gelu:
 Sic calor estatis subito feruore per agros
 Spersit, yemps modica quas retinere solet.¹⁹¹
 O res mira nimis, vaga dumque locusta labores

Formice proprios vendicat esse suos!
O res mira nimis, cum musca rapacior omni
Niso de predis feruet vbique suis!
O res mira nimis, pennati quando superbe
Pauonis fastum sordida musca tulit!
O res mira nimis, cum sit velocior alis
630 Musca volans minimis, quam sit Alauda suis!
O res mira nimis, dum viribus atque volatu
Debilis attemptat vincere musca gruem!
O res mira nimis, aquilam dum musca supremam
Precellit, que suum spirat habere gradum!

Hec erat illa dies, que muscas dente caninas
Misit, et ex viciis conviciauit humum:
Hec erat illa dies, qua vix fortuna iuuabat,
Vel loca que musca tangere nulla potest:
Hec erat illa dies, asino dextrarius in qua
640 Succubuit, que suo victus honore caret:
Hec erat illa dies, in qua fera corda leonum
Subduntur, que boum pressa vigore pauent:
Hec erat illa dies, qua porcus sordidus omnes
Sorde sua mundos commaculauit agros:
Hec erat illa dies, canis in qua forcior vrso
Fit, neque murelego pardus obesse potest:
Hec erat illa dies, mediis qua liber in aruis
Ad predas rapidus errat vbique lupo.

Hec erat illa dies, fortem qua debilis, altum
650 Infimus, et magnum paruus vbique terit:
Hec erat illa dies, subito qua maxima quercus
A modico leuiter stramine vulsa cadit:
Hec erat illa dies, fragilis qua tegula vires
Marmoreas vicit viribus illa suis:
Ecce dies, in qua sua stramina stramen habebat,
Que nullo precio grana valere putant:
Hec erat illa dies, qua libertate dolente,
Gaudet rusticitas rusticitate sua:
Hec erat illa dies, seruos que duxit in altum,

660 Subdidit et proceres, nec sinit esse pares:
Hec erat illa dies, virtutum dira nouerca
Que fuit et cuncti mater in orbe mali:
Hec erat illa dies, qua preteriisse futuram
Est qui vir sapiens omnis in orbe cupit.
Hec erat illa dies, manifestam numinis iram
Qua pro peccatis quisque venire timet:¹⁹²
Hec erat illa dies, que sola tremenda per orbem
Tanquam iudicii plena timoris erat:
Hec erat illa dies, de qua, si vera fatemur,
670 Cronica consimilem nulla per ante docet.
Heu quam terribilis! heu quam tristis vel amara!
Quam districta malis tunc fuit illa dies!
Vlcio celestis grauis et velox et aperta
Destruat hos per quos sic furit illa dies.
Tarda sit illa dies, nostro redeat nec in euo,
Absit et hec causa qua reditura foret:
Si prius est aliquid nobis hac luce petendum,
In loca ne redeat amplius ista rogo.

Hic dicit se per sompnum vidisse, quod, quando omnes predictae furie in vnum extiterant congregatae, quidam Graculus¹⁹³ ausus, anglice Gay,¹⁹⁴ qui vulgariter vocatur Watte, presumpsit sibi statum regiminis aliorum, et in rei veritate ille Watte fuit dux eorum.

Cap^m. ix. Copia dum tanta monstrorum more ferarum
680 Extitit vnita, sicut arena maris,
Graculus vnus erat edoctus in arte loquendi,
Quem retinere domi nulla catasta potest.
Hic, licet indignus, cunctis cernentibus, alis
Expansis, primum clamat habere statum.
Prepositus baratri velut est demon legioni,
Sic malus in vulgo prefuit iste malo.
Vox fera, trux vultus, verissima mortis ymago,

Eius in effigiem tanta dedere notam.
 Murmura compressit, tenuere silencia cuncti,
 690 Eius vt auditus sit magis ore sonus:
 Arboris in summum conscendit, et oris aperti
 Voce suis paribus talia verba refert:
 ‘O seruile genus miserorum, quos sibi mundus
 Subdidit a longo tempore lege sua,
 Iam venit ecce dies, qua rusticitas superabit,
 Ingenuosque suis coget abire locis.
 Desinat omnis honor, periat ius, nullaque virtus,
 Que prius extiterat, duret in orbe magis.
 Subdere que dudum lex nos de iure solebat,
 700 Cesset, et vltius curia nostra regat.’
 Singula turba silet, notat et sibi verba loquentis,
 Et placet edictum quicquid ab ore tulit:
 Vocibus ambiguis deceptam prebuit aurem
 Vulgus et in finem nulla futura videt.
 Exaltatus enim cum sic de plebe fuisset,
 Ad se confestim traxerat omne solum:
 Nam sine consilio cum plebs sibi colla dedisset,
 Conuocat hic populum iussaue verba dedit.
 Vt solet ex magno fluctus languescere flatu,
 710 Et velut a vento turbinis vnda tumet,
 Vocis in excessu reliquos sic commouet omnes
 Graculus, et mentes plebis ad arma trahit:
 Stultaque pars populi que sit sua curia nescit,
 Que tamen ipse iubet iura vigoris habent.
 Dixerat ille, ‘Feri,’ ferit ille;—‘Neca,’ necat alter;—
 ‘Solue nephas,’ soluit, quis neque fata vetat.
 Auribus extensis quemcumque vocat furor ille
 Audit, et ad vocem concitus vrget iter:
 Sic homo tunc multus suadente furore coactus
 720 Sepe suam posuit mestus in igne manum.
 Omnes, ‘Fiat ita,’ proclamant vocibus altis;
 Est maris vt sonitus, sic fuit ille sonus.
 Ex nimio strepitu concussus vocis eorum
 Vix potui tremulos ammodo ferre pedes;

Attamen a longe prospexi qualiter ipsi¹⁹⁵
 Complexis manibus mutua pacta ferunt.
 Hoc etenim dicunt, quod quicquid perstat in orbe
 Ingenui sexus rustica turba ruet.
 Hiis dictis pariter omnes gradiuntur in vnum,
 730 Ductor et inferni ducit iniquus iter.¹⁹⁶
 Nubes nigra venit furiis commixta gehenne,¹⁹⁷
 Cordibus infusum que scelus omne pluit;
 Roreque sic baratri fuerat tellus madefacta,¹⁹⁸
 Crescere quod virtus ammodo nulla potest:
 Omne tamen vicium, quod homo perfectus abhorret,
 Crescit, et ex illo tempore corda replet.
 Fecerat incursus tunc demon meridianus,
 Inque dolente die torta sagitta volat:
 Ipse solutus adest Sathanas omnisque caterua
 740 Pauperis inferni preuaricata simul.
 Perditur ecce pudor indocti cordis, et vltra
 Criminis aut culpe nulla verenda timet:
 Dumque duces Herebi sic vidi ducere mundum,
 Celica nullius iura valoris erant.
 Cum magis hos vidi, magis hos reor esse timendos,
 Ignorans qualis finis habendus erit.

**Hic dicit se per sompnum vidisse progenies
 Chaym maledictas vna cum multitudine seruorum
 nuper regis Vlaxis,¹⁹⁹ quos Circes in bestias mutauit,
 furiis supradictis associari.**

Cap^m. x. Estus erat nimius, rabies fera, turmaque magna,²⁰⁰
 Dum furit infernus associatus humo.
 Sicut arena maris, monstrorum concio feda
 750 Vndique progrediens innumeranda fuit.
 Demonis ex stirpe furiens fuit illa propago,
 Horrida facta viris et violenta deo;
 Contemptrix superum, seueque audissima cedis,
 Vt lupo est, ouium dum furit ipse fame.

Protinus irrupit vene peioris habundans
 Omne nephas, que viros inficit aura probos.
 Septem progenies, quas ipse Chaÿm generauit,²⁰¹
 Cum furiis socii connumerantur ibi.
 Terribilis, fedus, celer ad scelus, ad bona tardus,
 760 Quilibet arte sua deteriora parat.
 Praua creatura spernit metuenda futura,
 Omne quod imponunt sub paritate ferunt:
 Semper amans crimen fuit hec, actrixque ruine,
 Moreque carnificis aspera cede furit.
 Narrat Ysaïas, Ysidorus, Apocalipsis,²⁰²
 Tangit et in titulis magna Sybilla suis:²⁰³
 Gog erat atque Magog dictum cognomen eorum,
 Actibus in quorum stat magis omne scelus.
 Quid sit rex vel lex furiis nescitur ab illis,
 770 Regula nulla ligat ordo nec vllus eos:
 Non homines metuunt, superos cultu nec adorant,²⁰⁴
 Sed quod habet mundus turpius illud agunt.
 Carnibus humanis solet hec gens sordida vesci,
 Taleque dat populo vita ferina forum:
 Turpia sunt plura quibus vtitur atra figura,
 Quo capit exemplum turba maligna malum.
 Hec etenim rabies furiens connexa malignis
 Conuenit hiis furiis, de quibus ante loquor:
 Conueniunt eciam socii quos nuper Vluxis²⁰⁵
 780 Mutauit Circes, et sociantur eis:
 Nunc facies hominum, nunc transformata ferarum
 Gestabant capita, que ratione carent.

**Hic dicit secundum visionem sompni qualiter
 audiuit nomina et eorum voces diuersas et horribiles.
 Dicit eciam de Iohanne Balle, qui eos ad omne scelus
 tunc²⁰⁶ instigabat, et quasi propheta inter eos
 reputabatur.**

Cap^m. xi. Watte vocat, cui Thomme venit, neque Symme
retardat,

Bette que Gibbe simul Hykke venire iubent:[207](#)

Colle furit, quem Geffe iuuat, nocumenta parantes,

Cum quibus ad dampnum Wille coire vouet.

Grigge rapit, dum Dawe strepit, comes est quibus
Hobbe,

Lorkyn et in medio non minor esse putat:[208](#)

Hudde ferit, quos Iudde terit, dum Tebbe minatur,[209](#)

790 Iakke domos que viros vellit et ense necat:[210](#)

Hogge suam pompam vibrat, dum se putat omni

Maiorem Rege nobilitate fore:[211](#)

Balle propheta docet, quem spiritus ante malignus

Edocuit, que sua tunc fuit alta scola.

Talia quam plures furias per nomina noui,[212](#)

Que fuerant alia pauca recordor ego:

Sepius exclamant monstrorum vocibus altis,

Atque modis variis dant variare tonos.

Quidam sternutant asinorum more ferino,

800 Mugitus quidam personuere boum;

Quidam porcorum grunnius horridiores

Emittunt, que suo murmure terra tremit:

Frendet aper spumans, magnos facit atque tumultus,

Et quiritat verres auget et ipse sonos;

Latratusque ferus vrbis compresserat auras,

Dumque canum discors vox furibunda volat.

Vulpis egens vlulat, lupus et versutus in altum

Conclamat, que suos conuocat ipse pares;

Nec minus in sonitu concussit garrulus ancer

810 Aures, que subito fossa dolore pauent:

Bombizant vaspe, sonus est horrendus eorum,[213](#)

Nullus et examen dinumerare potest:

Conclamant pariter hirsuti more leonis,

Omneque fit peius quod fuit ante malum.

Ecce rudis clangor, sonus altus, fedaque rixa,

Vox ita terribilis non fuit vlla prius:

Murmure saxa sonant, sonitum que reuerberat aer,²¹⁴
Responsumque soni vendicat Eccho sibi:
Inde fragore grauis strepitus loca proxima terret,
820 Quo timet euentum quisquis adire malum.
Contigerat plures infamia temporis huius,²¹⁵
Que velut ex monstris obstipuerunt magis.²¹⁶
Terruerat magnas nimio pre turbine gentes
Graculus, a cuius nomine terra tremit.²¹⁷
Rumor it et procures sermonibus occupat omnes,
Consilium sapiens nec sapientis erat.
Causa inaudita stupefactas ponderat aures,
Et venit ad sensus durus ab aure pauor.
Attemptant medicare, sed inmedicabile dampnum,
830 Absque manu medici cura cessat ibi.

**Hic dicit secundum visionem sompni qualiter
furie supradicte precones sibi et tribunos
constituebant, et quomodo senes et iuuenes eorum
fuerunt armati.**

Cap^m. xii. Inter eos statuunt precones atque tribunos,
Et pro lege suum velle licere iubent.
Hoc sua iura ferunt preconis voce, quod omnis
Sit domus exusta que maledicit eis:
Qui scelus illorum non fortificat sceleratus,
Decapitatus erit, et domus igne perit.
Constituunt socios sceleris comitesque furoris,²¹⁸
Ex quorum manibus pendeat istud opus.
Hac quoque de causa vidi quam plurima dampna,
840 Dum prece fatui clamat in aure fori:
Rusticus intonuit, datus est celer ignis in edes,
Fitque repente sonus, plena fit igne domus.
Hec sibi rusticitas furiens statuebat, ut omnis
Et vetus et iuuenis que valet arma ferat:
Hii palos veteres gestant, qui sunt veterani,
Aut contos cicius quam sibi desit onus.²¹⁹

Membra leuant baculis fessique senilibus annis,
 Quos, velut est ouium, tussis eundo notat.
 Rusticus hic veniens fert euersamque pharetram,
 850 Hic fractos arcus, hic sine luce facem;
 Quique colum baiulat non se reputauit inermem,
 Debilis armatus sic furit ipse senex.
 Rusticitate tamen iuuenilis quos furit etas
 Quicquid adest manibus asperiora gerunt;
 Ascia, falx, fede quos roderat atra rubigo, [220](#)
 Gestantur, que suo cuspide colla secant.
 Quem vagina tegit ensem vix dimidiata, [221](#)
 Gestat et ingenuos rusticus inde ferit:
 Est ibi vanga loco gladii, baculus velut hasta
 860 Vibratur, que simul prompta securis adest:
 Arcus ibi multus fumo que etate retortus,
 Et sine tunc pennis multa sagitta volat:
 Tribula, furcula tunc quasi rumphea rite feruntur,
 Fertur et vt gladius malleus ipse ferus.
 Dixerat, 'Ista decent humeros gestamina nostros,'
 Rusticus, et tali murmure transit iter.
 Sic saltant iuuenes catulorum more per arua,
 Et transire feras de leuitate putant. [222](#)
 Est ibi funda manu lapides quoque limpidiores,
 870 Vnde dedit varias rusticus ipse minas.
 Hii glebas, hii direptos et ab arbore ramos,
 Est vbi nil aliud, de feritate ferunt: [223](#)
 Pars gerit et silices, ne desint tela furori,
 Menteque mortifera dant fera bella sua:
 Perfusam multo sapientum sanguine terram
 Hoc genus insipiens inmaduisse ferunt.
 Hii gradibusque suis iter arripuere gradatim,
 Quo sibi non ratio velle set ire iubet.

**Hic dicit secundum visionem sompni qualiter et
 quando dicte furie instigante diabolo, nouam Troiam,
 id est [224](#) ciuitatem Londoniarum, ingresse sunt: nam**

**sicut Troia nuper desolata extitit, ita ista ciuitas
protunc²²⁵ quasi omni consolacione destituta pre
dolore penitus ignominiosa permansit.**

Cap^m. xiii. A dextrisque nouam me tunc vidisse putabam

880 Troiam, que vidue languida more fuit:
Que solet ex muris cingi patuit sine muro,
Nec potuit seras claudere porta suas.²²⁶
Mille lupi mixtique lupis vrsi gradientes
A siluis statuunt vrbis adire domos:
Non erat in terris monstrosum quicquid abortum,
Seu genus, vnde furor ledere posset humum,
Quin venit et creuit, persus velut imber ab austro,
Qualibet ex parte parsque furoris adest.
Tunc in aperta loca que monstra prius latuerunt
890 Accedunt, paribus suntque recepta suis:
Belua vasta, ferox, siluis que palustribus exit,
Qui tantum rabie non furit, immo fame;
Plus tamen ex rabie dispersam seuit in urbem,²²⁷
Que stupet ignotum tale venire malum.
Agresti furia iurat siluestris, vt vno
Legibus excussis iura furore ruent:
Tantus adest numerus seruorum perdicionis,
Cingere quod murus vix valet vllus eos.
Cum furor vrget opus, remanet moderacio nulla,
900 Set magis in vetitum quodlibet ipse ruit:
Sponte sua properant, nichil est prohibere volentes,
Sic valet inceptam tollere nemo viam:
Omnia traduntur, postes reserauimus hosti,
Et fit in infida prodicione fides.
Vt fremit acer equus, qui bellicus ere sonoro
Saltat, et ignorat proximiora mala,
Sic fera rusticitas incircumspecta malorum
Incipit, et finem non videt inde suum:
Victricem repetit dextre coniungere dextram
910 Concio seruilis, quam furor omnis habet.
Sic adeunt vrbem turbe violenter agrestes,

Et maris vt fluctus ingrediuntur eam.
O quam magna nimis res et spectabile mirum
Creuit in introitu de nouitate mali!
Aula palentina grandis mutatur in vrbe,
Omnis et in formam vertitur ipsa case;
Atque casas minimas subito mutauit in aulas
Sors, que iudiciis tunc fuit egra magis.

- Ecce Iouis festiua dies de Corpore Cristi,
920 Cum furor accinxit vrbis vtrumque latus:[228](#)
Precedens alios Capitaneus excitat vnus
Rusticus, vt cuncti consequerentur eum.
Ipse viris multis prefultus conterit vrbem,
Ense necat ciues, concremat igne domos:
Non solus cecinit, set secum milia traxit,
Involuitque malo milia multa suo;
Colligit os rabiem seueque cupidine cedis
Auribus in vulgi concinit, 'Vre, feri.'
Que via salua fuit, furit ignibus impetuosa,
930 Quo longum castrum ductile nescit iter;
Baptisteque domus, sponso viduata, per ensem
Corruit, et flammis mox fuit illa cinis;
Flagrabant sancte sceleratis ignibus edes,
Mixtaque fit flamme flamma proterua pie.
Attoniti flebant trepido de corde ministri,
Abstulerat vires corporis ipse timor.
Qui fera terribili iaculatur fulmina dextra,
Iussit vt igne polus torqueat orbis humum.
Si qua domus mansit poteratque resistere tanto
940 Indeiecta malo, dat pia vota deo.
Est nichil vt queram dominans si vulgus in vrbis
Spirat opes et eo tempore furta parat:
Vt multe gracili terrena sub horrea ferre
Limite formice grana reperta solent,
Sic vehit examen furiarum furta per vrbem,
Nec valet in numero quis recitare forum.
Hic tenet, iste trahit, stetit ille que circuit alter,[229](#)
Fit cito per multas predaque lecta manus.[230](#)

Hos Bachus attingens tandem precordia vino
 950 Mersit, et in finem clauserat ipse Iouem:
 Nox erat, et vinis oculi mentesque natabant,
 Membra mouent, nec habent quo sibi ferre pedes.
 Postera sidereos Aurora fugauerat ignes, ²³¹
 En dolor excrescens iam noua dampna parat.
 Si prius ira Iouis nocuit violenta, sequenter
 Mota Venus duplo facta furoris agit.
 Discurrunt agiles furie, quasi fulgur ab austro;
 Sunt, vbi perueniunt, prodolor, heuque! pares.
 Tunc simul vnanimis lupus et canis vrsus in vrbe
 960 Depredant, que suas constituere moras.
 Ecce senem Calcas, cuius sapientia maior
 Omnibus est, nullum tunc sapuisse modum:
 Anthenor ex pactis componere federa pacis
 Tunc nequit, immo furor omne resoluit opus:
 A vecorde probum non tunc distancia nouit,
 Fit cor Tersitis et Diomedis idem:
 Lingue composite verbis nil rethor Vluxe ²³²
 Tunc valuit, nec ei sermo beatus erat:
 Et quoniam tantis fatum conatibus obstat,
 970 Quisque sua sorti frena relaxat homo.
 Tunc neque bella iuuant, nec tela, nec vsus equorum,
 Nec probitas veteris quid probitatis habet:
 Vt lactante furit catulo priuata Leena,
 Et ruit in pecora proximiora sibi,
 Sic fera rusticitas iuris priuata salute
 Irruit in proceres de feritate magis.
 Omnibus est casus communis, non tamen vnum
 Omnibus attribuit vna ruina locum.
 O denaturans vrbis natura prioris, ²³³
 980 Que vulgi furias arma mouere sinis!
 O quam retrograda res est, quod miles inermis ²³⁴
 Expauit, que ferus vulgus ad arma vacat!
 Prelia Thebarum, Cartaginis, illaque Rome
 Non fuerant istis plena furore magis.
 Non hic Capanæus valuit, nec et ille Tidæus,

Non facit excursus iste vel ille ferox:
Non hic Palamades superat, neque nobilis Ajax,
Nec regimen gladius Agamenontis habet.
Subdita Troiana cecidit victoria victa,
990 Troiaque preda fero fit velut agna lupo.
Rusticus agreditur, miles nec in vrbe resistit,
Hectore Troia caret, Argos Achille suo:
Hectoris aut Troili nil tunc audacia vicit,
Quin magis hii victi rem sine corde sinunt;
Nec solito Priamus fulsit tunc liber honore,
Set patitur dominus quid sibi seruus agat.
Vix Hecube thalami poterant tunc esse quieti,
Quin dolor interius languida corda mouet;
Set neque tunc poterat in turribus Ilion altis²³⁵
1000 A furiis clausum fortificare virum.

**Hic tractat secundum visionem sompni, quasi per
figuram, de morte Cantuariensis Archiepiscopi.**

Cap^m. xiiii. O qui palladium Troie seruabat ab ara,
Helenus Antistes raptus in ense perit:
Predicat ipse satis prius vt sibi vita daretur,
Nec tamen in melius corda ferina mouet.
Est satis hoc quod ait, si gracia tangeret aures,
Set sua pro nullo pondere verba ferunt:
Quicquid in exemplis ibi dixit ab aure recessit,
Et magis in facinus credula turba fuit.
Tunc resonat murmur ingensque tumultus ad horam
1010 Tollitur, et multum sedicionis habet:
Litibus agreditur virtutes plebs viciorum,
Conturbatque sacrum sordida turba forum:
Bella mouet cum fraude fides, cum crimine virtus,
Cum pietate scelus, cum racione furor:
Affectus de corde pios non suscipit hospes
Impietas, mentem deserit exul amor.
Scit deus hos homines siluestres igne perhenni

Dignos et reprobos a ratione vagos.
 O dolor in gestis, O gesta nephanda
 doloris!²³⁶
 Sunt magis hec baratri quam
 1020 malefacta viri.
 Non fuit humanum scelus hoc, quod
 demon agendum
 Duxit ab inferno tam violenter humo.
 Plebs furit in tanto, Cristi quod
 amore relicto
 Turba rudis patrem nescit habere deum.
 Deficit hic virtus, viciorum copia surgit,
 Et quem deseruit hec, rapit illa locum:
 Inde cadit bonitas, pietas perit, omnis honestas
 Exulat, atque fugam consulit omne bonum:
 Hinc amor et requies, pax et concordia mentis,
 1030 Spesque fidesque suas deseruere domos:
 Sobrietatis amans modus et moderacio rerum
 Et pudor a longe constituere moram:
 Transtulit ad sedem paciencia se meliorem,
 Mens humilis sequitur eius vbique comes:
 Agmine virtutum sublato surgit in illum
 Plebs inimica, manus impia, turba grauis.
 Undique concursus ingens conuentus, ad istum
 Conflictum mortis plurima turba ruit:
 Qui simul astabant spectantes vltima cause
 1040 Longius, ex illis vnus et alter ait,
 ‘Hic reus est mortis, sententia sit capitalis,
 Sit cruor in nobis inque perhenne suus.’
 Verbaque dicuntur dictis contraria verbis,
 Mutua vox tandem garrula dampnat eum.
 Presulis in mortem, violatis numinis aris,
 Prosiliunt hostes, et latus omne tenent:
 Clamant carnifices nulla pietate miserti,
 ‘Hic manibus nostris interimendus erit.’
 Impositis manibus collum cum falce secabant,
 1050 Nulla fides Cristi iura veretur ibi;

Ipse tamen facinus pacienter sustulit omne,
Cum mala tanta ferat, ipse quietus erat.
Non ignorat eos maledictio debita Cristi,
Qui cum sint membra, sic coluere caput.

- Quatuor in mortem spirarunt federa Thome,
Simonis et centum mille dedere necem:
De vita Thome rex motus corde dolebat,
Simonis extremum rex dolet atque diem:
Ira fuit regis mors Thome, mors set ab omni
1060 Vulgari furia Simonis acta fuit:
Disparilis causa manet et mors vna duobus,
Inmerito patitur iustus vterque tamen.
Illeso collo gladiis periit caput vnum,
Quod magis acceptum suscipit ara dei;
Alterius capite sano fert vulnera collum,
Cuius erat medio passio facta foro:
Miles precipue reus est in sanguine Thome,
Simonis inque necem rusticus arma dedit:
Ecclesiam Cristi proceres qui non timuerunt,
1070 Martirii Thome causa fuere necis;
Iusticie regni seruile genusque repugnans^{[237](#)}
Simonis extremum causat in vrbe diem:
Corruit in gremio matris Thomas, medioque
Natorum turba Simon in ense cadit:
Thomam rex potuit saluasse, set illa potestas
Simonis ad vitam regia posse caret:
Vlta fuit Thome mors, et nunc vlcio mortis^{[238](#)}
Simonis ante fores cotidiana grauat.
Fecerat exiguas iam sol altissimus vmbras,
1080 Fitque die media sanguine tinctus Ephot:
Candida sic paciens collum percussa securi
Victima purpureo sanguine pulsat humum.
Qui pater est anime, viduatur corporis expers,
Pastor et a pecude cesus abhorret agros:
Qui custos anime fuerat, custode carebat,
Huncque necant nati, quos colit ipse pater.
Qui fuerat crucifer que patrum Primas in honore,

Hic magis abiectus et cruciatus erat:
 Qui fuerat doctor legum, sine lege peribat,
 1090 Cesus et atteritur pastor ab ore gregis.
 Ante diem moritur sine culpis et sine causa,
 Quo tam natura quam Deus ambo dolent:
 Sit licet ex falsa seruorum lege subactus,
 Liber perpetuas ambulat ipse vias.
 Fortitudo quidem virtus, licet exteriora
 Perdidit, affirmat interiora deo;
 Temperiesque sibi, quicquid furor egerit extra,
 Interius patitur simplicitate sua.
 Tollitur a mundo quamuis sapiencia, virtus
 1100 Prouidet in celo cum sapiente locum:
 Obruta iusticia quamuis videatur, ad astra
 Se leuat et summum permanet ante deum.
 Viuere fecerunt quem mortificare putarunt,
 Quem tollunt mundo, non potuere deo.
 O probra transacto quis tempore talia nouit, [239](#)
 Que necis in speculo presulis acta patent?
 Multa per ante bona communia fecerat vltro, [240](#)
 Sponteque pro meritis vulgus abhorret eum.
 Tale patrasse malum non norunt Nestoris anni,
 1110 Fitque magis mira res, quia raro cadit.
 Non michi tam grauia sunt que prius acta fuerunt,
 Set magis ad presens cogniciora grauant;
 Nam quod adesse meo iam vidi tempore dampnum
 Horrida maioris facta doloris habet.
 O quid agit viciū de longo continuatum,
 Hoc docet in vulgo res patefacta modo.
 Hii sunt credo Chaÿm peiores, hic nisi tantum [241](#)
 Occidit fratrem, set pater iste fuit.
 Nescio quis laudem facinus per tale meretur,
 1120 Hoc scio quod crimen diruta Troia sinit:
 Iste iuuat quod et ille facit, consentit et alter,
 Vt malus et peior pessimus inde forent:
 Iura volunt quod homo facinus qui mittit, et alter
 Qui consentit ei, sint in agone pares.

O tibi commissos vrbs que lapidare prophetas
 Audes, quo doleas est tibi causa satis.
 Agrestes tamen hoc facinus specialius omni
 Plebe dabant furie, dum mala prima mouent.
 O maledicta manus caput abscisum ferientis!
 1130 Culpa fit horribilis, pena perhennis erit.
 O qui tale deo crimen prohibente parasti,
 Perfide, qua pena, qua nece dignus eris?
 O furor insane, gens rustica, plebs violenta,
 Quam tua fraus sceleris est super omne scelus!
 Dic qua fronte potes discrimina tanta patrare;
 Equiperat fraudem, perfida, nemo tuam. [242](#)
 Huc properate senes, huc florida confluat etas,
 Cernite que sceleris rusticus arma tulit.
 Tundite pectus, fundite fletus, plangite funus,
 1140 Cuius inaudita mors perhibetur ita:
 Vtque salire solet mutulati cauda colubri, [243](#)
 Palpitat et moritur qui solet esse caput.
 Mors etenim sacris fuit, heu! furiosior aris,
 Et minor a pecude presulis extat honor.
 Venturi memores estote, que temporis huius
 Casus inauditus instruat omne solum:
 Exemplo caueant qui spiritualia seruant,
 Ne simul officium det sibi terra suum.
 Que Cassandra solet predicere more prophete,
 1150 Eueniunt vrbi pondere valde graui.
 Hec manus alma dei mala permittendo sinebat,
 Que tamen inde fuit causa scit ipse deus.
 Insolita cuncti tali de morte stupebant,
 Saltem quos ratio stringit amore dei.
 Non Heleno potuit Priamus succurrere, Regis
 Imperii set eo tempore iura silent;
 Rex tamen vt sciuit quod sic fuit ordine rerum,
 Plangit et hinc doluit cordis amore sui:
 Rex doluit factum, nec habet quo frangere fatum, [244](#)
 1160 Iura nec ecclesie debita ferre sacre. [245](#)
 Ante sacras vidi proiecta cadauera postes,

Nec locus est in quo desinit esse nephas.

**Hic tractat vltcrius secundum visionem sompni
de diuersa persecucione et occisione, quas in dicta
ciuitate quodammodo absque vlla protunc²⁴⁶
defensione furie supradicte, prodolor! faciebant, et
qualiter huiusmodi²⁴⁷ fama vicinas perterruit
ciuitates.**

Cap^m. xv. Quique magis celebres fuerant hoc tempore ciues,

Sicut oues mortis procubuere manu.

Corpora missa neci nullo de more feruntur,

Immo iacent patulis vndique spersa viis:

Et quod nulla viris, rabies, monumenta manerent,

Mortua membratim corpora scissa terit:

Corpora cesorum muris suspensa reponunt,

1170 Brutaque brutorum more sepulta negant.²⁴⁸

Horrida plaga fuit dum sanguine terra madescit,

Fons vbicumque tumet, sanguinitate rubet:

Mors furit in foribus, mors pulsat ad ostia iuris,²⁴⁹

Viuere siue mori rusticus ipse iubet.

Quicquid erat forte manibus succumbit eorum,

Vrbs que summa fuit, cede repressa ruit:

Turribus euersis inuenta cibaria vastant,

Omnia diripiunt que meliora sciunt.

Fit nouus ergo dolor, fit planctus, luctus invndat,

1180 Deuiat a cultu regis iniquus homo:

Annos per centum veteres quos duxerat etas,

Flebant de casu quem dedit vna dies.

Plus quam piscis aquam rabies cupit ipsa cruorem,

Pacis in auxilium nec miserere iuuat:

Pro nato genitor si verba precancia dixit,

Corruit ex verbo cesus vterque simul:

Si veniam peteres, fleres et ad hoc maris vndas,

Non tamen hee lacryme pondera vocis habent.

Tunc magis indomitas ardescit vulgus in iras,

- 1190 Vt rediat pietas nil valere preces:[250](#)
Consumptis precibus furiens violencior extat
Rusticus, et peius quod valet ipse facit.
Sic nec aper media silua tam seuus in ira
Fulmineo rapidos conrotat ore canes;
Quin cicius verbo, furiis quod dixeris, vno
Sensisses lesum in caput arma tuum.
Confusum tanto subite terrore ruine,
Vix genus ingenuum scit genus esse suum.
Diffugit ingenuus, vagat, et nec menibus vrbis[251](#)
- 1200 Aut nemorum latebris fert loca tuta satis:
Mille domos adiit sortem repetendo salutis,
Set potuit nullo ferre quietam loco:
Nunc huc, nunc illuc, quasi mocio nubis aquose,
Se mouet ingenuus, fit neque firma salus:
Vir cubat in puteis, latebras magis optat Auerni,
Quam periturus erat, dum latitare queat.[252](#)
A siluis silue, set ab aruis arua timescunt,
Vrbs et ab vrbe, locus nescit habere loca.
Quam subito positas aspergit sanguine mensas[253](#)
- 1210 Ille furor, cuius horruit acta deus!
Spersaque sanguineis maduerunt pabula guttis,
Nec locus aut thalamus dat loca salua viris.[254](#)
Tunc nisi sub centro res aut super ethera nulla
Salua potest fieri proprietate loci.
Aduena preda fuit, quam rusticus inchola mortis
Morsibus exagitans ensis in ore terit.
O dolor in sponsa mortis cum viderit ensem,
Quo caderet sponsus, nec fuit ipse reus!
Occupat amplexu lacrimasque per oscula siccat,
- 1220 'O pariter celi summa petamus,' ait:
Accipiunt lacrymas spersi per colla capilli,
Oraque singultu concuciente sonant.
Sic magis orbatas quam sepe rigare maritis
Femineas vidi corde dolente genas;
Sepe manus stringi, dirumpere sepeque crines,

Vngues et propriam dilaniare cutem.
Qui tamen est omnis auctor feritatis, ob ipsos
Gaudia fert luctus et magis auget eos;
Monstraque sic hominum calido de sanguine gaudent,
1230 Quod nichil impietas de pietate sapit.

Sperserat ambiguas huius vaga fama per vrbes
Rumoris sonitum, cordaque firma mouet;
Euentuque graui recitatur publica clades,
Nec de fortuna quo cadet ipse sapit.
Sic magis ecce viros perterritus impius ensis,
Cuius non redimunt aurea dona manum:
Vrget amara sitis, que torrida viscera torquet,
Dum timor exsiccat pectoris antra viri:
Inuictumque virum potuit quem nullus ab ante
1240 Vincere, tunc vicit de grauitate pauor:
Ymber vt ipse cruor rubefactaque sanguine tellus²⁵⁵
Tunc magis audacis interiora mouet.
Set tamen vt curet morbum lex nulla medetur,²⁵⁶
Nec sibi pre manibus quis properauit opem:
Auxilium nullus rebus prestabat amaris,
Lance suam reputat quisque tenere necem:
Est inmota manus procerum nec temporis obstat
Ire, set paciens sustulit omne malum:
Nulla potentis erat hominis tunc salua potestas,
1250 Deprimit immo suum cauda maligna caput:
Tunc sua cuique domus homini funesta videtur,
Nec fuit a mortis vlcere certus homo.
In nimio tinxit elatos sanguine cultros,
Dum sua ruralis rusticus arma gerit:
Parcere nec pueris vult impius aut mulieri,
Vastat cunctorum res, loca, iura, forum.
Nemo potest veniam sub ea feritate mereri,
Impetus illorum terruit omne solum:
Omnis enim vulgi furiis tunc turba fauebat,
1260 Nec fuit ingenuus vnus vt obstet eis:
Non fuit in toto gladius vel lancea regno

Militis in manibus, quo tueatur opus:
 Dum furor excrescit, dum rustica turba tumescit,
 Miles vt ambiguus fit magis inde pius.
 Milicies cessit paciensque locum dedit ire,
 Dum terit improbitas que probitatis erant:
 Occupat en talus loca cordis, iuris et error,
 Nec medicus morbo quis reputauit opem.
 Sic neque nobilium scutum vel lancea quicquam²⁵⁷
 1270 Obstitit, vnde vetus fortificetur honor;
 Cassaque iusticia cessat, nec cordis agresti²⁵⁸
 Amplius indomiti debita iura tenet.
 Spacia nulla sinunt medicamina ferre furori,²⁵⁹
 Set furit ebrietas maior ad omne scelus:
 Hec mala corripere qui vellent nec potuerunt,
 Hii lacrimas animi signa dedere sui:
 Quisque suas lacrymas alto de corde petitas
 Edidit, et finem spectat adesse suum.
 Lumina que fuerant prius arida letaque risu,
 1280 Erumpunt lacrimae more fluentis aquae;
 Qui prius ex nullo casu deflere solebant,
 Vt flerent oculos erudiere suos:
 Flebat auus flebatque soror flebantque gemelli,
 Que videant oculi nil nisi triste ferunt.
 Vox fuit 'Heu! ve! ve!' sunt, prodolor! omnia luctus,
 Omnia solliciti plena timoris erant;
 Omnis habens lacrimas, 'Quis me manet exitus?' inquit,
 Nescius ad mane que sibi sero foret.
 'Fer, precor,' inquit, 'opem, nostroque medere timori,
 1290 Egraque sors abeat, o deus!' omnis ait.
 Rusticus ingenuis, 'Stat magna potencia nobis,'
 Dixerat, 'et vester ammodo cesset honor.'
 O genus attonitum gelide formidine mortis,
 Quam variata tibi sors dedit ista mali!
 Est in thesauris abscondita causa supremis,
 Cur ruit ingenuos tanta procella viros.
 Pax perit atque quies, animalia namque pusilla
 Intrepido corde bella tremenda ferunt:

Que fuerant prede nuper, sibi querere predas
 1300 Vidi, set preda nulla resistit eis.
 Vidi nam catulos minimos agitare leonem,
 Nec loca tuta sibi tunc leopardus habet:
 Aspera grex ouium pastori cornua tendunt,
 Cordis et effuso sanguine tincta madent:
 Postpositaque fide Cristi, furientibus illis,
 Ecclesiam reputant atque lupanar idem.
 Perfida stulticia tunc temporis omne negauit,
 Quod natura sibi vel deus ipse petit:²⁶⁰
 Non timet ipsa deum neque mundi iura veretur,
 1310 Set statuit licitum criminis omne malum:
 Ordine retrogrado sic quilibet ordo recessit,
 Nec status ipse sapit quid sit habere statum.²⁶¹
 Frumenti spicas tribulus vastauit, et ipsas
 Cardio supercreuit et viciauit agros.
 Loth capitur, pastor rapitur, locus expoliatur,
 Et qui cuncta videt secula ceca sinit.
 Tunc pro peccatis populi fit pena beatis,
 Cunctaque sacra furor esse nephanda putat:
 Demonibus homines subici culpis meruerunt,
 1320 Tunc quia non hominem nec timuere deum.
 Murmurat ex more plebs improba digna dolore,
 Murmur et in populo iurgia multa mouet:
 Iura sacerdotum presumentes, et honores
 Tollentes, iram commeruere dei.
 Fulgurat interius dolor huius turbine pestis,
 Intonat exterius horrida turba sonis:
 Conclamant furie, respondet flebile tellus,
 Heu, quod in hoc fient tempore tanta mala!
 Leticie facies tunc nulla videtur in vrbe,
 1330 Compatitur vultus cordis amara sui:
 Nulla quies mentis lese nullumque iuuamen
 Extitit, vt sanum tempus habere queat.
 Sic amor ecce vetus Troie mutatur in iram,
 Cantus et ex planctu victus vbique silet:
 In lacrimas risus, in dedecus est honor omnis

Versus, et in nichilum quod fuit ante satis.
 Ora rigant fletus, tremit et formidine pectus,
 Gaudia que fuerant deuorat ipsa dolor:
 Aspiceres alios flentes terraque iacentes,
 1340 Quos dolor alterius proprius atque dolet,
 Et sua multociens ad celum brachia tendunt,
 Si magis ex superis sit medicina malis.
 Qui bonus extiterat magis est bonitate remorsus,
 Planctus erat celebris, meror vbique nouus.
 ‘Omnia perdidimus,’ dicunt, quia nullus in vrbe,
 Quem status expectat, quicquid honoris habet.
 Qui de lege magis florebant tunc sapientes,
 Impositis gladiis colla secantur eis:
 Quos magis et furie reputabant esse peritos,
 1350 Vulneribus paribus corpora cesa ruunt.
 Garrula culpa volat, timidasque perhorruit aures,
 Nec sciuit sapiens quid sibi iura valent:
 Floruit omne scelus, bonitas perit, egraque iura
 Deveniunt, que regens non habet vnde regat.
 Hec et plura ferox rabies, que nullus ab ante
 Viderat, insolita fecit in vrbe mala:
 Vrbes non tantum generaliter, immo per omnem
 Iste furor patriam subpeditauit humum.

**Hic plangit secundum visionem sompnii quasi in
 propria persona dolores illorum, qui in siluis et
 speluncis pre timore temporis illius latitando se
 munierunt.**

Cap^m. xvi. Hec ita cum vidi, me luridus occupat horror,
 1360 Et quasi mortifera stat michi vita mea;
 Semper in interius precordia mortis ymago²⁶²
 Pungit, et vt gladius viscera tota mouet.
 Iamque dies medius tenues contraxerat vmbras,
 Iamque pari spacio vesper et ortus erat:
 Ter quater affligi sociorum corpora terre

Vidi, datque sua mors michi signa mori.
 Aspiciens vultus aliorum cede madentes,
 De propria timui morte remorsus ego;
 Crudelesque manus, orbem sine lumine iuris²⁶³
 1370 Percipiens dixi, 'Iam cadit ordo viri';
 Bestia cum regimen hominum rapuisset et arma,
 Et quod nulla suis legibus equa forent.
 Hoc michi solliciti certissima causa timoris
 Extitit et sortis peior origo mee;
 Nam quia sic procures vidi succumbere seruis,
 Spes magis in fatis nulla salutis erat.
 Est michi rupta domus per eos, quos rupta gehenna²⁶⁴
 Miserat, vt leges perderet ordo suas:
 Sic fugiens abii subite contagia cladis,
 1380 Non ausus lese limen adire domus.
 Tuncque domum propriam linquens aliena per arua
 Transcurri, que feris saltibus hospes eram.
 Morsus ego linguis a dorso sepe ruebar,
 Et reus absque meo crimine sepe fui:
 Sic reus infelix agor absens, et mea cum sit
 Optima, non vllo causa tuente perit.²⁶⁵
 Inde ferens lassos aduerso tramite passus,
 Quesiui tutam solus habere viam:
 Attamen ad tantam rabiem pedibus timor alas
 1390 Addidit, et volucris in fugiendo fui.
 Sic vagus hic et ibi, quo sors ducebat euntem,
 Temptauit varia cum grauitate loca.²⁶⁶
 Pes vagat osque silet, oculus stupet et dolet auris,
 Cor timet et rigide dirigere come.
 Sicut aper, quem turba canum circumsona terret,²⁶⁷
 Territus extrema rebar adire loca.
 Ha, quociens certam s u m m e mentitus habere
 Horam, proposito que foret apta meo!
 Si qua parte michi magis expediens foret ire,
 1400 Perstetit in media pes michi sepe via:
 Excidit omne decus michi tristi, nulla tuebar

Rura, nec in precio fertilis ortus erat.

Mens agitur, que diu pugnat sententia mecum,

Quis locus ad vitam fert pociora meam;

Vixque michi credens solo quasi vota momento

Millesies varians corde vagante tuli.

Si loca tuta forent, loca tuta libenter adissem,

Set quo non potui corpore, mente feror;

Cumque domum volui quandoque redire diebus,

1410 Vt me prepediat, occupat hostis iter.

Si progressus eram, caperer ne nocte timebam;

Sic michi de nullo tempore tempus erat:

Hostis adest dextra, surgit de parteque leua,

Vicinoque metu terret vtrumque latus.

Ha, quociens furiis visis cessi, que sub vmbris

Auris ad extrema semper aperta fuit!

Ha, quociens siluis latui vix ausus in antris,

Desperans sero quid michi mane daret!

Ha, quociens mentem pauor incutit hec michi dicens,

1420 'Quid fugis? hic paruo tempore viuus eris!' [268](#)

Ha, quociens fuerat mea mens oblita quid essem,

Dum status anterior posteriora tenet!

Sepius inque die dum sol clarissimus esset,

Nox oculis pauidis venit aborta meis.

Sompnia me terrent veros imitancia casus,

Et vigilant sensus in mea dampna mei:

Sic mea sompniferis liquefiunt pectora curis,

Ignibus appositis vt noua cera solet:

Aut nisi restituar melioris ymagine sompni,

1430 Aspicio patrie tecta relictas mee.

Concaua vallis vbi fuerat nemorosa, per vmbras

Vt lepus obliquas sepe viator eram:

Purus ab arboribus spectabilis vndique campus

Tunc michi pro nullo tempore fidus erat;

Silua vetus densa nulla violata securi

Fit magis ecclesiis tunc michi tuta domus.

Tunc labor insolitus sic me lassauit, vt egros

Vix passus potui ferre vel hic vel ibi:

Sic fugiendo domos proprias mens horruit antra;
 1440 Peius vt effugiat, sustinet ipsa malum.
 Absque supercilio michi nubis sub tegumento
 Copula cum foliis prebuit herba thorum.
 Si potui, volui sub eodem cortice condi,
 Nulla superficies tunc quia tuta fuit;
 Perque dies aliquot latitans, omnemque tremescens
 Ad strepitum, fugi visa pericla cauens.
 Glande famem pellens mixta quoque frondibus herba
 Corpus ego texi, nec manus vna mouet:
 Cura dolor menti fuerat, lacrimaeque rigantes
 1450 In fundo stomachi sunt alimenta quasi.
 Tunc cibus herba fuit, tunc latis currere siluis
 Impetus est, castra tunc quia nulla iuuant:
 Rore meo lacrimisque meis ieiunia paui,
 Fert satis ad victum langor in ore meum.
 Plura dolens timui tunc temporis, et super omne
 Ira dei magni causa timoris erat:
 Tristis eram, quia solus, egens solamine, cogor
 Tunc magis ignotas vt vagus ire vias:
 Sic loca secretos augent secreta dolores,
 1460 Vt releuet luctus quisque sodalis abest:
 Fert tamen, vt possum mestos depromere vultus, [269](#)
 Solus in exilio gaudia magna dolor.
 Sic lacrimae lacrimis, sic luctus luctibus assunt,
 Dum queror, et non est qui medicamen agat;
 Pectoribus lacrimaeque genis labuntur aborte,
 Dum fuerat fati spes inimica michi.
 Fine carent lacrimae, nisi cum stupor obstitit illis,
 Aut similis morti pectora torpor habet:
 Tunc pariter lacrimas vocemque introrsus abortas,
 1470 Extasis exemplo comprimit ipse metus.
 Brachia porrexerunt tendens ad lumina solis,
 Et, quod lingua nequit promere, signa ferunt;
 Cumque ferus lacrimas animi siccauerat ardor,
 Singultus reliquas clamat habere vices.
 Pallidiora gerens exhorruit equoris instar

Multa per interius mens agitata malis;
 Discolor in facie macies monstauerat extra,²⁷⁰
 Que magis obtruse mentis ad yma latent:
 Nam pauor et terror, trepidoque insania vultu,
 1480 Me magis ignotum constituere michi.
 Dum mens egra fuit, dolet accio corporis, in quo
 Ossa tegit macies, nec iuuat ora cibus:
 Iam michi subducta facies humana videtur,
 Pallor et in vultu signa reportat humi;
 Sanguis abit mentemque color corpusque reliquit,²⁷¹
 Pulcrior est et eo terra colore meo.
 Sic magis a longo passum quod corpus habebam,
 Vix habuit tenuem qua tegat ossa cutem;
 Sicque diu pauidus pariter cum mente colorem
 1490 Perdideram, que fui sic nouus alter ego.
 Vix fuerat quod ego solida me mente recepi,
 Dum bona promisit sors michi nulla fidem:
 Non michi libertas cuiquam secreta loquendi
 Tunc fuit, immo silens os sua verba tenet.
 Si michi quem casus socium transduxerat illuc,
 Miscuimus lacrimas mestus vterque simul:
 Raro fuit quod ego verbis solabar amicis,
 Vix quia tunc fidus vnus amicus erat:
 Illud erat tempus dubium, quo nullus amicum
 1500 Certum certus habet, sicut habere solet.
 Qui prius attulerat verum michi semper amorem,
 Tunc tamen aduerso tempore cessat amor:
 Querebam fratres tunc fidos, non tamen ipsos
 Quos suus optaret non genuisse pater.
 Memet in insidiis semper locuturus habebam,
 Verbaque sum spectans pauca locutus humum:
 Tempora cum blandis absumpsi vanaque verbis,
 Dum mea sors cuiquam cogerat vlla loqui.
 Iram multociens frangit responsio mollis,
 1510 Dulcibus ex verbis tunc fuit ipsa salus;
 Sepeque cum volui conatus verba proferre,
 Torpuerat gelido lingua retenta metu.

Non meus vt querat noua sermo quosque fatigat,
 Obstitit auspiciis lingua retenta malis;
 Sepe meam mentem volui dixisse, set hosti
 Prodere me timui, linguaque tardat ibi.
 Heu! miserum tristis fortuna tenaciter vrget,
 Nec venit in fatis mollior hora meis.
 Si genus est mortis male viuere, credo quod illo
 1520 Tempore vita mea morsque fuere pares.
 Sic vbi respexi, nichil est nisi mortis ymago,
 Quam reputo nullum tollere posse virum:
 Sepe mori volui ne quicquid tale viderem,
 Seu quod ab hiis monstris tutus in orbe forem;
 Velle mori statui, quia scribitur, 'Omnia soluit'²⁷²
 Mors et ab instanti liberat ipsa malo.'
 'Fortune,' dixi, 'dolor, vndique parce dolenti,
 Da michi vel plene viuere siue mori.'
 Set michi pro fine spem tantum mortis habebam,
 1530 Plusque nec ausus eram limen adire domus.
 Murmura tunc subite subeunt habitacula mentis,²⁷³
 Talia pro luctu sepeque verba ferunt:
 'O tibi quem presens spectabile non sinit ortus
 Cernere, quam melior sors tua sorte mea est!
 Heu! mea consueto quia mors nec erit michi lecto,
 Depositum nec me qui fleat vllus erit:
 Spiritus ipse meus si nunc exhibit in auras,
 Non positos artus vnget amica manus.
 Si tamen impleuit mea sors quos debuit annos,
 1540 Et michi viuendi tam cito finis adest,
 Ecce, deus, tu scis quia non tua fata recuso;
 Dum feris, en pacior que meruisse reor.'
 Cumque mei luctus torrens michi maior invndat,
 Et magis ex sterili sorte volutus eram,
 Ecce Sophia meis compassa doloribus inquit,
 'Siste, precor, lacrimas et pacienter age.
 Sic tibi fata volunt non crimina, crede set illud
 Quo deus offensus te reparando vocat.
 Non merito penam pateris set numinis iram:

1550 Ne timeas, finem nam dolor omnis habet.
 Talibus exemplis aliis quoque rebus vt essem
 Absque metu pociens sepe Sophia monet;²⁷⁴
 Conscia mensque michi fuerat, culpe licet expers,
 Spes tamen ambigue nulla salutis adest.
 Non fuerant artes tanti que numinis iram
 A me tollentes tempora leta ferunt.
 Tanta mee lasse fuerat discordia mentis,
 Quod potui sensus vix retinere meos.
 Quid michi tunc animi fuit aut quid debuit esse,
 1560 Cum michi rem certam mors neque vita tulit?
 Nunc id, nunc aliud, dubitata mente reuolui,
 Quo michi nulla quies fit neque leta dies.
 Cum fuit in sompnis mea desperacio maior,
 Exiguo dixi talia verba sono:
 'Crudeles sompni, cur me tenuistis inermem?
 Quin prius instanti morte premendus eram.'
 Arguit ergo meos ita mens quam sepe dolores,
 'Quid fles hic paruo tempore,' dixit, 'eris.'
 Sic tenuant vigiles corpus miserabile cure,
 1570 Quas vigili mente sompnia ferre dabant:
 Me timor inuasit, stabam sine lumine mestus,
 Et color in vultu linquit habere genas:
 Attonitus tanto miserarum turbine rerum,
 Vt lapis a mente sepe remotus eram.
 Mens tamen vt rediit, pariter redie r e dolores,²⁷⁵
 Mortem dum menti vita negare nequit:
 Sic mortem cupiens timui presagia mortis,
 Nec fore quid melius mens michi fida refert.
 Verbis planxissem, set viscera plena dolore
 1580 Obsistunt, nec eo tempore verba sinunt;
 Obice singultu vocis stetit impetus horrens
 Aduentum lacrimae, lingua refrenat iter.
 Est michi vita mori, mors viuere, mors michi vita
 Dulcior est, redolet viuere mortis amor:
 Solus, inops, expes, vite peneque relictus,
 Attendi si que sors mea certa foret.

Talia mira nimis longum narranda per annum,
Que modo vix recolo, tunc paciebar ego.²⁷⁶
Scire meos casus si quis desiderat omnes,
1590 Quo loquar hos finem non breue tempus habet:
Sic tamen in variis mea lassa doloribus ipse²⁷⁷
Tempora continuans asperiora tuli.

**Hic etiam secundum visionem sompni describit
quasi in propria persona²⁷⁸ angustias varias que
contingebant hiis qui tunc pro securitate optinenda in
Turrim Londoniarum se miserunt, et de ruptura
eiusdem turris: figurat enim dictam turrim similem
esse naui prope voraginem Cille periclitanti.**

Cap^m. xvii. Amplius vt vidi quia lex non nouerat orbem,
 Creuit et ex variis rumor vbique malis,
 En stupor in sompnis magis ac magis inde timorem
 Prouocat, et dubias fert michi sepe vias:
 Quid facerem metuens, aut quid michi cercius esset
 Ignorans, oculos sperserat ira meos.
 Haud procul aspexi nauem, properansque cucurri,
 1600 Sors mea si forte tucior esset ibi;
 Ecceque scala michi patuit, qua scansus in altum,
 Intraui, que pius dat michi nauta locum.
 Ingenui sexus alios conscendere nauem
 Vidi quam plures, quos timor omnis habet:
 Vix fuit a planta capiti gradus vllus eorum
 Qui tunc de stirpe nobilitatis erant,
 Quin maris in medio pauidus conscenderat ille
 Classem, quo requiem, si foret vlla, petat.
 Set quid agant alii, semper michi cura remansit
 1610 Vna, quod a furiis tutus abire queam. [279](#)
 Nauis in ingressu pauida de mente rogauit,
 Vt michi det faciles vtilis aura vias:
 Quem mare quemque colunt venti, per vota reclamo,
 Vt michi det placidum per mare Cristus iter:
 ‘Tu michi, stella maris, sis preuia, quo ferar vndis;
 Sit tibi cura mei, te duce tutus ero.’
 Cum maris vnda procul a litore nos rapuisset,
 Nauis et optato flumine carpsit iter,
 A furiis terre tunc amplius esse quietum
 1620 Me dixi, set in hoc spes mea vana fuit;
 Nam mea quando fuit spes maior vt ipse salutem
 Consequerer, subito causa doloris adest.
 Terribilem picea tectus caligine vultum
 Ether ab excelso commouet arma fretis:
 Quatuor ora fremunt ventorum sic, quod inermem
 Anchora non poterat vlla iuuare ratem. [280](#)
 Extra se positus madidis Nothus euolat alis,
 Cuius enim gutte dampna furoris agunt:

Quas sibi non poterat terre comprehendere virtus,
 1630 Pendula celestes libra mouebat aquas;
 Sic defrenato voluuntur in equora cursu,
 Quo maris vnda nimis aucta subegit humum.
 Seuiit in nauem ventis discordibus aura,
 Et maris in remos vnda coacta ruit;
 Fit fragor, et densi funduntur ab ethere nimbi,
 Nauis et est variis exagitata malis.
 Nuncia Iunonis varios tumefacta colores
 Induit, et vario more refudit aquas:
 Nulla set est gutta dulcis quam fuderat, immo
 1640 Turpis, amara, rudis, vilis, acerba, grauis;
 Nil valet ad gustum liquor hic, qui corda bibentum
 Perforat, et quassat viscera tota simul.
 O felix, tales qui tunc euaserat ymbres,
 Qui sunt Stige magis et Flegetonte graves!
 Ipse tamen naui turbatus semper adhesi,
 Quam furiens pelagi merserat ira quasi.
 Huius aque fluuio bubo natat inter alaudas,
 Nat lupus inter oues, inter honesta nephas.
 Huius aque subite magis insulcata carina
 1650 Forcia que subiit tecta que castra ruit.
 Pre nimia rabie timuerunt grandia cete,
 Dum magis atque magis aucta fit ira maris.
 Ecce cadunt largi resolutis nubibus ymbres,
 Aeris et medio fulminis ira tonat;
 Inque fretum credas totum descendere celum,
 Terruit et terras Iris vbique minis;
 Inque plagas celi tumefactus scandit et equor,
 Vt si de proprio vellet abire loco.
 Sternitur interdum spumisque sonantibus albet,
 1660 Et redit in subtus quod fuit ante super;
 Et modo cum fuluas ex ymo vertit arenas,
 Tincta superficies fulua patebat aquis. [281](#)
 Que freta seu venti poterant tormenta parare,
 Fluctibus et grauibus flatibus illa parant:
 Equoree miscentur aque celestibus auris,

Mixtaque cum pluuiâ salsa tumescit aqua.
 Vela madent nimbis, tegumenta nec vlla iuuabant,
 Vnus vt in sicco contegat inde caput;
 Pugnaque ventorum spumantes mouerat vndas²⁸²
 1670 Vertit et in variis fluctibus Auster eas.
 Desuper emissi tenuerunt equora venti,
 Est ita naualis regula ceca magis;
 Tetraque nox premitur, tenebrisque micancia lumen
 Fulmina fulmineis ignibus ipsa dabant.
 Cum mare sub noctem tumidis albescere cepit²⁸³
 Fluctibus, et preceps Eurus ad arma furit,
 ‘Ardua iam dudum dimittite cornua nauis,’
 Clamat, ‘et ad velum currite,’ rector ait.
 Hic iubet, impediunt aduerse iussa procelle,
 1680 Nec fragor auditum tunc sinit esse maris;
 Sponte tamen properant alii subducere remos,
 Pars munire latus quisque labore suo.
 Egerit hic fluctus equorque refundit in equor,
 Hic rapit antemnas, que sine lege vagant:
 Bella gerunt venti fretaque indignancia miscent,
 Cassus et vltius fit labor ille viris.
 Tanta mali moles classem compresserat audax,
 Vt vecors animum laxat abire vagum;
 Ipse pauet nec se quis sit status ipse fatetur,
 1690 Dum timor ex mentis frigore corda gelat.
 Quippe sonant clamore viri, stridore rudentes,
 Rector et in remis fert nichil ipse magis.
 Omnia pontus erat, deerant quoque litora ponto,²⁸⁴
 Regis et ad solium fert sua monstra fretum.

**Hic dicit secundum visionem sompni qualiter
 tanta superhabundauit tempestas, quod de certo
 absque manu diuina²⁸⁵ remedio omnes in dicta naui
 hesitarunt, et deum super hoc precipue quilibet sexus
 ingenui deuocius exorabat.**

Cap^m. xviii. Ceruleus, rubeus, pingit geminus color arcum,
 Et furor ethereus vndique spersus adest;
 Desuper ira tonat, subtus rumpuntur abissi,
 Et de visceribus terra fluenta vomit;
 Insolitas pluuias nubes effundit et vndas,
 1700 Sustinet innumeras vndique nauis eas.
 Nescia sicque vagans nauis qua sorte fruatur,
 Equoris et pluue sic natat inter aquas;
 Et mare terribili confundit murmure mentes,
 Quod timor ex solo terret vbique sono.
 Tristius et celum tenebris obducitur atris,
 Vix videt ex oculis iste vel ille manus. [286](#)
 De celo veniunt tunc signa minancia mortem,
 Omnis et expectat quid sibi fata volunt:
 Desuper impletur flammis vltricibus aer,
 1710 Et furor ex omni parte perurget aquas:
 Ignea tunc sonitus diffundit flamma feroces,
 Et scintilla quasi fulmina spersa volat.
 Igniuomus fluuius sic nos torquebat, vt omnis
 Submisso capite mutus in ore silet:
 Deficit ars animique cadunt viresque fatescunt,
 Nec fuit vlterius spes aliqualis eis.
 En super hoc veniens inmensus belua ponto
 Eminent, ex cuius naribus vnda tonat:
 Ipse velut nauis prefixus concita rostro
 1720 Sulcat aquas, et eum cuncta propinqua timent:
 Ipse ferox latum sub pectore possidet equor,
 Et propriata sibi iura marina petit:
 Frater erat Cille, furiens magis ipse Caribdi,
 Et velut os Herebi, que voret ipse petit. [287](#)
 Perdidit hiis visis audacior intima cordis
 Robora, que subito surripit ille pauor;
 Iamque gubernator, tollens ad sidera palmas,
 Exposcit votis inmemor artis opem:
 Vincitur ars vento, neque iam moderator habenis
 1730 Vtitur, immo vaga per freta nauis arat.
 Tunc quasi febricitans os omnes horruit escas,

Mensque vomit sensus absque salute suos:
 Brachia cum palmis, oculos cum menteque tristi
 In celum tendens, postulat omnis opem:
 Non tenet hic lacrimas, stupet hic, vocat ille beatos,
 Proque salute sua numina quisque vocat.
 Rector cuncta deo commendans talia dixit,
 ‘Celestis celerem det michi rector opem.’
 Rima patet, que viam prebet letalibus vndis,
 Nec stat qui mortis non reputaret iter.
 1740 Visa michi Cilla fuit et tunc visa Caribdis,
 Deuoret vt nauem spirat vtrumque latus.
 O quam tunc similis huic naui Londoniarum
 Turris erat, quod eam seua procella quatit;
 Turris egens muris, vbi sumpsit petra papiri
 Formam, quam penetrans sordida musca terit;
 Turris, vbi porta sibi seras ferre recusat,
 Quo patitur thalamus ingredientis onus;
 Turris, vbi patula furiis via restat, et omnis
 1750 Rusticus ingrediens res rapit atque loca;
 Turris, vbi vires succumbunt debilitati,
 Turris, vbi virtus non iuuat vlla viros;
 Turris in auxilium spirans, custode remoto,
 Et sine consilio sola relicta sibi;
 Turris in obprobrium patricida que sanguine feda,
 Cuius ineternum fama remorsa volat;
 Turris, vbi rupta spelunca fuit leopardi,
 Ipseque compulsus vt pius agnus abit;
 Turris, vbi pressit vi tegula feda coronam,
 1760 Quo cecidit fragili sub pede forte caput;
 Turris, non thuris olefacta salute set egra,
 Lugens non ludens, tedia queque ferens;
 Turris diuisa linguis Babilonis ad instar,
 Turris, vt est nauis Tharsis in ore maris.
 Sic patitur pressa vicii sub gurgite turris,
 Nescia qua morum parte para r e viam.
 Quisque dolet, set non vt ego, dum talis amarum
 Spectat ad interitum naufraga Cilla meum.

Hec ita sompnifero vigilans quasi lumine signa
1770 Vidi, quo timui dampna futura rei.
Nimirum quod ego, dum talia ferre putabam,
Territus in sompnis et timefactus eram:
Ductus in ambiguis dixi quam sepe periclis,
Quod michi naue mea tucius equor erat.
Sic ego concussus Euros Zephirosque timebam,
Et gelidum Boream precipitemque Nothum:[288](#)
Quatuor hii venti partes per quatuor orbis
Flant, nec obesse suis flatibus vlla queunt.
Nostra per aduersas agitur fortuna procellas,
1780 Sorte nec vlla mea tristior esse potest.
Talia fingebam misero michi fata parari,
Demeritoque meo rebar adesse malum.
Sic mecum meditans, tacito sub murmure dixi,
'Hec modo que pacior propria culpa tulit.'
Non latuit quicquam culparum cordis in antro,
Quin magis ad mentem singula facta refert:
Cor michi commemorat scelerum commissa meorum,
Vt magis exacuat cordis ymago preces.[289](#)
Non fuit ex sanctis quem non mea lingua precatur,
1790 Dum maris interitum preuia signa parant:
Accensam summi precibus mulcere paratus
Iram, cum lacrimis sic mea verba dedi.

'Conditor O generis humani, Criste redemptor,
Est sine quo melius nil vel in orbe bonum,
Dixisti, que tuo sunt omnia condita verbo,
Mandasti, que statim cuncta creata patent;
Inque tuo verbo celi formantur, et omnem
Spiritus ornatum fecerat inde tuus.
Per te sunt et aque, certus quoque terminus illis,
1800 Est per te piscis et maris omne genus:
Aera cum genere volucrum sermone creasti,
Quatuor et vento partibus ora dabas:
Cunctipotensque tuo fundasti numine terram,
Fixit quam stabilem prouidus ordo tuus:

Cunctaque terrigena viuunt animalia per te,
 Subque tua lege reptile quodque mouet.
 Sicut ymago tua tandem fuit et rationis
 Factus homo, quod opus sit super omne tuum;
 Qui precepta tua veteri serpente subactus
 1810 Preterit, et pomi mors sibi morsus erat.
 Set pietate tibi quod eum de morte resumās,
 Virginis ex carne tu caro factus eras;
 Sicque parens nostri generis de carnis amore
 Efficeris, nobis graciosior vnde fores.
 Vt te credo deum sic esse meumque parentem,
 Micius, oro, pater, tu mea fata rege!
 Vt de morte crucis te non pudet esse cruentum,
 Hoc ita, Criste meis tempore parce malis!
 Qui Paulum pelago, Petrum de carcere, Ionam
 1820 Eripis a piscis ventre, memento mei!
 Nescit abesse deus in se sperantibus, egros
 Visitat, elisos erigit, auget opem.
 Peccaui, redeo, miserere precor miserendi!
 Tempus adest, miseros te refouere decet.
 Parce, precor, fulmenque tuum tua tela reconde,
 Que michi nunc misero tristitia tanta parant.
 'O! cui fundo preces, te deprecor, intret in aures
 Hec mea diuinas vox lacrimosa tuas!
 Iam prope depositus sum mundo, frigidus, eger,
 1830 Seruatus per te, si modo seruer, ego.
 O superi, fractis,' dixi, 'succurrite remis,
 Et date naufragio litora tuta meo!
 Que genus humanum curauit origine Cristi,
 Materiam cure prebeat illa mee!
 Te precor, alme deus, sit vt illa michi mediatrix,
 Que peperit florem flore manente suo.
 Cur mala que pacior nullo michi tempore soluis?
 Ecce simul morimur, respice, plaga monet!
 Cum magis in precibus prostratus proxima dampna
 1840 Expectans timui speque salutis egens,
 Impetus en subito ruit, et concussit ad ymum

Nauem, quam Cille deuorat ira prope:
Vis tamen alma precum sitibunda voraginis ora
Obstruxit, nec ea fit saciata vice.
Semper in incerto fuimus quid fata pararent,
Nec spes pro nobis, nec timor equus adest.
Micius ille perit subitis qui mergitur vndis,
Quam sua qui timidis brachia iactat aquis.²⁹⁰
Absque quiete tamen rogat omnis votaue supplex
1850 Impendit, que pias fundit ad alta preces.

**Hic fingit secundum visionem sompni de quadam
voce diuina in excelsis clamante, et quomodo deus
placatus tandem precibus tempestates sedauit, et
quomodo quasi in holocaustum pro delicto occisus
fuit ille Graculus, id est Walterus, furiarum
Capitaneus.**

Cap^m. xix. Clamor in excelsis, lacryme gemitusque frequentes,
Non veniam cassi preteriere dei;
Attamen ipse maris Neptunus qui deus extat,
At mare pacificet, tunc holocausta petit.
Dona valent precibus commixta, per hec deus audit
Micius, et votis annuit ipse precum:
Cum magis ergo furit tumidi maris aucta procella,
Et magis in mortem visa pericla patent,
Vnus erat Maior Guillelmus, quem probitatis²⁹¹
1860 Spiritus in mente cordis ad alta mouet;
Iste tenens gladium quo graculus ille superbus
Corruit, ex et eo pacificauit opus.
Vna peribat auis, quo milia mille reuiuunt,
Et furibunda deus obstruit ora maris.
Sit licet hoc tarde, tunc nauis post scelus actum
Induit infelix arma coacta dolor.
Graculus en moritur! sic non moriuntur inuicti,
Quos prius ex rostro lesit ad arma suo:
Qui ferit ex gladio periit gladiator in illo,

- 1870 Et magis infelix imbuet auctor opus:[292](#)
In scelus addendum scelus est, in funera funus,
Sic luet exactor quod tulit ante malum;
Inque leues abiit morientis spiritus auras,
Si petat inferius antra scit ipse deus.[293](#)
Sic quia miliciam transumpsit ymagine monstri,
Irrita decepti vota colonis erant.
Cum magis est quicquid superi voluere peractum,
Desinit a furiis sors maledicta suis:
Forsitan illa dies erroris summa fuisset,
- 1880 Si deus in tali morte negasset opus.
O michi quanta tulit tantus solacia victor,
Obruta qui tante sortis ad alta leuat!
O benedicta manus, tam sufficiens holocaustum
Que dedit, vnde maris victa procella silet!
Nam deus vt voluit, plus dum furit equoris vnda,
Grata superveniens hora salutis adest.
Quod deus ipse suam pro tempore distulit iram,
Vocis ab excelso protulit ista sonus;
Aeris e medio diuina voce relatum
- 1890 Tunc erat et nostris auribus ista refert:
Dixit, 'Adhuc modicum restat michi tempus, et ecce
Differo iudicium cum pietate meum.'
Cilla per hoc verbum paciens restrinxit hiatum,
Quod prius exhausit protinus illa vomit;
Sicque iubente deo naus, quam seua vorago
Sorbuit, erigitur equoris alta tenens:
Sic prius austerus stat sub moderamine motus,
Tantus celesti venit ab ore vigor:
Et iam deficiens sic ad sua verba reuixi,
- 1900 Vt solet infuso vena redire mero.
Conclamant naute, surgunt pariter properantque
Quilibet officium fortificare suum:
Sic inter medium vite mortisque reformant
Cursum, quo breuiter tucius ire putant:
Exiguam veli, que tunc tamen integra mansit,
Extollunt partem, ducat vt ipsa ratem.

Tanta fit ingluuies et aquarum fluxus habundans,
 Vix quod sedatas terra resumpsit aquas:
 Set mare qui pedibus calcauit in orbe misertus,
 1910 Horrida compescens tempora leta dedit:
 Equora constrinxit celique foramina clausit,
 Et minus iratas cedere iussit aquas:
 Nebula deiecit nimbis aquilone remotis,
 Nec fragor vlterius voce tonante furit:
 Equoris arcet aquas, iubet vt sit terminus illis,
 Ne maris infirmam plus terat ira ratem.
 Tunc celo terras ostendit et ethera terris,
 Et pelagi furias pescuit ipse feras:
 Tunc loca concrescunt, quia decrescentibus vndis
 1920 Pax redit, atque probis fit renouata salus.
 Fusca repurgato fugiebant numina celo,
 Fulsit et optata clarior illa dies;
 Ortaque lux radiis solidum patefecerat orbem,
 Cessit et anterior sors tenebrosa malis.
 Sic mare litus habet, plenos capit alueus ampnes,
 Legibus atque noue tunc patuere vie:
 Sic, deus vt voluit, cum sit moderacior vnda,
 Leticie mixti convaluere metus.
 Omnes tunc Cristum laudant, quod ab ore procelle
 1930 Non sinit extinctos, set reparauit eos.
 Tunc ego, deflexis genibus set ad ethera palmis
 Tensis, sic dixi: 'Gloria, Criste, tibi!'
 Hoc iterans gelida formidine frena resolui,
 Leticieque noue spes michi mulcet iter.
 Dum mare pacatum, dum ventus amicier esset,
 Spes redit et nautis corda subacta leuat.
 Viribus ergo suis pauidus sibi nauta resumptis
 Nauigat, vt portum pacis adire queat.
 Carbasa mota sonant, iubet v t i nauita ventis,
 1940 Subque noue sortis spe noua vela dari.

Hic loquitur adhuc de naui visa in sompnis, id est²⁹⁵ de mente sua adhuc turbata, vt si ipse mentaliter sompniando, quasi per nauem variis ventis sine gubernaculo agitatam, omnes partes mundi pro pace mentis scrutanda investigasset, et tandem in partes Britannie maioris, vbi raro pax est, dicit se applicuisse. Dicit eciam qualiter vox in sompnis sibi iniunxit quod ipse omnino scriberet ea que de mundo in illo scrutinio²⁹⁶ vidisset et audisset; et ita terminatur sompnium.

Cap^m. xx. Clausit adhuc oculos sompnus, quo sompnia nauem
Semper pretendunt, que loco tuta petit,
Nec timor ambigue poterat cito cedere menti,
Quam prius ad portum salua venire queat.
Deficiunt remi iam ventis vndique fracti,
Ac vbi sors duxit nauis habebat iter:
Littora pacifica scrutans temptabat in omnem
Partem, nec poterat pacis habere locum;
Turbo set equoreis hanc tandem, prodolor! vndis
1950 Expulit in portum quo furit omne malum.
Sic Cillam fugiens minus est nec lesa periclis,
Dum Cilla grauior Insula cepit eam.
Insula lata quidem fuit hec vallata rotundo,
Que maris Occiani cincta redundat aquis.²⁹⁷
Ad portum veniens de naui concito litus
Egressus pecii, turbaque magna michi
Plebis in occursum iam venerat, ex quibus vnum
Pre reliquis dignum contigit esse virum:
A quo quesui, ‘Dic, Insula qualis, et vnde
1960 Tantus adest populus, quis sit et inde modus?’
Ecce senex ille, portu qui stabat in illo,
Reddidit ista meis horrida verba sonis.
‘Exulis hec dici nuper solet Insula Bruti,
Quam sibi compaciens ipsa Diana dabat.
Huius enim terre gens hec est inchola, ritus²⁹⁸
Cuius amore procul dissona plura tenet.

Nam quia gens variis hec est de gentibus orta,
 Errores varie condicionis habet:
 Egregie forme sunt hii, set condicione
 1970 Ecce lupis seue plus feritatis habent.
 Non metuunt leges, sternunt sub viribus equum,
 Victaque pugnaci iura sub ense cadunt:
 Legibus inculta fraudes, scelus, arma, furores,
 Pluraque pestifera plebs nocumenta parit:
 Que gestant homines terre de partibus huius
 Pectora, sunt ipso turbidiora mari.
 Hec humus est illa vario de germine nata,
 Quam cruor et cedes bellaque semper habent:
 Tristia deformes pariunt absinthia campi,
 1980 Terraque de fructu quam sit amara docet.
 Non magis esse probos ad finem solis ab ortu
 Estimo, si populi mutuus esset amor.'
 Pluribus auditis que singula displicuerunt,
 Heu! michi corda dolor iam renouatus agit:
 Dulcius ipse michi numen nunc quando putabam,
 Fortune species obstat acerba mee.
 Cum video quam sunt mea fata tenacia, frangor,
 Spesque levis magno victa timore silet:
 Sic ego fortune telis confixus iniquis
 1990 Pectore concipio nil nisi triste meo:
 Attigeram portum, portu terrebar ab ipso,
 Plus habet infesta terra timoris aqua.
 Sic magis in terris dubiis iactatus et vndis,
 Nescio quo possum tutus habere fugam:²⁹⁹
 Sic simul insidiis hominum pelagique laboro,
 Et faciunt geminos ensis et vnda metus.
 Cur ego tot gladios fugii, tociensque minata
 Obruit infelix nulla procella caput?
 Iam mea spes periit, tali dum sors mea portu,
 2000 Est vbi nulla quies, duxit habere moram.
 Fugerat ore color, macies subduxerat artus,
 Sumebant minimos ora subacta cibos;
 Vtque leui Zephiro graciles vibrantur ariste,

Frigida populeas vt quatit aura comas,
 Pergere cum volui, tremulus magis ipse iacebam,
 Et dolor in corde parturientis erat:
 Sic ego dumque queror, lacrimae mea verba sequuntur,
 Deque meis oculis terra recepit aquam.
 Viderit ista deus qui nunc mea pectora versat;
 2010 Nescio quid terris mens mea maius agat:[300](#)
 Sic iterum corde nouiter spasmatum ab infra
 In terram cecidi mortis ad instar ego.
 Tandem cumque leuans oculos et corpus ab ymo
 Erexī, vidi post et vtrumque latus,
 Ecce nichil penitus fuerat, velut vmbra set omnis
 Turba quae nauis abest, solus et ipse fui.
 Cum me perpendi solum, magis vnde dolebam,[301](#)
 Fit contristatus spiritus atque meus,
 Ipsa michi subito vox celica, quam prius ipse
 2020 Audieram, verbi more sequentis ait.
 ‘Nil tibi tristitia confert; si dampna per orbem
 Circuendo mare te timuisse liquet,[302](#)
 Immo tibi potius modo prouideas, quia discors
 Insula te cepit, pax vbi raro manet.
 Te minus ergo decet mundanos ferre labores,
 Munera nam mundus nulla quietis habet:
 Si tibi guerra foris pateat, tamen interiori
 Pace, iuuante deo, te patienter habe.
 Dum furor incurrit, currenti cede furori,
 2030 Difficiles aditus impetus omnis habet;
 Desine luctari, referant tua carbasa venti,
 Vtque iubent fluctus sic tibi remus eat.
 Siue die laxatur humus seu frigida lucent
 Sidera, prospicias quae freta ventus agit:
 Tempora sicut erunt sic te circumspice, nulla,
 Sint nisi praemanibus, secula visa cape:
 Ludit in humanis diuina potentia rebus,
 Et certam praesens vix habet hora fidem.
 Semper agas timidus, et quae tibi leta videntur,
 2040 Dum loqueris fieri tristitia posse putes:

Qui silet est firmus, loquitur qui plura repente,
Probra satis fieri postulat ipse sibi.
Ocia corpus alunt, corpus quoque pascitur illis,
Excessusque tui dampna laboris habent:
Gaudet de modico natura, set illud habundans
Quod nimis est hominem semper egere facit:
Te tamen admoneo, tibi cum dent ocia tempus,
Quicquid in hoc sompno visus et auris habent,
Scribere festines, nam sompnia sepe futurum
2050 Indicium reddunt.' Vocis et ecce sonus
Amplius hiis dictis non est auditus, et illo
Contigit vt gallus tempore more suo
Lucis in aurora cantum dedit, vnde remoto
Euigilans sompno sic stupefactus eram,
Vix ego quod potui cognoscere si fuit extra
Corpus quod vidi, seu quod abintus erat.
Nunc quia set vigilo viuens terrore remoto,
Est mea cum domino spes magis aucta meo.

**Hic reddit vigilans gracias deo, qui eum in
sompnis a pelago liberauit.**

Cap^m. xxi. Clarius aspiciens oculis vigilantibus orbem,
2060 Nubeque depulsa convaluisse diem,
Percipiens furias veteri de lege repressas,
Et noua quod fractum lex reparasset iter,
Illesosque mei nunc palpanis corporis artus,
Exultans humeros sustinuisse caput,
Creuit amicicia vetus et fugit impetus ire,
Et renouantur eo tempore iura viri.
Tunc prius ad dominum cordis nouitate reuiuens
Cantica celsithrono laudis honore dedi:
Non tamen ad plenum fateor mea corda redisce,
2070 Qui mala tam subito tanta per ante tuli. [303](#)
Qui semel est lesus fallaci piscis ab hamo,
Sepe putat reliquis arma subesse cibis;

Vix satis est hodie tutus qui corrui heri, [304](#)
Tranquillas eciam naufragus horret aquas:
Sic ego dum recolo steteram quibus ipse periclis,
Dampna priora michi posteriora timent:
In pelago positus sic me meminisse procellam
Nosco, quod a mentis non cadet ipsa viis.

Me miserum! quanto cogor meminisse dolore
2080 Temporis illius, quo dolor omnis erat!
Nunc tamen euasus, quia viuo furore remoto,
Cum laudis iubilo cantica soluo deo. [305](#)
Stella Maria maris, michi que mulcebat amaros
Fluctus ne periam, laudo quietus eam.
Gaudeo pre cunctis quia non me Cilla vorauit,
In cuius positus gutture totus eram:
Hostibus in mediis interque pericula versor,
Set pietate dei sum modo liber ego:
Sic ego transiui latebras horrenda ferarum
2090 Oraque, nec mortis morsus habebam eis.
Vt rosa per spinas non nouit acumine pungi,
Eripior gladio sic ferientis ego.

Sic cum rusticitas fuerat religata cathenis,
Et paciens nostro subiacet illa pede, [306](#)
Ad iuga bos rediit, que sub aruis semen aratis
Creuit, et a bello rusticus ipse silet.
Sic ope diuina Sathane iacet obruta virtus,
Que tamen indomita rusticitate latet;
Semper ad interitum nam rusticus insidiatur,
2100 Si genus ingenuum subdere forte queat.
Nam fera rusticitas nullo moderatur amore,
Corde set aduerso semper amara gerit:
Subditus ipse timet nec amat seruilis arator,
Fecat et hunc cicius qui magis ornat eum.
Forcius ergo timor stimulans acuatur in ipsos,
Et premat hos grauitas quos furit illa quies:
Qui premunitur non fallitur ingeniosus,
Per mala preterita dampna futura cauet.
Dextra tamen domini virtutem fecit, vt illa

- 2110 A me transiret plena furore dies:
Contritus laqueus est, a quo liber abiui,
Et velut a sompno sum renouatus homo.
Vt cecidi subito, subiti releuamina casus
Dat deus, et lapsum subleuat ipse pedem:
Viueret nunc video michi sompnum, nunc puto vitam
Esse meam, nouitas cor michi tanta tenet:
Me polus absoluit, quamuis sua fulmina misit,
Terret nec nocuit illa procella michi.
Qui michi consilium viuendi mite dedisti,
- 2120 Cum foret in misero pectore mortis amor,
Est michi, quod viuens tibi iam pro munere laudes
Reddo, quod vlterius sis michi vita deus:
Gaudia posco michi renoues, deus, est quia longo³⁰⁷
Tempore leticie ianua clausa mee.
O mea si tellus, quam non absorbuit equor,
Debita sciret eo reddere vota deo!
Castigauit eam dominus, nec in vlcera mortis
Tunc tradidit, set adhuc distulit ira manum.
Quicquid agant laudis alii, non ipse tacebo,
- 2130 Quem deus in furiis vulsit ab ore maris:
Set quia tunc variis tumidis iactabar in vndis,
Que mea mens hausit, iam resoluta vomet.
Me licet vnda maris rapuit, mea numina laudo,
Fluctibus ingenium non cecidisse meum.
Dum mea mens memor est, scribens memoranda
notabit,
In specie sompni que vigilando quasi
Concepi pauidus, nec dum tamen inde quietus
Persto, set absconso singula corde fero.
Non dedimus sompno quas sompnus postulat horas,
- 2140 Tale licet sompnis fingo videre malum.
O vigiles sompni, per quos michi visio nulla
Sompniferi generis set vigilantis erat!
O vigiles sompni, qui sompnia vera tulistis,
In quibus exemplum quisque futurus habet!
O vigiles sompni, quorum sententia scriptis

Ammodo difficilis est recitanda meis!
Vt michi vox alias que vidi scribere iussit,
Amplius ex toto corde vacare volo:
Quod solet esse michi vetus hoc opus ammodo cedat,
2150 Sit prior et cura cura repulsa noua.

FOOTNOTES:

- [144](#) Cap. i. *Heading* 1 eciam *om.* D
[145](#) 3 contingebant DL
[146](#) 4 terre illius D
[147](#) 5 omnium E quod omnium CGDLT
[148](#) 7 nimis horribile *om.* L
[149](#) Cap. i. 12 hilarem D hillarem CEL
[150](#) 19 *S resumes here*
[151](#) 21 themo CE
[152](#) 40 *Text* CEGT ffertilis occultam inuenit herba viam SD ffertilis inuenit
occultam herba viam L
[153](#) 41 pruinosos *om.* E (*blank*)
[154](#) 79 *No paragraph* CE
[155](#) 81 irriguis S irriguus CEGDL
[156](#) 95 uolitabat CE
[157](#) 100 sue ... vocis D
[158](#) 101 Progne *om.* D
[159](#) 106 ad] aut S
[160](#) 113 quam] qui DH₂
[161](#) 117 veniens D cui] cum DH₂ voluptas *om.* D
[162](#) 124 girovagando D girouogare L
[163](#) 145 in antrum D
[164](#) 163 *om.* L
[165](#) 165-2150 *om.* L
[166](#) 165 Cumque DT
[167](#) 209 possint D
[168](#) 231 Non leuiter D
[169](#) 232 vincit D
[170](#) 259 Sic DH₂
[171](#) 263 thauri SH₂ tauri CEGDT
[172](#) 280 crapulus SCEGTH₂ ^capulus D
[173](#) 302 Postea CED
[174](#) 321 cancia EH₂ ffrancia D (*rubricator*)
[175](#) 325 vrbis S urbes (vrbes) CEGDT
[176](#) 349 Regia EDH₂
[177](#) 379 vidique] vidi D
[178](#) 396 Linquendo S
[179](#) 431 Iehenne C
[180](#) 447 hispania CE
[181](#) 465 super est S superest CED

[182](#) 468 sit CEDH₂ sic SGT
[183](#) 479 caui (?) C canis D
[184](#) 502 MS. Harl. 6291 (H) *begins here*
[185](#) Cap. vii. *Heading 2* idest HGD
[186](#) 3 associebantur SGH associabantur CED associantur T
[187](#) 576 prestimulant S perstimulant CED
[188](#) 597 ludunt sed ludere D
[189](#) 609 exercitus huius C exercitus eius D
[190](#) 610 Beelzebub C
[191](#) 622 hyemps C
[192](#) 666 viuere quisque D
[193](#) Cap. ix. *Heading. 2 After* Graculus H₂ *has* sibi statum regiminis presumpsit aliorum et in rei veritate ille Graculus fuit dux eorum, qui Graculus angilice vocatus est a gaye et secundum vulgare dictum appellatur Watte.
[194](#) Cap. ix. *Heading 3* Gay SH Geay CT a Geay D Iay E
[195](#) 725 alonge CE
[196](#) 730 iniquus CED
[197](#) 731 Iehenne C
[198](#) 733 Rore quidem baratri D
[199](#) Cap. x. *Heading 2* Vlixis CED
[200](#) 747 turbaque CE
[201](#) 757 Caym HDT
[202](#) 766 S *has lost one leaf containing ll. 766-856. Text follows C*
[203](#) 766 sybilla C sibilla EHD
[204](#) 771 dominos superos nec adorant D
[205](#) 779 Vluxis HT Vlixis CE Alixis D
[206](#) Cap. xi. *Heading 3* tunc om. T
[207](#) 784 Betteque CEHG Recteque DT hykke C hikke E hicke HGD
[208](#) 788 Lorkin HGD
[209](#) 789 Cebbe D
[210](#) 790 Iacke HGD
[211](#) 792 fore] sua E
[212](#) 795 quamplures HGD
[213](#) 811 eorum CEHGT earum D
[214](#) 817 sonitum quoque verberat D
[215](#) 821 Congestat D
[216](#) 822 obstupuere C
[217](#) 824 in cuius DT
[218](#) 837 celeris C furorum D
[219](#) 846 conchos D sibi om. D (*marg. rubr. Deficit in copia*)
[220](#) 855 roderat CEHGTH₂ roserat D rubedo D
[221](#) 857 S *resumes*
[222](#) 868 de S se CEHD
[223](#) 872 ibi ED
[224](#) Cap. xiii. *Heading 2* idest HD
[225](#) 4 pro tunc CEH
[226](#) 882 poterat C
[227](#) 893 om. D (*marg. deficit versus in copia*)
[228](#) 920 vtrumque latus] vbique loca D
[229](#) 947 stetit] rapit D

[230](#) 948 preda peracta D
[231](#) 953 igne S
[232](#) 967 retor CEHG
[233](#) 979 vrbis S orbis CEHD
[234](#) 981 *om.* D (*margin deficit versus in copia*) retro grada C
[235](#) 999 ylion CE Olion (*rubr. ylion*) D
[236](#) 1019-1023 *Text over erasure* SCHG *without erasure* E *As follows in* D

Non pungens ramnus, sed oliua nitens, *sed* adornans
1020* Ficus, sed blanda vitis, abhorret eos:
Non summus dominus regit hos, non spiritus almus,
Nec lex nec *Cristus* tunc dominatur eis;
Namque creatorem nullo venerantur honore,

TH₂ *also have this text, but in l. 1021 these read*

Summus demon enim regit hos nam spiritus almus

[237](#) 1071 repugnans CED repugnans SHGTH₂
[238](#) 1077 *margin* Nota C
[239](#) 1105 Reproba D
[240](#) 1107 perante HD
[241](#) 1117 Caym HD
[242](#) 1136 perfida SCHGDTH₂ perfide E
[243](#) 1141 mutulati SHD mutilati CE
[244](#) 1159 frangeret actum D
[245](#) 1160 subdita C
[246](#) Cap. xv. *Heading* 3 pro tunc CED
[247](#) 4 huius ED
[248](#) 1170 sepulcra D
[249](#) 1173 hostia CE
[250](#) 1190 redeat C
[251](#) 1199 vagus D
[252](#) 1206 Quem D
[253](#) 1209 mensas] mammas D
[254](#) 1212 locus S thorus CEHGD
[255](#) 1241 vt (ut) CEHD et S
[256](#) 1243 Eius enim nulla morbo medicina medetur D
[257](#) 1269 vel] nec C
[258](#) 1271 cessat CEHDTH₂ cessit SG
[259](#) 1273 Nulla sumunt spacia D
[260](#) 1308 dedit D
[261](#) 1312 sit CE scit SHD
[262](#) 1361 internis D
[263](#) 1369 limine S
[264](#) 1377 Iehenna C
[265](#) 1386 ullo *om.* D (*marg. deficit*)
[266](#) 1392 Giraui D
[267](#) 1395 turma D
[268](#) 1420 hic] en D
[269](#) 1461 possum SHD possim CE

[270](#) 1477 monstauerat S
[271](#) 1485 corpusque reliquit *om.* D (*marg. deficit*)
[272](#) 1525 statui CEHD statim SGH₂
[273](#) 1531 subito D
[274](#) 1552 mouet D
[275](#) 1575 redire EHD
[276](#) 1588 Que modo SGD Quo modo H Quomodo CE
[277](#) 1591 Si S
[278](#) Cap. xvii. *Heading 2* persona propria CHDT
[279](#) 1610 tutus] cautus D
[280](#) 1626 potuit C
[281](#) 1662 patebit S
[282](#) 1669 Pugnaque CEDH₂ Pungnaque SHGT
[283](#) 1675 tumidus EH
[284](#) 1693 erant ED
[285](#) Cap. xviii. *Heading 2* de certo remedio absque manu diuina CEHD
[286](#) 1706 ille vel iste CE
[287](#) 1724 quem D
[288](#) 1776 boriā CE notum C
[289](#) 1788 cordis S mentis CEHGDTH₂
[290](#) 1848 timidus SCEHGH₂ timidus T tumidis D (*corr.*)
[291](#) 1859 *Willelmus* D
[292](#) 1870 imbuet SG imbuit CEH incidet D
[293](#) 1874 infernis E infernus D
[294](#) *Between 1939 and 1940* D *inserts* Nauigat vt portum queat habere bonum (*marg. Deficit versus in copia*).
[295](#) Cap. xx. *Heading 1* idest H et D
[296](#) 7 scrutineo CE
[297](#) 1954 Occiani (occiani) SGHT oceani CED
[298](#) 1965 inchola S incola CEHGDT
[299](#) 1994 possim D
[300](#) 2010 magis EDT
[301](#) 2017 inde CE
[302](#) 2022 Circuiendo SHT Circueundo CED
[303](#) 2070 perante H
[304](#) 2073 hodie tutus S tutus hodie CEHGDT
[305](#) 2082 soluo] psallo D
[306](#) 2094 ipsa C
[307](#) 2123 renoues est *et* quia D

³⁰⁸Hic dicit quod ipse iam vigilans, secundum
vocem³⁰⁹ quam in sompnis acceperat,³¹⁰ intendit
scribere ea que de mundo vidit et audiuit, et vocat
libellum istum Vox Clamantis, quia de voce et
clamore quasi omnium conceptus est; vnde in huius
operis auxilium spiritum sanctum inuocat.

Incipit prologus libri Secundi.³¹¹

Multa quidem vidi diuersaque multa notaui,
Que tibi vult meminsens scribere penna sequens:
Non tamen inceptis ego musas inuoco, nec diis
Immolo, set solo sacrificabo deo.
Spiritus alme deus, accendens pectore sensus,
Intima tu serui pectoris vre tui:
Inque tuo, Criste, laxabo nomine rethe,
Vt mea mens capiat que sibi grata petit.
Inceptum per te perfecto fine fruatur
10 Hoc opus ad laudem nominis, oro, tui.
Qui legis hec eciam, te supplico, vir, quod honeste
Scripta feras, viciis nec memor esto meis:
Rem non personam, mentem non corpus in ista
Suscipe materia, sum miser ipse quia.
Res preciosa tamen in vili sepe Minera
Restat, et extracta commoditate placet:
Hoc quod in hiis scriptis tibi dat virtutis honestas
Carpe, nec vlla tumens vlteriora pete.
Si te perstimulet stilus hic stillatus in aure,
20 Sit ratio medicus mulceat inde graue:³¹²
Et si compositis verbis non vtar, vt illis
Metra perormentur, cerne quid ipsa notant:
Et rudis ipse rude si quid tractauero, culpe
Qui legis hoc parce, quod latet intus habe:
Et si metra meis incongrua versibus errent,

Que sibi vult animus congrua vota cape.
 Rethorice folia quamuis formalia desint,
 Materie fructus non erit inde minor:
 Sint licet hii versus modice virtutis ad extra,³¹³
 30 Interior virtus ordine maior erit.
 Quamuis sensus hebes obstet, tamen absque rubore
 Que mea simplicitas sufficit illa dabo.
 In sene scire parum multum solet esse pudori
 Temporis amissi pre grauitate sui;
 Set modo siqua sapit docet aut prouisa senectus,
 Vix tamen hec grata vox iuuenilis habet.
 Que scribunt veteres, licet ex feruore studentes,
 Raro solent pueris dicta placere satis;
 Obloquioque suo quamuis tamen ora canina
 40 Latrent, non fugiam quin magis ista canam.
 De saxis oleum, de petra mel tibi sugge,
 Deque rudi dociles carmine sume notas.
 Quicquid ad interius morum scriptura propinat,
 Doctrine causa debet habere locum:
 Verba per os asini qui protulit, hic mea spes est,
 Eius vt ad laudem cercius ore loquar.
 Ergo recede mee detractor simplicitati,
 Nec mea scripta queat rodere liuor edax:
 Lite vacent aures lectoris et obuia cedant
 50 Murmura, differ opus, inuida turba, tuum.
 Si tamen incendat Sinon Excetraque sufflet,³¹⁴
 Non minus inceptum tendo parare stilum.
 Est oculus cecus, aurisque manet quasi surda,
 Qui nichil vt sapiat cordis ad yma ferunt;
 Et si cor sapiat quod non docet, est quasi pruna
 Ignea, sub cinere dummodo tecta latet.
 Nil fert sub modio lucens candela reensa,
 Pectoris aut sensus ore negante loqui.
 Quid si pauca sciam, numquid michi scribere pauce
 60 Competit, immo iuuat alter vt illa sciat.
 De modicis igitur modicum dabo pauper, et inde
 Malo valere parum quam valuisse nichil.

Non miser est talis, aliquid qui non dare possit;
Si dare non possum munera, verba dabo.
Attamen in domino credenti nulla facultas
Est impossibilis, dum bene sentit opus.

Gracia quem Cristi ditat, non indiget ille;
Quem deus augmentat possidet immo satis:
Grandia de modico sensu quandoque parantur,
70 Paruaque sepe manus predia magna facit:
Sepius ingentes lux pellit parua tenebras,
Riuulus et dulces sepe ministrat aquas.
Constat difficile iustum nichil esse volenti;
Vt volo, sic verbum det deus ergo meum.
Non tamen ex propriis dicam que verba sequuntur,
Set velut instructus nuncius illa fero.
Lectus vt est variis florum de germine fauus,
Lectaque diuerso litore concha venit,
Sic michi diuersa tribuerunt hoc opus ora,
80 Et visus variis sunt michi causa libri:
Doctorum veterum mea carmina fortificando
Pluribus exemplis scripta fuisse reor.
Vox clamantis erit nomenque voluminis huius,
Quod sibi scripta noui verba doloris habet.

**Hic dicit, secundum quod de clamore communi
audiuit, qualiter status et ordo mundi precipue in
partibus istis in peius multipliciter variantur; et
quomodo super hoc vnusquisque fortunam accusat.**

Incipit liber Secundus.

Cap^m i. Incausti specie lacrimas dabo, de quibus ipse
Scribam cum calamo de grauitate nouo.
Esse virum vanum Salomon dat et omnia vana,
Datque nichil firmum preter amare deum.
Quotquot nascuntur vox illis prima doloris,
Incipit a fletu viuere quisquis homo:

Omnes post lauacrum temptatio multa fatigat,
 Demonis ars, carnis pugna, cupido grauis:³¹⁵
 Nunc stat et abstat homo, flat et efflat, floret et aret,³¹⁶
 10 Nec manet vllus ei firmus in orbe gradus.
 Incipit ecce mori vir, cum iam fuderit aluo
 Mater eum, quem post terminat hora breuis:
 Infantem fletus, puerum scola, luxus adultum,
 Ambicioque virum vexat auara senem;
 Sola nec vna dies homini tam leta ministrat,
 Quin dolor ex aliqua parte nocebit ei.
 Si tamen esse potest quod felix esset in orbe,
 Dudum felices nos dedit esse deus:
 Quicquid summa manus potuit conferre creatis,
 20 Contulit hoc nobis prosperitatis opus.
 Huius erat vite, si que sit, gloria summe,
 Nobis pre reliquis amplificata magis.
 Tuncque fuisse deum nobis specialius omni
 Conuersum plebe clamor vbique fuit:
 Famaque sic mundi, nobisque beacius omni
 Tempus erat populo nuper; et ecce modo
 Turpiter extincta sunt nostra beata vetusta
 Tempora, nam presens torquet amara dies.
 Quam cito venerunt sortis melioris honores,
 30 Tam cito decasum prosperitatis habent:
 Nos cito floruius, set flos erat ille caducus,
 Flammaque de stipula nostra fit illa breuis;
 Set labor et cure fortunaque moribus impar,
 Quod fuit excelsum iam sine lege ruunt.
 Nostra per immensas ibant preconia gentes,
 Que modo mutata sorte pericla ferunt.
 Querunt propterea plures cur tempus et aura
 Stat modo deterius quam solet esse prius:
 Querunt cur tanta nobis quasi cotidiana
 40 Assunt insolita nunc grauiora mala:
 Nam nichil in terra contingens fit sine causa,
 Sicut Iob docuit, qui mala multa tulit.
 Se tamen immunes cause communiter omnes

Dicunt, vt si quis non foret inde reus;
Accusant etenim fortunam iam variatam,
Dicentes quod ea stat magis inde rea.
Fortunam reprobant nunc omnis homo, quia mutat
Et vertit subito quod fuit ante retro;
Hocque potest speculo quisquis discernere nostro,
50 Que fuerat dulcis nunc fit amara nimis.

**Hic corripit fortunam et sui euentus
inconstanciam deplangit.**

Cap^m. ii. O tibi que nomen fortune concipis, illos
Quos prius exaltas cur violenta premis?
Hiis quibus extiteras pia mater dira nouerca
Efficeris, vario preuaricata dolo:
Quos conformasti tua sors dissoluit in iram,
Quos magis vnisti spergis in omne malum.³¹⁷
Si pudor in facie fallente tua foret vllus,
Te quibus associas non inimica fores.
Dudum flore rosa fueras, set mole perurens
60 Nunc vrtica grauas quos refouere soles:
Mobilis est tua rota nimis, subito quoque motu
Diuitis ac inopis alterat ipsa status.
Malo set a fundo conscendere summa rotarum,
Quam quod ab excelso lapsus ad yma cadam:
De super in subtus absit, de sub michi supra³¹⁸
Adueniat, namque prospera lapsa nocent.
Est nam felicem puto maxima pena fuisse,
Quam miser in vita posset habere sua.
Est o quam verum, quod habenti multa dabuntur,
70 Qui tenet et pauca perdere debet ea!
Hoc patet in nobis, quibus olim magnificatis
Gens quasi tota simul subdita colla dabat.
Patria nulla fuit, vbi nos in honore locati
Non fuimus, set nunc laus vetus exul abest:
Omnis enim terra nobis querebat habere

Pacem, nunc guerras hostis vbique petit.
Qui plana fronte dudum comparuit, ecce
Cornua pretendens obuius ipse venit;
Et qui cornutus fuerat, nunc fronte reflexa,
80 Cornibus amissis, vix loca tutus habet.
Que fuerat terra bene fortunata per omne,
Dicunt fortunam iam periisse suam.
Dic set, fortuna, si tu culpabilis extas;
Credo tamen causa nulla sit inde tua:
Det quamuis variam popularis vox tibi famam,
Attamen ore meo te nichil esse puto.
Quicquid agant alii, non possum credere sorti,
Saltem dumque deus sit super omne potens.
Non te fortunam quicquid michi ponere credam,
90 Vt gens que sortem murmurat esse tuam:
Hac tamen in carta, que sit sibi ficta figura,
Scribere decreui, set nichil inde michi.

**Hic describit fortunam secundum aliquos, qui
sortem fortune dicunt esse et casum.**

Cap^m. iii. O fortuna, tibi quod aperte dicitur audi,
Inconstans animi, que nec es hic nec ibi:
Es facie bina, quarum deformiter vna
Respicit, ex et ea fulminat ira tua;
Altera felici vultu candescit, et ipsi
Hanc qui conspiciunt, prospera cuncta gerunt.
Sic odiosa tua facies et amabilis illa
100 Anxia corda leuat sepeque leta ruit:
Ex oculo primo ploras, ridesque secundo,
Ac econuerso, te neque noscet homo.
Dum geris aspectum duplum variata per orbem,
Non te simplicibus constat inire viis.
Prosperitate tua stetero si letus in orbe,
Dum puto securo stare, repente cado;
Et timet incerta cor sepe doloris in vmbra,

Cum michi leticia cras venit ecce noua.
 Omnia suntque tuo tenui pendencia filo,
 110 Qui plus credit eis fallitur atque magis;
 Sique leues oculi sint ictus, sunt leuiora
 Ordine precipiti pendula fata tua.
 Munera nulla iuuant vt te possint retinere,
 Nec domus est certa que stat in orbe tua.
 Tu grauior saxis, leuior tu quam leuis aura,
 Asperior spinis, mollior atque rosis:
 Tu leuior foliis tunc cum sine pondere siccis
 Mobilibus ventis arida facta volant;
 Et minus est in te, quam summa pondus arista,
 120 Que leuis assiduis solibus vsta riget.
 Tu modo clara dies, modo nox terrore repleta;
 Tu modo pacifica, cras petis arma tua:
 Nunc tua deliciis sors fulget, nunc et amaris
 Pallet, vt incerta des bona desque mala:
 Parca que larga manu tu singula premia confers,
 Ac aufers cui vis, sic tua fata geris.
 Non Iris tot diuersos in nube colores,
 Marcius aut varia tempora Mensis habet,
 Quin magis in mille partes tua tempora scindis,
 130 Omnia dissimili tincta colore gerens.
 Est meretrice tuus amor et fallacior omni,
 Et velut vnda maris sic venis atque redis:
 Nemo sciet sero que sit tua mane voluntas,
 Nam tua mens centri nescit habere locum:
 Omne genus lustras, nec in vllo firma recumbis,
 Turbinis et vento te facis esse parem.
 Non tua conceptam michi firmant oscula pacem,
 Nam tua principia finis habere negat:
 Est sine radice tua plantula, nec diuturni
 140 Floris habet laudem, namque repente cadit.
 Quod sibi permaneat tua nil sapientia confert,
 Set sunt ambigua singula dona tua:
 Est tua prosperitas aduersis proxima dampnis,
 Et tua, si que sit, gloria rite breuis.

**Hic tractat vltcrius de mutacione fortune
secundum quod dicunt: concludit tamen in fine, quod
neque sorte aut casu, set ex meritis vel demeritis sunt,
ea que hominibus contingunt.**

Cap^m. iiii. Frustrantur cuncti querentes gaudia mundi,
Nam fortuna nequit mel sine felle dare:
Invidie comes est melior fortuna, nec vmquam
Fida satis cuiquam, mobilis immo manet.
Quis miser ignarus fortune nesciat actus?
150 Quod dat idem tollit, infima summa facit.
Fert vt luna suam fortuna perambula speram,
Decrescit subito, crescit et illa cito:[319](#)
Crescit, decrescit, stabilis nec in ordine sistit,[320](#)
Est nunc subtus ea, nunc et in orbe supra.
Regnabo, regno, regnaui, sum sine regno,
Omnes sic breuiter decipit illud iter.
Motibus innumeris variare momenta dierum,
Omne quod instituunt fata perire sinunt.
Quando fauet fortuna caue, rota namque rotunda
160 Vertit, et inferius que tulit alta premit:
Quos vocat eicit, erigit, obruit, omnia voluit,
Esse suum proprium vendicat ipsa dolum.
Passibus ambiguis fortuna volubilis errat,
Et manet in nullo cotidiana loco:
En rapuit quodcumque dedit fortuna beatum,
Fit macer et subito qui modo crassus erat.
Dum iuuat et vultu ridet fortuna sereno,
Prospera tunc cuncta regna sequuntur opes:[321](#)
Cum fugit illa, simul fugiunt, nec noscitur ille
170 Agminibus comitum qui modo cinctus erat.
Monstrat in exemplis anni mutabile tempus,
Quam fortuna suis stat varianda modis.
Non est fortuna talis quin fallat amica,
Dum mentita sue lex regit acta rote.[322](#)
Hec rota continue per girum de leuitate
Vertitur, et nullo tempore fixa manet:

Hec rota personas mundi non excipit vllas;
 Hec rota castigat, soluit, et omne ligat.
 Non illam flectis precibus, non munere mulces,
 180 Non nullis lacrimis nemo mouebit eam:
 Non sexus, non condicio, non ordo vel etas,
 Nil compellit eam cum pietate pati.
 Ciuis et agricola, rex, rusticus, albus et ater,
 Doctus et insipiens, diues inopsque simul,
 Mitis et impaciens, pius, atrox, equus, iniquus,
 Sunt in iudicio, iudice sorte, pares.
 Hos premit, hos releuat, leuat hos vt ad yma retrudat,
 Interutrumque iocat quos ad vtrumque vocat:
 Ludit et illudit rebus, cum lubricus axis
 190 Labitur et secum lubrica queque facit.
 Hec rota nugatrix sic girovagatur eodem
 Motu, ne possit rebus inesse quies.
 Impetus euertit quicquid fortuna ministrat
 Prospera, nec stabilem contulit ipsa statum.
 Heu! cur tanta fuit concessa potencia tali,
 Cui nichil est iure iuris in orbe datum?
 Si quid iuris habet, surrepcio dicitur esse,
 Nam de iure nichil quo dominetur habet.
 Sic dicunt homines, qui credunt omnia casu
 200 Quod deus extruxit ipsa mouere potest:
 Set fortuna tamen nichil est, neque sors, neque fatum,
 Rebus in humanis nil quoque casus habet:
 Set sibi quisque suam sortem facit, et sibi casum
 Vt libet incurrit, et sibi fata creat;
 Atque voluntatis mens libera quod facit actum
 Pro variis meritis nomine sortis habet.
 Debet enim semper sors esse pedisseca mentis,
 Ex qua sortitur quod sibi nomen erit:
 Si bene vis, sequitur bona sors; si vis male, sortem
 210 Pro motu mentis efficis esse malam.
 Si super astra leues virtutum culmine mentem,
 Te fortuna sue ducit ad alta rote:
 Set si subrueris viciorum mole, repente

Tecum fortunam ducis ad yma tuam.
Expedit vt sortem declines deteriolem,
Dum tuus est animus liber vtrumque sequi.

**Hic dicit secundum scripturas et allegat, qualiter
omnes creature homini iusto seruientes obediunt.**

Cap^m. v. Dixerat ista deus, si que preceperit ipse
Quis seruare velit, prospera reddet ei,
Campos frugiferos, botris vinetaque plena,
220 Temperiem solis et pluuiialis aque;
Sidera compescet, Saturnum reddet amenum,
Qui fuerat pestis tunc erit ipse salus;
Inque suas metas gladius non transiet, immo
De virtute sua singula bella fugat.
Sic pax, sic corpus sanum, sic copia rerum
Sunt homini iusto, dum timet ipse deum:
Tempore quo iustus steterit, stant prospera secum,
Sique cadat iustus, prospera iure cadent;
Nam retrouersantur peruersi prospera iusti,
230 Cumque malus fuerit, carpet et ipse mala.
Sic deus ex meritis disponit tempora nostris,
Vt patet exemplis, si memoranda legis.
Angelus hic cecum Raphael sanare Tobiam
Euolat e celis pronus in orbe viris:
Imperio iusti nequeunt obstare subacti
Tortores baratri, set famulantur ei:
Ac elementorum celestia corpora iustum
Subdita iure colunt, et sua vota ferunt.
In virtute dei sapiens dominabitur astra, ³²³
240 Totaque consequitur vis orizontis eum:
Circulus et ciclus, omnis quoque spera suprema
Sub pede sunt hominis quem iuuat ipse deus.
Sol stetit in Gabaon iusto Iosue rogitante,
Nec poterat gressus continuare suos;
Imperio Iosue solis rota non fuit ausa

Currere, set cursus nescia fixa stetit:
Stella quidem natum patefecit nuncia Cristum,
Quo pacem iustis reddidit ipse deus.
Aeream pestem legimus sanasseque sanctum
250 Gregorium Rome, subueniente prece.
Diuisit Moyses mare virga percuciente,
Quo poterat populus siccus inire pedes:
Firma fides Petri dum cepit credere Cristi
Verba, viam pedibus prebuit vnda maris:
Propter Heliseum limpharum gurgite mersum
Ferrum transiliit desuper atque redit.
Ignea tres pueros fornax suscepit Hebreos,
Flamma set illesis victa pepercit eis.
Terra set Hillario, que plana fuit prius, almo
260 Se leuat, et sedes alta recepit eum:
Ex duris Moyse saxis heremique iubente
Dum saliant fluctus, gens bibit atque pecus:
Montes rex Macedum diuisos consolidauit;
Ex precibus iustis sic dedit esse deus.
 Omnis in orbe fera iusti virtute subacta
Est, draco sicque leo, quos sibi subdit homo:³²⁴
Namque per hoc iustum nouit Babilon Danielelem,
Romaque Siluestrum senserat esse sacrum.
Aeris et volucres iussu Moysi ceciderunt,
270 Inque cibos populi subiacuere dei:
Et piscis triduo Ione seruiuit in vndis,
Dum Niniue portu ventre refudit eum.
Omnia sic iusto patet vt diuina creata
Subueniunt homini, subdita sunt et ei.
O quam diues homo, quam magno munere felix,
Cui totus soli subditur orbis honor!
Felix pre cunctis, cui quicquid fabrica mundi
Continet, assurgit et sua iussa facit.
Si tamen econtra iustus sua verterit acta,³²⁵
280 Illico peruersum senciet inde malum.

**Hic tractat secundum scripturas et allegat,
qualiter omnes creature homini peccatori
aduersantes inobediunt.**

Cap^m. vi. Dum Dauid ipse scelus commisit, in aere pestis

Congelat, et gentem sternit vbique suam:

Et pro peccatis Sodomam combusserat ignis,

Estque Chore culpis eius adusta domus:

Propter peccatum torrens peruenit aquarum,

In moriendo quibus condolet omne genus:

Et terre solida viciis fuerant liquefacta,

Dum Dathan ac Abiron scissa cauerna vorat:

Angelus et domini Sirie turmas dedit ensi,

290 Lisiamque ducem fecit inire fugam:

Septem nocte viros Sarre iugulauit iniquos

Demon et Asmodeus, vult ita namque deus.

Nil fortuna potest iniusto ferre salutis,

Namque creans obstant atque creata simul:[326](#)

Nil valet auferre iusto fortuna valoris,

Nam deus ipse iuuat, et sibi fata nichil.

Vires Sampsoni, vel sensum quis Salomoni,

Absolon aut speciem contulit? Ecce quidem

Corpora natura dedit, et sic exigit illa,

300 Virtutes anime gracia sola dei:[327](#)

Sic patet vt fortuna nichil valet addere nobis,

Tollere seu quicquid, cum nichil ipsa dedit.

Cum tam pacificum rexit Salomon sibi regnum,[328](#)

Tot quoque diuicie quando fuere sue,

Cumque Philisteum constat vicisse gigantem

Funda manu Dauid, num deus ista tulit?

Cumque dies fuerant Ezechie morientis

Sic elongati, mors quoque cessit ei,

Set cum de culpa fuit excusata Susanna,

310 Hester et in populo glorificata suo,

Dic que fortuna tunc prospera contulit ipsis?[329](#)

Nulla, puto, neque iam quis rogo causet eam.

In recolente deum non est fortuna colenda,

Nec faciente malum sors valet esse bona.

Quid Pharaon poterat fortunam corripuisse,
Cumque furore sui tot periere viri?
Aut Nabugodonosor sua quod mutata figura
In pecus extiterat, quid nisi culpa dabat?
Aut quid et ille Saül, qui regnum perdidit et se,
320 Num quia precepti fit reus ipse dei?
Non Azariam lepra candida sorte subegit,
Vsurpans templi presulis acta sibi?
Set quid Achab dicet? Naboth dum tolleret agrum,
Eius auaricia fit sibi causa necis.
Aut Roboas? quoniam senium bona dogmata spreuit,
Diuinum regnum plangit habere suum.
Aut Phinees et Ophni, quos belli strauerat ensis,
Archaque capta fuit? preuia culpa tulit.
Aut quid Hely, qui retrocadens sibi vertice fracto
330 Corruit a Sella, dum stupet inde noua?
Non sors fortune poterat sibi talia ferre,
Set pro peccatis contigit illud eis.
Qui male fecerunt mala premia fine tulerunt,
Namque malos iuste perdidit ipse male.
Cum simulacra colens populus peccasset Hebreus,
Illum tradebat hostibus ira dei:
Cum prece pulsaret celum simulacra relinquens,
Hostes terga dabant, illud agente deo.
Iudei reges valuerunt tunc super omnes,
340 Dum non iura sui preteriere dei;
Hostiles acies populus Iudeus in armis
Semper deuicit, dum bonus ipse fuit:
Set cum transgressi fuerant, tunc hostis vbique
Victos, captiuos, sternere cepit eos.
Ex meritis vel demeritis sic contigit omne,
Humano generi quicquid adesse solet:
Sic vario casu versabitur alea mundi,
Dum solet in rebus ludere summa manus.

**Hic loquitur de deo summo Creatore, qui est
trinus et vnus, in cuius sciencia et dispositione omnia
creata reguntur.**

Cap^m. vii. Est deus omnipotens solus qui cuncta gubernat,
350 Omnia preuidit totus vbique manens;
Omnia ventura sibi sunt presencia semper,
Quam prius et fiant, hec quasi facta videt.
Ante creaturam genitor deus, et genitura
Prima creatura, causaque prima mouens.
Omne quod est esse certum sibi tempus habebat,
Ante quidem tempus set deus omne fuit:
Omne quod est, quod erat, quod erit, quod ducit ad esse,
Est deus, et nec ei temporis esse datur:
Nulla coeua deo poterunt se tempora ferre,
360 Sic patet est dominus iure priore deus.
Est pater, est natus deus, est et spiritus almus,
Tres ita personas nomina trina sonant:
Quelibet hic persona deus dominusque vocatur,
Est deus et dominus solus et vnus idem.
Hee sunt persone tres, set substantia simplex,
Hee tres sunt vnum, non tria, tres set idem:
Hiis tribus vna manet essencia, tres deus vnus,
Hic nichil aut maius aut minus esse potest:
Vna tribus mens, vna trium substantia simplex,
370 Vna tribus bonitas, vna Sophia trium.
Est ignis, calor et motus tria, sicque videntur;
Hec tria sic semper feruidus ignis habet:
Sic pater et natus et spiritus in deitate
Tres sunt, et solum cum paritate notant.
Cum dominus dicat, 'Hominem faciamus,' in illo
Clarius insinuat que sit habenda fides:
Hic persona triplex auctore notatur in vno, [330](#)
Cum maneat simplex in deitate sua.

**Hic loquitur de filio dei incarnato domino nostro
Ihesu Cristo, per quem de malo in bonum
reformamur.**

Cap^m. viii. Nunc incarnatum decet et nos credere natum,
380 Quem colimus Cristum credulitate Ihesum.
Sic opus incepit natus, de corde paterno,
De gremio patris venit ad yma deus.
De patre processit, set non de patre recessit,
Ad mundi veniens yma, set astra tenens;
Semper enim de patre fuit, fuit in patre semper,
Semper apud patrem, cum patre semper idem:
Assumpsit carnem factus caro, nec tamen illam
Desiit assumens esse quod ante fuit:
Vnitur caro sic verbo, quod sint in eadem
390 Hec duo persona, verus vbique deus:
Quod fuit, hoc semper mansit, quod non fuit, illud
Virginis in carne sumpsit, et illud erat.
Par opus huic operi nusquam monstratur, honori
Nullus par potuit esse, Maria, tuo.
Infirmus carne, set robustus deitate,
Carne minor patre, par deitate manens:
Hinc alit, hinc alitur, hinc pascit, pascitur inde,
Hinc regit, hinc regitur, hinc nequit, inde potest:
Hinc iacet in cunis et postulat vbera matris,
400 Hinc testatur eum celicus ordo deum:
Hinc presepe tenet artum sub paupere tecto,
Hinc ad eum reges preuia stella trahit:
Hinc sitis, esuries, lacrimae, labor atque dolores,
Et tandem potuit sustinuisse mori.
Ponitur in precio res impreciables, ipse
Proditur et modico venditur ere deus:
Postque salus, vita, seui predacio claustrum;
Inde resurrexit regna paterna petens:³³¹
Iudicioque suo, finis cum venerit orbis,
410 Attribuet cunctis que meruere prius.
Sic homo perfectus, sic perfectus deus idem,

Exsequitur plene quicquid vtrumque decet.
Suggestit hoc verum mortale quod vbera suggestit,
Quod noua stella gerit suggestit esse deum:
Quod presepe tenet, hominis; quod tres tribus vnum
Muneribus laudant, cernitur esse dei.
Vt sit inops diues, deus infans, rex sine lecto,
Lactis opem poscit pascere cuncta potens,
Hospicium presepe tenens, cui fabrica mundi
420 Est domus, et thalamus ardua tecta poli.
Venit vt esuriat panis, requiesque laboret,
Fons siciat, penas possit habere salus,
Lux obscurari tenebris, sol luce carere,
Et contristari gloria, vita mori.
Hec ita sponte tulit proprio commotus amore,
Vt deus in nostra carne maneret homo.
Sicut Adam fragilis fit primi causa doloris,
Ille deus fortis letificauit opus:
Culpa prioris Ade nascentes vulnerat omnes,
430 Donec sanet eos vnda sequentis Ade.
Primus Adam pecudi, volucris dominatur et angui,
Sub pede noster habet cuncta secundus Adam.
Tempore descensus veteri fuit ad loca flendi,
Ad loca gaudendi lex noua fecit iter.
Vt sic credat homo fore qui vult saluus oportet,
Nec sciat vlterius quam sibi scire licet.

**Hic dicit quod quilibet debet firmiter credere, nec
vltra quam decet argumenta fidei inuestigare.**

Cap^m. ix. Cum deus ex nichilo produxit ad esse creata,
Ipse deus solus et sine teste fuit.
Vt solus facere voluit, sic scire volebat
440 Solus, et hoc nulli participauit opus.
Materies nulla, subtilis forma, perhennis
Compago nostre nil rationis habet.
Subde tuam fidei mentem, quia mortis ymago

Iudicis eterni mistica scire nequit:
 Letitiam luctus, mors vitam, gaudia fletus,
 Non norunt, nec que sunt deitatis homo:
 Non tenebre solem capiunt, non lumina cecus,
 Infima mens hominis nec capit alta dei.
 Nempe sacri flatus archanum nobile nunquam
 450 Scrutari debes, quod penetrare nequis.
 Cum non sit nostrum vel mundi tempora nosse, [332](#)
 Vnde creaturas nosse laborat homo?
 Nos sentire fidem nostra ratione probatam,
 Non foret humanis viribus illud opus.
 Humanum non est opus vt transcendat ad astra,
 Quod mortalis homo non ratione capit:
 Ingenium tante transit virtutis in altum,
 Transcurrit superos, in deitate manet.
 Qui sapienter agit, sapiat moderanter in istis,
 460 Postulet vt rectam possit habere fidem.
 Ingenium mala sepe mouent; non nosse virorum [333](#)
 Est quid in excelsis construit ipse deus:
 Multa viros nescire iuuat; pars maxima rerum
 Offendit sensus; sobrius ergo sciat:
 Committat fidei quod non poterit rationi,
 Quod non dat ratio det sibi firma fides.
 Adde fidem, nam vera fides, quod non videt, audit,
 Credit, sperat, et hec est via, vita, salus.
 Argumenta fides dat rerum que neque sciri
 470 Nec possunt mente nec ratione capi:
 Vera fides quicquid petit impetrat, omne meretur,
 Quicquid possibile creditur ipsa potest.
 Lingua silet, non os loquitur, mens deficit, auris
 Non audit, nichil est hic nisi sola fides.
 Vna quid ad solem sintilla valet, vel ad equor
 Gutta, vel ad celum quid cinis esse potest?
 Vult tamen a modicis immensus, summus ab ymis,
 Vult deus a nobis mentis amore coli.
 Hunc in amando modus discedat, terminus absit;
 480 Nam velut est dignus, nullus amauit eum.

Ille docet quodcumque decet, set et aspera planat,
Curat fracta, fugat noxia, lapsa leuat:
Nam crux et roseo perfusi sanguine clauī,
Expulso Sathana, nostra fuere salus.

Quisque Ihesum meditans intendere debet vt actus
Deponat veteres et meliora colat.
Vita per hoc nomen datur omnibus, et benedicti
Absque Ihesu solo nomine nemo potest.
Non est sanctus vt hic dominus, qui solus ab omni
490 Labe fuit mundus, sanctificansque reos.
Et nisi tu non est alius, quia s u n t nichil omnes
Hii quos mentitur aurea forma deos.
Sic beat ecclesia nos per te larga bonorum,
Et Sinagoga suis est viduata bonis.

**Hic tractat quod in re sculptili vel conflatili non
est confidendum, nec eciam talia adorari debent; set
quod ex illis in ecclesia visis mens remorsa ad solum
deum contemplandum cicius commoueatur.**

Cap^m. x. O maledicta deo gens perfida, nempe pagani,
Quos incredulitas non sinit esse sacros;
Recta fides Cristi quos horret, nam sine recto
Iure creatoris ligna creata colunt.
Incuruatur homo, sese prosternit, adorat
500 Ligna, creatoris inmemor ipse sui. [334](#)
Ligna sibi, lapides, que cernit ymagine sculpta,
Quodlibet ipse suum iactitat esse deum.
Quem deus erexit, pronus iacet ante fauillam,
Et sculptam statuam stipitis orat homo;
Orat opem, petit auxilium, nec muta refantur,
Postulat et manibus quos creat ipsa manus.
Quam vacui sensus est et rationis egeni,
Quod dominus rerum res facit esse deos!
O perturbate mentis reminiscere pensa,
510 Cuius erat primo condicionis homo:

Ad mentem reuoca titulum, quo te deus olim
 Insignem fecit, cum dedit esse tibi.
 Nonne fuit primo totus tibi conditus orbis,
 Subiecteque tuis nutibus eius opes?
 Non fuit ad cultum, factus fuit orbis ad vsum,
 Esse tuus seruus, non deus esse tuus.
 Que iubet ergo tibi ratio, quod vel faber igne
 Conflat vel ligno leuigat, esse deum?
 O miser, vnde deos tibi dices ydola vana,
 520 Tuque deo similis ad simulacra iaces?
 Omnibus, heu! viciis hec est insania maior,
 Numina muta coli, dum nichil ipsa sciunt.
 Que nec habent gressum, tactum, gustum neque visum,
 Numquid ymaginibus sit reputanda salus?
 Ad rationale quid brutum, quid minus illud
 Ad vitale genus, quod neque viuit, erit?
 Arboris est vna pars sulcus, pars et ymago,
 Pars pulmenta coquit, arbor et vna fuit:
 Ecce duas partes calco, set tertia sculpta
 530 Nescio deberet qua ratione coli.
 'Fiat eis similis ea qui componit, et ille
 Qui confidit eis': sic iubet ipse deus.
 Dignior est sculptor sculpto: concluditur ergo
 Quod nimis est fatuus qui colit actor opus.
 Nos set ymaginibus aliter fruimur, puto, sculptis,
 Non ad culturam ius minuendo dei;³³⁵
 Nos set habemus eas, memores quibus amplius esse
 Possumus, vt sanctis intima vota demus.
 Credimus esse deum, non esse deos, neque ritus
 540 Nos gentilis habet: absit ab orbe procul!
 Set cum causa lucri statuas componit et illas
 Ornat, vt ex plebe carpere dona putet,
 Qui sic fingit opus saltem deuotus ad aurum,
 Nescio quid meriti fabrica talis habet.
 Cumque deus Moysi fuerat de monte locutus,
 Visa dei populo nulla figura fuit;
 Nam si quam speciem populus vidisset, eadem

Forma fecisset sculptile forsán opus.
 Set deus ex tali sculpto qui spernit honorem,
 550 Noluit effigiem quamque notare suam;
 Est set ymago dei, puto, iuncta caro rationi,
 Ex qua culturam vendicat ipse suam.
 Vndique signa crucis in honore Ihesu crucifixi
 Mentibus impressa sunt adoranda satis.
 Vis crucis infernum vicit, veterisque ruine,
 Demone deiecto, crux reparauit opus:
 Crux est vera salus, crux est venerabile lignum,^{[336](#)}
 Mors mortis, vite porta, perhenne decus:
 Pectora purificat, mentemque rubigine mundat,^{[337](#)}
 560 Clarificat corda, corpora casta facit;
 Dat sensus, auget vires, tollitque timorem^{[338](#)}
 Mortis, et ad martem corda parata facit.
 In cruce libertas redit, et perit illa potestas,
 Hoste triumphato, que dedit ante mori:
 In cruce religio, ritus cultusque venuste
 Gentis concludunt omnia sacra simul:
 In cruce porta patet paradisi, flammeus ensis
 Custos secreti desiit esse loci:
 Ecce vides quantis prefulgeat illa figuris,
 570 Pagina quam pulcre predicet omnis eam.
 Mira quidem crucis est virtus, qua tractus ab alto
 Vnicus est patris, vt pateretur homo.
 Vi crucis infernum Cristus spoliauit, et illam,
 Perdita que fuerat, inde reuexit ouem:
 Vi crucis in celum conscendit, et astra paterni
 Luminis ingrediens ad sua regna redit:
 Glorificata caro, que sustulit in cruce penas,
 Presidet in celo sede locata dei.
 Sic virtute pie crucis et celestis amoris
 580 Surgit in ecclesia gracia lege noua.

**Hic dicit quod, exquo solus deus omnia creauit,
 solus est a creaturis adorandus, et est eciam magne**

**rationis vt ipse omnia gubernet et secundum merita
et demerita hominum in sua voluntate solus iudicet.**

Cap^m. xi. Semper id est quod erat et erit, trinus deus vnus;
Nec sibi principium, nec sibi finis adest:
Principium tamen et finem dedit omnibus esse,
Omnia per quem sunt, et sine quo nichil est.
Que vult illa potest vt sufficiens in idipsum;
Iussit, et illico sunt que iubet ipse fore:
Cuius ad imperium famulantur cuncta creata,
Hunc volo, credo meum celitus esse deum.
Dum sit aperta dei manus omnia replet habunde,
590 Auertenteque se, vertitur omne retro.
Singula iudicio sapiens sic diuidit equo,
Fallere seu falli quod nequit ipse deus.
Res est equa nimis, deus exquo cuncta creauit,
Sint vt in arbitrio subdita cuncta suo.
Cum solo causante deo sint cuncta creata,
Num fortuna dei soluere possit opus?
Que nil principiis valuit, nec fine valebit,
Estimo quod mediis nil valet ipsa suis.
Quis terre molem celique volubile culmen,
600 Quis ve mouere dedit sidera? Nonne deus?
Quis ve saporauit in dulcia flumina fontes,
Vel quis amara dedit equora? Nonne deus?
Conditor orbis ad hoc quod condidit esse volebat,
Vt deseruaret fabrica tota deo.
Terram vestiuit herbis et floribus herbas,
Flores in fructus multiplicare dedit:
Invigilat summo studio ditescere terram,
Et fecundare fertilitate sua:
Nec satis est mundus quod flumine, fontibus, ortis,
610 Floribus et tanto germine diues erat;
Res animare nouas, varias formare figuras,
Et speciebus eas diuaricare parat.
Diuersi generis animancia terra recepit,
Ingemuitque nouo pondere pressa suo;[339](#)

Distribuitque locos ad eorum proprietates,
 Iuxta quod proprium cuilibet esse dedit,
 Montibus hiis, illis convallibus, hiis nemorosis,
 Pluribus in planis dans habitare locis:
 Aera sumpsit auis, piscis sibi vendicat vndas,
 620 Planiciem pecudes, deuia queque fere.
 Ars operi dictat formas, opifexque figurat,
 Artificis sequitur fabrica tota manum.
 Fortune nichil attribuit, set solus vt ipse
 Cuncta creat, solus cuncta creata regit:
 Est nichil infelix, nichil aut de sorte beatum,
 Immo viri meritis dat sua dona deus.
 Quicquid adest igitur, sapiens qui scripta reuoluit
 Dicet fortunam non habuisse ream:
 Hoc fateor vere, quicquid contingit in orbe,
 630 Nos sumus in causa, sint bona siue mala.

FOOTNOTES:

- [308](#) *Heading L resumes here*
[309](#) 1 vocem] visionem DH₂
[310](#) 2 acceperat et ex plebis voce *communi* concepit L
[311](#) Incipit prologus &c. *om.* L
[312](#) 20 Sic EDL Set T
[313](#) 29 Sunt C
[314](#) 51 Symon excetraque L si non excecraque D
[315](#) Cap. i. 8 pugna CEDL pungna S pungna H
[316](#) 9 obstat ED
[317](#) 56 spargis CED
[318](#) 65 Desuper EDLT
[319](#) 152 Crescit decrescit/crescit D
[320](#) 153 Crescit, decrescit] Decrescit subito D
[321](#) 168 cunta C
[322](#) 174 tegit CE
[323](#) 239 *No paragr. here* CE
[324](#) 266 dracho C
[325](#) 279 Attamen econtra si iustus D
[326](#) 294 obstat CGDL
[327](#) 300 anime CEHGD L animi S
[328](#) 303 *Paragraph here* HDL
[329](#) 311 illis CE
[330](#) 377 Hic SCEHG Hec DLH₂
[331](#) 408 resurexit SHT surrexit CEDL

[332](#) 451 f. nosce CE

[333](#) 461 nosce CE

[334](#) 500, 501 Lingua H

[335](#) 536 muniendo (?) C

[336](#) 557 signum D

[337](#) 559 mentesque CEH

[338](#) 561 f. *two lines om.* T

[339](#) 614 Ingenuitque DL

Hic dicit quod, exquo³⁴⁰ non a fortuna, set meritis et demeritis, ea que nos in mundo prospera et aduersa vocamus digno dei iudicio hominibus contingunt, intendit consequenter scribere de statu hominum, qualiter se ad presens habent, secundum hoc quod per sompnum superius dictum vidit et audiuit.

Incipit prologus libri tercii.

Cum bona siue mala sit nobis sors tribuenda
Ex propriis meritis, hiis magis hiisque minus,
Fit mundique status in tres diuisio partes,
Omnibus vnde viris stat quasi sortis opus,
Et modo per vicia quia sors magis astat iniqua,
Ponderet in causis quilibet acta suis:
In quocumque gradu sit homo, videatur in orbe
Que sibi sunt facta, sors cadit vnde rea.
Non ego personas culpabo, set increpo culpas,³⁴¹
10 Quas in personis cernimus esse reas.
A me non ipso loquor hec, set que michi plebis
Vox dedit, et sortem plangit vbique malam:
Vt loquitur vulgus loquor, et scribendo loquelam³⁴²
Plango, quod est sanctus nullus vt ante status.
Quisque suum tangat pectus videatque sequenter
Si sit in hoc talis vnde quietus erit.³⁴³
Nescio quis purum se dicet, plebs quia tota
Clamat iam lesum quemlibet esse statum.
Culpa quidem lata, non culpa leuis, maculauit
20 Tempora cum causis, nos quoque nostra loca:
Nil generale tamen concludam sub speciali,
Nec gero propositum ledere quemque statum.
Nouimus esse status tres, sub quibus omnis in orbe
More suo viuunt atque ministrant eis.

Non status in culpa reus est, set transgredientes
 A virtute status, culpa repugnat eis.
 Quod dicunt alii scribam, quia nolo quod vlli
 Sumant istud opus de nouitate mea.
 Qui culpat vicia virtutes laudat, vt inde
 30 Stet magis ipse bonus in bonitate sua:
 Vt patet oppositum nigris manifestius album,
 Sic bona cum viciis sunt patefacta magis:
 Ne grauet ergo bonos, tangat si scriptor iniquos,
 Ponderet hoc cordis lanx patientis onus:
 Vera negant pingi, quia vera relacio scribi
 Debet, non blandi falsa loquela doli.
 Si qua michi sintilla foret sensus, precor illam
 Ad cumulum fructus augeat ille deus:
 Si qua boni scriptura tenet, hoc fons bonitatis
 40 Stillet detque deus que bona scribat homo:
 Fructificet deus in famulo que scripta iuuabunt,
 Digna ministret homo semina, grana deus.
 Mole rei victus fateor succumbo, set ipsam
 Spes michi promittit claudere fine bono:
 Quod spes promittit, amor amplexatur, vtrique
 Auxiliumque fides consiliumque facit;³⁴⁴
 Suggest, instigat, suadet, fructumque laboris
 Spondet, et exclamat, 'Incipe, fiet opus.'
 Quo minor est sensus meus, adde tuum, deus, et da,
 50 Oro, pios vultus ad mea vota tuos:
 Vt nichil abrupte s i b i p r esumat stilus iste,
 Da veniam cepto, te, deus, oro, meo.
 Non ego sidereas affecto tangere sedes,
 Scribere nec summi mistica quero poli;
 Set magis, humana que vox communis ad extra
 Plangit in hac terra, scribo moderna mala:
 Vtilis aduerso quia confert tempore sermo,
 Promere tendo mala iam bona verba die.³⁴⁵
 Nulla Susurro queat imponere scandala, per que
 60 Auris in auditu negligat ora libri:
 Non malus interpres aliquam michi concitet iram,

Quid nisi transgressis dum loquar ipse reis.
 Erigat, oro, pia tenuem manus ergo carectam,
 Vt mea sincero currat in axe rota:
 Scribentem iuuat ipse fauor minuatque laborem,
 Cum magis in puido pectore p e rstat opus:
 Omnia peruersas poterunt corrumpere mentes,
 Stant tamen illa suis singula tuta locis:
 Vt magis ipse queam, reliqui poterintque valere,³⁴⁶
 70 Scit deus, ista mei vota laboris erunt.
 Aspice, quique leges ex ipsis concipe verbis,
 Hoc michi non odium scribere suadet opus.
 Si liber iste suis mordebitur ex inimicis,
 Hoc peto ne possint hunc lacerare tamen:
 Vade, liber, seruos sub eo qui liberat omnes,
 Nec mala possit iter rumpere lingua tuum;
 Si, liber, ora queas transire per inuida liber,
 Imponent alii scandala nulla tibi.
 Non erit in dubio m e a v o x clamans, erit omnis
 80 Namque fides huius maxima vocis homo.
 Si michi tam sepe liquet excusacio facta,
 Ignoscas, timeo naufragus omne fretum.
 O sapiens, sine quo nichil est sapientia mundi,
 Cuius in obsequium me mea vota ferunt,
 Te precor instanti da tempore, Criste, misertus,
 Vt metra que pecii prompta parare queam;
 Turgida deuitet, falsum mea penna recuset
 Scribere, set scribat que modo vera videt.
 In primis caueat ne fluctuet, immo decenter
 90 Quod primo pon i t carmine seruet opus:³⁴⁷
 Hic nichil offendat lectorem, sit nisi verum
 Aut veri simile, quod mea scripta dabunt.
 In te qui es verus mea sit sententia vera,
 Non ibi figmentum cernere possit homo:
 Conueniatque rei verbum sensumque ministret,
 Dulce sit et quicquam commoditatis habens:
 Absit adulari, nec sit michi fabula blesa,
 Nec michi laus meriti sit sine laude tua.

Da loquar vt viciū minuatur et ammodo virtus
100 Crescat, vt in mundo mundior extet homo:
Tu gressus dispone meos, tu pectus adauge,
Tu sensus aperi, tu plue verba michi;
Et quia sub trino mundi status ordine fertur,
Sub trina serie tu mea scripta foue.
Hiis tibi libatis nouus intro nauta profundum,
Sacrum pneuma rogans vt mea vela regas.

Hic tractat qualiter status et ordo mundi in tribus consistit gradibus, sunt enim, vt dicit, Clerus, Milicies, et Agricultores, de quorum errore mundi infortunia nobis contingunt. Vnde primo videndum est de errore cleri precipue in ordine prelatorum, qui potenciores aliis existunt; et primo dicet de prelatis illis qui Cristi scolam dogmatizant et eius contrarium operantur.

Incipit liber tercius.[348](#)

Cap^m. i. Sunt Clerus, Miles, Cultor, tres trina gerentes,
Set de prelatis scribere tendo prius.
Scisma patens hodie monstrat quod
sunt duo pape,
Vnus scismaticus, alter et ille bonus:
Francia scismaticum colit et statuit
venerandum,
Anglia set rectam seruat vbique
fidem.
Ergo meis scriptis super hoc
vbicumque legendis
Sint bona dicta bonis, et mala linquo
malis.
Inter prelatos dum Cristi quero
sequaces,
Regula nulla manet, que prius esse
10 solet.

Cristus erat pauper, illi cumulantur in auro;
 Hic pacem dederat, hii modo bella mouent;
 Cristus erat largus, hii sunt velut archa tenaces;
 Hunc labor inuasit, hos fouet aucta quies:
 Cristus erat mitis, hii sunt tamen impetiosi;
 Hic humilis subiit, hii superesse volunt:
 Cristus erat miserans, hii vindictamque
 sequuntur;
 Sustulit hic penas, hos timor inde fugat:
 Cristus erat virgo, sunt illi raro pudici;
 20 Hic bonus est pastor, hii set ouile vorant:
 Cristus erat verax, hii blandaque verba requirunt;
 Cristus erat iustus, hii nisi velle vident:
 Cristus erat constans, hii vento mobiliore;
 Obstitit ipse malis, hii magis illa sinunt:
 Hii pleno stomacho laudant ieiunia Cristi;
 Cristus aqua m peccat, hii bona vina bibunt:

As follows in CHGEDL,

*Cap^m. i. Sunt Clerus, Miles, Cultor, tres trina gerentes;
 Hic docet, hic pugnat, alter et arua colit.
 Quid sibi sit Clerus primo videamus, et ecce
 Eius in exemplis iam stupet omnis humus. [349](#)
 Scisma patens hodie monstrat quod sunt duo pape,
 Vnus scismaticus, alter et ille bonus:
 Francia scismaticum colit et statuit venerandum,
 Anglia sed rectam seruat vbique fidem.
 Ergo meis scriptis super hoc vbicumque legendis
 10* Sint bona dicta bonis, et mala linquo malis.
 Delicias mundi negat omnis regula Cristi,
 Sed modo prelati preuaricantur ibi.
 Cristus erat pauper, illi cumulantur in auro;
 Hic humilis subiit, hii superesse volunt:

- Cristus erat mitis, hos pompa superbit inanis;
Hic pacem dederat, hii modo bella ferunt:
Cristus erat miserans, hii vindictamque sequuntur;
Mulcet eum pietas, hos mouet ira frequens:³⁵⁰
Cristus erat verax, hii blandaque verba requirunt;
20* Cristus erat iustus, hii nisi velle vident:
Cristus erat constans, hii vento mobiliiores;
Obstitit ille malis, hii mala stare sinunt:³⁵¹
Cristus erat virgo, sunt illi raro pudici;
Hic bonus est pastor, hii sed ouile vorant:
Hii pleno stomacho laudant ieiunia Cristi;
Mollibus induti, nudus et ipse pedes:
Et que plus poterunt sibi fercula lauta parari,³⁵²
28* Ad festum Bachi dant holocausta quasi.
Esca placens ventri, &c. *as* 29 ff.
-

As follows in TH₂,

- **Cap^m. i. Sunt clerus, miles, cultor, tres trina gerentes;³⁵³
Hic docet, hic pugnat, alter et arua colit.
Quid sibi sit clerus primo videamus, et ecce
De reliquis fugiens mundus adheret eis.³⁵⁴
Primo prelatos constat preferre sequendos,
Nam via doctorum tucior illa foret.
Morigeris verbis modo sunt quam plura docentes,
Facta tamen dictis dissona cerno suis.
Ipse Ihesus facere bene cepit, postque docere,
10** Set modo prelati non manet ille modus.
Ille fuit pauper, isti cumulantur in auro;
Hic pacem dederat, hii quoque bella ferunt:
Ille fuit largus, hii sunt velut archa tenaces;
Hunc labor inuasit, hos fouet aucta quies:
Ille fuit mitis, hii sunt magis igne furentes;
Hic humilis subiit, hii superesse volunt:

Ille misertus erat, hii vindictamque sequuntur;
Sustulit hic penas, hos timor inde fugat:
Ille fuit virgo, vix vnus castus eorum;
20** Hic bonus est pastor, hii set ouile vorant:
Ille fuit verax, hii blandaque verba requirunt;
Ille fuit iustus, hii nisi velle vident:
Ille fuit constans, hii vento mobiliiores;
Obstitit ipse malis, hii magis ipsa sinunt.³⁵⁵
Hii pleno stomacho laudant ieiunia Cristi;
26** Hic limpham peciit, hii bona vina bibunt:
Et quotquot poterit &c., as 27 ff.

Et quotquot poterit mens escas premeditari
Lautas, pro stomacho dant renouare suo.
Esca placens ventri, sic est et venter ad escas,
30 Vt Venus a latere stet bene pasta gule.
Respuit in monte sibi Cristus singula regna,
Hiis nisi mundana gloria sola placet.
Moribus assuetus olim simplex fuit, et nunc
Presul opes mores deputat esse suos.
Creuerunt set opes et opum furiosa cupido,
Et cum possideant plurima, plura petunt.
Sunt in lege dei nuper magis hii meditati,
Numen eis vultum prestitit vnde suum:
Nunc magis intrauit animos suspectus honorum,
40 Fit precium dignis, sunt neque cuncta satis.
In precio precium nunc est, dat census honores,
Omneque pauperies subdita crimen habet.
Cum loquitur diues, omnis tunc audiet auris,
Pauperis ore tamen nulla loquela valet:
Si careat censu, sensus nichil est sapienti,
Census in orbe modo sensibus ora premit.
Pauper erit stultus, loquitur licet ore Catonis;
Diues erit sapiens, nil licet ipse sciat:

50 Est in conspectu paupertas vilis eorum
 Cuiuscumque viri, sit licet ipse bonus;
 Sit licet et diues peruerse condicionis,
 Horum iudiciis non erit ipse malus.
 Nil artes, nil pacta fides, nil gracia lingue,
 Nil fons ingenii, nil probitas, sine re:
 Nullus inops sapiens; vbi res, ibi copia sensus;
 Si sapiat pauper, nil nisi pauper erit.
 Quem mundus reprobatur, en nos reprobamus eundem,
 Vtque perit pereat perdicionis opus;³⁵⁶
 60 Nos set eum laude nostra dignum reputamus,
 Copia quem mundi duxit ad orbis opes:
 Et sic prelatis mundus prefertur ab intus,
 Hiis tamen exterius fingitur ipse deus.
 Laudamus veteres, nostris tamen vtimur annis,
 Nec vetus in nobis regula seruat iter:
 Non tunc iusticiam facinus mortale fugarat,
 Que nunc ad superos rapta reliquit humum.
 Felices anime mundum renuere, set intus
 Cura domos superas scandere tota fuit;
 Non venus aut vinum sublimia pectora fregit,
 70 Que magis interius concupiere deum.
 Plura videre potes modo set nouitatis ad instans,
 Que procul a Cristi laude superba gerunt:
 Nunc magis illesa seruant sua corpora leta,
 Set non sunt ista gaudia nata fide:
 Sufficit hiis sola ficte pietatis in vmbra,
 Dicant pomposi, quam pius ordo dei.
 Pro fidei meritis prelati tot paciuntur,
 Vnde viros sanctos nos reputamus eos.

**Hic loquitur de prelatis illis qui carnalia
 appetentes vltra modum delicate viuunt.**

Cap^m. ii. Permanet ecce status Thome, cessit tamen actus,
 80 Normaue Martini deperit alma quasi;

Sic qui pastor erat, nunc Mercenarius extat,³⁵⁷
 Quo fugiente lupus spergit vbique gregem.
 Non caput in gladio iam vincit, nec valet arto
 Vincere cilicio deliciosa caro:
 Ollarum carnes preponit fercula, porros,
 Gebas pro manna presul habere petit.³⁵⁸
 Prodolor! en tales sinus ecclesie modo nutrit,
 Qui pro diuinis terrea vana petunt.
 Ollarum carnes carnalia facta figurant,
 90 Que velut in cleri carne libido coquit.
 Est carni cognata venus, iactancia, fastus,
 Ambicio, liuor, crapula, rixa, dolus.
 Ventre saginato veneris suspirat ad vsum
 Carnis amica caro, carnea membra petens:
 Et sic non poterunt virtutum tangere culmen,
 Dum dominatur eis ventris iniquus amor.
 Subuertunt Sodomam tumor, ocia, copia panis,
 Impietasque tenax: presul, ad ista caue.
 Set modo prelati dicant michi quicquid ad aures,
 100 Lex tamen ex proprio velle gubernat eos:
 Si mundo placeant carnique placencia reddant,
 Ex anima virtus raro placebit eis.
 Bachus adest festo patulo diffusus in auro,
 Precellit calices maior honore ciphus;
 Glorificans mensam non aurea vasa recondit,
 Quo poterit vano vanus honore frui.
 Aula patet cunctis oneratque cibaria mensas,
 Indulgetque nimis potibus atque cibis:
 Vestibus et facie longus nitet ordo clientum,
 110 Ad domini nutus turba parata leues:
 Sic modico ventri vastus vix sufficit orbis,
 Atque ministrorum vocibus aula fremit.
 Tantum diuitibus, aliis non festa parantur,
 Nec valet in festo pauper habere locum;
 Vanaque sic pietas stat victa cupidine ventris;
 Dum sit honor nobis, nil reputatur onus.
 Sicque famem Cristi presul laudare gulosus

Presumit, simile nec sibi quicquid agit;
Quicquid et ad viciū mare nutrit, terra vel aer,
120 Querit habetque sibi luxuriosa fames:
Esuriens anima maceratur, et ipsa voluptas
Carnis ad excessum crassat in ore gulam.
Sic epulis largis est pleno ventre beatus
Luce, set in scortis gaudia noctis habet;
Cumque genas bibulas Bachus rubefecerit ambas,
Erigit ex stimulis cornua ceca Venus:
Sic preclara viri virtus, sic vita beata
Deliciis pastus cum meretrice cubat.
Frigida nulla timet Acherontis, quem calefactum
130 Confouet incesti lectus amore sui;
Sicque voluptatum varia dulcedine gaudet,
Et desideriiis seruit vbique suis;
Sicque ioco, venere, vino sompnoque beatus,
Expendit vite tempora vana sue.
Nescit perpetuo quod torrem nutriat igni
Corpus, quod tantis nutrit alitque modis.

**Hic loquitur de prelatiis illis qui lucris terrenis
inhiant, honore prelacie gaudent, et non vt prosint set
vt presint, episcopatum desiderant.**

Cap^m. iii. Nemo potest verus dominis seruire duobus,
Presul in officio fert tamen illa duo:
Eterni regis seruū se dicit, et ipse
140 Terreno regi seruit et astat ei:
Clauiger ethereus Petrus extitit, isteque poscit³⁵⁹
Claues thesauri regis habere sibi.
Sic est deuotus cupidus, mitisque superbus,
Celicus et qui plus sollicitatur humo:
Sic mundum sic et Cristum retinebit vtrumque,
Mundus amicior, Cristus amicus, erit.
Inter eos, maior quis sit, lis sepe mouetur,
Set quis erit melior, questio nulla sonat:

Si tamen ad mundi visum facies bonitatis
 150 Eminent, hoc raro viscera cordis habent.
 Hoc deus esse pium statuit quodcunque iuuaret,
 Nos tamen ad nocuas prouocat ira manus:
 Vti iusticia volo, set conuertor in iram,
 Principiumque bonum destruit ira sequens:
 Carnem castigo, miseros sustento, set inde
 Nascens furatur gloria vana bonum.
 Istud fermentum mundane laudis et ire
 Absque lucro meriti respuit ira dei:
 In viciū virtus sic vertitur, vt sibi mundus
 160 Gaudeat et Cristus transeat absque lucris.
 Vt presul prosit dudum sic ordo petebat,
 Set modo que presit mitra colenda placet.
 Presulis ex precibus populo peccante solebat
 Ira dei minui nec meminisse mali;
 Nuncque manus Moyses non erigit in prece noster,
 Nos Amalech ideo vexat in ense suo.
 Moyse leuante manus Iosue victoria cedit,
 Dumque remittit eas, victus ab hoste redit:
 Sic pro plebe manu, lacrimis, prece, sidera pulsans
 170 Presul ab instanti munit ab hoste suos;
 Ac, si dormitet victus torpore sacerdos,
 Subdita plebs viciis de leuitate cadit.
 Quos habeat fructus suplex deuocio iusti,
 In precibus Moysi quisque notare potest.
 Qui bonus est pastor gregis ex pietate mouetur,
 Et propriis humeris fert sibi pondus ouis;³⁶⁰
 Qui licet immunis sit ab omni labe, suorum
 Membrorum culpas imputat ipse sibi.
 Non in se Cristus crimen transisse fatetur,
 180 Set reus in membris dicitur esse suis:
 Non facit hic populum delinquere, set tamen eius
 Suscepit culpas vt remoueret eas.
 Nunc tamen, vt dicunt, est presul talis in
 orbe,
 Qui docet hoc factum, nec tamen illud agit:

Nam qui de proprio se ledit crimine, raro
Efficitur curis hic aliena salus:
Non valet ille deo conferre salubria voto,
Ad mundi cultum qui dedit omne suum.

- Presul in orbe gregem curare tenetur egentem,
190 Ipse videns maculas vngere debet eas:
Set si magnatos presul noscat maculatos,
Illos non audet vngere, namque timet.
Si reliqui peccent, quid ob hoc dum soluere possunt?^{[361](#)}
Torquentur bursa sic reus atque rea:
Ipse gregis loculos mulget, trahit in tribulosque
Cause quo lana vulsa manebit ei.
Quod corpus peccat peccantis bursa relaxat:
Hec statuunt iura presulis ecce noua.
Sic iteranda modo venus affert lucra registro;
200 Dum patitur bursa, sunt residua mala:
Dum locus pregnat satis, impregnare licebit;
Dat partus loculi iura subacta tibi.
Sic timor et lucrum sunt qui peccata relaxant,
Sub quorum manibus omne recumbit opus:
Sic lucri causa presul mulcet sua iura,
Annuat et nostris fas adhibere malis:
Mammona sic nummi nobis dispensat iniqui,
Non tamen eternas prestat habere domos.
Nunc furit en Iudex, si luxuracio simplex
210 Fiat, et incestum nescit habere reum:
Si coheat laicus resolutus cum resoluta,
Clamat in ecclesia clerus et horret ea;
Clerus et in cohitu si peccet, nil reputatur,
Dum Iudex cause parsque sit ipse sue.
Sic modo dii gentis subuertunt cunctipotentis
Iura, que dant michi ius, sum magis vnde reus;
Sicque grauant alios duro sub pondere pressos,
Inque suis humeris quam leue fertur onus.
Vxor adulterio deprensa remittitur, in quo
220 Exemplum venie Cristus habere docet;
Tale tamen crimen non aurea bursa redemit,

Set contrita magis mens medicamen habet.
Non tamen est lacrima modo que delere valebit
Crimen, si bursa nesciat inde forum:
Bursa valet culpam, valet expurgareque penam,
Bursa valet quantum curia nostra valet.

**Hic loquitur de legibus eorum
positiuis, que quamuis ad cultum
anime necessarie non sunt, infinitas
tamen constitutiones quasi cotidie
ad eorum lucrum nobis grauiter
imponunt.**³⁶²

Cap^m. iiii. Num dat pre manibus sceleris veniam michi Cristus?

Non puto, set facto post miseretur eo:

Aut quod peccatum non est, numquid prohibendum³⁶³

230 Hoc Cristus statuit? talia nulla facit.

Nunc set, que Moysi neque lex prohibet neque Cristi,
Plurima decretis dant prohibenda nouis;

Set michi que statuunt hodie peccata, remittunt
Cras, sibi si dedero: de quibus ergo peto.

Aut est quod proprie res peccatum gerit in se,
Aut nisi sit vetita, non foret ipsa mala.

Est si peccatum, tunc cur, quam sit prius actum,
Prestat idem nummis posse licere meis?

Est si res licita, tunc cur sua lex positiua

240 Hanc fore dampnandam striccius artat eam?

Hoc de iusticia puto non venit, immo voluntas
Taliter vt fiat lucra petendo iubet:

Exequitur iuste rem iustam, qui bene causas
Non zelo nummi iudicat, immo dei.

Legibus ecclesie quicquid sit in orbe ligatum
Ex iusta causa, credo ligare decet:

Set nichil iniustum deus accipit, vnde nec alter
Affirmare potest quod deus ipse negat.

Alcius ecce Simon temptat renouare volatum,

- 250 Ne cadat ipse nouo plura timere potest.
Non laqueare venit iter humanum pius ille
Cristus, set planam dirigit ipse viam;
Nos tamen ex plano componimus aspera, durum
Ex molli, que scelus pro pietate damus.
Lex etenim Cristi fuit hec quam gracia mulcet,
Nostra set ex penis lex positua riget.
Lex Cristi simplex sub paucis condita verbis
Clauditur, vnde iugum suaue ministrat onus:³⁶⁴
Infinita tamen legis sententia nostre
- 260 Aggravat, et finem vix habet ipsa suum.
Libera lex Cristi satis est, fit legeque nostra
Absque lucro gratis gracia nulla viris.
Omne fit ex causa; sic est quod lex positua,
Quam fundat clerus, grande figurat opus.
In quanto volucres petit auceps carpere plures,
Vult tanto laqueos amplificare suos:
In quanto leges auget clerus posituas,
Fit magis hiis stricta gentis in orbe via:
Cum magis in stricto gradimur, cicius pede lapso
- 270 Sternimur, et clero subpeditamur eo:
Cum sibi plus mundum teneat clerusque subactum,
Tum magis ecclesia gestat in orbe l u c r a:
Dum magis est clerus diues, magis inde superbus³⁶⁵
Astat, et ex velle dat sua iura fore.
Sol notat ecclesiam, Sinagogam luna figurat,
Set modo custodes ista nec illa ferunt:
Sunt qui nec legis veteris precepta reseruant,
Nec que Cristus eis addidit ipse noua.
Nuper erat firmus presul sine crimine sanctus,
- 280 Vtilis in populo, dignior ante deum;
Set modo si mundum poterit complectere vanum,
Est sibi nil populi laus vel ab ore dei.

**Hic loquitur de prelati qui bona mundi
temporalia possidentes spiritualia omittunt.**

Cap^m. v. Hec vox angelica, que nuper in ethere Romam
Terruit, en nostro iam patet orbe nouo.

Tempore Siluestri, dum Constantinus eidem
Contulit ecclesie terrea dona sue,

‘Virus in ecclesia seritur nunc,’ angelus inquit,
‘Terrea dum mundi fit domus ipsa dei.’

Sic fuit vt dixit, postquam possessio creuit

290 In proprium cleri, virus adhesit ei:

Sic reditus iam quisque suos amat, et sibi quid sit
Vtile sollicitis computat ipse viis.

Ecclesie iura sibi nil sunt, dummodo castra

Curant cum t e r r i s amplificare suis.

Esuriunt mundum semper, set in ordine solum

Nomen ab ecclesiis sufficit illud eis.

Ordinis angelici fertur quod sunt dominati

Atque potestates, sic et in orbe vides;

Nam quia clerus ibi nequit ipsis assimilari,

300 Ferre gerarchiam dat sibi terra suam:³⁶⁶

Sic quia prelatus dubitat quid carpere celis,

Huius vult mundi certus honore frui.

Dixit Pilato Cristus, quod in hoc sibi mundo

Non fuerat regnum: iam neque presul eum

Consequitur, set ei contraria sumere cuncti

Regna volunt, et in hiis bella mouere viris.

Pro fidei causis nolunt dare bella paganis,

Solum nec verba pandere lege sacra;

Set pro terrenis si contradixerit ipsis

310 Saltem Cristicola, dant ibi bella fera.

Sic quia mundana sine Cristo iam capit arma

Clerus in ecclesia, iure carebit ea.

‘Cognoscetis eos,’ Cristus, ‘de fructibus horum,’

Dicit, et est illa regula vera satis.

Quomodocumque suam clerus legem posituam

Laruat, erit testis cultus ad acta foris.

Egros vmbra Petri sanauit, lux neque nostra

Nec vox nec votum ferre meretur opem.

Subdita decurrit pedibus super equora siccis

320 Petrus, iam nostram mergit et vnda fidem.
Qui nos prosequitur, Cristi de lege iubemur
Illum per nostras rectificare preces;
Nos tamen absque deo de iure nouo positiuo
Vindictam gladii ferre monemus ibi.
Sic hos destruimus quos edificare tenemur,
Perdimus et Cristi quod tulit ipse lucri.
'Sit michi vindicta,' deus inquit, set quia papa
Est deus in terris, vindicat ipse prius.

**Hic loquitur qualiter Cristus pacem suis discipulis
dedit et reliquit: dicit tamen³⁶⁷ quod modo propter
bona terrena guerras saltem contra Cristianos prelati
legibus suis positiuis instituunt et prosequuntur.**

Cap^m. vi. Ante sue mortis tempus dedit atque reliquit
330 Pacem discipulis Cristus habere suis;
Et quia tunc solum cupiebant nil nisi Cristum,
In Cristi pace cuncta tulere pie.
Set quia nunc mundum cupiunt tantummodo vanum,
Que sibi sunt mundus bella ministrat eis;
Et quia belligeram ducit clerus modo vitam,
Auctor eos pacis non iuuat ipse deus.
Dixerat ad Petrum Cristus, 'Quicumque virorum
Percutit in gladio, fine peribit eo':
Nec poterit falli fateor sententia Cristi,
340 Quamuis sit cleri mortifer ensis ibi.
Percuciunt ense; si quisque repercutit, inde
Dampnat eum libri lex positiva noui.
Predicat en Petrus, set pugnat papa modernus,
Hic animas, alius querit auarus opes:
Hic fuit occisus pro iure dei, tamen alter
Occidit, neque ius sic habet ipse deus:
Simplicitate fidem non viribus excitat vnus,
Alter et in pompis prouocat arma magis.
Vult Deus vt non sit temeraria nostra querela,

350 Set mala que patimur vindicet illa deus:
 Hostiles acies inimicaque vinximus ora, ³⁶⁸
 Cum vindex nostras nesciat ira vias.
 Mollibus in rebus non se probat accio Cristi,
 Tempore set duro se probat alta fides:
 Militat in Cristo pia que patientia tristi
 Materiam vere tempore laudis habet.
 Cristus erat paciens, probra dum tulit omnia, set nos
 De facto minimo commouet ira modo.
 Omne vigebat opus, dum cleri nobiliores
 360 Cuncta sub arbitrio deseruere dei;
 Ipsa vetus pietas plantare fidem dabat, et nunc
 Extirpat vindex ira superba patrum.
 'Non gladius saluat, et qui sperabit in arcu
 Non saluatur eo,' testificante Daudid:
 Set nos Dauiticam variamus tradicionem,
 Dumque sacerdotis sit gladiata manus.
 Archa vetus Moysi valuit, nobisque valebit
 Arcus qui populum tensus in orbe ferit.
 In celo posuit deus arcum, sit quod ibidem
 370 Federis in signum pacis ad omne genus;
 Nos tamen in terris nostrum dum tendimus arcum,
 Pacis in exilium signa cruoris habet.
 Adiuvet ipse deus quos vult, set noster in armis
 Saluus erit clerus militis acta tenens.
 Criste, tua forti Sathanam virtute
 ligasti,
 Quem nos de clero soluimus ecce
 nouo;
 Ipse solutus enim soluit quoscumque
 ligatos,
 Quo sua vota deo soluere nemo venit.
 Abbatem monachus nescit, nec claustra
 priorem ³⁷³
 380 Ordinis in forma iam retinere queunt;
 A dextro latere meretricem dumque sacerdos
 Et gladium leua promptus ad arma tenet.

³⁶⁹Nota hic ³⁷⁰ de
 bello Cleri tempore
 Regis Ricardi in
 Flandria, quia tunc
 non solum
 seculares set eciam
 regulares presbiteri
 in guerris ³⁷¹
 ibidem mortalibus
 quasi Laici
 spoliantes ³⁷²
 insisterunt.

Quis tali melius est consignatus in orbe,
Forcior armatus, vt bene bella ferat?
Tempore quo cohitum natura mouet, pecus omne
Prouocat ex facili bella furore suo:
Set si causa sit hec, sumat qua presbiter arma,
Longior a pace pugna perhennis erit.
Militis officium non aris thurificare
390 Est, neque presbiteri publica bella sequi.
Si valet in bello clerus sibi ferre triumphum,
Ammodo quid validi militis acta valent?
Quem decet orare clerum pugnare videmus,
Curam de bellis, non animabus habent.
Quid si vulneribus superaddat homo tibi vulnus,
Num dici medicus debeat ipse tuus?
Num decet aut medicum morbo superaddere morbum,
Quo fugit interius longius ipsa salus?
Hoc experta docet natura, quod omnis in orbe
400 Qua magis infirmor, est medicina mala.
Quos reperare decet pacem, si bella frequentent,³⁷⁴
Nescio quo pacis tutus inire viam.
Dicitur vt fortuna rei de fine notatur,
Rebus et in dubiis exitus acta probat:
Qualis erit finis, seu que fortuna sequetur
In cleri bellis scit magis ipse deus.

**Hic loquitur qualiter clerus in amore dei et
proximi deberet pius et paciens existere et non
bellicosus.**

Cap^m. vii. Semper in aduersis est virtus maior, et ecce
Lumen in obscuro clarius esse solet.
Nobile vincendi genus est paciencia; vincit
410 Qui patitur; si vis vincere, disce pati.
Armiger ipse tuus et signifer est tibi Cristus,
Si simplex fueris et pacienter agas.
Ense manu, iaculis, aliis pugnare iubetur,

Nos pugnare fide, spe, pietate decet.
 In seruum domini nichil hostis iuris habebit,
 Ordine seruato causa fauebit ei:
 Sic cum doctrinis fueris completus honestis,
 Tunc hostes poteris inde fugare tuos.
 Vt sis sublimis meritis accinctus in hostes,
 420 Scripture iaculis hostica tela fugas.
 Pro nobis pugnet Ysaïas cum Ieremia,
 Cum Daniele Iohel, cum Samuele Daud;
 Lex euangelii, vox Pauli, sermo prophete,
 Tres michi sunt testes, nostra stat vnde salus.
 Cogitat ecce Daud domino fundare, set audit
 A domino, templum, 'Non fabricator eris:
 Es vir sanguineus, ideo dignum michi templum
 Sanguine fedatus tu fabricare nequis.'
 Sanguinis effusor, amplexens crimina mundi,
 430 Ex bellis templum non valet esse dei:
 Ecclesie sancte talis non erigit edem,
 Nec sacre fidei collocat ipse domum.
 Est nam mors odium, sicut scriptura fatetur;
 Qui fratres odit est homicida sui:
 Quomodo nos igitur, plebis de sanguine tincti,
 Altaris famuli possumus esse dei?
 Peccantis Cristus vult vitam, nec moriatur,
 Set conuertatur, viuat vt ipse deo:
 Et nos pro mundi rebus iugulamus in ense,
 440 Quos Cristi sanguis viuere fecit, eos.
 Quas statuit Cristus leges fuerant pietatis,
 Nec peciit mundi quid nisi corda sibi;
 Non cordis carnem, set quam dileccio mentem
 Prestat, et has leges vendicat esse suas:
 Nos tamen econtra cum sanguine carnea corda
 Poscimus, vt nostra sit magis ira fera.
 Nescio si mundum sub guerra vincere tali
 Possumus; hoc reputo, displicet illa deo:
 Namque malignantis deus ecclesiam magis odit,
 450 Subque manu tali prospera nulla sinit.

Virtutem dat eis, qui mundum vincere norunt,
 Ipsa fides Cristi fratris et intus amor.
 Fratris amor pacem confirmat, federa seruat,
 Stringit amicitias continuatque fidem:³⁷⁵
 Fratris amor nescit aliena sitire, nec vmquam
 Que sua sunt querit, nec scit habere suum:
 Fratris amor ledi non vult nec ledere querit,
 Nec queritur, nec dat vnde queratur homo.
 Augens merorem male vindicat ipse dolorem,
 460 Dum pugnat clerus obstat et ipse deus:
 Nam mundanus amor premit omni tempore quosque,
 Set diuina manus seruat ab hoste suos.³⁷⁶
 Prima dei timor est sapiencia, prima salutis
 Est via, lux prima premia prima parans:
 Federe perpetuo timor amplexatur amorem,
 Quem sibi consimili federe iungit amor.
 Vna nequit virtus alia virtute carere,
 Nam timor est et amor connumeratus idem:
 Est pater, hinc amor est; est iudex, inde timetur;
 470 Et timor hic et amor comoda multa ferunt.
 Non timor est serui set nati, suppliciumque
 Non parit, immo parat premia magna viro.
 Omnis amans Cristum timet illum; qui timet ipse
 Non facit excessum, prouocet vnde d e u m:
 Hic amor inspirat hominem discernere celum,
 Iudicat et mundi gaudia vana fore.
 Est igitur mirum, modo quod discordia cleri
 Non se pacificat huius amoris ope.
 Litera sacra docet, virtus quod amor placet omnis,
 480 Et non mundanus ambiciosus honor;
 Namque suos mundus dilectores magis arcet,
 Et minus in fine commoditatis habent.
 In veteri lege nullas habuere Leuite
 Terras, nec mundus sollicitauit eos;
 Immo deo soli plebis pro pace vacare
 Est et non alia sollicitudo sua.
 Non est ergo bonum mundanas sumere guerras,

Cum deus est mitis et bona pacis amat.

**Hic tractat eciam qualiter non decet prelatos
contra populum Cristianum ex impaciencia
aliquaqualiter bella mouere; set tantum ex precibus, deo
mediante, absque ire impetu omnem mundi
deuincant³⁷⁷ maliciam.**

Cap^m. viii. Inuoluens mentem meditando me stupor angit,

490 Cristi doctrina quam pietosa fuit;
 Omne quod est pacis instruxit regula Cristi,
 Quicquid et est belli nostra cupido mouet.
 Ponit et opponit ratio michi de ratione,
 Qualiter ex clero bellicus vnus erit.
 Plures sunt cause, quod non ita fiat, et inde
 Cristus in exemplum plurima verba docet:
 Et si pro mundo fiat, sapiencia mundi
 Arguit econtra, si videatur opus:
 Nam dum pacifici fuerant nec honoris auari,
500 Omnis tunc requies glorificabat eos.
 Si mundana decet mundanos bellica pugna,
 Longius a clero sit tamen ille furor:
 Que prosunt aliis, aliis nocuisse probantur,
 Quo d facit hunc stare, corruiet alter eo:
 Non bene conueniunt laicis misteria cleri,
 Nec clero laici conuenit arma sequi.
 Bella gerant alii, regat et paciencia clerum,
 Quique tubis resonant, nos tacuisse decet.
 Quo leuius cessit cuiquam victoria belli,
510 Victoris tanto gloria maior erit.
 Non hiis, qui poterunt ex verbo cuncta ligare,
 Expedit vt ponant quomodocumque manus:
 Non opus est armis, vbi vox benedicta triumphat;
 Qui vincit precibus, est sibi guerra nichil:
 Quem deus in tanto promouit munere clerum,
 Sollempnes satis est voce mouere preces.³⁷⁸

Qui sibi vult pacem, paciens in pace quiescat;
 Non grauat hunc mundus quem iuuat ipse deus:
 Quo casu queris, tibi respondere tenebor:
 520 Qui bellator erit, bella parantur ei.
 O quam perduros habet impaciencia fines,
 Vnde solet preceps exitus esse grauis.
 Impetus, vt memini, grauis est deformiter illis,
 Quos sine iure dei propria iura regunt;
 Stultaque multociens nocuit vexacio stulto,
 Qui proprio capiti fine refundit onus:
 Cumque suas vires quis vult preponere Cristi
 Viribus, et bellum vincere credit eis,
 Tanto debilior erit, et cum sic superare
 530 Se putat, en victus subditur ille prius.
 Vult implere viam Balaam, set trita flagellis
 Et diuina videns tardat asella viam:
 Quod sibi sic hominis habet impetuosa voluntas,
 Denegat effectus commoditatis opus.
 Quam variis vicibus humane res variantur,
 Hoc docet expertus finis vbique rei.³⁷⁹
 Quam minima causa magnum discrimen oriri
 Possit, ab effectu res manifesta docet.
 Rebus in aduersis opus est moderamine multo,
 540 Nec decet in grauibus precipitare gradum:
 Micius in duris sapiens Cato mandat agendum,
 Nam nimis accelerans tardius acta facit:
 Rebus in ambiguis quociens fortuna laborat,
 Plus faciet paciens quam furor ille potest.
 Talia rite docet, aliis dum predicat, ecce
 Clerus, et econtra sic quasi cecus agit.³⁸⁰
 Turpia doctorem fedant, cui culpa repugnat,
 Nec sibi quid longo tempore laudis erit.
 Nos nisi prosperitas nichil excusare valebit,
 550 Quam constat nimiam nos tenuisse diu:
 Extitit in letis minor et sollercia nobis,
 Cernere nec cecos nostra cupido sinit.
 Copia multociens hominem defraudat inanem,

Atque magis plenum causat habere famem.
 Quam fuerat requies nuper sine crimine clero
 Dulcis, amara modo sollicitudo docet.
 Casibus in letis magis est metuenda voluptas,
 Sepius in viciū que vaga corda ruit:
 Casibus in letis quam sit vicina ruina,
 560 Et lapsus facilis, nemo videre potest.
 Non reputet modicum modico contenta voluntas,³⁸¹
 Res de postfacto que fuit ante docet:
 Nec magnum reputet quisquam, quin tempore quouis
 Fortuito casu perdere possit idem.
 Discant precipites et quos mora nulla retardat,
 Ne nimis accelerent in sua dampna manus:
 Hoc docet in clero magis experientia facti,
 Quod mundana nichil cura valoris habet.
 Est homo iumentis similis, qui fulget honore
 570 Vanus, et ignorat quid sit honoris onus.
 Est honor ille deo, puto, quando superbia mentem
 Non grauat, immo dei debita iura tenet.
 ‘Qui mecum non est, hic contra me reputatur,
 Collector sine me spensor inanis erit’:
 Hec sunt verba dei, cuius de pondere legis
 Addit vel minuit lex positiua nichil.

**Hic tractat quod, sicut non decet dominos
 temporales vsurpare sibi regimen in spiritualibus, ita
 non decet³⁸² cleri prelatos attemptare sibi guerras et
 huiusmodi temporalia, que mundi superbia et
 auaricia inducunt.**

Cap^m. ix. Anulus et baculus sunt ius papale sequentes,
 Quos velut in signum spirituale tenet;
 Cesaris et ceptum mundi sibi signat honorem,³⁸³
 580 Quo quasi mundane res famulantur ei.
 Papa colens animas has dampnat viuificatque,
 Corpora set Cesar subdita iure regit.

Non licet vt Cesar animas torquere valebit,
Nec de posse suo res tenet illa sibi;
Nec decet ex guerris hominum quod papa fatiget
Corpora, namque sibi non tenet illud opus:
Quisque suum faciat factum, pro quo venit ille,
Saltem qui pondus tam capitale gerit.
Qui tenet hic animas sub cura, celsior extat,
590 Et gradus anterior glorificabit eum.
Quicquid agit papa, licet, vt status ille fatetur,
Errat persona, non status ille tamen:
Nam sacer ille status mundum transcendit, et eius
Celorum clauis dextera palma gerit.
Hinc aperitque polum, tetram quoque claudit
abissum, [384](#)
Que super aut subter sunt, sua iura colunt;
Quod ligat est firmum, quod soluit eritque solutum,
Posse suum nostris sic animabus habet.
Cesaris hec que sunt, lex vt reddantur eidem
600 Vult, et vt illa dei sint tribuenda deo.
Cesaris est vt ei caput inclines, animamque
Pape, sic proprium reddis vtrique suum:
Cesar habere statum pape nequit, aut sibi papa
Cesaris imperium non propriare potest.
Cesaris hoc non est vt spiritualia temptet,
Nec decet vt papa Cesaris arma gerat:
Papa suum teneat Cesarque suum, quod vtrique
Iura coequata stent ratione rata.
Si sibi presumat Cesar papalia iura,
610 Hoc non papa sinit, immo resistit ei:
Ergo quid est bellum pape quod Cesaris extat?
Nam deus ecclesie pacis amator erat.
Set quia papa suis mundum scrutatur in armis,
Inueniet similem quem petit inde modum:
Opponis mundo, mundus respondet, et illam
Quam sibi preponis rem dabit ipse tibi.
Quos prius ecclesia fundauerat ipsa fideles, [385](#)
Nunc magis impaciens dura per arma necat.

Rusticus agricolam, miles fera bella gerentem,
 620 Rectorem dubie nauita puppis amat:
 Cristus amat pacem, pax vendicat et sibi clerum,
 Clerus et ergo suos debet habere pios.
 Turpe referre pedem nec passu stare tenaci,
 Turpe laborantem deseruisse ratem;
 Turpius est Cristi pro mundo iura fugare,
 Qui statuunt bellum pacis adesse loco.
 Omnia regna quasi, Cristi que nomen invndat,
 Bella gerunt reprobis horridiora Gethis.
 Sufficeret tamen hoc, quod bella forent laicorum,
 630 Si non quod proprio clerus in ense ferat:
 Quicquid agant laici, minus excusare valebo
 Clerum, quem Cristi regula pacis habet.
 Set bona que mundi fugitiua sunt velut vmbra, [386](#)
 Postposito Cristo, bella nephanda mouent.
 Quicquid in humanis sit spiritualiter actum,
 Clerus in officio clamat habere suo:
 Est et mundanis que maior gloria rebus,
 Vendicat hoc gladii proprietate sui.
 Sic modo fert clerus geminas quibus euolat alas,
 640 Illa tamen mundi plus placet ala sibi.
 Sic piper vrtice mordacis semina miscent, [387](#)
 Dum clerus mundi sponsus adheret ei;
 Dumque tumens mundo clerus se miscet auaro,
 Quo doleat populus, fit magis egra salus.
 Non satis est illis populum vexare quietum,
 Set magnum bello sollicitare deum.
 Est 'Non occides' scriptum, set in orbe manentem
 Preualet hoc certum nullus habere locum.
 Est vbi dic ergo ius nostrum, nonne caducis
 650 Talibus in rebus quas retinere nequis?
 Linea natalis matris de iure fatetur
 Heredem Cristum, qua fuit ortus, humi:
 Si quid in hoc mundo nobis proprium magis esset,
 Pars foret hoc Cristi que titulatur ei:
 Hanc tenet intrusor modo set paganus, ab illa

Thesauris nostris nulla tributa feret.
 Nos neque personas neque res repetendo mouemus
 Bella viris istis, lex ibi nostra silet:
 Non ibi bulla monet, ibi nec sententia lata
 660 Aggrauat, aut gladius prelia noster agit:
 Que sua sunt Cristus ibi, si vult, vendicet ipse,
 Proque sua bellum proprietate ferat.
 Nos ita longinquis non frangimus ocia guerris,
 It neque pro Cristi dote legatus ibi;
 Set magis in fratres, signat quos vnda renatos,
 Pro mundi rebus publica bella damus.
 Mandatum Cristi clerus quod predicet extat,
 Et sibi sic lucrum spirituale gerat;
 Non lego quod mundi pro lucro clerus ad arma
 670 Procedat, set ibi parcat amore dei.
 Sermo tamen cleri paganos nescit, vt illos
 Conuertat, nec eo se iuuat ipse lucro:
 Castra sibi que domos potius lucratur et vrbes,
 Pro quibus, vt vincat, forcius arma mouet.
 Est sibi quod proprium, sic spirituale recusat,
 Torpet et improprie quo foret ipse vigil;
 Que tamen impropria Cristus sibi dixerat, i l l a
 Mundi terrena propriat ipse sua:
 Sic magis impropria propriat, propriisque repugnans
 680 Dispropriat clerus, que dedit acta deus.
 Venit enim princeps huius mundi, famulatum
 Optinet et nostrum, fert quia grande lucrum.
 Cristi pauperiem mens nostra perhorret auara,
 Ocia ne nostri corporis ipsa premat;
 Nec sua cor mulcet humilis paciencia nostrum, [388](#)
 Hoc etenim nostra pompa superba negat:
 Nullus nos cinget nisi libera nostra voluntas,
 Cuius habet tenera ducere frena caro.
 Conditor est iuris qui spernere iura videtur,
 690 Nec tenet ipse vias, quas docet esse suas;
 Crimina condempnat qui crimine primus habetur,
 Corripiens alios deteriora facit.

Ipse suas maculas, qui noscere vult aliorum,
 Noscat, et emendet que sua culpa parat:
 Qui claues Petri gestaret vt ostia celi
 Panderet, illa viris claudit in orbe prius.
 Cum magis hoc penso, magis obstupefactus in illo
 Sum, nam lux quicquid predicat vmbra fugat:
 Vnius gustus infecit milia multa,
 700 Commaculantur eo cuncta sapore malo.
 Sublimo residens dux prima superbia curru,
 Multa minans vultu, lumine, voce, manu:
 Subsequitur liuor, turba comitatus acerba,
 Pallida res, atra pestis, amara lues;
 Que solet et pietas peccata remittere vindex,
 Extat auaricia lucra caduca petens.
 Quam grauis est pestis, quam triste superbia nomen,
 Radix peccati, fons et origo mali!
 Fons fuit hec sceleris, tocius causa doloris,
 710 Virtutum morbus, saltus ad yma cadens,
 Hospes auaricie, paupertas prodiga, fraudis
 Principium, fallax sensus, iniquus amor,
 Irrequies mentis, lis proxima, mortis amica,
 Perfida mens, ratio deuia, vanus honor.
 Hec quasi de proprio sunt apropiata superbo,
 Heres et baratri primus habetur ibi:
 Hoc capitale malum quo regnat egens caput omne
 Conficit, et caude par facit esse sue.
 Hoc caput est rerum viciis seruire coactum,
 720 Liber homo didicit hoc graue ferre iugum;
 Non illud domini, quod dicitur esse suaue,
 Immo quod imposuit inuidus hostis ei;
 Non quo libertas perquiritur illa salutis,
 Set quod seruili condicione premit.
 Fabrica prima, decus primum, primatis honore
 Preditus, est prime perdicionis opus.
 Prodolor, heu! tante dic que sit causa ruine:
 Elate mentis motus origo fuit.
 O mens elata, presumpcio dira, superni

730 Regis habere locum, iudicis esse parem,
Equarique suo factori, non imitari,
Equiperare deum nec bonitate sequi!
Expediit exemplis vt talibus euacuetur
Fastus, et ex humili corde paretur opus.
Incertum dimitte, tene certum, quia Cristi
Actus erat pacis, bella nec vlla mouet.
Si caput ecclesie delinquat ab ordine sacro,
Ecce nephas capitis membra nephanda parat.

Ordo sacerdotum pro Cristi nomine guerras
740 Non dedit, immo pati cum pietate solet.
Fustibus hii torti quemquam torquere recusant,
Cunctaque sic vincunt, dum pacienter agunt;
Inque bono vicere malum, quia Cristus eorum
Dux fuit, et iustis iusta petita dabat.
Quesiuit precibus bona spiritualia Petrus,
Vicit et egregie sic sua bella prece:
Hec fuit excelsi dextre victoria, cuius
Viribus efficitur quicquid adesse cupit.
Omnia namque pie moderatur, et omnia iusto
750 Pondere perpendit, dum sua vota dedit:
Sic qui prospiceret Cristi meditans pietatem,
Non tumidus fieret nec leuitate fluens.

Non fuit argentum sibi dixit Petrus et aurum,
Set preciosa magis dat sibi dona deus:
Dixerat hic claudio quod surgat, surgit et ille,
Ambulet et vadat, vadit et ipse statim.
Nunc quid erit nobis? nam si vir postulet omnis
Vt sic curemus, absque salute sumus.
Non habet elatus animus, quo digna precetur,
760 Molle cor; ad timidas dat deus immo preces.
Qui fuerat dulcis salibus viciatur amaris,
Floriger et veris floribus extat inops.
Auro magnifici sumus et virtutis egeni,
Nam que sunt auri duximus illa sequi:
Aurum si quis habet, satis ipsum constat habere,

Est et in hoc mundo sic benedictus homo.
 Influit in cleri totus quasi mundus hiatum,
 Inque suas fauces aurea queque vorat:
 Vt tamen inde iuuet inopes, non paruula gutta
 770 Refluit, immo tenax propriat omne sibi.
 Se dedit in precium Cristus pro munere plebi,
 Nos tamen ingrati nostra negamus ei.
 O caput ecclesie, reminiscere tempora Cristi,
 Si dedit exemplis talia sicut agis.
 Ipse redemit oues, a morteque viuificauit,
 Quas pietatis inops tu cruciando necas.
 Precipit ipse, vices per septem septuagenas
 Dimittat Petrus, parcat et ipse reis;
 Tu tamen ad primam gladio cum vindice culpam
 780 Percutis, et nullo parcis amore viro.
 Ecce Rachel plorat nec habet solamina tristes,
 Dum genus ex proprio ventre reliquit eam.
 O genus electum, gens sancta, quid est quod auara
 Scandala iudiciis ponis in orbe tuis?
 Prodolor! ecclesie bona, que debentur egenis,
 Dissipat in bellis qui dominatur eis.
 Prodolor! a clero, pietatis iure remoto,
 Cauda fit ecclesie qui solet esse caput;
 Fitque salus morbus, fit vitae mors, releuamen
 790 Lapsus, lex error, hostis et ipse pater.

**Hic querit quod, ex quo prelati scribunt et docent
 ea que sunt pacis, quomodo in contrarium³⁸⁹ ea que
 sunt belli procurant et operantur. Ad quam tamen
 questionem ipse subsequenter respondet.**

Cap^m. x. In libris cleri Rome sic scribere vidi:
 ‘Vt melius viuas, hec mea scripta legas.
 Vis seruire deo, vis noscere qualia querit?
 Hec lege, tuncque scies qualiter illud erit.
 Dilige mente deum, pete, crede, stude reuereri.’

Teste libro cleri, sic iubet ipse geri.
 'Est quia vita brevis, fuge luxus corporis omnes,
 Preponens anime celica dona tue:
 Iusticiam serua, tua sit lex omnibus equa;
 800 Hoc facias alii, quod cupis ipse tibi:
 Ex toto corde dominum tu dilige, tota
 Ex animaque simul sit tibi fratris amor:
 Gignit nempe dei dileccio fratris amorem,
 Et diuinus amor fratris amore viget.
 Munera fer miseris, que Cristo ferre teneris,
 Arma quibus noceas, bella nec vlla geras:
 Sis pius et paciens, tua sitque modestia cunctis
 Exemplum pacis, duret vt illa magis.'
 Hec ita cum legi, confestim me stupor vrget,
 810 Qualiter in clero bella videre queo:
 Querere sic volui de clero, quis foret ille;
 Qui michi responsum de ratione daret.
 Questio mota fuit, qua sumpta clericus vnus
 Astat et oppositis prompserat ista meis;
 Supponens primis quod ei sit culmen honoris
 Pontificis summi, talia dixit ibi.
 'Diuidit imperium terrena potencia mecum,
 Iureque celicolo subdita regna colo;
 Set quia terra prope nos est celumque remotum,
 820 Que magis est nobis terra propinqua placet.
 Aula michi grandis, sublimis et arte decora,
 Nobilis est thalamus, mollis et ipse thorus:
 Vt placeant ori que postulo, de meliori
 Fercula lauta cibo sunt michi, vina bibo:
 Ex auium genere, de piscibus omne salubre,
 Vt magis est placitum, dant michi ferre cibum:
 Singula que genera vini dat potibus vua
 Optineo, quod in hiis sit michi nulla sitis.
 Sunt michi carmina consona, timpana, letaue musa,
 830 Histrio dat variis cantica plena iocis:
 Que mare, terra parit, meliora vel aera format,
 Sunt michi prompta foro, sicut habere volo.

Est michi vinea, sunt viridaria fonte reclusa,
 Que peto de mundo cuncta tenere queo:
 Est michi fecundus dotalibus ortus in agris,
 Pompaque castrorum, summus et vrbis honor:
 Silua feras, volucres aer suscepit habendas,
 Et mare quam vario pisce repleuit aquas.
 Set loca non tantum nobis, nec et illa creata
 840 Sufficiunt, auri sint nisi dona l u c r i. [390](#)
 ‘Ecce fores large, quas seruat ianitor arte,
 Sic vt in has pauper nullus habebit iter:
 Curia quos reprobat isto sermone repellit,
 “State foras, vacui, flebitis ante fores.”
 Que non dona manum presentat ianitor illam
 Excludat, nostras nec sciat ipsa vias:
 Qui tamen occulto cupit vt sit noster amicus,
 Aurum det, sine quo victima nulla placet:
 Que manus est plena, magis inuitabitur illa,
 850 Stet foris et vacua, nec veneretur ita.
 Omnia soluo, ligo, summo diademate regno,
 Orbis ego dominus: quid michi velle magis?
 Me dominum clamat, me viuens omnis adorat,
 Omne solum calco sic deus alter ego.
 Est thronus excelsus, quo possumus omnibus vna
 Et benedicta manu, sic maledicta dare:
 Sicque potestate nostra reuerenter vbique
 Magnus in ecclesia, maior in orbe sumus.
 ‘Dicimus, et facta iam sunt, mandamus, et ecce
 860 Accrescunt subiti dona creata lucri.
 Que Cristus renuit suscepimus omnia regna
 Mundi, que dominans gloria vana dedit:
 Sic exaltati de terra traximus ad nos
 Omnia deliciis amplificata magis.
 Sic status assumptus quales sumus approbat, vt nos
 Ocia plectentes qui cruciamus humum.
 Suaue iugum, leue Cristus onus nobis dedit, et nos
 Pondera que mundi sunt grauiora damus:
 Iura damus populis, set nos non lege tenemur,

870 Que michi lex placuit iuris habebit onus.
 Iudiciis hominum non stat quod pecco per orbem,
 Sic michi cuncta licent, que magis acta placent;
 Et si mundus in hiis fiat michi forte rebellis,
 Est mea de guerris forcior ecce manus.
 Hiis quoque de causis respondeo papa, quod omnes
 Per mea terrigenos bella retrudo viros.
 ‘Inter discipulos fuerat discordia facta,
 Norma set infantis pacificauit opus:
 Nos tamen ad veram nullo moderamine pacem
 880 Flectere quis poterit, hoc neque pompa sinit.
 In cruce confixus patitur sua funera Cristus,
 Et fuit illa viris passio vera salus:
 Omnibus exemplum fuit hec paciencia Cristi,
 Alterutrum socii simus vt inde pii.
 Nos tamen in signum vindicte ponimus illam,
 Plebis et in mortem ferre iubemus eam:
 Sicque pium signum diuertimus a pietate,
 Que fuit et vita, nunc noua pestis erit.
 Sic modo sunt mortis nuper vexilla salutis,
 890 Que tulit et pacem crux modo bella gerit:
 Sicque crucem domini baiulamus, mente set vlla
 Non sequimur dominum, qua tulit ipse crucem.
 Quod nequit hoc virtus, supplebunt ammodo vires,
 Non mos set mortis pugna parabit iter:
 Nostra sinistra teret quicquid fundauerat olim
 Dextra, que sic humilis non parit oua fides.
 Quam collegerunt alii dispergere messem
 Tendimus, et feritas nostra vorabit humum:
 Vinea sic domini nostros inculta labores
 900 Non habet, estque magis bellica facta manus:
 Sic magis, extrahere quem de pietate tenemur,
 Sternimus in puteum de feritate bouem.
 ‘Quod tulerat Petrus lucrum Iudea fatetur,
 Quas tulit et Paulus gens manifestat opes:
 Nos neque cum vacuis manibus veniemus in auro,
 Quod tamen est lucrum spirituale nichil.

Postera quicquid agat etas, iam nulla veremur
 Crimina, dum mundus noster amicus erit:
 Vt sit enim nomen nostrum nomen super omne,
 910 Est vbi rarus honor, pugna iuuabit opus.
 Ense peribit homo iuxta leges Machometi,
 Eius qui nomen spernit habere sacrum:
 Nos ita decretum iam ponimus ense volutum,
 Nomen vt hinc nostrum presit in omne solum.
 Caesaris imperio qui contradicit, amicus
 Eius in hoc mundo non reputatur homo:
 Sic homo, qui nomen nostrum non preficit altum,
 Filius est mortis, ensis in ore reus.
 'Mittere sic gladium non pacem venimus orbi,
 920 Et noua iam facimus omnia, dampna tamen.
 Sic caput in membra iam seuit, et aggrauat illos,
 Quos minus officio lederet ipse suo:
 Sic pater in natos nunc fit magis ipse Saturnus,
 Quos sua deberet lexque fouere, necat:
 Sic et pastor oues, quas pascere iure tenetur
 Iam vorat, et proprium predat ouile suum:
 Sic ferus vt iudex agitamur secla per ignem,
 Purgatique magis eris habemus opes.
 Vendat enim tunicam sibi clerus et hinc emat ensem,
 930 Cesset et a sacris quilibet ordo suis:
 Nomen et in terris sic nostrum magnificemus,
 Vt timeant alii bella futura sibi.
 Iam pastoralis baculus vertetur in hastam,
 Mitra fit in galeam, pax ruit inque necem:³⁹¹
 Qui prodesse velit prosit, nam nos super omnes
 Preferri volumus, gestet et alter onus.
 'Sic nos, qui summi portamus nomina cleri,
 Corde magis ceci duximus arma sequi:
 Quicquid agant anime, nos subdere corpora mundi
 940 Tendimus, et nobis lex positua fauet;
 Nam licet ex glosa gladium quod sumat vtrumque,
 Quo ferat extenta bellica, nostra manus.
 Ergo magis paueant omnes dedicere nobis,

In quorum bellis os ferit atque manus.
Attamen ad pacem nostram suscepimus omnes
Barbaricas gentes, ne cruciemur eis:
Contra Cristicolas pretendimus arma mouere,
Qui modo sunt ausi vix sua iura loqui.
Auriculam Petrus abscidit, vulnus et illud
950 Sanum restituit Cristus vt ante fuit;
Nostra set ira caput aufert, quo vulnere nullum
Nouimus in sanum post reuenire statum.
Est igitur Petri maior sententia nostra,
Et gladius noster forcior ense suo.’
Sic differt Clemens nunc a clemente vocatus,
Errat et Acephalo nomine nomen habens.

**Hic loquitur de prelati illis, qui nomen sanctum
sibi presumunt, appropriant tamen sibi terrena, nec
aliis inde participando ex caritate subueniunt.**

Cap^m. xi. Angelus, vt legitur, sancto quandoque Iohanni
Dixit, cumque cadens alter adorat eum,
‘Tu michi, serue dei, videas ne feceris illud,
960 Immo deum toto cordis honore cole.’
‘Quem tamen in terris celestis ciuis honorem
Respuit, hunc repetit curia nostra sibi;
Flectitur inde genu, que pedes post oscula nostros
Mulcent, vt Cristi pes foret alter ibi.’
Precipit hoc Cristus, eius quod discipulorum
Nemo patris nomen querat habere sibi:
In celo sancti proclamant ‘Sanctus’ vt illi
Qui sedet in solio dignus honore suo.
‘Nos tamen in gente nomen portamus vtrumque,
970 “O pater, o sancte,” quisque salutat, “aue!”
Extitit a Cristo data nobis magna potestas,
Vndique quam mundus amplificare studet.
Hoc sit vt esse potest: celum quicumque ligabit,
Scimus nos mundum posse ligare satis:

Nam modo lex posita bellorum ponit auara
 Quod valet ecclesia vi reuocare sua.
 Set quicquid clerus rapit et tenet ex alienis,
 Hoc valet a clero tollere nullus homo.'
 Quicquid habet clerus proprios hoc vertit in vsus,
 980 De laicis partem vult set habere suam.
 Hic bona cuncta sua fore dicit sanctificata,
 Nec licet vt laicus mittat ad illa manus;
 Partem sed laici petit ipse per omnia lucri,
 Nec vult cum dampno participare suo.
 Si communis amor fuerit, commune sit omne,
 Quod liquet alterutrum posse iuuare virum:
 Set quia iam clerus non est communis amoris,
 Quicquid habet soli vult retinere sibi.
 Ex veteri lege raptum sit quicquid ab hoste, [392](#)
 990 Non valet illud homo sanctificare deo;
 Nostra set ecclesia clerus vicinia rapta
 Predat, et hec propria dicit habere sacra.
 Sic multat laicum clerus, multare set ipsum
 Nemo potest, et ita stant modo iura noua:
 Sic non pastor oues pascit, set pastus ab ipsis
 Lac vorat et vellus, alter vt ipse lupo:
 Sic libras siciens libros non appetit, immo
 Marcam pro Marco construit ipse libro:
 Summas non summa memoratur, et optima vina
 1000 Plusquam diuina computat esse sacra:
 Virtutis morem non, set mulieris amorem
 Querit, et hoc solo temptat arare solo.
 Sic honor ex onere non est, nam fulget honore
 Corpore, set corpus non digitabit onus.

**Hic loquitur de Simonia prelatorum, et qualiter
 hii delicati, dicentes se esse ecclesiam, aliis grauiora
 imponunt, et vltius de censura horribili laicos pro
 modico impetuose infestant.**

Cap^m. xii. Ecce, deo teste, vir qui non intrat ouile
 Per portam, latro furque notatur eo.
 Sic et in ecclesiam promotus per Simoniam
 Clerus, furtiuo se gerit inde modo;
 Nec bona de furto conferre placencia Cristo
 1010 Quis valet, immo deus pellit ab inde manus.
 Ergo valet fiscus que non vult carpere Cristus;
 Sunt quia mundana, mundus habebit ea:
 Namque suo iure dum clerus abutitur, inde
 Priuari dignum iura fatentur eum.
 Se vocat ecclesiam clerus, quasi diceret, illam
 Non tanget laicus, est honor immo suus:
 Sic fastus cleri communi iustificari
 Non vult iusticia, set latitante via.
 Se leuat et reliquos subdit predatque subactos
 1020 Legis composite de nouitate sue:
 Sic modo sub specie diuina cerno latere
 Has pompas mundi, stant neque iura dei.
 Sancta quid ecclesia est hominum nisi turma fidelis?
 Sic patet vt laicus, quem colit ipsa fides,
 Est pars ecclesie, melior nec clericus ipse,
 Ni melius viuat. Quis michi tale negat?
 Vna fides, vnum baptisma, deus manet vnus,
 Sic nos ecclesia iungit et vna tenet;
 Et veluti multa tegit vna cortice grana,
 1030 Sic populos plures colligit vna fides.
 Ecclesie sancte cur tunc sibi nomen habere
 Vult tantum clerus, alter vt ipse deus?
 Appendit legis pondus collis alienis,
 Set non vult humeris quid graue ferre suis
 Omnia dat licita sibimet, michi set prohibenda;
 Ille quiescit, ego sudo labore meo.
 Sic iter ex factis viciis prebet faciendis,
 Verba set econtra dicet in aure tua:
 Hinc plebs attonita dubitat, si credere dictis,
 1040 An cleri factis debeat ipsa prius.
 Set prohibens michi rem, dum sit culpandus eadem,

Vix credo verba, sunt quia facta rea:
Tollere sicque nouos de clero cerno superbos,
Per veteres humiles quod d e d i t ipsa fides.

Precipiunt isti maxillam percucienti
Subdere, sic vt eo stet pacienter homo:
Intuleris set eis si quid graue, mox tibi mortis
Censuris anime dant maledicta tue.
Qui necat hic animam sub pena mortis, eadem,
1050 Si posset, corpus perderet ipse prius.
Sic magis ipse lupo fert pastor dampna maligno
In iugulando suas, quas medicaret, oues.
Hii gestant celi claues, intrant nec et ipsi,
Nos nec inire sinunt, quos sine lege regunt:
Nec populi mentes doctrine vomere sulcant,
Nec faciunt operis id quod oportet opus.
Ad dextram Cristi vellent residere beati,
Set nollent calicem sumere, Criste, tuam.
Hii piscatores laxant sua recia lucris,
1060 Vt capiant mundum, non animabus opem.
Sic male viuentes laicis exempla ministrant,
Qui velut instructi more sequuntur eos:
Sic ouis ex maculis pastoris fit maculosa,
Et cadit in foueam cecus vterque simul.

**Hic loquitur qualiter prelatus non solum doctrina
set eciam bonis actibus populo sibi commissio lucere
deberet.**

Cap^m. xiii. In tenebris pergens nescit quo vadat, vt ille
Qui non discernit que sit habenda via;
Cumque caret populus doctrina, nec videt ipsum
Qui suus est presul iura tenere dei,
Cum neque scripta docet, neque facta facit pietatis,
1070 Immo sui vicii dedita culpa patet,
Cum de nocte sua pereat sine luce lucerna,
Et virtutis habent presulis acta nichil,

Tunc errare facit plebem, sine luceque cecus
 Cecum consequitur, vnde ruina venit.
 Ergo suas luces accendant clarius illi
 Qui sunt ductores, vt videamus iter.
 Igne lucerna micans tria dat, splendet, calet, vrit;
 Hec tria presul habet sub ratione trium:
 Vita splendorem demons t r a t , a m o r e calorem,
 1080 Et quia peccantes arguit, vrit eos.
 Cum populum sibi corde ligat, precibusque beatis
 Seruat et auget oues, tunc placet ipse deo.
 Vt sit sollicitus quicumque pauore tenetur,
 Ne lupus ille Sathan intret ouile suum:
 Pascat oues presul exemplaue sancta ministret,
 Vt sapiant dulces mellis in ore fauos.
 Sepius assueuit Tubicen prodesse, suosque
 Dux bene pugnantes concitat ore viros:
 Te magis, o presul, qui dux es spiritualis,
 1090 Promere lege dei consona verba decet.
 Solue tuam vocem sicut tuba ductilis altam,
 Osque tuum verbis instruat acta gregis:
 Clama, ne cesses, populo dic crimen eorum,
 Preuius exemplis tu tamen esto bonus.
 Dum sapor assidua remanens sit dulcis in vnda,
 Gracius ex ipso fonte bibuntur aque:
 Cum magis in Cristo sit cleri vita beata,
 Quem docet ille magis, sermo beatus erit.
 Sermo dei numquam vacuus redit, immo lucrata
 1100 Conferet emissus dupla talenta lucri:
 Sermo dei purus, mens quem sincera ministrat,
 Clastra poli penetrans dona reportat humo.
 Curatos anima tales que possidet egra,
 Inueniet, si vult, sana salutis iter.
 Qui nil terrenum sapiunt, set celica querunt,
 Et solum siciunt esuriuntque deum;
 Quos non librarum pascit nitor, immo librorum,
 Non facies auri, set cibatur ara dei;
 Hii, cum sint propria digni mercede laboris,

- 1110 Permansura serunt que sine fine metunt.
Sic qui recta docet, facit et super hoc quod oportet,
Expedit vt facias quod tibi dictat opus:
Tunc bene fortis equus reserato carcere currit,
Cum quos pretereat quosque sequetur habet.
Legis enim veteris scripture sunt memorande,
Quo bonus exemplum pastor habere queat.
Commemoranda satis fuit hec sapiencia, quando
Ante gregem virgas ordinat ille Iacob:
Partim nudat eas ablato cortice, partim
- 1120 Corticis indutas veste relinquit eas.
In virgis splendet sublato cortice candor,
Cum de scripturis splendida verba trahit;
Cortex saluatur, cum litera sola tenetur,
Et pastor sensu simplice pascit oues.³⁹³
Set quid pastores dicent exempla negantes?
Vt sibi proficiant ista nec illa tenent.
Cuius nec vita bona seu doctrina iuuabit,
Instruat vt populum, nil reputamus eum.
Indiscreta tamen sunt qui documenta parantes
- 1130 Scismatis in plebem magna pericla mouent.
Indocti causa doctoris sepe scolares
Virtutis capiunt commoda nulla scole:
Sic importuni prelati, quamuis habundent
Dogmata, si desint acta, vigore carent.
Quidam corripiunt magis ignibus impetuosius,
Et velut vrsus oues de feritate premunt;
Talis enim doctor, cum durius increpat vllum,
Ledit eum cuius debuit esse salus;
Vulnerat ipse reos, set vulnera nulla medetur;
- 1140 Prouocat in peius quod fuit ante malum:
Sic nos prelati nequit os curare superbi,
Cum viciosus homo moribus auctor erit.
Est et prelatus, qui corripiens quasi blando
De sermone fauet, nec reus inde cauet:
Corripiebat Hely pueros dulcedine patris,
Non vice pastoris, non grauitate soni;

- Pro quorum culpa dampnatur Hely, quia valde
Impius in pueris per pia verba fuit.
Sic pastor qui subiectos non corripit, iram³⁹⁴
- 1150 Summi patris emens carcere dignus erit.
Ista solent scribi, 'Medium tenuere beati,
Non nimis alta petas, nec nimis yma geras.'
Non nimis ex duro presul nos iure fatiget,
Nec nimis ex molli simplicitate sinat.
Si non leua manus equitis moderacior extet,
Oppositis frenis sepe repugnat equus.
Eripit interdum, modo dat medicina salutem,
Nil prodest quod non ledere possit idem.
Set qui frena tenet, prouiso tempore, presul,
- 1160 Quo magis est sanum ducet honestus iter:
Sepius ex dulci peccans sermone reuiuít,
Qui magis impaciens verba per acra foret.
Expedit interdum tamen absque fauore rebelles
Equa quod inuitos presulis ira premat:
Sepe ferus morbus herbis mitescit amaris,
Namque feret molles aspera spina rosas:
Dura vides quod humus stimulantibus obruta sulcis
Sepius ad placitum molle cacumen habet.
Vnctus erit presul oleo, quod plura figurat,
- 1170 Precipueque sibi conuenit illa sequi:
Quatuor ista facit, penetrat, lucet, cibát, vngit,
Que sibi mitratus debet habere bonus.
Nil penetrare potest nisi cum virtute vigoris,
Ista tamen virtus in penetrando iuuat;
Nam cum mollicies fuerit coniuncta vigori,
Mitis et austerus presulis actus erit.
Fermento careat, oleo spergatur, vt absit
Culpa nocens, et eum sanctus inungat amor:
Vox ita doctoris, quanto sublimius intus
- 1180 Corda ferit, tanto forcius illa mouet:
Sic olei virtus virtutes ponderat eque,
Forcia dum penetrat, micus acta regit.
Lux cecis, cibus est ieiunis, vnccio morbis;

Hiis iubar infundit, hos cibet, hosque fouet:
Lux est exemplo, cibus est dum pascit egenos,
Vnccio dum populis dulcia verba serit.
Hoc oleo, testante Daud, Cristus fuit vnctus,
Vngvine leticie cum pater vnxit eum:
Non vnguntur eo qui culpam Simonis equant,
1190 Qui vendunt vel emunt, nec sacra gratis habent:
Exulat hic de plebe dei qui peccat in istis,
Tales nam pellit Cristus ab ede sua.

**Hic loquitur qualiter signa Anticristi in Curia
Romana precipue ex auaricia secundum quosdam
apparuerunt.**

Cap^m. xiiii. Plura locutura mens deficit ipsa timore,
Labitur exanguis et tremefacta silet;
Huius enim vicii michi tangere si licet vlla,
Testis erit Cristus Romaque tota simul.
Roma manus rodit non dantes, spernit et odit,
Donum pro dono sic capit omnis homo.
Non est acceptor personarum deus, immo
1200 Gracior intendit actibus ipse viri;
Gracia set nostra tantum quos mundus in auro
Ditat, non alios accipit illa viros.
Qui precium ponit diues preciata reportat
Munera, nam tali curia tota fauet:
Assumens oleum secum non intrat ibidem,
Aurea ni valeat vngere gutta manum:
Copia nil morum confert vbi deficit aurum,
Nam virtus inopum nulla meretur opem.
Auro si pulses, intrabis, et illud habebis
1210 Quod petis, et donum fert tibi dona tuum:
Si tibi vis detur large, da munera larga,
Nam si pauca seras, premia pauca metes.
Quid faciet sapiens? stultus de munere gaudet.
Dicat ad hec clerus, qui sapit ista magis. [395](#)

Munera, crede michi, capiunt hominesque deosque,
 Placatur donis maior in orbe datis:
 Set cum pro mundo tribuat sua munera Simon,
 Promotus Cristi non erit inde sui.
 Vt veniant ad aquas sicientes sponte citauit
 1220 Cristus, et ecce suo fonte cibauit eos;
 Fontibus et nostris siciens non hauriet vllus
 Absque lucri pretio, quod dabit ipse prius.
 Vendere quid pro quo modus est quem curia nostra
 Seruat, et auxilio Simonis ipsa viget:
 Curia nostra virum nouit sine munere nullum,
 Set redit in vacuis euacuata manus.
 Dum dare vult laicus, precellit Theologiam;
 Si des dona michi, dona rependo tibi:
 Marcus, Matheus, Lucas, si nulla, Iohannes,
 1230 Dona ferant, perdunt que sibi dona petunt:
 Si veniat famulus mundi, viget ipse receptus,
 Si famulus Cristi, nemo ministrat ei.
 Si veniat pauper, musis comitatus Homeri,
 Et nichil attulerit, pauper vt ante redit:
 Si nouus Augustinus ibi peteret, nec haberet
 Quod daret ipse prius, transiet ipse vagus.
 Construit atque legit laicus, bene cantat, in auro;
 Si dare sufficiat, stat bene quicquid agit.
 Qualis enim pietas hec est discernite vosmet,
 1240 Aut si iusticia iura tenebit ita.
 Si labat ecclesia declinans forte per istos,
 Summus eam releuet de pietate sua,
 Confundens hereses et que sunt scismata tollat,
 Ne quis Cristicolas perdere possit oues:
 Vnanimis redeant tibi, te miserante, redemptor,
 Quos pax, quos pietas, quos liget vna fides.
 Anticristus aget que sunt contraria Cristo,
 Mores subuertens et viciosa fouens:
 Nescio si forte mundo iam venerat iste,
 1250 Eius enim video plurima signa modo.
 Petri que titubat nauem prius erige, Criste,

Quam pereat, nec eam fastus in orbe voret.

Hic loquitur secundum commune dictum, qualiter honores et non onera prelacie plures affectant, quo magis in ecclesia cessant virtutes, et vicia multipliciter accrescunt.

Cap^m. xv. O deus, omne patet tibi cor loquiturque voluntas,
Et secreta tuo lumine nulla latent:
Tu nosti, domine, quod quantum distat ab ortu
Solis in occasum regula prima fugit.
Ipsa fides operans, quam tu plantare volebas
Est quasi de clero preuaricata modo:
Ius quod erat Cristi mundus sine iure resoluit,
1260 Prelatosque novos vindicat ipse suos.
Nomen enim sancti sanctum non efficit, immo
Efficitur sanctus quem probat ipse deus.
Nos tamen a plebe si nomine glorificemur,
Et laudet mundus, laus placet illa satis:
Laruata facie sic fallitur ordo paternus, [396](#)
Quo furtiuus honor expoliauit onus.
Vox populi cum voce dei concordat, vt ipsa
In rebus dubiis sit metuenda magis:
Hec ego que dicam dictum commune docebat,
1270 Nec mea verba sibi quid nouitatis habent.
In cathedram Moysi nunc ascendunt Pharisei,
Et scribe scribunt dogma, nec illud agunt.
Nam constans, humilis, largus, castus que modestus,
Fit quibus ecclesiis regula culta prius,
Nunc vanos, cupidos, elatos, luxuriosos,
Raptoresque suo substituere loco.
Pacificos ira mitesque superbia vicit,
Nummus habet iustos et Venus illa sacros.
Sic non iusticia causas regit, immo voluntas
1280 Obfuscata malis que ratione carent:
Sic modo terra deos colit et laceratur ab ipsis,

Est dum lex cleri nescia lege dei.
 Nudis iam verbis vani tua iura figurant,
 Et nichil aut modicum pondere iuris agunt;
 Exemplis operum te raro, Criste, sequuntur,
 Perfectumque tue legis inane tenent.
 Que tua precepta ponunt, deponere curant
 A propriis humeris, que michi ferre iubent;
 Hec precepta tamen que gloria ponit inanis,
 1290 A me tollentes propria ferre volunt.
 De fundamento non curant, immo columpne
 Effigiem laruant, se quoque templa vocant.
 Nuper erat celum corruptum, sicque superbus
 Corruit ex altis, lapsus et yma tenet;
 Proque suo vicio sic Adam de paradiso,
 Sic Iudasque suum perdidit ipse gradum:
 Non faciunt hominem status aut locus esse beatum,
 Quin magis hos sternunt qui superesse volunt.
 O deus, ecclesiam fecisti quam tibi sanctam,
 1300 Sanctos prelatos fac simul inde tuos:
 Corrigat, oro, deus, tua iam clemencia tales,
 Nos quibus vt sanctis subdere colla iubes:
 Esse duces nostros quos lege tua statuisti,
 Fac magis vt recta semita ducat eos;
 Et licet instabilis vanus sit et actus eorum,
 Da populo stabilem semper habere fidem:
 Da, deus, et clero, verbo quod possit et actu
 Sic reuocare malum, nos vt in orbe iuuat.
 Exoptata diu dulcis medicina dolorum,
 1310 Sero licet veniat, grata venire solet:
 Sique boni fiant de clero, nos meliores
 Tunc erimus, que dei laus ita maior erit.

**Postquam dictum est de illis qui errant in statu
 prelatie, dicendum est de errore curatorum, qui sub
 prelatis constituti, parochiarum curas in animarum
 suarum periculo admittentes negligenter omittunt: et**

**primo intendit dicere de curatis illis qui suas curas
omittentes ad seruiendum magnatum curiis adherent.**

- Cap^m. xvi. Presulis incauti, sicut de voce recepi,
Errores scripsi, pennaque cessat ibi.
Sunt tamen, in curis anime qui iura ministrant,
Rectores alii non sine labe doli.
Quo status ille modo se tendit scribere tendo,
Si sit ibi mundus vel magis ipse deus.
Ad tempus presens rectorum facta reuoluens,
1320 Inuenio mundi quod solet esse dei.
Presulis errore, curarum qui caput extat,
Errat curatus, presulis ipse manus.
Iam sine prebenda de Simonis arte creata
Nil putat ecclesiam quomodocumque bonam:
Hec prebenda tamen inopem non, set meretricem
Pascit, sicque deum non colit, immo deam.
Tales nec caste curant neque viuere caute,
De quibus exempla sunt modo sepe mala:
Vestis habet pompam, cibus vsum deliciarum,
1330 Et thorus incestum clamat habere suum.
Ex Cristi poteris nuper cognoscere verbis
Discipulos tunicas non habuisse duas;
Set quia discipuli non sunt, in talibus isti
Nolunt impositum sic retinere modum.
Non tantum vestes geminant set condiciones,
Quas magis errantes regula nulla sapit:
En venit incastos aurum precingere lumbos,
Denotet vt vanos comptus inanis eos;
Militis effigie, nisi solum calcar abesse,
1340 Cernimus hos pompis degenerare suis.
Cuius honor, sit onus; qui lucris participare
Vult, sic de dampnis participaret eis:
Sic iubet equa fides, sic lex decreuit ad omnes,
Set modo qui curant ipsa statuta negant.
Curas admittunt pingues et pingua sumunt,
Set nolunt cure pondera ferre sue.

Si viciis residere nequit curatus in ista
 Cura, tunc aliam querit habere nouam;
 Inficiens primam, post polluit ipse secundam,
 1350 Sic loca non vicia mutat et ipse sua.
 Litera dispensat curato presulis empti,
 Et sic curati cura relictæ manet;
 Presbiterum laicum retinet sibi substituendum,
 Curia magnatum dum retinebit eum.
 Est ut apes ibi sollicitus dum spirat honores,
 Set piger in cura tardat agenda sua.
 Quicquid habet mundus fictum, tunc fingit et ille,
 Curia quo dignum credere possit eum:
 Verba dabit blanda, set nec canis aptus ad arcum,
 1360 Sic humili vultu flectit ad yma genu.
 Alter ut ille Iacob socios supplantat, et omne
 Quo poterit mundi lucra tenere facit.
 Absit eum quicquam tamen absque iuuamine docti
 Simonis incipere, qui suus actor erit:
 Ostia si clausa fuerint, sic intrat ouile,
 Ac aliunde suum carpit auarus iter.
 De curis anime nil curat, dummodo terre
 Curia magnatis sit sibi culta lucris:
 Fert sibi nil virtus anime set corporis actus,
 1370 Munus non meritum dat sibi ferre statum.
 Qui nichil est per se, nec habet quo tendat in altum,
 Expedit alterius ut releuetur ope:
 Est tamen absurdum, cum quilibet ex alieno
 Intumet ulterius quam tumuisse decet.³⁹⁷
 Littera dum Regis Papales supplicat aures,
 Simon et est medius, vngat ut ipse manus,³⁹⁸
 En l a i c u s noster fit clericus aptus ut omnes
 Simone consultus scandat in orbe gradus.
 Hic qui pauper heri fuerat quasi nudus et omni
 1380 Laude carens, nec eum patris habebat honor,
 Cuius erat tunica vilis, non larga set arta,
 Vix sibi que tetigit simplicitate genu,
 Hunc polimita modo vestis circumdat, et eius

Alludens pedibus fimbria lambit humum:
Vestis que medium non nouit poplicis olim,
Iam colit hec talos oscula dando pedi.
Si mundi speculum scruteris in huius amictu,
Plurima rectoris cernere vana potes.

- Presulis ipse gradum si non dum scandere possit,
1390 Ecce tamen vestes comparat ipse pares.
Cuius erat solus nuper catulus domicellus,
En sequitur totus nunc quasi mundus eum;
Cuius erat baculus nuper palfridus, ad eius
Sellam cum loris subditur altus equus.
Sic viget in curis diues, set moribus expers
Indiget, et vano more gubernat opes.
Compotus in mundi rebus quod fiat habunde
Perstudet, vt domino det sua iura suo:
Computet vt Cristo set de curis animarum,
1400 Turpiter absque lucro fossa talenta latent.
Curia sic Cristi tollit mundana clientem,
Qui venit ad laqueum, dum sitit ipse lucrum.

**Hic loquitur de rectoribus illis, qui ab episcopo
licenciati se fingunt ire scholas, vt sub nomine virtutis
vicia corporalia frequentent.**

- Cap^m. xvii. Alter adest rector, causam designat et ipse,
Dicit enim sacras quod cupit ire scholas:
Vt vagus astet ibi prece ruffi presul et albi
Annuit, vt dominis quos amat ipse nimis.
Sic rector sibi sub specie virtutis adoptat,
Vt queat in viciis rite studere vagus.
Nil decreta placent sibi nec sacra theologia,
1410 Ars sibi nature sufficit immo sue:
Ipsa magistra docet res plures, discit et ille,
Scribit et in nocte que studet ipse die.
Et propter formam tandem petit ipse cathedram,
Vt sit ad hoc ductus, plura dat ipse prius:

Sic est curatus doctoris sede locatus,
 Datque legenda suis mistica iura scolis.
 'Ve soli,' legimus ex scripturis Salomonis,
 Namque virum solum nemo requirit eum:
 Qua ratione scole mos est, quod quisque studere
 1420 Debet cum socia doctus in arte sua.
 Ipse deus sociam fecit per secula primam,
 Vt iuuet hec hominem, sicque creauit eam:
 Masculus in primo factus fuit, atque secundo
 Femina, sic vt in hiis det deus esse genus:
 Istaque principia discretus rector agenda
 Perstudet, et vota prebet in arte pia.
 Quis laterisque sui costam quam sentit abesse
 Non cuperet, per quam perficeretur homo?
 Prima viri costa mulier fuit ipsa creata,
 1430 Vult igitur costam rector habere suam.
 Nam deus humanam precepit crescere gentem,
 Cuius precepto multiplicabit homo:
 Sic sibi multiplicat rector, dum semen habundat,
 Vt sit mandati non reus ipse dei.
 Causas per tales rector probat et rationes,
 Quod sibi sint socie, dum stat in arte scole.
 Primo materiam conceptus tractat, et illam,
 Vt veniat partus, stat repetendo magis;
 Sic legit et textum, legit et glosam super illum,
 1440 Vt scola discipulis sit patefacta suis:
 Verberat ipse regens pro forma sepe scolares,
 Vt vigili virga sit vigil ipsa scola.
 Quanto formalis magis extat in arte legendo,
 Est opus in tanto materiale minus.
 Non labor excusat, doceat quin nocte dieque,
 Quo sibi dat vacuum sollicitudo caput:
 Questio namque sua, quam disputat esse profundam,
 Sentit et in casu plura profunda mouet.
 Responsalis ei respondet ad omnia, quare,
 1450 Nec sinit a logica quicquid abire sua;
 Sepeque doctori concluditur, ipseque tantum

Confusus cathedra linquit inesse sua.
Leccio lecta nocet, decies repetita nocebit;
Dum legit inde magis, plus sibi sensus hebes
est. ³⁹⁹

Et sic ars nostrum curatum reddit inertem,
De longo studio fert nichil ipse domum:
Stultus ibi venit, set stulcior inde redibit,
Dum repetendo scolis sit magis ipse frequens.

Hec est illa scola, studet in qua clerus, vt yma
1460 Nature iura scribat in arte sua:
Practica discipulo bene conuenit atque magistro,
Vt speculatiuum construat ipse suum.
Hec est illa scola super omnes labe colenda,
Qua socius sociam gaudeat habere suam:
Attamen illa scola, dum sit socie sociata,
Fine dabit socium plangere gesta reum.
Sic scola cum socia confirmat in arte scolarem,
Fiet quod laicus, quando magister erit.
Heu! grauis est socia, grauis est scola iuncta sodali,
1470 Ista vorat corpus, illaque tollit opes:
Est inhonesta deo res, et mirabile plebi,
Quando magister erit atque ribaldus idem.

Ecclesia sponsa nuda, vestitur amica;
Sponsa relicta perit, altera cara viget:
Sic desponsata clamare fide sibi fracta
Nunc venit ecclesia iura petendo sua.
Set quia lux periit, perit hinc ius, sicque recedit
Curati sponsa stans quasi tota vaga.
Sic rector viciis studium non moribus aptans,
1480 Dat decimam Veneri, que solet esse dei:
Sic sibi consimilem generat curatus, vt artem
Nature solitam compleat ipse suam:
Sic viget in studio laici curatus ad instar
Corporis, vt sexum multiplicare queat:
Sic scola, que morum mater magis esse solebat,
Efficitur viciis stulta nouerca suis.

**Hic loquitur de rectoribus illis, qui in curis
residentes, curas tamen negligentes, venacionibus
precipue et voluptatibus penitus intendunt.**

Cap^m. xviii. Tercius est rector, animum qui tendit ad orbem,
 In cura residens dum manet ipse domi:
 Nuda sue folia cure sine fructibus affert,
 1490 Dum sine luce regens stultus obumbrat eam.
 Predicat ipse nichil animas saluare, nec egros
 Visitat, aut inopes tactus amore iuuat:
 Est sibi crassus equus, restatque sciencia macra,
 Sella decora que mens feda perornat eum.
 Ad latus et cornu sufflans gerit, vnde redundant
 Mons, nemus, vnde lepus visa pericla fugit;
 Oris in ecclesia set vox sua muta quiescit,
 Ne fugat a viciis sordida corda gregis.⁴⁰⁰
 Sic canis, ad questum qui clamat in ore fideli,
 1500 Certus habebit eo quicquid habere velit;
 Set miser, ad portas qui clamat et indiget escis,
 Heu! neque mica datur nec liquor vllus ei.
 O deus, in quanta talis tibi laude meretur,
 Dans alimenta cani, que negat ipse viro!
 Vix sibi festa dies sacra vel ieiunia tollunt,
 Quin nemus in canibus circuit ipse suis:
 Clamor in ore canum, dum vociferantur in vnum,
 Est sibi campana, psallitur vnde deo.
 Stat sibi missa brevis, deuocio longaue campis,
 1510 Quo sibi cantores deputat esse canes:
 Sic lepus et vulpis sunt quos magis ipse requirit;
 Dum sonat ore deum, stat sibi mente lepus.
 Sic agitat vulpis vulpem similis similemque
 Querit, dum iuuenem deuorat ipse gregem;
 Nam vagus explorat vbi sunt pulchre mulieres
 Etatis tenere, pascat vt inde famem:
 Talis enim rector mulieribus insidiatur,
 More lupi clausas circuientis oues.⁴⁰¹
 Dum videt ipse senem sponsum sponsam iuuenemque,
 1520 Tales sub cura visitat ipse sua;
 Suplet ibi rector regimen sponsi, que decore
 Persoluit sponse debita iura sue.

Sic capit in cura rector sibi corpora pulcra,
Et fedas animas linquit abire vagas.

**Hic loquitur de rectoribus in curis residentibus,
qui tamen curas animarum omittentes, quasi seculi
mercatores singula temporalia de die in diem ementes
et vendentes, mundi diuicias adquirunt.**

- Cap^m. xix. Quartus adhuc rector curam residendo sinistrat,
Ipseque mercator circuit omne genus.
Est sibi missa: forum meditatur et inde tabernam,
Ad socii dampnum dum petit ipse lucrum.
Ecclesie meritum perdit, lucratur et aurum;
1530 Vt teneat mundum, deserit ipse deum.
Computat ipse diem cassam, qua vel sibi lucrum,
Corporis aut luxum non capit ipse nouum:
Est et auaricia sibi custos, sic vt in illis⁴⁰²
Partem diuiciis pauper habere nequit.
Masculus in nullo casu partitur egenus,
Dupplce nam clauis cista resistit ei;
Set pietas aliter se continet ad mulierem,
Vt iubet ipsa Venus, est ibi larga manus.
Expansis genibus expanditur aurea cista;
1540 Femina si veniat, dat sibi clauis iter:
Durior est ferro, quem nullus mollificabit,⁴⁰³
Vincit feminea set caro mollis eum.
Dans ita quid pro quo merces mercede locabit
Rector, in impropriis dum vacat ipse lucris.
Omne quod vna manus sibi congregat, altera spergit,
Dum sua dat cribro balsama stultus homo:
Stultaque sic stultum predat, quod fine dierum
Nil nisi sit rasa barba manebit ei.
O si curatis nati succedere possent,
1550 Ecclesie titulo ferreque iura patrum,
Tunc sibi Romipetas, mortis quibus est aliene
Spes, nichil aut modicum posse valere puto.⁴⁰⁴

Talis in ecclesia nunc est deuocio mota
Curatis nostris: iudicet inde deus.

**Postquam⁴⁰⁵ dictum est de errore illorum qui in
ecclesia beneficiati existunt, iam⁴⁰⁶ dicendum est de
presbiteris stipendiariis; de talibus saltem, qui non
propter mundiciam et ordinis honestatem, set
propter mundi ocia, gradum presbiteratus appetunt
et assumunt.**

Cap^m. xx. Si de presbiteris dicam qui sunt sine curis,
Hos viciis aliis cernimus esse pares.
Si tamen ecclesiam non optinet iste sacerdos,
Annua servicia sunt velut ecclesia:
Plus quam tres dudum nunc exigit vnus habendum,
1560 Strictus auaricia plus cupit ipse quia.
Hos velut artifices cerno peditare per vrbes,
Conductos precio sicut asella foro.
Dignus mercede tamen est operarius omnis,
Iuxta condignum quod labor ille petit:
Set tamen vt vendat nulli diuina licebit,
Sic poterit vendi missa nec vlla tibi.
Credimus vt sancta Cristus sacratus in ara
Non plus vult vendi venditus ipse semel.
Se sine dat precio, dare qui iussit sacra gratis:
1570 Presbiter, ergo tibi quid petis inde lucri?
Cum tibi vestitus, aptus fuerit quoque victus,
Vnde deo viuas, cur tibi plura petis?
Si tibi plus superest de lucro, nil tibi prodest,
Nam male quesitum nescit habere modum.
Aut Romam perges mercatum Simonis auro,
Qui te promotum reddet, et inde tuum
Argentum tollet collectum per prius, et sic
Quod tibi missa dedit Simon habere petit;
Aut meretrix bursam, te luxuriante, repletam
1580 Sugget, et in vacuam quam cito reddet eam.

Quod dedit ecclesia tollit meretrix que taberna:
 Hec tria dum iungunt, turpia plura gerunt.
 Hec ita cum videam, mundi noua monstra putarem,
 Si foret hoc raro quod speculamur eo;
 Set quia cotidie potero predicta videre,
 Sepe michi visa nil modo miror ea.
 Mergulus inmergit fluuio sua membra frequenter,
 Et longas gignit in latitando moras;
 Isteque signat eos quos carnis fluxa voluptas
 1590 Funditus exercet et retinendo premit.
 Est apud antiquos 'hic et hec' dixisse 'sacerdos,'
 Dicere sic et nos possumus 'has et eos:'
 Hii modo namque sua mundum replent genitura;
 Si pietas sit ibi, sunt modo valde pii.
 Nox et amor, vinum, nullum moderabile suadent,
 Que tria presbiteris sunt modo nota satis.
 Stat brevis ordo precum, dum postulat ipse vicissim
 Oscula per longas iungere pressa moras,
 'O sacer,' hec dicens, 'quam longum tempus ad illud
 1600 Vt tua sint collo brachia nexa meo?'
 Qui vult vxorem seruare sibi modo castam,
 Et mundas cameras querit habere suas,
 Longius a camera sit presbiter atque columba,
 Stercora fundit ea, fundit et ipse stupra.
 Sobrius a mensa, de lecto siue pudicus
 Consurgit raro presbiter ipse deo:
 Cantat in excelsis sua vox agitata tabernis,
 Est set in ecclesiis vox taciturna nimis:
 Doctus et a vino colit ipse lupanar, et illuc
 1610 Exorando diu flectit vtrumque genu.
 Sic vetus expurgat fermentum, dum noua spergit,
 Non tamen vt Paulus iusserat ipse prius:
 Sic altare Baal modothurificare sacerdos
 Vult, per quem viui feda fit ara dei.
 Sufficit vna michi mulier, bis sex tamen ipsi,
 Vt iuueni gallo, cerno subire modo.
 Sic sacra presbiteri celebrant solempnia Bachi,[407](#)

Ebrietasque magis sanctificatur eis.
Gentilis ritus vetus incipit esse modernus,
1620 Talibus et Cristi lex perit ipsa quasi:
Sic modo templorum cultores suntque deorum,
Plus in honore quibus stat dea summa Venus.

**Hic loquitur de consueta presbiterorum voluptate,
et qualiter hii stipendia plebis ex conuencione
sumentes, indeuote pro mortuis orando non se debite
ad suffragia mortuorum exonerant.**

Cap^m. xxi. Ignis edax terram vorat et nascencia terre;
Quo furit illius impetus, omne terit;
Sic et in incastis exemplis presbiterorum
Indoctis laicis feda libido nocet.
Nil commune gerunt luxus sibi cum ratione,
Corporeos sensus quinque libido cremat:
Quos talis maculat nota talis pena sequetur,
1630 Illorum pene sulphur et ignis erunt.
Consuetudo tamen solet attenuare pudorem,
Reddit et audacem quem mora longa trahit.
Non peccare putant quod sepius oscula iungant,
Oscula nam pacis signa parare solent;
Estque parare piam pacem meritoria causa,
Nec sine pace diu stat pietatis amor:
Sic in presbiteris amor est de pace creatus,
Oscula nam solito more frequenter agunt.
Altera natura solitus reputabitur vsus,
1640 Vsus et a longo tempore iura parit;
Immoque nature si nos de iure loquamur,
Hoc in presbiteris splendet vbique magis: [408](#)
Et si sub forma tali sint iura creanda,
Legis quod vires longior vsus habet,
Tunc puto presbiteros ex vsu condere leges,
Oscula dum crebro dant in amore suo.
E c c l e s i e gremium notat ordo presbiterorum,

Quo debent animas rite fouere bonas;
 Quomodo set proprias qui non curant, alienas
 1650 Curabunt? non est hoc rationis opus.
 Nescio quid meriti poterunt tales michi ferre,
 Qui sibi nil proprie commoditatis habent:
 Nam peccatores scitur quod non deus audit,
 Est inhonesta deo laus set ab ore mali:
 Indeuota deo qui verba precancia confert,
 Iudicii proprii dampna futura petit.
 Qui dampnum causat, hic dampna dedisse videtur,
 Ledit qui patitur que reuocare potest:
 Infligit mortem languenti, qui valet illam
 1660 Nec vult auferre, set sinit esse malum:
 Presul qui laicos, cum non sint ordine digni,
 Ordinat ad sacra, scandala plura mouet.
 Tales si quis emit lucro, frustrabitur inde,
 Aut si perdet in hiis scit magis ipse deus.
 Hoc scio, quod panem qui fregerit esurienti,
 Cuius debilitas est sine fraude patens,
 Qui nudos operit, infirmos visitat, illi
 Debentur merita pro bonitate sua:
 Set qui sunt fortes, vanaque sub ordinis vmbra
 1670 Conspirant requiem quam sibi mundus habet,
 Errat eos presul sacrans, et quosque locando
 Tales de merito perdere dona puto.

**Hic tractat causam, quare accidit quod laici, quasi
 iuris amici, luxurie presbiterorum consuetudinem
 abhorrentes, eam multociens castigantes grauit
 affligunt.**

Cap^m. xxii. Hoc dicit clerus, quod, quamuis crimine plenus
 Sit, non est laici ponere crimen ei;
 Alter et alterius cleri peccata fauore
 Excusat, quod in hiis stat sine lege reus.
 Non accusari vult a laicis, tamen illos

Accusat, que sibi libera frena petit.
 Libera sunt ideo peccata placencia clero,
 1680 Sit nisi quod laici iura ferantur ibi.
 Presbiter insipiens populum facit insipientem,
 Et mala multa parit qui bona pauca sapit:
 Clerus lege carens populum dat lege carentem,
 Sic parat et causam presbiter ipse suam:
 Nam quia lege caret laicus, sine lege *m a n e n t e m*
 Ignorat clerum, quem videt esse reum.
 Si foret et sapiens clerus, sapientia plebis
 Staret, vt in lege perstet vterque simul;
 Set quia iam fatui patet insipientia cleri,
 1690 Despicitur vita desipientis ita.
 Pluribus exemplis natura iuuat rationem,
 Docius vnde suum iudiciale regat.
 Hinc est quod latitans bubo lucis iubar odit,
 Escam vestigat nocte, veretur aues:
 In quam forte greges auium si lumina figant, [409](#)
 Conclamando volant et laniando secant.
 Presbiteros notat iste reos, qui corpore fed
 Que sunt luxurie feda latenter agunt;
 Hos laici quasi lucis aues restringere querunt,
 1700 Zelo succensi legis, amore dei.
 Preuaricatus enim Iudas non amplius inde
 Seruorum Cristi dignus honore fuit.
 Dum iuga luxurie supportat presbiter, ipsum
 Si pungant laici, computet *i n d e s i b i*.
 Iusto iudicio lex vult, quod iuris abusor
 Amittat vicio quod sibi iura dabant.
 Ecclesie fratres in Cristo nos sumus omnes,
 Semper et alterius indiget alter ope:
 Lex tamen hoc dicit, frater quod si tuus erret,
 1710 Corripe, sic et eum fac reuenire deo:
 Si te non audit, dic ecclesie, set et illam
 Si non audire vult, nec adheret ei,
 Amplius ille tibi velut Ethnicus est reputandus,
 Quo sibi de culpa parcere nullus habet.

Presbiter ergo suis assistens cotidianis
Peccatis nullo debet honore frui:
Non erit exemptus, nam qui neque iura veretur,
Non est iusticie quod quis honoret eum:
Qui contra legem vetitis presumpserit vti,
1720 Debet concessis lege carere bonis.
Omne quod occultum latet, vltiore patebit
Fine, nec excusat ordo vel ille status.
Dic, sibi quid valuit tunc excusacio ficta,
Dum foliis fici se male textit Adam?
Quid valet aut, culpam carnis si presbiter vmbra
Contegat ipse sui fultus honore status?

**Hic scribit contra hoc quod aliqui presbiteri
dicunt, qualiter ipsi in carnis luxuriam committendo
non grauius hominibus laicis deum offendunt.**

Cap^m xxiii. Dicunt presbiteri, non te peccant magis ipsi,
Dum carnis vicio fit sua victa caro:
Sicut sunt alii fragili de carne creati,
1730 Dicit quod membra sic habet ipse sua.
'Sum velut alter homo,' dicit 'cur tunc mulieres,
Sicut habent alii, non retinebo michi?'
Argumenta sui sic criminis ipse refingit,
Liber et est vicio, dicit, vt alter homo.
Hec tamen, vt credo, fingit contraria vero,
Nam magis est sanctus omnibus ille status.
Ex improviso sumi reliquis valet ordo,
Quo minor est culpa, si cadat inde rea;
Assumi subito set presbiteri sacer ordo
1740 Non valet, immo suas spectat habere vices.
Nam per quinque gradus scandit prius, estque probatus,
Quolibet vnde suum preuidet ipse statum:
Omnis et inde gradus a presule sanctificatus
Est et non alio, sanccior vt sit eo.
Per caput atque manus est crismate presbiter vinctus,

Vt sit ob hoc aliis dignus in orbe magis;
 Accipiensque iugum votum vouet ammodo castum,[410](#)
 Quo faciat munda mundior acta sua:
 Et quia preuisa sic vota facit, puto culpa,
 1750 Dum facit econtra, fert grauiora mala:
 Qui daret exemplum virtutis et est viciosus,
 Errat plus ducto ductor in ore meo.
 Hiis circumspectis michi sic per singula causis,
 Estimo presbiteros te magis esse reos.
 Se licet excuset fingens sibi verba sacerdos,
 Nulla sue mentis interiora iuuat;
 Inmemor immo sacri quem ceperat ordinis, vltro
 Scandala sic facti querit in orbe sui.
 Non puto presbitero sutorem quod status vnit,
 1760 Culpa nec in simili lance coequat eos:[411](#)
 Presbiter et laicus non sunt Bercarius vnum,
 Nec scelus in simili condicione grauat.
 Castum se vouit sibi cum fuit vncta corona,
 Stringitur et voto quisq u e fidelis homo.
 Non foret hic tanti mercede locatus honoris,
 Sit nisi quod maius inde subiret onus:
 Nam nequit hoc facere rex est qui maior in orbe,
 Quod minor in Cristo presbiter ipse potest:
 Sic, quia de iure reliquis prefertur honore,
 1770 Ledit eum grauius crimine iuris onus.
 Heu! quod iniqua manus mulierum feda pudendis
 Debet in altari tangere sacra dei!
 Qui corpus domini tractabit, et est meretrici
 Turpiter attractus, Cristus abhorret opus.
 Qui fierent Cristi serui, sunt dumque ministri
 Demonis, heu! nostram quis reparabit opem?

**Hic describit qualiter omnia et singula que
 sacerdocii concernunt officium magne virtutis
 misteria designant: et primo dicet de vestibis
 sacerdotalibus ex vtraque lege competenter dispositis.**

Cap^m. xxiiii. O bene si penset que sunt sibi iura sacerdos,
 Quid sit honor, quid onus, quid vel honoris opus,
 Singula qui iuste sibi ponderat, instat et eque,
 1780 Res est mira nimis, si male gestet onus.
 Omne quod ille status sibi vendicat esse beatum
 Cernitur, vt sancti sint magis inde viri.
 Non est tam modicum quod misse spectat ad vsum,
 Lege sacerdotum quin decet esse sacrum.
 Ornatus varii, quibus vtitur ipse sacerdos,
 Virtutis varie mistica signa gerunt.
 Poderis est vestis, aliter que dicitur alba,
 Presbiteri corpus que tegit vsque pedes:
 Vt foris est albus, fieret sic albior intus
 1790 Presbiter, vt mores gestet in orbe bonos.
 Cinctus ephot Samuel domini studet esse minister,
 Cui paruam tunicam texuit Anna parens:
 In tunica tenui fidei doctrina notatur,
 Qua tenues animos gracia mater alit:
 Ex lino factum per ephot signatur honestas
 Carnis, quam mundam presbiter ipse geret.
 Balteus est eciam, tunicam qui stringit honeste,
 Ne femur in luxu facta pudenda sciat:
 Fert humerale decens, vt nostras presbiter egras
 1800 Confortans animas ad meliora ferat:
 Et ligat in summo sapiens capitale sacerdos,
 Vt capitis sensus non sinat ire vagos.
 Infula vestit eum circumdata, que nitet auro,
 Quod virtute sua cuncta metalla regit;
 Splendet et in simili forma virtute sacerdos,
 Si bene conseruet ordinis ipse statum:
 Aurum veste gerit sanctus, cum splendet in illo
 Pre reliquis rutilans clara sophia dei.
 Ne tunice leuiter possit ruptura minari,
 1810 Nobilis in giro texilis ora micat:
 Se nec et ipse bonus disrumpat in orbe sacerdos,
 Ne pateat rima criminis vlla sui.
 Hac se mundicia precinctus presbiter ornat,

Vt totus mundus munera munda sacret.

Aron et electis vestes texuntur, vt horum⁴¹²

Quisque sacerdotis possit honore frui:

Sic modo presbiteri, seu summi siue minores,

Efficiunt Cristi corpus idemque sacrant.

Nam nos cum vinum panemque sacramus in ara,

1820 Hoc verus sanguis vna fit atque caro:

Qui Cristi carnem matris confecit in aluo,

Corpus in altari conficit ille sacrum.

Quadra fit altaris species, vt quatuor orbis

Partibus ecclesie sit solidata fides.

Vestibus ornatus qui sic et moribus extat

Dignus, non aliter, presbiterandus erit.

Quos tante vestes, quos gloria tanta perornat,

Sint magis vt sancti causa requirit eos:

Dedecus ecclesie presul qui talia prestat

1830 Presbiteris laicis, iure negante, parit.

Quos sinus ecclesie recipit, noscat sinus aptos

Esse deo, reliquos euomat ipsa foris.

**Hic loquitur qualiter sacrificia de veteri lege
altari debita fuerunt in figura ad exemplum nunc
noue legis presbiterorum: dicit vlterius qualiter ex
vtraque lege sacrificantes altari debent esse sine
macula.**

Cap^m. xxv. Lex vetus instituit animalia, de quibus olim

Immolat altari plebs holocausta deo;

Semper et ex omni mactato sic animali

Debita presbitero porcio certa fuit.

Hoc tamen ad Cristi legem latitante figura

Presbiteris nostris mistica iura notat.

Illa sacerdoti que spectat pars holocausti,

1840 Curatis nostris est memoranda satis:

Heeque sacerdotis sunt partes, pectus et armus

Diuisus dexter, lege iubente sacra.

Pectus doctrine locus est, nam quisque sacerdos
 Debet subiectos recta docere suos:
 Forcior est armus dexter, signatque quod eius
 Actus sit fortis, nulla sinistra gerens:
 Armus diuisus docet vt viuendo sacerdos
 Excedat populum, nil populare gerens.
 Non est tam modicum quid in ordine presbiterorum,
 1850 Grande ministerii quin sibi pondus habet;
 Nam lex iuncta vetus cum lege noua manifestant
 Vndique presbiteros quod decet esse sacros.
 Petrus in Aurora que scribam scripsit, et ille
 Testis in hac causa verus et auctor erit.
 Lex vetus ista iubet, noua que confirmat, vt omnis
 Sacrificans aris immaculatus erit;
 Absque sui macula sit corporis actus et eius,
 Displicet vnde deo, feda nec vlla gerat:
 Non habeat maculam, nec sit mixtura reatus,
 1860 Ne purum maculet accio praua bonum.
 Que tamen hee macule dicuntur in ordine dicam,
 Presbiter vt lector sit magis inde memor.
 Dicitur hic cecus, qui mundi puluere plenus⁴¹³
 Ad lumen vite carpere nescit iter:
 Est lippus, cuius mens ingenio micat intus,
 Set carnale tamen eius opacat opus:
 Albugo cecat oculos, et denotat illum
 Qui tumet, ascribens candida facta sibi:
 Est paruo naso qui nec discernere parua
 1870 Sufficit, et quod agit perficit absque sale:
 Est nimio naso, qui non intelligit illud
 Quod legit, et doctum se tamen ipse facit:
 Est torto naso, qui dulce fatetur amarum,
 Et sanctos actus iudicat esse malos:
 Est claudus, qui nouit iter, set currere tardus
 Heret in hoc mundo, carne ligante pedem:
 Fractus pes et fracta manus reputatur in illo,
 Qui claudus peior tardat ad omne bonum:
 Hic est gibbosus, quem mundi sarcina curuat,

- 1880 Lumina nec cordis summa videre sinit:
Corporis in scabie succensa libido notatur,
Que corrupta suo crimine plura facit.
Predictis viciis si quis se senciatur egrum,
Lex iubet ut panem non sacret ille deo.
Oza manus tendens accessit ut erigat archam,
Set nimis audacem mors fuit ultima manum:
Hinc ideo dicunt meruisse necem, quia nocte
Transacta cohitu coniugis usus erat.
Declaratur in hoc, quod qui pollutus ad aram
- 1890 Accedat, mortis vulnere dignus erit:⁴¹⁴
Experimenta docent, quod ab hoc detergere sordes
Feda manus nescit, dum tenet illa lutum.
Presbiter est dictus prebens aliis iter, et si
Erret, tunc errant ducere quosque putat.
Dans sacra siue docens, notat ista loquela, sacerdos
Si malus est, alii sunt magis inde mali.
Non sine stat cura quicumque professus in huius
Ordinis est opere, si bene seruet opus:
Ergo prius videas qui scandere vis, et in illum
- 1900 Si scandas, facias que iubet ordo tuus:
Non solum faciem, mores set confer et artes,
Proficias curis ex quibus ipse tuis.

**Hic loquitur quod etas sufficiens, priusquam
gradum sacerdotii sibi assumat, in homine
requiritur: loquitur etiam de suorum rasura
pilorum, et dicit quod talia in signum mundicie et
sanctitatis specialiter presbiteris conueniunt: dicit
ulterius quod presbiteri a bonis non debent esse
operibus ociosi.**⁴¹⁵

Cap^m. xxvi. Quam prius assumat, matura requiritur etas,
Presbiter officium, plenus ut ipse regat:
Nam flos etatis temptanti congruit hosti;
Carnis et etatis feruet uterque calor:

Iam quos vexat ad huc tenere lasciuia carnis⁴¹⁶
 Improba, pastores non decet esse gregis.
 Vt regnare deo possint, sibi rasa corona
 1910 Restat, et vt facta nobiliora gerant.
 Radices non extirpat rasura pilorum,
 Set rasi crescunt multiplicando magis:
 Sic licet expellas omnes de pectore motus,
 Non tamen hec penitus cuncta fugare potes:
 Non ita rasmus eris, quin semper habet caro pugnam;⁴¹⁷
 Intus habes cum quo prelia semper agas.
 Si quando mundum fugias, a puluere mundi
 Perfecte purus non potes esse tamen:
 Nam, licet eniteas summis virtutibus, omnes
 1920 Ex animo culpas non resecare vales.
 Fit tamen ex minimis hec quam retines tibi culpa,
 Ne tua mens tumeat, dum bona multa geris:⁴¹⁸
 Ex tali culpa tibi soluitur ergo tributum,
 Vt tua mens paueat labe remorsa breui.
 Sepe cadit iustus, fragilis quia vir manet omnis,
 Ne nimis exaltet gloria vana virum:
 Qui leuiter cecidit, vt surgat forcius, ille
 Casum felicem suscipit ante deum.
 Lux estis mundi, set non penitus sine fumo,
 1930 Nam sine peccato viuere nullus habet:
 Sepe boni fructus post temptamenta sequuntur,
 Mercedemque suam prelia carnis habent.
 Vtile nempe foret seuas extinguere flammam,
 Et sanum vicii pectus habere tuum:
 Ne videant oculi per quod temptentur, et aures
 Obtura, vicii ne sonus intret ibi.
 Tucius est aptumque magis discedere pace,
 Ponere quam bellum, vincere quale nequis:
 Integer est melior nitidus gladiator in armis,
 1940 Quam cum tela suo sanguine tincta madent:
 Inque dei missis nitidus sine labe sacerdos
 Victor in hoc placidum fert sibi lucra deum.
 Quale sit hoc quod amas celeri circumspice mente,

Et tua lesuro subtrahe colla iugo:
 Debet homo sapiens nascentes pellere morbos,
 Inueniet tardam ne sibi lentus opem:
 Opprime, dum noua sunt, subiti mala semina morbi,
 Et tuus incipiens ire resistat equus;
 Nam mora dat vires, teneras mora conficit vuas,
 1950 Et validas segetes quod fuit herba facit.
 Si Venus agreditur, tibi sit magis aspera vita,
 Flamma recens modica sepe retardat aqua.
 Vt corpus redimas, ferrum pacieris et ignem,
 Quantum fert anime plus medicina tue.
 Ocia si tollas, periere Cupidinis arcus,
 Extincteque iacent et sine luce faces.
 Vt non delinquas, debes imponere culpe
 Frena, vagos gressus, ocia queque fugans.
 Presbiteros opere de re sibi que sit honesta,
 1960 Aut se de precibus sollicitare decet:
 Fecit enim sportas, vt frangeret ocia, Paulus,
 Namque vagans aliquo noluit esse modo.
 Ex requie cerpit pestis seuissima luxus,⁴¹⁹
 Armiger et fame prodigus hostis honor:
 Ex requie sequitur infortunata voluptas,
 Pauperies anime, criminis omne nephas.
 Luxuriant animi varia sub ymagine moti,
 Saltem virtutis dum caro nescit opus:
 Vtile nempe dabit deus omne viris operosis,
 1970 Debet mercedis pondera ferre labor.
 Sollicitudo decet animam discreta, labores
 Dum subit, vt vicia carne domare queat:
 Sollicitudo iuuat corpus, perquirat vt illa
 Victum, quo licitis viuat in orbe modis:
 Ocia dumque caro petit et torpet labor exul,
 In scelus ex solito more paratur iter.
 Demon femineos et molles diligit actus,
 Quando viri virtus omne virile negat;
 Ocia quippe nocent in talibus absque labore,
 1980 Quorum Cristicolis non valet esse salus.

Culpa quidem longe facit esse deo, prope virtus;
Displicet ista deo, placat et illa deum.

**Hic loquitur de presbiterorum dignitate spirituali,
et qualiter hii, si bene agant sua officia, plus aliis
proficiunt: sinautem, de suis malis exemplis
delinquendi magis ministrant occasiones.**

Cap^m. xxvii. Presbiteri fit magnus honor maiorque potestas,
Si procul a viciis sit pius atque bonus.
Hii sacramenti manibus misteria summi
Tractant, quo verbo fit caro iuncta deo:
Hiique scelus lauacro baptismi tollere sancto
Possunt, quo primus corrui ipse parens:
Hii quoque lege noua celebrant sponsalia nostra,
1990 Et si iura petunt cassaque nulla ferunt:
Hii quoque confessis veniam prestant residuiis, [420](#)
Errantique viro dant remeare deo:
Hii quoque celestem nobis dant sumere panem,
Post et in extremis vnccio spectat eis:
Hii quoque defunctis debent conferre sepultis,
Inque sua missa reddere vota pia.
Hii sunt sal terre, quo nos condimur in orbe,
Absque sapore suo vix salietur homo.
In sale, quod misit in aquas, Heliseus easdem [421](#)
2000 Sanat, nec remanet gustus amarus eis:
In sale signatur prudens discrecio iusti,
Vt discretus homo condat inde suos.
Hii sunt lux mundi, quapropter si tenebrosi
Sint, tunc nos ceci stamus in orbe vagi.
Dans offendiculum ceco quo leditur vllum
Vt deus instituit, hic maledictus erit:
Ceco preponit obstacula, qui maledicta
Peccandi prebet per sua facta viam.
Hii sunt scala Iacob tangens celestia summa, [422](#)
2010 Plena satis gradibus, vnde patebit iter:

Hii sunt mons sanctus, per quos conscendere debet
 Virtutum culmen quisque fidelis homo:
 Hii sunt consilium nostrum, via recta superne,
 Legis doctores, et noua nostra salus:
 Hii claudunt celum populo, reserant et apertum,
 Possunt hiique boni subdere cuncta sibi.
 ‘Crescite,’ dicitur hiis, ‘et multum reddite fructum’;
 Pertinet ad mores ista loquela bonos:
 Dicitur hiis, ‘Terram replete’; nota tibi dictum:
 2020 Plenus in ecclesia fructibus esto bonis.
 Ante deum vacuus nemo veniet, quia nullus
 Expers virtutis debet adesse deo.
 Sic placare deo iustosque reosque sacerdos
 Debet, et ad celos fundere thura precum:
 Oret ne iustus a iusticia cadat, oret
 Vt prauus surgat et mala prima fleat.
 O quam res vilis, dum presbiter est vt asellus,
 Moribus indoctus, et sine lege rudis!
 In numero sunt presbiteri celi quasi stelle,
 2030 Vix tamen ex mille si duo luce micant:
 Scripta legunt nec scripta sciunt, tonsi tamen ipsi
 A vulgo distant, quod satis esse putant.
 Sunt tales; et sunt alii quos ardua virtus
 Ornat in ecclesia, qui bona multa ferunt.
 Emitterit coruum Noe, non redit ille; columbam
 Emitterit, reditum missa columba facit:
 Sic et in ecclesia sunt corui suntque columbe,
 Sunt cum felle mali, sunt sine felle boni.
 Cras primam cantant, cum se conuertere tardant,
 2040 Set tollit tales sepe suprema dies:
 Tales sunt pigri, quos mundi vincula nectunt,
 Nec promissa dei regna sitire volunt.
 Ordinis ipse sui qui seruat iura sacerdos,
 Rebus et exemplis dogmata sancta docens,
 Non honor est tantus, quo non sit in ordine dignus,
 Laus sibi nec populi sufficit, immo dei:
 In clero fateor, quos approbat ardua virtus,

Illorum merito gracia maior erit.

**Postquam dixit de errore illorum qui inter
seculares sacerdocii ministerium sibi assumpserunt,
intendit dicere secundum tempus nunc de errore
scolarium, qui ecclesie plantule dicuntur.**

Cap^m. Nomine sub cleri cognouimus esse scolares,
xxviii. Ecclesie plantas quos vocat ipse deus.

- 2050 Orti diuini bonus extat planta scholaris,
Ecclesie fructus que facit esse bonos.
Qui studet in morum causis et non viciorum,
Qui sibi nec mundum computat, immo deum,
Clericus ipse dei super hoc reputatur, et eius
Principium fine clauditur inde bono.
Summi doctoris virtutum regula iusta
Discipulos dociles de ratione fouet:
Qui studiis herent, cor ad alta leuant et in altis
- 2060 Figunt, hii vera sunt holocausta deo.
Nunc tamen inter eos puto multos esse vocatos,
Electos paucos condicione probos:
Moribus hii dudum studii virtute vacabant,
Nunc viciis studia dant vigilare sua.
Vix pro materia si nunc studet vnus habenda,
Solum set forme sufficit vmbra sue.
Clericus ire scholas animo paciente solebat,
Gloria nunc mundi statque magistra sibi,
Discurrensque vagus potator et accidiosus,
- 2070 Deditus et veneri, circuit hic et ibi.
Ex planta sterili non fiet fertilis arbor,
Nec faciet fructus arbor iniqua bonos:
Sepe senecta tenet, tenuit quodcumque iuuentus;
Si malus est iuuenis, vix bonus ipse vetus.
Est bona que radix bonitatis germina profert,
De radice mala germinat omne malum.
Quisque suos igitur pueros castiget, vt illa

Virgula non licite mentis agenda fugat:
Qui virtutis habet iuuenis cum flore magistrum,
2080 Discat et ipse pie que probitatis erunt,
Proficiet talis; set quem doctor viciosus
Instruit, hic raro fructificabit homo.

**Hic querit causam que scolarium animos ad
ordinem presbiteratus suscipiendum inducit: tres
enim causas precipue allegat; tractat eciam de quarta
causa, que raro ad presens contingit.**

Cap^m. xxix. Sunt aliqui, studio modo qui perstant animoso,
Nescio que causa sit tamen inde rea.
Quicquid agant homines, intencio iudicat omnes;
Corde quod interius est capit ipse deus:
Istis prepositis, verum michi pande, scolaris,
Dic que sit studii condita causa tui:
Muniri primo cum te facis ordine sacro,
2090 Cum te principiis presbiterare venis,
O que mente tua fuerit tunc mocio summa,
Hoc vel pro mundi sit vel amore dei?
Aut tu certa tue michi dic primordia cause,
Aut tibi que sapio dicere vera volo.
‘Sunt plures cause, per quas communis in orbe⁴²³
Est sacer hic ordo carus vt ecce modo:
In prima causa fugio mundana flagella
Legis communis, que dat amara viris:
Vlterius video quod non sudore laboro,
2100 Ocia que quero sic et habere queo:
T e r c i a causa meum dat vestitum quoque victum;
Sicque meo placito persto quietus ego.
Ex hiis causata mea stat deuocio tota,
Qua poterit cerni rasa corona michi:
Hec est causa scole, ciuilia iura studere
Que facit, et logicam me docet arte suam.
Ipsa scoleque gradus michi dat conscendere summos,

Sic et in ecclesiam scandere quero bonam:
 Nam si fama viget, puto quod prebenda vigebit,
 2110 Sicque vacare libris est labor ipse levis.
 Sic sacer ordo michi placet, et sic litera cleri
 Confert, dum studio pingua lucra gero.
 Nunc causas dixi, constat quibus ordo scolari,
 Sic propter mundum me reor esse reum;
 Nam michi nil melius, dum sufficit ipsa facultas,
 Estimo, quam mundi gaudia ferre michi.'
 Est set adhuc causa melior tamen omnibus, illa
 Qua scola discipulum gaudet habere bonum.
 Hec solet antiquis, non nostris stare diebus,
 2120 Que de virtute concipit acta scole.
 Nuper erant mundi qui contempsere beati
 Pompas, et summum concupiere bonum;
 Et quia scire scholas acuit mentes fore sanctas,
 Scripture studiis se tribuere piis.
 Non hos ambicio, non hos amor vrget habendi,
 Set studio mores conuenienter eunt:
 Hii contemplantes celum terrena negabant,
 Causa voluptatis nulla remouit eos:
 Hii neque serviciis optabant regis inesse,
 2130 Nec foris in plebe nomen habere Rabi:
 Hos neque precellens superabat comptus inanis
 Nec vini luxus, nec mulieris amor:
 Moribus experti dederant exempla futuris,
 Que sibi discipulus debet habere scolis.
 Nunc tamen in viciu virtus conuertitur,
 e t que
 Nuper erant mores turpia plura gerunt:
 Que modo scripta dei dicunt se discere laudi,
 In laudem mundi vertit auarus honor.
 O res mira nimis! legit et studet ipse scholaris
 2140 Mores, dum vicia sunt magis acta sua:
 Sic quia stat cecus morum sine lumine clerus,
 Erramus laici nos sine luce vagi.

FOOTNOTES:

- [340](#) *Heading* Hic incipit exquo L Incipit prologus libri tercii *om.* L
[341](#) 9 set et S (et *in later hand*)
[342](#) 13 vulgus] populus (*ras.*) C
[343](#) 16 Vt sit D Sit sic L
[344](#) 46 conciliumque H
[345](#) 58 malo C
[346](#) 69 poteruntque C
[347](#) 90 Quodque prius D Quod prius L
[348](#) *In place of* Incipit &c., L *has here the four lines* ‘Ad mundum mitto,’ *with picture below: see p. 19.*
[349](#) 4* exempla D humus] mundus DL
[350](#) 18* eum] ei D enim L
[351](#) 22* ille CD ipse HGEL
[352](#) 27* poterint D
[353](#) 1** regentes H₂
[354](#) 4** mundit T
[355](#) 24** ipse] ille H₂
[356](#) 58 periat HCGL
[357](#) 81 Marcenarius G mercennarius E
[358](#) 86 Glebas D
[359](#) 141 ipseque D
[360](#) 176 ouis CEHGDLH₂ onus ST
[361](#) 193 possint D
[362](#) *Heading* Hic loquitur quomodo de legibus posituiis quasi cotidie noua instituuntur nobis peccata, quibus tamen priusquam fiant prelati propter lucrum dispensant, et ea fieri libere propter aurum permittunt LTH₂ (Hic quomodo diligentibus posituiis ... prius fiant &c. L liberi LT)
[363](#) 229 numquam L vnquam D
[364](#) 258 iugum] suum C
[365](#) 273 Dum S Cum CEHDL
[366](#) 300 gerarchiam SHT Ierarchiam CL ierarchiam ED
[367](#) *Heading* 2 dicitur tamen nunc D dicitur tamen L
[368](#) 351 vinximus SDL vincimus CEHG
[369](#) 375 ff. *marginal note om.* ELTH₂L₂
[370](#) 375 *margin* hic *om.* S
[371](#) *margin* in guerris S guerris CHGD
[372](#) 380 *margin* spoliantes S *om.* CHGD
[373](#) 379 neque C
[374](#) 401 reperare S reparare CED
[375](#) 454 cotinuatque H
[376](#) 462 saruat H
[377](#) *Heading* deuincant EL deuincat SCHD
[378](#) 516 Solennes CEL Solemnes D
[379](#) 536 Hec DL
[380](#) 546 sit CE
[381](#) 561 *No paragraph* S

[382](#) Cap. ix *Heading* 2 nec decet CEDL
[383](#) 579 sceptrum C
[384](#) 595 tetram CEH terram SGDL
[385](#) 617 *No paragr.* CE
[386](#) 633 sunt vmbra velud (velut) fugitiua CEG sunt fugitiua velut vmbra L
[387](#) 641 piper vrtice *om.* D (*blank*)
[388](#) 685 Ne C
[389](#) *Heading* 2 in contrarium S
[390](#) 840 lucri] dei EHT
[391](#) 934 ruet CH
[392](#) 989 sit] sic S
[393](#) 1124 Et CEGDL Est SHTH₂
[394](#) 1149 subectos S
[395](#) 1214 ad hec CEHGDTH₂ ad hoc L et hec S
[396](#) 1265 fallit S
[397](#) 1374 timuisse EHL
[398](#) 1376 vngat vt D vngat et SCEHGL
[399](#) 1454 plus sibi sensus hebes est SGDL fit sibi sensus hebes CEHTH₂
[400](#) 1498 Nec CE
[401](#) 1518 circueuntis C
[402](#) 1533 Est et S Est sed (set) CEHGL Est *set et* D
[403](#) 1541 Durior CEHGDLT Durius S
[404](#) 1552 modicum S
[405](#) *Heading* 1 Qostquam S
[406](#) 2 iam *om.* S
[407](#) 1617 solennia CEDL
[408](#) 1642 Hoc S Hec CEHGDL
[409](#) 1695 si CEHGDLTH₂ sua S
[410](#) 1747 vouet CEHGT vouit SDLH₂
[411](#) 1760 nec in simili conditione grauatur (*om.* ll. 1761 f.) C
[412](#) 1815 Aaron CED
[413](#) 1863 puluere CEH vulnere SGDL
[414](#) 1890 Accedat SL Accedit CEHGD
[415](#) *Heading* 5 f. a bonis non debent operibus esse CE a bonis operibus non debent esse L a bonis operibus non esse D
[416](#) 1907 ad huc SGT adhuc CEHDL
[417](#) 1915 pugnam CEHL pugnā SGT pingū D
[418](#) 1922 Nec C timeat EDL
[419](#) 1963 serpit CE
[420](#) 1991 residuiis SET recidiuiis CHDL
[421](#) 1999 Helizeus C Helyseus EL
[422](#) 2009 *No paragr.* S
[423](#) 2095 *No paragr.* S

**Exquo tractauit de errore cleri, ad quem precipue
nostrarum spectat regimen animarum, iam intendit
tractare de errore virorum Religiosorum: et primo
dicet de Monachis, et aliis bonorum temporalium
possessionem optinentibus; ordinis vero illorum
sanctitatem commendans, illos precipue qui contraria
faciunt opera redarguit.**

Incipit liber Quartus.

Cap^m. i. Sunt et Claustrales diuerse condicionis,
De quibus vt sapio scribere pauca volo.
Actus vt ipse probat, quosdam possessio signat,
Quosdam pauperies, set similata nimis.
Est bona religio de se, set religionem
Qui fallunt, tales dicimus esse malos:
Qui bene sub claustro viuunt fore credo beatos,
Quos mundanus amor nescit habere reos;
Quique manus aratro mittunt nec respicientes
10 Retro, viros sanctos ordo notabit eos.
Est deus in monachis, sunt et commercia celi
Hiis, sine qui mundo claustra subire volunt.
Cum quis amare duo pariter contraria sumit,
Alterius vires subtrahit alter amor:[424](#)
Sic qui presumunt facies laruare sub vmbra
Ordinis, et mundi crimina subtus agunt,
Talibus ipse mea fero scripta, nec alter ab ipsis
Leditur, immo suum quisque reportet onus.
Est nichil ex sensu proprio quod scribo, set ora
20 Que michi vox populi contulit, illa loquar.
Sunt etenim monachi, possessio quos titulauit,
Quidam, quos nullis moribus ordo ligat;
Nam possessores aliqui sic ocia querunt
Ordinis, vt nequeunt vlla nociua pati:
Ferre famem fugiunt, vinoque sitim supervndant,

Pellicibus calidis frigus et omne fugant:
Sic gravitas ventris noctis non surgit in horis,
Nec vox rauca citho concinit alta choro.
Deuoret in mensa talis nisi fercula plura,
30 Euacuet plures potibus atque cithos,
Tunc infirmari se credit, et hinc recreari
Postulat, et ludis sic vacat ipse suis.
Est nam vix fessus a potibus ille professus,
Sic cupit in vino dompnus adesse deo:
Vinum dumque geres, ad se trahit hoc mulieres,
Dant simul ista duo claustra relictata modo.
Si celum poterit calefacta veste lucrari,
Et gula cum superis possit habere locum,
Tunc puto quod monachus causa signatus vtraque
40 Conciuis Petri stabit in arce poli.

**Hic loquitur de monachis illis, qui contra primi
ordinis statuta abstinentie virtutem linquentes,
delicias sibi corporales multipliciter assumunt.**

Cap^m. ii. Mortua cum viuus nulla racione coherent,
Orbem nec renuens orbis ad acta redit:
Nil tonsura iuuat, nichil aut vilissima vestis,
Si lupus est, quamuis esse videtur ouis.
Nam falli possunt homines, set fallere Cristum,
Qui nullum fallit, fallere nemo potest:
Ille quidem fucum similate religionis
Dampnat, et ad nichilum computat illud opus.
Veste tamen sola monachus iam cedit ab orbe,
50 Et putat in forma sufficit ordo sibi;
Materiamque sui curat nichil ordinis vltra,
Vestis erit Monachus, mens et in orbe vagat.⁴²⁵
Talis enim monachus, quia scit quod in ordine ventris
Ex tenui victu corpora raro vigent,
Postulat oris opem, quas et magis appetit escas
Sumit, vt ex ore gaudia venter agat.

Immemor ipse patris, humeris qui ferre solebat,
Vina suo monachus optima ventre gerit;
Haurit et in stomachum talis velut amphora Bachum,
60 Est dare nec vacuum ventre tumente locum.
Pluribus ex causis monachus vitare Lieum
Debet, ex est vna, ne caro stupra petat;
Nec bona confratrum vastet, nec in ebrietate
Desideat, nec eo febricitetur homo.
Attamen ipse nichil curat, quin replet inane
Corpus, et est anime cotidiana fames.
Nunc niueus panis monachis subtileque vinum
Et carnes festa cotidiana parant;
Nunc cocus ecce coquit, assat, gelat atque resoluit,
70 Et terit et stringit, colat et acta probat.
Si poterit monachus ventrem crassare gulosus,
Sit labor vt sacris nil putat esse libris:⁴²⁶
Despiciens manna plebs ista nigras petit ollas,
Preponit vicia moribus atque sua.
Ne macerare fames crassos queat, en gula plene
Languentes stomachos ventris amica replet:
Quid sit honorari nescit, set ventre beari,
Hoc, dicit monachus, est via, vita, salus.
Accelerans currit cito, cum pulsatur ad ollam,⁴²⁷
80 Preterit a mensa mica nec vna sibi;
Set pede spondaico lentus de nocte resurgens,
Cum venit ad laudes, vltimus esse petit.
Ordinis in primo monachis domus antra fuere,
Aulaque nunc grandis marmoris ornat eos:
Nulla coquina sibi fuerat fumosa, nec igne
Deliciosa cocus cocta vel assa tulit;
Non cibus excoctus neque fercula carne repensa
In primo monachis tempore crassa dabant;
Corporis ingluuies animas non pressit eorum,
90 Nec calefacta caro callida stupra petit:
Vesteque pellicea sua corpora nuda tegebant,
Qui modo de lana mollius ipsa tegunt:
Herba dabat victum, fons potum, turpeque vestem

Cilicium, nec eo tempore murmur erat.
Non erat invidia claustralis tunc neque pompa;
Qui fuerat maior, seruit vt ipse minor:
Non erat argenti pondus neque circulus auri,
Que poterant sanctum tunc violare statum:
Non tetigit loculos nummus neque vina palatum,
100 Nec fuit in lumbis carnea flamma suis:
Hiis fuerat sancta mens propositum bene seruans,
Perdurans in idem quod bene cepit opus.
 Hii fuerant homines iusti, mundum fugientes, [428](#)
Quos peccatorum nullus onustat amor:
Mundus non retrahit illos a tramite recto,
Illos nec reuocat ad mala feda caro:
Omnia postponunt que mundus vana ministrat,
Et celi solum concupiere deum.
Tunc pudor in stipula nec erat cepisse quietem,
110 Nec fenum capiti supposuisse suo:
Silua domus fuerat, cibus herba, cubicula frondes,
Que tellus nulla sollicitate dabat.
In magno Corulus precio tunc floruit illis,
Duraque magnificas quercus habebat opes:
Arbuteos fetus montanaque fragra legebant,
Que condita sale nec speciebus erant:
Si que deciderant patule Iouis arbore glandes,
Sumebant, et in hiis convaluere cibis.
Contenti modicis natura sponte creatis,
120 Soluebant summo vota pudica deo.
Hii tunc iusticie perfecti grana serentes,
Fructus centenos nunc sine fine metunt:
Set vetus illa salus animarum, religionis
Que fuit, infirma carne subacta perit.

**Hic loquitur qualiter modus et regula, qui a
fundatoribus ordinis primitus fuerant constituti, iam
nouiter a viciorum consuetudine in quampluribus
subuertuntur.**

Cap^m. iii. In noua multociens animus mutatur, et inde
 Testis erit monachi regula mota michi.
 Fit modo curtata monachorum regula prima,
 Est nam re dempta, sic manet ipsa gula;
 Et modus a modio largissima vina bibendo
 130 Dicitur in monacho, qui vorat absque modo.
 Vt non lingua loquax dentes turbare gulosos
 Possit, dum prandet, ordo silere iubet:
 Ne pes deficiat ventris sub pondere pressus,
 Quando bibit monachus persedet ipse prius:
 Expedit et monacho rasum caput esse rotundo,
 Ne coma perpediat pendula quando bibit:
 Mutua pacta ferunt monachi, quod, si quis eorum
 Prebibat, in fundo nil remanere sinet;
 Vasaque sic plena vacuant que replent vacuata,
 140 Vt faciant Bachi propria festa loci:
 Sic confert monacho vestis largissima pleno,
 Ne pateat grossi ventris ymago sui.
 In monacho tali semper furit ardor edendi,
 Dant cibus et sompnus que cupit ipse magis:
 Quod pontus, quod terra parit, quod et educat aer,
 Ex auidis auidus faucibus ipse vorat;
 Vtque fretum recipit de tota flumina terra,
 Et tamen aucta maris crapula semper hiat,
 Gurges et vt putei peregrinos suscipit ampnes,
 150 Quantumcunque fluunt, nec saciatur aquis,
 Vt cremat inmensas pluresque faces calor ignis,
 Et sibi, quo magis est copia, plura petit,
 Sic epulas varias consumit ab ore prophano
 Ingluuias monachi ventris amore sui;
 Sic gerit ille grauem maturo pondere ventrem
 Et levis a Cristo mens vacuata redit.
 Potibus assumptus sacer hic non mobilis extat,
 Firmiter et sumpto stat grauis ipse loco;
 Sic sumpto vino monachorum torpet inane
 160 Pectus, et a claustris pondere cedit onus;
 Sic magis impleta pia gaudent viscera fuso,

Que fouet afflata spiritus ille, mero;
Sic sancti faciunt longos medicamina sompnos,
Sumptaque vina nimis causa soporis erunt.
Rite bibens vinum sit castus nescio, namque
Sic Venus in vinis ignis vt igne furit:
Tucius ergo Venus latitans sub veste dolenti
Gaudet, subque sacra fronte nephanda gerit.

170 Murmurat inuidia monachi sub pectoris antro,
Os silet exterius, mens tamen intus agit;
Et quia lingua tacet, manus est que conscia signis
Fabulat in digitis turpia plura satis;
Sicque loquax digitus redimendo silencia verbi
Dictat, et in rixis plus meretrice furit:
Ora tument ira, nigrescunt sanguine vene,
Lumina commota lenius igne micant.
Sepe suum feruens oculis dabit ira colorem, [429](#)
In quibus alterius mortis ymago patet:
Non minus in vultu dampnosa superbia tali est,
180 Quam si de iugulo sterneret ense suo.
Sic quamuis ordo prohibet bellare loquendo,
Pugnat, et in mente discutit ense caput:
Dum nequit ipse loqui, sub cordis ymagine raucum
Fratris in invidiam clanculo murmur agit:
Iram vultus habet, pro verbis murmura reddit,
Et necat in mente, quem manus ipsa nequit.
Tunc pallor vultus, suspiria pectoris, horror
Aspectus mote nuncia mentis erunt;
Quicquid homo patitur nam sensus exteriores
190 Interior motus ad sua signa mouet.

Allegat vultus affectum mentis, et iram
Pectoris accensi de grauitate notat:
Nullus enim mentis, vt se sine voce loquatur,
Index quam vultus cercior esse potest.
Quicquid habet vestis nigredo simplicitatis,
Quid latet interius experimenta docent.
Prepositum monacho monachus postponit amore,
Inuidet hos omnes, quos nequit ipse sequi.

200 Conuolat ad pulsum campane quisquis in vnum,
Ordinis et forma cetera vana ferunt:
Vox canit ipsa choro foris, et mens murmurat intus,
Os petit in celo, mens set in orbe, locum.
Sic non materiam seruant set in ordine formam;
Fructibus ablatis corpus inane fouent:
Sic patet exterius labor et sapiencia, set quid
Stulcior interius occupat actus eos.

**Hic loquitur de monachis illis qui contra
primitiua sui ordinis statuta mundi diuicias ad vsus
malos, suo nesciente preposito, apropiare sibi
clanculo presumunt.**

Cap^m. iiii. Nulla vouere iuuat cicius quam frangere votum,
Est nam mendaci laus tribuenda nichil.
Fraternalis amor deberet mutuus esse,
210 Inter eos saltem quos pius ordo ligat.
Non tamen hoc patitur hodierna dies, set in iram
Prouocat invidia quicquid amoris erat:
Vt bos campestris, rursum qui ruminat herbas,
Detrahit in claustro sic semidemon homo.
Si non corrodi vis, tu corrodia nulla
Inter eos sumas, est vbi raro fides:[430](#)
Dum tua deposcunt, tunc te reuerenter adorant,
Set vix si memores amplius esse volunt.
Nil sibi quod dederat confert fundacio prima,
220 Sit nisi quod querant cotidiana lucra.
Denegat hoc ratio, quod homo possessor vterque
Et mendicus erit, ordo nec illud habet:
Nunc tamen hos vanos monachos nichil implet in orbe,
Est quibus vna fames semper et vna sitis.
Hoc de Ieronimo legitur simul et Benedicto,
Vt magis exemplis consequeremur eos;
Ornamenta sui vendunt altaris, et illa
Pauperis in licitos distribuere cibos.

Ecclesie bona sunt inopum, que religiosis
230 Quando necesse vident non retinere licet.
 Si monacho dare vis, sibi possidet omne quod offers,
Nil set habet proprium, si quid ab inde petas.
Hii sunt vnanimis, hoc est animo quod eodem
Quisque suum proprium solus habere cupit.
Sic quecumque prius vetus ordo statuta colebat,
Mutatis vicibus inficit ordo nouus.
Ingenuos raro monachari cernimus, immo
Ordine rurales, sunt magis ergo rudes;
Quos tamen in sanctos sanctus creat ordo professos,
240 Hii satis ingenui sunt et honore probi:
Quid dicam set eis, dignos quos ordo nec ortus
Approbat? immo suum tempus inane ferunt.
Si Benedictus eos fundauit qui maledicti
Sunt, deus a parte non benedicit eis:
Quos magis attraxit mundus quam Cristus, aratro
Et retro respiciunt, hos mea scripta notant.
 Cur, queso, cupiat quicquam qui cuncta reliquit?
Ad mala cur redeat qui bona facta vouet?
Terram contempnas qui celum queris habere;
250 Si mansura petas, hec fugitiua fuge.
Numquid habent monachi proprium de iure creati?
Nescio de iure, tu tamen acta vide.
Si feretri custos, poterit dum carpere nummos,
Quid proprium querit, hic michi testis erit;
Seu quod in officiis monachus quandoque regendis
Propria conseruat, exitus acta probat.
Nam cum congeries sibi sit, tunc inde nepotes
Ditat, et en claustra sic parat ipse noua;
Sepeque quos natos gignit vocat ipse nepotes,
260 Ad laudem Veneris, quam colit ipse pius:
Eius enim nati sunt ficto nomine versi,
Versaque sic pietas ceca iuuabit eos.
 Sic viget in claustris elemosina ficta sinistris,
Dum monachus genitis dat sua dona suis:
Sic floret pietas mundo secreta monilis,

Talia dumque dari fingit amore dei.
Cum furtum licitum fuerit, tunc dicere possum
Quod licet ex dono talia ferre deo;
Set qui sic proprios communia vertit in vsus,
270 Ex merito doni fert maledicta dei:
Talibus in donis curuantur claustra ruinis,
Horrea cum granis compaciuntur eis.
Centum claustrales macerantur, vt hii duo vel tres,⁴³¹
Officiis dum stant, pingua labra gerant.
'Omnia sunt nostra,' dicunt, lanx non tamen equa
Pendet, dum solus plus capit ipse tribus.

**Hic loquitur qualiter monachi extra claustrum
vagare non debent.**

Cap^m. v. Est mare viuientis habitacio congrua piscis,
Et claustrum monachi stat domus apta sibi:
Vt mare defunctos retinere negat sibi pisces,
280 Sic claustrum monachos euomit inde malos.
Non foris a claustris monachus, nec aqua fore piscis
Debet, tu nisi sis, ordo, reuersus eis.
Si fuerit piscis, qui postpositis maris undis
Pascua de terra querat habere sua,
Est nimis improprium piscis sibi ponere nomen,
Debeo set monstri ponere nomen ei.
Sic ego claustrali dicam, qui gaudia mundi
Appetit et claustrum deserit inde suum,
Non erit hic monachus set apostata iure vocandus,
290 Aut monstrum templi quod notat ira dei.
Qui tamen in claustro resident, et mente vagantes
Respiciunt mundum cordis amore nouo,
In visu domini tales trangressio fedat,
Quo perdunt claustri premia digna sui.
Non est hic sapiens sibi qui bona pluribus annis⁴³²
Colligit, et solo dissipat illa die;
Qui villas monachus et campos circuit, illud

Sepius incurrit quo reus ipse cadit:
Sunt tamen ad presens pauci, qui mente vel actu
300 Non vaga deliciis corda dedere suis.
Dixerat hec Salomon, hominis quod inanis amictus,
Qui patet exterius, interiora docet:
Set licet ex humili monachus se veste figuret,
Nunc tamen a latere plura superba vides.

**Hic loquitur de monachis illis qui non pro diuino
seruicio, set magis pro huius mundi honore et
voluptate, habitum sibi religionis⁴³³ assumunt.**

Cap^m. vi. Est nigra coruus auis predoque cadaueris, ipsum
Quem male denigrat ceca libido notans:
Sub volucrum specie descripsit legifer ipsos,
Quos mundanus amor religione tegit:
Hunc eciam tangit quem religionis amictus
310 Laruat, vt hinc cicuius possit honore frui.
Turpe pecus monstrum, turpis sine gramine campus,
Et sine fronde frutex, et sine crine caput:
Turpior est monachus, habitum qui religionis
Sumpserit, et monachi condicione caret.
Vt fugiant mundum iubet ordo vetus monachorum,⁴³⁴
Dicunt quod fugiunt, set fugiendo petunt.
Pauper, quem sulco genuit natiua propago,
Vult, licet indignus, esse Priore prior:
Quem sibi non dederat mundus, scrutatur honorem
320 In clauastro, veteris immemor ipse status:
Sic quos iure patris humiles natura creauit,
Cum monachi fiant, ordo superbit eos:
Non dompni set et hii domini nomen sibi querunt,
Et faciunt largam que fuit arta viam.
Nil graue tangit eos, reputant neque posse grauare,
Vix nichil ergo sciunt vnde rogare deum.

**Hic loquitur qualiter paciencia vna cum ceteris
virtutibus a quibusdam claustris, viciis
superuenientibus, se transtulerunt.**

Cap^m. vii. Mortuus est dompnus Paciens, viuitque professus
Murmur, et in claustris pax nequit esse suis:
Mortuus est eciam modo dompnus Castus, et ipsi
330 Successit Luxus, vastat et ipse domos:
Dompnus et Inconstans Constanti claustra negauit,
Que residens Odium vendicat esse sua:
Dompnus et Ypocrisis dompnum copulat sibi Fictum,
Dum sibi Fraus magnum spirat habere statum.
Quos monachi veteres plantabant nuper amoris,
Invidie fructus iam nouus ordo parit.⁴³⁵
Nil modo Bernardi sancti vel regula Mauri
Confert commonachis, displicet immo, nouis:
Obstat avarus eis que superbus et invidus alter,
340 Ordinis exemplum qui modo ferre negant.
Expulit a claustris maledictus sic Benedictum,
Sic gula temperiem, sic dolus atque fidem:
Mollis adest Abbas, quem mollia claustra sequuntur,
Vanaque sic vanos ordinis vmbra tegit.
Spiritus hoc quod erat, nunc extat corpus inane,
Et dompnus Mundus omne gubernat opus.

**Hic loquitur quod sicut monachi ita et errantes
Canonici a suis sunt excessibus culpandi.**

Cap^m. viii. In re consimili, sicut decreta fatentur,
Iudicium simile de racione dabis:
Quotquot in ecclesia signantur religiosi,
350 Si possessores sint, reputantur idem.
Vt monachos, sic canonicos quos deuiat error,
In casu simili culpa coequat eos.
Nunc tamen, vt fertur, plures sua iura recidunt,
Apocapata nouo que quasi iure silent:

Hunc rigidum textum, quem scripserat auctor eorum,
 Mollificant glosis de nouitate suis.
 Sufficit, vt credunt, signari nomine sancti
 Ordinis, et facere quod petit ordo parum.
 Nomen Canonici si sit de canone sumptum,
 360 Illud in effectum res tibi raro probat:
 Hii tamen ad visum gestant in plebe figuram
 Sanctorum, set in hoc regula sepe cadit.
 Subtus habent vestes albas, set desuper ipsas
 Nigra superficies candida queque tegit;
 Actus et econtra se demonstrabit eorum,
 Fingunt alba foris, nigra set intus agunt.
 Non sic dico tamen hiis, qui sua claustra
 frequentant
 Ad contemplandum simplicitate sua:
 Talibus immo loquor, quibus est scrutatus ab infra
 370 Mundus, et exterius celica signa gerunt.

**Hic loquitur qualiter religiosi male viuentes
 omnibus aliis quibuscumque hominibus infelicissimi
 existunt.**

Cap^m. ix. Estimo claustrales magis infelicibus horis
 Pre reliquis nasci, sint nisi forte boni:
 Mundo nam monachus moritur viuendo professus,
 Quod nequit in mundo, sic velut alter homo,
 Exterius gaudere bonis, et si quid ab intus
 Sit cupidus mundi, perdit amena poli.
 Sic nec presentem vitam nec habere futuram
 Constat eum, quo bis est miser ipse magis:
 Mortuus hac vita moritur, dum morte secunda
 380 Computet amissum tempus vtrumque suum.
 Et quia sic mundo moritur, quod viuus ab illo
 Ordinis ex iure gaudia nulla capit,
 Et nisi corde deum solum meditetur et inde
 Gaudeat, in celo pars sibi nulla manet,

Nescio quis stultus claustrali stulcior extat,
Qui se sic proprio priuat vtroque bono.
Tempus inane perit cui presens vita negauit
Gaudia, nec celum vita secunda tenet.

**Hic loquitur qualiter vnusquisque qui religionis
ingredi voluerit professionem, cuncta mundi vicia
penitus abnegare et anime virtutes adquirere et
obseruare tenetur.**

Cap^m. x. O comites claustrum sub religione professi,
390 Concludam breuibus, quid sit et ad quid onus.
Informatus ego sanctorum scripta reuolui,
Que magis in vestram sunt memoranda scolam:
Sancta valent verba plus, cum plus sint patefacta;
Vos igitur, monachi, cernite quid sit ibi.
Vouistis, fratres, vouistis; vota tenete,
Et quod spondistis perficiatis opus:
Vouistis domino vestros conuertere mores,
Vos deus elegit, stetis amore dei.
Propositum vite monachi seruare rigorem
400 Debent, nec pigeat tempore dura pati:
Exiguus labor est, set merces magna laboris;
Preterit ille cito, premia fine carent.
Hinc monachi sancti mentis conamine toto
Preteritas culpas flendo, ghemendo, lauent.⁴³⁶
Nunc humilis viuatur, qui vixerat ante superbus,
Sit castus quisquis luxuriosus erat:
Querebat census quidam, temptabat honores;
Ammodo vilescat omnis inanis honor:
Gaudebat dapibus, gaudebat diuite mensa,
410 Nunc tenuem victum sobria cena dabit;
Et mundi, quamuis delectent, vana cauebit,
Nam certe gustu dulcia sepe nocent.
Ille suis letus excessibus esse solebat,
Nunc lacrimis culpas diluat ipse suas:

Verbosus taceat, mitescat feruidus ira,
Invidus invidie dira venena vomat;
Cuique prius gladius placuit, placuere rapine,
Nunc pius et mitis pacis amator erit.
Quisquis adulantum ventosa laude tumebat,
420 Nunc hominum laudes estimet esse nichil;
Et qui rite solet aliis feritate nocere,
Nunc eciam lesus discat amara pati:
Ad lites facilis fuit hic, ad iurgia preceps,
Fortiter alterius nunc maledicta ferat.
Que modo pugnarunt, iungunt sua rostra columbe,
Nec prior vlterius ira manebit eis.
Sic sine peccato foret ira brevis, quod in vllo
Nesciat interius mentis agenda furor.
Hec veniam, fratres, conuersio vera meretur,
430 Hec valet offensum pacificare deum.

**Hic loquitur qualiter religiosi consorcia mulierum
specialiter euitare debent.**

Cap^m. xi. Feminum fuge colloquium, vir sancte, caueto
Ne te confidas igne furente nimis;
Nam que femineo mens capta ligatur amore
Numquam virtutum culmen habere potest.
Harum colloquium tibi quid fert vtilitatis?
Venisti monachus, turpis adulter abis.
Ergo virosum nisi declinaueris anguem,
Cum minus esse putas, inficieris ea.
Accendit mulier quecumque libidinis ignem,
440 Si quis eam tangat, vritur inde statim:
Si veterum libros et patrum scripta revoluas,
Condoleas sanctos sic cecidisse viros.
Numquid non hominem mulier de sede beata
Expulit, et nostre mortis origo fuit?
Qui bonus est igitur pastor vigilet, que rapaces
Eminus a claustris pellat vbique lupas.

Depositum serua: tibi que responsa valebunt,
 Pastor, qui rapide linquis ouile lupe?
 Sepe sequens agnum lupa stat de voce retenta,
 450 Sepeque pastoris ore tacente perit.
 Ad plures lupa tendit oues, pastoreque lento
 Sepius insidiis fedat ouile suis:
 Vtque rapax stimulante fame cupidusque cruoris
 Incustoditum captat ouile lupus,
 Sic vetus hic serpens, paradisum qui violauit,
 Clastra magis sancta deuiolare cupit.
 Pellat et ergo lupas pastor, ne grex in earum
 Decidat ingluuiem, quam saturare nequit:
 Pastores, vigilate lupas, seruetur ouile,
 460 Ne maculare gregis sanguine clastra queant.
 Occidunt animas, pluresque ad tartara mittunt;
 Est monachis pestis nulla timenda magis.
 Femina, mors anime, monachis accedere numquam
 Debeat, a sacro sit procul ipsa choro;
 Sit procul a cetu sanctorum femina, namque,
 Et si non poterit vincere, bella mouet.
 O caueant igitur monachi, ne carnea culpa
 Virtutes anime de leuitate terat.
 Cum quid turpe facit, qui me spectante ruberet,
 470 Cur, spectante deo, non magis inde rubet?
 Si patrie Iudex sciret sua facta, timeret;
 Scit dominus rerum, cur nichil ergo timet?
 Funestum monacho cum sic male suggerit hostis,
 Et conatur eum fallere mille modis,
 Esse deum credat presentem semper vbique,
 Nec se, si peccet, posse latere putet.
 Cuncta scit atque videt, nec quicquam preterit illum,
 Omnia sunt oculis semper aperta suis:
 Si tacet et differt et non dum crimina punit,
 480 Puniet, et meritis arbiter equus erit.
 Non igitur monachos breuis hec et vana voluptas
 Occupet, immo dei debita iura colant:
 Ad quod venerunt faciant, sua vota que soluant,

Nec queat in claustris hostis habere locum:
Distinctis vicibusque legant, operentur et orent,
A studiis sacris tempora nulla vacent:
Vtilibus semper studeant et rebus honestis,
Res est segnicies perniciosa nimis;
Luxurie fomes, res incentiua malorum,⁴³⁷
490 Spiritibus nequam preparat ipsa locum.

**Hic tractat quasi⁴³⁸ sub compendio super hiis que
in religionis professione secundum fundatorum
sancciones districcius obseruanda finaliter existunt.**

Cap^m. xii. Hoc qui dogma vetus sanctorum claudit in antro
Cordis, et intendit ordinis acta prius,
Scit bene quod mundus est in claustro fugiendus,
Quo tamen ad presens vendicat ipse locum.
O bone claustralis, mundum qui linquis, eidem
Non redeas iterum, que docet immo fuge:
Quo caro nutritur, ne queras molle cubile,
Sit claustrum cultus, et liber ille iocus.
Cor doleat, sit larga manus, ieiunia crebra,
500 Non incastus amor sit neque vanus honor:
Sit tibi potus aqua, cibus aridus, aspera vestis,
Dorso virga, breuis sompnus, acuta quies:
Flecte genu, tunde pectus, nudus caput ora,
Quere deum, mundum sperne, relinque malum:
Hereat os terre, mens celo, lingua loquatur
De plano corde, planaue verba sonet.
Litus arat sterile deuoto qui sine corde
Verba serit precibus, sunt sine namque lucris:
Non vox set votum, non musica cordula set cor,
510 Non clamans set amans, cantat in aure dei.
Mens humilis, simplex oculus, caro munda, pium cor,
Recta fides, firma spes tibi prestet iter:
Si gustare velis modulamina dulcia celi,
Est tibi mundana mirra bibenda prius:

Ex humilique tuo te subdas corde Priori,
Ordine pacificus murmuris absque nota.
Summa quidem virtus monachi parere Priori,
Ferre iugum norme seque negare sibi:
Non vilis vestis, non te locus vltimus angat,
520 Sepe tui stultos ordinis ista mouent.
Qui sibi vilescit et se putat esse minorem,
Et timet et mundi labilis alta fugit,
Hic est et sapiens et celo proximus iste,
Non sine re monachi nomen inane gerit.
 Sit tibi lex domini requies, caro victima, mundus
Exilium, celum patria, vita deus:
Iussa molesta data fer, fac et suscipe grata,
Sic eris in domino religiosus homo:
Que tibi prepositus quamuis vilissima suadet,
530 Dum tamen hec licita sint, patienter age;
Nec tibi turpe putes, et si s i t turpe placebit,
Cum tuus in Cristo spiritus albus erit.
Vt subeunt iuuenes veteris mandata Prioris,
Et nichil econtra pondere iuris agunt,
Sic Prior in licitis iuuenes tractare modeste
Debet, et ex humili vincere corde malum.
Aspicis vt pressos ledunt iuga prima iuuenkos,
Et noua velocem cingula ledit equum;
Sic importunus iuuenum rector grauat, et dat
540 Causam, quo solita murmura pectus agit.
Hec tibi scripta tene mentis per claustra, que caste
Mortuus a mundo viue, professe, deo:
Paruo perpetuam mercare labore quietem,
Et reuoca fletu gaudia longa breui:
Nam si nulla tibi fuerit nunc sarcina carnis,
Tunc sine fine quies paxque perhennis erit.

**Hic loquitur vlterius de mulieribus, que in habitu
moniali sub sacre religionis velo professionem
suscipientes ordinis sui continenciam non obseruant.**

Cap^m. xiii. Errantis Monachi culpas scribendo reliqui,
 Et tibi velatam religione canam.
 Conuenit ordo viris, dum conuersantur honeste,
 550 Quo procul a mundo celica regna petant;
 Conueniens eciam castis mulieribus extat
 Soluere sub velo vota pudica deo:
 Sic ligat ordo sacer monachos, ligat et moniales,
 Vnde deo meritis fulget vterque suis.
 Si tamen in claustris fragiles errent mulieres,
 Non condigna viris culpa repugnat eis;
 Nam pes femineus nequit vt pes stare virilis,
 Gressus nec firmos consolidare suos;
 Nec scola nec sensus, constancia, nullaue virtus,
 560 Sicut habent homines, in muliere vigent:
 Set tam materia fragili quam condicione
 Femineos mores sepe mouere vides.
 Quas magis ordo putat sapientes, sepius ipsas
 Cernimus ex fatuis actibus esse graues;
 Et que scripta sciunt, magis omnibus hee laicali
 Ex indiscreto crimine sepe cadunt.
 Simpliciter textum dum sepe legunt, neque glosam
 Concernunt, vt agant scripta licere putant:
 Leccio scripture docet illas cuncta probare,
 570 Sic, quia cuncta legunt, cuncta probare volunt.
 Crescere nature sunt iura que multiplicare,
 Que deus in primo scripsit ab ore suo;
 Hecque dei scripta seruare volunt, quoque iura
 Nature solita reddere mente pia.
 Nititur in vetitum mulier, set quod licet ipsa
 Hoc sine mentali murmure raro facit;
 Set magis hiis scriptis perfecte sunt moniales,
 Et patienter agunt que sibi scripta iubent.
 Scribitur, hec grana que non capiet bona terra,
 580 Nil sibi fructificant, set peritura iacent:
 Que tamen et qualis sit terra patet monialis,
 Est ibi nam decies multiplicata Ceres:
 Et quia sic teneres subeunt pondus mulieres,

Non temptabis eas igitur, scis namque quod vnam
 Rem poterit fragilem frangere causa levis;
 Femina nam iuuenis nisi preseruata frequenter
 Extat eo fragilis quod genus esse docet:
 Dum nouus in viridi iuuenescit cortice ramus,
 Concuciens tenerum quelibet aura ruet.
 In quibus est claustris sapiens discrecio custos,
 620 Clauditur ex altis sepibus ista seges.
 Facta fuit fragilis de limo carnis origo,
 Sedibus e superis spiritus ille venit:
 Spiritus est promptus, infirma caro; magis ergo
 Noli cum sola solus habere locum:
 Non debet sola cum solo virgo manere,
 Famaque, non tacto corpore, crimen habet.
 Sicut et est claustris, ita sit custodia campis,
 Ludus erit licitus et labor aptus eis:
 Hiis sine labe iocis liceat monialibus vti,
 630 Que pudor et leges et sua iura sinunt.
 Velatas ideo fragilis ne subruat error,
 Sub moderante manu frena pudica iuuant.
 Quid michi, si fallat vxor de fraude maritum,
 Qui nichil vxoris scit neque facta videt?
 Set de fraude sua miror que decipit ipsum, [441](#)
 Cuius in aspectu secula cuncta patent.
 Si sacra sint hominum, quid plus sponsalia Cristi
 Debent more sacro casta manere deo.
 Vestibus in nigris prius est induta puella,
 640 Crinibus abscisis, cum monialis erit;
 Deformat corpus foris, vt sit spiritus intus
 Pulcher, et albescat plenus amore dei.
 Dum foris est nigra, fieret si nigrior intra,
 Non vt amica dei, feda reiecta foret;
 Set dum casta manet, omnis nigredo perextra [442](#)
 Mentem candoris signat habere magis.

**Hic loquitur de castitatis commendacione, que
maxime in religione mulieribus conuenit professis.**

Cap^m. xv. O quam virginitas prior omni laude refulget,
Agnum que sequitur cuncta per arua poli;
Splendet et in terris deitati nupta, relinquens
650 Corporis humani que genus acta docet.
Fetet vt incasta, fragrat sine labe pudica,
Ista deum retinet, illa cadauer habet.
Centeno trina fructu cumulata perornant
Virginis ante deum floridaserta caput:
Angelicas turmas transcendit virginis ordo,
Quam magis in celo trina corona colit.
Iura sequens aquile mens virginis alta cupiscens
Celsius ante deum, teste Iohanne, volat.
Vt rosa de spinis oriens supereminet illas,
660 Sic superat reliquos virginis ille status;
Vt margarita placet alba magis preciosa,
Sic placet in claustro virgo professa deo.⁴⁴³
Talis enim claustris monialis dignior extat
Sanccior et meritis, dum sua vota tenet.
Set quecumque tamen sub velo claustra requirit,
Regula quam seruat sanctificabit eam:
Si fuerit mulier bona, reddit eam meliorem,
Moribus et mores addit vbique magis;
Si polluta prius sit quam velata, que caste
670 Ammodo viuat, erit preuia culpa nichil.
Non licet ergo viris monachas violare sacratas,
Velum namque sacrum signa pudica gerit.
Alterius sponsam presumens deuiolare,
Quam graue iudiciis perpetrat ipse scelus!
Crede tamen grauius peccat, qui claustra resoluens
Presumit sponsam deuiolare dei.

**Postquam tractauit de illis qui in religione
possessoria sui ordinis professionem offendunt,**

**dicendum est iam de hiis qui errant in ordine
fratrum mendicantium; et primo dicet de illis qui sub
ficta paupertatis vmbra terrena lucra conspirantes,
quasi totius mundi dominium subiugarunt.**

Cap^m. xvi. Dum fuit in terris, non omnes quos sibi legit
Cristus, erant fidi, lege nouante dei:
Non tamen est equm, quod crimen preuaricantis
680 Ledat eos rectam qui coluere fidem.
Sic sterilis locus est nullus, quod non sit in illo
Mixta reprobatis vtilis herba malis;
Nec fecundus ita locus est, quo non reprobata
Mixta sit vtilibus herba nociua bonis:
Tam neque iustorum stat concio lata virorum,
Est quibus iniusti mixtio nulla viri.
Sic excusandos, quos sanctos approbat ordo,
Fratres consimili iure fatetur opus:
Non volo pro paucis diffundere crimen in omnes,
690 Spectetur meritis quilibet immo suis;
Quos tamen error agit, veniens ego nuncius illis,
Que michi vox tribuit verba loquenda fero.
Sicut pastor oues, sic segregat istud ab edis
Quos opus a reprobis senserit ordo probos:
Que magis huius habet vocis sententia scribam
Hiis quos transgressos plus notat ordo reos.
Crimina que Iudas commisit ponere Petro
Nolo, ferat proprium pondus vterque suum.
Ordinis officia fateor primi fore sancta,
700 Eius et auctores primitus esse pios;
Hos qui consequitur frater manet ille beatus,
Qui mundum renuens querit habere deum,
Qui sibi pauperiem claustralis adoptat, et vltro
Hanc gerit, et paciens ordinis acta subit:
Talis enim meritis extat laudabilis altis,
Eius nam precibus viuificatur humus.
Set sine materia qui laruat in ordine formam,
Predicat exterius, spirat et intus opes,

Talibus iste liber profert sua verba modernis,
 710 Vt sibi vox populi contulit illa loqui.
 Ordine mendico supervndat concio fratrum,
 De quibus exvndans regula prima fugit:
 Molles deveniunt tales, qui dura solebant
 Ordinis ex voto ferre placenda deo.
 Acephalum nomen sibi dant primo statuendum,
 Seque vocant inopes fert quibus omnis opem:
 Cristi discipulos affirmant se fore fratres,
 Eius et exempli singula iura sequi:
 Hoc mentita fides dicit, tamen hoc satis illis
 720 Conuenit, vt dicunt qui sacra scripta sciunt.
 Sunt quasi nunc gentes nil proprietatis habentes,
 Et tamen in forma pauperis omne tenent.
 Gracia si fuerit aut fatum fratribus istis
 Nescio, set mundus totus habundat eis.
 In manibus retinent papam, qui dura relaxat
 Ordinis et statuit plura licere modo;
 Et si quas causas pape negat ipsa potestas,
 Clam faciet licitas ordo sinister eas.
 Nec rex nec princeps nec magnas talis in orbe est,
 730 Qui sua secreta non fateatur eis.
 Et sic mendici dominos superant, et ab orbe
 Vsurpant tacite quod negat ordo palam.
 Non hos discipulos, magis immo deos fore dicam,
 Mors quibus et vita dedita lucra ferunt:
 Mortua namque sibi, quibus hic confessor adhesit,
 Corpora, si fuerint digna, sepulta petit;
 Set si corpus inops fuerit, nil vindicat ipse,
 Nam sua nil pietas, sint nisi lucra, sapit.
 Baptizare fidem nolunt, quia res sine lucro
 740 Non erit in manibus culta vel acta suis.
 Vt sibi mercator emit omne genus specierum,
 Lucra quod ex multis multa tenere queat;
 Sic omnes mundi causas amplectit auarus
 Frater, vt in variis gaudeat ipse lucris.
 Hii sunt quos retinens mundus non horruit, immo

Diligit, hiisque statum tradidit ipse suum:
Istos conuersos set peruersos magis esse
Constat, vt ex factis nomina vera trahant.
Transtulit a vite se palmes sic pharisea,
750 Eius et in gustu fructus acerbus olet.

**Hic loquitur de fratribus illis, qui per ypocrisim
predicando populi peccata publice redarguentes,
blandiciis tamen et voluptatibus clanculo deseruiunt.**

Cap^m. xvii. Semināt ypocrisis sermones dedita fratris,
Messis vt inde sui crescat in orbe lucri.
Horrida verba tonat, dum publica per loca dampnat
Vsum peccandi seruus vt ipse dei;
Seruus et vt Sathane, priuatis cum residere
Venerit in thalamis, glosa remittit eis;
Et quos alta prius stimulabat vox reboantis,
Postera blandicies vnget in aure leuis:
Et sic peccator aliis peccata ministrat,
760 Namque fouens vicium percipit inde lucrum.
Hoc bene scit frater, peccatum cum moriatur,
Tunc moritur lucrum tempus in omne suum.
Dic vbi ter veniet frater, nisi lucra reportet,
Est vbi sors vacua, non redit ipse via.
De fundamentis fratrum si crimina tollas,
Sic domus alta diu corruet absque manu.
O quam prophete iam verificantur Osee
Sermones, qui sic vera locutus ait:
'In terris quedam gens surget, que populorum
770 Peccatum comedet et mala multa sciet.'
Hancque propheciam nostris venisse diebus
Cernimus, atque notam fratribus inde damus,
Ad quorum victum, fuerit quodc u m q u e n e c e s s e,
Sors de peccatis omne ministrat eis.
Delicie tales non sunt, que fratribus escam,
Si confessores sint, aliquando negant.

Aspicis vt veniunt ad candida tecta columbe,
Nec capiet tales sordida turris aues:
Sic nisi magnatum dat curia nulla modernis
780 Fratribus hospicium quo remanere volunt.
Horrea formice tendunt ad inania numquam,
Nec vagus amissas frater adibit opes:
Immemores florum gestaminis anterioris,
Contempnunt spinam cum cecidere rose;
Sic et amicitie fratres benefacta prioris
Diuitis aspernunt, cum dare plura nequit.
 Nomine sunt plures, pauci tamen ordine fratres;
Vt dicunt aliqui, Pseudo prophetat ibi.
Est facies tunice pauper, stat cistaque diues,
790 Sub verbis sanctis turpia facta latent:
Sic sine pauperie pauper, sanctus sine Cristo,
Eminet ille bonus, qui bonitate caret.
Ore deum clamant isti, venerantur et aurum
Corde, viam cuius vndique scire volunt.
Omnia sub pedibus demon subiecit eorum,
Ficta set ypocrisis nil retinere docet:
Sic mundana tenet qui spernit in ordine mundum,
Dum tegit hostilem vestis ouina lupum;
Et sic ficticiis plebs incantata putabit⁴⁴⁴
800 Sanctos exterius, quos dolus intus habet.
Vix est alterius fraudem qui corripit vnus,
Set magis vt fallant auget vterque dolos:
Sic magis infecti morbo iactantur eodem,
Inficiuntque suis fraudibus omne solum.
Comprimat hos dominus saltem, quos nouit in isto
Tempore primeuam preuaricare fidem.
Non peto quod periant, set fracti consolidentur,⁴⁴⁵
Et subeant primum quem dedit ordo statum.

**Hic loquitur de fratribus illis, qui propter huius
mundi famam, et vt ipsi eciam, quasi ab ordinis sui
iugo exempti, ad confessiones audiendum digniores**

**efficiantur, summas in studio scole cathedras
affectant.**

Cap^m. xviii. Est qui precessor fiat velut ipse minister,
810 Cuius in exemplum Cristus agebat idem:
Set qui discipulum Cristi se dicit, ad altum⁴⁴⁶
Cum venit ipse statum, non tenet inde modum.
Quamuis signa tenet mendici pauperis, ecce
Frater honore suum spirat habere locum:
Appetit ipse scolis nomen sibi ferre magistri,
Quem post exemptum regula nulla ligat:
Solutus habet cameram, propriat commune, que nullum
Tunc sibi claustralem computat esse parem.
Vt latrunculis statuis claustrales ferre magistris
820 Debent et pedibus flectere colla suis:
Sic tumor et pompa latitant sub theologia,
Ducere nec duci dum fauet ordo sibi.
Tunc thalamos penetrat sublimes, curia nulla
Est cuius porta clauditur ante virum.
Aspiciens varias species variatur et ipse
Camelion, et tot signa coloris habet:
Frater ei similis, perpendens velle virorum,
Vult in consimili par sit vt ipse pari;
Et quia sic similem sibi sentit curia fratrem,
830 Eius in aduentu presulis acta vacant.
Circuit exterius, explorat et interiora,
Non opus occultum nec locus extat ei:
Nunc medicus, nunc confessor, nunc est mediator,
Et super et subter mittit ad omne manum.
Spiritus vt domini, sic frater spirat vbique,
Et venit ad lectum quando maritus abest:
Sic absente viro temerarius intrat adulter
Frater, et alterius propriat acta sibi:
Sic venit ad strati capitata cubicula lecti,
840 Sepius et prima sorte futurus erit.
Sic genitus Salomon est hac que nupsit Vrie,
Dum pius intrusor occupat inde locum:

Sponsi defectus suplet deuocio fratris,
 Et genus amplificans atria plena facit.
 Verberat iste vepres, volucrem capit alter; et iste
 Seminat in fundum, set metet alter agrum:
 In stadio currunt ambo, brauium tamen vnus
 Accipit iniuste longius ipse retro:
 Sic intrat sponsus aliorum sepe labores,
 850 Ac vbi non soluit in lucra, vana tamen.
 Credit et exultat prolem genuisse maritus,
 Vngula nec prolis pertinet vna sibi.
 Predicat ypocrita cum sponso carmina sancta,
 Vt deus ex verbo staret in ore suo:
 Cum sponsa Veneris laudes decantat, et eius
 Officium summe suplet honore dee:
 Sic opus in basso tenementum construit altum,
 Cuius egens nocte fabrica poscit opem.
 O pietas fratris, que circuit et iuuat omnes,
 860 Et gerit alterius sic pacienter onus:
 O qui non animas tantum, set corpora nostra,
 In sudore suo sanctificare venit.
 Hic est confessor domini non, set dominarum, [447](#)
 Qui magis est blandus quam Titiuillus eis:
 Hic est confessor quasi fur quem furca fatetur,
 Sic quia ius nostrum de muliere rapit.
 Hic est confessor in peius qui male vertit,
 Sordida namque lauans sordidiora facit:
 Pellem pro pelle, quod habet sibi frater et omne
 870 Pro nostri sponsa, se dabit atque sua.
 O condigna viro tali quis premia reddet,
 Aut deus aut demon? vltima verba ligant.
 Peccati finis fert namque stipendia mortis,
 Est dum culpa vetus plena pudore nouo:
 Horum, viuentes qui tot miracula prestant,
 In libro mortis nomina scripta manent.
 Inter apes statuit natura quod esse notandum
 Sencio, quo poterit frater habere notam.
 Nam si pungat apes, pungenti culpa repugnat,

880 Amplius vt stimulum non habet ipse suum;
Postque domi latebras tenet et non euolat vltra,
Floribus vt campi mellificare queat.
O deus, in simili forma si frater adulter
Perderet inflatum, dum stimulare, acum,
Amplius vt flores non colligat in muliere,
Nec vagus a domibus pergat in orbe suis!
Causa cessante quia tunc cessaret ab ipsis
Effectus, quo nunc plura pericla latent.

**Hic loquitur qualiter isti fratres inordinate
viuentes ad ecclesie Cristi regimen non sunt
aliquaqualiter necessarii.**

Cap^m. xix. Vna michi mira res est, quam mente reuoluens
890 Nescio finali qua ratione foret.
Quam prius ordo fuit fratrum, quoscumque necesse
Congruit ecclesie fertur inesse gradus.
Papa fuit princeps, alios qui substituebat,
Vt plebem regerent singula iura dedit:
Ius sibi presul habet, sub eo curatus, et ille
Admittens curas pondera plebis agit:
Proprietarius est presul qui proprietatem
Curato tribuit, qua sua iura regat:
Presulis inde loco curatus iurat, vt ipse
900 Tempore iudicii que tulit acta dabit.
Est igitur ratio que vel tibi causa videtur,
Alterius proprium quod sibi frater habet?
Inter aues albas vetitur consistere coruum,
Quem notat ingratum quodlibet esse pecus;
Inter et ecclesie ciues consistere fratrem,
Qui negat eius onus, omnia iura vetant.
Caucius in rebus dubiis est semper agendum,
Causa nec est mundi talis vt ipsa dei:
Si tamen vsurpet mundi quis iura, refrenant
910 Legis eum vires nec variare sinunt.

Que mea sunt propria mundo si tolleret alter,
Taliter iniustum lex reputabit eum:
In preiudicium partis lex non sinit equa,
Possit vt alterius alter habere locum:
Que bona corporea sunt alterius, nequit alter
Tollere, ni legum condita iura neget:
Set que sunt anime frater rapiens aliena,
Nescio qua lege iustificabit opus.
Si dic a t, 'Papa dispensat,' tunc videamus,
920 Est sibi suggestum, sponte vel illud agit.
Papa mero motu scimus quod talia numquam
Concessit, set ea supplicat ordo frequens:
Papa potest falli, set qui videt interiora,
Est hoc pro lucri scit vel amore dei.
Lingua petit curas anime, mens postulat aurum,
Bina sicque manu propria nostra rapit:
Defraudans animas, talis rapit inde salutem,
Et super hoc nostras tollere temptat opes.
Non ita Franciscus peciit, set singula linquens
930 Mundi pauperiem simplicitate tulit.
Gignit humus tribulos, vbi torpet cultor in agris,
Quo minus ad messes fert sua lucra Ceres:
Pungitur ecclesia, fratrum quos sentit abortos
Inuidie stimulis lesa per omne latus.
Quilibet ergo bonus tribulos extirpet arator,
Ne pharisea sacrum polluat herba locum.

**Hic loquitur qualiter isti fratres inordinate
viuentes ad commune bonum vtiles aliququaliter non
existunt.**

Cap^m. xx. Fratribus vt redimant celum non est labor Ade,
Quo sibi vel reliquis vina vel arua colunt;
Corporis immo quies, quam querunt forcus, illos
940 Iam fouet, et mundi tedia nulla grauant:
Hiis neque perspicuus armorum pertinet actus,

Publica quo seruant iura vigore suo:
 Sic neque milicies neque terre cultus adornat
 Hos, set in orbe vagos linqvit vterque status.
 Nec sunt de clero f r a t r e s, quamvis sibi temptent
 Vsurpare statum, quem sinit vmbra scole:
 Non onus admittunt fratres cleri set honorem,
 In cathedra primi quo residere petunt.
 Non curant animas populi neque corpora pascunt:
 950 Ad commune bonum quid magis ergo valent?
 Vt neque ramosa numerabis in ilice glandes,
 Tu fratrum numerum dinumerare nequis:
 Immo, velut torrens vndis pluuiialibus auctus,
 Aut niue, que zephiro victa tepente fluit,
 Ordo supercreuit habitu, set ab ordine virtus
 Cessit, et in primis desinit ire viis.
 Si ratio fieret, famulorum poscit egestas
 Tales quod sulcus posset habere suos.
 Hos Daudid affirmat hominum nec inesse labore,
 960 Nec posite legis vlla flagella pati.
 Regia i u r a n i c h i l aut presulis acta valebunt,
 Excessus fratrum quo moderare queant.
 Que sua sunt mundus ea diligit, fratribus ergo
 Attulit vt caris prospera queque suis:
 Non sulcant neque nent, falcant nec in horrea ponunt;
 Pascit eos mundus non tamen inde minus.
 Pectora sic gaudent, nec sunt attrita dolore,
 Anterior celo dum reputatur humus:
 Cordis in affectum sic transit frater, et illum
 970 Quem querit cursum complet in orbe suum.
 Dic quid honoris habet, si filius Hectoris arma
 Deserit et vecors predicat acta patris?
 Aut quid et ipse valet, si frater Apostata sanctum
 Clamat Franciscum, quem negat ipse sequi?
 Fictis set verbis mundi sine lumine sensum
 Obfuscant, que sua sic maledicta tegunt:
 Sic vbi non ordo, manet error in ordinis vmbra,
 Et quasi laruatus stat sacer ordo nouus.

Hiis qui Francisci seruant tamen ordine iusto
980 Debita mandata, debitus extat honor.

**Hic loquitur de fratribus illis, qui incautos pueros
etatis discrecionem non habentes in sui ordinis
professionem attractando colloquiis blandis
multipliciter illaqueant.**

Cap^m. xxi. Est michi suspectum de fratribus hoc, quod eorum
Reddere se primo nullus adultus adest:
Non sic Franciscum puerilis traxerat etas
Ordinis ad votum, quando recepit eum:
Sic nec eum pueri primo coluere sequaces,
Nec blande lingue fabula traxit eos.
Estimo maturos Franciscus sumpserat annos,
Dum per discreta viscera cepit opus;
Et puto quod similes sua dogmata sponte sequentes
990 Nec prece nec precio reddidit ordo deo.
Set vetus vsus abest, nam circumvencio facta
Nunc trahit infantes, qui nichil inde sciunt;
Et sic de teneri tener ordo mollia querit,
Vmbraque sola manet atque nouerca quasi.
Vt vocat ad laqueos volucrem dum fistulat auceps,
Sic trahit infantes fratris ab ore sonus:
Vt laqueatur auis laqueorum nescia fraudis,
Sic puer in fratrem fraude latente cadit:
Et cum sic poterit puerum vetus illaqueare,
1000 Debet ob hoc frater nomen habere patris.
Sic generata dolis patrem sequitur sua proles,
Addit et ad patrios facta dolosa dolos;
Solaque sic radix centenos inficit ex se
Ramos, qui fructus fraudis in orbe ferunt.
Nam puer a veteri deceptus fratre per illud
Decipit exemplum, quando senecta venit:
Sic post decipiunt qui primo decipiuntur,
Et fraus de fraude multiplicata viget:

Sic crescit numerus fratrum, fit et ordo minutus,
1010 Dum miser in miseris gaudet habere pares.
‘Ve, qui proselitum vobis faciatis vt vnum,
Mundum circuitis,’ dixerat ipse deus:[448](#)
Illud erat dictum phariseis, et modo possum
Fratribus hec verba dicere lege noua.

**Hic loquitur de apostazia fratrum ordinis
mendicantium, precipue de hiis qui sub ficta
ypocrisis simplicitate quasi vniuersorum curias
magnatum subuertunt, et inestimabiles suis ficticiis
sepissime causant errores.**

Cap^m. xxii. Vt bona multa bonum fratrem quocumque sequuntur,
Sic mala multa malum constat vbique sequi.
Sunt etenim domini tres, quorum quilibet vni
Seruit homo, per quem se petit ipse regi:
Est deus, est mundus, est demon apostata, cuius
1020 Ordine transgressus fert sibi frater onus.
Regula namque dei non nouit eum, neque mundi
Dat sibi milicies libera nulla statum:
Non habet ipse deum, nec habere valet sibi mundum,
Demonis vt proprium sic subit ipse iugum:
Omnis enim vicii viciosus apostata motor
Aut fautor nutrit quod videt esse malum.
Testis erit Salomon, vir talis inuutilis extat,
Et peiora sue crimina mentis agit:
Arte vel ingenio, quo talis in orbe frequentat,
1030 Ducit in effectum plura timenda satis.
Non obstat paries illi, non clausa resistunt,
Inuia consistunt peruia queque sibi:
Per mare, per terras, per totum circuit orbem;
Vt sibi plus placeat, cernere cuncta potest.
Nititur in fraudes, componit verba dolosa,
Auget et accumulatur multiplicatque dolos;
Proponit lites, rixas accendit in iram,

Liuores nutrit invidiamque fouet;
 Vincula dirumpit pacis, socialis amoris
 1040 Federa perturbat, dissociatque fidem;
 Suggestit incestum, suadet violare pudorem,
 Soluere coniugium, commaculare thorum;
 Vsurpando fidem vultum mentitur honestum,
 Caucius vt fraudem palleat ipse suam.
 In dampnis dandis promissor vbique fidelis,
 Comoda si dederit, disce subesse dolum:
 Sub grossa lana linum subtile tenetur,
 Simplicitas vultus corda dolosa tegit;
 Lingua venenato dum verba subornat in ore,
 1050 Mellificat virus melque venena facit.
 Vt sub virtutum specie lateat viciorum
 Actus, et vt turpis Simea fiat homo;
 Ipse tumens humilem mentitur sepe professum,
 Quem fugit occulto spiritus ille dei.
 Ordinis ipse sacri quicquid Franciscus honeste
 Virtutis statuit, hic viciare studet:
 Cuncta colore tamen operit, facieque decora
 Fallit, dumque latent viscera plena dolo.
 Inuenies scriptum quod pennas strucio gestat
 1060 Herodii pennis ancipitrisque pares;
 Set non tam celeri viget eius penna volatu,
 Ypocritamque notat, qui simulando volat.
 Aurea facta foras similans ypocrita fingit,
 Set mala mens intus plumbea vota gerit:
 Sunt etenim multi tales qui verba colorant,
 Qui pascunt aures, aurea verba sonant,
 Verbis frondescunt, set non est fructus in actu,
 Simplicium mentes dulce loquendo mouent:
 Set templum domini tales excludit, abhorret
 1070 Verborum phaleras, verba polita fugit.
 Scripta poetarum, que sermo pictus inaurat,
 Aurea dicuntur lingua, set illa caue:⁴⁴⁹
 Est simplex verbum fidei bonus vnde meretur,
 Set duplex animo predicat absque deo.

Despiciat eloquia deus omnia, quando polita
 Tecta sub eloquii melle venena fouent:
 Qui bona verba serit, agit et male, turpiter errat,
 Nam post verba solet accio sancta sequi.
 Quos magis alta scola colit, hii sermone polito
 1080 Scandala subtili picta colore serunt.
 Sepius aut lucrum vel honoris adepcio vani⁴⁵⁰
 Fratrum sermones dat magis esse reos:
 Sub tritici specie zizannia sepe refundunt,
 Dum doctrina tumens laudis amore studet:
 Sepe suis meritis ascribere facta, mouere
 Scisma, peritorum mens studiosa solet.
 Phiton siue Magus est scismaticus, quia turbat
 Verum quod credis et dubitanda mouet;
 Set contra voces incantantis sapienter
 1090 Aures obtura, ne cor adheret eis.
 Non sunt hii fratres recti nec amore fideles
 Ecclesie Cristi, sicut habetur ibi;
 Imperfecta magis Sinagoga notabit eorum
 Doctrinam, plene que neque vera docet:
 Multociens igitur aliis nocet illa superba
 Copia librorum quos Sinagoga tenet.
 Non sunt ecclesie recti ciues, Agar immo
 Parturit ancilla, perfida mater, eos:
 Ergo recedat Agar, pariat quoque Sarra fidelem
 1100 Ecclesie clerum, det Sinagoga locum.
 Plantauit pietas et amor primordia fratrum,
 Quos furor ad presens ambiciosus agit:
 Frater adest Odium, qui federa pacis abhorret,
 Cuius ab inferno cepit origo viam;
 Ille professus enim claustralia iura resoluit,
 Nec fore concordēs quos sinit ipse pares.
 Qui tamen in culpa frater se sentit, et illam
 Non delet, tali talia verba loquor:
 ‘Culpa mali laudem non debet tollere iusto,
 1110 Nam lux in tenebris fulget honore magis:
 Quisque suum portabit onus, culpetur iniquus,

Laudeturque suis actibus ipse bonus.'

Hic loquitur qualiter isti fratres mendicantes mundum circuiendo amplioresque querendo delicias de loco in locum cum ocio se transferunt: loquitur eciam de superfluis eorum edificiis, que quasi ab huius seculi potencioribus vltra modum delicate construuntur.

Cap^m. xxiii. Iudeos spersos fratrum dispersio signat,
Quos modo per mundum deuius error agit;
Iste nec ille loco stabilis manet, immo vicissim
Se mouet, et varia mutat vbique loca.
Sic in circuitu nunc ambulat impius orbis,
Nec domus est in qua non petit ipse locum;
Pauperis in specie sibi sic elemosina predas
1120 Prebet, et ora lupi vellere laruat ouis:
Absque labore suo bona nemo meretur, et ergo
Omne solum lustrant, idque piamen habent.
Nescio si supera sibi clausurit ostia celum;
Dat mare, dant ampnes, totaque terra viam.
Hoc lego, quod raro crescit que sepe mouetur
Planta, set ex sterili sorte frequenter eget:
Non tamen est aliqua quin regula fallit in orbe,
Mocio nam fratris crescere causat eum;
Nam quocumque suos mouet ille per arida gressus,
1130 Mundus eum sequitur et famulatur ei.
Vt pila facta pilis solito dum voluitur ipsis
Crescit, et ex modico magnificatur opus,
Sic, vbi se voluit frater, sibi mundus habundat,
Quicquid et ipse manu tangit adheret ei:
Federa cum mundo sua frater apostata stringit,
Sic vt in occulto sint quasi semper idem.
Multis set quedam virtutes esse videntur,
Qui nil virtutis nec bonitatis habent;
Ista dabunt vocem, set erunt deformia mente,

- 1140 Multaque dum fiunt absque salute placent.
Ad decus ecclesie deuocio seruit eorum,
Et veluti quedam signa salutis habent:
Eminet ecclesia constructa sibi super omnes,
Edificant petras sculptaque ligna fouent;
Porticibus valuas operosis, atria, quales
Quotque putas thalamos hic laberintus habet:
Ostia multa quidem, varie sunt mille fenestre,
Mille columpnarum marmore fulta domus.
Fabrica lata domus erit, alta decoraque muris,
- 1150 Picturis variis splendet et omne decus;
Omnis enim cella, manet in qua frater inanis,
Sculpture vario compta decore nitet:
Postibus insculpunt longum mansura per eum
Signa, quibus populi corda ligare putant.
Fingentes Cristum mundum querunt, et in eius
Conspirant laudem clamque sequuntur eum:
Talis sub facie deuocio sancta figure
Fingitur, et testis fit magis inde domus:
Qui tamen omne videt, rimatur et intima cordis,
- 1160 Scit quia pro mundo tale paratur opus.
Set docet exemplis historia Parisiensis,
Quod contentus homo sit breuiore domo.
Non sibi de propriis habet vlla potencia regis
Illorum thalamis tecta polita magis:
Non ita fit vestis fratrum nota simplicitatis,
Quin magis in domibus pompa notabit eos.
In fabrice studio vigilat conuentus eorum
Ecclesie, prompti corpore, mente pigri:
Sic patet exterius fratrum deuocio sancta,
- 1170 Vana set interius cordis ymago latet:
Sunt similes vlnō tales, qui sunt sine fructu,
In quibus impietas plurima, pauca fides.
Dic, tibi quid, frater, confert, tantas quod honestas
Cum feda mente construis ipse domos?
Esto domus domini, quam sacris moribus orna,
Virtutem cultor religionis ama.

Omnia fine patent, tibi fingere nil valet extra,
Per quod ab interius premia nulla feres:
Si tibi laus mundi maneat furtiua diebus,
1180 Cum celum perdis, laus erit illa pudor.
Ordinis es, norma tibi sit, nec ab ordine cedas,
Est aliter cassum quicquid ab inde geris.

**Hic loquitur qualiter, non solum in ordine
fratrum mendicantium set etiam in singulis cleri
gradibus, ea que virtutis esse solebant a viciis quasi
generaliter subuertuntur: dicit tamen quod
secundum quasdam Burnelli constitutiones istis
precipue diebus modus et regula specialius⁴⁵¹
obseruantur.**

Cap^m. xxiiii. Diuersat fratres tantummodo vestis eorum,
Hii tamen existunt condicione pares:
Regula nulla manet, fuerat que facta per ante,
Set nouus ordo nouum iam facit omne forum.
Sicut enim fratrum nunc ordo resoluitur, ecce
Ecclesie norma fit quasi tota noua;
Set sacer ordo tamen remanet, quem sanxerat olim
1190 Frater Burnellus, crescit et ille magis.
Hec decreta modo, Burnellus que statuebat,
Omnia non resero nec reserare volo;
Set duo iam tantum que iussit in ordine dicam,
Et sunt presenti tempore iura quasi.
Mandatum primum tibi contulit, omne iocosum,
Quicquid in orbe placet, illud habere licet:
Si vis mercari, sis mercenarius, autem⁴⁵²
Si vis mechari, dat tibi, mechus eris:⁴⁵³
Que magis vlla caro desiderat, illa beato
1200 Sunt fratri nostro debita iura modo.
Precipiens vltra statuit de lege secunda,
Quod nocuum carni sit procul omne tibi:
Omne quod est anime reputatur in ordine vile,

- Et caro delicias debet habere suas:
Cor dissolue tuum, te nullus namque ligabit,
Quo vis vade tuas liber vbique vias.
Mollibus ornatus sic dignior ordo nouellus
Restat Burnelli, vult quia velle viri.
Nil michi Bernardus, nichil ammodo seu Benedictus⁴⁵⁴
1210 Sint, set Burnellus sit Prior ipse meus;
Quo viget en carnis requies, quo lingua precantis
A prece torpescens fit quasi tota silens:⁴⁵⁵
Ordoque sic precibus dum vult succurrere nobis,
Linquo choax ranis et nichil inde magis:⁴⁵⁶
Si veniantque michi mala tempora, credo quod isti⁴⁵⁷
De clero causam dant nimis inde grauem;
Quis poterit namque nobis bona tempora ferre,
Ordine claustrali dum perit ordo dei,
Et fugit a reliquo deuocio celica clero?
1220 Sic fugit a nobis vndique nostra salus.
Nam quia sic medii fallunt discorditer ipsi,
Ignaui populi stamus in orbe vagi.
Quid sibi corpus habet in eo, nisi spiritus extet,
Quid nisi nos clerus suplet in orbe pius?
A planta capiti set qui discernere cleri
Vult genus aut speciem, vix sciet inde bonum.
Sic vbi lux, tenebre, sic mors, vbi normula vite
Instrueret sanam gentibus ire viam.
Vt dicunt alii de clero, sic ego dixi,
1230 Quo creuit reliquis error in orbe magis:
Nam sine pastore grex est dispersus, et ecce
Pascua peccati querit vbique noui.

1221-1232. *Text* STH₂ *As follows in* CEHGD_L,

Nunc quia sic Cleri sors errat ab ordine Cristi,
Vsurpat mundus que negat ipse deus.

Dum tua, Burnelle, scola sit communis in orbe,
 A planta capiti fallitur omnis ibi:
 Sed cum Gregorii scola fulsit in orbe beati,⁴⁵⁸
 Vera fides viguit, cunctaque pace tulit.
 Nunc tamen est Arius nouus, est quasi Iouinianus,
 Doctor in ecclesiis scisma mouendo scolis.
 Sic vbi lux, tenebre, sic mors, vbi regula vite
 1230* Instrueret rectam gentibus ire viam.
 Quilibet ergo bonus, sit miles siue Colonus,
 Orans pro Clero det sua vota deo.

FOOTNOTES:

- [424](#) 14 subtrahet CE
[425](#) 52 erat ... vrbe DL
[426](#) 72 esse SG ipse CEHDL
[427](#) 79 dum CE
[428](#) 103 *No paragr.* S
[429](#) 177 oculis T oculus SCEHGDLH₂
[430](#) 216 rara CE
[431](#) 273 vt (ut) CEHGDLT et S
[432](#) 295 sibi *om.* S (*p. m.*) vir *inserted later* bona qui sibi D
[433](#) Cap. vi. *Heading* 2 f. religionis sibi CE
[434](#) 315 *No paragr.* S
[435](#) 336 iam CEHGDLTH₂ non S
[436](#) 404 ghemendo SH gemendo CEDL
[437](#) 489 fomes est res C fomes res est L
[438](#) *Heading* 1 quasi *om.* D
[439](#) 587 *Marginal note ins.* SCG *om.* EHDH₂ Nota quod Genius secundum
 Ouidium dicitur sacerdos Veneris G
[440](#) 593 ibi SE
[441](#) 635 qui CE
[442](#) 645 *perextra* SHGTL *per extra* CED
[443](#) 662 placet CEH patet SGDL
[444](#) 799 putabit CEHD putabat SGL
[445](#) 807 pereant CEL
[446](#) 811 ad CEHGDL et S
[447](#) 863 sed non D
[448](#) 1012 *margin* Nota C
[449](#) 1072 lingua SH₂ verba CEHGDLT
[450](#) 1081 *adepcio* CEHGDL *adopcio* S
[451](#) *Heading* 5 specialiter S
[452](#) 1197 autem STH₂ et si CEHGDL
[453](#) 1198 *Text* STH₂ Mechari cupias dat tibi GDL Mechari cupias ordine CEH
[454](#) 1209 seu] uel C

[455](#) 1212 *Text* STH₂ Auribus alma sonat menteque vana petit CEHGDL
[456](#) 1214 *Text* STH₂ Folia non fructus percipit inde deus CEHGDL
[457](#) 1215 *Text* STH₂ Si veniant mundi CEHGDL
[458](#) 1225* fulscit HG

**Postquam dictum est de illis qui in statu cleri
regere spiritualia deberent, dicendum est iam de hiis
qui in statu milicie temporalia defendere et
supportare tenentur.**

Incipit liber Quintus.

Cap^m. i. Quid sit de clero dixi, dicamque secundo
Quomodo Militibus competit ordo vetus.
Primo milicia magno fit honore parata;
Est tribus ex causis ipsa statuta prius.
Ecclesie prima debet defendere iura,
Et commune bonum causa secunda fouet;
Tercia pupilli ius supportabit egeni,
Et causam vidue consolidabit ope:
Istis namque modis lex vult quod miles in armis
10 Sit semper bellum promptus adire suum.
Sic etenim miles dudum superauerat hostes,
Vnde sibi fama viuit in orbe noua:
Non propter famam miles tamen arma gerebat,
Set pro iusticia protulit acta sua.
Ordinis ipse modum miles qui seruat eundem,
Debet ob hoc laudes dignus habere suas;
Set si pro laude miles debellet inani,
Est laus iniusta, si tribuatur ita. [459](#)
Dic michi nunc aliud: quid honoris victor habebit,
20 Si mulieris amor vincere possit eum?
Nescio quid mundus michi respondebit ad istud;
Hoc scio, quod Cristi nil sibi laudis erit.
Si quis honore frui cupiat, sibi causet honorem,
Gestet et illud opus, quod sibi suadet onus:
Nil nisi stulticiam pariet sibi finis habendam,
Cui Venus inceptam ducit ad arma viam.
Non decet vt rutili plumbum miscebitur auro,
Nec Venus vt validi militis acta sciat.

30 Quem laqueat mulier non laxat abire frequenter,
Immo magis fatuo voluit amore suo:
Qui prius est liber, facit et se sponte subactum,
Stulcior est stulto sic reputandus homo.
Bella quibus miles fieret captiuus, ab illis
Expedit vt fugiat, vincere quando nequit.
Non vada quo mergi liquet est sapientis vt intret,
Set magis a visa morte refrenet iter.

**Hic loquitur qualiter miles, qui in mulieris
amorem⁴⁶⁰ exardescens ex concupiscencia armorum
se implicat exercicio, vere laudis honorem ob hoc
nullatenus meretur. Describit eciam infirmitates
amoris illius, cuius passionis variis adinuicem
motibus maxime contrariantur.**

Cap^m. ii. O si mutatas miles pensaret amoris
Tam subito formas, non pateretur eas.
Non amor vnicolor est set contrarius in se,
40 Qui sine temperie temperat esse vices;⁴⁶¹
Detegit atque tegit, disiungit amor que reiungit,
Letaque corda suo sepe dolore furit.
Est amor iniustus iudex, aduersa maritans
Rerum naturas degenerare facit:
Consonat Architesis in amore, sciencia nescit,⁴⁶²
Ira iocatur, honor sordet, habundat egens;
Leta dolent, reprobatur laus, desperatio sperat,
Spes metuit, prosunt noxia, lucra nocent;
Anxietas in amore sapit, dulcescit amarum,
50 Vernat yemps, sudant frigora, morbus alit.
Sic magis vt caueas, miles, tibi visa pericla,
Has lege quas formas morbus amoris habet.
Est amor egra salus, vexata quies, pius error,
Bellica pax, vulnus dulce, suaue malum,
Anxia leticia, via deuia, lux tenebrosa,
Asperitas mollis, plumbea massa leuis,

Florescens et yemps et ver sine floribus arens,
Vrticata rosa, lex sine iure vaga,
Flens risus, ridens fletus, modus inmoderatus,
60 Hostilis socius, hostis et ipse pius,
Instabilis constancia, velle sibique repugnans,
Spes sibi desperans et dubitata fides,
Albedo nigra, nigredo splendida, melque
Acre, que fel sapidum, carcer amena ferens,
Irrationalis racio, discrecio stulta,
Ambiguus iudex, inscius omne putans,
Numquam digestus cibus et semper sitibundus
Potus, mentalis insaciata fames,
70 Mors viuens, vita moriens, discordia concors,
Garrula mens, mutus sermo, secreta febris,
Prosperitas pauper, paupertas prospera, princeps
Seruus, regina subdita, rex et egens,
Ebrea sobrietas, demens clemencia, portus⁴⁶³
Cille, pestifera cura, salutis iter:
Mulcebris anguis amor est, agna ferox, leo mitis,
Ancipiter pauidus atque columba rapax,
Infatuata scola reddens magis infatuatum
Discipulum, cuius mens studet inde magis.

**Hic describit formam mulieris speciose, ex cuius
concupiscencia illaqueata militum corda rationis
iudicio sepissime destituuntur.**

Cap^m. iii. Cum pauidus miratur amans candore repletam,
80 In cuius facie stat rubor ille rose,
Aurigeros crines, aures patulas mediocres,
Planiciem frontis, que nitet alba satis,
Impubesque genas, oculos qui solis ad instar
Lucent, et stabilis vultus honestat eos,
Nasum directum naresque decenter apertas,
Labraque melliflua, fragrat et oris odor,
Equales lacte sibi dentes candidiores,

Et formam menti conuenientis ei;
 Splendor et a facie dat eburnea colla nitere,
 90 Guttare cristalli concomitante sibi,
 Et niue candidior nitet eius pectore candor,
 Candida poma cui sunt duo fixa quasi.
 Brachia longa videt pauce crassata rotundo,
 Amplexus quorum celica regna putat,
 Et videt ornatos splendere manus digitosque,
 Lanaque nec mollis mollior astat eis;
 Cernit et insolitos humeros ad onus pueriles,
 Nec patet os in eis, sic stupet inde magis:
 Per latus et gracilem videt elongare staturam,
 100 Linea nec recta reccior astat ea;
 Eius et incessus cernit peditare choreis,
 Passus mensuram denotat atque suam;
 Nil sibi Sirenes equantur voce canentes,
 Nec vox angelica vix sonat vtque sua.
 Et caput amplecti cernit gemmisque nitere,
 Ac vestis pompam que magis aptat eam:
 Compta venit nimium, que vult formosa videri,
 Vnde stupore magis sit semiraptus amans.
 Omnia membra sibi reputantur in ordine tali,
 110 Vt deus in superis fecerat illud opus;
 Discrimen capitis, frons libera, lactea colla,
 Ora, labella, rubor, lumina clara placent;
 Vertex, frons, oculi, nasus, dens, os, gena, mentum,
 Colla, manus, pectus, pes sine labe nitent,
 Vnam nec maculam solam natura reliquit,
 Ad caput a planta transuolat iste decor:
 Humanam speciem transcendit forma puelle,
 Excedens hominem numinis instar habet;
 Pre cunctis aliis, quas ornat gracia forme,
 120 Felix et fenix ista fit absque pare.
 Splendida vestis erit, precinctum flore caputque,
 Flaua verecundus cingit et ora rubor;
 Forma placet niueusque color flauique capilli,
 Estque micans nulla factus ab arte decor:

Vix erit aspiciens qui non capietur ab illa,
Pronus vt in terram vir sua vota ferat;
Ipsa suo vultu si quem concernat amantem,
Heret in opposita lumina fixus homo.

- 130 Qui cum tam dulcem videt ornatam que decoram
Femineam speciem, set magis angelicam,
Hanc putat esse deam, manibus sub cuius adeptam
Dat vite sortem mortis et esse suam:
Dum tam mirificam voluit sibi mente figuram,
Ipse volutus ea non reuolutus abit;
Non capit exterius quid preter eam sibi visus,
Corque per interius pungit amoris acus.
Vt sibi stat saxum non mobile, sic stat et ipse,
Nec mouet a visu, qui velut extasis est;
Sic oculus cordis carnis caligine cecus
140 Languet, et in dampnum decidit ipse suum.
Quod videt, hoc nescit, set quod videt, vritur illo;
Sic furit a ceco cecus amore suo:
Frigidior glacie, feruencior igne cremante,
Sic et in igne gelat, vritur inque gelu:
Sicut auis visco volutans se voluitur illo,
Sic se defendens ardet amore magis.
Sic amor omne domat, quicquid natura creauit,
Et tamen indomitus ipse per omne manet;
Carcerat et redimit, ligat atque ligata resoluit,
150 Subdit et omne sibi, liber et omnibus est;
Naturam stringit, mulcet, minuit que reformat,
Plangit et hoc per eum, nec sine gaudet eo:
Militat in cunctis, nullum vix excipit eius
Regula, nam sanctos sepe dat esse reos;
Legibus aque suis non est transire quietus
Qui valet, ipse tamen cuncta quieta gerit.
Nam quem non poterit probitas, prudencia fallit,
Nec stat vitalis tutus vt obstat eis:
Non amor in penis est par pene Talionis;
160 Vulnerat omne genus, nec sibi vulnus habet:
Sic quia vulnifico fixurus pectora telo

Vibrat amor, caute longius inde fuge.
Est nichil armorum quod prelia vincit amoris,
Nec sua quis firme federa pacis habet.

Credula res amor est subito collapsa dolore,
Nec sciet inceptor quis sibi finis erit.
Non sine stat bello miles qui dicit ad infra,
'O quam me tacitum conscius vrit amor!'

Artibus innumeris mens exagitur amantis,
170 Vt lapis equoreis vndique pressus aquis;
Nobilitas sub amore iacet, que sepe resurgit,
Sepius et nescit nobile quid sit iter:
Semper in incerta varians sub ymagine mentis,
Nunc leuat interius cordaque versat amor:
Cecus amor fatuos cecos sic ducit amantes,
Quod sibi quid deceat non videt vllus amans.
Impetus in furia, dic, quid non audet amoris?
Dum sitit amplexus, scit nichil vnde timet;
Non frondem siluis nec aperto gramina campo
180 Mollia, nec pleno flumine cernit aquas;⁴⁶⁴
Immo quasi cecus sic commoda, sic sibi dampna,
Impetus vt mentem cogit amare, facit.
Non polus aut tellus, Acheron, mare, sydus et ether,
Possunt vi ceptis rebus obesse suis;
Sepe ferens ymbrem celesti nube solutum
Frigidus in nuda sepe iacebit humo:
Nox et yemps longaeque vie seuique dolores
Sunt ea que fatuis premia prestat amor.
Murmura quot seruis, tot sunt in amore dolores,
190 Sunt furor et pietas eius in orbe pares;
Sentit amans dampna, feruens tamen astat in illis,
Materiam pene prosequiturque sue.

O, quia per nullas amor est medicabilis herbas,
Nec vis nec sensus effugit eius onus;
Nullus ab innato valet hoc evadere morbo,
Sit nisi quod sola gracia curet eum.
O natura viri quam sit grauis, unde coactum
Eius ad interitum cogit amare virum!

200 O natura viri, poterit quam tollere nemo,
 Nec tamen excusat quod facit ipsa malum!
 O natura viri, duo que contraria mixta
 Continet, amborum nec licet acta sequi!
 Bella pudicicie carnis mouet illa voluptas;
 Que sibi vult corpus, spiritus illa vetat.
 O natura viri, que naturatur eodem,
 Quod vitare nequit, nec licet illud agi!
 O natura viri, fragilis que vim rationis
 Dirimit, et bruti crimen ad instar habet!
 Nil prosunt artes, furit inmedicabile vulnus;
 210 Sit cum plus sapiens, vir furit inde magis;
 Sique suam vellet flammam compescere quisquam,
 Artem prevideat quam prius ipse cadat.
 Dum freta mitescunt et amor dum temporat vsum, [465](#)
 Tunc inter medium sit cuperanda salus.
 Vinces si fugias, vinceris sique resistas;
 Ne leo vincaris, tu lepus ergo fuge.
 Femina nec flammam nec seuos effugit arcus;
 Quo magis est fragilis, acrior ignis erit:
 Vtque viros mulier fallit, sic vir mulieres,
 220 Dum vulpinus amor verba lupina canit.
 Fallere credentem non est laudanda puellam
 Gloria, set false condicionis opus.
 Est ars nulla viri Veneris subtilior arte,
 Qua sua iura petat arte perhennat amor.

**Hic loquitur quod, vbi in milite mulierum
 dominatur amoris voluptas, omnem in eo vere
 probitatis miliciam extinguit.**

Cap^m. iiii. Non sibi vulnus habet miles probitate timere
 Corporis, vt mundi laus sit habenda sibi,
 Vulnere sed mentis timeat, quam ceca voluptas
 Tela per ignita non medicanda ferit.
 Vulnere corporea sanantur, set quis amore

- 230 Languet, eum sanum non Galienus aget:
Femineos mores teneat si miles, abibit
Orphanus a stirpe nobilitatis honor.
Dum sapiens miles quasi stultus et infatuatus
Incidit in speciem, fama relinquit eum:
Dum carnalis amor animum tenet illaqueatum,
Sensati ratio fit rationis egens:
Dum iubar humani sensus fuscatur in umbra
Carnis, et in carnem mens rationis abit,
Stans hominis ratio calcata per omnia carni
240 Seruit, et ancille vix tenet ipsa locum.
Set tamen in lance non ponderat omnibus eque,
N e c dat condigna premia cecus amor:
Pellit ab officio sine causa sepe fideles,
Infidosque suo sepe dat esse loco:
Denegat ipse michi donum quandoque merenti,
Absque nota meriti quod dabit ipse tibi:
Sicut habes varios sine lumine scire colores,
Sic amor vt cecus dat sua iura viris.
Nunc tamen omnis ei miles quasi seruit, et eius
250 Ad portas sortem spectat habere suam.

**Hic loquitur de militibus illis, quorum vnus
propter mulieris amorem, alter propter inanem
mundi famam, armorum labores exercet; finis tamen
vtriusque absque diuine laudis merito vacuus
pertransit.**

Cap^m. v. Milicie pars vna petit mulieris amorem,
Altera quod mundi laus sonet alta sibi.
Miles vbique nouum spirat temptatque fauorem
Munere lucrari, fama quod astet ei:
Scit tamen inde deus, quo iure cupit venerari,
Si dabit hoc mundus seu mulieris amor.
Si laudem mundi cupiat, tunc copia Cresi
Defluit, vt donis laus sonet alta suis:

Tunc aurum, vestes, gemmas et equos quasi grana
 260 Seminatur, ut laudis crescat in aure seges.
 Sed sibi femineum si miles adoptet amorem,
 Carius hunc precio tunc luet ipse suo:⁴⁶⁶
 Quod sibi natura, sibi vel deus attulit omne,
 Corpus, res, animam, tot dabit inde bona.
 Cum tamen ipse sui perfecerit acta laboris,
 Laus et utraque simul perfida fallat eum,
 Cum nec fama loquax mundi peruenit ad aures,
 Nec sibi castus amor reddit amoris opem,
 Tunc deceptus ait, 'Heu, quam fortuna sinistrat!
 270 Cum labor a longo tempore cassus abit.'
 Tardius ipse venit, qui sic sibi plangit inepte,
 Cum sibi non alius causa sit ipse doli.
 Fert mundus grauias, fert femina set grauiora;
 Hic mouet, illa ruit, hic ferit, illa necat.
 Cum vicisse putet miles sibi vim mulieris,
 Hec et amore pio cuncta petita fauet,
 Vincitur ipse magis tunc quando magis superesse
 Se putat, et mulier victa revincit eum.
 Aut etiam mundi famam si miles adoptet,
 280 Numquid et ipsa breui tempore vana perit.
 O, cur sic miles mundi sibi querit honores,⁴⁶⁷
 Cuius honor mundi stat sine laude dei,
 Vulgi vaniloqui sermones miles honorem
 Credit, et hos precio mortis habere cupit?
 Nil tamen ipse cauet dum vincitur a muliere,
 Quo reus ante deum perdit honoris opem.
 Quid sibi vult igitur audacia sic animosa
 Militis in vacuum, que ratione caret?
 Laus canitur frustra, nisi laudis sit deus auctor;
 290 Dedecus est et honor qui sonat absque deo.
 Nescio quid laudis cupit aut sibi miles honoris,
 Dum deus indignum scit fore laudis eum.

**Hic loquitur interim de commendacione mulieris
bone, cuius condicionis virtus approbata omnes
mundi delicias transcendit: loquitur eciam de muliere
mala, cuius cautelis vix sapiens resistit.**

Cap^m. vi. Vna fuit per quam mulier deus altus ad yma
Venit, et ex eius carne fit ipse caro,
Cuius honore magis laudande sunt mulieres
Hee quibus est merito laudis agendus honor.
De muliere bona bona singula progrediuntur,
Cuius honestus amor prebet amoris opem:
Preualet argento mulier bona, preualet auro,
300 Condignum precii nilque valebit ei;
Lingua referre nequit aut scribere penna valorem
Eius, quam bonitas plena decore notat.
Nobilis in portis reuerendus vir sedet eius,
Hospiciumque suum continet omne bonum:
Vestibus ornantur famuli, quas ordine duplo
Eius in actiuis fert operosa manus:
Ocia nulla suos temptant discurrere sensus,
Quos muliebris ope seruat vbique pudor.
Sic laudanda bona meritis est laude perhenni,
310 Quam mala lingua loquax demere nulla potest.
Que tamen econtra mulier sua gesserit acta,
Non ideo reliquas polluit ipsa bonas:
Sunt nichil illa probo cum de vecorde loquamur,
Improba nec iustos scandala furis habent.
Sit licet absurdum nomen meretricis, ab illo
Quam pudor obseruat femina nulla capit;
Sit licet infamis meretrix, tamen illa pudicas
Non fedat fedo nomine feda suo.
Hic bonus, ille malus est angelus vnus et alter,
320 Nec valet vlla mali culpa nocere bono;
Nec decet infamis nomen mulieris honeste
Ledere, vel laudem tollere posse suam.
Fetida dumque rose se miscet inuutilis herba,
Non tamen est alia quam fuit ante rosa:

Semper erat quod erit, vbi culpa patens manifestat⁴⁶⁸
 Crimina, quale vident hoc opus ora canunt.
 Quod tamen hic scribam, sit saluo semper honore
 Hiis quibus obseruat gesta pudoris honor:
 Ergo quod hic agitur, culpandas culpa figurat,
 330 Quo laus laudandis sit tribuenda magis.
 Scire malum prodest, potius vitemus vt illud,
 Labile pre manibus et caueamus iter.
 De muliere mala mala queque venire solebant,
 Est etenim pestis illa secunda viris:
 Femina dulce malum mentem, decus ipsa virile,
 Frangit, blandiciis insidiosa suis;
 Sensus, diuicias, virtutes, robora, famam
 Et pacem variis fraudibus ipsa ruit.
 Mille modis fallit, subtiles milleque tendit
 340 Insidias, vnus vt capiatur homo.
 Femina talis enim gemmis radiantibus, auro,
 Vestibus, vt possit fallere, compta venit:
 Aptantur vestes, restringitur orta mamilla,
 Dilatat collum pectoris ordo suum;
 Crinibus et velis tinctis caput ornat, et eius
 Aurea cum gemmis pompa decorat opus:
 Vt magis exacuat oculos furientis in illam,
 Anulus in digitis vnus et alter erit.
 Non erit huius opus lanam mollire trahendo,
 350 Set magis vt possit prendere compta viros:
 Se quoque dat populo mulier speciosa videndam;
 Quem trahit e multis forsitan vnus erit.
 Ha quociens fictis verbis exardet amator,
 Dum temptat forme subdola lingua bone!
 In vicio decor est, mulier si verba placendi
 Non habet, vt fatuos prouocet inde viros;
 Crebraque complexis manibus suspiria mittit,
 Nec sibi pollicito pondere verba carent:
 Sepe sonat raucum quoddam, set amabile ridet,
 360 Blesaque fit bleso lingua coacta sono.
 Quo non ars poterit? discit lacrimare decenter,

Fallat vt hos vultu quos neque sermo trahit;
 Vultibus et lacrimis in falsa cadentibus ora
 Decipit et fingit vix sibi posse loqui;
 Et quociens opus est, fallax egrotat amica,
 Vultus et exterius absque dolore dolet.
 Monstra maris Sirenes erant, que voce canora
 Quaslibet admissas detenuere rates;⁴⁶⁹
 Sic qui blandicias audit solito muliebres,
 370 Non valet a lapsu saluus abire pedem.
 Pingere sicut habet multas manus vna figuras,
 Que variis formis diuaricabit opus,
 Sola sibi varios mulier sic auget amantes,
 Quos Venus in fatuam credere cogit opem.
 Quod natura sibi sapiens dedit, illa reformat,
 Et placet in blesis subdola lingua suis;
 Eius enim plures fatuos facundia torquet,
 Dum modo ridendo, nunc quoque flendo placet.
 Sic fragili pingit totas in corpore partes,
 380 Addit et ad formam quam deus ipse dedit.
 Huius ego crimen detestor ferre loquele,
 Quam magis expertus alter ab ante tulit;
 Codice nempe suo referam que carmina vates
 Rettulit Ouidius, nec michi verba tenent.
 Vtque suum iuuenis mulier seruare decorem
 Temptat et in variis amplificare studet,
 Sic vetus amissi speciem renouare coloris
 Spirat, et vnguentis sollicitabit opus.
 Horrida sicut yemps agit vt neque lilia florent,⁴⁷⁰
 390 Set riget amissa spina relictæ rosa,⁴⁷¹
 Sic rapit a forma veteres etas mulieres,
 Maior et est ruga quo solet esse rubor.
 Dextra senectutis, tunc cum sit discolor etas,
 Protegit antiquas picta colore genas:
 Nam modus est tali casu quod femina vultum
 Comat, vt vnguentis splendeat ipsa magis.
 Arte supercilia mensurat, labraque rubro,
 Gracius vt placeant, mixta colore iuuat;

400 Sepeque caniciem medicantibus ornat in herbis,
 Et melior primo queritur arte color;
 Sepeque precedit densissima crinibus empta,
 Proque suis alios efficit esse suos;
 Sicque venit rutilus humeros protecta capillis,
 Et vultum iuuenis arte requirit anus.
 Sepe crocum sumit, croceo velatur amictu,
 Quo minus ex proprio lesa colore patet.
 Quot noua terra parit flores in vere tepenti,
 Tot habet ad curas femina feda suas.
 Non omnes vna pulcras se pingere forma⁴⁷²
 410 Crede, set est vsa quelibet arte sua;
 Ista petit roseum, niueum cupit illa decorem,
 Ista suos vultus pingit, et illa lauat;
 Altera ieiunat misere minuitque cruorem,
 Et prorsus quare palleat ipsa facit;
 Nam que non pallet sibi rustica queque putatur,
 'Hic decet, hic color est verus amantis,' ait.
 Mille modis nostras impugnat femina mentes,⁴⁷³
 Si tibi non videas, illico captus eris.
 Feminei sensum virus tibi tollit amoris,
 420 Recia cuius enim gracia sola fugit.
 Ista dat amplexus dulces et mollia figit
 Oscula, set tacito corde venena premit:
 Fraudibus vxorum multi periere virorum,
 Femina nil horret, cuncta licere putat;
 Audet quicquid eam iubet imperiosa libido,
 Et metus et ratio cedit et ipse pudor:
 Sepius esse solet quia pugnat forma pudori,
 Raro de pulcris esse pudica potest.
 Ve cui stulta comes sociali federe nupsit!
 430 Non erit illius absque dolore thorax:
 Federa seruasset, si non formosa fuisset,
 Sponsa, que multociens res docet ista patens.
 Quam Venus inspirat seruat custodia nulla,
 Ad fatuam nullus limes agendus erit:
 Cum Venus et mulier tempus que locum sibi spirant,

Non caret effectu quod voluere duo:
Frustratur custos mulieris, dum tamen ipsa
Se non custodit, si foret ipse Cato.
Tunc prius incipient turre vitare columbe,
440 Antra fere, pecudes gramina, mergus aquas,
Femina cum Veneris fatuum scrutetur amantem,
Et non inueniat ad sua facta locum.
Littora quot conchas, quot amena rosaria flores,
Quotque soporifera grana papauer habet,
Silua feras quot alit, quot piscibus vnda natatur,
Et tener ex pennis aera pulsat auis,
Non faciunt summam talem, que dicitur eque
Ad mala que mulier insidiosa parat.
Est mundus fallax, mulier fallacior ipso,
450 Senciit infidam nam paradisus eam:⁴⁷⁴
Est lupus ecce latens agni sub vellere mundus,
Quo lambit primo, fine remordet eo.
Hoc tamen est extra, set serpentina columba
Prouocat in thalamis dampna propinqua magis;⁴⁷⁵
Hec etenim serpens est, que per mille meandros
Decipit, et pungens corda quieta ferit.
Quis fortis manet aut sapiens illesus ab ipsa,
Celicus est, set eam vincere terra nequit:
Sampsonis vires gladius neque Dauid in ipsam
460 Quid laudis, sensus aut Salomonis habent.
Vt quid ad huc miles temptat superare modernus,
Vincere quod tanti non potuere viri?
Non est quem faciunt transacta pericula cautum,
Set magis in laqueos quos videt ipse cadit.
Quis vetat a magnis ad res exempla minores
Sumere? set noster non sinit illud amor.
Impetuosus agit pugnam gladiator, et idem
Immemor antiqui vulneris arma capit.

**Hic loquitur qualiter milicia bene disposita
omnibus aliis gradibus quibuscumque commune**

securitatis prestat emolumentum.

Cap^m. vii. O quam milicia terra consistit in ista
470 Audax, preclara, si bene viuat ea!⁴⁷⁶
Si non pro mundi lucro neque laude laboret,⁴⁷⁷
Indomitus nec amor ferrea corda domet,
Miles perpetue laudis tunc vincet honore,
Nomen et eternum nobilitabit eum.
Si bona milicia fuerit, deus astat in illa,
Vincat vt invicto miles in ense suo:
Si bona milicia fuerit, vigilat bona fama,⁴⁷⁸
Que iacet in lecto victa sopore modo:
Si bona milicia fuerit, tum pace reviuat
480 Sponsus cum sponsa preparat acta sua:
Si bona milicia fuerit, tunc hostis ab illa
Sternitur ecclesie, crescit et ipsa fide:
Si bona milicia fuerit, taxacio dura
Que sonat in patria tunc erit absque nota:
Si bona milicia, tunc non tardabit adesse
Pax, cum qua redeunt prospera cuncta simul.
Qui bonus est miles nequit exercere pauorem,
Nec tepide mentis intima lesa gerat:
Qui bonus est miles mundi terit omne superbum,
490 Vincit et ex humili corde maligna ferus:
Qui bonus est miles pro Cristi nomine certat,
Et rem communem protegit ipse manu:
Qui bonus est miles probat et bene scit quod in orbe
De belli fine pacis origo venit;
Talis enim miles de vera laude meretur
Quicquid in hoc mundo regula laudis habet.

**Hic loquitur qualiter milicie improbitas alios
gradus quoscumque sua ledit importunitate et
offendit.**

Cap^m. viii. Si tamen econtra miles sua gesserit arma,

Euenient plura dampna timenda mala:
 Si mala milicia, nichil est scutum, nichil hasta,
 500 Nec manus in gladio fulget honore suo:
 Si malus est miles, quis nos defendet in armis?⁴⁷⁹
 Si mollis fuerit, aspera nostra dabit:
 Si mala milicia, quid clerus vel sibi cultor
 Possunt, dum foribus guerra patebit eis?
 Si mala milicia fuerit, tunc hostis agenda
 Dat renouare ferus, qui solet esse pius.
 Sic bonus ille bona, malus aut mala fert metuenda,⁴⁸⁰
 Qui gerit in manibus nostra tuenda suis.
 Munda manus mire probitatis conferet ictus,
 510 Dum polluta suis sordibus arua fugit:
 Conscius ipse sibi, mala dum meditabitur acta,
 Hesitat, et varia mente vacillat opus.
 Moribus arma vigent, aliter fortuna recedit,
 Stat probitas viciis proxima nulla diu.
 Moribus ergo stude, miles, viciisque resiste
 Belliger, et valide publica iura foue.
 Est michi nil cunctas terrarum vincere turmas,
 Dum solo vicio vincor inermis ego:
 Nec magis in culpa quid obest quam miles ad arma
 520 Tardus, et assissis promptus inesse lucris.
 Hostibus vt perdix vicinis ancipiterque
 Miles dum steterit, res sibi vilis erit.
 Non valet hic dignus amplexibus esse Rachelis,
 Inclita quem Martis arma beare negant:
 Que speciosa viro tali concedit amorem,
 Errat et ignorat quid sit amoris honor.
 Lya magis fedapro coniuge congruit immo
 Tali, qui minime gesta valoris habet:
 Tales ad Lyam redeant et eam sibi iungant,⁴⁸¹
 530 Lya sit hic pauidus, qui nequit esse Rachel.
 Nullus ametur homo qui non est dignus amore,
 Sit set amoris egens qui negat eius onus:
 Non sine sollicito septenni temporis actu
 Captus amore Iacob colla Rachelis habet.

Set quem causa lucri mouet vt procedat ad arma,
Miles honore suo nil probitatis habet.
Vulturis est hominum natura cadauera velle,
Vt cibus occurrat bellica castra sequi;
Sunt similes qui bella volunt, qui castra sequuntur,
540 Qui spoliis inhiant esuriendo lucrum:
Horret auis rapidum quia predat proxima nisum,
Et pecus austerum quodlibet esse lupum.
Qui tibi delicias, miles, preponis, et arma
Deseris, et requiem queris habere domi,
Pauperis et spolia depredans more leonis,
Quo maceras alios, tu tibi crassa rapis,
Que tibi torpor agit, que deliciosa voluptas
Suadet, auaricie pelleque lucra simul:
Suscipe sanguinei trepidancia munera belli,
550 Credoque quod vicia iam tibi terga dabunt.
Ante suum lucrum miles preponat honorem,
Dans sua vota deo cunctaque vincet eo:
Heu! modo set video quod honor postponitur auro,
Preferturque deo mundus et ipsa caro.
Milicie numerus crescit, decrescit et actus;
Sic honor est vacuus, dum vacuatur onus.

**Postquam dictum est de illis qui in statu militari
rem publicam seruare debent illesam, dicendum est
iam de istis qui ad cibos et potus pro generis humani
sustentacione perquirendos agriculture labores
subire tenentur.**

Cap^m. ix. Que sit milicia iam vos audistis, et vltra
Dicam de reliquis, regula que sit eis.
Nam post miliciam restat status vnus agrestis,
560 In quo rurales grana que vina colunt.
Hii sunt qui nobis magni sudore laboris
Perquirunt victus, iussit vt ipse deus:
Est et eis iure nostri primi patris Ade

Regula, quam summi cepit ab ore dei.
 Nam deus inquit ei, dum corrui a Paradisi
 Floribus, in terram cepit et ire viam:
 'O transgresse, labor mundi tibi sint quoque sudor,
 In quibus vteris panibus ipse tuis.'
 Vnde dei seriem cultor si seruet eundem,
 570 Ac opus in cultu sic gerat ipse manu,
 Tunc pariet fructus quam fertilis ordine campus,
 Vuaeque temporibus stabit habunda suis.
 Nunc tamen illud opus vix querit habere colonus,
 Set magis in viciis torpet vbique suis.
 Inter quos plebis magis errat iniqua voluntas,
 Sulcorum famulos estimo sepe reos.
 Sunt etenim tardi, sunt rari, sunt et auari,
 Ex minimo quod agunt premia plura petunt:
 Nunc venit hic usus, petit en plus rusticus vnus,
 580 Tempore preterito quam peciere duo;
 Et dudum solus plus contulit vtilitatis
 Nunc tribus, vt dicunt qui bene facta sciunt.
 Sicut enim vulpis resonantibus vndique siluis
 De fouea foueam querit et intrat eam,
 Sic famulus sulci contrarius ammodo legi
 De patria patriam querit habere moram.
 Ocia magnatum cupiunt hii, nil tamen vnde
 Se nutrire queunt, ni famulentur, habent:
 Hos seruire deus naturaue disposuerunt,
 590 Ille vel illa tamen hos moderare nequit:
 Quisque tenens terras has plangit in ordine gentes,
 Indiget omnis eis, nec reget vllus eas.
 Non impune deum veteres spreuere coloni,
 Nec mundi procerum surripuere statum;
 Set seruile deus opus imponebat eisdem,
 Quo sibi rusticitas corda superba domet:
 Mansit et ingenuis libertas salua, que seruis
 Prefuit atque sua lege subegit eos.
 Nos magis hesterna facit experientia doctos,
 600 Quid sibi perfidie seruus iniquus habet;

Vt blada cardo nocens minuit, si non minuatur,
 Sic grauat indomitus rusticus ipse probos.
 Vngentem pungit pungentem rusticus vngit,
 Regula nec fallit quam vetus ordo docet:
 Vulgi cardones lex amputet ergo nociuos,
 Ne blada pungentes nobiliora terant.
 Nobile quicquid habent seu dignum, rustica proles
 Ledit in ingenuis, sit nisi lesa prius:
 Quod sit rusticitas vilis, docet actus ad extra,
 610 Que minus ingenuos propter honesta colit;
 Vtque labant curue iusto sine pondere naues,
 Sic, nisi sit pressus, rusticus ipse ferus.
 Contulit et tribuit deus et labor omnia nobis,
 Commoda sunt hominis absque labore nichil;
 Rusticus ergo sua committat membra labori,
 Ocia postponens, sicut oportet agi.
 Horrea sicut ager sterilis sub vomere cultus
 Fallit, et autumpno fert lucra nulla domum,
 Sic miser ipse, tuo cum plus sit cultus amore,
 620 Rusticus in dampnum fallit agitque tuum.
 Nulla ferunt sponte serui seruilia iura,
 Nec sibi pro lege quid bonitatis habent:
 Quicquid agit paciens corpus seruile subactum,
 Mens agit interius semper in omne malum.
 Contra naturam fiunt miracula, vires
 Nature deitas frangere sola potest:
 Non est hoc hominis, aliquis quod condicionis
 Seruorum generis rectificare queat.

**Hic loquitur eciam de diuersis vulgi laborariis,
 qui sub aliorum regimine conducti, variis debent pro
 bono communi operibus subiugari.**

Cap^m. x. Gens et adhuc alia cultoribus est sociata,
 630 Que stat communis, ordo nec vllus eis:
 Hii sunt qui cuiquam nolunt seruire per annum,

Hos vix si solo mense tenebit homo;
Set conventiciis tales conduco dietis,
Nunc hic, nunc alibi, nunc michi nuncque tibi.
Horum de mille vix est operarius ille
Qui tibi vult pacto fidus inesse suo.

Hec est gens illa que denaturat in aula,⁴⁸²
Potibus atque cibis dum manet ipsa tuis:
Dum commensalis conductus sit tibi talis,
640 Omnes communes reprobat ipse cibos:
Omnia salsa nocent, tantum neque cocta placebunt,
Ni sibi des assum, murmurat ipse statim;
Nil sibi ceruisia tenuis neque cisera confert,⁴⁸³
Nec rediet tibi cras, ni meliora paras.
O cur sic potum petit hic sibi delicosum,
Quem fouet ex ortu limpha petita lacu?
Pauperis ex stirpe natus, quoque pauper et ipse,
Vt dominus stomacho poscit habere suo.
Nil sibi lex posita prodest, nam regula nulla
650 Talibus est, nec quis prouidet inde malis:
Hec est gens ratione carens vt bestia, namque
Non amat hec hominem, nec putat esse deum.
Hiis, nisi iusticia fuerit terrore parata,
Succumbent domini tempore credo breui.

**Quia varias rerum proprietates vsui humano
necessarias nulla de se prouincia sola parturit
vniuersas, inter alios mundi coadiutores Ciuium
Mercatores instituuntur, per quos singularum bona
regionum alternatim communicantur, de quorum iam
actibus scribere consequenter intendit.**

Cap^m. xi. Si mea nobilibus vrbanis scripta revoluam,
Quid dicam, set eis est honor est et onus?
Est honor vt tantas teneat Ciuis sibi gasas,
Est onus vt lucra querit habere mala:
Est honor officium maioris prendere ciuem,

660 Est onus officii iura tenere sui:
Transit honor set perstat onus, quod si male gessit,
Hoc scio, quod pondus non leuiabit honor.
Vrbs stat communis de gentibus ecce duabus,
Sunt Mercatores, sunt simul artifices:
Indiget alterius sic alter habere iuuamen,
Vt sit communis sic amor inter eos;
Vincula namque duo sibi stringunt forcius vno,
Sic duo cum socii sint in amore probi.
Inter maiores dum firmus amorque minores
670 Permanet, vrbs gaudet et policia viget:
Crescere rem minimam gentis concordia prestat,
Maxima res discors labitur inque nichil.
Vnio dum gentis durat, durabit et vrbis
Mutua iusticia, plaudit et omnis ea;
Si sit et econtra, tunc vrbes mutua dampna
Vexant, et rara sunt magis inde lucra.
Sicut et audiui, sic possum testificari,
Vix sedet in Banco regula iusta modo:
Non sapit ille deum qui totus inheret habendum
680 Has pompas mundi, nomen vt addat ei.
In specie nullos statuo neque culpo, set illos
Qui propter mundum preteriere deum:
Set qui iudicium cordis vult reddere iustum,
Credo quod ante deum se dabit inde reum.
Omnes namque lucris sic tendimus omnibus horis,
Quod iam festa deo vix manet vna dies.
O quam Iudeus domini sacra sabbata seruat,
Non vendens nec emens, nec sibi lucra petens!
Lex diuina iubet, quod homo sua sabbata sacret,
690 Sanctificetque diem, quo colat ipse deum.
Cum plueret manna per desertum deus olim,
Quod fecit populus tunc modo signa notat:
Duppla die sexta tollebant facta, laborem
Ostendunt, quia lux septima nescit opus.
Omnia set licita sunt nobis lege moderna:
Respectu lucri quid sacra festa michi?

Nil modo curatur, qua forma quisque lucratur,
Dum tamen ipse suum possit habere lucrum.
Dic michi quis socius est aut tibi carus amicus,
700 Cuius amicitia fert tibi nulla lucra.
Dic modo quis ciuis manet expers fraudis in vrbe:
Si fuerit talis, vrbs mea vix scit eum.

**Hic loquitur de binis Auaricie filiabus, scilicet
Vsura et Fraude, que in ciuitate orientes ad ciuium
negociaciones secretum prestant obsequium. Set
primo dicet de condicione Vsure, que vrbis
potencioribus sua iura specialius ministrat.**

Cap^m. xii. O quam subtiles Fraus ac Vsura sorores
Sunt, quibus vrbani dant sua iura quasi!
Hee fuerant genite diuersis patribus vrbe,
Quas peperit sola mater Auaricia;
Est pater Vsure magnus diuesque monete,
Est Fraus et vulgo degenerata stupro:
Sic soror Vsura stat nobilior genitura,
710 Quam clamat natam diues habere suam.
Nititur hec magnas sub claue recondere summas,
Ex quibus insidias perficit ipsa suas:
Ista soror dampno solum viget ex alieno,
Alterius dampna dant sibi ferre lucra:
Est soror ista potens, aulas que struxit in vrbe,
Et tamen agrestes dissipat ipsa domos;
Ista soror ciuem ditat, set militis aurum
Aufert et terras vendicat ipsa suas.
Vsuram dominus defendit lege perhenni,
720 Vnde satis clare scripta legenda patent.
Nonne foret sapiens qui posset ponere glosam
Hunc contra textum, quem dedit ipse deus?
Hoc scit mercator instanti tempore ciuis,
Qui probat vsuram posse licere suam:
Omnia nuda patent, quapropter vestibus ipsam

Induit, vt ficto fallat operta dolo.
Sic latet Vsure facies depicta colore
Fraudis, vt hinc extra pulcra pateret ea;
Si tamen inde genus sic vertat fraude dolosus,
730 Vsure species stat velut ipsa prius.
Nonne deum fallit cautelis institor ipse,
Talia dum scelera celat in arte sua?
Est deus aut cecus, qui singula cernit vbique?
Vsure tunicam cernit et odit eam.

**Postquam dixit de potencia Vsure, iam de Fraudis
subtilitate dicere intendit, que de communi consilio
quasi omnibus et singulis in emendo et vendendo ea
que sunt agenda procurat et subtiliter disponit.**

Cap^m. xiii. Ista soror grauia parat, altera set grauiora,
Nam stat communis omnibus ipsa locis:
Quo tamen Vsura pergit Fraus vadit et illa,
Vna viam querit, altera complet opus.
Vrbibus Vsura tantum manet hiis sociata
740 Quorum thesaurus nescit habere pares;
Set Fraus ciuiles perstat communis ad omnes,
Consulit et cunctis viribus ipsa suis:
Clam sua facta facit, nam quem plus decipit ipsa,
Ipse prius sentit quam videt inde malum.
Stans foris ante fores proclamat Fraus iuuenilis
Merces diuersas, quicquid habere velis.
Quot celi stelle, tot dicet nomina rerum,
Huius et istius, et trahit atque vocat:
Quos nequit ex verbis, tractu compellit inire,
750 'Hic,' ait, 'est quod vos queritis, ecce veni.'
Sic apprenticius plebem clamore reducit,
Ad secreta doli quando magister adest:
Dum Fraus namque vetus componit verba dolosa,
Incircumventus nullus abire potest:
Si sapiens intrat, Fraus est sapiencior illo,

Et si stultus init, stulcior inde redit.

Ad precium duplum Fraus ponit singula, dicens
Sic, 'Ita Parisius Flandria siue dedit.'

Quod minus est in re suplent iurancia verba,
760 Propter denarium vulnerat ipsa deum;
Nam nichil in Cristo membrorum tunc remanebit,
Dum iuramentis Fraus sua lucra petit.
Hac set in arte tamen nos sepe domos fore plenas
Cernimus, et proprium nil domus ipsa tenet:
Sicque per ypocrisim ciuis perquirat honorem,
Quo genuflexa procul plebs valedicat ei:
Accidit vnde sibi quasi furtim maior vt ipse
Astat in vrbe sua, qui minor omnibus est.
Set cum tempus erit quo singula nuda patebunt,
770 Dedecus euertit quod decus ante fuit;
Nam cum quisque suum repetit, tunc coruus amictus
Alterius pennis nudus vt ante volat.

Fraus et ab vrbe venit campestris querere lanas,
Ex quibus in stapula post parat acta sua.
Numquid vina petit Fraus que Vasconia gignit?⁴⁸⁴
Hoc dicunt populi rite nocere sibi:
Fraus manet in doleo, trahit et vult vendere vinum,
Sepeque de veteri conficit ipsa nouum.
Fraus eciam pannos vendet, quos lumine fusco
780 Cernere te faciet, tu magis inde caue:
Discernat tactus, vbi fallunt lumina visus,
Ne te pannificus fraudet in arte dolus.
Absit enim species quis vendat Fraude negante,
Dumque suis mixtis dat veterata nouis;
Decimat in lance sibi, partem sepeque sextam⁴⁸⁵
Pondere subtili Fraus capit ipsa sibi.⁴⁸⁶

**Hic loquitur vlterius quomodo Fraus singula
artificia necnon et vrbis victualia vbicunque sua
subtili dispositione gubernat.**

Cap^m. xiiii. Nolunt artifices Fraudis deponere leges,
 Cuius in arbitrio dant sua facta modo:
 Fabricat ista ciphos, argentum purgat et aurum,⁴⁸⁷
 790 Set capit ex puro purius ipsa tuo;
 Conficit ex vitris gemmas oculo preciosas,
 Nomen et addit eis, fallat vt inde magis.
 Si quid habes panni, de quo tibi vis fore vestem,
 Fraus tibi scindit eam, pars manet vna sibi;
 Quamuis nil sit opus vestis mensuraque fallit,
 Plus capit ex opere quam valet omne tibi.
 Set quid pellicibus albis, nigris, quoque gris
 Dicam? numquid eis Fraus iuuat ipsa prius?
 Fraus prima facie trahit in longum satis apte,⁴⁸⁸
 800 Quod trahit hoc hodie, cras caret inde pede:
 Fraus quoque debilia vendens care facit arma,
 Contractos et equos Fraus facit armigeros:
 Fluxum candele Fraus de pinguedine facte
 Prouocat, hinc fluxus sit sibi perpetuus:
 Fraus eciam sellas, ocreas facit et sotulares;⁴⁸⁹
 Omnem nunc artem Fraus facit esse suam.
 Fraus etenim carnes populo vendit, quoque pisces,
 Condolet hinc gustus dum sapit inde prius:
 Fraus facit ob panes pistorum scandere clatas,
 810 Furca tamen furis iustior esset eis:⁴⁹⁰
 Ceruisie domina Fraus est, testante lagena,
 Qua vix per seriem scit Thethis esse Cerem:⁴⁹¹
 Fraus cocus et cocta componit et ordinat assa,
 Inque cibos horum conuocat ipsa forum:
 Vt fuit absque modo clamor constanter abisso,
 Sic Fraus assa sibi clamat in aure fori.
 Hospes in hospitiis Fraus gaudet de peregrinis,
 Set peregrinus eam plangit habere malam:
 Sincopat in modio, decaudat fraus minuendo
 820 Fena per apocapen, lucra colendo tamen.
 Dum curat minima, Fraus pullos vendit et oua,
 Est nichil inque foro, quin regit ipsa dolo:

Fraus procurator communis in vrbe notatur;
Dum causas iungit, semper id vna luit.
Vt numeranda maris consistunt litora nobis,
Sunt infiniti fraudis in ore doli.
Fraus facit et facta vendit, quoque iudicat acta,
Ambicione sua statque per omne rea.
Non commune bonum Fraus cum sit rector agendum
830 Auget, set proprium spectat habere lucrum.
Sic patet in fine, nunc transiit exul ab vrbe
Ipsa Fides sterilis, Fraus parit atque magis.
Hoc ego non dico, quod Fraus dominatur in omnes,
Iusto nam ciui Fraus nichil addit ibi.

**Hic loquitur de ciue illo⁴⁹² maliuolo et impetuoso,
qui maioris ministerium⁴⁹³ sibi adoptans in conciuies
suam accendit maliciam, quo magis sanum ciuitatis
regimen sua importunitate perturbat et extinguit.**

Cap^m. xv. Turpiter errat auis, proprium que stercore nidum,
Cuius erit custos, contaminare studet:
Dedecus est ciui sociis qui tollit honorem,
Quo campestris habet ciue priora loca.
Est inter populum furiosus vbique timendus,
840 Saltem dum gladium possidet ipse manu;
Est set in vrbe magis hominis metuenda potestas,
Iudicis officio dum furit ipse suo.
Vtpote sola domum poterit sintilla cremare,
Sic malus indigena solus in vrbe grauat.
Mutatis subito rebus natura gemescit,
Et magis insolita de nouitate dolet,
Sorte repentina dum pauper in vrbe leuatur,
Et licet indignus culmen honoris habet.
Vrbis nobilitas poterit tunc dampna timere,
850 Cum noua stultorum gloria laudat eum.
Arridet stultus stulto, vir iniquus iniquo,
Gaudet sensatus cum sapiente viro.

Asperius nichil est humili cum surgit in altum,
Saltem cum seruus nascitur ipse prius;
Mens antiqua manet serui de condicione,
Det quamuis summum sors sibi ferre statum.
Si cursoris equi sella sit Asellus opertus,
Non tamen in cursu fit magis inde celer:
Indoctus que rudis nec homo mutatur honore,
860 Rusticitate sua quin magis asper erit.
Coruum perfidie dampnant animalia queque,
Sic est de ciue qui stat in vrbe male:
Quamuis sors fallax hominem sine moribus vrbe
Preponat, quis sit vltima fama dabit.
Vir malus est hominum multorum sepe flagellum,
Quem deus ad tempus plura mouere sinit:
Fine tamen proprio capiti mala cuncta refundit,
Que foris in populo fecerat ipse prius.
Mille cados olei premit vncia sola veneni,
870 Solus millenos vir malus atque bonos:
Ignitus carbo plures producit in ignem,
Sic mala multa facit, quo manet ipse, malus:
Talis enim summam fuerit cum scansus in arcem,
Spirat et imperio subdere cuncta suo,
Vertitur ecce rota, prius et qui celsior vrbis
Exstitit, inferior omnibus ipse cadit.⁴⁹⁴
Fraus florere potest, set fructificare nequibit,
Nec sua radices plantula firmat humo:
Res probat in fine, cum quis tumefactus auare
880 Se dabit in precium, non fore grande lucrum.
Quisque valet speculo satis ista videre moderno,⁴⁹⁵
Vix tamen est sapiens, qui cauet acta videns.

**Hic loquitur eciam de ciue illo, qui linguosus et
Susurro inter conciuēs seminator discordiarum
existit. Loquitur de variis eciam⁴⁹⁶ periculis
occasione lingue male contingentibus.**

Cap^m. xvi. Dum Susurro manet et vir linguosus in vrbe,
Plebis in obprobrium scandala plura mouet;
Nam linguosus homo reliquos velut altera pestis
Ledit, et vt turbo sepe repente nocet.
Set quia lingua mala mundo scelus omne ministrat,
Que sibi sunt vires dicere tendo graues.
Lingua mouet lites, lis prelia, prelia plebem,
890 Plebs gladios, gladii scismata, scisma necem;
Extirpat regnis, dat flammis, depopulatur
Lingua duces, lingua predia, lingua domos:
Lingua maritorum nexus dissoluet, et vnum
Quod deus instituit, efficit esse duo;
Lite fugantque viros nupte, nuptasque mariti,
Inque malum dicunt res sibi semper agi.
Corporis exigua pars nulli parcere nouit,
Fallax et facilis fasque nephasque loqui:
Fermentum modicum totum corrumpit aceruum;
900 Exacuens mentem singula membra mouet.
Non nichil est quod eam duplex custodia seruat,
Ne fluat in verbis impetuosa suis:
Dentibus obstruxit prudens natura palatum,
Vt claustro residens clausa silere queat;
Talis eam custos stimulis castigat acutis,
Vt nichil abrupte queque licenter agat:
Exterius datur alter ei custos labiorum,
Vt duplex duplici ianua claudat iter:
Osseus ordo prior excessus corrigit, alter
910 Carneus et madidus micia verba facit.
Hos tamen erumpit aditus quandoque latenter,
Et ruit in verba que reuocare nequit:
Impetus huius habet rerum discrimina mille,
Que velut ignis edax prospera queque vorant.
Dicere qui poterit quot in ethere lumina lucent,
Paruaque quot siccus corpora puluis habet,
Vix satis est sapiens homo talis vt omnia dicat
Semina pestifera que mala lingua serit.
Nemo referre potest mala que linguosus in vrbe

- 920 Parturit, et duplo prouocat ore dolos.
Res mala lingua loquax, res peior, pessima res est,
Que quamuis careat ossibus, ossa terit:
Non locus est pacis vbi regnat lingua loquacis;
Qui nec habet pacem, non habet ipse deum:
Qui sine pace dei discordat, habere salutem
Non valet, est et opus absque salute nichil:
Omne quod acquirit sibi pax, discordia tollit,
Quicquid et ista leuans erigit, illa ruit.
Est vbi regnat amor deus; est vbi nullus amator,
- 930 Dirigat vt causas nescit adesse deus:
Est grauior plumbi massa sic garrula lingua,
Pondere sub cuius corruiit vrbis honor.
Qui mala vult vrbi conciuus nesciat urbem,
Ianua fallaci nec sit aperta viro:
Ore licet duplex talis canat vrbis honorem,
Corde silens tacite semina fraudis habet:
Sicut aqua piscis gaudet, letatur iniquus
Dum videt alterius dampna patere magis.
Fontem dum solus communem toxicat vnus,
- 940 Plebs perit et pestis magna repente venit:
Ciuis qui ciues conturbat et opprimit omnes,
Exulis aut mortis sit sibi pena prius.
Dum dens solus olet, totum caput inficit ille,
Si foris extrahitur, cessat ab inde dolor;
Sic prius extractus sit ciuis in vrbe malignus,
Quam ciuilis honor perdat in vrbe locum.
Expedit vnus enim moriatur, ne quasi tota
Gens pereat lesa de grauitate sua.
- Vrbis rector, age quod sit concordia, que dat⁴⁹⁷
- 950 Pacem: pax etenim prospera cuncta parit.
Non sonet in populis sermo tuus impetuosus;
Dulcibus est verbis vrbis alendus amor.
Obsequium tigresque domat tumidosque leones,
Rustica paulatim taurus aratra subit;
Sic sibi quod nequeunt, valet hoc prudencia, vires,⁴⁹⁸

Comptaque de facili pondere complet opus.
 Non satis vna tenet agitata anchora puppes,
 Nec satis est liquidis vnicus hamus aquis;
 Sola nec vna viri persona potest sine plebis
 960 Auxilio cunctas vrbs habere vices.
 Principiis obsta, si tu potes, aut sapienter
 Discute paulatim quod nequis ipse simul:
 Tempora dum veteris queris temeraria dampni,
 Sepe magis morbum quam medicamen habent:
 Curando fieri quedam maiora videmus
 Vulnera, que melius non tetigisse fuit.
 Flumina magna vides paruis de fontibus orta,
 Flumina collectis multiplicantur aquis:
 Sepius, in primo quod erat sanabile vulnus,
 970 Dilatum longo tempore nescit opem.
 Ad vomitum scelus est reuocabile fitque nouatum
 Vulnus, et infirmis causa pusilla nocet:
 Vulnus in antiquum rediet mala sana cicatrix;
 Defectus cure causa prioris erat.
 Vt vix extinctum cinerem sub sulphure tangas,⁴⁹⁹
 Viuit, et ex minimo maximus ignis erit;
 Sic indiscrete veterem qui corripit iram,
 Commouet ex facili ferre quod ipse nequit:
 Quelibet extinctos iniuria suscit ignes,
 980 Quo prius oblita forcius ira redit.
 Ira subit, deforme malum, lucrique cupido;
 Est vbi nullus amor, vrbs habet omne nephas:
 Crimina dicuntur, resonat clamoribus ether,
 Inuocat iratum sic sibi quisque deum.
 Pertinet ad ciues rabidos compescere mores
 Candida pax homines, trux decet ira feras:
 Nulla fides, vbi nullus amor, set amore remoto
 Ignorat proprium quisquis in vrbe gradum.
 Dum diuisa manet plebs a sapientibus vrbs,
 990 Consilium multe calliditatis init:
 Ignis, aqua dominans duo sunt pietate carentes,
 Vulgus et indomitus peior habetur eis.

Nuper iusticia pax et concordia ciues
 Rebus et in causis rectificare solet.
 Nunc vbi sunt? dicas. Non hic. Cur tunc abierunt?
 Liuor et argenti lamina causa fuit.
 Quod dolus acquirit, lucrum durabile non est,
 Invidie nec amor durat in vrbe comes.
 Ablue preteriti periuria temporis, oro;
 1000 Ablue preterita perfida verba die.
 Sic plus quam credi poterit fortuna reuiuet,
 Surget et in precium quod modo vile cadit.
 Assolet interdum fieri placabile numen,
 Nube solet pulsa clarior esse dies:
 Pax datur in terris quibus extat honesta voluntas;
 Vir malus omne quod est pacis ab vrbe fugat.
 Roma caput mundi fuit omni tempore, saltem
 Dum communis amor rexit in vrbe forum:
 Set diuisa statim viduata recessit honore,
 1010 Eius et imperium perdidit omne decus.
 Non honor Athenis decessit, dummodo ciues
 Vnanimis odium non habuere simul;
 Postea quando grauis vrbem diuisio spersit,
 Ammodo de veteri sumpsit honore nichil.
 Sors tamen illa deo mediante recedat ab vrbe
 Nostra, que magno fulsit honore diu.

FOOTNOTES:

- [459](#) 18 ita] ei D
[460](#) *Heading* 1 amore DLT
[461](#) 40 Qui] Oui S
[462](#) 45 Architesis (architesis) CEHGDL Archtesis S archtesis T
[463](#) 73 Ebria CE
[464](#) 180 Molia S
[465](#) 213 temporat SGD tempat CEHL
[466](#) 262 Carnis EL
[467](#) 281 sic CEHGDL si S
[468](#) 325 quod erit S et erit CEHGDL
[469](#) 368 detinuere CE
[470](#) 389 hyemps C
[471](#) 390 Sic C
[472](#) 409 *Paragr. here* CEHT

[473](#) 417 impugnat ED impugnat SHL
[474](#) 450 *Text* SH₂ Illa quidem fatuos que ligat arte viros CEHGTDL
[475](#) 454 in thalamis S interius CEHGDL
[476](#) 470 viuit C
[477](#) 471 laborat CE
[478](#) 487 f. *Two lines om.* DL *No paragr.* CEHT
[479](#) 501 nos CEGDL non SHTH₂
[480](#) 507 Si CE
[481](#) 529 Liam SL
[482](#) 637 *No paragr.* SD
[483](#) 643 seruisia CE
[484](#) 775 gignit CEDL gignit SH
[485](#) 785 sibi SEHH₂ fraus CGDL
[486](#) 786 fraus capit SEHH₂ surripit CGDL
[487](#) 789 ista SG ipsa CEHD ipse L
[488](#) 799 Stans C
[489](#) 805 eciam CEHDLT etenim S sellas] cellas CEL
[490](#) 810 ffurta EDLT
[491](#) 812 Thethis (thethis) SCEHGT Thetis D tethis L
[492](#) Cap. xv. *Heading* 1 ciue illo S illo ciue CEHGDLT
[493](#) 2 ministerium] officium CE
[494](#) 876 cadet CE
[495](#) 881 Quis valet in speculo D Quisquis valet speculo L
[496](#) Cap. xvi. *Heading* 2 f. eciam de variis EDL
[497](#) 949 *Ordinary paragraph* CEDL
[498](#) 955 sibi CEHGDLH₂ vbi S
[499](#) 975 *No paragr.* CEHTD

**Exquo de errore in singulis temporalium gradibus
existente tractatum est, iam quia vnumquemque sub
legis iusticia gubernari oportet, tractare vltius
intendit de illis qui iuris ministri dicuntur, quamuis
tamen ipsi omnem suis cautelis iusticiam confundunt,
et propter mundi lucrum multipliciter eneruant.**

Incipit liber Sextus.

Cap^m. i. Sunt modo quam plures nomen de lege gerentes,
Qui tamen in parte nomen habent sine re:
Hii sine lege dei sub lege viri quasi fictum
Vsurpant nomen legis habere suum;
Est quibus omnis amor extraneus, omnis et error
Proximus et proprii causa creata lucri:
Hic labor, hoc opus est primo cum munere iungi,
Est sine quo lingue muta loquela sue.
Qui tamen ad veras leges vacat, et sine fraude
10 Iusticiam querule proximitatis agit,
Vt psalmista canit, est vir magis ille beatus;
Paucos set tales iam sibi tempus habet.
Aurea pugna nouo sic conterit vlcere leges,
Lesa quod vltius iura salute carent.
Hoc ego quod plebis vox clamat clamo, nec vllos,
Sint nisi quos crimen denotat, ipse noto.
Talibus in specie, quos deuia error auare,
Non aliis ideo scripta sequenter ago.
Legis sub clamide latet ars, qua lex sine iure
20 Vertit vt est velle quolibet acta die;
Causidici talem poterunt dum plectere legem,
Transformant verbis iura creata suis.
Iuris in effigie sunt omnia picta colore,
Quo magis occultum fert sibi lucra forum:
Iusta vel iniusta non curant quomodo causa
Stat, set vt illa lucris fertilis astet eis.

Nunc cum causidicus aduerse ius fore partis
 Scit, tunc cautelas prouocat ipse suas:
 Quod nequit ex lege, cautelis derogat ipse,
 30 Cum nequeat causam vincere, vexat eam:
 Si tamen hanc vincat, mos exigit et modo prestat⁵⁰⁰
 Legis sensati nomen habere sibi:
 Nam nisi cautelis laruare sciat sibi leges,
 Tunc dicent alii, deficit actus ei.
 Sic actus falsi leges confundere veri
 Preualet, et lucro plus capit inde suo;
 Sic cum causidicus fuerit sapiencior, auctis
 Legem cautelis opprimit ipse suis.
 Sic lex pro forma patet, et cautela perita
 40 Stat pro materia iuraque vincit ea.
 Hec est linguosa gens, que vult litigiosa
 In falsis causis vociferare magis.
 Vult sibi causidicus seruare modum meretricis,
 Que nisi sit donum nescit amare virum,
 Est et, vt ipse vides, semper venalis ad omnes;
 Aurum si sibi des, corpus habere potes.
 Cuius enim generis aut ordinis est homo nusquam
 Curat, dum poterit quicquid habere lucri.
 Vt via communis astat Rome peregrinis,
 50 Qui veniunt sanctis reddere vota locis;
 Est ita vulgaris domibus via causidicorum,
 Qua graditur populus donaque reddit eis.
 Nam velut antiqui iustos strinxere tiranni,
 Qui renuerunt diis reddere thura suis,
 Sic modo causidicus vicinos stringit auarus,
 Qui sunt inviti ferre tributa sibi,
 Sic video populos modo sacrificare coactos
 Causidico legis, ne male fiat eis.
 Diuerse gentes, vt sufficit ipsa facultas,
 60 Munera diuersa dant sibi sepe noua:
 Conuenit immo tibi, donum si deficit auri,
 Munus vt argenti des reuerenter ei;
 Si tamen argentum non est, exennia prebe

Illi, quem saciat est quod in orbe nichil.
 Singula que terra bona gignit, et ether in alto,⁵⁰¹
 Seu mare, de dono querit habere tuo;
 Ex omni parte, sic post, sic congregat ante;
 Dum tamen omne capit, nil tibi retro dabit.
 Non vno volucres laqueo set pluribus auceps
 70 Carpit, nec pisces vnicus hamus habet;
 Lex in non leges iam transmutata nec vnum
 Rethe, set in lucrum recia mille parat.⁵⁰²
 Vndique casus adest legis, quo pendulus hamus
 Aurea de burse gurgite dona capit;
 Non via talis erit qua non scrutabitur auri
 Arte vel ingenio, vi vel amore, lucrum.
 Contextat tenues subtilis aranea telas,
 Possit vt hiis predas illaqueare suas;
 Si veniat musca volutans, cadit ipsa retenta,⁵⁰³
 80 Nisus et a medio transiet absque malo;
 Quod volat ex alis euadet fortibus illud,
 Voluitur et laqueis debile quicquid adest.
 Causidicus cupidus pauidos de lege propinquos
 Voluit et illaqueat condicione pari;
 Ignauum populum, cuius defensio nulla est,
 Opprimit, et legis rethe coartat eos;
 Plebs cadit in telas simplex, hominique potenti
 Recia causidici dant lacerata viam.
 Vespere pronus humi vespertilio volat, vti
 90 Pennis pro pedibus in gradiendo solet;
 Sic cuius mentem terrena sciencia ditem
 Efficit, huic volucris se facit esse parem;
 Iste velut circa terram volutat, quia veri⁵⁰⁴
 Luminis ignarus terrea sola rapit.
 Dicitur in noctem subtilis noctua visu
 Esse, nitente die luce minore frui;
 Hanc imitantur auem legis qui sunt sapientes,
 Vt mala noctis agant, nec bona lucis habent.
 Sepius illa tamen quam preda rapit sibi mors est,
 100 Dum latet occulto finis habendus ei:

Improuisus adest cum pullos tollere miluus,
Esurit, et fraude fraus sua sepe cadit:
Sic capiens capitur, sic qui vorat ipse voratur,
Infelix hamum quo capietur amat.

**Hic loquitur de causidicis et aduocatis illis, qui
vicinum populum depredantes, ex bonisque alienis
ditati, largissimas sibi possessiones adquirunt: de
quibus tamen, vt dicitur, vix gaudet tercius heres.**

Cap^m. ii. Plusquam Cilla maris rapiens sibi deuorat vndas,
Causidicus patriam deuorat ipse suam;
Plus cane qui siluis predam sibi querit in amplis,
Causidicus lucrum querit habere suum;
Nec canis hic predam plus stringit, dum capit illam
110 Dentibus, vt carnes deuoret ipse suas,
Quin plus causidicus stringit de lege clientem,
Munus vt argenti possit habere sibi.
Vt solet ancipiter trepidas vrgere columbas,
Causidicus gentes vrget et angit eas:
Vt tremit agna pauens, nouiter que saucia canis
Est euasa lupis, nec bene tuta manens;
Vtque columba suo madefactis sanguine plumis
Horret adhuc vngues, heserat illa quibus;
Sic pauet a laqueis oppressus causidicorum
120 Pauper, et inde sui clamat in aure dei.
Vulnera plebeia medicus desiderat, vt sic
Det dolor alterius munera leta sibi;
Gentes causidicus discordes optat, vt ipse
Prospera de lite gentis habere queat.
Ex hoc quod perdis lucratur, sique lucreris,
Hinc tecum partem querit habere suam;
Cum plenam dextram teneat, tunc ipse sinistram
Tendit, que sibimet insaciata manet.
Sic quacumque via furit Eurus, semper in aura
130 Velum tranquillum gestat ad omne fretum:

Sic viget ex auro locus pregnans alieno;
Quod male concepit, peius id ipse parit:
Nam modus est legis cito cum locuplex fore nummis
Possit, tunc terras appetit ipse novas.

Vt constricta fame lupa more suo catulorum
Querit habere suos lata per arua cibos,
Sic cum causidico sit proles aucta, per omnes
Machinat insidias, de quibus auget opes.
O sine tunc requie conspirans nocte dieque,
140 Vt capiat lucrum, temptat vbique forum;
Tuncque domos domibus, campos iungit quoque
campis,
Vellet vt hiis per se solus in orbe fore:
Sic rapiens oua fouet vt perdix aliena,
Set de fine patet quid sibi iuris habet.
Que pater in studio quesivit vix sibi magno,
Dissipat in vicio filius ipse cito;
Et que fraude sua sapiens mundi cumulata
Strinxerat, hec stultus laxat abire vagus;
Sic male quesitis non gaudet tercius heres, [505](#)
150 Set rapit hec mundus que dedit ipse prius.
Causidico fore ve patet ex dictis Ysaïe,
Namque domum vidue dissipat ille male.

**Hic loquitur de causidicis et aduocatis illis, qui
quanto plures sunt in numero, tanto magis lucra
sicientes patriam deuorant, et iuris colore subtilia
plectentes, suis cautelis innocentem populum
formidantem illaqueant.**

Cap^m. iii. Cum fuerint tribuli summe maioris aborti,
Sunt blada depresso facta minora solo;
Cum magis atque suis Sus fuderit vbera natis,
Est macies lateris macrior acta Suis.
Cum magis et numerum lex auget causidicorum,
Tum gemit in patriis plebs spoliata magis.

160 Vt blada que mersa torrens supervndat aquarum,
 Vellit et extirpat quicquid adheret humo,
 Concio lege rapax sic multiplicata virorum
 Lucra, superficies que tenet orbis, habet.
 Non valet esse salus, medicus dum vulnerat egros,
 Addit et ad dampnum dampna furore suo;
 Sic, vbi causidici causas sine iure revoluunt,
 Esse quies longo tempore certa nequit.
 Sunt ita continua presentibus ista diebus,
 Vix vt ab hoc morbo sanus abibit homo.
 Aurea dum leges lanx ponderat, equa statera
 170 Non erit, hoc et opus iura moderna docent.
 Scribitur, os auri Crisostomus ipse gerebat;
 Sub sermone latens illa figura fuit:
 Aurea de facto gestant tamen ora potentes
 Causidici, qui nunc aurea cuncta vorant.
 Pondere subtili species venduntur, vt emptor
 Circumventus eo nesciat inde forum;
 Est tamen ecce modo pondus subtilius, in quo
 Venduntur verba legis in arte sua.
 Quicquid agant leges, hominis lex interioris
 180 Gestat ab interius iudicis illud onus:
 Omnia dat gratis dominus, set legis auarus
 Sermonem nullum dat nisi vendat eum.
 Si bene promittant, totidem promittere verbis
 Ius foret, et pactis pacta referre suis:
 Hii tamen ante manum, quicquid de fine sequetur,
 Sepius inmerito premia ferre petunt.
 Sic magis obliqua lanx nescit pondera iuris, [506](#)
 Quo ruit in tortam, que foret equa, viam;
 Sic solet iniustum fieri sub nomine iusto,
 190 Quod foret et fidum, fit magis absque fide:
 Causidici legem proponunt esse beatam,
 Concludunt set eam facta per ipsa malam.
 De ligno quicquid rectum si vir sibi sumat,
 Ad visum claris subdet et illud aquis, [507](#)
 Apparet tortum sibi quod fuit ordine rectum;

Sic ad propositum lex agit ecce meum.
 Nam si causidico modo dicam ius manifestum,
 Quod michi iusticia nulla negare potest,
 Ipse suum lucrum conspirans quicquid ad ipsum
 200 Dixero subuertet, multa pericla mouens;
 Conficit ex mellis dulcedine fellis amarum,
 Vrtice similem fingit et esse rosam,
 Et velut ex flatu Basiliscus toxicat oris
 Aera, quo peste proxima vita perit,
 Est quod plus sanum, sic ius vir iuris ad aures
 Inficit ex verbis, plenus in ore dolis:
 Et sic vulpis ouem terret predoque vianthem
 Predat, sicque dolus cogit abire fidem.
 Micius est lapso digitum supponere mento,
 210 Mergere quam liquidis ora natantis aquis:
 Miror eo, causas inopum qui lege tueri
 Deberet, cicius aggrauat auctor opus.
 Sompnia perturbant quam sepe viros sine causa,
 Non res set sompno visa figura rei;
 Sic tibi causidicus fingens quam sepe pericla,
 Est vbi plus rectum, diuaricabit iter:
 Mente tibi loquitur dubia, nam nemo dolose
 Mentis securis vocibus esse potest;
 Questio preceedit, rationem fallere pergit,
 220 De quo non dubitat te dubitare facit:
 Incutit ipse tibi ficta sic lege timorem,
 Vertat vt in brutum de racione virum:
 Ex oculis primum dabis, vt retinere secundum
 Possis, dum causam lex regit ipsa tuam.
 Causidici nubes sunt ethera qui tenebrescunt, [508](#)
 Lucem quo solis nemo videre potest:
 Obfuscant etenim legis clarissima iura,
 Et sua nox tetra vendicat esse diem;
 Istis inque viris perdit sua lumina splendor,
 230 Verum mentitur, fraus negat esse fidem.
 Lex furit et pietas dormit, sapiencia fallit,
 Pax grauat, et lites commoda queque ferunt:

Et sic lex legis a ledo ledis in isto,
Et ius a iurgo, tempore iura legit.
Vnio set populi firmo si staret amore,
Causidici vanus tunc foret ille status.

Est bona lex in se fateor, tamen eius inique
Rectores video flectere iura modo.
Non licet, vt dicunt, quod conspiracio fiat,
240 Non tamen hoc faciunt quod sua iura docent:
Contra causidicum si quid michi lex det agendum,
Et peto consilium iuris habere meum,
Tunc dicunt alii, nolunt obstare sodali;
Sic ledunt, set eos ledere nemo potest.
Sic sibi causidicus mundi perquirat honores,
Subuertens lingue iura vigore sue:
Castiget reliquos lex quos vult, non tamen ipsos,
Quos deus aut mundus nescit habere probos.

**Hic loquitur qualiter isti causidici et iuris
aduocati, in sua gradatim ascendentes facultate,
Iudicisque aspirantes officium, iudicialis solii tandem
cacumen attingunt; vbi quasi in cathedra
pestelencie⁵⁰⁹ sedentes, maioris auaricie cecitate
percussi, peioris quam antea conditionis existunt.**

Cap^m. iiii. Est Apprenticius, Sergantus post et Adultus,

250 Iudicis officium fine notabit eum.
Si cupit in primo, multo magis ipse secundo,
Tercius atque gradus est super omne reus;
Et sic lex grauibus auri moderatur habenis,
Quod modo per iustas non valet ire vias.
Libera qualis erat lex non est, immo ligatam
Carcere nummorum ceca cupido tenet:
Aurea ni clauis dissoluerit ostia clausa,
Eius ad introitum nullus habebit iter.
Nil manus in pulsu, nil vox clamore iuuabunt
260 Te cum lege loqui, qui sine claue venis:

Dux tibi si nummus non sit, conducat et ipse
Custodes legis, cassus abire potes.
Et sic causidicus causam, iudex neque iustum
Iudicium cernit, dux nisi nummus erit.

Sunt tria precipue, quibus est turbacio legis,
Vnde sui iuris perdit vbique locum;
Munus, amicitia, timor, hec tria iure negante
Pacta ferunt, quod eis obstat in orbe nichil.
Dicit enim Salomon oculos quod Iudicis aurum
270 Cecat, et est ratio contaminata lucro;
Scimus et hoc omnes, qui iudicis extat amicus,
Perdere iudicio nil valet ipse suo.
Nouimus hoc eciam, tangat si causa potentem,
Cernere iusticiam dat timor inde fugam;
Horrendasque minas iudex non sustinet ipsas,
Sepius et precibus flectitur absque minis:
Litera magnatis dum pulsat iudicis aures,
Tollit vis calami debita iura sequi.
Set super omne modo sibi ve, qui pauper egendo
280 Quid petit in lege, dum nequit ipse dare!
Publica sunt ista nobis, quod lege moderna
Pauperis in causa ius negat acta sua.
Sic ego non video mea que sunt, set dubitando
Auribus attonitis quero cauenda malis.

Ecce dies in qua, fuerat que iuris amica,
Nunc magis econtra lex gerit acta sua:
Larua tegit faciem, confundit glosaque textum,
Vertit et in logicam lex variata scolam;
Absque tamen numero sunt legis in orbe scolares,
290 Plurima sunt folia, fructus et inde minor.
Nomine sub iusto quam sepe nephanda parantur,
Subque dolus facie plurima iuris agit:
Qui magis in causis discernunt talibus orbem,
Crimina sunt cautis ista timenda viris.
Grandia per multos tenuantur flumina riuos,
Alueus et sterilis sic vacuatur aquis:
Pluribus expensis patitur thesaurus eclipsim,

Fit, nisi preuideat, sepeque diues inops:
Sic humus ista breui ditissima tempore pauper,
300 Excessus legum ni moderetur, erit.
Tollere nodosam nescit medicina podagram,
Sic nec auaricie lex medicamen habet.
Est mea bursa potens, lex inde subacta silebit, [510](#)
Preueniens auro singula iura fugo:
Aut si magnatis michi curia sit specialis,
Nil opus est legum viribus, ipse loquor.
Continuata diu sic vlcerat illa cicatrix,
Non habet vlterius iam noua plaga locum.

**Hic loquitur quasi per epistolam Iudicibus illis
directam, qui in caduca suarum diuiciarum
multitudine sperantes, deum adiutorem suum ponere
nullatenus dignantur.**

Cap^m. v. O qui iudicia vite mortis quoque rerum
310 Clauditis in manibus apreciata lucris,
De qua iusticia vosmet saluare putatis,
Cum sit lex aliis vendita vestra dolis?
O dilectores mundi falsique potentes,
Terre quique deos esse putatis opes,
O qui mundanos sic affectatis honores,
Est quibus assidua sollicitudo comes,
Discite precipitem quia sepius ardua casum
Expectant que leui mobilitate cadunt.
Sepius alta cadit ventorum flatibus arbor,
320 Planta satis placido permanet atque gradu:
Aerias alpes niuibus candescere scimus,
Quas subito torquent frigus et omne gelu;
Est ibi ventorum rabies seuissima, dumque
Temperiem gratam proxima vallis habet.
Sic vobis numquam desunt aduersa, potentes,
Nec pax est vobis certa nec vlla quies.
Dic michi diuitibus si quando defuit hostis:

Quin magis hos quassat sepe ruina grauis.
 Non dat securos nec ebur nec purpura sompnos,
 330 Paupertas vili stramine tuta iacet:
 Perdere quo possunt, torquet timor omnis auaros,
 Vanaque sollicitis incutit vmbra metus.
 Auri possessor formidat semper, et omnem
 Ad strepitum fures estimat esse prope;
 Arma, venena timet, furtum timet atque rapinas,
 Fiduciam certam diues habere nequit.
 Hunc, dum querit opes, cruciat miseranda cupido,
 Cum iam quesitas cepit habere, timor.
 Sic igitur miser est, dum pauper querit habere,
 340 Et miser est diues, perdere dumque timet.
 Dum iacet in plumis, vigilans mens aspera sentit,
 Feruet enim variis exagitata dolis:
 Dicit, 'Habere volo vicini pauperis agrum,
 Est etenim campus proximus ille meis.'⁵¹¹
 Sic fugat a domibus pupillos iste paternis,
 Insequitur viduas iudiciisque premit:
 Deliciis fruitur de rebus pauperis iste,
 Dampna set alterius computat esse nichil.
 Si posset mundum lucrari, quis deus esset,
 350 Vltius scire nollet in orbe deum.
 Iudex, nonne tui fulgor tibi sufficit auri,
 Vt careat tenebris mens tua ceca tuis?
 Aproprias aurum tibi fertile, nec tamen vmquam⁵¹²
 Ad sterilem vitam respicis ipse tuam.
 Iusticie montes Iudex vix ardua purus
 Scandit, dum mundi rebus onustus erit.
 Agrorum fines longos extendere queris,
 Nec reputas vite tempora curta tue.
 Quid petis argentum tibi? spem quid ponis in aurum?
 360 Sunt nam communes omnibus orbis opes.
 Sepius ista dei data conspicias hostibus esse,
 Ante deum nulla laus et habetur eis:
 Ista paganus habet, Iudeus, latro cruentus;
 Crede quod iratus sepe dat ista deus.

Parua puto, quecumque malos contingit habere,
 Non est prauorum copia grande bonum.
 O quociens vir iustus eget, scelerosus habundat,
 Hic set non alibi, ius quia regnat ibi.
 Dilectus domini moritur, dum viuit adulter,
 370 Non tamen hii Cristi sunt in amore pares:
 Egrotat iustus, dum sanus floret iniquus,
 Fine tamen proprium quisque reportat onus.
 Si tamen in mundo iudex sibi ferre salutem
 Possit, non curat quid sibi finis erit.
 O qui cuncta cupis, cur temet deseris? Omne
 Est quod in orbe tenes, set neque temet habes.
 O qui scis alios non te, tu notus ad omnes,
 Non tibi quid prodest illa sciencia, nil.
 Te noscas igitur primo, me nosce secundo,
 380 Rectum iudicium sic sapienter age.
 Omnia que mundi sunt diligis, omnia Cristi
 Linquis, et ex nichilo credis habere satis:
 Tu celum perdis, mundum lucraris, inane
 Corpus supportas, spiritus vnde cadit.
 Est tibi perfectum vanum, tibi mobile firmum,
 Talis enim iudex non bene sentit opus:
 Edificas turres, thalamos nouitate politos,
 Quicquid et est orbis plus deitate colis:
 Edificas ampla, fossa clauderis in arta,
 390 Quo medium frontis ostia clausa prement.
 Quid vestes referam, lectos vel iudicis edes,
 Quorum luxuries nescit habere pares?
 Qui modo prospiceret habitacula queque fuerunt,
 Alterius nouiter diceret illa Iouis.
 Gloria nonne tuis erit aut tibi pompa perhennis,
 Quas facis in domibus, dum tua lucra rapis?
 En cecidit Babilon, cecidit quoque maxima Troia,
 Romaque mundipotens vix tenet illa locum.
 Omnis habet subitum mundana potencia finem,
 400 Atque fuga celeri deserit ipsa suos:
 Iudex, ergo time, magnos qui scandis honores,

Teque ruinoso stare memento loco.
Omne quod est mundi tibi carum transiet a te,
Inque tuis meritis iudicat ipse deus:
Euaque lex domini tunc que modo cernis ineque⁵¹³
Discernet, que tibi pondera iusta dabit.
Cum te terribilis exactor missus ab equo
Iudice sulphurei merget in yma laci,
Prodolor! infelix tunc, quamuis sero, dolebis,
410 Talibus in falsis spem posuisse bonis:
Gemma vel argentum nec ibi descendet et aurum,
Nec fragilis mundi gloria lapsa breui.
Iudicibus populi vanum tamen est quod in ista
Materia scripsi; perdita verba dedi:
Que nam iusticia, que vel sit Iudicis equa
Conditio, non est tempore visa modo:
Iusticiarius est; sub tali nomine fallit,
Qui sine iusticia nomen inane gerit.

**Hic loquitur de errore Vicecomitum, Balliuorum,
necnon et in assisis iuratorum, qui singuli auro
conducti diuitum causas iniustas supportantes,
pauperes absque iusticia calumpniantur et
opprimunt.**

Cap^m. vi. Nunc eciam vicecomitibus quid dicere possum?
420 Numquid in assisis dant nocumenta viris?
Macra fit hec causa, de qua viget vnccio nulla
Distillans, vt eis vncta sit inde manus:
Legis in assisa si sint tua dona recisa,
Ius perit et causa scinditur inde tua;
Si tamen assessa sint pre manibus tua dona,
Tunc potes assisis sumere lucra tuis.
Vtque bouem, precio qui stat conductus aratro,
Sic tibi iuratos munere ferre vales:
Hii tibi proque tuis vendent periuria nummis,
430 Sic aurum iura vincit in vrbe mea:⁵¹⁴

Diuitis iniustam causam sic cerno quietam,
 Et iustam causam pauperis esse ream.
 Non comes a vice, set vicio comes accipit ortum,
 Iuris auaricie fert tamen ipse vices.
 Sic dico vicecomitibus, quod munere victi
 Communi populo dant nocumenta modo:
 Nec sibi iurati sapiunt quid, sit nisi lucri,
 De sale conditum quod dabis ante manum:
 Causidici lanam rapiunt, isti quoque pellem
 440 Tollunt, sic inopi nil remanebit oui.
 Sic ego legiferis concludens vltima primis,
 Dico quod ex bursa lex viget ecce noua;
 Vt margaritas si porcus sumat in escas,
 Sumunt legiferi sic modo iura sibi.
 Vendere iusticiam quid id est nisi vendere
 Cristum,⁵¹⁵
 Quem Iudas cupido vendidit ipse dolo?
 Numquid adhuc Iude similis quis viuit in orbe?
 Immo sibi plures viuere credo pares.
 Namque semel Iudam talem committere culpam
 450 Nouimus, hunc et eo penituisse lego;
 Nunc tamen vt merces vendunt communiter omnes,
 Gaudentes lucrum sic habuisse suum.
 Rettulit hoc precium Iudas quod cepit iniquum,
 Nec liquet hinc veniam promeruisse suam:
 Nunc erit ergo quid hiis, vendunt qui iura sinistris,
 Est quibus hora fori cotidiana quasi?⁵¹⁶
 Vt vorat et stricte tenet ipsa vorago gehenne,
 Nec redit vllus homo liber ab ore suo,
 Sic modo qui vendunt leges que premia carpunt,
 460 Hec valet a manibus tollere nemo suis;
 Et quia sic similes inferno suntque tenaces,
 Credo quod infernus fine tenebit eos.
 Quid seu Balliuis dicam, qui sunt Acherontis
 Vt rapide furie? Tu magis inde caue.
 Quo portas intrant, prenostica dampna figurant,
 Cunctis namque viis ve comitatur eis.

Vt Crati bufo maledixit, sic maledico
Tot legum dominis et sine lege magis.

**Hic loquitur quod sicut homines esse super
terram necessario expedit, ita leges ad eorum
regimen institui oportet, dummodo tamen legis
custodes verum a falso discernentes vnicuique quod
suum est equo pondere distribuunt. De erroribus
tamen et iniuriis modo contingentibus innocenciam
Regis nostri, minoris etatis causa, quantum ad
presens excusat.**[517](#)

Cap^m. vii. Pro transgressore fuerant leges situate,
470 Quilibet vt merita posset habere sua:
Nunc tamen iste bonus punitur, et alter iniquus,
Dum viget ex auro, iustificatur eo.
Omnia tempus habent et habet sua tempora tempus,
Causaque sic causas debet habere suas.
Quid mare conferret, altis dum fluctuat vndis,
Sit nisi nauis ei quam vehit vnda fluens?[518](#)
Set quid fert nauis nisi nauta regens sit in illa?
Quid valet aut nauta, si sibi remus abest?
Quid mare, quid nauis, quid nauta, vel est sibi remus,
480 Sit nisi portus aquis ventus et aptus eis?
Gens sine lege quid est, aut lex sine iudice quid nam,
Aut quid si iudex sit sine iusticia?
In patria nostra si quis circumspicit acta,
Hec tria cernet ibi sepe timenda michi.
Omnia dampna grauant, set nulla tamen grauiora,
Quam cum iusticiam iustus habere nequit.
Ex iniusticia discordia crescit, et inde
Cessat amor solitus, murmurat atque domus:
Murmur si veniat, venit et diuisio secum,
490 Terraque diuisa non bene stabit ea;
Et quodcumque sit hoc per se quod stare nequibit,
Ve sibi, nam subito corruet absque modo.

Testis enim deus est, dicens quod regna peribunt⁵¹⁹
In se diuisa, credoque dicta sua.
Ergo videre queunt quotquot qui regna gubernant,
Nostre pars sortis maxima spectat eis.
Quicquid delirant reges, plectuntur Achiui,
Nam caput infirmum membra dolere facit:
Dux si perdat iter, errant de plebe sequentes,
500 Et via qua redient est dubitanda magis.
Propter peccatum regis populi perierunt,
Quicquid et econtra litera raro docet;
Regia set bonitas fert plebi gaudia pacis,
Nam deus ad sancti regis agenda fauet:
Si viciosus enim sit rex, quia lex nequit, ipsum
Vult punire deus, qui super omne potest.
Expediens populo foret vt bene viueret omnis
Rex, iacet in manibus sors quia bina suis:
Vna salus populi rex qui bene viuit habetur,
510 Plebis et in pestem rex malus acta parit;
Eius enim scelera constat magis esse nociua,
Cuius habent populi condita iura sequi.
Cum sit maior homo, sunt plus sua crimina tanto;
Dum cadit ex altis, leditur inde magis.
Plures cerno reos, magis attamen omnibus ipsos,
Legiferi qui sunt et sine lege manent.
Cum sine lege furit regni viciata potestas,
Esse nichil toto tristius orbe potest:
Sanccius esse pecus animoque capacius ipso
520 Estimo, qui iura dat neque seruat ea.
Imperium Regis non solum bella triumphis
Ornant, set leges seruet vbique bonas.⁵²⁰
Nonne domus poterit componere se sine lignis;
Set sibi quid ligna, si nec acuta foret?
Set quid acuta valet, nisi persistens operantis
Vnitis causis sit manus artificis?
Hec sibi si fuerint coniuncta, per omne iuuabunt,
Et si diuisa, pars sibi nulla iuuat.
Terra quid est sola, populus nisi sistat in illa?

530 Quid populus ve sibi, rex nisi regnet ibi?
Est quid rex, nisi consilium fuerit sibi sanum?
Sunt quid consilia, rex nisi credat ea?
Attamen in nostra sic stat diuisio terra,
Quod sibi quisque suam iam legit ire viam:
Conciues hodie discordia vexat in vrbe,
Extinguit quod ius quilibet alterius;[521](#)
Nec lex campestris est iam memorata magistris,
Set qui plus poterit, ipse magister erit.
Nunc clerus populum, populus culpat quoque clerum,
540 Et tamen in culpa perstat vterque sua:
Invidus alterius nunc culpat quemlibet alter,
Parsque suum proprium nulla reformat iter.
Si videas vtrumque statum, dices quia certe
In magnis lesi rebus vterque sumus.

Nunc magis in specie vox plebis clamat
vbique
Pectore sub timido que metuenda
fero.
Curia que maior defendere iura
tenetur,
Nunc magis iniustas ambulat ipsa
vias:
Infirmo capite priuantur membra
salute,
Non tamen est medicus qui modo
550 curat opus.
Est ita magnificus viciorum morbus
abortus,
Quod valet excessus tollere nulla
manus:
Sic oritur pestis, per quam iacet
obruta virtus,
Surgit et in vicium qui regit omne
forum.

Rex, puer indoctus, morales
negligit actus,⁵²²
In quibus a puero crescere possit
homo:
Sic etenim puerum iuuenilis concio
ducit,
Quod nichil expediens, sit nisi velle,
sapit.
Que vult ille, volunt iuuenes sibi
consociati,
Ille subintrat iter, hiique sequuntur
560 eum:
Vanus honor vanos iuuenes facit esse
sodales,
Vnde magis vane regia tecta colunt.
Hii puerum regem puerili more
subornant,
Pondera virtutum quo minus ipse
gerit.
Sunt etiam veteres cupidi, qui
lucra sequentes
Ad pueri placitum plura nephanda
sinunt:⁵²³
Cedunt morigeri, veniunt qui sunt
viciosi,
Quicquid et est vicii Curia Regis
habet.
Error ad omne latus pueri consurgit,
et ille,
Qui satis est docilis, concipit omne
570 malum:
Non dolus immo iocus, non fraus set
gloria ludi
Sunt pueris, set ei sors stat aborta
doli.
Sunt tamen occulte cause, quas
nullus in orbe

Scire potest, set eas scit magis ipse
deus:
Nescit enim mater nato que fata
parantur,
Fine set occultum clarius omne patet.
Taliam vox populi conclamat vbique
moderni
In dubio positi pre grauitate mali:
Sic ego condoleo super hiis que tedia
cerno,
Quo Regi puero scripta sequenda
580 fero.

545-580 *Text SCEHGDL As follows in TH₂*

Nunc magis ecce refert verbi clamantis ad aures⁵²⁴
Vox, et in hoc dicit tempore plura grauant.
Crimen et, vt clamat, fert maius curia maior,
Que foret instructor, legibus extat egens.
Ad commune bonum non est <modo> lingua locuta,⁵²⁵
550* Immo petit proprii commoda quisque lucri.
Agmen adulantum media procedit in aula,
Quodque iubet fieri, curia cedit eis:⁵²⁶
Set qui vera loqui presumunt, curia tales
Pellit, et ad regis non sinit esse latus.
Stat puer immunis culpe, set qui puerile
Instruerent regimen, non sine labe manent:
Sic non rex set consilium sunt causa doloris,
Quo quasi communi murmure plangit humus.
Tempora matura si rex etatis haberet,
560* Equaret libram que modo iure caret:
Regis namque modus alios moderatur, et omnis⁵²⁷
Iuris ad officium dicitur esse caput.
Si bonus esse velit rex, hii qui sunt bonitatis

Sunt magis edocti condicione bona:⁵²⁸
Si malus esse velit, simili rex sorte clientes,
Vt sibi complaciant, eligit, ornat, amat:⁵²⁹
Hoc set eum tangit discretum quem probat etas,
Non puerum, quia tunc fit sibi culpa minor
Non est nature lex nec rationis, vt illud
570* Quod mundum ledit sit puerile malum;
Non dolus, immo iocus, non fraus set gloria ludi,
Sunt pueris, nec ibi restat origo mali.
Dixit enim Daniel, quod de senioribus orta
Exiit impietas, quam furor orbis habet:
Omne quod est mundi vicium plantant veterani,
Et quasi de peste spersa venena serunt.⁵³⁰
Horum namque scelus fertur maculare figuras
Tocius mundi, quo furit ira dei.
Iamque supercreuit dolus et defecit honestas,⁵³¹
580* Sentit et opprobrium quod fuit ante decus.

**Hic loquitur quod, ex quo omnes quicumque mundi status sub regie
magestatis iusticia moderantur, intendit ad presens regnatura⁵³²
iam Regi nostro quandam epistolam doctrine causa⁵³³ editam
scribere consequenter, ex qua ille rex noster, qui modo in sua puerili
constituitur etate, cum vberiores postea sumpserit annos, gracia
mediante diuina, in suis regalibus exercendis euidencius instruatur. Et
primo dicit quod, quamuis regalis potencia quodammodo supra leges
extollatur, regiam tamen decet clemenciam, quod ipse bonis moribus
inherendo, quasi liber sub iusticie legibus se et suos in aspectu Regis
altissimi assidue gubernet.**

Cap^m. viii. Cumque sui Regis legi sit legius omnis
Subditus, et toto corpore seruit ei,
Est ita conueniens quod eum de corde fideli
Mentis in affectu legius omnis amet:
Regis et est proprium, commissam quod sibi plebem

Dirigat, et iusta lege gubernet eam.
 Hinc est, quod normam scriptis de pluribus ortam
 Regis ego laudi scribere tendo mei.
 O pie rex, audi que sit tua regula regni,
 590 Concordans legi mixtaque iure dei.
 Legum frena tenens freno te forcius arce;
 Dum nullum metuis, sis metus ipse tibi:
 Namque timor, virtus humilis, fugit omne superbum,
 Et quasi virtutum clauiger esse solet.
 Est tibi, rex, melius quod te de lege gubernes,
 Subdere quam mundi singula regna tibi:
 Est propter mundum tibi subdita sors aliorum,
 Tu propter celum subditus esto deo.
 Vt tibi deseruit populus de lege subactus,
 600 Cristi seruiciis temet ad instar habe:
 Vincere te studeas, alios qui vincis, et omnes
 Excessus animi subdere disce tui:
 Iustificans alios cupias te iustificare,
 Iuraque dans plebi, des ita iura tibi.
 Qui superas alios, temet superare labora;
 Si rex esse velis, te rege, rex et eris.
 Qua fore se regem poterit ratione fateri,
 Mentis qui proprie non regit acta sue?
 Non valet hoc regimen aliis conferre salutem,
 610 Dum sibi non fuerit rector, vt esse decet.
 Dum tibi cuncta licent, ne queras cuncta licere,
 Res etenim licite noxia sepe ferunt:
 Tu super es iura, iustus set viue sub illis, [534](#)
 Spesque tui nobis causa salutis erit.
 Est mors ira tua, potes id quod non licet, et te
 Prestita vota tamen ducere iuris habent:
 Quod licet illesa mentis precordia seruat,
 Omne tamen licitum non probat esse probum:
 Quod licet est tutum, set que potes illa sub arto
 620 Discute iudicio fultus honore tuo.
 Micius acta regas, aliter nisi causa requirat;
 Asperitas odium seuaque bella mouet.

Non te pretereat populi fortuna potentis
 Publica, set sapiens talia fata caue.
 Vita Pharaonis et gesta maligna Neronis,
 Que iusto regi sunt fugienda docent.
 O bone rex iuuenis, fac quod bonitate iuuentus
 Sit tua morigeris dedita rite modis.
 Quid tibi forma iuuat vel nobile nomen Auorum,
 630 Si viciis seruus factus es ipse tuis?
 Doctor Alexandri Magni prauos sibi mores
 Primitus edocuit, dum puer ipse fuit:
 Rex puer hec didicit, que post dum dedidicisse
 Temptauit, primus obstat abusus ei:
 Vicit Alexander Darium simul et Babilonem,
 Set nequit impressum vincere corde malum.
 Nuper in exemplis scripserunt sic sapientes,
 Quod prius imbuerit, testa tenere solet:
 Rex, igitur cicius viciosos pelle remotos,
 640 Nam vix turpe vetus nescit abire foras.
 Plaude bonis, fuge prauorum consortia, labem
 De pice tractata contrahit egra manus.

**Hic loquitur qualiter rex⁵³⁵ sibi male consulentes
 caucius euitare, proditoresque regni sui penitus
 extinguere, suorum eciam conditiones ministrorum
 diligencius inuestigare, et quos extra iusticiam
 errantes inuenerit, debita pena corrigere debet et
 districcius castigare.**

Cap^m. ix. Sordibus implicitos falsosque cauebis amicos,
 Qui tua deposcunt, te nec amare volunt:
 Blanda dolosorum fugias per verba leuari,
 Ne speciale tuum nomen ad yma ruant:
 Verba nimis leuiter audire que credere dicta
 Sepe supervacuus cogit inire metus.
 Vir qui bella mouet, qui predas consulit, et qui
 650 Conspirat taxas plebis habere tue,

O rex, oro tuas quod claudas talibus aures,
 Ne tua nobilitas lesa fatiscat eis. [536](#)
 Consilium regale tuum vir nullus avarus
 Tangat, set tales mortis ad instar habe.
 Illud in orbe malum non est, quod cordis avari
 Non latet in cella, dum sitit inde lucrum:
 Ambulat in tenebris, opus exercet tenebrarum,
 Odit et impugnat nil nisi pacis opus. [537](#)
 Qui mel in ore gerens, set habens in corde venenum,
 660 Pacis habet verbum, mente notando malum,
 Hic est versutus, inimicis regis amicus,
 Semper venalis, dum vacat ipse lucris;
 Vipereum genus et vanum plenumque veneno, [538](#)
 Fraudibus, insidiis, artibus arma parat:
 Semper in insidiis sedet incautisque nocere
 Temptat, et occulto fabricat ipse dolos.
 Hic rimans animos hominum secreta reuelat,
 Et similis Iude fabricat acta sua.
 Qui te sollicitat, rex, et subuertere temptat,
 670 Qui te persuadet soluere iussa dei,
 Quis sit et ipse vide, qualis vel condicionis,
 Aut tibi si vera dicere verba velit.
 Discute mente prius animum temptantis, et audi
 Si vel constanter vel dubitanter agat,
 Si tibi preponat dubium, mendacia fingens:
 Semper deprendi verba dolosa timent.
 Cum sit causa doli, pie rex, tu credere noli,
 Si quis agat praue, tu sua facta caue.
 Multus non credit, nisi cum res noxia ledit; [539](#)
 680 Ante manum sapiens prouidet acta regens:
 Decipiuntur aues per cantus sepe suaues;
 Blande, rex, lingue mellea verba fuge.
 Rex, bona digna bonis da premia, rex, et iniquis
 Que sua promeruit premia culpa dabis:
 Latro bonus veniam Cristo miserante meretur,
 Penam promeruit in cruce latro malus.
 Obsequium prauum trahit e manibus graue donum,

Que sunt facta suo fine notabit homo.
 Si scelus vlcisci ratio certissima poscit,
 690 Iustus in hoc casu quod decet illud age.
 Ficta tibi pietas non mulceat aspera iuris,
 Vlcio iudicium compleat immo tuum:
 Sepe pericla fera fert iudicis vlcio tarda,
 Destruit ille bonos qui sinit esse malos.
 Diuersas penas diuersis addito culpis,
 Mille mali species, mille salutis erunt.
 Iudicii signum gladius monstrare videtur,
 Proditor vt periat, rex tenet arma secus: [540](#)
 Rex iubeat tales laqueo super alta leuari,
 700 Ne periat Regis legis et ille status. [541](#)
 Rex, age, ne plebis furiens discordia dicat,
 'Lex caruit rege iura paterna regens':
 Absit et hoc vulgo ne dicat, iure remoto,
 Quod nichil auxilii principis vmbra facit.
 Fraus cum fraude sua periat de morte remorsa, [541](#)
 Vt stet iusticia regia laude tua:
 Sic dicant populi, 'Sit semper gloria regi,
 Quo bona pax viguit, quo reus acta luit.'
 Precipitur gladius vibratus semper haberi,
 710 Prompcius vt crimen iudiciale ferat:
 Ense quiescente, compescere non valet orbem;
 Qui regnare cupit sanguine iura colat.
 Arma ferunt pacem, compescunt arma rapacem,
 Vt reus hec timeat, rex probus arma gerat;
 Nomine subque tuo ledant ne forte quirites,
 Plebem te tenero corde videre decet:
 Si vis namque tuos non castigare ministros,
 Crimen habet culpe regia culpa sue.
 Euolat ancipiter ad predas, lucra suisque
 720 Deseruit dominis in rapiendo cibos:
 Sic sunt qui regi famulando suos et ad vsus
 Tollunt pauperibus dampna ferendo nimis.
 In prece pondus habet pauper qui clamat egenus
 Ad dominum, memor est pauperis ipse sui.

Sicut enim presul, qui custos est animarum,
Pondus in officio debet habere suo;
Compotus vtque suus, sic stabit et vltima merces,
Gloria vel pena perpetuatur ei;
Rex ita qui nostrum moderaris legibus orbem,
730 Dona tuis meritis conferet equa deus.
Posse tuum grande, rex, est, que potencior ille,
Omne tuum cuius dextera librat opus.

**Hic dicit quod rex sano consilio adhereat, ecclesie
iura supportet et erigat,⁵⁴² equus in iudiciis et pietosus
existat, suamque famam cunctis mundi opibus
preponat.**

Cap^m. x. Sperne malos, cole prudentes, compesce rebelles,
Da miseris, sontes respue, parce reis.
Quicquid agas, vicio numquam mergatur honestum;
Fama lucro, rebus preficiatur opus.
Nil tibi, rex, fingas pro mundo, quo reputeris
Iustus apud proceres et reus ante deum:
Ecclesiam studeas multa pietate fouere,
740 Cuius enim precibus vult diadema geri.
Pauperis et vidue dum cernis adesse querelas,
Iudicium miseris cum pietate geras.
Expedit interdum sanccta remittere legum,⁵⁴³
Ne periat pietas de feritate tua:
Indulgere tuis tua sic dignetur honestas,
Nam puto sepe deum viuere velle reum.
Par quoque portet onus sic nobilis atque colonus,
Et nichil archanum polluat ante manum.
Ardua si causa tibi sit, videas, quia certe
750 Tarda solet magnis rebus inesse fides.
Rebus in ambiguis tu certum ponere noli,
Fallitur augurio spes bona sepe suo:
Est magis humani generis iactura dolori,
Nescit principium quid sibi finis aget.

Dum tibi suadet opus tractare negocia regni,
Consilium regat hoc cum seniore senex.
Ibit in occasum quicquid dicemus ad ortum,
Lingua loquax habitum nesciat ergo tuum.
Consilium prauum regalem turbat honorem,
760 Prouocat inque scelus que bona pacis erant.
Iura dabit populo senior, discretaque iustis
Legibus est etas vnde petatur honor.
Est satis ille senex, cuius sapientia sensum
Firmat in etate, sit licet ipse minor.
Non stabiles animos veteres fatuam ve iuuentam [544](#)
Comprobo, non etas sic sua iura dedit:
In sene multociens stat condicio iuuenilis,
Dum iuuenis mores obtinet ipse senis.
Caucius ergo statum videas, pie rex, ad vtrumque;
770 Vnde legas homines, tu prius acta proba.
Qui tibi seruicium prebet nec inuutilis aurum
Appetit, hic seruus debeat esse tuus:
Dulcius est mercede labor qui regis honorem
Spectat, et in tali spem tibi ferre potes.
Est qui pacificus, est vir qui iuris amicus,
Liber auaricie, largus ad omne bonum,
Vtere consilio tali, pie rex, vt habundet
Cronica perpetue laudis in orbe tue.
Fama volans gratis, nullo soluente catenas, [545](#)
780 Proclamat meritis ista vel illa tuis:
Nomen, crede, bonum gasas precellit, honorem
Conseruat, remouet scandala, laude viget:
Tange bonum florem, dulcem prestabit odorem,
Sic virtusque viri fragrat vbique boni.
Consule doctores legis, discede malorum
A conuenticulis, concomitare bonos:
Vt granum de messe tibi, de fonte salubri
Pocula, de docto dogmata mente legas.

Hic loquitur qualiter regiam libertatem in viciis nullatenus decet incidere seruitutem, set sicut coram populo alios excellit potencia, ita coram deo pre ceteris ampliori virtutum clarescat habundancia.

Cap^m. xi. Gloria nulla, precor, te, rex, extollat inanis,
790 Tedia nam populis vita superba parit.
Musca nocet modica, modicis sis prouidus ergo,[546](#)
Non faciunt tutos regia ceptra suos:[547](#)
Exiguus magnum vicit Dauid ille Goliam,
Nam virtus humilis corda superba domat.
Cristus amans humiles leuat, et de corde superbos
Obruit, ergo pie, rex, tua regna rege.
Sit tibi credibilis sermo consultaque verba,
Quo, quibus et quando, sicut oportet agi:
Vt scriptura fidem tuus addat sermo per aures,
800 Verba minus certi ficta timoris habent.
Mocio, rex, in te subito non irruat ire;
Causas iusticie set moderanter age:
Ira mouens animum tollit sibi vim rationis,
Et discreta sue mentis agenda negat.
Mors et vita tuis manibus de lege feruntur,
Prouidus in causis te decet esse magis:
Nulla cupido tuam valeat corrumpere famam,
Immo tuis donis gaudeat omnis humus.
Seruus auaricie non debet nobilis esse
810 Rex, set erit regis liber vbique status.
Larga tuis meritis inopes elemosina curet,
Qua poteris regem pacificare deum:
Fac bona queque potes modico dum tempore viuis;
Multa metes, si nunc semina pauca seris.
Da tua non parce, cui des tamen aspice caute;
Crede, satis res est ingeniosa dare:
Non perit hec probitas que dona rependit honeste,
Namque piam laudem res data dantis habet.
Sepe iuuat, nec eo minor est substantia ponti,

820 Qui modicam pleno flumine sumit aquam:
 Sic tua rite iuuat miseros elemosina sumpta,
 Nec erit argenti sic tua summa minor.
 Si quis amore dei miseris sua dona ministrat,
 Munera tempus habent, fama perhennis erit.
 Scindantur vestes, gemme frangantur et aurum,
 Porrige pauperibus que dedit ante deus.
 Est ancilla dei simplex elemosina, mortis
 Antitodum, venie porta, salutis iter:
 Disputat aduersus dantis peccata, perorat
 830 Auctori, redimit probra, precatur opem.
 Peccatum mors est anime, mors debita pena
 Peccato, set in hoc mens pia delet eam.
 Absit culpa gule tibi, rex, nam regis honestas
 Omnis mundicie debet honore frui:
 Illud enim viciū primeū labe parentem
 Dampnavit, fragilis quo cadit ipse reus:
 Hostis in hoc vicio Cristum temptavit, et ipse,
 Qui rex est verus, respuit illud opus:
 Ecce Saül pugnare volens ieiunia cunctis
 840 Imposuit, donec hostica tela domet.
 Rex, tibi pigriciem pellas et motibus obsta
 Carnis, et ad mores arripe fortis iter:
 Regius vtque status plebem supereminet omnem,
 Nobilis in gestu sic magis ille foret.
 O tener annorum, dolus in quo nullus habetur,
 Simplex nobilitas, perfida tela caue:
 Etas namque doli non te sinit esse capacem,
 Non te vultque tuum degenerare genus.
 Sunt tibi forma, genus, honor, ordo, decus que
 potestas;⁵⁴⁸
 850 Contulit hec ortus libera dona tuus:
 Teque sequantur ita laus, virtus, gracia morum,
 Et sic plenus homo, rex pie, viue deo.

**Hic loquitur qualiter rex a sue carnis voluptate
illicebra⁵⁴⁹ specialiter se debet abstinere, et sub sacre
legis constitutione propter diuinam offensam sue
coniugis tantum licito fruatur consorcio.**

Cap^m. xii. O super omne fuge, pie rex, ne ceca voluptas

Carnis ad illicebra prouocet acta tua;

Sponsus set propria de legibus vtere sponsa,

Nec spolies sacrum laudis honore thorum.

Nulla vetus scriptura docet regum quod ab euo

Stant Venus et regnum pacificata simul:

Intendat Veneri quod homo simul et rationi,

860 Numquam possibile creditur illud opus.

Pluribus exemplis tibi luxus erit fugiendus;

Biblia que docuit, respice facta Daud:

Involuit regem processu temporis error,

Eius dum rapuit cor mulieris amor:

Quis dolor inde fuit, seu que vindicta secuta,

Terret adhuc animum qui legit illa viri.

Sit tibi culpa Daud speculum, speculeris in illo,

Casus vt alterius te super alta leuet:

Felix quem faciunt aliena pericula cautum,

870 Precauet vnde vias quas videt ante manum.

Respice, dum populum fraus nulla valebat Hebreum

Vincere, femineus vicit amore dolus.

Exemplis Balaam docearis, quomodo regem⁵⁵⁰

Ipse Balak docuit, qualiter ecce fuit.

Consilium dedit ipse Balak, qua turbet Hebreos

Arte, quibus frangat hostica bella dolis.

‘Accipe, rex,’ inquit, ‘quo consilio potes vti:

Non vincit populus viribus ille suis;

Immo colendo deum corpusque gerendo pudicum,

880 Vincere semper habet ille per ista duo.

Vt superes illum non Marte set arte, puellas

Elige, quas ornat vestis et oris honor;

Que manibus plaudant, pede ludant, noctibus ignem

Spirant, plectra gerant, astra decore premant:

Non rigor armorum set lusus pugnet amorum,
 Non acuum ferrum, set muliebre forum:
 Sic species vincat acies, sic arma virorum
 Forma puellarum sub pede victa terat.
 Celestis sic ira dei consurget in illos,
 890 Sic victor populi leta trophea feres.'⁵⁵¹
 Rex hoc consilium credens dedit esse, puellas
 Preparat insignes sidereasque genas:
 Prelia mira parat, arcu non arcet Hebreos,
 Non ferit hos ferro nec feriendo fugat:⁵⁵²
 Pugnat non equitum loricis, set nec equorum
 Loris, immo liris femineisque choris.
 Hec canit, hec ludit, hec adiuuat arte decorem,
 Vt gemino vultu fallat in ore decor;
 Per faciem iacit ista facem, vomit hec per ocellos⁵⁵³
 900 Sintillas, profert illa per ora fauos:
 Hee species animos predantur plebis Hebre;e;
 Peccant, peccantes opprimit ira dei.
 Rex tibi sume notam, quam te docet experimentum,
 Et vetus exemplum det tibi scire modum.
 Rex, et in exemplis regis concerne Saülis,
 Femina dum superest, qualia mira potest:
 Demonis arte potens Maga suscitatur illa prophetam,
 Regis et ad nutum stare coegit eum.
 Corpora que poterat sibi subdere mortua, viuos
 910 Arte magis facili subderet illa viros.
 Qui premunitur non fallitur, ergo cauendum
 Est tibi, rex, corpus vt sine labe regas.
 Rex es, regina satis est tibi sufficit vna;
 Hanc tibi consocias, sic docet alma fides:
 Rex, ita si fugias viciorum pondera, mores
 Et teneas, poteris quicquid habere velis.

**Hic loquitur et ponit magnifico iam regi nostro
 Iuueni nuper Serenissimi Principis patris sui
 exempla, dicens quod, vbi et quando necessitatis illud**

**exigit facultas, rex contra suos hostes armorum
probitates audacter exerceat,⁵⁵⁴ et quod ille nulla
aduersitate constanciam sui vultus videntibus aliis
amittat.**

Cap^m. xiii. Est tibi, rex, aliud, quod sis defensor in armis
Plebis; et vt iura de probitate tegas,
Huius in exemplum reminiscere facta paterna,
920 Cuius adhuc vigilans laus vbicumque sonat.
Numquam de terra nomen delebitur eius,
Precellunt armis Hectoris arma sua;
Inque suam laudem que tuam mea scripta reuoluo,
Vt probitate memor sit tibi patris honor.
Iustus erat iustos, probus vnde probos sibi legit,
Nec sinit vrticas commaculare rosam:
Confluit in donis non parce dona merenti,
De largo corde fit sibi larga manus:
Extera depredat loca, set sua propria seruat,
930 Et sibi commisse prospera plebis agit.
Eius enim laudes si nos cantabimus omnes,
Omnia sunt meritis ora minora suis:
Nulla suum meritum poterit complectere fama,
Vox minor est omnis laude ferenda sua.
Vt breuitate loquar, tantus princeps fuit ille,
Laudantum poterit quantus ab ore cani.
Francia sentit eum, recolens Hispannia vires,
Vnde subegit eam de probitate, timet.
Turbans hostiles turmas mediosque per hostes
940 Irruit, et rumpit more leonis iter:
Vt lupo ipse fame strictus dispergit ouile,
Hos premit, hos perimit, hos secat hosque necat.
Sobrius in gestis semper fuit ille, set hostis
Sanguine sepe suus ebrius ensis erat:
Pugnat et impugnat expugnans acriter hostes,⁵⁵⁵
Vaginant siccus mucro subire negat:
Fit satur hostilis hostili sanguine mucro,
Armorum pascit sanguinis vnda sitim

950 Intra vaginam mucro torpere recusat,
 Euomitur gladius eius ab ore foras.
 Sicut aper querulis siluis latratibus actus
 Letifero celeres conterit ore canes,
 Sic magis audaces prope se quos attigit hostes,
 Fulmineo gladii triuit in ore sui.
 Singula perdomuit fera prelia more leonis;
 Depopulans populos forcia castra ruit:
 Vt predas raperet, audax descendit in hostes,
 Hostica sunt eius colla subacta manu:
 Colla superborum premit eius dextra per orbem;
 960 Sic leopardus eo dicitur esse leo.
 Terra quieta fuit sub tali principe magno,
 Non terret gladius quos tegit illa manus:
 Sub ficu, sub vite sua, sub fronde, sub vmbra,
 Quisque manet tutus nobilis ense ducis:
 Sic robusta sua virtus plus surgit in altum,
 Plus viget hoste suo, plus probitatis habet.
 O rex, facta tui retine tibi patris, vt illa
 Laus, quam promeruit, sit tribuenda tibi.
 Audaces fortuna iuuans consummat in actum
 970 Que sibi vult animus, et pociora dabit.
 Pax super omne bonum scandit, set quando probata
 Bellum iura petunt, illud oportet agi:
 Est tempus belli, sic sunt et tempora pacis,
 Actibus in cunctis tu moderamen habe.
 Hector, Alexander, fuerant dum nobiliores,
 Sistere disparibus non potuere rotis:
 Acta patris vince, maiorque vocaberis illo,
 Totaque vox clamet laudis honore tue.
 Rebus in aduersis ne laxes frena timori,⁵⁵⁶
 980 Si dolor in mente sit, sine teste dole:
 Si dolor incurrat animum, simulacio vultum
 Erigat, et facies contegat inde metum:
 Vultus iocundus timor hostibus est et amicis
 Gloria, nam facies nuncia mentis erit.

**Hic loquitur, quod absque iusticie experta causa
rex bellare non debet. Dicit insuper quod regie
congruit dignitati, discreto tamen prouiso regimine,
magis amore quam austeritatis rigore suos subditos
tractare.**

- Cap^m. xiiii. Alta petens aquila volat alite celsius omni,
Et regem mundum corde figurat ea.
Vt sacra testantur citharistea scripta prophete, [557](#)
In celum tales cor posuere suum.
Pennatum Griphes animal pedibusque quaternis
990 Invitos homines carpit et horret equos:
Designatur in hoc facinus crudele potentum,
Qui mortes hominum cum feritate vorant.
Est igitur melius aquile tibi sumere formam, [558](#)
Rex, vt amore pio regna quieta regas,
Griphis quam specie populum terrere pauore,
Semper enim superat acta timoris amor.
Non omnis qui timet amat, set amans timet omnis;
Plebs in amore manens plectit vtrumque simul.
Omnia vincit amor, amor est defensio regis,
1000 Gloria plebis amor, laus et in orbe deo:
Plebs est regis ager, rex cultor qui colit agrum, [559](#)
Si male, fert tribulos, si bene, grana parit.
Qui bene regis agit regimen, rex est, set inique
Qui regit in viciis, ipse tyrannus erit.
Si rex de prediis viuatur, maledictio plebis
Murmurat, et regi mota fit ira dei.
Lucratur populum que deum rex iustus vtrumque,
Statque per hoc regni firma corona sui.
Tange tuum pectus, pie rex, quo sumere possis
1010 Regis ad imperium que meliora parant:
Si te nobilitas generosaque nomina tangunt,
In genus exemplum fer magis ipse tuum:
Nomine perspicuo cum sis generosus auorum,
Equipares stirpis moribus acta tuis.
Hoc in honore dei communi voce precamur,

Vt gemines animi nobilitate genus.
 Pars sit in aspectu tibi quem deus equiparauit
 Natura, precio, condicione pari:
 Disceque cunctorum quod sit communis origo,
 1020 Ortus et occasus vnus, et vna caro.
 Nobilis est mentis quisquis virtute refulget,
 Degener est solus cui mala vita placet;
 Mores namque bonos veneratur curia celi,
 Et celum iustus, non generosus, habet.
 Esto memor, quod fratris amor tibi cuncta ministrat,
 Datque tibi solus omnia fratris amor:
 Fratris amor transit terrena, superna resumtis
 Viribus ascendit, astra polumque petit:
 Noticiamque dei dum querit, ad astra volare
 1030 Non timet, vt videat quis deus ipse Syon,
 Quis rex inmensus et que sit visio pacis,
 Quis ve locus celi, gloria quanta dei.
 Ista decent regem meditari, sit quod in illis
 Aprior vt reddat debita iura deo.
 Noscere te studeas et amare deum, duo namque
 Hec sunt, que tibi, rex, scire necesse iubet.
 Hec est condicio sub qua tibi contulit esse
 Viuendique modum conditor ipse tuus.

**Hic loquitur secundum Salomonis experientiam,
 quod ceteris virtutibus ad regni gubernaculum
 preualet sapiencia, que deo et hominibus regem
 magis reddit acceptabilem.**

Cap^m. xv. O pie rex iuuenis, iuuenili quid Salomoni
 1040 Contigit intende, sis memor vnde tui:
 Hic bis sex puer annorum cum sacra dedisset
 Dona deo, meruit nocte videre deum:
 Quem deus alloquitur, ‘Pete quod vis munus,’ et inquit
 Ille, ‘Peto sensum, quo mea regna regam.’
 Regia diuino placuerunt verba fauori,

Responsumque deus reddidit istud ei:
 'Non plures annos nec opes nec ab hoste triumphos
 Quesisti, dentur que petis ergo tibi:
 Non solum sapiens, set diues eris super omnes,
 1050 Quos habuit mundus, quos vel habere potest.'
 O bene si speculo, rex, te speculeris in isto,
 Quid magis expediens sit tibi scire potes.
 Hiis tamen exemplis patet vt sapiencia regis
 Ad regimen plebis est adhibenda prius.
 Annus et annus abit, semper sapiencia stabit;
 Stans super hanc petram non cadet vlla domus.
 Res est grata senem iuueniliter esse iocosum,
 Gracior est iuuenem moribus esse senem.
 Qui gressu morum sequitur quo vult deus, illum
 1060 Precedit que suas firmat vbique vias.
 Mane precare deum, quod leta dies tibi plaudat,
 Vespere, quod tutus tempora noctis agas:
 Nam rex qui summo se vult submittere regi,
 Optinet in regno cuncta petita suo.
 In manibus regum regalia ceptra tenentur,
 Vt quasi per virgam cuncta nociua fugat.
 O rex, ergo tue tua legi debita solue,
 Corporis ac anime quod sit honoris age:
 Sume bonos, depelle malos, sis iuris amator,
 1070 Sis pius et populum dirige lege tuum:
 Set lex vt prosit, accedat gracia legi
 Per Cristum, sine quo lex bona nulla datur:
 Sit tibi iuris honor, timor excicii, pudor almus, [560](#)
 Simplicitas animi, proximitatis amor.
 Rex, ita si sapiens sapias sapienter ad omnes,
 Tunc sapis in Cristo regna sapore bono.

**Hic loquitur qualiter celi deus, qui est rex regum
 et dominus dominancium, a regibus terre pura mente
 precipue colendus est et super omnia metuendus.**

Cap^m. xvi. O rex, quicquid habes dedit hoc deus, et nichil a te

Est quod habes proprium, vel quod habere potes:

Esse creaturam te nosce dei, nec ab eius

1080 Tu discede viis, si bene stare velis.

Nobile corpus habes et singula membra decora,

Sit virtus animi sic magis illa tibi:

Vt foris est forma tibi splendida, splendeat intra

Mens tua, quod tibi, rex, sit decor ille duplex.

Labile forma bonum, species inimica pudoris

Vtile virtutum sepe retardat iter:

Forma dei munus, forma pars multa superbit,

Non tamen in sanctis stat viciata viris:

Non tibi forma deum set mens sincera meretur,

1090 Iusticie soli vita beata datur.

Non decet in rege quod mens contraria forme

Sit, set ab interius exteriora regas.

Qui tibi regna tulit, alii quo te venerantur,

Rex, in honore dei da tua vota deo.

Qui pius est Cristo, regi nichil ingruit hostis,

Subdita fortune sors magis immo fauet.

Si cupis vt timeant hostes tua ceptra, superni

Ceptra dei timeas, tuque timendus eris:

Sit tibi celsithronus metuendus ab arce polorum,

1100 Cuius ad imperium flectitur omne genu.

Hic ruit, exaltat, infirmat, firmat et orbem,

Singula fertque sua regia corda manu:

Hic est rex in quo regnant per secula reges,

Hic est rex sine quo regna subacta cadunt,

Hic est rex per quem mors fine suo rapit omnes

Reges, reddit eos actibus atque suis.

Magnus erat Cesar totoque potencior orbe,

Nunc quem nec mundus ceperat, vrna capit.

Sic et Alexander fortissimus ille Macedo

1110 Clauditur angusto, puluis et ossa, loco:

Maior erat magno mundo, modo nobile corpus

Exulis et victi vilis arena tegit.

Ecce diu res nulla manet mortalibus, ecce

Nullus honor prohibet, gloria nulla mori:
Non prosunt quicquam preconia vana sepultis,
Torquent famosos tartara sepe reos.
O de preteritis, pie rex, memorare futura,
Et reputa firmum quod sit in orbe nichil:
Cumque tibi spacium vite conceditur huius,
1120 Semper ad omne bonum viue paratus opus.
Subditus esto deo, si tu vis vincere mundum:
Qui Cristo seruit, optima regna regit.

**Hic loquitur qualiter rex in⁵⁶¹ caritate dei et
proximi viuens, contra superuenientem mortem, que
nulli parcit regi, omni se debet diligencia prouidere.**

Cap^m. xvii. Omnes de morte statuit natura timere,
Sub cuius lege terminat omne genus:
Doctus et indoctus, pauper que potens moriuntur,
Omnes fine pari mors facit esse pares.
Vnccio nil valet hic, nichil hic insignia rerum
Regia, non sanant nec medicamen habent:
Gloria nulla potest in mundi rebus haberi,
1130 Nec quo se mundus tunc tueatur habet.
Disce quod omnis honor oneri coniunctus adheret,
Est onus in fine maius honore tamen:
Cum magis excelsus fueris, magis adde timorem,
Ardua nam preceps gloria vadit iter.
Est hominis vita quasi milicies reputata,
Bella super terram nam tria semper agit:
Rex qui per medium belli transibit inermis,
Sepius incaute stulcior ipse cadit.
O rex, ergo tibi bene prouideas, quod iturus
1140 Es, set vbi nescis, alta vel yma petens.
Omnia leta vale tibi sunt dictura memento,
Pauperis et regis exitus vnus erit;⁵⁶²
Nam nemo per se subsistere, nemo supremum
Securo poterit claudere fine diem.

Vt te de mundo moueas, bonus esse viator
Incipias, Cristi te sacra scripta monent:
Vt fugias hiemem scelerum, te floribus orna
Morum, virtutum luce choruscus eas.⁵⁶³
Motus ab Egipto veluti tentoria tendis,
1150 Ad patriam vite dum properare studes.
Esto memor quod sis factus factoris ymago:
Cur? vt ei similis iure sequaris eum.
Expedit ergo tibi, totis vt viribus illum,
Qui te formauit teque redemit, ames.
Tanti regis opem, rex, ora, quod tibi vitam
Supleat et mortem muniat ipse tuam.⁵⁶⁴
Fac ea que tibi vis, bona vel mala, sic et habebis,
Te tamen in melius dirigat oro deus.

**Hic in fine regis epistolam breuiter concludit,
dicens quod, sicut rex ex sue libertatis
priuilegio sublimari et inde coram populo
dominari magnificus affectabit, ita ad onus sui
regiminis cum omni iusticia supportandum
coram deo iustum et humilem se presentabit.
Non aliter stabit regnum quod rex variabit.**

Cap^m. xviii. Regia maiestas veneracior est super
omnes,
Dum probus in regno rex regit acta
1160 suo.
Ipse deum primo placat, populi que
secundo
Corda trahit, mundum sic habet ipse
bonum:
In terra pacem scrutatur et inuenit
illam,
Quo celi regnum possidet ante deum:
Sic magnus mundo viuus, set maior
olimpo
Mortuus, in Cristo regnat vtroque
loco.

Ista bono regi bona de bonitate
superni
Adueniunt; aliter non ita stabit iter.
Si rex sit vanus, sit auarus, sitque
superbus,
Quo regnum torquet, terra subacta
1170 dolet.
Omne quod est regi placitum non
expedit illi,
Que sibi iura volunt, absque rigore
licent:
Mira potest regis pro tempore ferre
potestas,
Vana tamen finis comprobat acta
satis.
Si positum lance sit onus cum regis
honore,
Non honor est tantus sicut habetur
onus.
Rex sibi commissas regni componere
leges
Debet, et a nullo tollere iura viro:
Nunc tamen in plebe vox est, quod
deficiente
1180 Lege dolus iura vendicat esse sua:
Sic bona iusticie fraus compta
subintrat, et inde
Inficit occultam lex hodierna fidem.
Quo lex decessit, error sibi regna
repressit,
Vnde decet regem ponere iuris opem.
O rex, ergo tui detergas crimina
regni,
Et rege discretus que tibi suadet
opus:
Perdita restaures communia iura, que
leges

Ad regnum reuoca, crimen et omne
fuga.
Si tibi subiectum cupias conuertere
regnum,⁵⁶⁵
1190 Te prius in Cristo fac revenire deo:⁵⁶⁶
Postque tuum populum stabilem tibi
pacificatum
Non vice terroris fac set amore
magis.
Corda tue plebis ita dum patienter
habebis,
Nobilis in regno stabis vbique tuo:
Dumque tuas leges mixtas pietate
gubernes,
Cuncta tue laudi gesta feruntur ibi.
Si tamen econtra rigidus tua verteris
acta,
Vertet se populus qui solet esse tuus.
Hec tibi, rex, scribo pro tempore
nunc que futuro;
Semper in ambiguo sors variatur
1200 humo.

*The chapter stands as above in SCEHG (over erasure in all except E):
the original form is given by DTH₂, and both forms (the original first) by
LL₂.*

**Hic loquitur in fine istius Epistole, vbi pro statu
Regis devocius exorat, vt deus ipsius etatem iam
floridam in omni prosperitate conseruet, et ad
laudem dei suique et sibi commisse plebis vtilitatem
feliciter perducatur in euum.**

Rex celi deus et dominus, qui tempora solus

Cap^m.Condidit, et solus condita cuncta regit;
 xviii*.Qui rerum causas ex se produxit, et vnum
 1160* In se principium rebus inesse dedit;
 Qui dedit vt stabili motu consisteret orbis
 Fixus ineternum mobilitate sua;
 Quique potens verbi produxit ad esse creata, [567](#)
 Quique sue mentis lege ligauit ea;
 Ipse meum Iuuenem conseruet supplico Regem,
 Quem videant sanum prospera Regna senem;
 Ipse iuuentutem regat et producat in eum,
 1170* Semper et in melius dirigat acta deus.
 Consilium nullum te tangere possit iniquum, [568](#)
 Rex nec in hac terra proditor esse tua;
 Omne malum cedat, ne ledere possit, et omne
 Est quod in orbe bonum, det deus esse tuum.
 O tibi, Rex, euo detur, fortissime, nostro
 Semper honorata ceptra tenere manu;
 Assit et illa dies, qua tu, pulcherrime Regum,
 Quatuor in niueis aureus ibis equis. [569](#)
 Qualis et Augusti nuper preconia Rome
 1180* Extiterant laudis sint renouanda tibi. [570](#)
 Augeat imperium nostri ducis, augeat annos,
 Protegat et nostras aucta corona fores: [571](#)
 Stes magis, o pie Rex, domito sublimis in orbe,
 Cunctaque sint humeris inferiora tuis.
 Que magis eterne sunt laudis summus ab alto
 Aurea det dextre fulgida ceptra tue:
 Qui tibi prima dedit, confirmet Regna futuri,
 Vt poteris magno magnus honore frui.
 Sic tua processus habeat fortuna perhennes, [572](#)
 1190* Vt recolant laudes secula cuncta tuas.
 Ad decus imperii, Rex, ista tui metra scripsi
 Seruus ego Regni promptus honore tibi.
 Hec tibi que, pie Rex, humili de corde parauit,
 Scripta tue laudi suscipe dona dei:
 Non est ista mea tantum doctrina, sed eius

Qui docet, et dociles solus ab ore creat.
O iuuenile decus, laus Regia, flos puerorum,
Vt valor est in te, sic tibi dico vale.

**Quia, prout de communi voce audistis,
modernorum condiciones per vniuersum orbem
erroribus vbique mutantur, nunc de illorum
condicionibus qui nos precesserunt, precipue in
ecclesia, que iam diuisa est, diuersitatem sub
exemplis figuratam consequenter videamus.** [573](#)

Cap^m. xix. Poma cadunt ramis, agitantur ab Illice glandes,
Marcescunt flores, defluit orta seges:
Proles granifera desistit reddere grana,
Irrita thura deo templa geruntque modo:
Qui color albus erat, nunc est contrarius albo,
Pallet et hec gemma que renitere solet.
Nunc est quod Babilon super vrbes nobilitatur,
Nec manus est fidei talis vt obstet
ei; [574](#)

Ecclesieque nouis virtus iacet obruta sompnis,
1210 Et Synagoga quasi fit modo sponsa dei. [575](#)
Nunc iustos veteres constat nec habere sequaces,
Omnes set morti preteriere boni:
Sique mali fuerant tunc temporis, ecce reuiuunt,
Dummodo consimilis mos sit in orbe malis.

Decidit in mortem Noë iustus, surgit et ille
Nembrot in arce Babel, spernit et ipse deum: [576](#)
Mortuus estque Iaphet, operit patris ipse pudenda,
Set modo deridens Cham patefecit ea.
Mortuus est Abraham fidei primordia
querens, [577](#)

Belus adest, que deos fabricat ipse
1220 nouos. [578](#)

Mortuus est Ysaac, oritur genus vnde
beatum, [579](#)
Set modo degenerans Hismael obstat
ei: [580](#)

Mortuus estque Ioseph, erat ille pudicus, et Oza [581](#)
Nunc sequitur carnem luxus amore
suam.

Mortuus est Moyses veteri de lege refulgens, [582](#)
Transgrediens Abiron viuit in orbe
tamen. [583](#)

Quem deus elegit Aron mors morte subegit,
Fomes et inuidie dat thimiam Chore.

1230 Mortuus est curru celum qui scandit Helias,
Infera qui meruit viuit et ipse Dathan. [584](#)

Micheas moritur, viuit nec in orbe secundus,
Qui modo veridicus audet obesse malis;
Nam Sedechias super omnes esse prophetas
Vendicat, et cuncti nunc famulantur ei.
Est nec Heliseus, Naaman neque fit modo sanus,
Vult tamen en Giesi sumere dona sibi.

Euolat ex archa modo nec redit ipsa columba,
Cuius enim coruus iam regit ipse vices.
Sic capit exempla nullus de lege vetusta,
1240 Quo testamentum defluit ecce nouum.

Dic vbi sunt illi qui nuper in ordine Cristi
Rebus et exemplis dogmata sancta dabant.
Mortuus est Petrus, stat Liberius modo, cuius
Custodit portas Simon in arte Magus.

Nuper conuersum de Saulo sencio Paulum,
Saulum de Paulo nuncque redire scio.

Gregorii scripta verbis seruanda iubemus,
Nostris set factis ipsa neganda damus.

Martini legimus donum, set diuitis aures
1250 Nos surdas gerimus, quo bona nulla damus.
Dic vbi defunctis alter sit in orbe Thobias, [585](#)
Dic vbi vel pietas corda moderna mouet.

Aduerso paciens, conuerso tempore mitis,
Iob fuit, et stabili mente remansit idem:
Nunc tamen econtra de prosperitate superbit
Omnis, et aduerso tempore murmur agit.

Ordinis instructor nunc mortuus est Benedictus,
Set Iulianus adhuc viuit et obstat ei.
Fallit sal terre, non est in quo salietur,
1260 Fetet ob hoc anima crimine carnis olens.
Non moritur granum, manet in se set modo solum,
Occupat et terram cardo que vastat eam:
Non manet in vite modo palmes, sic neque fructus
Fert ea, set sterilis sicca cremanda iacet.
Lux perit a Phebo stellarum lumine verso,
Et sinit eclipsim subdita luna suam.
Nunc nouus est Arius, nouus est quasi Iouinianus;
Dum plantant heresim, dant dubitare fidem:
Ecce diem noctem dicunt, tenebras quoque lucem,
1270 Iniustum rectum; sic perit omne bonum.

**Hic tractat quod, sicut virtuosus nuper in ecclesia
existentibus succedunt viciosi, sic et mundi
proceribus omnis milicie nuper de probitate famosis
succedunt modo alii, qui neque diuine neque humane
laudis digni efficiuntur.**

Cap^m. xx. Legis diuine si cultores abiere,
Sic proceres mundi nunc abiere probi.
Mortuus est iustus Troianus, et ecce tyrannus
Iusta statuta modo deprimit ipse Nero:
Conditor et legum nunc Iustinianus abiuit,
Set Dionisius has dampnat habere suas.
Mortuus est castus probus atque Valentinianus,
Tarquinus ceptri iam regit acta sui.
Largus Alexander moritur rex nuper opimus,
1280 Et modo successit Cresus auarus ei.
Mortuus ille pius est Constantinus, et ecce

Antonius solio iam sedet ipse suo.
 Ecclesie cultor Theodosius ipse recessit,
 Successitque Leo, soluere vult et eam:
 Insultor fidei Constancius acta prophanat,
 Tiberiique modo deperit alma fides.
 Mortuus est Iulius, qui regna subegit in armis,
 Et Romam statuit omnibus esse caput.
 Mortuus est Hanibal, per quem Cartago vigeat,
 1290 Iam neque Cartago, set neque Roma viget.
 Hector, in ense suo qui nuper erat metuendus,
 Nunc magis est Heleno bella timente pauens:
 Corruit Eacides, pro quo surrexit inermis
 Tersites, que suus indiget ensis ope.
 Mortuus est sapiens Salomon Roboasque reviuat,
 Quo superant iuuenes prouida dicta senum.
 Distat amor Ionathe que Dauid modo dissociatus,
 Ex odioque furit invidus ipse Saül:
 Consulit hic eciam modo Phitonem mulierem,
 1300 Dumque dei vacuum gracia linquit eum.
 Nunc induratum persistit cor Pharaonis;
 Sentit amara dei, nec timet inde deum:
 Sic redit in vulnus nullo medicante cicatrix,
 Que prius et tenuit sors mala, peior habet.
 Consilium prauum nunc creditur Achitofellis,
 Consulit et Cusay, quis neque credit ei:
 Inuidiaque Ioab immunem iam necat Abner,
 Nec sibi cum rege quem sinit esse parem.
 Qui fuerat iudex Cato iustus ab vrbe recessit,
 1310 Pilatusque loco iudicat ecce suo.
 Nunc occisus Abel iustus fratris perit ense,
 Approbat hoc licitum lex tamen esse modum:⁵⁸⁶
 Nunc Mardocheum suspensum cerno, set Aman⁵⁸⁷
 Eripitur laqueo, lex sinit ista modo.
 Nunc iterum Cristus sine culpa fit crucifixus,
 Et Barabas latro liber abibit eo.
 Sic cadit et stratum ius nescit noscere iustum,
 Nec virtus animi iam regit acta viri.

**Hic loquitur adhuc⁵⁸⁸ vltterius super eodem,
qualiter loco eorum qui nuper casti fuerunt et
constantes, surrexerunt modo alii, qui huius seculi
vanitatem concupiscentes pudoris constanciam
penitus amiserunt.**

Cap^m. xxi. Mortuus est vicia Socrates virtute restringens,

1320 Dispensare quibus nunc Epicurus adest:

Vana relinquendo nunc mortuus est Dyogenes,

Vanus et hunc mundum nunc Arisippus habet.

Mortuus est corpus castigans virgo Phirinus,

Mechus et Agladius viuit in vrbe nouus.

Mortuus est Troilus constanter amore fidelis,

Iamque Iasonis amor nescit habere fidem:

Solo contenta moritur nunc fida Medea,

Fictaque Crisaida gaudet amare duos.

Estuat in lumbis incasta Semiramis, et nunc

1330 Vix si Cassandra casta manere queat:

Mortua Penolope, sic est Lucrecia Rome,

Et regnant Circes atque Calipsa pares.

Ammodo Iustina, luxus que spreuit iniquos,

Transiit, et Thais fit resupina magis.⁵⁸⁹

Nunc amor est Paridis communis in orbe quietus,

Vt sine nunc bello quisque fruatur eo.

Non Hymeneus in hiis conseruat pacta diebus,

Set Venus in thalamis reddit agenda suis:

Aurum sponsatur, vultuque decora paratur

1340 Ad thalamum Veneris pluribus apta viris.

Mutua cura duos et amor socialis habebat

Nuper, et vna tamen nunc sibi quinque trahit:

Vt duo sint carne simul vna lex dedit olim,

Ad minus inque tribus nunc manet ordo nouus.

Nunc iubet ipsa Venus et habet sua castra Cupido,

Castus et ad presens tempus abiuit amor.

Ales habet quod amet; cum quo sua gaudia iungat,

Invenit in media femina piscis aqua:

Cerua parem sequitur, serpens serpente tenetur:

- 1350 Femina virque thoro sunt magis vna caro.
Heus, vbi pacta fides? vbi connubialia iura?
Responsis careo, que ferat alter homo.
Ferrea frons laus est, nescit que signa pudoris,
Et pudor a vicio desinit esse pudor:
Quam solet inque genis ornare rubor muliebris,
Absque pudore malo plus furit ipsa viro.
Graculus ipsa quasi tacet, et quasi casta columba
Se gerit, et paciens est tibi spina rosans:
Vt laticem cribro, sic in muliere recondo
- 1360 Consilium, set eo scire potes quod amo.
Dum Iesabel regnat blando sermone pervngens,
Qui fuerat Iosue, vertitur hic in Achab.
Dum caput inclinat viciis, sibi subdita membra
Succumbunt ipsis vi vel amore malis:
Comptaque sic viciis stat florigerata voluptas,
Est quoque virtutis flos pede trita viris.

FOOTNOTES:

- [500](#) 31 mos SCEHGT mox DLH₂
[501](#) 65 gignit CEDL gignit SHG gignit T
[502](#) 72 rethia CE
[503](#) 79 volitans CE
[504](#) 93 volitat CE
[505](#) 149 non] vix CD
[506](#) 187 Set C
[507](#) 194 subdet SH subdat CEGDL
[508](#) 225 que L
[509](#) *Heading 4* pestelencie SH pestilencie CEDL
[510](#) 303 sub acta C
[511](#) 344 campis C (*corr.*)
[512](#) 353 Apropias SC Approprias EHGD
[513](#) 405 que tunc modo C
[514](#) 430 orbe CE
[515](#) 445 id *erased in* C
[516](#) 456 ora CE
[517](#) Cap. vii. *Heading 5* ff. innocenciam—excusat] omnipotens qui cuncta
discernit causas melius nouit G (*ras.*) D (*Heading om.* L)
[518](#) 476 quem S
[519](#) 493 *No paragr.* S
[520](#) *After 522 D has the following:—*

Regis namque modus alios moderatur, et omnis
Iuris ad officium dicitur esse caput.
Si bonus esse velit Rex, hii qui sunt bonitatis
Sunt magis edocti condicione sua:
Si malus esse velit, simili Rex sorte clientes,
Vt sibi complaciant, eligit, ornat, amat.
Iamque supercreuit dolus et defecit honestas,
Sentit et opprobrium, quod fuit ante decus.

Then l. 522 (*repeated*) and 523 ff.

- [521](#) 536 vltorius SH (v *nearly erased in S*)
- [522](#) 555 negligit S respuit CEHGDL
- [523](#) 564 virtum H
- [524](#) 545* magis *om.* T
- [525](#) 549* modo *om.* TH₂
- [526](#) 552* iubent H₂
- [527](#) 561* omnes TH₂
- [528](#) 564* magis *om.* T
- [529](#) 566* complaceant H₂
- [530](#) 576* de peste H₂ depiste T
- [531](#) 579* supercernit T deficit T
- [532](#) Cap. viii. *Heading* 3 regnaturo] excelentissimo T (*text over erasure* SCHG)
- [533](#) 3 doctrine causa] in eius honore T (*text over erasure* SCHG)
- [534](#) 613 super es SGDL superes CEHT
- [535](#) Cap. ix. *Heading* 1 rex *om.* C
- [536](#) 652 fatescat H
- [537](#) 658 impugnat S
- [538](#) 663 Viperium CE
- [539](#) 679 legit S
- [540](#) 698 periat SHT pereat CEDL
- [541](#) 700, 705 periat SHT pereat CEDL
- [542](#) Cap. x. *Heading* 2 supportet erigat *et* defendat D
- [543](#) 743 sanctita DT sancciata L
- [544](#) 765 fatuos ve C statuum ve E
- [545](#) 779 soluente CEH iubente SGDL
- [546](#) 791 sis] sic CE
- [547](#) 792 septra C sceptra E
- [548](#) 849 decorque C
- [549](#) Cap. xii. *Heading* 1 illecebra CE (*so also below*)
- [550](#) 873 Exemplo C
- [551](#) 890 leta] victa C
- [552](#) 894 fugat] furit CEH
- [553](#) 899 iacet SD
- [554](#) Cap. xiii *Heading* 4 excerceat C excerciat L
- [555](#) 945 Pugnata et impugnat expugnans CEDL Pugnata et impugnat expugnans
S Pugnata et impugnat expugnans HGT
- [556](#) 979 ne] nil C
- [557](#) 987 cytharistea CE citheristea D citheristia L
- [558](#) 993 aliquile S
- [559](#) 1001 agrum] illum C

- [560](#) 1073 excicii SEHGDLT excicii (*corr.*) C
[561](#) Cap. xvii. *Heading* 1 in *om.* C
[562](#) 1142 et SL vt (ut) CEHGD
[563](#) 1148 choruscus SD coruschus E coruscus CHT coruscas L
[564](#) 1156 Supleat SEG Suppleat CHDL
[565](#) 1189 O qui subiectum poteris tibi flectere regnum H O *quam* subiectum poteris tibi flectere regnum CE
[566](#) 1190 Si prius in mundo sis pius ipse deo C
[567](#) 1165* adesse DL
[568](#) 1171* te tangere T detangere DL
[569](#) 1178* aureis D
[570](#) 1180* sunt D
[571](#) 1182* foras D
[572](#) 1189* perennes D
[573](#) Cap. xix. *Heading* Hic recapitulat quodammodo sub figuris et exemplis tam veteris quam noui testamenti, in quibus pretendit quod eorum loco qui in omni sanctitate legem dei et fidem Cristi primitus augmentantes Ecclesiam colebant, et a diu mortui sunt, iam resurgunt alii precipue de Clero, qui illam omni viciorum multitudine suffocantes corrumpunt DLTH₂ (*but* multitudinem *for* multitudine)
[574](#) 1208 *Text* SCEHG Subditur ecce sibi vrbsque beata dei DTH₂ *Both forms given in* LL₂
[575](#) 1210 fit modo sponsa dei SCEHGL peruigil obstat ei DTH₂
[576](#) 1216 Nembroth CED
[577](#) 1219 primordia querens SCGL scrutator et ecce EHDTH₂
[578](#) 1220 *Text* SCGL qui diis dat thimiam suis EHDTH₂ (*que* E)
[579](#) 1221 cui rite deus benedixit EHDTH₂
[580](#) 1222 Nunc maledictus enim uiuit et ipse Caym EHDTH₂
[581](#) 1223 f. et alter Qui facit econtra regna moderna regit EHDTH₂ et alter Nunc sequitur carnem nilque pudoris habet LL₂
[582](#) 1225 Mortuus estque docens Moyses EHDTH₂ (decens D)
[583](#) 1226 Ac Abiron murmur cum grauitate datur EHDTH₂
[584](#) 1230 Infera descendens EHDLTH₂
[585](#) 1251 defunctus DT
[586](#) 1312 esse] ecce CE
[587](#) 1313 Mardocheum S (*corr.*) CED Madocheum HGLT
[588](#) Cap. xxi. *Heading* 1 adhuc *om.* CE
[589](#) 1334 Taysis CE

Postquam de singulis gradibus, per quos tam in spiritualibus quam in temporalibus error vbique diffunditur, tractatum hactenus existit, iam secundum quorundam opinionem tractare intendit de pedibus statue, quam Nabugodonosor viderat in sompnis, quorum videlicet pedum quedam pars ferrea, quedam fictilis, in figura deterioracionis huius mundi extiterat, in quam nos ad presens tempus, quod est quodammodo in fine seculi, euidencius devenimus. Et primo ferri significacionem declarabit.

Incipit liber Septimus.

- Cap^m. i. Quod solet antiquis nuper latitare figuris,
Possumus ex nostris verificare malis:
Quod veteres fusca sompni timuere sub vmbra,
Iam monstrat casus peruigil ecce nouus.
Nunc caput a statua Nabugod prescinditur auri,
Fictilis et ferri stant duo iamque pedes:
Nobilis a mundo nunc desinit aurea proles,
Pauperies ferri nascitur atque sibi.
Non modo magnanimi volat inclita fama per orbem, [590](#)
10 Cuius honor mundo congruit atque deo:
Non modo pauperibus spergit sua munera largus,
Nec fouet in mensa vix modo diues eos:
Vix pietate modo nudos quis vestit egenos,
Nec capit hospicio quos scit egere vagos.
Non manet obtrusis qui carcere vult misereri,
Sana nec infirmos que iuuat vlla manus:
Inter discordes antiquum fedus amoris
Non est ad presens qui reparare venit.
Nunc tamen esse duas specialius estimo causas,
20 Ex quibus hic mundus desinit esse bonus.
Harum luxuria reperitur in ordine prima,
Ex qua torpor hebes nascitur atque quies.

Sic causatur ea miles modo tardus ad arma,
 Quem mulier thalamis mulcet amore suis;
 Et clauduntur ea cleri communiter ora,
 Quod nequit ipse modo psallere vota deo.
 Concilium Balaam nos vicit per mulieres, [591](#)
 Vnde deo moto plebs sua quassa perit.
 Altera set causa nunc temporis astat auara,
 30 Que fouet invidiam semper in orbe nouam.
 Hec predat, pugnat, occidit iuraque falsat,
 Quod nequit a bello pax reuenire suo:
 Exterius domini tractant bona pacis auari,
 Set tamen interius stant sibi bella prius.
 Dum poterit guerra plus pace recondere lucra,
 Nescit auaricia pacis amare bona:
 Nec sinit invidia tua te michi ferre quieta,
 Lacrima namque mea ridet in aure tua.
 Nil tibi si populus plangat sua dampna subactus,
 40 Dum commune malum dat tibi ferre lucrum.
 Sic et auaricia procerum se subdere corda
 Dicit, et hii dicunt subdere iura volunt:
 Sic honor ingenuus descessit victus ab auro, [592](#)
 Ad loca iusticie nec revenire studet:
 Sic patet ydropicus nummorum gustus auari;
 Dum bibit, inde sitis appetit ipsa magis:
 Sic census non diues habet, set habetur ab ipsis,
 Sic dominus seruo seruit et ipse suo:
 Sic viget ipse foris diues, tamen intus egenus;
 50 Sic habet ipse nichil, dum nichil omne putat.
 Saxea duricies mentisque liquescere nescit,
 Nec pietatis ope soluitur inde gelu:
 Pauperis in lacrimis deridet, vultque labore
 Pauperis oppressi ferre quieta sibi.
 Sic etenim nummis animus sepelitur auari;
 Hos habet ipse deos, nec scit habere deum.

**Hic loquitur contra istos auaros omni ferro in hoc
precipue tempore duriores, quorum diuicie, nisi
participentur, nullius, vt dicit, possunt esse valoris.**

Cap^m. ii. Heu! quid opes opibus cumulat qui propria querit,
Cum se nemo queat appropriare sibi?
Nil possessus habet, quia quisquis habetur habere
60 Nulla potest; se non possidet, ergo nichil.
Seruit habens habitis, nec habet set habetur, auarum
Census habet, domino predominantur opes.
Cum nequeas tuus esse, tuum nichil est; suus esse
Nemo potest, igitur est nichil hoc quod habes.
Si quis enim dominum rerum sibi subdit, et ipsa
Res serui domini dicitur esse sui:
Euicto seruo sequitur possessio seruuum,
Et cedunt domino seruus et eius opes:
Adquirat domino, nil adquirit sibi seruus;
70 Quicquid habet, dominum constat habere suum.
Seruus auaricie sibi non dominatur, abutens
Arbitrio proprio proprietate caret.
Cum proprium nichil esse scias, est danda facultas,
Queque retenta nocent, particulata iuuant.
Nullus enim poterit veraciter esse beatus,
Qui sua cum socio participare nequit.
Qui dare nulla potest, satis ipsum constat egere;
Cum desit cui det, diues egenus erit;
Diues in hoc quod habet, set semper egenus in illo,
80 Quod non sit cum quo participabit opes.
Si tibi sit rerum possessio larga, nec vllus
Sit tua cui dones, copia nulla tibi:
Si tibi sit facies, sit honor, sit forma, sit alta
Mens tibi, si tamen hoc nesciat alter, eges.
Dispensa quod habes, vt consulit vsus, ad vsum,
Non ad auaricie pabula confer opes:
Da nudis, da pauperibus de pinguibus vti; [593](#)
Pingit amiciciam commoditatis amor.
Cum bona cuncta regas, vel ad esum sunt vel ad vsum;

90 Velle tuum rebus vtere sicut habes.
 Instat auaricia set tanta modo, quod ad aures
 Diuitis est nichilum quod mea scripta ferunt.
 Non modo magnates tantum fore constat auaros,
 Hos set vulgares nouimus esse reos.
 Vt gallina suum granis iecur implet habundum,
 De minimis magnum sumit et ipsa cibum,
 Striccius hic nummos imbursat et auget auarus,
 Nil sibi tam modicum, quin dat habere lucrum.
 Iniungit proprio talis ieiunia ventri,
 100 Vt pariat locus fercula plura suos.
 Ferreus ille tenax sua seruat corde tenaci
 Propria, quod nullus participabit eis;
 Perdidit et cordis clauem, qua vult pietatis
 Officium claudi, ne deus intret ibi.
 Sic nequit ipse suis sibi sumere gaudia questis;
 Omnia dumque tenet, nec sibi quicquid habet.
 Pectora sic ferri gestant homines quasi cuncti,
 Dum caput a statua decedit ecce sua.
 Aurea que fuerant iam ferrea tempora constant;
 110 Ferrea condicio sic manet inque viro:
 Aureus atque modus probitatis, quem coluerunt
 Patres, nunc cupido deperit ecce modo.
 Plus cupiens miser est, non qui minus optinet; immo
 Qui sibi contentus est, habet ipse satis.
 Diuitis autem diuicias non dampno, set illas
 Approbo, si dentur quando requirit opus:
 Non quia diues habet nummos, culpabitur, immo
 Se quia nec fratres non iuuat inde suos.
 Si sibi larga manus foret, vnde pararet egenti
 120 Partem, tunc laude mammona digna foret:
 Se tamen vnde iuuat alios vel, diues in orbe
 Vix hodie viuit, qui sibi seruat opes.
 Sermo, 'Tene quod habes,' qui scribitur Apocalipsi,
 Iam sua completi iura vigoris habet:
 Iam noua sunt silicis circum precordia vene, [594](#)
 Et rigidum ferri semina pectus habet.

Pauperis ex clamore sonos non percipit, immo
Diues in auditu fingitur esse lapis.
Tempus erit quo tu, qui nunc excludis egentes,
130 Ibis in extrema pauper egendo loca.
Ad ferrum, secla, iam vos venistis ab auro,
Et magis est vile, nobile quicquid erat:
Posterior partes superatque cupido priores,
Nec scit honor solium, quod solet esse suum.

**Hic loquitur de statue secunda parte pedum, que
fictilis et fragilis erat, et de eiusdem partis
significatione.**

Cap^m. iii. Vltima per terras superest modo fictilis etas,
Vnde pedes statue dant michi signa fore.
Non cicius figuli fragilis nam fictilis olla
Rupta fit in testas, dum lapis angit eas,
Quin plus condicio fragilis temptata virorum
140 Rupta iacet vicii de grauitate sui.
Fictilis est laicus, set fictilior modo clerus
Eius in exemplis causat agenda malis:
Sic sacra scripta caro conscribitur vndique mundo,
Littera quod Cristi nulla videtur ibi.
Qui iubet vt carnem vincamus, cernere victum
Possumus, et doctum spernere dogma suum.
Clerus habet voce sibi nomen spirituale,
Spiritus in carnem vertitur ipse tamen:
Carnis enim vicia sunt sic communiter acta,
150 Quod de continuis vix pudet vsus eis.
Fit quasi nunc mulier hominis dominus que magister,
Vir fit et ancilla subdita, prona, pia:
Debilis in fortem ruit et vecordia vincit,
Qui foret et sapiens, fictilis ipse cadit.
Preuia dum clerus Veneris vexilla subibit,
Iam Venus a tota gente tributa petit.
Gallica peccata, nuper quibus hii ceciderunt,

Clamant iam nostras intitulare domos:
 Nunc licet alterius sponsam quod quisque frequentet
 160 Est status ingenui, dicitur illud amor.⁵⁹⁵
 Non erit hoc laicis viciū set gracia magna,
 Dum sit adulterio magnificatus homo,
 Dummodo sponsa stuprum perquirat adultera donis:
 Soluet ob hoc sponsus, qui luet illud opus.
 Sic se nunc homines vendunt, quasi sint meretrices,
 Prospera dum Veneris larga sit illa manus:
 Sic sub mendaci specie grossantur amoris,⁵⁹⁶
 Perque nephas tale lucra pudenda petunt.
 Set qui de clero sponsam promotus adoptat,
 170 Plura dabit Veneri, sit quod adulter ibi:
 Pauper enim frater capit hic quod ibi dabit, et sic
 Aut dans aut capiens proficit ille magis.
 In causa fragili sic causat fictilis etas,
 Quo nunc de facili frangitur omnis homo.
 Ficta set ypocrisis fraudes celare latentes
 Temptat, et occulto turpia plura facit:
 Sic viget in facie ficti palloris honore,
 Macrior vt vultus sordida facta tegat:
 Set neque iusticia maxillas mentis adornat,
 180 Immo placens mundo fert maledicta deo.
 Sic vrtica rose faciem furatur, et a u r i
 Sub specie plumbum dat latitare d o l u m:⁵⁹⁷
 Sic latet iniustum sub iusto, sic maledictum
 Sub sancto, que s c e lus sub recolente fidem:⁵⁹⁸
 Virtutum clamidem foris induit, interiorem
 Contegat vt culpam, ne quis abhorret eam.
 Sic foris apparet r u t i l a n s a l b e d o, set intus⁵⁹⁹
 Omnis spurcicie tecta nigredo latet:
 Sic quasi vox pacis odium blanditur ad
 a u r e s,⁶⁰⁰
 O s d a t a m i c i c i a s m e n s q u e t i m e n d a
 190 m i n a s;
 Sicque columbinis stat pennis coruus amictus,

Turturis et falco fingit habere modum:⁶⁰¹
 Sic animus Sathane gerit aspectum Gabrielis,
 Est caput ancille, cauda set anguis erit:
 Sic mellita bona visu tibi monstrat aperta,
 Que si gustabis, sunt tibi mirra magis.
 Disce quod ypocrisis est demonis archa, reclusum
 Sub qua peccati continet omne nephas.
 Non acus abscondi valet in sacco, set ad extra
 200 Feruidus ex stimulo quod videatur agit;
 Nec latet ypocrisis ita quod non se manifestat,
 Et sua quod virtus non viciata patet;
 Hocque sui viciium vicii vult pandere glosam,
 Dum furit impaciens, ira reuelat eum:
 Mendacisque diu pietatis fallitur vmbra,
 Tam cito, cum grauius quid sibi ferre velis.
 Sic lupus agnelli tectus sub vellere dentes
 Nudat, et infecta pandit operta mala:
 Sub vicii taxa sic virtus victa laborat,
 210 Liber et a seruo nil modo iuris habet.
 Ad placitum viciis laxantur frena pudoris,
 Vt tollant gratam moribus ire viam.
 Sic ego concludo breuiter, virtus quod vbique
 Subiacet, et viciium scanna priora tenet:
 Omnis et econtra fallit modo regula versa,
 Sunt et in orbe nouo cuncta referta dolo.

**Hic loquitur adhuc vltterius de miseriis que in
 pedum statue diuersitate nouissimis iam temporibus
 eueniendis figurabantur: dicit enim quod ea que
 nuper condicionis humane virtuosa fuerant, in suum
 modo contrarium singula diuertuntur.**

Cap^m. iiii. Res fit amara modo dulcis, fit dulcis amara,
 Fedaque fit pulcra, deficit ordo quia:⁶⁰²
 Fit scola nunc heresis, fiunt peccataque mores,
 220 Fit dolus ingenium, raptaque preda lucrum:

Fit sacer ordo vagus, fingens ypocrita sanctus,
 Magniloqus sapiens, stultus et ipse silens:
 Confessor mollis peccator fit residuus,
 Verba satis sancta, facta set ipsa mala.
 Custodit vulpis modo pullos et lupo agnos,
 Perdices nisus lignaque sicca focus.
 Doctores vicia mendacia suntque prophete;
 Fabula ficta placet, litera sacra nichil:
 Displicet expediens doctrina, set illa voluptas
 230 Dictorum Veneris gaudet in aure satis.
 Nunc amor est luxus, et adulterium modo nubit,
 Et iubet incestus iura pudica michi:
 In vulgum clerus conuertitur, et modo vulgus
 In forma cleri disputat acta dei.
 Sunt serui domini, sunt et domini modo serui;
 Qui nichil et didicit, omnia scire putat:
 Rusticus ingenui se moribus assimilari⁶⁰³
 Fingit, et in veste dat sua signa fore;
 Isteque se miserum transfert gentilis in illum,
 240 Vultque sui vicii rusticitate frui.
 Sic modus est pompa, probitas iactancia, risus
 Scurrilitas, ludus vanus et absque deo.
 Nunc fautor scelerum specialis habetur, et obstans
 Alterius viciis est inimicus ei:
 Nunc magis est carus vir blandus in aure pervngens,
 Et duplex lingua rethor habetur ea.
 Nunc puer impubes sapiencior est Citherone
 Regis in aspectu, plusque Catone placet:
 Blandicieque sue nunc gestant premia lingue,
 250 Quas mundi proceres magnificare vides.
 Absit honor cunctis nisi lingue, que velut Eccho
 Auribus in regis consona verba sonat.
 Quod culpas culpat, quod laudas laudat et ipse,
 Quod dicis dicit, quod colis ipse colit.
 Rides, arridet: fles, flebit: semper et equas
 Imponet leges vultibus ipse tuis.⁶⁰⁴
 Premia iudicium Philemonis nulla meretur,

Dum tamen hoc verum sit quod ab ore refert.
Quem prius infantem texit pastoria pellis,
260 Iam subito blanda sindone verba tegunt.
Curia nulla suum veterem conseruat honorem,
Vrbs neque iusticiam, terra nec vlla fidem.
Sunt magis arma forum quam nobilitas, quibus ille
Garcio sutoris nunc galeatus adest:
Fuluus iam talus nimis est communis, eoque
Non honor est armis vt solet esse prius:
Namque superbus inops, dum non habet vnde superbe
Se regat, ex prediis viuunt vbique suis.

Debilitas regni surgit, vires requiescunt, [605](#)
270 Sic paleas multas granaque pauca vides:
Corda latent leporum, panduntur et ora leonum,
Aurea nunc verba plumbeus actus habet.
Nuncque solent homines consumere larga loquendo
Tempora, sermoni deficiente die;
Et bona, que regnum concernunt, vtiliora
Discordes animo posteriora sinunt.
Factis de nostris hodie conuertitur in cras,
Dicuntur facta que peragenda manent.
Nunc aliena sibi vult regna superbia subdi,
280 Que vix in proprio stat semituta solo.
Bella tonat valide thalamis audacia lingue,
Vecors set campis non mouet illa manus:
Sub facie guerre nos multant vndique taxe,
Vniusque lucro milia dampna scio.
Libertas solita nuper modo fertur auara,
Et magis ingrata condicione grauat:
Omnia pre manibus promittit premia seruis,
Nec memoratur eo, cum bene fecit homo.
Nil vetus exemplo nunc regula sufficit, immo
290 Acta loco iuris ammodo velle reget.

Est modo fel mellis, et liuor amoris ad instar, [606](#)
Quod patet exterius, hoc nichil intus habet.

Vox leuis illa Iacob, Esau manus hispida nuper
 Fallebant, set ob hoc signa futura dabant:
 Quicquid verba ferunt modo nam bonitatis ad aures,
 Cum probat illud opus actus, iniqua gerit.
 Cessit iusticia cessitque fides sociata,
 Fraus, dolus atque suum iam subiere locum.
 Nunc socii luctus socio velut organa plaudunt;
 300 Vnus si presit, invidet alter ei.
 Ex dampno fratris frater sua commoda querit,
 Et soror ad laudem raro sororis agit:
 Filius in matre iam sentit habere nouercam,
 Sentit et hec nati plurima facta doli:
 Filia maternos actus detractat, et ipsa
 Mater iam natam spernit et odit eam.
 Filius ante diem patrios iam spectat in annos,
 Nec videt ex oculis ceca cupido suis:
 Sit licet ipse parens, natis minus impius ipse
 310 Non est, nec cordis viscera suplet eis:
 Nullus amor parcit cuiquam quem ledere possit;
 Quod voluere duo, tercius esse negat.
 Plebs sine iure manet, non est qui iura tuetur,
 Non est qui dicat, 'Iura tenere decet.'
 Viuitur ex raptu, vix hospes ab hospite tutus,
 Nec socer a genero, dum vacat ipse lucro.
 Tempore nunc plures odio remanente salutant,
 Tempus et ad vomitum ruminat ira suum:
 Facta mouent odium, facies exorat amorem,
 320 Oscula pretendit os, manus atque ferit.
 Pectoribus mores tot sunt quot in orbe figure,
 Nec longum stabile quid bonitatis habent:
 Vtque leues Protheus sese tenuauit in vndas,
 Nunc leo, nunc arbor, nunc erat hircus, aper,
 Sic modus ad presens hominum mutabilis extat,
 Nec scio quo possum firmus adire gradum.
 Vacca sit an taurus non est cognoscere promptum,
 Pars prior apparet, posteriora latent:
 Sic prima facie non est cognoscere verbum;

330 Qui nichil occultat, pondera finis habet.
 Dum fueris felix, plures numerantur amici,
 Aspera si fuerint tempora, solus eris:
 Vt lepus in variis fugiens se munit in aruis,
 Errat et in nulla sede moratur amor.
 Tempore creuit amor antiquo, set resolutus
 Vix vltra quo nunc progrediatur habet:
 Illud amicitie quondam venerabile nomen
 Cessit, et in questu pro meretrice sedet.
 Orbis honorifici periunt exempla prioris,
 340 Et nichil est de quo iam sit habenda fides.
 Nunc amor est solus, nec sentit habere secundum,
 Stans odioque tibi diligit ipse tua.
 Sic est quod non est lepus et leporarius vnum;
 Nescio quod video, sum neque cecus ego.
 Est odium commune modo, set amor quasi fenix
 Per loca deserta solus in orbe latet.
 Est nocuum ferrum ferroque nocencius aurum,
 Cuius nunc bello sternitur omnis homo.
 Quid modo, cumque manus mentitur dextra sinistre,
 350 Dicam, numquid homo credet id ipse sibi?⁶⁰⁷
 Omnibus in causis, vbi commoda sunt ve voluptas,
 Nunc modus est que fides non habuisse fidem:
 Sicque pedum statue duplex variata figura
 Quam varios hominum signat in orbe dolos.
 Vndique dampna fluunt, quod in isto tempore liber
 Nescio pacificis quo fruar ipse viis.
 Expers invidie paupertas sola manebit,
 Quam supplantare nullus in orbe studet.
 O miser et felix pauper, qui liber vbique
 360 Cum requie mentis absque pauore manes!
 'O mundus, mundus,' dicunt, 'O ve tibi, mundus,
 Qui magis atque magis deteriora paris!'
 Quid sibi sit mundus igitur, que forma vel eius,
 Que vel condicio, singula scire volo.

**Quia vnusquisque ad presens de mundi fallaciis
conqueritur, intendit hic de statu et condicione
mundi, necnon et de miseria condicionis humane,
tractare consequenter.**

Cap^m. v. Mundus enim sibi dat nomen, set mundus haberi

Ex inmundiciis de ratione nequit:

Sordibus est plenus, viciorum germine plenus,

Plenus peccatis, plenus vbique dolis.

Tempora mutantur mutantur condiciones,

370 Mutanturque status, nec manet ordo diu.

Discite quam prope sit et quam vicina ruina,

Talis enim nullum que releuamen habet:

Discite quam nichil est quicquid peritura voluptas

Possidet et false vendicat esse suum.

Vita quid est presens? temptacio, pugna molesta;

Hic acies semper, semper et hostis adest:

Fur opibus, guerra paci, morbusque saluti

Inuidet, et corpus nostra senecta premit:

Sicque perit placite paulatim gracia forme,

380 Nullaque de multis que placuere manent.

Nam gustata minus sapiunt, vix sentit odores,

Vix quoque clamosos percipit aure sonos:

Caligant oculi, de toto sola supersunt

Vix cutis et neruis ossa ligata suis.

Estates odit, hyemes et frigora culpat,

Nec querulo possunt vlla placere seni:

Frigore nunc nimio, nimio nunc leditur estu,

Et stabili numquam permanet ille statu.

Dens dolet aut ceruix, aut forsan lingua ligatur,

390 Splen tumet, egrotat pulmo, laborat epar;

Cor marcet, renes paciuntur, soluitur aluus,

Brachia vix possunt, languida crura dolent.

Longius in curis viciatum corpus amaris

Non patitur vires langor habere suas:

Singula non paucis pars est obnoxia morbis,

Et patet infelix ad mala totus homo;

Ingratusque suis morbis confectus et annis,
Conqueritur vite tempora longa sue.

- 400 Omnis enim virtus, qua gaudet corpus inane,
Desinit et vario pressa dolore perit.
Es sapiens? marcet sapientia morte. Redundas
Diuiciis? lapsu mobiliore fluunt.
Es probus? expirat probitas. Es honestus? honestas
Labitur. Es fortis? forcia morte iacent.
Set cum te viciis victum succumbere cernis,
Miror te fortem dicis et esse putas.
Bella libido mouet; primos tu cedis ad ictus,
Et tua das fedo colla premenda iugo:
Sic et auaricie seruis, sic mo t i b u s i r e, [608](#)
410 Sic facis ardentis iussa pudenda gule.
Sic vbicumque tuam faciem cum mente revoluas,
Corporis et mundi singula vana scies.
Si corpus penses, ex omni parte videbis
Naturam fragilem, que remanere nequit:
Si mundum penses, ex omni parte volutum
Rebus in incertis fraude videbis eum.
Excussas aliquis deplorat grandine vites,
Iste mari magno deperiisse rates:
Istum luxuries illumque superbia vastat,
420 Hunc et tristicie seua procella quatit.
Et sic de variis mundus variatur, et ipsum
Quem prius exaltat forcius ipse ruit:
Labilis ille locus satis est, et more fluentis
Et refluentis aque fluminis instar habet.
Si cui blanditur, fallit, nec creditur illi;
Eius quo doleas gaudia semper habent.
Rebus in humanis semper quid deficit, et sic
Ista nichil plenum fertile vita tenet.
Quam prius in finem mundi deuenerit huius,
430 Nulla potest certo munere vita frui.
Si te nobilium prouexit sanguis auorum,
Hinc est quod doleas, degenerare potes:
Prospera si dederit tibi sors, et sorte recedunt;

Si mala succedunt, deteriora time.
Si tibi persuadet vxorem fama pudicam,
Hinc eciam doleas, fallere queque solet:
Hic gemit incestum corrupte coniugis, alter
Delusus falsa suspicione timet:
In quam suspirant multorum vota timebis
440 Perdere, vel soli ne sit habenda tibi;
Sic illam metuis ne quis corrumpat adulter,
Et pariat quorum non eris ipse pater.
Si tamen illorum succrescit turba bonorum,
Hinc iterum doleas, mors tibi tollit eos:
Si tibi diuicie modicam famulantur ad horam,
Has, vt plus doleas, auferet vna dies.
Tempora si viridis promittit longa iuuentus,
Fallit, et vt doleas Attropos occat eam.
Si tibi perspicue pollet sapientia mentis,
450 Vt merito doleas, in Salomone vide.
Si facies niuea rubicundo spersa colore
Splendeat, hinc doleas, curua senecta venit.
Non habet hic requiem tua mens, set et intus et extra
Prelia cum multis irrequieta geris.
Dum potes, amissum tempus suple, quia Cristus
Heu nimium tardo tempore dampnat opus.
Vltima qui vite peiora prioribus egit,
Si perdat, caueat, qui malus emptor erat.
Discat homo iuuenis, celeri pede labitur etas,
460 Nec bona tam sequitur quam bona prima fuit:
Non que preteriit iterum revocabitur vnda,
Nec que preteriit hora redire potest:
Stare putas, et eo procedunt tempora tarde,
Et peragit lentis passibus annus iter.
Ancipitrem metuens pennis trepidantibus ales
Audet ad humanos fessa venire sinus;
O vetus in viciis, Sathanas quem spectat in ymis,
Quid fugis, et pro quo non venis ipse deo?
Ecce senilis yemps tremulo venit horrida passu,
470 Pulcher et etatis flos iuuenilis abit: [609](#)

Labitur occulte fallitque volatilis etas,
Et celer annorum cursus vt vmbra fugit.

Hec quoque nec perstant que nos elementa vocamus,
Immo gerunt varias diuaricata vices:
Corpora vertuntur, nec quod fuimus ve sumus nos
Cras erimus, set idem se neque tempus habet:
Nil equidem durare potest forma sub eadem,
Mutari subito quin magis omne liquet.
Cerue, fretum quod erat, nunc est solidissima tellus,
480 Quod fuit et tellus, iam maris vnda tegit:
Nunc fluit, interdum suppressis fluctibus aret
Fons, nec et ipse statu permanet ecce suo.
Conteritur ferrum, silices tenuantur ab usu:
Numquid homo fragilis rumpitur ipse magis?
Qui nunc sub Phebo ducibusque palacia fulgent,
Nuper araturis pascua bobus erant:
Nuper erant rura, quo nunc sunt castra, que culti
Quo nunc sunt campi, castra fuere prius:
Frondebz ornabant que nunc capitolia gemmis,
490 Pascebatque suas ipse senator oues. [610](#)
Et si regna loquar hominum, scimus quia nullum
Principis imperium perstat in orbe diu.
Hec que preteritum tempus dedit, illa futurum
Post dabit, estque nouus nullus in orbe status.
Dicere quis poterit, 'Ego persto quietus in orbe?'
Et quis non causas mille doloris habet?
Quo se vertit homo, dolor aut metus incutit ipsum;
Excipitur nullus qui sit in orbe gradus.
O quantos regum paciuntur corda tumultus,
500 Quamque procellosis motibus ipsa fremunt!
Inter regales epulas variosque paratus
Tabescunt vario sollicitata metu:
Mille satellitibus cinctus telisque suorum
Non valet e trepido pellere corde metus.
Sic inmundas suis de fraudibus omnia mundus
Polluit, et nullo tempore munda facit:
Iste per antifrasm nomen sibi vendicat vnum,

Quo nullo pacto participare potest.

**Hic loquitur de principio creacionis humane.
Declarat eciam qualiter mundus ad vsum hominis, et
homo ad cultum dei creatus extitit; ita quod, si homo
deum suum debite non colat, mundus que sua sunt
homini debita officia vlterius reddere non teneatur.**

Cap^m. vi. O si vera loquar, quicquid sibi mundus iniquum
510 Gestat, homo solus est magis inde reus.
Scripta docent Genesis, primo cum conditor orbem
Fecerat, hec dicens ipse creauit Adam:
'Nos faciamus,' ait, 'hominem, qui nos imitari
Possit; et vt nobis seruiat atque colat,
Inspiremus ei sensum rationis, amorem,
Vim discretiuam, quid sit et vnde venit:
Inspiremus ei factoris cognicionem,
Vnde creatorem noscat ametque suum,
Quis suus est auctor, quis ei dedit esse vel vnde:
520 Mundus eum sequitur et famulatur ei.
Solutus rimetur mentis secreta superne,
Et perscrutetur singula solus homo:
Singula scrutetur, set quod sibi postulat vsus,
Vtile vel credat, quod ve necesse putet.'
O sublime decus, honor eximius, decor altus,
Vt sit homo terra tectus ymago dei!
Vt sit ad exemplum factoris fabrica facta,
Resque creatori consimilata suo!
Cetera queque deus solo sermone creauit,
530 Hoc formauit opus appositque manum.
Terrula suscipitur, formatur massa pusilla,
Fit corpus solidum, quod fuit ante solum:
Ossa medullata neruis compegit in vnum,
Firmauit gressus composuitque gradum:
Hiis super induxit venas set sanguine plenas, [611](#)
Carnes vestiuit pellicibus atque pilis:

Visceribus plenis fudit spiracula vite,
Ex quibus officiis singula membra vacant:
Os loquitur, manus exercet, pes currit, et aures
540 Ascultant, oculus sidera solus habet.
Viuificatur homo, surgit factura biformis,
Stat caro, statque comes spiritus, vnus homo.
Hec caro que carnis sunt sentit, spiritus alta
Sidera suspirat et sua iura petit.
Stat formatas homo, miratur seque suosque
Gestus, et nescit quid sit et ad quid homo:
Corporis officium miratur, membra moueri,
Artificesque manus articulosque pedum.
Artus distendit, dissoluit brachia, palmis
550 Corporis attractat singula membra sui:
In se quid cernit sese miratur, et ipsam
Quam gerit effigiem non videt esse suam:
Miratur faciem terre variasque figuras,
Et quia non nouit nomina, nescit eas.
Erexit vultus, os sublimauit in altum,
Se rapit ad superos, spiritus vnde fuit:
Miratur celi speciem formamque rotundam,
Sidereos motus stelliferasque domos:
Stat nouus attonitus hospes secumque revoluit,
560 Quid sibi que cernit corpora tanta velint.
Noticiamque tamen illi natura ministrat;
Quod sit homo, quod sunt ista creata videt:[612](#)
Quod sit ad humanos vsus hic conditus orbis,
Quod sit ei proprius mundus, et ipse dei.
Ardet in auctoris illius sensus amorem,
Iamque recognouit quid sit amare deum.

**Hic loquitur quod, exquo creator omnium deus
singulas huius mundi delicias vsui subdidit humano,
dignum est quod, sicut homo deliciis secundum
corpus fruitur, ita secundum spiritum deo creatori**

**suo gratum obsequium cum graciарum accione toto
corde rependat.**

Cap^m. vii. Dic, Adam, dic, Eua parens, dic vnus et alter,
Dic tibi si desit gracia plena dei.
Cuncta tuis pedibus subiecit, ouesque bouesque,
570 Et volucres celi pisciculosque maris:
En, elementa tibi, sol, aer, sidera, tellus,
Diuitis vnda maris, cetera queque fauent.
Auctor enim rerum sic res decreuit, vt orbis
Queque creatura consequeretur eum;
Vt seruiret ei factura, suumque vicissim
Factorem solum consequeretur homo.
Erige sublime caput et circumspice mundum,
Collige cuncta, sue dant tibi queque manus:
Omnia subiecta tibi sunt, tibi cuncta ministrant,
580 Omnia respondent obsequiumque parant.
Qui tibi tanta tulit, qui pro te tanta peregit,
Qui pro te mundum duxit ad esse suum,
Qui dedit ex nichilo tantarum semina rerum,
Confusumque chaos ordine stare suo,
Sortes distribuens per partes quatuor equas,
Iratos motus temperat arte sua:
Sidere depingens celum, septemque planetas,
Et si nitantur, ad sua puncta vocans,
Signifer accessu solis signis duodenis
590 Tempora per totidem dat variare vices.
Qui totum mundum, postquam decreuerat illum,
Ornauit vario multiplicique bono,
Esse feras siluis, in montibus esse leones,
In planis pecudes, rupibus esse capras.
Pluma tegit volucres et oues sua lana decorat,
Inque tuos vsus est tamen hoc quod habent.
Respice delicias mundi, quas flumina dotes,
Quas tibi donat opes diuitis vnda maris;
Arboribusque sitis, herbis, radicibus ortos, [613](#)
600 Floribus et foliis fructiferisque bonis.

Pre cunctis recolat tua mens, quem te quoque fecit,
Et de quam nichilo traxit ad esse bonum;
Nam tuus illius est spiritus, et tuus eius
Est sensus, ratio de ratione sua.

Te caput esse dedit rerum, rebusque locatis
Nomina te cunctis queque vocare dedit:
Qui tibi spem prolis dedit in mulieris amore,
Consortemque parem coniugiiue fidem.
Te sibi pene parem fecit, te pene secundum,
610 Dicere si possem, prestitit esse deum:
Contulit in celum sese, tibi tradidit orbem, [614](#)
Et mundi tecum dimidiauit opes.
Celum sole tibi, sol lumine seruit, et aer
Flatibus, vnda cibus, terraque mille bonis.
Set quod es vnde tibi? quod habes quis prebet?
Vtrumque
Sponte facit pietas dulcis et ampla dei:
Qui tibi te tribuens sese promisit, eoque
Non habuit melius quod daret ipse deus.
Nonne superbire quemcumque virum decet ergo
620 Contra mandata que dedit ipse deus?
Celum deiecit set et odit terra superbum,
Solut et inferni fit locus aptus ei.
Hoc etenim vicio tactum fuit et viciatum,
Quod genitor primus protulit, omne genus:
In radice fuit omnis viciata propago,
Quo mundum quicquam mundus habere nequit.
Non fuit in mundo qui mundum mundificaret,
Nec quod in hoc venie posset habere locum:
Set pietate prius qui condidit omnia solus,
630 Ille reformauit et reparauit opus.
Accepit serui formam seruosque redemit,
Demonis et quod erat fecerat esse dei:
Hunc igitur superest deuota mente sequaris,
Vtque tuum dominum confitearis eum;
Preceptumque leue, vetitum non tangere crimen,
Si toto sequeris corde, beatus eris.

**Hic tractat qualiter homo dicitur minor mundus;
ita quod secundum hoc quod homo bene vel male
agit, mundus bonus vel malus per consequens existit.**

Cap^m. viii. O pietas domini, qualisque potencia, quanta
Gracia, que tantum fecerat esse virum!
Vir sapit angelicis cum cetibus, vnde supremum
640 Esse creatorem noscit in orbe deum:
Sentit et audit homo, gustat, videt, ambulat, vnde
Nature speciem fert animalis homo:
Cum tamen arboribus homo crescit, et optinet esse
In lapidum forma proprietate sua:
Sic minor est mundus homo, qui fert singula solus,
Soli solus homo dat sacra vota deo.
Est homo qui mundus de iure suo sibi mundum
Subdit, et in melius dirigit inde status:
Si tamen immundus est, que sunt singula mundi
650 Ledit, et in peius omne refundit opus:
Vt vult ipse suum proprio regit ordine mundum,
Si bonus ipse, bonum, si malus ipse, malum.
Qui minor est mundus, fert mundo maxima dampna,
Ex immundiciis si cadat ipse reus:
Qui minor est mundus, si non immunda recidat,
Cuncta suo mundi crimine lesa grauat:
Qui minor est mundus homo, si colat omnipotentem,
Rebus in humanis singula munda parit:
Qui minor est mundus, si iura dei meditetur,
660 Grande sibi regnum possidet ipse poli.
Conuenit ergo satis, humili quod corde rependat
Digna creatori dona creatus homo:
Restat vt ipse sui factoris querat amorem,
Restat vt ipse sciat quid sit et vnde venit:
Restat vt agnoscat, quo nominis ordine solus
Pre cunctis mundus dicitur esse minor.
Si minor est mundus, quo mundi machina constat
Ordine si querat, est meminisse sui:
Si minor est mundus, que sunt primordia mundi

670 Si meditetur, agit vnde sit et quid homo:
Si se nesciret, nec eum cognosceret, a quo
Vel per quem factus est, nec amaret eum.
Et tamen est illi substantia facta biformis,
Quo compegit eum, spiritus atque caro;
Vt deseruaret factori spiritus eius,
Et mundus carni spirituique caro.
Est ancilla caro fragilis, cuius dominatrix
Desuper est anima de ratione dei;
Nunc tamen a mundo caro victa negat rationem,
680 Linquit et hec anime iura subire sue.
Sic seruit dominans, sic regula fallit, et extra
Deuiat illa deo, que foret intus homo.
Stulcior o stulto, commutans celica mundo,
Postponens aurum queris habere lutum.⁶¹⁵
Cur dominus rerum, quare deitatis ymago
Parua cupis? Cupias maxima magnus homo.
Orbis terrarum tuus est, et quicquid ab illo
Clauditur, arbitrio subditur omne tuo:
Nempe parens rerum celo dimissus ab alto
690 Ad tua descendens est tibi factus homo.
Noli te regno peccati subdere, noli⁶¹⁶
Que cicius fugiunt ista caduca sequi:
Set satagas humiles animo transcendere terras,
Desuper in celis arripe fortis iter.
Tu si magna petis, deus est super omnia magnus,
Si bona, quam bonus est dicere nemo potest.
Nil genus aut sexus tibi, nil vel comptus inanis
Mortis ad excessus vtilitatis habent.
Quid penetrasse iuuat studiis archana Platonem,
700 Natureque suos composuisse libros?
Solis iter celique plagas luneque meatus,
Et vaga vel summo sidera fixa polo,
Multaque preter ea satis ardua nouerat; et nunc
Philosophus cinis est, nomen inane perit.
Dum res et rerum causas vestigat Ypocras,
Dum medicinali corpora seruat ope,

Talis eum poterat sapientia nulla mederi,⁶¹⁷
Quin medico mortis lex subienda foret.
Sic patet, est hominis natura potencior arte,
710 Et ruit in mortem quos sua causa petit.
Est tibi nil melius igitur, quam prouidus illam
Prospicias mortem, que tibi finis erit.
Semper iturus ades, accedis ad vltima vite,
Nec scis quo fine, quando vel illud erit:
Celo longa via, restantque dies tibi pauci;
Tardat iter mundi qui sibi sumit onus.

Hic loquitur qualiter homo, qui minor mundus dicitur, a mundo secundum corpus in mortem transibit, et sicut ipse corporis sui peccato huius mundi corrupcionis, dum viuit, causat euentum, ita in corpore mortuo postea putredinis subire corrupcionem cogetur. Et primo dicit de mortui corporis corrupcione secundum Superbiam.

Cap^m. ix. O tibi quid dices, cum non mouet aura capillos,
Arent et fauces, nec via vocis inest,
Et color in vultu sine sanguine, lumina mestis
720 Sunt inmota genis osque madere nequit,
Atque per interius cum duro lingua palato⁶¹⁸
Congelat, et pulsum vena mouere negat,
Nec flecti ceruix nec brachia plectere quicquid
Possunt, nec passus pes valet ire suos?
Quid modo respondet homo mortuus ille superbus?
Dicat nunc quid ei gloria vana dabit.
Eius enim, nuper alios qui despiciebat,
Corporis exanimi iam perit omnis honor:
Et quia se corpus dudum tollebat in altum,
730 Vermibus esca modo subditur ipsa caro.
Non modo palpebra quasi dedignando leuatur,
Nec manus in longum planat vtrumque latus:
Quas vires habuit mortalis vis superauit,

Est musce spina forcior ecce sua.
 Si decor aut species nuper florebat in illo,
 Eius turpedo iam fugat omne pecus:
 Si fuerat sapiens, modo differt a sapiente,
 Est sibi conclusum quo nichil ipse sapit:
 Que magis in studio peciit subtilia longo,
 740 Mors ea dissoluit de breuitate cito.
 Artibus in variis fuerat licet ipse peritus,
 Iam cecidit prudens artis in arte sua:
 Desinit ingenii ratio sine iam ratione,
 Mors ruit in vacuum que rationis erant:
 Littera quem docuit magis est indoctus asello,
 Pectore nec remanet iota vel vnus apex.
 Non sibi mentalis presumptio iudicat vllos,
 Se neque iactare mortua causa sinit:
 Qui solet ypocrisi fecte virtutis honorem
 750 Tollere, nunc monstrat quid fuit ipse palam.
 Nil sibi quod genera linguarum nouerat olim
 Confert, qui muto mortuus ore silet:
 Organa nulla sibi nota vel citharistea plaudunt,
 Quo perit auditus, musica nulla placet.
 Nil valet ingenuas corpus coluisse per artes,
 Qui modo nature perdidit omne decus:
 Nil vestis pompa, nichil aut ascensus equorum,
 Corpus iam rigidum magnificare queunt.
 Nil sibi pulcra domus aut seruicium famulorum;
 760 Nunc foris in populo nemo salutat eum:
 Nunc serpens famulus puteusque vocabitur aula,
 Nuncque loco thalami tetra cauerna datur.
 Sic quia nuper eum fallebat gloria vana,
 Nunc sibi nil remanet vnde superbus erit.

**Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corrupcione
secundum Inuidiam.**

Cap^m. x. Ecce per inuidiam qui roserat ore canino,

Iam canis aut vermis rodere debet eum.
Alterius famam spernens que leserat olim,⁶¹⁹
Ammodo corrupta lingua dolosa tacet:
Alterius dampna risit, quoque prospera fleuit,
770 Nunc ridere nequit ore carente labris.
Murmure cor plenum nuper modo fit putrefactum,
Et via iam rupta cordis ad yma patet:
Iam nequit ambicio socii postponere laudem,
Nec preferre suam, qui sine laude iacet.
Tunc fel sub melle condens nunc conditur ipse,
Quo sine mente caro nil simile potest:
Amplius invidie mens ignea plena veneno
Liuoris stimulo pungere quosque nequit.

**Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corruptione
secundum Iram.**

Cap^m. xi. Feruida viuentem quem nuper torruit ira,
780 Amplius impaciens non mouet ille caput:
Lite sua dudum qui vicinos agitabat,
Mutus ad interitum non habet ipse sonum:
Nuper linguosus nequit amplius esse susurro;
Mors vocat, ipse tacet, nilque refatur ei.
Qui terrere solet inopem terrore minarum,
Contra vermiculum iam valet ipse nichil:
Non suus ad bellum furor ammodo prouocat ipsum,
Qui neque cum verme federa pacis habet:
Eius enim gladius iam non erit ecce timendus,
790 Qui patitur vermem cor lacerare suum:
Corporis ex odio non inficiet rationem,
Ammodo vitali qui ratione caret.

**Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corruptione
secundum Auariciam.**

Cap^m. xii. O quid avaricia nuper modo prestat auaro?

Sola sibi stricta lignea cista manet.
Terra sibi fuerat nimio quesita labore,
Septem nuncque pedes, non magis, inde tenet.
Qui dudum fuerat raptor predans aliena,
Ipsum nunc predam mors quasi predo rapit:
Qui nuper fatuis tendit sua recia lucris,
800 Nunc capitur rethe quo remouere nequit.
Diuicias multas vniuit et arcus illas
Seruabat, set nunc dissipat alter opes:
Que quasi fine carens fuerat possessio larga,
Transiit et subito nulla remansit ei.
Gaudet enim coniux sponsi nouitate secundi,
Nec sibi cor meminens anterioris habet;
Immemor et patris letatur filius heres,
Nec sibi qui moritur vnus amicus adest.
Sic qui res rebus agros et agris sociauit,
810 Ammodo de questis fert nichil ipse suis:
Abstulit vna dies quicquid sibi contulit annus,
Et labor a longo tempore cassus abit:
Pauperibus bursam qui clauserat, indiget ille,
Nec valet argenti copia tota sibi.
Nil dolus aut furtum, nil circumvencio corpus,
Iam neque periura falsa cupido iuuat. [620](#)

**Hic loquitur de corporis mortui^{[621](#)} corrupcione
secundum Accidiam.**

Cap^m. xiii. Amplius accidia sibi qui fuit accidiosus
Corporis ad placitum membra fouere negat.
Deditus hic sompno nuper nunc sompnit habunde,
820 De longo sompno quo vigilare nequit:
Mollia qui dudum quesuiit stramina lecto,
Anguibus aspersa frigida terra subest:
Ocia qui peciit nuper fugiendo labores,
Nunc nichil est quod agat, vnde meretur opem.
Si didicisse bonum potuisset, iam scola nulla

Reddit eum doctum, quo magis ipse sapit
Quid sit de rerum dampno: valet ipse dierum
Perdita iam flere tempora longa nimis.
Nuper in ecclesia rogitaui raro, set inde
830 Iam nequit auferri, nil tamen ipse rogat.
Semina qui parce spersit, parce metet ipse;
Quod nuper potuit, vult modo, quando nequit.

**Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corruptione
secundum Gulam.**

Cap^m. xiiii. Nil gula, que dudum fuerat sibi cotidiana,
Amplius in ventre, set nec in ore placet:
Viscera que pressa fuerant grauitate ciborum,
Euacuata modo nil retinere queunt.
Gustauit species et dulcia vina bibebat,
Horum suntque loco stercora mixta luto:
Eius in vmbiculo, sua quo pinguedo latebat,
840 Iam latitat serpens, qui sua crassa vorat:
Olla sui ventris, que parturit ebrietatem,
Rumpitur, et bufo gutturis antra tenet.
Esca sibi dudum redolens nichil ammodo confert, [622](#)
Occupat en nares feda putredo suas:
Crapula, que nuper ieiunia nulla subiuit,
Iam rupto stomacho sentit in ore nichil.

**Hic loquitur de corporis mortui corruptione
secundum Luxuriam.**

Cap^m. xv. O qui luxurie viciu tam dulce putabat,
Iam sugget serpens membra pudenda sua.
Amplius incaste non circuit ille lupanar,
850 Nec manus in tactu feda placere valet:
Non valet ex oculis vultu simile procaci,
Prouocet vt fatuam, quo magis ipsa fauet.
Cantica composita Veneris sermone dolosa

Cum iuramentis ammodo nulla iuuant;
Est sibi nil cantus, nichil aut peditare coreis,
Nam sibi guttur abest, pes neque substat ei.
Non facit incestum, neque virginitatis honorem
Mortuus in carne iam violare potest:
Est modo putredo quicquid fuit ante voluptas,
860 Et calor in coitu frigiditate gelat.
Sic quod erat dudum corpus, nunc ecce cadauer;
Et redit in cinerem quod fuit ante cinis.

**Exquo tractauit qualiter variis peccati deliciis
humanum corpus mortis putredine in hoc mundo
consumitur, interrogat vltius de homine peccatore,
quomodo mundi voluptates tam fallibiles in sui
preiudicium ita ardentem sibi appetit et conspirat.**

Cap^m. xvi. O michi responde, fert quid tibi pompa, superbe,
Cum teret in terra membra putredo tua?
Dic tibi, tu serico, gemmis vestitus et auro,
Quid cum mors veniat gloria vana dabit?
Quid victor gaudes? hec te victoria linquet,
Sit nisi quod vicii vincere bella queas.
Quid tibi liuor aget, vrentis filius Ethne,
870 Cum mors cor que labra soluerit ipsa tua?
Quid tibi siue furor aut ira valere putatur,
Cumque furore mali mors furit ipsa tibi?
Tempora siue tua tibi quid dant accidiosa,
Cum mors sit perstans absque quiete nocens?
Quid tibi delicie poterunt conferre gulose,
Cum morsus mortis fine perhennis eris?
Quid ve putas Venus ipsa dabit tibi fine laboris,
Cum calor in membris desinit esse tuis?
Aurea quid prodest tibi, diues, pompa monete?
880 Vltimus in terram finis vtrumque vorat:
Que tibi sollicitus longeuus contulit annus,
Cuncta simul rapiet hora repente breuis.

Quid reges vincis, quid subdis regna, tyranne?
 Est deus invictus, qui tibi bella parat.
 Quid tibi fama volans, honor, aut quid comptus inanis?
 Omnis enim mundi gloria vana perit.
 Occupat extrema stultorum gaudia luctus,
 Et risum lacrima plena dolore madet.
 Corporis in forma, quid vel de stirpe superbis,
 890 Qui cinis in cineres vermibus esca redis?
 Quid tibi si fortis poteris superare leones,
 Numquid te poterit inquietare pulex?
 Quid nisi stulticiam tibi fert sapiencia mundi?
 Ergo nichil sapiens quod sapit absque deo.
 Est tibi de limo formatum corpus inane,
 Pronaque natura carnis ad omne malum;
 Incipit in luctu finitque dolore: quid ergo
 Queris vt hic tale glorificetur opus?
 Cum nichil ex mundo sit corpore glorificatum,
 900 Est tibi nil corpus glorificare tuum.
 Nil tibi plus remanet aut corporis aut tibi rerum,
 Sola nisi merita, sint bona siue mala:
 Cum venit illa dies, que nil nisi corporis huius⁶²³
 Ius habet, inueniet tunc homo facta sua.
 Non hic iure locum valet vllus habere manentem,
 Mortis ad incertas transiet immo vias.

**Hic loquitur qualiter omnia mundi huius sicut
 vestimentum veterascunt, et quasi sompnifera in ictu
 oculi clauduntur: loquitur eciam in speciali de mortis
 memoria et eiusdem nominis significacione.**

Cap^m. xvii. Omnia quam cicius oculi clauduntur in ictu,
 Et quasi per sompnum preterit omnis homo:
 Gaudia perpetuos pariunt mundana dolores
 910 Tollit et eternum viuere vita brevis.
 Omnia que possunt amitti nulla videntur,
 Nec longum quicquid desinit esse reor.

Dic quid honor, quid opes, quid gloria, quid ve
iuuentus,
Forma, genus, vires, femina, vestis, ager,
Gemma vel argentum, quid septrum, regna vel aurum,
Purpura, quid latus fundus et ampla domus,
Magna potencia, multa sciencia, vana voluptas,
Vita quid, et nostri corporis ipsa salus.⁶²⁴

920 Quod caro mortalis tanquam vestis veterascit
Et celeri lapsu curua senecta venit,
Quod nostre semper minuuntur tempora vite,⁶²⁵
Quodque dies hominis fumus et vmbra fugit,
Quod sit vita brevis, quod mors incerta, quod omni
Tempore nos queuis causa molesta premit,
Alterutrum poterunt homines exemplificari;
Res etenim tales experimenta docent.
Rex est quisque sui, bene qui regit acta, beatus;
Qui regit acta male, seruus ineptus erit:
Rex appellaris: quid inani nomine gaudes,
930 Qui viciis pulsus seruus vbique iaces?
Cur viciis seruit qui regnis imperat, et non⁶²⁶
Mancipium vile corporis esse pudet?
Dum viciis sordes, nil prodest fulgida vestis,
Absterget maculas purpura nulla tuas.
Expediens igitur foret, vt sic quisque viator
Quam leuius poterit exoneratus eat.
Singula de nobis anni predantur euntes,
Morsque superveniens prospera queque rapit:
Regreditur cinis in cinerem, resolutio carnis
940 Monstrat principii materiale lutum.
Scit deus hoc anime quod fiet in orbe futuro,
Integra seu lesa, quanta que qualis erit:
Ista sciunt homines, mundo quod corpus in isto
Nil sibi perdurans vtile carnis habet.
Est caro corrupta viuens, plus mortua cunctis
Atque creaturis vile cadauer habet.

O speculum mortis! quotquot speculantur in illo,
Si bene se videant, gloria nulla patet:

950 Aduerse mortis sic ordo retrogradus extat,
Quod statuit caudas ad caput esse pares.
A morsu vetito mors dicitur; omnia mordens
Nominis exponit significata sui.
Rebus in incertis nihil est incercius hora
Mortis, morte nichil cercius esse potest.
Dum minus esse putat, hominem mors fallit, et ipse
Qui magis est sanus clanculo celat eam:
Non erit astrologus, medicus seu, de medicina
Qui prolongatum possit habere diem.
Sic homo, sic animal pariter moriuntur, et ambo
960 In terram redeunt condicione pari.
Est nichil exceptum: quicquid fit in orbe creatum, [627](#)
Sicut habet vitam, constat habere necem.
Clam veniens thalamis mors furtiuis volat alis,
Subuertens subito quod fuit ante retro:
Predat opes, vires nichilat, disiungit amicos,
Auro nec redimi quomodocumque potest:
Tollit agenda viris, reddit tamen actibus ipsos,
Compotus vt fiat iudicis ante pedes.
Ille quidem Iudex, qui singula iudicat eque,
970 Munera quem mundi flectere nulla queunt:
Iudicioque suo capiet vir digna laboris
Premia pro meritis absque fauore suis.

**Hic loquitur quod, quamuis iustis et iniustis vnus
sit naturaliter interitus, mors tamen iusti omnes
exsoluens miserias eius spiritum glorie reddit
sempiterne.**

Cap^m. xviii. Iustus et iniustus per mortem transit vterque,
Terraque sorte pari corpus vtrumque vorat:
Disparilis meriti restat tamen exitus horum,
Est nam leta bonis mors et amara malis.
Est igitur felix homo qui viuens bene fecit,
Quo moriens poterit sumere dona dei;

Dona quidem celi, quo gaudia cuncta refulgent,
 980 Quo sine tristitia vita perhennis erit.
 Mors aberit, morbus, labor, hostis, curua senectus,
 Non habet hec felix illa superna domus:
 Spiritibus summis equabit gracia regis,
 Pro quibus est vltro passus amara crucis.
 Hic est ille locus pacis que potentis honoris,
 Quo tenebre nulle, quo sine nocte dies;
 Quo deus absterget lacrimam luctumque, nec illuc
 Amplius aut clamor aut dolor vllus erit:
 Nec mors nec morbus, sitis, esuries nec egestas,
 990 Set neque casus habet hunc habitare locum.
 Lux ibi continua, pax iugis, gloria perpes,
 Vita beata, salus vera, perhennis amor:
 Est ibi spes que fides, bonitas, laus, gracia, virtus,
 Sensus, amor, pietas, gloria, forma, decus.
 Est sine sorde caro iuuenilis, et absque senecta
 Etas, diuicie sunt sine labe doli:
 Est pax absque metu, honor omnis et absque
 superbo;⁶²⁸
 Absque labore quies, absque dolore salus.
 Consummata manent ibi gaudia, passio nulla
 1000 Est et ibi, set habet omne quod optat homo:
 Vita perhennis ibi viget, et patet illa beata,
 Que super omne valet, visio clara dei.
 Vis tibi describam paucis quid sit locus ille?
 Plus est quam quiuis dicere possit homo:
 Plus est quam possit mentis ratione doceri,
 Vel plus quam cordis cella tenere queat.
 Quam felix locus est, quam digna laude colendus,
 In quo conveniunt gaudia cuncta simul!
 Sic, quia non finit ibi gloria, non ego possum
 1010 Finem condigne ponere laudis ei.
 Hic erit angelici cetus, quam perdidit olim,
 Suppleto numero gloria plena suo:
 Hic erit humano generi laus summa, resumpto
 Corpore cum fuerit glorificata caro:

Hic erit in domino cunctis gaudere per eum,
Omnia cum fuerit omnibus ipse deus:
Et sic mors iusti tollit sibi cuncta nociua
Corporis, ac anime celica regna parat.
Cum moritur iustus, tunc viuens incipit esse;
1020 Hec mors vitalis, que moriendo iuuat;
Hec mors non oneri set plus conducit honori,
Possidet in requiem mortuus vnde deum.

**Hic loquitur de duplici⁶²⁹ morte peccatoris, vna
ex qua corpus hic resoluitur, alia ex qua digno dei
iudicio penis perpetuis anima cruciatur.**

Cap^m. xix. Heu! nimis infelix qui se viuens male gessit,
Quo grauis in morte pena vorabit eum:
Mors etenim duplex homini debetur iniquo;
Est mors prima grauis, altera feda magis.
Prima necans corpus de mundo segregat illud,
Nec valet vlterius quid sibi ferre mali;
Altera set grauior animam deducit ad yma,
1030 Reddit et hanc Sathane, que solet esse dei:
Ponit in ambiguum que sit mundana voluptas,
Et fore dat certum pena quod omnis adest,
Pena quidem baratri, dolor omnis quo vegetabit,
Quo semper moritur, nec valet ipse mori.
Non vox vlla valet miseras edicere penas,
Quorum tormenta languida fine carent:
Hinc timor atque tremor, labor et dolor inde sequetur,
Perpetue pene mors furit absque mori:
Iugi morte mori, seu iugi viuere morte,
1040 Nil differt dicas, viuere siue mori.
Heu! mortem repeto tociens, quia nil nisi mortis
Effigiem miseris inferet ille locus,
Ille locus quem dira fames, quem frigus et ardor,
Quem tenebre, quem nox, noctis et vmbra tegit.
Vermis ibi mentes corrodit, et ignis ab estu

Corpora consumet, pena timenda nimis:
Tortor ibi, qui semper habet torquere nec vnquam
Deficiet, tortum torrida pena teret.

- Quicquid erat placitum carni subuertitur omne,
1050 Quod fuit et dulce torquet amara lues:
Quod fuerat pulcrum fedat turpissima forma,
Quod fuerat sanum, pena resoluit opus:
Quod fuerat forte tunc viribus expoliatur;
Est sapiens stultus, est ibi diues inops:
Quod fuerat luxus prius, est ibi vermis et ignis,
Fit, gula que fuerat, insaciata fames.
Sunt tenebre visus pungens et scorpio tactus,
Gressus et in laqueos mortis habebit iter:
Aures torquentur strepitu fetoreque nares,
1060 Et que sunt pene gustus amara sapit:
Est ibi flens oculus, dens stridens, omneque membrum
Soluitur in luctum, quo sine fine dolet.
Quod fuerat vita mors est, quod corpus eratque
Vt fax comburens semper in igne coquit.
Heu, set ymago dei nuper tam pura creata
Illa dolens anima demonis instar habet.
Non Thetis extinguit ibi fulmina, set neque morsus⁶³⁰
Vipereos medici compta medela iuuat:
Stans ibi continuus dolor est vt parturientis,
1070 Tempora nec venie spectat habere locus.
Perpetuum pene tormentum nemo gehenne
Mente capit, set ibi stat dolor absque pari:
Cor de mente tremit, de corde caro, quod in ista
Scribere materia plus nequit egra manus.
Quo vultu, vel qua facie, vel quo comitatu
Tunc apparebit iudicialis apex?
Terribilis vultus, facies quasi sit furibundi,
Horridus aspectus aspera queque minans:
Iudicis ille furor breuis, ira set absque remissa
1080 Pena, nil venie nil pietatis habens.
Mater et angelicus cetus, necnon duodenus
Iudicium faciens ordo sequetur eum:

Angelus hic et homo pariter tormenta subibunt,
Penam pro meritis soluet vterque suis;
Efficientque pares pene, quos nuper iniquus
Peccandi pariles efficiebat amor.
Distinguetur ibi malus et bonus, ille sinistram,
Ille tenens dextram, iudiciumque ferent.

O, quam tristis erit miseris sententia danda,
1090 Perpetue mortis perdicione mori.
Hec erit illa dies domini, qua luce patebunt
Clarius occulta, que modo clausa latent:
Hec erit illa dies ire, lux illa tremenda,
Qua non subsistet angelus absque metu.
Cum vix si iustus puncto saluandus in illo, [631](#)
Impie, quo fugies? quae fuga? Nulla quidem.
Est igitur mentis prudentis, mentis honeste,
Mentis discrete tale timere malum.
O nimium felix, tales euadere clades
1100 Qui valet, et meriti viuere laude sui!
O nimium felix, o secla per omnia felix,
O preseruatus, oque beatus homo,
Qui poterit mortis tantas euadere penas,
Celica cumque deo gaudia ferre suo!
Nunc igitur sedeat sapiens et computet actus,
Quam prius adueniat iudicis illa dies.

**Postquam de gaudiis et penis que bonis et malis
debentur tractauit, consulit vltius quod
unusquisque ad bonos mores se conuertat, et de hiis
que negligenter omisit, absque desperatione contritus
indulgenciam a deo confidenter imploret.**

Cap^m. xx. Cumque repentinum casum brevis hora minatur, [632](#)
Dum tenuem flatum suscitatur aura leuis,
Care, memento tui, quis sis, cur, unde vel ad quid,
1110 Vel cuius factus condicionis eras;
Quod caro sit fragilis, fallax facilisque moueri,

Prona sit ad peius, pessima prompta sequi.
 Spiritus hunc mundum spernat speretque futura,
 Semper in auctoris fixus amore sui:
 Quod caro spiritui subdatur eumque sequatur,
 Spiritus auctori seruiat ipse suo;
 Quod motus carnis moderetur, commemoranda
 Est mors et pena mortis habenda malis.
 Non poterit melius hominis caro viua domari,
 1120 Quam quod mente gerat mortua qualis erit.
 Fletibus assiduis, est dum data gracia flendi,
 Penituisse iuuat estque salubre satis:
 Nec deus ethereus hec crimina vendicat vlli,
 Que confessa dolens non residiua facit.
 Qui reus est igitur homo, penam temporis huius
 Sustineat, donec diluat omne malum;
 Vt sic purgatus, cum iudex venerit, illam
 Effugiat penam, que sine fine manet:
 Nam qui iussa dei non seruat et vltima vite
 1130 Spectat, ad infernum cogitur ille trahi.
 Scripture fallunt, aut certe noscere debes
 Quod reddit ad veniam vix animalis homo;
 Victus enim vicio vicii fit seruus, et in se
 Non habet admissum soluere posse iugum:
 Ergo perpes ei debetur pena necesse,
 Qui sibi peccandi velle perhenne facit.
 Parcere nempe deo proprium tamen et misereri est,
 Vnde, licet sero, te reuocare stude.
 Figmentum nostrum nouit, set et ipse medetur
 1140 Tandem contritum, qui petit eius opem.
 Non te desperes, pius est deus, immo deumque
 Qui negat esse pium, denegat esse deum:
 Hic quasi fons viuus patet omnibus, et vacuari
 Vt fons nescit aquis, hic pietate nequit.
 Set quia spem nimiam presumptio sepe fatigat,
 Tu tibi spem pone sicut oportet agi:
 Vt sapiens speres, tibi sit tua spes moderanda,
 Eius habent sancto frena timore regi.

Non timor excedat, quo desperacio mentem
1150 Polluat, immo deum mentis amore time:
Nec spes presumat, set amet commixta timore, [633](#)
Sic timor est virtus spes et vterque salus.
Set meditando tamen tua mens de fine remorsa,
Semper amara timens speret habere bona:
Sanccius vt viuas, memorare nouissima semper,
Ledunt nam iacula visa perante minus.
Respice cotidie, mortis quia tempus adesse
Festinat, que simul prospera cuncta ruet.

**Hic loquitur quod sunt modo pauci, qui aut
propter celi affectum aut gehenne metum huius vite
voluptatibus renunciant; set quecumque caro
concupiscit, omni postposita ratione, ardencius
perficere conantur.**

Cap^m. xxi. Qui sibi commemorans, puto, singula ponderat eque,
1160 Senciet a fine gaudia vana fore:
Nunc tamen a viciis est quilibet infatuatus,
Quod de fine suo vix memoratur homo.
Quisque suum corpus colit, et de carnis amore
Gaudet, et est anime causa relictæ sue:
Gloria nec celi mentes neque pena gehenne
A mundi labe iam reuocare queunt.
Sic caro, sic demon, sic mundus vbique modernos
Deuiat, vt Cristi vix sciat vnus iter:
Est caro que fragilis, demon versutus, iniquus
1170 Mundus, in hoc hominum tempore regna colunt:
Et sic bruta quasi perit humane rationis
Virtus, dum vicium corporis acta regit.
Est homo nunc animal dicam, set non rationis,
Dum viuit bruti condicione pari.
Nescia scripture brutum natura gubernat,
Iudicis arbitrium nec rationis habet:
Est igitur brutis homo peior, quando voluntas

Preter naturam sola gubernat eum.
 Corporis, heu! virtus per singula membra revoluens
 1180 Naturam viciis seruit ad acta foris;
 Ac anime ratio carnis viciata vigore
 De virtute nichil interiore sapit.
 Morigeri cicius modo sunt derisio plebis,
 Et scola peccati iustificabit opus:
 Que solet illa viros veteri de more beare,
 Iam noua virtuti frena libido mouet. [634](#)
 Inter eos mundi quibus est donata potestas,
 'Sic volo, sic iubeo,' sunt quasi iura modo.
 Succumbunt iusti clamantes, 'Ve! quod in orbe
 1190 Impia pars hominum singula regna terit.'
 Vis prohibet leges, euertunt crimina mores,
 Virtus peccati turbine quassa perit:
 Mundus turbatur, rerum confunditur ordo,
 Involuitque simul omnia grande chaos.
 Squalidus in terra sic stat genitor genitusque,
 Quod natura suo vix stat in orbe loco.
 Liur et ambicio, gula, fraus, metuenda libido,
 Ira, tumor mentis, scismata, laudis amor,
 Ambiciosus honor, amor et sceleratus habendi,
 1200 Ipse voluptatis vsus et ecce malus,
 Furta, rapina, dolus, metus et periuria, testes
 Sunt mundi quod erit ammodo nulla fides.

**Hic loquitur de variis vindictis occasione peccati
 in hoc seculo iam quasi cotidie [635](#) contingentibus, que
 absque iustorum virorum meritis et oracionibus
 nullatenus sedari poterunt.**

Cap^m. xxii. Ecce dies veniunt, predixit quos fore Cristus,
 Et patuere diu verba timenda dei.
 Precessere fames, pestis, motus quoque terre,
 Signaque de celo, stat quoque guerra modo:
 Nititur aduersus regnum consurgere regnum,

Gens contra gentem, sic patet omne malum.
 Vt pecoris sic est hominis fusus modo sanguis,
 1210 Victa iacet pietas, et sinit ista deus:
 Est et adhuc vindex extenta manus ferientis
 Continuans plagas, nec timet vllus eas.
 Longanimis domini sententia sepe moratur,
 Vir bonus immunis nec malus vllus erit.
 Quem deus ille ferit, nullo valet orbe tueri,
 Si non contritum culpa relinquat eum.
 Mortem peccantis non vult deus, immo misertus
 Vult vt vertatur, quo sibi vita datur:
 Est pius ipse deus, scripturis sicut habemus,
 1220 Pro Sodomis Abrahe dixerat ipse pie:
 'Inter iniquorum tot milia tu populorum
 Redde decem iustos, et miserebor eis.
 Est michi nam soli proprium miseris misereri,
 Multis pro paucis parcere curo libens.'
 O deus, ergo tibi quid dicam, quomodo nostri
 Luctus continui sunt tibi nuga quasi?
 Nonne decem iusti modo sunt, meritis vt eorum
 Stellifer ipse dies curet in orbe malos?
 Aut deus oblitus est immemor ad miserandum,
 1230 Dormit vel fingit, aut sibi facta latent.
 Verius vt dicam, deus est accensus, et ignis
 Fulminat inde Iacob, iraque lata furit:
 Sic et plasma suum plasmator abhorret, et ipsum
 Torquet pro factis que videt ipse malis.
 O, qui mentali videt ex oculo mala nostra
 Omnibus in gradibus continuare dies,
 Dicere tunc poterit quod talia nullus ab euo
 Impunita diu crimina vidit homo.
 Quis status ille modo, quin sit transgressus, et ordo,
 1240 Quem iustum dicam, deficit vnde sciam.
 Hoc nisi gratis emat, dubito prope quod generalis
 Decasus nostre prosperitatis adest:
 Set quia de summis gradibus mala progrediuntur,
 Est qui summus eos corrigat ipse deus.

**Hic loquitur sub compendio recapitulando
finaliter de singulis mundi gradibus, qui singillatim a
debito deuiantes ordine virtutes diminuendo
extingunt, et ea que viciorum sunt augmentando
multipliciter exercent.**

Cap^m. xxiii. Dudum prelati solum diuina gerebat,
Nunc propter mundum nescit habere deum:
Curatus cure dudum seruiuit, et ipse
Nunc vagus exterius circuit omne genus:
Dudum presbyteri casti, nunc luxuriosi;
1250 Ocia que querunt plurima dampna fouent:
Ex studio mores dudum didicere scolares,
Nunc tamen econtra stat viciata scola:
Indiuisus amor monachos sibi strinxit vt ardor,
Nunc petit inuidia claustra tenere sua:
Asperitas dudum fratres in carne domabat,
Regula set mollis ammodo parcet eis: [636](#)
Dudum milicia fuit et sibi gracia prompta,
Gracia nunc tarda stat, quia vita mala:
Mercator dudum iustum peciit sibi lucrum,
1260 Nunc quoque fraude sua querit habere lucra:
Simplicitas animi fuerat sociata coloni,
Nunc magis indomitum cor gerit ipse ferum:
Lex dudum iusta nulli parcebat amica,
Quam vigor argenti subdit vbique sibi.
Par status imparibus est actibus attenuatus,
Exceditque suum quisque viator iter.
Sic pietas humilis teritur, que superbia regnat;
Liuor adest agilis, torpet et omnis amor:
Permanet ira ferox, et abit paciencia suplex,
1270 Viuit et accidia, sollicitudo perit:
Ebrietas, non sobrietas, tenet ammodo mensas,
Feruet et in viciis crapula plena cibis:
Casta pudicicia dudum precingere lumbos
Affuit, et modo vult soluere luxus eos:
Nuper larga manus inopi sua munera spersit,

Nunc cupit et bursam claudit auara tenax.

Dic modo quot viciis modo sola superbia mundum

Ad varii sceleris precipitauit opus: [637](#)

Dic quot liuor edax acies sua signa sequentes

1280 Subdidit imperio vique metuque suo:

Dic quot auaricie manibus vel mente rapaci

Intendunt populi iura negando dei;

Quot gula deliciis torpet, quot torpor inanes

Carnis adulterio fedat in orbe suo.

Singula nempe vorat anime caro, sic quod vbique

Subdidit inmundam crimine mundus eam:

Singula fallacis mundi dulcedo subegit,

Nos tamen inmundos mundificare nequit.

Iam in fine libri loquitur magis in speciali de patria illa in qua natus fuerat, vbi quasi plangendo conqueritur, qualiter honores et virtutes veteres a variis ibidem erroribus superuenientibus, vt dicitur, ad presens multipliciter eneruantur.

Cap^m. xxiiii. Singula que dominus statuit sibi regna per orbem,

1290 Que magis in Cristi nomine signa gerunt,

Diligo, set propriam super omnia diligo terram,

In qua principium duxit origo meum.

Quicquid agant alie terre, non subruor inde,

Dum tamen ipse foris sisto remotus eis;

Patria set iuuenem que me suscepit alumpnum,

Partibus in cuius semper adhero manens,

Hec si quid patitur, mea viscera compaciuntur,

Nec sine me dampna ferre valebit ea:

Eius in aduersis de pondere sum quasi versus;

1300 Si perstet, persto, si cadat illa, cado.

Que magis ergo grauant presenti tempore, saltem

Vt dicunt alii, scismata plango michi.

Vna meo sensu res est, que pessima cunctis

Iam poterit dici fons et origo mali.

Heu! quia iusticia procul abcessit fugitiua,
 Cessit et est alibi pax sociata sibi:
 Pax, que iusticie dudum solet oscula ferre,
 Nunc fugit a terra, ius perit ecce quia.
 Plures iam nocui sumunt sibi regna magistri,
 1310 Vis iubet et velle, iura nec vlla videt:
 Nunc vbi se vertit magnas, sine iure sequuntur
 Leges, set populus inde subibit onus:
 Corpore sicque meo non tantum torqueor, immo
 Sunt michi pro minimo res quibus vtar ego.
 Non est de modicis quod adulterium modo ledit;
 Que caro deposcit omnia namque licent.
 In terris aliis Venus et si predominetur,
 Exsoluunt meritis hoc aliunde suis;
 Est ibi nam posita lex, que communis ad omnes
 1320 Iudicat, et causas terminat absque dolo:
 Non status aut sexus, non dona, preces, timor aut quid
 Possunt a minimo tollere iura viro:
 Et sic iusticia redimit quodammodo culpam
 Carnis, que fragili condicione cadit.
 Set nos in patria non solum vincimur ista
 Ex carnis stimulo, quo stimulatur homo;
 Immo suas metas lex transit nescia iuris,
 Sicque per obliquas patria nostra vias
 Deuiat in tanto, quod, dicunt, amplius ordo
 1330 Non erit in nostris partibus: vnde deus
 Visitat has partes vindicta, qualis ab euo
 In nullo mundi tempore visa fuit.
 Non tamen est terra que gaudet in omnibus vna,
 Set magis in nostra fit modo virga fera:
 Clamor vbique, vide, non solus conqueror ipse;
 Culpas tam patulas est reticere nephas:
 Sic fleo cum flente, lex fallit, fallor et ipse;
 Stat mea nam grauibz patria plena malis.
 Nos, quibus assuevit numquam crudeliter vti
 1340 Fatum, iam pressos sternit vbique reos.
 Que fuerat tellus omni preciosa metallo,

Iam nequit ex plumbo pondus habere suum;⁶³⁸
 Dignior argento, fuluo quoque dignior auro,
 Nobile que genuit, vix valet esse quadrans.
 Nuper dixerunt quicumque venire solebant,
 'Venimus ad portus, vbera terra, tuos.'
 Nunc tamen vt sterilis reputaris et es, quia mores
 Nunc neque diuicie sunt aliquando tue.
 Quo ferar, vnde petam mestis solacia rebus?
 1350 Anchora iam nostram non tenet vlla ratem.
 Sic mea, que stabilis fuit, infirmatur iniquis
 Patria iudiciis, iura negando viris:
 Sic gentis domina, quasi iam viduata, tributa
 Reddit peccato, statque remota deo.
 Sic que morigera fuerat, nunc est viciosa;
 Dudum legifera, nunc sine lege fera:
 Sic ea que larga fuerat, nunc tollit egena;
 Que fuerat sancta, fit Venus ipsa dea:
 Est sale iam spersa, fuerat que fructibus ampla,
 1360 Et velut vrtica, que solet esse rosa:
 Que fuerat pulcra, quasi monstrum stat reputata;
 Fit caput in caudam, sic terit omnis eam.
 Scandala feda parit nouiter transgressa nouerca,
 Omnis que laudis mater et hospes erat:
 Que fuit angelica nuper, nunc angulus extat,
 Languet et in tenebris sorde repressa magis.
 Patria, quam famam dicunt habuisse sororem,
 Est magis infamis omnibus ipsa locis:
 Que fuerat digne super omnes celsior orbe,
 1370 Nunc deus est alibi, subditur ipsa quasi:
 Ordine retrogrado quicquid sibi laudis habebat
 Cedit, et instabilis vndique spreta iacet.
 Firma mouet, ruit alta, terit modo forcia discors
 Error, et innumera spergit vbique mala:
 Torpescunt procures, clerus dissoluitur, vrbes
 Discordant, leges sunt sine iure graues:
 Murmurat indomitus vulgus, concrescit abvsus
 Peccati solitus; sic dolet omnis humus.

1380 Hinc puto quod seuit pes terreus in caput auri,
Et lupus agnorum cornua vana timet.⁶³⁹
In meritis hominum solum deus aspicit orbem,
Et sua de facto tempora causat homo.

O sterilis terra morum, sani viduata
Consilii, lesa nec medicamen habens,
Dic vbi fortuna latitat modo, qua reputabas
Nuper in orbe tuum non habuisse parem.
Si Lachesis sortem tibi contulit esse dolosam,
Iam venit ipsa tui r e d d e r e pacta doli.⁶⁴⁰
Nunc palletque tuis nigris Aurora venenis,
1390 Cuius lux aliis fulsit in orbe magis;
Nuncque iuuentutis flos que tibi creuit habunde
Aret, et a viciis inveterata peris;
Fedaque nunc volucris, venturi nuncia luctus,
Concinit in fatis bubo propheta tuis.
Scit deus hanc causam specialius esse notandam,
Qua locus iste modo distat honore suo:
Hoc scio, quod cunctis locus in proueria crescit,
Et quasi nunc speculum denotat omnis eum.

Talia per terras fatali lege geruntur,
1400 Vt reputant, set ego non ita stare puto:
Non est fortuna, que talia causat habenda,
Nec sors, set merita nostra per acta mala.
Qui tamen hanc stare modo credit et hanc reuocare
Vult, purget crimen, sic reuocabit eam:
Gracia prompta dei querentibus inuenietur,
Nam sibi conuersis vertitur ipse deus.
Dum pia pro pace cecinit processio terre,
Firmaque iusticia fecerat acta sua,
Dumque fides steterat et amor s i n e l a b e
m a n e b a t,⁶⁴¹

1410 Tunc, quia pax viguit, sors bona
cuncta tulit.

Nunc igitur nostra sit vita deo renouata,⁶⁴²
Ne sors fortuita plus queat esse mala:

Vota vetusta precum redeant domino dominorum,
Vt redeat dominus cum pietate suis;
Per quem pax et honor et tempora sana redibunt,
Que pro peccato sunt fugitiua modo.

- Prospera qui veteris vult temporis esse renata,
Reddat et emendet facta priora nouis.
Est deus ipse piis pius et seuerus iniquis,
1420 Sic valet ob meritum quisquis habere deum.
Nos igitur, domine, tua gracia, que solet olim
Ferre reis veniam, te miserante iuuat:
Anticipet pietas tua nos, ne dicat eorum
Gens, 'Vbi sit dominus, qui solet esse pius?'
Da, precor, accessum lacrimis, mitissime, nostris,
Nam sine te nullum scis quod habemus opem:
Nunc tua pro lapsis nitatur gracia rebus,
Nostra nec anterior sit tibi culpa memor:
Numquam pigra fuit causis tua gracia nostris:
1430 Est vbi nunc illa, que solet esse salus?
Nos peccatores sumus, et tu plus miserator,
Scit bonitasque tua nos opus esse tuum:
Si plus peccaret vir, plura remittere posses,
Materiam venie sors tibi nostra dedit.
Si quociens homines peccant, tua fulmina mittas,
Exiguo presens tempore mundus erit:
A te pendentem sic cum circumspicis orbem,
Auctor, pacificum fac opus esse tuum.
Nos, deus alme, tui serui, quamuis modo tardi,
1440 Te, non fortunam, credimus esse deum:
Scimus te solum super omnes esse colendum;
Sic nostri solus tu miserere, deus!

**Hic loquitur qualiter ea que in hoc presenti libello
quasi sompniando de mundi scripsit erroribus, non
ex se tantum, set ex plebis voce communi concepit.
Consulit tamen finaliter quod, si quis inde se
culpabilem senciatur, priusquam nobis peiora**

**succedant tempora, suam ex humili corde culpam
penitens emendet.**

Cap^m. xxv. Hos ego compegi versus, quos fuderat in me
Spiritus in sompnis: nox erat illa grauis.
Hec set vt auctor ego non scripsi metra libello,
Que tamen audiui trado legenda tibi:
Non tumor ex capite proprio me scribere fecit
Ista, set vt voces plebis in aure dabant.
Quem sua mens mordet, de voce sit ille remorsus,
1450 Curet vt in melius que tulit egra prius:
Qui tamen immunem se sentit, ab inde quietus⁶⁴³
Transeat, et meritis sic stet vterque suis.
Quem non culpa grauat mea non sententia culpat,
Leditur hinc nullus, sit nisi forte reus:⁶⁴⁴
Ne grauet ergo tibi, gibbosus namque
panelli⁶⁴⁵
Et non sanus equus ferre recusat onus.
Non tamen in specie quemquam de pondere culpe
Accuso, set eo se probet intus homo:
Non ego mordaci distrinxi crimine quemquam,
1460 Nec meus vllius crimina versus habet.
Que sompno cepi, vigilans mea scripta peregi,
Sint bona dicta bonis, et mala linquo malis:
Omnis enim mundum gemit esse dei laceratum
Vindicta nostri pro grauitate mali.
Ergo suam culpam contrito corde, priusquam
Consumpti simus, corrigat ipse malus.
Corrigit hic mundum, qui cor retinet sibi mundum:
Cor magis vnde regat, hec sibi scripta legat.
Quod scripsi plebis vox est, set et ista
videbis,⁶⁴⁶
Quo clamat populus, est ibi sepe
1470 deus.
Qui bonus est audit bona, set peruersus obaudit,
Ad bona set pronus audiat ista bonus.
Hec ita scripta sciat malus, vt bonus ammodo fiat,

Et bonus hec querat, vt meliora gerat.
Mundus non ledit iustum, bene dummodo credit,
Quando set excedit, mundus ad arma redit:
Mundus erit talis, fuerit viuens homo qualis;
Obstet vitalis quilibet ergo malis.
Culpa quidem lata, qua virtus stat
viciata,⁶⁴⁷
Cum non purgata fuerit set
1480 continuata,
Que meruit fata sunt sibi fine data.

⁶⁴⁸Explicit libellus qui intitulatur Vox Clamantis,
editus precipue super articulo primi infortunii, quod
infortunato Ricardo secundo in primordiis regni sui,
vt audistis, quasi ex dei virga⁶⁴⁹ notabiliter in Anglia
contingebat. Et nunc vlterius, quia ipse non inde
remorsus, immo magis ad modum tyranni induratus,
regnum suum assiduis oppressionibus incessanter
flagellare non desistit, diuine vindicte flagellum vsque
in sue deposicionis exterminium non inmerito
assecutus est. Tres namque tunc regni nobiles super
hoc specialius moti, scilicet Thomas Dux Glouernie,
qui vulgariter dictus est Cignus, Ricardus Comes
Arundellie, qui dicitur Equus, Thomas Comes de
Warrewyk,⁶⁵⁰ cuius nomen Vrsus, hii vero vnanimis
cum quibusdam aliis proceribus sibi adherentibus, vt
regie malicie fautores delerent, ad dei laudem
regnique commodum in manu forti iusto animo
viriliter insurrexerunt, prout in hac consequenti
cronica, que tripertita est, scriptor manifestius
declarare intendit.

FOOTNOTES:

⁵⁹⁰ 9 magnanimi CEHDL magnatum S

⁵⁹¹ 27 Consilium CEHDL

[592](#) 43 decessit SHG descenscit L decessit CED
[593](#) 87 da pinguibus CE
[594](#) 125 circumprecordia SG
[595](#) 160 Est S Et CEHDL
[596](#) 167 grossantur S grassantur HDLT crassantur CEG
[597](#) 182 dolum SCGDL suum EHT
[598](#) 184 scelus] dolus EH
[599](#) 187 rutilans albedo set SCGDL albus paries tamen EHT
[600](#) 189f.

Sic foris ex auro tumulus splendescit, et intro
Fetet putredo, vermibus esca caro. EHT

DL have both this couplet and that in the text

[601](#) 192 falco SCGDL nesus EHT
[602](#) 218 pulchra C
[603](#) 237 ingenii H (*corr.*) Ingenuum L assimilari CE
[604](#) 256 ipse SL ille CEHD
[605](#) 269 *Ordinary paragr. in CDL, no paragr. E*
[606](#) 291 *Ordinary paragr. CEDL*
[607](#) 350 credet CEHGDL credit S
[608](#) 409 seruus CE
[609](#) 470 estatis C (*ras.*)
[610](#) 490 Passebatque S
[611](#) 535 set] et CEL
[612](#) 562 sunt] sint CE
[613](#) 599 sitis] satis D
[614](#) 611 tradidit] contulit CE
[615](#) 684 queris SGL mauis (mavis) CEHD
[616](#) 691 regno peccato EHL Regni peccato D
[617](#) 707 eum CEHDL₂ enim SGLT
[618](#) 721 perinterius GLT
[619](#) 767 spernens famam C famam serpens L
[620](#) 816 iuuat S iuuant EGD₂LT₂
[621](#) Cap. xiii. *Heading 1 mortui corporis CH*
[622](#) 843 redolens dudum CEHD
[623](#) 903 nisi] sibi C
[624](#) 918 et] est S
[625](#) 921 nostre D nostri SCEHGL
[626](#) 931 imparat C
[627](#) 961 fit S sit CEHGDL
[628](#) 997 et *om.* S
[629](#) Cap. xix. *Heading 1 duplici CEG₂L duplici SHT duplici D*
[630](#) 1067 Tethis D
[631](#) 1095 si SGL sit CEHD
[632](#) 1107 Cumque ST Dumque CEHGDL
[633](#) 1151 comixta H
[634](#) 1186 mouet] tenet EDLT
[635](#) Cap. xxii. *Heading 2 quotidie CED*
[636](#) 1256 parcit CE

- [637](#) 1278 opes S
[638](#) 1342 suum SG suo CEHDL
[639](#) 1380 Et lupus SHDL Pastor et CG (*ras.*) Lupus et E
[640](#) 1388 reddere SEHG soluere CDLT
[641](#) 1409 f. commune regebat Perstitit in nobis tunc honor atque salus EDLTH₂
(gerebat E)
[642](#) 1411 Sint igitur nostra bona facta deo renouata EDLTH₂ (reuocata L)
[643](#) 1451 innumen S
[644](#) 1454 *Text* SCEG Sic precor vt nullus DLT
[645](#) 1455 *Text* SCEG Detrahet inde michi DL Se trahit inde michi T
[646](#) 1469 f. *Text* SCEHG (in ista E) per scripta cauebis Que mala sunt, ideo te
dabis atque deo DLTH₂ (perscripta D)
[647](#) 1479-81 DLTH₂ *have two lines only, as follows:—*

Omnibus ipse tamen peior sum, sed releuamen
Det michi per flamen conditor orbis. Amen.1480*

- [648](#) EXPLICIT, &c. Explicit libellus qui intitulatur Vox Clamantis (*omitting the
rest*) EDTH₂ Explicit liber intitulatus Vox clamantis (*omitting the rest*) L
[649](#) 4 virga dei CHG
[650](#) 12 Warwyk CH

CRONICA TRIPERTITA⁶⁵¹

Ista triperita, sequitur que, mente
perita
Cronica seruetur; nam pars que prima
videtur
Est opus humanum, pars illa secunda
prophanum
Est opus inferni, pars tertia iure
superni
Est opus in Cristo. Vir qui bene sentit
in isto
Scire potest mira, quid amor sit, quid
sit et ira:
Est tamen hoc clamor, 'Omnia vincit
Amor.'

Opus humanum est
inquirere pacem et
persequi eam. Hoc
enim fecerunt hii
tres procures de
quibus infra fit
mencio, vbi fides
interfuit.

Opus inferni
est pacem turbare,
iustosque regni
interficere. Hoc
enim Ricardus
capitulos⁶⁵²
dolosa
circumvencione
facere non timuit.

Opus in Cristo
est deponere
superbos de sede et
exaltare
humiles. Hoc
enim deus fecit;
odiosum
Ricardum de
Solio suo proiecit,
et pium Henricum
omni dileccione
gratissimum cum
gloria sublimari
constituit.

TOLLE caput mundi, C ter et sex lustra
fer illi,
Et decies quinque cum septem post
super adde:
Tempus tale nota, qui tunc fuit Anglia
mota.

Hic in prima
parte⁶⁵³ cronice
compositor
tempora
distinguens,⁶⁵⁴
causas vnde
regnum fuit in se
diuisum,

	Dum stat commotus	postmodum per
	Ricardus amore	singula tractabit.
	remotus,	
	Principio Regis oritur transgressio	
	legis,	
	Quo fortuna cadit et humus	
	retrograda vadit.	
	Quomodo surrexit populus, quem non	
	bene rexit,	
	Tempus adhuc plangit super hoc,	
	quod cronica tangit.	
	Libro testante, stat cronica scripta	
	per ante;	
10	Est alibi dicta, transit nec ab aure	
	relicta:	
	Audistis mira, vulgaris que tulit ira:	
	Omnibus in villis timuit vir iustus ab	
	illis.	
	Rex induratum cor semper habet,	Qualiter
	neque fatum	infortunatus rex
	Tale remordebat ipsum, qui iure	Ricardus, virgam
	carebat: 655	dei non metuens,
	Stultorum vile sibi consilium iuuenile	de malo in peius
	Legerat, et sectam senium dedit esse	suam semper
	reiectam:	maliciam
	Consilio iuuenum spirauerat ille venenum,	continuauit.
	Quo bona predaret procerum, quos mortificaret:	
	Sic malus ipse malis adhesit, eisque sodalis	
20	Efficitur, tota regis pietate remota.	
	Tunc accusare quosdam presumpsit auare,	
	Vnde catallorum gazas spoliaret eorum.	
	Tres sunt antiqui proceres, quos regis iniqui	
	Ira magis nouit, et eos occidere vouit:	
	Et sic qui cati pellem cupit excoriati,	
	Fingebat causas fallaci pectore clausas.	Nota de iudicibus
	Caucius vt factum sibi possit habere	illis, qui vt regis
	subactum,	errorem precipue
		contra illos tres

	Leges conduxit, pro parte suaque reduxit:	proceres quos occidere vellet iustificarent, literas
	Munere corrupti suadente timoreque rupti	sub eorum sigillis scriptas errone composuerunt.
30	Legis in errorem regi tribuere fauorem: Hii tunc legiste, quicquid rex dixerat iste, Federa componunt, que sigilla sub ordine ponunt. Tunc rex letatur, super hoc quod fortificatur, Quo magis ad plenum diffundat ille venenum: 656 Tunc aderant tales iuuenes, qui sunt speciales, Laudantes regem, quia vertit sic sibi legem.	
	Hoc concernentes alii, que dolos metuentes, Ad defendendum statuunt cito quid sit agendum.	Qualiter tres proceres predicti de regis malicia secrecius premuniti in sui defensionem roborati sunt.
	Tunc rex festinat, et ad hoc sua iussa propinat,	
40	Vt tres querantur vbi sunt, et ibi capiantur. Tunc tres, qui iusti fuerant et ad arma robusti, Factum disponunt et ad hoc sua robora ponunt. Qui fuerant isti proceres, in nomine Cristi Expedit vt dicam referens, et eis benedicam. Si non directe procerum cognomina recte, Hec tamen obscura referam, latitante figura: Scribere que tendo si mistica verba legendo Auribus apportant, verum tamen illa reportant.	
	Sunt Olor, Vrsus, Equis, stat eorum quilibet equus, Non hii diuisi, set in vnum sunt quasi visi:	Nota de nominibus trium procerum predictorum sub figura. Comes Marescallus. Strenuissimus Comes Derbeie.
50	Penna coronata tribus hiis fuit associata: Qui gerit S tandem turmam comitatur eandem, Nobilis ille quidem probus et iuuenis fuit idem, Sic quasi de celis interfuit ille fidelis: Hac sub fortuna presens aquilonica luna 657	Comes Northumbrie, cuius

	Non fuit ad sortem, sequitur set mente cohortem. 658	Signum fuit luna crescens.
	Qui solem gessit tenebrosus lumina nescit, In Troie metas dum vendicat ipse dietas. Troia fuit prima, per quem sol tendit ad yma; Pallet in eclipsi populus quia non fauet ipsi: Obsistunt turbe Phebo, ne scandat in vrbe, Dumque suis alis Cignus fuit imperialis. Fraus tamen obliquas nubes commouit iniquas, Extera dum rebus temptauit lumina Phebus: Cestria surrexit, Aper in qua lumina rexit, Regis vexillum fatue signauerat illum. Set conspiranti deus obstat et insidianti, Quo dolus exosos inuoluit fine dolosos: Auxilio Cigni, regis pro parte maligni 659 Si vis queratur, contraria vis operatur. Querit Aper latebras, fraudes mortisque tenebras, 660 Quo regnum periat regisque superbia fiat; Cignus et expresse super hiis que cernit adesse Prouidet, et curam regni colit ipse futuram: Ducit Aper gentes, quas concitat arma gerentes, Liber vt hiis pergat proceresque per omnia spergat. Cignus vt hoc sciuit, venientibus obuius iuit, Belliger et purgat regnum, quo vita resurgat: Cum Venus incepit lucem, sors bella recepit.	Qualiter rex, cuius Signum Sol erat, ciues Londonienses pro auxilio ab eis contra dictos tres proceres optinendo requisiuit; set illi regis maliciam perplectentes eidem nullatenus consensierunt. Qualiter rex Comitem Oxonie, qui per aprum designatur, vt ipse contra tres proceres antedictos gentes bellatrices secum duceret, in partes Cestrie vna cum regio vexillo destinauit.
60		
70		

80	Stat Tetis a parte, cecidit dum Cestria Marte,⁶⁶¹ Thamisie fluctus capiunt de sanguine luctus: Vicit Olor pennis, sit ei quo vita perhennis. Tunc Aper Oxonie cecidit de sede sophie; Cum prope stat villam, maledixerat impius illam: Non ibi permansit fugiens set Aper vada transit,⁶⁶²	prope villam Oxonie in fugam se vertit, et castra, que ipse familie sue pro signo gestanda attribuerat, ad terram absque releuamine finaliter proiecta sunt. Nam et ipse Comes, vt securiori modo vitam seruaret, profugus vltra mare nauigio transiit.
90	Infortunatus fit ibi de fonte renatus. De vulpis cauda velox Aper est vt alauda, Cauda ruit castra, que sunt numero velut astra: Sic quia deliquit, vacuus sua castra reliquit, Pauper et exposcit foueam, qua viuere possit. Set neque castrorum iuuat Aprum pompa suorum, Nec sibi fossa datur, dum profugus inde fugatur: Hec ita dum vidit, quod eum fortuna rescidit,⁶⁶³ Per mare transiuit, alibi quo viuere quiuit. Sic Aper in leporem mutatus perdit honorem, Amplius et certus locus est sibi nullus apertus.	
100	Nil odor incensi tunc profuit Eboracensi, Set nec mitra choris nec opes nec culmen honoris; Ad regale latus cum plus sit ad alta leuatus, Corruit a sede, sic transit presul ab ede. Cure mercator primas fuit et spoliator, Pauper et abcessit, quem preuia culpa repressit: Sic fugit hic predo cleri Noua villa Macedo, Quem, quia sic vixit, pater ecclesie maledixit. Est Comes elatus, fallax, cupidus, sceleratus;	Qualiter statim post fugam dicti Comitis Oxonie Alexander de Nevill tunc Eboracensis archiepiscopus, qui eciam cum rege in suis erroribus particeps erat, tunc metu ductus consimili fuga per mare reus euasit. Qualiter Michael de la Pole, Comes

	Fraudes per Mille stat Cancellarius ille: Hic proceres odit et eorum nomina rodit Morsibus a tergo, fit tandem profugus ergo. Sic deus in celis mala de puteo Michaelis	Suffolcie, qui tunc regis Cancellarius erat, dum se culpabilem senciit, trans mare eciam nauigando ad salutem ⁶⁶⁴ alibi se muniuit.
110	Acriter expurgat, ne plus comes ille resurgat. Alter et est talis, sub regis qui cubat alis, Mollis confessor, blandus scelerisque professor: Extitit hic frater, qui stat foris intus et ater, Cuius nigredo fedat loca regia, credo. Hic fuit obliquus procerum latitans inimicus, Semper in augendo magis iram quam minuendo: Hic tamen in fine fugit, et de sorte ruine Que mala spondebat aliis prius ipse luebat. Sunt ita predicti cordis formidine victi,	Qualiter eciam episcopus Cicestrie, tunc regis confessor, consciis culpe extera loca petens propria fugiendo reliquit.
120	De propria viui terra quod sunt fugitiui. Tunc tres persone, qui pleni sunt racione, Iusticiam querunt, regem super hoc adierunt. Rex fuit ad muros Turris proceresque futuros Vidit, et ex visu cognouit se sine risu. Armatis turbis portas intransibiles vrbis, Intrans audaces proceres in pace sequaces; Turrim ceperunt, vbi regis honore steterunt. Eius vt a latere vicium poterint remouere, Est iter inuentum, statuunt quo parliamentum,	Qualiter tres proceres de querela antedicti Londonias pariter aduenientes, cum rege, tunc apud Turrim existente, pro remedio in premissis optinendo, seruata regis reuerencia, colloquium pacificum habuerunt: vnde de regis consensu parliamentum infra breue Londoniis tenendum optinuerunt.

130	Vt sic purgarent regnique statum repararent. Terra covnata fuerat de lege vocata; Rex sedet, et tutum fuit os commune locutum. Dicit enim, tales qui regis collaterales ⁶⁶⁵ Extiterant gentes, super hoc quod sunt fugientes, Iudicium tale fuit exilium generale: De terra dempti sic sunt, non ense perempti; Est ita dilata procerum sententia lata. Hoc facto querunt alios, qui tunc latuerunt, Quorum regalis Camerarius est capitalis.	Qualiter in principio parliamenti concordatum est, quod absencia tunc illorum qui, vt premittitur, a regno sponte fugierunt, in perpetuum exilium absque redempcione iudicaretur.
140	Corruit in fata gladii vestis stragulata; Stat quia non recta, magis est culpanda senecta: Lacrima Regine dum poscit opem medicine, Obrutus amittit caput et sua funera mittit. Ecce Senescalli non tantum lucra catalli, Que mala quesuiuit, sceleris fortuna sitiuit, Set magis in mortem decreuit curia sortem: Dum caput inclinat, gladius sibi iura propinat. Ille quidem Cignum despexit, Aprumque malignum Semper laudauit, cor regis et infatuauit; Fallax, versutus, quasi vulpis fraude volutus,	Qualiter parliamentum gradatim processit, precipue contra illos qui regis iniqui fautores iniqui fuerunt, quorum Simon de Burle ⁶⁶⁶ miles, tunc regis Camerarius, in iudicio conuictus mortis sententia decollatus est.
150	Inuidus et paci lingua fuit ille loquaci. Nomen Baronis cecidit sic Pons Aquilonis; Hoc rex erroris posuit sibi nomen honoris.	Qualiter etiam Iohannes Beauchamp miles, tunc regis hospicii Senescallus, quem rex Baronem de Briggenorth vocari constituit, amisso capite de Curia recessit.

	Maiores erat ville, Tribulus dictus fuit ille, Qui proceres pungit regisque dolos magis vngit: Hunc quasi consortem dilexit rex, quia sortem Consilii cepit, quo mortem fine recepit: Furcis pendebat, quem primo terra trahebat, Ictum sic ensis non sentit Londoniensis. In banco regis qui librat pondera legis, Iuraque cognouit, aliis plus iura remouit, Cornubiensis erat: si quis sua crimina querat, Peior eo nullus, nec eo fallacior vllus. Hic scelus instigat proceres, quos sepe fatigat, Vnde fatigatus tandem perit hic sceleratus: Crimine prestante super hoc quod fecerat ante, Ad furcas tractus fit ibi pendendo subactus. Pendula sors tristis morientibus accidit istis, In manibus quorum pendebant iura virorum. Iudicibus reliquis falsisque scienter amicis, 668 Vt patet ante nota, conclamat curia tota: Vrbs, ager et villa damnarunt falsa sigilla, Que dederant causam sceleris regi, magis ansam. 669 Non fuit hec pena, delictis que fore plena Posset, et hoc certe vox plebis dixit aperte, 670 Set nimis ornate penam ficta pietate Pontifices regis moderantur ab ordine legis: Sic non ense cadunt, set in exilium mare vadunt,	Qualiter Nicholaus Brembel, qui ciuis et Maior Londoniarum fuerat, ad furcas tractus et ibi suspensus suam vrbs libertatem turpiter amisit. Qualiter eciam Robertus Tresilian miles, qui 667 tunc de Banco regis iudex capitalis extitit, sub eadem furcarum pena diem vite sue iudicialiter clausit extremum. Qualiter iudices alii, qui originales regis excessus, vt prefertur, sigillis suis contra proceres roborarunt, ad instanciam prelatorum absque mortis iudicio in partes Hibernie exules ab Anglia transierunt.
160		
170		

Quos inconsultos suscepit Hibernia stultos.
 180 Legiferi tales super omnes sunt speciales,
 Regis ad errorem qui plus tribuere fauorem.
 Hic non sorte pari statuit sors fata parari,⁶⁷¹
 Vt reus incepit, sic de mercede recepit:
 Exulat iste status, fuit alter decapitatus,
 Hii, cum ceduntur, ad funera fune trahuntur.
 Dispar erat munus, fuerat tamen exitus vnus;⁶⁷²
 Quicquid homo voluit, tandem mors omnia soluit.
 Vt rex purgetur, vt regnum Qualiter diuersi
 clarificetur, fratres, diuersarum
 Restat adhuc queri, poterit quo culpa curiarum tunc
 mederi. confessores, vna
 Absque deo fratres fuerant hoc tempore cum aliis ministris
 190 patres, quampluribus,
 quasi palee invtiles
 Nec sibi confessa per eos est culpa per loca
 dispersuntur.
 repressa:⁶⁷³
 In viciis arent, viciū qui mundificarent;
 Morum more carent, mores qui multiplicarent.
 Fraudis in exemplum sic errat ab ordine templum,
 Nec cauet ille status solita de sorde reatus:
 Sunt ita transgressi fratres ad sacra professi,
 Quod personarum deus extitit vltor earum.
 Ad regale latus non est status immaculatus,
 Quo plus quam Centum remouentur abinde clientum:
 200 Lugent cantores, perdunt quia cantus honores,
 Plangunt scriptores scriptos de fraude rigores:
 Transit adulator, sceleratus et insidiator,
 Consilii fautor, inuentor et inuidus auctor.
 Stat manus extenta, nec cessat Curia Qualiter proceres
 tenta, predicti de querela
 Donec purgetur dolus omnis et principales, si
 euacuetur. precibus aut donis
 Falsi temptarunt iustos, set non flecti possent,
 superarunt, sepissime
 Nec prece nec dono, Cristo mediante blandiuntur; set illi
 patrono. tanquam vere
 iusticie executores,
 vsque in sue

	Tempore quo stabant hii tres, regnum solidabant, Legem firmabant viciataque iura fugabant:	querele consummacionem vnanimes constanter astiterunt.
210	Sic emendatum Regem faciunt renouatum, Cercius vt credunt, et sic cum laude recedunt. Concinit omne forum benefactaque laudat eorum, Talia dicentes sunt vndique laude canentes. ⁶⁷⁴ In Cristi signo sit semper gloria Cigno, Laus et in hoc mundo sit Equo, quem signat hirundo, Vrsus et ex ore populi fungatur honore. Hii tres Anglorum fuerant exempla bonorum; Regnum supportant alienaque pondera portant: Reddat eis munus tribus est qui trinus et vnus. Amen. ⁶⁷⁵	Hic in fine compositor gesta dictorum trium procerum laudabiliter commendans, pro eis apud altissimum deuocius exorat.

FOOTNOTES:

⁶⁵¹ CRONICA TRIPERTITA. *The MSS. are SCHG, as for the Vox Clamantis, and also the Bodleian MS. Hatton 92 (H₃).*

⁶⁵² PREFACE *margin* capitosus] obstinatus H₃

⁶⁵³ 1 *margin* In hac prima parte CHH₃

⁶⁵⁴ 2 *margin* primo tempora distinguens H primo distinguens tempora H₃

⁶⁵⁵ 14 ipsum qui iure carebat] semper mala quin faciebat H H₃ mala semper quin faciebat C

⁶⁵⁶ 34 diffundat vbique CHH₃

⁶⁵⁷ 55 presens] fallax H (*ras.*)

⁶⁵⁸ 56 Eclipsata dolis sequitur consortia Solis H (*ras.*)

⁶⁵⁹ 69 parte CHH₃ parce SG

⁶⁶⁰ 71 fraudis HH₃

⁶⁶¹ 80 tetis SH thetis CGH₃

⁶⁶² 85 trancit C

⁶⁶³ 93 dum] cum CH

⁶⁶⁴ 109 *margin* ad sui salutem CHH₃

⁶⁶⁵ 133 legis H collater ales C

⁶⁶⁶ 141 *margin* Burlee CHH₃

⁶⁶⁷ 161 *margin* qui om. S

⁶⁶⁸ 170 amicis] iniquis CHH₃

⁶⁶⁹ 173 ausam (?) MSS.

⁶⁷⁰ 175 Possit C

⁶⁷¹ 182 Sic CHH₃

[672](#) 186 munus] nimius C
[673](#) 191 sibi] ibi H
[674](#) 213 laude] verba CHH₃
[675](#) 219 eis] ei H

Explicit prima Pars Cronice et Incipit Secunda.

Hic in Secunda parte Cronice declarat qualiter rex, sub vmbra fecte concordie pacem dissimilans, tres procures predictos dolose circumuenit; ita quod vnum ex istis iugulari, alium decollari fecit,^{[676](#)} tercium vero vna cum domino de Cobham, qui regni verus amicus semper extitit, in exilium mancipari tyrannica potestate, prothdolor! destinavit. Insuper et, quod detestabile fuit, idem crudelissimus rex reuerendum in Cristo patrem Thomam Arundellie,^{[677](#)} tunc Cantuariensem Archiepiscopum, de Sede sua penitus expulit, ipsumque pro perpetuo in exilium delegari crudelissime constituit.

O DOLOR in mente, set prothdolor ore loquente!
Heuque mee penne, scribam quia facta gehenne!
Obice singultu, lacrimis pallenteque vultu,
Vix mea penna sonat hec que michi Cronica donat.^{[678](#)}

In hac secunda parte cronice compositor primo ea que post sequuntur dolorosa infortunia doloroso corde deplangit.

Vt prius audistis, hii tres, quibus Anglia tristis
Plus delectatur, magis hos fortuna minatur:
Rex facie bina fallax, latitante ruina,
Omnia fingeat, que dolos sub fraude tegebat.

Ad regale latus, quasi frater et associatus,
Cignus erat factus, et eos quos vult facit actus:

Qualiter, vt hii tres procures, de quibus audistis, cum rege,

	Taliter est et Equus regis de carmine cecus, Quod non discernit ea que fallacia cernit: Est incantatus eciam quasi magnificatus	quem dolosum sciebant, pacem securiorem habere possent, cartas concordie ab ipso impetratas optinuerunt.
	Vrsus, et ignorat finem, qua sorte laborat. Set magis vt tuti maneant de lege statuti, 679 Hii regis querunt cartas, quas optinuerunt: Sic se conformant, sic se cum rege reformant, Quod viuunt more quasi grex pastoris amore. Hoc credunt plane, set transit tempus inane;	
20	Cum se stare putant, subito sua tempora mutant. Ecce scelus magnum, latitans quasi vulpis in agnum, Sic dolus expectat, quos ira tyrannica spectat. 680 O fraus, o que dolus, quos rex s u b y m a g i n e solus, Dum scelus exhaustit, tam longo tempore clausit!	Qualiter rex, vt ipse sub dissimilate pacis concordia proceres decipiat, vulpe fallacior continua circumuencione dolos machinatur.
	Set magis ad plenum tunc fuderat ille venenum, Quo prius inflatus quamsepe dolet sceleratus: Turbinis vt ventus, sic irruit acra iuuentus In Cignum spretum, dum se putat esse quietum. O quam fortuna stabilis non permanet vna!	
30	Exemplum cuius stat in ordine carminis huius. Rex agit et Cignus patitur de corde benignus, Illeque prostratus non est de rege leuatus: Ad Plescy captus tunc est velut hostia raptus, Rex iubet arma geri, nec eo voluit misereri. Cum sponsa nati lugent quasi morte grauati,	Qualiter rex sui pectoris odium, quod adiu latuit, ad expressam vindictam primo contra ducem Glouernie, qui Cignus dicitur, in oculis omnium fulmine plus subito produxit. Nam et ipse rex in propria persona dictum ducem apud Plescy improuisum manu forti cepit, et eum

	Plusque lupo seuit rex, dummodo femina fleuit: Nil pietas munit, quem tunc manus inuida punit; Rex stetit obliquus, nec erat tunc vnus amicus. ⁶⁸¹	sic captum Calisias indilate produci, et ibi sub arta custodia striccius incarcerari constituit.
40	O regale genus! princeps quasi pauper egenus Turpiter attractus iacet et sine iure subactus. Sunt ibi fautores regis de sorte priores, Qui Cignum prendunt, vbi captum ducere tendunt: Sic ducendo Ducem perdit sine lumine lucem Anglia, que tota tenebrescit luce remota: Trans mare natauit, regnum qui semper amauit, Flent Centum Mille, quia Cignus preterit ille. Calisie portus petit, vnde dolus latet ortus, Error quem regis genuit putredine legis: Carcere conclusus subito fuit ille reclusus; 50 Nescit quo fine, sit vite siue ruine. Tunc rex elatum sumpsit quasi falco volatum, Vnde suas gentes perdit custode carentes.	
	Amoto Cigno, rex feruens corde maligno Prendere querit Equm, super hocque reuoluere secum Caucius in mente conspirat fraude latente. Periurans Cristum Comitem sic decipit istum: Ipse libro tacto iurat, firmanteque pacto Promisit certe que fidem donauit aperte, Dicens quod tutus nulla de fraude volutus Liber transiret, ad eum si quando 60 veniret. Hoc iuramentum frater Comitis manutentum	Qualiter rex, qui per mille meandros procerum corda exagitans inquietauit, Ricardum Comitem Arundellie ⁶⁸² qui dicitur Equis, fraudulenter decepit. Erat enim tunc frater dicti Comitis Thomas, Cantuariensis archiepiscopus, cui rex sub iuramento fidem prestitit, quod, si dictus Comes ad sui regis presenciam obediens sponte veniret, liber extunc absque

	Primas feruore regis suscepit ab ore: Presul letus erat, sub tali federe sperat, Et sic cautelis captus fuit ille fidelis. Vrsus vt audiuit, non ergo remotus abiuit; Signans se Cristo mentem stabiliuit in isto: Non facit excursus paciens que piissimus Vrsus, Set magis attendit mala que fortuna rependit: Londoniis mansit, nec ab vrbis cardine transit, 70 Quo captiuatus fuit hic sine labe reatus. Sic tres persone vi set non iure corone Carceribus stricti remanent velut vmbra relicti. Celsius in scanno tunc creuit pompa tiranno, Nulli parcebat, sibi dum fortuna fauebat:683 Stat scelus extentum statuit quo parliamentum, Vt sit finalis sic vlcio iudicialis. Tunc appellantes fuerant octo dominantes, Qui tres appellant, vt eos a luce repellant. O, quis pensare posset quin fleret amare, Dum scelus explorat, per quod magis Anglia plorat? 80 Ecce dies mortis aderant, qua pompa cohortis Regem pomposum statuit magis esse dolosum. Pro regis parte subtili fingitur arte, Cignum tam purum sine response moriturum: Cum magis expresse rex nouit eum superesse,	calumpnia, vbicumque transire vellet, cum firma regis amicitia fiducialiter permaneret: et sic ueniens probus Comes ab improbo rege decipitur. Qualiter Thomas, alio nomine Vrsus, tunc Comes de Warwyk, a regis satellitibus Londoniis captus et in carcerem missus innunis culpe paciens succubuit. Super quo suum parliamentum apud Westmonasterium in proximo pronunciandum rex tirannus decreuit. Qualiter pronunciato parlamento octo tunc appellantes contra dictos tres procures ad eorum perditionem promptissimi interfuerunt, et quia rex propter metum populi ducem Glouernie coram eo personaliter in parlamento comparere noluit, subtili mendacio finxit eum in lecto
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90

Finxit eum lecto transisse sub ordine
recto.

Sic non inuento Cigno, nil parlamento
Pro se respondit, quem rex sub claue
recondit:

Cum non apparet, vt se de lege iuuaret,
Hunc condempnarunt subito, quem
post spoliarent.

O scelus inferni, poterunt quo flere moderni,
De iugulo Cigni quod constituere maligni!

Occulte querunt quod aperte non
potuerunt,

Dumque timent gentes, clam sunt s u a
f a c t a gerentes.

Assunt tortores de nocteque feruidiores
Cignum prostratum iugulant quasi
mart i r i z a t u m:

Calisiis actum sceleris fuit hoc
malefactum,

Regis precepto, iugulo qui gaudet
adepto.

Sic nece deuictum, sic corpus ab hoste
relictum,

100

Clam de conclauis suscepit Anglia
naui;

Per mare regreditur corpus, nec adhuc
sepelitur,

Namque sepulturam defendit Rex sibi
puram:

Desuper a latere patris loca iusta tenere
Dummodo quesivit, vix bassa sepulcra
subiuit.

O que nephas tale, quod nec ius imperiale,
Set neque lex Cristi proceri sic contulit isti!

Eius enim vita periit sine iure sopita,

Et mors eius ita negat esse sepulcra petita.

Heu! quia iam viuit, vnquam qui talia sciuit,

mortuum fuisse,
qui adhuc superstes
in carcere Calisie
sub claue
tenebatur; et sic
ducem absentem
absque responsione
rex pestifer
falsissime
condempnauit.

Qualiter rex, cum
ipse se ducem
prenotatum
cautelose, sicut
audistis,
condempnari
spirauerat, postea
infra tempus
quosdam tortores
sibi quasi ab
inferno
confederatos
Calisias, vbi dux
adhuc viuus
incarceratus est,
transmisit, qui illuc
aduenientes, ad
regis preceptum de
iugulo pre manibus
excogitato, ducem
improvisum
clanculo de nocte
sub pondere lecti
plumalis mortaliter
depressum absque
pietate subito
suffocarunt.

110	Sic regis natum per regem mortificatum? Heu! quia regalis stirps Anglica tam specialis Regis precepto periit sine crimine cepto. Heu! quia tortorum quidam de sorte malorum Sic ducis electi plumarum pondere lecti Corpus quassatum iugulant que necant iugulatum; Quod nimis ingratum dolet Anglia tota relatum. Det deus hoc fatum, sit adhuc quod corpus humatum, Spiritus atque statum teneat sine fine beatum!⁶⁸⁴	
120	Est recitandus Equis, Cignus quia preterit equus: Non hos morte pari voluit sors equiparari. Rex sedet, et cuncti fautores tunc sibi iuncti Sunt ibi presentes ad Equum mala plura loquentes; Isteque solus erat, que deum solummodo sperat, Quo pius et fortis permansit ad vltima mortis. Rex prius accusat, et Equus scelus omne recusat, Pretendens regisque sigilla sub ordine legis Cartam monstravit, qua tucior esse putavit: Non fuit absque nota, prius est concordia nota. Set rex cautelis Comitum responsa fidelis Caucius extinxit, que dolos sub fraude refinxit.	Qualiter Comes Arundellie ab impio rege in parlamento accusatus, ad ea que sibi obiciuntur intrepidus respondit; et primo singula que per ipsum fiebant, secundum sue intencionis propositum ad regis honorem facta fuisse claro sermone iustificavit; secundo enim regis cartas super hoc pacem et concordiam specialiter testificantes in auribus omnium manifestius pronunciauit: set ille, coram quo nullum ius procedit, rex impius Comitum responsa non acceptans, ex propria malicia ipsum mortali sententia dampnatum, in impetu furoris apud montem
130	Tunc conspirati cum rege que magnificati⁶⁸⁵ Regis predicta firmarunt omnia dicta.	

	Heu! nimis ingrata tunc est sententia lata, Horrida, mortalis, quia pena fuit capitalis. Per loca, per vicos ductus respexit amicos, Qui magis occulta dederant suspiria multa: Vndique tunc flebant qui talia fata videbant, Cum prece deuota facientes plurima vota. Sunt et fallaces alii, pro rege sequaces	Turris Londoniarum decollari fecit, vbi fratres Augustinenses corpus cum capite secum ad eorum ecclesiam cum psalmis deferentes in loco congruo deuote sepelierunt.
140	Qui veniunt equites, neque iusti set neque mites; Hii penam talem proclamant tunc capitalem, Ad loca signataque iubent procedere fata. Tunc Comes ad Cristum sermonem dixerat istum: 'Omnia tu nosti: moriar, quia sic placet hosti; Hostibus exactus perio, sine iure subactus; Inmunis pergo, miserere michi, precor, ergo.' Expansis palmis que sonantibus vndique psalmis, Sic patitur tandem, penamque subintrat eandem: Quin caput amittit sibi gracia nulla remittit,	
150	Milia quo Centum maledicunt parliamentum. Corpus ad ima cadit, dum saluus ad ethera vadit Spiritus in celis, vbi viuit amore fidelis: Augustinenses fratres tunc Londonienses Hunc magis extollunt, que caput cum corpore tollunt; Vix tamen audebant hoc ponere quo cupiebant, Set magis occultum condunt pro rege sepultum. Det deus hoc sciri, poterit quod adhuc sepeliri, Eius et heredes proprias habeant sibi sedes. Iam refrenato violenter Equo que grauato,	
160	Vrsum querebant, quem tunc agitare volebant; Pestiferique canes aderant tunc regis inanes,	Qualiter Comes de Warwyk, ⁶⁸⁶ ex regis collusione circumventus, in parlamento se culpabilem recognouit, sperans

Vndique latrando pacem nec habent
aliquando.

Ad latus omne terunt, set ad hoc quod
plus potuerunt

Non magis attendit, quin rex sua recia
tendit.

O! quam subtilis oritur tunc fraus
iuuenilis,

Per quam tunc fraudem nequit Vrsus
carpere laudem.

Hoc rex testatur, Vrsus quod si
fateatur⁶⁸⁷

Quod reus existat, nec ad illa relata
resistat,

Rex sibi prestabit veniam, qua curia
stabit,

Et sic transibit sine morteque liber
abibit;

170

Sique recognoscat aliter, sibi iuraque poscat,
Incidet in mortem: trahat hanc quam vult sibi sortem.

Qui cum rege pares fuerant tunc consiliares,
Vrsum temptarunt, eius quoque velle probarunt:

Hic vitam portat, alius mortemque reportat;

Hic consolatur, alius quandoque minatur;

Quisque dolos fingit, quibus Vrsi pectora stringit,

Quo minus agnoscit quid regi dicere possit.

Sicque fatigatus tandem de labe reatus

180 Se fore conuictum reddit: fuit hoc male dictum:

Tali sermone concrescunt iura corone,

Rex tres deuicit, vnus quia talia dicit.

Ad regis vota fuit Vrsi dicio tota,

Omneque respondet verbum, quod rex sibi spondet:

Set cum sic vere regi putat ipse placere,

Regis et ad nutum sperabat se fore tutum,

Tunc magis amisit que rex sibi federa misit;

Nam quod promisit rex pactum denique risit,

Et sic delusus fuit Vrsus ab ore reclusus,

per hoc
certissimam regis
veniam, vt sibi
promittebatur,
infallibiliter
promeruisse. Set
rex omni fallacie
intendens, qui per
talem
recognitionem
alios de querela
convicisse putauit,
dicto Comiti mala
pro bonis
retribuens, ipsum
pro mercede
exheredatum in
partes longinquas,
vt ibi in carcere
seruaretur, exulem
pro perpetuo
mancipauit.

- 190 Vnde pium verbum gustu magis extat acerbum.
Heu, quam res tristes! heu, quam fuit error in istis,
Quando suum pactum rex non produxit in actum!
Fingit et ignorat que rex tunc fraude colorat,
De quibus extantum finis docet experimentum.
Vrsus poscebat, quod rex non perficiebat,
Nec pudet hoc gestum, fraudis quod erat manifestum.
Vrsum contemptum, nulla pietate redemptum,
Exilio demptum statuit rex esse peremptum:
Insula tunc hominis longinqua que plena ruinis
200 Carcere concludit Vrsum, quem pena retrudit.
Quod sic ledebat, regi non sufficebat,
Set capit ex toto terras herede remoto,
Nec sibi dimissam solam fouet hic Comitissam,
Set magis amouit, inopem quam Curia nouit.
Sic rex deleuit, quem tota prouincia fleuit;
Ne plures ledat, moriens prius ipse recedat.
Restat adhuc dira mons Ethna latente sub ira
Regis, dum quae facies magis obtinet inde voraces. [688](#)
Quem rex iratus, quamuis sine labe
reatus, [689](#)
- 210 Tangit in ardore, subito perit ille dolore.
Cum plus morosus sit homo, magis est viciosus,
Regi qui seuit pestis quo pessima creuit.
Vnus erat dignus, paciens, pius atque benignus,
Prouidus et iustus, morum virtute
robustus,
Non erat obliquus, regni set verus
amicus:
Hunc rex odiuit, in quo bona talia
sciuit;
Vt dicunt Mille, dominus Cobham fuit
ille,
Cronica quos lesit, quibus ille fidelis
adhesit. [690](#)
Cristo set vere voluit quia fine placere
- Qualiter rex,
omnes quoscunque
ledere posset
querens, tandem
innocentem
dominum de
Cobham, qui per
prius seculo
renuncians in
domo Cartusiensi
tunc moram traxit,
eciam in iudicium
parliamenti
produxit. Set ille,
nullo minarum
terrore aut

220 Transtulit ad sedem se Cartusiensis ad edem: Sic cepit Cristus, voluit quem tollere fiscus;⁶⁹¹ Quem Cristus duxit, fiscus sine iure reduxit. Rex scelus accusat, Cobham scelus omne recusat, Iustificans factum; sic res processit in actum: Que sapit hec loquitur, nec in hoc vecors reperitur, Immo quod est certum regi manifestat apertum. Sic, quia veridicus tribus est constanter amicus, Rex condempnauit Cobham, set non maculauit: Sic non conuictus gladii non senciit ictus,⁶⁹² 230 Exilii lora subiit tamen exteriora. Hinc rogo quod purus redeat cum laude futurus, Vt sic felici reditu letentur amici. Heu! mea penna madet lacrimis, dum scribere suadet Infortunata sceleris quibus horreo fata. Non satis est regem mundi deflectere legem, Vt pereant gentes sub eo sine lege manentes,⁶⁹³ Set magis in Cristum seuit, quapropter ad istum Casum deflendum non est michi credo tacendum. Anglorum Primas, suppremo culmine primas Qui tenuit sedes, melius dum sperat in edes, 240 Hunc rex compellit et eum de Sede repellit,	blandimentorum exhortacione locum tiranno prebens, in omnibus suis responsionibus fidelissimus inveniebatur: vnde rex quasi confusus, eius constanciam abhorrens, ipsum pre verecundia absque mortis sententia in exilium longius ab Anglia destinavit. Qualiter rex, qui nec deum timet nec hominem veretur, contra reuerendissimum in Cristo patrem Thomam Arundellie, tunc Cantuariensem Archiepiscopum, dum inter eos maior putabatur dileccio, occasiones discordie importabiles ductus auaricia fingere non erubuit. Vnde idem Thomas, de Archiepiscopo in non Archiepiscopum⁶⁹⁴ subito mutatus,
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Dum Simon Rome supplantat federa Thome. Hic Thomas natus Comitis fuit intitulatus, Clericus aptatus, doctor de iure creatus, 695 Legibus ornatus, facundus, morigeratus, Cum Cristo gratus in plebeque magnificatus.	omnia bona sua tam temporalia quam spiritualia dolosa regis circumvencione penitus amisit; expulsusque insuper absque vllo mundi releuamine, solum deum reclamans exul et pauper ab Anglia recessit.
O quam prelatus tam purus et immaculatus Ad regale latus tandem fuit illaqueatus! Tramite subtili latitans plus vulpe senili 250 Rex studet in fine Thomam prostrare ruine. De tribus audistis, cum rex scelus intulit istis, Presul vt adiutor fuit hiis quodammodo tutor, Non contra legem, set ab ira flectere regem Nomine pastoris temptauerat omnibus horis: Semper erat talis, restat dum spes aliqualis, Si contra mortem poterat saluasse cohortem.	Hic declarat aliqua- liter figmenta causarum, per quas pontifex supradictus a parliamento tunc absens contra omnem iusticiam, vt audistis, exilii sentenciam ab improviso quasi nescius incurrebat.
Rex tulit hoc triste, quia Cancellarius iste Tempore quo stabat hos tres constanter amabat; Sic procurator pius extitit et mediator, 260 Cartas quod Regis habuerunt munere legis. Pontificis more summi pro regis amore Sic pacem mittit, mortis gladiumque remittit: Hec ita fecisset, pactum si rex tenuisset, Set que iurauit hodie, cras verba negauit. Cernite pro quali culpa magis in speciali Pontifici tali sine causa materiali Rex fuit iratus, set et altera causa reatus Est plus secreta, tunc Rome quando moneta	

300 Vt pater intrauit, ita solus ab orbe migrauit.
 Sic vice iam versa spergens fuit vnio spersa,
 Heri rectores, hodie magis inferiores,
 Et sic derisi fuerant quodammodo visi.
 Portas clausurunt, vbi claues non habuerunt,
 Nec tamen exclusus fuerat tunc regis abusus:
 Non se conuertit, in peius qui male vertit;
 Dum mala queruntur, in eo peiora sequuntur;
 Tres interfecit proceres, dum pessima fecit,
 Quo nimis elatum sumpsit sua pompa volatum.
 310 Tunc delusores, quos curia turbidiores
 Nouit, ridebant super hiis que gesta videbant;
 Friuola componunt tribus et tria scandala ponunt;
 Tale fuit dictum, nec adhuc stat ab ore relictum:
 ‘Non Olor in pennis, nec Equus stat crine perhennis,
 Iam depennatus Olor est, Equus Canticum, quod
composuere
maligni in derisum
procerum tyrannice
interfactorum.
 excoriatus,
 Vrsus non mordet, quem stricta cathena
 remordet.’
 Sic fatue turbe vox conclamabat in vrbe:
 Omnia que dici poterant dicunt inimici,
 Pluraque fingentes mendacia sunt parientes.
 320 Grene, Scrop, Bussy, cordis sine lumine fuscī,[700](#)
 Omne nephas querunt, quo ledere plus potuerunt:
 Rex fuit instructus per eos, et ad omnia ductus
 Que mala post gessit, quibus Anglia tota pauescit.
 Intra se flebat populus, qui dampna videbat;
 Cum non audebat vocem proferre, tacebat.
 O Dux immense, tu Gallica regna sub Hic circa finem
probitates ducis
Glouernie necnon
Comitis Arundellie
magis in speciali
commemorans,
eorum gesta
laudabiliter
commendat.
Consulit insuper,
quod per ea que
preterita sunt
 ense
 Militis ex more bellasti regis honore.
 O Comes, inque mari pro rege tuo
 superari
 Classem fecisti Francorum, quos
 domuisti.
 Heu, rex, qui tales fraudasti
 330 collaterales,

Sit tibi de fine vindex fortuna ruine!
Principio rerum placido quamsepe
dierum

Finis adest tristis; ideo speculemur in
istis:⁷⁰¹

presentes vtinam
discreto pectore
sibi contra futura
prouidere
nullatenus
omittant.⁷⁰²

Estque fides rara modo, quam mens nescit auara.
Dum fauet os fraudis, ne credas omne quod audis:
Fingere fingenti scola nuper erat sapienti;
Talis vt hesterna fuit, est scola nunc hodierna:
Fallitur incertum, set quando videbis apertum
Finem cum cauda, tunc demum tempora lauda.

340 Anno bis deno primo de sanguine pleno
Septembris mense feritas dominatur in ense:⁷⁰³
Tristis vt audiui, carmen scribendo subiui:
Plangite, vos viui, quia planctus s u n t r e s i d i u i.
Doctoris verba sunt hec que miror acerba;
'Dum melius fecisse putes, latet anguis in herba.'
Quicquid homo fatur, quicquid facit aut meditatur,
Stat fortuna rei semper in ore dei.

FOOTNOTES:

- ⁶⁷⁶ *Heading 4* fecit *om.* CHH₃
⁶⁷⁷ *Heading 8* Arundellie CHH₃ Arundell S
⁶⁷⁸ 4 penna] lingua CHH₃
⁶⁷⁹ 15 de] do C
⁶⁸⁰ 22 dolor H
⁶⁸¹ 38 vnus] vllus H
⁶⁸² 56 *margin* Arundell MSS., and so later, 119, 236, &c.
⁶⁸³ 75 statuunt H
⁶⁸⁴ 118 fine] labe H
⁶⁸⁵ 131 magnificate C
⁶⁸⁶ 160 *margin* Warewyk CH
⁶⁸⁷ 167 fatiatur C
⁶⁸⁸ 208 dumque] qui HH₃ inde] ille HH₃
⁶⁸⁹ 209 f. quamuis sine labe reatus Tangit] tetigit de face reatus Eius HH₃
⁶⁹⁰ 218 lecit C
⁶⁹¹ 221 sepiet C
⁶⁹² 229 ictis C
⁶⁹³ 236 periant CHH₃
⁶⁹⁴ 243 *margin* nonarchiepiscopum CH
⁶⁹⁵ 244 optatus C

[696](#) 278 Tunc] Sic CHH₃
[697](#) 284 *margin* precipue *om.* CH
[698](#) 285 variate C
[699](#) 287 dicuntur C
[700](#) 320 Scrōp SCHG Buscy G
[701](#) 333 idio C
[702](#) 334 *margin* omittant CH₃ ommittant SHG
[703](#) 341 Semptembris S

Explicit secunda pars Cronice et Incipit Tercia.

Hic in tertia parte Cronice finaliter scribit qualiter rex antedictus, vtroque dei et hominum iure postposito, Strenuissimum Principem Dominum Henricum, tunc Derbeie⁷⁰⁴ Comitem, patre suo Duce Lancastrie adhuc viuento, per decennium capitose in exilium delegauit. Postea vero, patre defuncto filioque in partibus Francie tunc existente, idem rex omnis malicie plenus, quasi per infinitas doli circumuenciones, tam in ipsius absentis personam quam in eius hereditatem, occasiones maliciose fulminari decreuit. Set qui verum a falso discernit summus iudex, tantas malicie abhominaciones impune non ferens, dictum dominum Henricum, tunc post obitum patris sui Ducem Lancastrie, in Angliam sua diuina prouidencia, inuito rege, remeare fecit: ob cuius aduentum vniuersi regni fideles, tam proceres quam communes, deum quasi ex vno ore collaudantes pestiferum Ricardum suis ex demeritis regno renunciantem penitus a gradu suo deposuerunt, gratissimumque Ducem dominum Henricum prenotatum in Solium regie magestatis⁷⁰⁵ regnaturum coronantes cum gaudio sublimarunt, terciodecimo die mensis Octobris, Anno domini Millesimo tricentesimo nonagesimo nono.

TRISTIA post leta, post tristia sepe
quieta,
Si bene pensemus, satis hec manifesta
videmus.
Regnum confractum regis feritate
subactum
Nuper defleui, lacrimas set abinde quieui;
Regnum purgatum probitate ducis renouatum
Amodo ridebo, nec ab eius laude tacebo.

Hic in tertia parte
cronice compositor
in principio finem
premeditans sub
spe glorie future
letatur.

	O res laudanda, o res sine fine notanda, Ad laudem Cristi, qui nos de carcere tristi R. tunc custodis, quasi sit regnantis Herodis,	
10	Gracius eduxit et ad inclita regna reduxit! Nouit enim mundus, Ricardus quando secundus Iustos deleuit proceres, quos Anglia fleuit, Ipse superbire sic spirat et alcius ire, Quod dedignatur proprium regnumque minatur: Amplius ex more solito latitante furore Seuit, et oppressit populum cui parcere nescit. Sicut humum fodit euertens talpa que rodit, Vnde caret requie, sic alter nocte dieque, Vt magis euertat regnum quod demere certat,	Qualiter ad modum talpe, que semper terram effodiens eam continue subuertit, rex Ricardus, vt suum regnum tyrannice disperdat, assiduis ymaginacionibus ad populi destruccionem omnes suas cautelas indesineenter coniectat.
20	Sic scelus apponit et ad hoc sua robora ponit; Vt princeps baratri furians regit acta theatri. Pondera prebebat, populum quibus ipse premebat: Vtpote salsarum furiosa caribdis aquarum Gurgite feruoris bibit, euomit, omnibus horis, Sic sibi collectum facinus sub pectore tectum Rex vomit in gentem, ve, ve! sine lege manentem. Per prius optentum semper sibi parlamentum Per loca conseruat, in quo mala queque reseruat; Est vbi persona regis residente corona, Corpore presenti stat ibi vis parliamenti: Sic, vbicumque sedet presencia regia, ledet, Quod nullus sciuit sceleris que facta subiuit. Hoc factum regis fuit abhominacio legis, Quo fremuit certe populus, set nullus aperte:	
30		Nota qualiter rex subtili fraude concessum sibi optinuit, quod vbicumque sedere vellet cum certis personis sibi assignatis, per prius inceptum continuuare posset parlamentum.

Sic tamen vt staret et tempora continuaret,
 Rex sibi papales bullas habuit speciales;
 Si quis in extento prius aut post parlamento
 Quid contradicit, in eum sententia vicit.
 Ad scelus implendum tunc rex habet omne timendum,
 40 Excepte Cristo, qui non fuit auctor in isto;
 Quicquid enim dicit clerus, populus maledicit,
 Inuocat et Cristi vindictam pectore tristi.
 Inde set oblitus rex pestifer hos sibi ritus,
 Quos prius elegit, maledicto fine peregit;
 Consensu, tactu, visu que ferocior actu
 In regnum seuit, qui post sua crimina fleuit:
 Que non audiuit auris, nec cor mala sciuit,
 Tristia coniectat, populum quo perdere spectat.
 Carte scribuntur et in omni parte leguntur,
 50 Hasque sigillari iubet omnibus et
 venerari:
 Perficit hoc clerus, si debeo dicere
 verus
 Nescio, set gentes sua sunt exempla
 sequentes;
 Nescia plebs legis, dum sperat premia
 regis,
 Vt dicebatur, ad regia iussa paratur.
 Vrbs, ager et villa cartis posuere sigilla,
 Quo magis ad plenum conspergitur omne venenum:
 Fallitur ex illo quisquis, cum firma sigillo
 Culpa recordetur, qua proditor omnis habetur.
 Cum sic quisque status sit in hiis cartis viciatus,
 60 Vt veniam portet sibi soluere quicquid oportet;
 Tunc exactores baratro magis audiores
 Absoluunt gentes, pacem quasi sint redimentes.
 Hec set cautela nichil est nisi ficta medela,
 Nam magis insanus stat morbus cotidianus;
 Rex populum pressit, et ab inde quiescere nescit,
 Semper turbatur, semper sua regna minatur.
 Post primas cartas alias statuit magis artas,

Nota de primis
 cartis, quas scriptas
 ex regis
 compulsione tam
 clerus quam
 populus formidans
 sigillauit: tali enim
 subtilitate rex
 varias regni sui
 patrias spoliando
 destruxit.

	Set de scriptura patuit non vna figura. Has eciam villis iubet affirmare sigillis; ⁷⁰⁶	Nota de secundis cartis que blanche- chartres vulgariter nuncupantur.
70	Qualis finis erit quisquis sub murmure querit; Et sic velata facie plebs illaqueata, Quod facit ignorat, ita dum fortuna laborat. Accidit interea, dum terra fuit pharisea, Est noua lis mota, quam nouerat Anglia tota. Nobilis Henricus, omnis probitatis amicus, Hic tunc florebat super omnes plusque valebat; Vt rosa flos florum, melior fuit ille bonorum,	Qualiter rex Ricardus omnis malicie plenus strenuissimum dominum Henricum, tunc Derbeie Comitem Ducisque Lancastrie filium et heredem, sola ex inuidia, vt ipsum perderet, in exilium proiecit.
80	Custos Anglorum, per quem lux fulsit eorum, Exemplar morum que probacior ille proborum: Ad loca bellorum leo conterit arma luporum; Eius cognomen venerabile percipit omen, Quod numquam victum rutilat Lancastria dictum. Hunc patre viuente de sorte superueniente Rex delegauit et eum sine labe fugauit; Rex etenim nouit, ad eum quod patria vouit, Vnde timens sortem dolet eius habere cohortem: Inuidus hanc causam gestat sub pectore clausam, Donec disperdat iustum sine iureque perdat.	
90	Hic tamen ex more solito pro regis honore Semper promptus erat, aliter quo premia sperat; Sic nichil offendit, quo rex sibi dampna rependit, Set quia cunctorum rex oderat acta proborum. Singula non scripsi, que dux bona contulit ipsi; Si meritum detur, tunc dux mala nulla meretur: Exilium tortum gremio de regis abortum ⁷⁰⁷ Hoc pro finali mercede datur speciali. Purus ad omne latus sic exulat immaculatus,	

	Et quem decepit rex Anglus Francia cepit:	Qualiter nobilis Henricus antedictus in partes Francie, vt ibi tempore exilii moraretur, animo constanti viriliter se transtulit.
	Stans ibi preclarus regno fuit vndique carus,	
100	Quo sibi concreuit requies, set non requieuit.	
	Dum genus exquirat in quo sibi iura requirit,	
	Quem deus absoluit patri mors omnia soluit;	
	Sic, patre defuncto, de consilio sibi iuncto	
	Est tunc querendum, melius sibi quid sit agendum:	
	Et sic consultus velut heres Miles adultus,	
	Que sua cognoscit post patrem propria poscit.	
	Hos per rumores adeunt ambassiatores	
	Regem querentes, legem super hocque petentes;	
	Set qui cuncta vorat non audit quod pius orat, 708	
110	Exheredatum set eum iubet esse fugatum.	
	Et sic nec regem iustum iustam neque legem	
	Dux probus inuenit, dum vox sibi nuncia venit.	
	Tunc confiscatus rapitur sine iure ducatus,	
	Quo se confortat dux commoda nulla reportat;	
	Pulli coruorum, pascit quos mater eorum,	
	Non ita proclamant, quin plus sibi castra reclamant	
	Regis fautores, terras que ducatus honores:	
	Rex bona dispergit, qui non sine crimine pergit,	
	Distribuens sortes, ditescat vt inde cohortes.	
120	Quod sic decreuit rex fama perambula creuit,	
	Per mundum totum scelus hoc erit amodo notum.	
	O quam plura sinit deus, et cum tempora finit,	Nota qualiter post obitum patris sui ducis Lancastrie nobilissimus filius suus Comes antedictus, tunc de iure dux, vt ipse hereditatem suam vendicaret, de partibus Francie prouiso sapienter itinere Calisias
	Omnia tunc certe que sunt demonstrat aperte!	
	Dux inspiratus tandem, quasi sit renouatus,	
	Singula compensat perfecto cordeque pensat:	

	Tortorem regem tortam creuisseque legem	adiit, vbi cum domino Thoma Cantuariensi
	Cernit, et errores in vtroque statu grauiores:	Archiepiscopo, necnon Thoma filio et herede
	Signans se Cristo quesiu it opem super isto,	Ricardi Comit is Arundellie, vt
	Qui, bene dum sperat, iubet vt sua propria querat.	prefertur, defuncti, vt in Angliam transfretaret, Cristo
130	Ex subito more, saluo sibi semper honore,	se commendans nauem ascendit.
	Partes subtiles Francorum dux quasi miles ⁷⁰⁹	
	Cum paucis transit, nec ibi tardando remansit:	
	Calisias iuit, vbi propria regna petiuit;	
	Cum modica classe sic magnanimum remeasse	
	Constat, et in naui dux ducitur inde suaui.	
	Primas Anglorum, tunc exul fraude malorum,	
	Thomas deuote stat ibi, comitante nepote:	
	Hos dux regalis, veluti gallina sub alis,	
	Secum votiua saluos duxit comitiua.	
140	Dux, Comes, Antistes, pariter solamina tristes	
	Querunt sperantes, vbi venti sunt agitantes:	Qualiter nobilis Henricus, tunc Dux Lancastrie, per
	Vela petunt portum quem sors prope contulit ortum;	mare nauigando portum querens tandem prope
	Vt dux concepit, Aquilonica littora cepit.	Grymmesby, Cristo mediante, littora
	Tunc magis audaci vultu cum plebe sequaci	pacifica sortitus est.
	Exultans dicit, quod in hoc quasi prelia vicit.	
	Ex animo forti dederat bona corda cohorti, ⁷¹⁰	
	Quod bene sperarent, quicquid sibi fata pararent.	
	Sic congaudentes sub spe que nichil metuentes,	
	Quo melius querunt, naues simul applicuerunt:	
150	Dux prius egressus disponit humo sibi gressus,	
	Primitus exorat que deum genuflexus adorat	
	Votis sincere mentis, quod possit habere	
	Victoris palmas, extendit ad ethera palmas;	

	Vtque scelus guerre superet, dedit oscula terre, Pluraque deuota dux fecit ibi pia vota. De prece surrexit, surgendoque se cruce textit, Et tunc quam letas incepit adire dietas:	Qualiter ad seruicium nobilis ducis quasi vniuersa terra gratanter se optulit.
	Patria cum sciret quod saluus dux reueniret, Totus ei mundus occurrit vbique iocundus.	
160	Tunc rex Ricardus lepus est et non leopardus; Quem timor astrinxit, alibi sua robora finxit: Hic ducis aduentum presciuit ab ore scientum, Quo celer exiuit et Hibernica regna petiuit. Sepe silens plangit, quem tunc vecordia tangit, Ex quo singultus plures rex cepit adultus. Sic redit absente dux noster rege timente, Nec quid presumit, sua propria dumque resumit. Dux probus audaci vultu cum plebe sequaci Regnum scrutatur, si proditor inueniatur;	Qualiter rex Ricardus tempore quo nobilis dux Henricus applicuit, in partibus Hibernie inviles dies ad sui confusionem infortunate consumpsit.
170	Sic tres exosos magis omnibus ambiciosos Regni tortores inuenerat ipse priores: Ense reperiussi periunt Scrop, Grene que Bussy; ^{711} Hii quasi regales fuerant cum rege sodales. Scrop Comes et Miles, eius Bristollia viles Actus declarat, quo mors sua fata pararat; Greneque sorte pari statuit dux decapitari, Bussy conuictus similes quoque sustinet ictus: Vnanimis mente pariter mors vna repente Hos tres prostrauit, gladius quos fine vorauit,	Qualiter apud Bristoliam capti et decapitati fuerunt tres precipue regis fautores, qui in mortis articulo dicti regis condiciones multipliciter accusarunt.
180	Sicut et egerunt aliis, sic hii ceciderunt;	

	In Turrim transit R., sub custode remansit;	tempus sub custodia remansit.
	Sic caput Anglorum minimus iacet ipse minorum.	
250	Vt sit opus planum, nichil et de pondere vanum, Apponendo manum dux purgat ad horrea granum; Iustos laudauit, iniustos vituperauit, Hos confirmauit, hos deprimit, hos releuauit. Regni primatem, crudelem per feritatem	Qualiter nobilis dux Henricus procures quoscumque per regem Ricardum in exilium delegatos ad propria mitissime reuocauit.
	Quem rex explantat, dux ex pietate replantat: Humfredum natum patre defuncto spoliatum, Quem rex transduxit, hunc dux probitate reduxit. Nil tibi desperes, Arundell profugus heres, ⁷¹⁶ Prospera namque ducis fatis tua fata reducis.	
260	Warwici Comitem, cuius sine crimine litem Dux pius agnouit, saluum de carcere mouit: Cobham sorte pari dux fecit et hunc reuocari; Exilio demptus iustus redit ille redemptus Nec prece nec dono, Cristo mediante patrono. Tanta tulit gratis primordia dux bonitatis: Vt bona tam grata super hoc sint continuata, Cristus adhuc mentem ducis efficit esse manentem.	
	Londoniis festo Michaelis tunc manifesto, Stent vt ibi tuta, sunt parlamenta statuta: Quilibet attendit que sors sibi fata rependit,	Qualiter assignatum fuit parliamentum tenendum apud Westmonasterium ad festum Sancti Michaelis tunc proximi. Et interim
270	Semper et in gente fit murmur rege regente. Interea transit moriens nec in orbe remansit Humfredus dictus, redit ille de o benedictus: Defuncto nato, cito post de fine beato	Humfredus filius et heres ducis Glouernie vna cum matre sua corporis infirmirate mortui sunt.

Mater transiuit, nati dum funera sciuit:
 Primo decessit Cignus, dolor vnde repressit
 Matrem cum pullo, sibi mors nec parcit in vllo.
 Est apud antiquos dictum, 'Defunctus amicos
 Vix habet,' a tergo caueat sibi quilibet ergo:
 280 Quisque suum pectus tangat viuens homo rectus,
 Nec sic gaudebit, quia singula vana videbit.
 Scribere iam restat, que mundus adhuc manifestat,
 Vt sit opus tale cunctis speculum generale.
 Tunc prius incepta sunt parlamenta recepta,
 De quibus abstractus Ricardi desinit
 actus. Qualiter primo die
 parlamenti rex
 Ricardus
 Ecce dies Martis, nec adest presentia
 partis, personaliter non
 comparuit, set alibi
 existens titulo
 Non sedet in sede, quem culpa repellit
 ab ede; corone sue sub
 forma magis
 Denegat in scanno loca tunc fortuna
 tiranno, auctentica penitus
 renunciauit; super
 quo nobilis
 A visu gentis quem terruit accio
 mentis. Henricus, vniuerso
 populo in eius
 laudem
 R. non comparet, alibi set dummodo
 290 staret, conclamante vt rex
 efficiatur, electus
 Causas assignat, quibus H. sua sceptrum
 resignat:⁷¹⁷ est.
 Substituit aliquos procures tunc iuris amicos,
 Ad quos confessus proprio fuit ore repressus.
 Hiis circumspectis aliisque sub ordine lectis,
 R., qui deliquit, hunc curia tota reliquit;
 Hunc deponebant, plenum quem labe sciebant,
 Nec quis eum purgat, iterum ne forte resurgat:
 Tunc decus Anglorum, set et optimus ille bonorum,
 H. fuit electus regno, magis est quia rectus.
 300 Sola dies tentum tulit istud parlamentum,
 Nec magis expressit pro tunc, set ab inde recessit:
 H. tamen extenti noua tempora parlamenti
 Proxima decreuit, quo regni gloria creuit.
 Quando coronatus foret et de fine leuatus,

Tunc processus erit super hoc quod curia querit;
Interea gentes viuunt sub spe recolentes,
Quod nouus errores rex conteret anteriores.

Sexta dies stabat Octobris, quando Qualiter
parabat parlamentum
Rex nouus optata sua parlamenta continuatur⁷¹⁸
nouata: vsque post
coronacionem.

310 Curia verbalis fuit et non iudicialis,
Ad tempus restat nichil et de pondere prestat:
Dicitur expletum quod nil valet esse quietum,
Donec persona regis sit operta corona;
Sicque coronari, quem Cristus vult venerari,
Corditer exultat plebs omnis et inde resultat.

Qui res disponit et eisdem tempora Qualiter in die
ponit, solempti nobilis
Ille diem fixit, Henricum quo Henricus in Solium
benedixit: regie maiestatis⁷¹⁹
Predestinauit deus illum quem titulauit, sublimatus cum
Vt rex regnaret sua regnaque omni gaudio
iustificaret. coronatur.

320 Quem deus elegit, regali laude peregit,
Vnde coronatur in honoreque
magnificatur:

Tempore felici poterunt sollempnia Nota, qualiter iura
dici, corone serenissimo
Que tam sacratis horis patuere iam regi nostro
beatis;⁷²⁰ Henrico quarto
tribus modis
accrescunt:
Primo
Successione:
Secundo eleccione:
Tercio conquestu
sine sanguinis
effusione.

Plebs canit in mente que resultat in ore loquente,
Quisque colit Christum, quia regem suscitatur istum;
Vix homo pensare poterit seu dinumerare,
Que tunc fulserunt sollempnia quanta fuerunt:

330 Omnis terra deum laudat que canit iubileum,
Henricum iustum que pium que ferum que robustum.
Vnde coronatur trino de iure probatur,

Regnum conquestat, que per hoc sibi ius manifestat;
Regno succedit heres, nec ab inde recedit;
Insuper eligitur a plebe que sic stabilitur:
Vt sit compactum, iuris nil defuit actum;
Singula respondent Henrici iuraque spondent.

Fama volans creuit, que climata	Qualiter
cuncta repleuit,	parliamentum
Quo laus vexilli super omnes prefuit	adhuc fuit
illi:	continuum.

340 Sic regnat magnus reprobis leo, mitibus agnus, [721](#)
Hostes antiquos qui terret et augit amicos.
Luna diem donat, qua Regem terra coronat,
Marsque sequens terre dat parlamenta referre:
Rex sedet et cuncti proceres resident sibi iuncti,
Stant et presentes communes plus sapientes;
Tempus erat tale communeque iudiciale.
Quod bene prouisum nichil est a iure res c i sum, [722](#)
Est quia protectus, letatur sic homo rectus,
Et metuunt reliqui sua dampna dolenter iniqui.

350	Set quia plus dignum prius est	Qualiter Henricus,
	recitare benignum,	Regis tunc Henrici
	Que sunt maiora scribens recitabo	primogenitus,
	priora:	statum que nomen
	Henrici natus Henricus, honore beatus,	Principis de
	Est confirmatus heres Princepsque	consensu omnium
	vocatus:	glorioso adeptus
		est.

Sic pars abscisa, summo de iudice visa,
Arboris est vncta veteri stipitique reiuncta.
Istud fatatum fuit a sanctisque relatum,
Quod tunc compleuit deus, ex quo terra quieuit:
Hoc facto leta stupet Anglia laude repleta,
Cordeque letatur, quia stirps de stirpe leuatur.

360	Tunc de consensu Regis procerum quoque sensu,	Qualiter ea que
	Plebe reclamante, stant parlamenta per	nuper in
	ante;	parlamento
	Sic procedebant super hiis que gesta	tempore Ricardi
	videbant	per ducem

	Ad commune bonum, recolentes gesta baronum.	Glouernie et socios suos gesta fuerunt, presens
	Que prius Vrsus, Equus et Olor, qui dicitur equus, Nuper fecerunt, firmissima constituerunt;	parliamentum confirmavit; et ea que Ricardus in vltimo suo parliamento constituit, presens eciam parliamentum penitus cassauit.
	Et que pomposa peruersaque fraude dolosa Ricardus fecit, hec curia tota reiecit. Et tunc tractatum fuit illud opus sceleratum, Quo dudum Cignus periit sine i u r e benignus; ⁷²³	
370	Iusticie vere vindictam clamat habere Omnis ob hoc funus populus, quasi vir foret vnus: Sic communis amor popularis et vndique clamor Exstitit acceptus a Rege que lege receptus. Infortunatus Ricardus, plus sceleratus, Omnibus ingratus, fuit vndique tunc maculatus;	
	Sic quasi dampnatus abiit pre labe reatus, Quo stetit elatus sub carcere magnificatus.	Qualiter Ricardo suis ex demeritis iudicialiter condempnato, ceteri qui cum eo accusati erant, tantummodo ex mera regis pietate quieti permanserunt.
	Eius fautores, qui sunt de sorte priores, Tunc accusati sunt ad responsa vocati:	
380	Hi responsales submittunt se speciales Iudicio Regis, per quem silet vlcio legis. Regia nam pietas sic temperat vndique metas, Quod nil mortale datur illis iudiciale; Est tamen ablatum, quod eis fuit ante beatum, Vocibus Anglorum venerabile nomen eorum; Corpora stant tuta, cecidit set fama minuta, Dux redit in Comitem, quatit et sic curia litem, Labitur exosus Bagot, quem rex pietosus Erigit, et mite prolongat tempora vite.	
390	Sic pius Henricus, inimico non inimicus, Gracius, vt debet, pro dampno commoda prebet; Ipse pium frenum laxat, quia tempus amenum	

Appetit, et Cristo placuisse putauit in isto.
Non tamen in gente placet hoc, set in ore loquente
Publica vox dicit, leges quod mammona vicit;
Iusticiam queri plebs vult, rex vult misereri,
Et sic fortuna pro tempore non fuit vna:
Rex excusatur, nam dicunt quod variatur
Consilio tali, quo res latet in speciali.

400	Quatuor auctores sceleris, Iuda nequiores, Ore dabant laudes, tacito sub cordeque fraudes; Holand, Kent, Sarum, Spenser, quasi fellis amarum, Federa strinxerunt, quibus H. seducere querunt. Viueret quos fecit pius H., nec eis male fecit, 724 Hii mala coniectant in eum, quem perdere spectant; H. etenim pacem dedit illis, hiique minacem	Qualiter, finito parlamento, infra breue post quidam impii instigante diabolo, vt ipsi pium Regem Henricum cum sua progenie a terra delerent, proditorie conspirantes insurrexerunt, quos ira dei preueniens in villa de Circestria per manus vulgi interfectos miraculose destruxit.
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Eius spirantes mortem sunt arma parantes:
Sic nimis ingrati mala retribuunt bonitati,
In caput illorum tamen est vindicta malorum.
410 Nam, qui cunctorum cognoscit corda virorum,
Detegit occulta, quibus accidit vlcio multa:
Cum magis instabant subitoque nocere putabant,
Ex improviso periunt discrimine viso.
Per loca diuersa fuit horum concio dispersa,
Quos deus extinxit, nec in hoc miracula finxit;
De populo patrie, nato comitante Marie,
Quatuor elati perierunt decapitati.
Ecce dei munus! populus quasi vir foret vnus,
Surgit ad omne latus, sit vt H. ita fortificatus.

420	Quod satis est carum, conciues Londoniarum Nobilis Henrici steterant constanter amici:	Qualiter regis nati in custodia tunc Maioris
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	Rex iubet et prompti fuerant armis cito compti, Eius et in sortem magnam tribuere cohortem.	Londoniarum pro securitate secundum tempus fidissime seruabantur.
	Vrbs fuit adiutrix, que Regis tunc quasi nutrix Natos seruauit, et eos quasi mater amauit; Regis enim camera fuit vrbs hoc tempore vera, In qua confisus multum fuit ille gausus: Sic pius in Cristo pietatem sentit in isto, ⁷²⁵ Quo preseruatur et regnum clarificatur.	
430	Anglicus a sompnis quasi surgens vir canit omnis, R. cadit, H. regnat, quo regnum gaudia pregnat. ⁷²⁶ Tempore quo facta sunt hec Ricardus ad acta Non foris exiuit, qui quando pericula sciuit, Quod sors falsorum destructa fuit sociorum, Fortunam spreuit et eorum funera fleuit. Tunc bene videbat, quod ei fraus nulla valebat, Quo contristatus doluit quasi morte grauatus:	Qualiter Ricardus, cum ipse noua de morte illorum qui apud Circestriam, vt predictum est, interierunt audisset, seipsum ⁷²⁷ omni cibo renunciantem pre doloris angustia morientem extinxit.
	Ecce dolor talis suus est, quod spes aliqualis ⁷²⁸ Amodo viuentem nequii conuertere flentem.	
440	Qui tamen astabant custodes sepe iuuabant, Ne desperaret, dum tristia continuaret; Set neque verborum solamina cepit eorum, Dum lacrimas spersit, sibimet nec amore pepercit: Sic se consumit, quod vix si prandia sumit, Aut si sponte bibit vinum, quo viuere quibit; Semper enim plorat, semper de sorte laborat, Qua cadit, et tales memorat periisse sodales: Solam deposcit mortem, ne viuere possit Amplius, est et ita moriens sua pompa sopita.	
450	Anglia gaudebat, quia quem plebs plus metuebat Cristus deleuit, quo libera terra quieuit:	

Set probus Henricus, pietatis semper amicus,
 Ad Cristi cultum corpus dedit esse sepultum
 Sollempni more, quamuis sine laudis honore.
 Langele testatur quod ibi Ricardus humatur;
 Ipse loco tali magis omnibus in speciali
 Corpus donauit, quod mundus habere negauit.
 Sic bona proque malis H. mitis et imperialis
 Reddit ei mite, qui clauserat vltima vite:
 460 Mortuus R. transit, viuens probus H. que remansit,
 Quem deus extollit, et ab R. sua prospera tollit.
 O quam pensando mores variosque notando,
 Si bene scrutetur, R. ab H. distare
 videtur!
 Clarus sermone, tenebrosus et intus
 agone,
 R. pacem fingit, dum mortis federa
 stringit:
 Duplex cautelis fuit R., pius H. que
 fidelis;
 R. pestem mittit, mortem pius H. que remittit;
 R. seruitutem statuit, pius H. que salutem;
 R. plebem taxat, taxas pius H. que relaxat;
 470 R. procures odit et eorum predia rodit,
 H. fouet, heredesque suas restaurat in edes;
 R. regnum vastat vindex et in omnibus astat,
 Mulset terrorem pius H., que reducit amorem.
 O deus, Henrico, quem diligo, quem benedico,
 Da regnum tutum nulla grauitate vultum:
 Vite presentis pariter viteque sequentis
 Da sibi quodcumque felicius est ad vtrumque.

Cronica Ricardi, qui scepra tulit
 leopardi,
 Vt patet, est dicta populo
 set non benedicta:
 Vt speculum mundi, quo
 lux nequit vlla

Nota hic secundum
 commune dictum
 de pietate
 serenissimi regis
 Henrici, necnon de
 impietate qua
 crudelissimus
 Ricardus regnum,
 dum potuit,
 tyrannice vexauit.

Hic in exemplum
 aliorum Ricardi
 demerita
 commemorans

480 refundi,
Sic vacuus transit, sibi
 nil nisi culpa remansit.
Vnde superbus erat, modo si preconia
 querat,
Eius honor sordet, laus culpat, gloria
 mordet.
Hoc concernentes caueant qui sunt
 sapientes,
Nam male viuentes deus odit in orbe
 regentes:
Est qui peccator, non esse potest dominator;
Ricardo teste, finis probat hoc
 manifeste:
Post sua demerita periit sua pompa
 sopita;
Qualis erat vita, cronica stabit ita.

**Explicit Cronica presentibus que futuris vigili corde Regibus⁷³⁵
commemoranda.**

FOOTNOTES:

- [704](#) *Heading* 3 Derbei H
[705](#) *Heading* 18 maiestatis CH₃
[706](#) 69 affirmare C
[707](#) 95 abhortum CH
[708](#) 109 pius] CHGH₃ prius S
[709](#) 131 miles CHH₃ viles S
[710](#) 145 quasi] sua H
[711](#) 172 Scrōp SCH Buscy G
[712](#) 188 sceleres SHGH₃ celeres C (*corr.*)
[713](#) 197 fata C
[714](#) 219 protunc CH₃
[715](#) 239 tunc CGH₃ nunc SH
[716](#) 258 Arunde℥ MSS.
[717](#) 291 quibus SG et ad CHH₃
[718](#) 309 *margin* continuatum fuit CH fuit *continuatum* H₃
[719](#) 318 *margin* magestatis CHH₃
[720](#) 323 sacratus C
[721](#) 340 regnant C
[722](#) 347 recisum CH₃

[723](#) 369 iure SG labe CHH₃
[724](#) 404 malefecit C
[725](#) 428 pius CHH₃ prius SG
[726](#) 431 pregnant C
[727](#) 436 *margin* se ipsum CH
[728](#) 438 suus CHH₃ suis SG
[729](#) 468 *line om.* C
[730](#) 473 Mulcet GH₃
[731](#) 479 ff. *margin Text* SG Hic in fine cronicam Regis Ricardi secundum sua
demerita breuiter determinet CH Hic *determinatur* de demeritis Regis
Ricardi H₃
[732](#) 478-483 As follows in G,

O speculum mundi, quod debet in ante refundi,
Ex quo prouisum sapiens acuat sibi visum,
Cronica Ricardi, qui regna tulit leopardi,
480*
Vt patet, est dicta, populo sed non
benedicta.
Quicquid erat primo, modo cum sors fertur in ymo,
Eius honor sordet, laus culpat, gloria mordet.

[733](#) 479 populo set non benedicta SC violenta grauis maledicta HH₃
[734](#) 488 f.

Sic diffinita stat regia sors stabilita;
Regis vt est vita, cronica stabit ita. G

[735](#) EXPLICIT. 2 Regibus SG iugiter CHH₃

REX CELI DEUS ETC.

**Sequitur carmen vnde magnificus Rex noster
Henricus prenotatus apud deum et homines cum
omni benediccione glorificetur.**

[736](#) REX celi deus et dominus, qui tempora solus
Condidit, et solus condita cuncta regit,
Qui rerum causas ex se produxit, et vnum
In se principium rebus inesse dedit,
Qui dedit vt stabili motu consisteret orbis,
Fixus ineternum mobilitate sua,
Quique potens verbi produxit ad esse creata,
Quique sue mentis lege ligauit ea,
Ipse caput regum, reges quo rectificantur,
10 Te que tuum regnum, Rex pie, queso regat.
Grata superueniens te misit gracia nobis,
O sine labe salus nulla per ante fuit: [737](#)
Sic tuus aduentus noua gaudia sponte reduxit,
Quo prius in luctu lacrima maior erat.
Nos tua milicia pauidos releuauit ab ymo, [738](#)
Quos prius oppressit ponderis omne malum:
Ex probitate tua, quo mors latitabat in vmbra,
Vita resurrexit clara que regna regit:
Sic tua sors sortem mediante deo renouatam
20 Sanat et emendat, que prius egra fuit.
O pie rex, Cristum per te laudamus, et ipsum
Qui tibi nos tribuit terra reuiua colit:
Sancta sit illa dies, qua tu tibi regna petisti,
Sanctus et ille deus, qui tibi regna dedit!
Qui tibi prima tulit, confirmet regna futura,
Quo poteris magno magnus honore frui:
Sit tibi progenies ita multiplicata per eum,

Quod genus inde pium repleat omne solum:
 Quicquid in orbe boni fuerit, tibi summus ab alto
 30 Donet, vt in terris rex in honore regas:
 Omne quod est turpe vacuum discedat, et omne
 Est quod honorificum det deus esse tuum.
 Consilium nullum, pie rex, te tangat iniquum,
 In quibus occultum scit deus esse dolum:
 Absit auaricia, ne tangat regia corda,
 Nec queat in terra proditor esse tua:
 Sic tua processus habeat fortuna perhennes,
 Quo recolant laudes secula cuncta tuas;
 Nuper vt Augusti fuerant preconia Rome,
 40 Concinat in gestis Anglia leta tuis.
 O tibi, rex, euo detur, fortissime, nostro
 Semper honorata sceptrum tenere manu:
 Stes ita magnanimus, quod vbi tua regna gubernas,
 Terreat has partes hostica nulla manus:
 Augeat Imperium tibi Cristus et augeat annos,
 Protegat et nostras aucta corona fores:
 Sit tibi pax finis, domito dominaris in orbe,
 Cunctaque sint humeris inferiora tuis:
 Sic honor et virtus, laus, gloria, pax que potestas
 50 Te que tuum regnum magnificare queant.
 Cordis amore tibi, pie Rex, mea vota paraui, [739](#)
 Est qui seruii nil nisi velle mihi: [740](#)
 Ergo tue laudi que tuo genuflexus honori
 Verba loco doni pauper habenda tuli.
 Est tamen ista mei, pie rex, sententia verbi,
 Fine tui regni sint tibi regna poli!

FOOTNOTES:

[736](#) REX CELI, &c. *The MSS. referred to for this and the two succeeding pieces are SCHGH₃ and (for this piece and the next) the Trentham MS. (T).*

[737](#) 12 Quo T

[738](#) 15 milicia S (*corr.*) milicies CHH₃T

[739](#) 51 tibi] boni T

[740](#) 52 Corpore cum nequii seruo mente tibi T

Prophecia. H. aquile pullus, quo nunquam graciosus ullus,
Hostes confregit, que tyrannica colla⁷⁴¹ subegit.
H. aquile cepit oleum, quo regna recepit,
Sic veteri iuncta stipiti noua stirps redit vncta.

FOOTNOTES:

⁷⁴¹ PROPHECIA. 2 colla CHH₃T bella S

O RECOLENDE ETC.

**Epistola brevis, vnde virtutes regie morales ad
sanum regimen ampliori memoria dirigantur.**⁷⁴²

O r e c o l e n d e, bone, pie rex, Henrice, patrone,
Ad bona dispone quos eripis a Pharaone:
Noxia depone, quibus est humus hec in agone,
Regni persone quo viuant sub racione.⁷⁴³
Pacem compone, vires moderare corone,
Legibus impone frenum sine condicione,
Firmaque sermone iura tenere mone.

10 Rex confirmatus, licet vndique magnificatus,
Sub Cristo gratus viuas tamen immaculatus.
Est tibi prelatus, comes et baro, villa, Senatus,
Miles et armatus sub lege tua moderatus:⁷⁴⁴
Dirige quosque status, maneat quo pacificatus;
Inuidus, elatus nec auarus erit sociatus;
Sic eris ornatus, purus ad omne latus.
Hec, vt amans quibit, Gower, pie Rex, tibi scribit:
Quo pietas ibit, ibi gracia nulla peribit:
Qui bene describit semet, mala nulla
subibit,⁷⁴⁵
Set pius exhibit, que dei pietate
redibit:⁷⁴⁶
Sic qui transibit opus et pietatis
adibit,
Hunc deus ascribit, quod ab hoste
20 perire nequibit;
Et sic finibit qui pia vota bibit.⁷⁴⁷
Quanto regalis honor est tibi plus
generalis⁷⁴⁸
Tanto moralis virtus tibi sit specialis:⁷⁴⁹

Sit tibi carnalis in mundo regula, qualis
Est tibi mentalis in Cristo spiritualis.⁷⁵⁰
Si fueris talis, tua Cronica perpetualis
Tunc erit equalis perfectaque materialis:
Rex immortalis te regat absque malis!

FOOTNOTES:

⁷⁴² O RECOLENDE, &c. *Title* Epistola—dirigantur *om.* GH₃

⁷⁴³ 4 *margin* Nota de iusticia C

⁷⁴⁴ 11 *margin* Nota de regimine C

⁷⁴⁵ 17-21 *Over erasure in SCG, as follows in HH₃,*

Dum pia vota bibit, tua fama sitire nequibit,
Plena set exhibit, cum laudeque plena redibit:
Non sic transibit, vbicumque tyrannus abibit;
Cum nimis ascribit sibi magna, minora subibit;
Vt meritum querit, sors sua fata gerit.

⁷⁴⁶ 18 *margin* Nota de pietate C

⁷⁴⁷ 21 pia] pita S

⁷⁴⁸ 22 Vt tibi regalis, pie rex, honor est generalis HH₃

⁷⁴⁹ 23 Sic rogo HH₃

⁷⁵⁰ 25 *margin* Nota de contemplacione C

CARMEN SUPER MULTIPLICI VICIORUM PESTILENCIA⁷⁵¹

⁷⁵²Nota consequenter⁷⁵³ carmen super multiplici
viciorum pestilencia, vnde tempore Ricardi Secundi
partes nostre specialius inficiebantur.

Non excusatur qui verum non fateatur,
Vt sic ponatur modus, vnde fides reolatur:
Qui magis ornatur sensu, sua verba loquatur,
Ne lex frangatur, qua Cristus sanctificatur.
Hoc res testatur, virtus ita nunc viciatur,
Quod vix firmatur aliquis quin transgrediatur:
Hinc contristatur mea mens, que sepe grauatur,
Dum contemplatur vicium quod continuatur;
Set quia speratur quod vera fides operatur,
10 Quod deus hortatur, michi scribere penna paratur,
Vt describatur cur mundus sic variatur:
Ecce malignatur que modo causa datur.

⁷⁵⁴Putruerunt et corrupte sunt cicatrices a facie
insipiente, set priusquam mors ex morbo finem
repente concludat, sapientie medicinam detectis
plagis cum omni diligencia sapienter investigare
debemus. Vnde ego, non medicus set medicine
procurator, qui tanti periculi grauitatem deplangens
intime contristor, quedam vulnera maiori
corrupcione putrida euidenti distincione, vt inde
medicos pro salute interpellam,⁷⁵⁵ consequenter
declarare propono. Anno⁷⁵⁶ regni Regis Ricardi
Secundi vicesimo.

Contra demonis astuciam in causa Lollardie.

- Quod patet ad limen instanti tempore crimen⁷⁵⁷
Describam primo, quo pallent alta sub ymo.
Nescio quid signat, plebs celica iura resignat,
Dum laicus clausas fidei vult soluere causas,
Que deus incepit et homo seruanda recepit:
Iam magis eneruant populi quam scripta reseruant,
Vnde magis clarum scribere tendo parum.
- 20 Lollia messis habens granum perturbat et ipsum,
Talia qui patitur horrea sepe grauat:
Semina perfidie sacros dispersa per agros
Ecclesie turbant subdola sicque fidem.
Inuentor sceleris sceleratus apostata primus
Angelicas turmas polluit ipse prius;
Postque ruit nostros paradisi sede parentes,
Morteque vitales fecerat esse reos:
Callidus hic serpens nec adhuc desistit in orbe,
Quin magis in Cristi lollia messe serit.
- 30 Ecce nouam sectam, mittit que plebis in aures,
Ad fidei dampnum scandala plura canit:
Sic vetus insurgit heresis quasi Iouiniani,
Vnde moderna fides commaculata dolet:
Vsurpando fidem vultum mentitur honestum,
Caucius vt fraudem palliet inde suam:⁷⁵⁸
Sub grossa lana linum subtile tenetur,
Simplicitas vultus corda dolosa tegit.
Fermento veteri talis corrumpit aceruum,
Qui noua conspergit et dubitanda mouet:
- 40 Dum magis incantat, obtura tu magis aures,
Forcius et cordis ostia claude tui:
Simplicitate tua ne credas omne quod audis;
Que docet ambiguus auctor aborta caue:
Nil nouitatis habens tua mens fantastica cedat;
Vt pater ante tuus credidit, acta cole.
Vera fides Cristi non hesitat, immo fideles
Efficit vt credant cordis amore sui:

Nil valet illa fides vbi res dabit experimentum,
 Spes tamen in Cristo sola requirit eum:
 50 Recta fides quicquid rectum petit, omne meretur,
 Quicquid possibile creditur, ipsa potest.
 Argumenta fides dat rerum que neque sciri,
 Nec possunt verbo nec ratione capi:
 Subde tuam fidei mentem, quia mortis ymago
 Iudicis eterni mistica scire nequit:
 Vt solus facere voluit, sic scire volebat
 Solus, et hoc nulli participauit opus.
 Vna quid ad solem sintilla valet, vel ad equor⁷⁵⁹
 Gutta, vel ad celum quid cinis esse potest?
 60 Leticiam luctus, mors vitam, gaudia fletus
 Non norunt, nec que sunt deitatis homo:
 Non tenebre solem capiunt, non lumina cecus,⁷⁶⁰
 Infima mens hominis nec capit alta dei:⁷⁶¹
 Nempe sacri flatus archanum nobile nunquam
 Scrutari debes, quod penetrare nequis.
 Cum non sit nostrum vel mundi tempora nosse,
 Vnde creaturas nosse laborat homo?
 Nos sentire fidem nostra ratione probatam
 Non foret humanis viribus illud opus;
 70 Humanum non est opus vt transcendat ad astra,
 Quod mortalis homo non ratione capit:
 Ingenium tante transit virtutis in altum,
 Transcurrit superos, in deitate manet.
 Qui sapienter agit, sapiat moderanter in istis,
 Postulet vt rectam possit habere fidem:
 Committat fidei quod non poterit rationi,
 Quod non dat ratio, det tibi firma fides.
 Quod docet ecclesia tu tantum crede, nec vltra
 Quam tibi scire datur quomodocumque stude:
 80 Sufficit vt credas, est ars vbi nulla sciendi,
 Quanta potest dominus scire nec vllus habet.
 Est deus omnipotens, et qui negat omnipotenti
 Credere posse, suum denegat esse deum;
 Sic incarnatum tu debes credere Cristum

Virginis ex vtero, qui deus est et homo.

Vis saluus fieri? p e t e, crede, s t u d e reuereri;⁷⁶²

Absque magis queri lex iubet ista geri.

H a s fantasias aliter q u e dant heresias⁷⁶³

Dampnat Messias, sobrius ergo scias.

90 Tempore Ricardi, super hiis que fata tulerunt,⁷⁶⁴

Scismata lollardi de nouitate serunt:

Obstet principiis tribulos purgareque vadat

Cultor in ecclesiis, ne rosa forte cadat.

Contra mentis Seuiciam in causa Superbie.

Deficit in verbo sensus, quo cuncta superbo

Scribere delicta nequeo, que sunt michi dicta.

Radix peccati fuit ille prius scelerati,

Ex quo dampnati perierunt preuaricati:

Desuper a celis deiecit eum Michaelis

Ensis ad inferni tenebras de luce superni;

100 Nec paradisus ei prebere locum requiei

Spondet, vbi vere sibi gaudia posset habere:

Sic, quia deceptus alibi nequit esse receptus,

Mundum deposcit, vt in illo viuere possit:

Sic adhibendo moram venit ille superbus ad horam,

Quem mea mens tristis in partibus asserit istis.

Hunc vbi ponemus, hostem quem semper habemus?

Nam magis infecta veniens facit omnia tecta.

Laus ibi non lucet, vbi vana superbia ducet

Regna superborum; docet hoc vestitus eorum:

110 Cum valet ornatum sibi vanus habere paratum,

Non quasi mortalis, set vt angelus euolat alis.

Militis ad formam modo pauper habet sibi normam,

Vana sit vt vestis erit inde superbia testis,

Exterius signum cor signat habere malignum,

Cordis et errore fortuna carebit honore.

Nos igitur talem non consociare sodalem

Expedit, vt tuti reddamur in orbe saluti.

Quod deus odiuit reprobos Daudid hoc bene sciuit,
 Ipseque psalmista scripsit de talibus ista:
 120 'Elatas mentes posuit de sede potentes,
 Et sublimauit humiles, quos semper amauit.'
 Vanus non durat, quem vana superbia curat,
 Hec set eum ducit vbi gracia nulla reducit;
 Culpa quidem fontis latices dabit hec Acherontis,
 Vnde bibunt vani mortem quasi cotidiani.
 Omne quod est natum stat ab hoc vicio viciatum,⁷⁶⁵
 Quo magis inmundum vir vanus habet sibi mundum;
 Set qui mentali de pondere iudiciali
 Istud libraret, puto quod meliora pararet.
 130 Hoc nam mortale viciu stat sic generale,
 Quod mundum fregit, vbi singula regna subegit;
 Hec etenim cedes nostras, vt dicitur, edes
 Vertit, et insana dat tempora cotidiana.
 O deus eterne, culpe miserere moderne,
 Facque pias mentes sub lege tua penitentes!
 Corpus, opes, vires sapiens non sic stabilires,
 Dumque superbires, subita quin sorte perires:
 Sunt que maiores humilis paciencia mores⁷⁶⁶
 Nutrit, et errores vicii facit esse minores:
 140 Ergo tuam vera mentem moderare statera;
 Sit laus vel labes, pectore pondus habes.

Contra carnis lasciuia in causa Concupiscencie.

O sexus fragilis, ex quo natura virilis
 Carnea procedit, anime que robora ledit!⁷⁶⁷
 O natura viri carnalis, que stabiliri
 Non valet, vt pura carnalia sint sibi iura!
 Federa sponsorum que sunt sacrata virorum,
 Heu, caro dissoluit, nec ibi sua debita soluit:
 Tempore presenti de carne quasi furienti
 Turpia sunt plura, que signant dampna futura:
 150 Hec desponsatis sunt metuenda satis.

Philosophus quidam carnis de labe remorsus
Plebis in exemplum talia verba refert:
‘Vnam de variis penam sortitur adulter,
Eius ut amplexus omnis in orbe luat;⁷⁶⁸
Aut membrum perdet, aut carceris antra subibit,
Aut cadet insanus non reputandus homo,
Aut sibi pauperies infortunata resistet,
Aut moriens subito transit ab orbe reus.’
Et sic luxuries fatuis sua dona refundit,⁷⁶⁹
160 Vertit et econtra quicquid ab ante tulit.
Quod prius est dulce, demonstrat finis amarum,
Quo caro non tantum, spiritus immo cadit:
Sic oculus cordis carnis caligine cecus
Errat, et in dampnum decidit ipse suum:
Sic iubar humani sensus fuscatur in vmbra
Carnis, et in carnem mens rationis abit.
Dum carnalis amor animum tenet illaqueatum,
Sensati ratio fit rationis egens;
Stans hominis ratio calcata per omnia carni
170 Seruit, et ancille vix tenet ipsa locum.
Non locus est in quo maneant consueta libido
Et ratio pariter, quin magis vna vacat:
Bella libido mouet, fauet et vecordia carnis,
Et sua dat fedo colla premenda iugo;
Libera set ratio mentem de morte remordet
Carnis in obsequio, statque pudica deo.
Nil commune gerunt luxus sibi cum ratione;
Ista deum retinet, illa cadauer habet:
Sic patet ut nichil est quicquid peritura voluptas
180 Appetit in carne, que velut vmbra fugit.
Pluribus exemplis tibi luxus erit fugiendus;
Biblea que docuit, respice facta Dauid:
Consilio Balaam luxus decepit Hebreos,
Quos caro commaculat, carnea culpa premit.
Discat homo iuuenis, celeri pede labitur etas,
Nuncia dum mortis curua senecta venit:
Ecce senilis yemps tremulo venit horrida passu,

Et rapit a iuvene quod reparare nequit:
 Vir sapiens igitur sua tempora mente reuoluat,
 190 Erigat et currum, quam prius inde cadat.⁷⁷⁰
 Heu, set in hoc vicio plebis quasi tota propago
 Carnis in obsequio stat viciata modo:
 Ex causa fragili causatur fictilis etas,
 Quo nunc de facili frangitur omnis homo.
 Carnis enim vicia sunt sic communiter acta,
 Quod de continuis vix pudet vsus eis:
 Cecus amor fatuos cecos sic ducit amantes,
 Quod sibi quid deceat non videt vllus amans.
 Pendula res amor est subito collapsa dolore,
 200 Ordine precipiti miraque facta parat;⁷⁷¹
 Sique tuam velles flammam compescere tutus,
 Artem preuideas, quam prius inde cadas.
 Cum viciis aliis pugna, iubet hec tibi Paulus,⁷⁷²
 Carnis et a bello tu fuge solus homo;
 Et quia vulnifico fixurus pectora telo
 Vibrat amor, caute longius inde fuge:
 Vinces si fugias, vinceris sique resistas;
 Ne leo vincaris, tu lepus ergo fuge.
 Mente tui cordis memorare nouissima carnis,
 210 Et speculo mortis respice qualis eris:⁷⁷³
 Oscula fetor erunt, amplexus vermis, et omne
 Quod fuerat placidum, pena resoluet opus.
 Occupat extrema stultorum gaudia luctus,
 Et risum lacrima plena dolore madet:
 Vana salus hominis, quam terminat egra voluptas,
 Tollit et eternum viuere vita brevis.
 Crede, satis tutum tenet hoc natura statutum,⁷⁷⁴
 Quo caro pollutum reddet ad yma lutum;
 Cum fera mors stabit et terram terra vorabit,
 220 Tunc homo gustabit quid sibi culpa dabit.
 Est vbi mundicia carnis sine labe reatus,
 Casta pudicicia gaudet ad omne latus:
 Stat nota bina solo quo luxus non dominatur,

Pax manet absque dolo, longaue vita datur.

Contra mundi fallaciam in causa Periurii et Auaricie.

Sunt duo cognati viciorum consociati,
Orbem qui ledunt pariter, nec ab orbe recedunt:
Iste fidem raram periurat, et alter auaram
Causam custodit; socios tales deus odit.
Primo periurum describam, postque futurum,
230 Est vbi ius raram, scriptura remordet auaram:
Ex vicio tali fertur origo mali.
Nemo dei nomen assumere debet inane,
Falsa nec vt iuret, os perhibere malo:
Lex vetus hoc statuit, set, prothdolor, ecce modernus⁷⁷⁵
Munere corruptos iam nouus error agit.
Nil nisi dona videt dum se periurat Auarus,
Eius enim sensum census vbique regit;
Sic non liber homo librum sine pondere librat,
Seruit et ad libras quas sua libra trahit.
240 Set quia periurus defraudat iura superni,
Iurat eum dominus iure perire suo:
Sic lucrum siciens laqueos incurrit, et eius
Lingua prius mendax premia mortis habet;
Sic vendens et emens vacuus non transiet, immo
Munera que capiet sulphur et ignis erunt.
Vendere iusticiam nichil est nisi vendere Cristum,
Expectat dampnum qui facit inde forum:
Testis erit Iudas quid erit sibi fine doloris;
Dum crepuit medius, culpa subibat onus.
250 Penituit culpam, que semel nisi fecerat illam,
Quod tulit et lucrum reddidit ipse statim;⁷⁷⁶
Set nec eo veniam meruit nec habere salutem,⁷⁷⁷
Iam valet exemplum tale mouere virum.
Vendidit ipse semel iustum, nos cotidianum
Ob lucri precium vendimus omne malum:
Ille restaurauit, set nos restringimus aurum;

Penituit, set nos absque pauore sumus.
 Sic et auaricia tanta feritate perurget
 Corda viri, quod ab hoc vix homo liber abit:
 260 Cessat iusticia, cessatque fides sociata,
 Fraus dolus atque suum iam subiere locum:
 Plebs sine iure manet, non est qui iura tuetur,
 Non est qui dicat, iura tenere decet:
 Omnibus in causis, vbi gentes commoda querunt,
 Nunc modus est que fides non habuisse fidem.⁷⁷⁸
 Vox leuis illa Iacob, Esau manus hispida nuper,
 Que foret ista dies, signa futura dabant:
 Alterius casu stat supplantator, et eius
 Qui fuerat socius fraude subintrat opes:
 270 Ex dampno fratris frater sua commoda querit;
 Vnus si presit, inuidet alter ei:
 Filius ante diem patruos iam spectat in annos,
 Nec videt ex oculis ceca cupido suis:
 Nunc amor est solus, nec sentit habere secundum,
 Stans odioque tibi diligit ipse tua.
 Quid modo, cumque manus mentitur dextra sinistre,
 Dicam? set caueat qui sapienter agit.
 Viuitur ex velle, non amplius est via tuta,
 Cuncta licent cupido, dum vacat ipse lucro;
 280 Arma, rapina, dolus, amor ambiciosus habendi,
 Amplius ad proprium velle sequuntur iter:
 Lex silet et nummus loquitur, ius dormit et aurum
 Peruigil insidiis vincit vbique suis:
 Hasta nocet ferri, gladius set plus nocet auri;
 Regna terit mundi, nilque resistit ei.
 Set quia mors dubium concludit ad omnia finem,
 Est nichil hic certum preter amare deum:
 Rebus in humanis semper quid deficit, et sic
 Ista nichil plenum fertile vita tenet:
 290 Quod tibi dat proprium mundus, tibi tollit id ipsum,
 Deridensque tuum linquit inane forum:
 Quam prius in finem mundi deuenerit huius,
 Nulla potest certo munere vita frui.

Heu, quid opes opibus cumulas, qui propria queris,
Cum se nemo queat appropriare sibi?
Hunc igitur mundum quia perdes, quere futurum;
Est aliter vacuum tempus vtrumque tuum.

300 Mammona transibit et auara cupido peribit,
In cineres ibit, mors tua fata bibit,
Pauper ab hac vita, sic princeps, sic heremita,
Mortuus ad merita transiet omnis ita.

Quicquid homo voluit, mors mundi
cuncta reuoluit,
Nemoque dissoluit, quin morti debita
soluit:

Salomon:
Memorare
nouissima, et
in eternum non
peccabis.

Hec qui mente capit gaudia, raro sapit.
Set sibi viuenti qui consilio sapienti
Prouidet, ingenti merito placet
omnipotenti.

Idem: Omnia fac
cum consilio, et
in eternum non
penitebis.

Tempore presenti que sunt mala
proxima genti,⁷⁷⁹

Ex oculo flenti Gower canit ista legenti:

310 Quisque sue menti qui concipit aure patenti
Mittat, et argenti det munera largus egenti;
Stat nam mortalis terra repleta malis.⁷⁸⁰

Hoc ego bis deno Ricardi regis in anno
Compaciens animo carmen lacrimabile scribo.⁷⁸¹

Vox sonat in populo, fidei iam deficit ordo,
Vnde magis solito cessat laus debita Cristo,
Quem peperit virgo genitum de flamine sacro.
Hic deus est et homo, perfecta salus manet in quo,
Eius ab imperio processit pacis origo,
Que dabitur iusto, paciens qui credit in ipso.

320 Vir qui vult ideo pacem componere mundo,
Pacificet primo iura tenenda deo.

FOOTNOTES:

⁷⁵¹ CARMEN SUPER MULTIPLICI, &c. *The MSS. referred to are SCEHL with Fairfax 3 (F) and Bodley 294 (B).*

[752](#) *Title and Preface* ll. 1-12 *om.* EL
[753](#) *Title and Preface* consequenter] hic precipue F
[754](#) *Title and Preface* 'Putruerunt,' &c. *om.* E
[755](#) *Title and Preface* pro salute interpellam] pro salute efficacius interpellem F
[756](#) Anno] In Anno F
[757](#) l. 13 *ad om.* S
[758](#) 35 palliet F (*corr.*) palleat SCHLB paleat E
[759](#) 58 scintilla CEL
[760](#) 62 non] nec F
[761](#) 63 nec] non CEH
[762](#) 86 *No paragr. here* FL stude SCEHLB time F
[763](#) 88 Que fantasias aliter tibi FB
[764](#) 90 *Paragr.* FL
[765](#) 126 *stat om.* S
[766](#) 138 f. *Two lines om.* FL *The section ll. 142-224 is omitted here in E and inserted after l. 321*
[767](#) 143 legit C
[768](#) 154 omnis SFLB viuus CEH
[769](#) 159 fatuis *om.* F
[770](#) 190 inde] ille FL
[771](#) 200 fata EHLB
[772](#) 203 hoc EH
[773](#) 210 mortis] cordis S
[774](#) 217 statum S
[775](#) 234 modernus SFLB modernos CEH
[776](#) 251 Quot C
[777](#) 252 Sic CEH
[778](#) 265 est qui CEH
[779](#) 307 *Paragr.* SE *no paragr.* CHFLB
[780](#) *After 311 one line space* F
[781](#) 312-321 *Ten lines om.* L

782TRACTATUS DE LUCIS SCRUTINIO

**Incipit tractatus de lucis Scrutinio quam a diu
viciorem tenebre, prothdolor, suffocarunt,⁷⁸³
secundum illud in euangelio, Qui ambulat in tenebris
nescit quo vadat.**

Heu, quia per crebras humus est
viciata tenebras,
Vix iter humanum locus vllus habet
sibi planum.
Si Romam pergas, vt ibi tua lumina
tergas,

Nota quod eorum
lucerna minime,
clarescit quos in
ecclesia per
Antipapam
Auaricia promotos
ditescit.

Lumina mira cape, quia Rome sunt duo pape;
Et si plus cleri iam debent lumina queri,
Sub modio tecta latitat lucerna reiecta:
Presulis officia mundus tegit absque sophia,
Stat sua lux nulla, dum Simonis est ibi bulla;
Est iter hoc vile, qui taliter intrat ouile,
10 Nec bene discernit lucem qui lumina spernit.
Sic caput obscurum de membris nil fore purum [784](#)
Efficit, et secum sic cecus habet sibi cecum. [785](#)

Aut si vis gressus claros, non ordo
professus

De luce ordinis
professi.

Hos tibi prestabit, quos caucius vmbra fugabit.
Ordine claustrali manifestius in speciali⁷⁸⁶
Lux ibi pallescit, quam mens magis inuida nescit:
Lux et moralis tenebrescit presbiteralis,
Clara dies transit, nec eis lucerna remansit;
Sunt ibi lucerne, iocus, ocia, scorta, taberne,
Quorum velamen viciis fert sepe iuuamen.
Sic perit exemplum lucis, quo turbida templum
Nebula perfudit, que lumina queque recludit:⁷⁸⁷

De luce ordinis
professi.

Sic vice pastorum quos Cristus ab ante bonorum
Legerat, ecce chorum statuit iam mundus eorum.

Si lux presentum scrutetur in orbe
regentum,
Horum de guerra pallet sine lumine
terra:
Ne periant leges, iam Roma petit sibi
reges,
Noscat vt ille pater que sit sibi credula
mater.
Scisma modernorum patrum nouitate
duorum

Nota quod, si
regum lucerna in
manu caritatis
deuocius
gestaretur, ecclesia
nunc diuisa eorum
auxilio discrecius
reformaretur,
eciam et incursus
paganorum a Cristi
finibus eorum
probitate eminus
expelleretur.

30 Reges delerent, si Cristi iura viderent;
Lux ita regalis decet ecclesiam specialis,
Qua domus alma dei maneat sub spe requiei.
Teste paganorum bello furiente deorum,
Raro fides crescit vbi regia lux tenebrescit:
Hec tamen audimus, set et hec verissima scimus⁷⁸⁸
Nec capit hec mentis oculus de luce regentis.
Vlterius quere, cupias si lumen habere,
Lumina namque Daudid sibi ceca magis titulauit.

Si regni proceres aliter pro lumine
queres, De luce procerum.

40 Aspice quod plenum non est ibi tempus amenum,
Dumque putas stare, palpabis iter, quia clare
Nemo videt, quando veniet de turbine grando,
Diuicie cece fallunt sine lumine sese;
Quam prius ille cadat, vix cernit habens vbi vadat:
Sic via segura procerum non est sine cura.
Stans honor ex onere sibi conuenit acta videre;
Qui tamen extentum modo viderit experimentum,
De procerum spera non surgunt lumina vera.

Si bellatorum lucem scrutabor
eorum,

De luce Militum et
aliorum qui bella
sequuntur.

50 Lucerne lator tenebrosus adest
gladiator,
Sunt ibi doctrina luxus, iactura, rapina,

Que non splendorem querunt set habere cruorem;
Et sic armatus lucem pre labe reatus
Non videt, vnde status suus errat in orbe grauatus.

Si lex scrutetur, ibi lux n o n De luce legistarum.
i n u e n i e t u r,

Quin vis aut velle ius concitat esse rebelle:
Non populo lucet index quem mammona ducet,
Efficit et cecum quo sepe reflectitur equum.

Ius sine iure datur, si nummus in aure loquatur,
60 Auri splendore tenebrescit lumen in ore,
Omnis legista viuit quasi lege sub ista,
Quo magis ex glosa loculi fit lex tenebrosa.

Si Mercatorum querantur lumina De luce
morum, Mercatorum.

Lux non fulgebit, vbi fraus cum ciue manebit.
Contegit vsure subtilis forma figure
Vultum laruatum, quem diues h a b e t s i m i l a t u m.

Si dolus in villa tua possit habere sigilla,
Vix reddes clarus bona que tibi prestat auarus;
Et sic maiores fallunt quamsepe minores,
70 Vnde dolent turbe sub murmure plebis in vrbe.
Sic inter ciues errat sine lumine diues,
Dumque fidem nescit, lux pacis ab vrbe recessit.

Si patriam quero, nec ibi michi De luce vulgari,
lumina spero; que patriam
conseruat.

Nam via vulgaris tenebris viciatur
amaris:

Plebs ratione carens hec est sine moribus arens, [789](#)

Cuius subiectam vix Cristus habet sibi sectam.

Sunt aliqui tales, quos mundus habet speciales,

Fures, raptores, homicide, turbidiores:

Sunt et conducti quidam pro munere ducti,

80 Quos facit assisa periuros luce rescisa. [790](#)

Rustica ruralis non est ibi spes aliqualis,

Quo nimis obscura pallent sine lumine rura:

Sic magis illicebras mundanas quisque tenebras [791](#)

Nunc petit, et vota non sunt ad lumina mota.

Sic prior est mundus, et si deus esse secundus
Posset, adhuc talis foret in spe lux aliqualis:
Set quasi nunc totus deus est a plebe remotus;⁷⁹²
Sic absente duce perit orbis iter sine luce.

90 O nimis orbatus varii de labe reatus, Hic in fine⁷⁹³
Omnis in orbe status modo stat quasi tenebras
preuaricatus. deplangens pro
Cum tamen errantes alios sine lege luce optinenda
vagantes⁷⁹⁴ deum exorat.

Cecos deplango, mea propria viscera tango:⁷⁹⁵
Cecus vt ignorat quo pergere, dumque laborat,⁷⁹⁶
Sic iter explorat mea mens, que flebilis orat:
Et quia perpendo quod lucis ad vltima tendo,
Nunc iter attendo quo perfruar in moriendo.
Tu, qui formasti lucem tenebrasque creasti,
Crimina condones, et sic tua lumina dones:
In terram sero tunc quando cubacula quero,
100 Confer candelam, potero qua ferre medelam.
Hec Gower scribit, lucem dum querere quibit;
Sub spe transibit, vbi gaudia lucis adibit:
Lucis solamen det sibi Cristus. Amen.

FOOTNOTES:

⁷⁸² *Text of S collated with CEHL*

⁷⁸³ *Title 2 Suoffocarunt S*

⁷⁸⁴ 11 oscurum CH

⁷⁸⁵ 12 cecus] secus C

⁷⁸⁶ 15 manifestus L

⁷⁸⁷ 22 Nebula] Lumina L

⁷⁸⁸ 35 et hec] per hec L

⁷⁸⁹ 75 hec om. L

⁷⁹⁰ 80 rescisa SEHL rescisa C (*corr.*)

⁷⁹¹ 83 illecebras EL

⁷⁹² 87 a plebe] a luce CEH

⁷⁹³ 89 *margin* Hic in fine] *Nota quod Iohannes Gower auctor huius libr hic in fine E*

⁷⁹⁴ 91 sine luce L

⁷⁹⁵ 92 de plango C

⁷⁹⁶ 93 S *has here lost a leaf*

ECCE PATET TENSUS ETC. [797](#)

Ecce patet tensus ceci Cupidinis arcus,
Vnde sagitta volans ardor amoris erit.
Omnia vincit amor, cecus tamen errat vbique,
Quo sibi directum carpere nescit iter.
Ille suos famulos ita cecos ducit amantes,
Quod sibi quid deceat non videt vllus amans:
Sic oculus cordis carnis caligine cecus
Decidit, et ratio nil rationis habet.
Sic amor ex velle viuit, quem ceca voluptas
10 Nutrit, et ad placitum cuncta ministrat ei;
Subque suis alis mundus requiescit in vmbra,
Et sua precepta quisquis vbique facit.
Ipse coronatus inopes simul atque potentes
Omnes lege pari conficit esse pares.
Sic amor omne domat, quicquid natura creauit,
Et tamen indomitus ipse per omne manet:
Carcerat et redimit, ligat atque ligata resoluit,
Vulnerat omne genus, nec sibi vulnus habet.
Non manet in terris qui prelia vincit amoris,
20 Nec sibi quis firme federa pacis habet:
Sampsonis vires, gladius neque Daud in istis
Quid laudis, sensus aut Salomonis, habent.
O natura viri, poterit quam tollere nemo,
Nec tamen excusat quod facit ipsa malum!
O natura viri, que naturatur eodem
Quod vitare nequit, nec licet illud agi!
O natura viri, duo que contraria mixta
Continet, amborum nec licet acta sequi!
O natura viri, que semper habet sibi bellum
30 Corporis ac anime, que sua iura petunt!
Sic magis igne suo Cupido perurit amantum
Et quasi de bello corda subacta tenet.

Qui vult ergo sue carnis compescere flammam,
Arcum preuideat vnde sagitta volat.
Nullus ab innato valet hoc euadere morbo,
Sit nisi quod sola gracia curet eum.

* * * * *

The MS. has here lost a leaf.

FOOTNOTES:

[797](#) 'Ecce patet tensus' &c. *This follows the Cinkante Balades in the Trentham MS.*

EST AMOR ETC. [798](#)

**Carmen quod Iohannes Gower super amoris
multiplici varietate sub compendio metricè
composuit. [799](#)**

Est amor in glosa pax bellica, lis pietosa,
Accio famosa, vaga sors, vis imperiosa,
Pugna quietosa, victoria perniciosa,
Regula viscosa, scola deuia, lex capitosa,
Cura molestosa, grauis ars, virtus viciosa,
Gloria dampnosa, flens risus et ira iocosa,
Musa dolorosa, mors leta, febris preciosa,
Esca venenosa, fel dulce, fames animosa,
Vitis acetosa, sitis ebria, mens furiosa,
10 Flamma pruinosa, nox clara, dies tenebrosa, [800](#)
Res dedignosa, socialis et ambiciosa,
Garrula, verbosa, secreta, silens, studiosa,
Fabula formosa, sapientia prestigiosa,
Causa ruinosa, rota versa, quies operosa,
Vrticata rosa, spes stulta fidesque dolosa.

Magnus in exiguis variatus vt est tibi clamor,
Fixus in ambiguis motibus errat amor.
Instruat audita tibi leccio sic repetita;
Mors, amor et vita participantur ita.

Lex docet auctorum quod iter carnale bonorum
Tucius est, quorum sunt federa coniugiorum:
Fragrat vt ortorum rosa plus quam germen agrorum,
Ordo maritorum caput est et finis amorum.
5 Hec est nuptorum carnis quasi regula morum,
Que saluandorum sacratur in orbe virorum.
Hinc vetus annorum Gower sub spe meritorum

Ordine sponsorum tutus adhibo thorum.

FOOTNOTES:

[798](#) *Text of S, collated with F See also vol. i. p. 392*

[799](#) *Title Carmen de variis in amore passionibus breuiter compilatum F*

[800](#) 10 tenobrosa S

QUIA VNUSQUISQUE ETC.⁸⁰¹

Quia vnusquisque, prout a deo accepit, aliis impartiri tenetur, Iohannes Gower super hiis que deus sibi sensualiter donauit villicacionis sue rationem⁸⁰² secundum aliquid alleuiare cupiens, tres precipue libros per ipsum, dum vixit, doctrine causa compositos ad aliorum noticiam in lucem serieose produxit.⁸⁰³

Primus liber Gallico sermone editus in decem diuiditur partes, et tractans de viciis et virtutibus, necnon et de variis huius seculi gradibus, viam qua peccator transgressus ad sui creatoris agnicionem redire debet, recto tramite docere conatur. Titulusque libelli istius Speculum Meditantis nuncupatus est.

Secundus enim liber sermone Latino metrico compositus tractat de variis infortuniis tempore regis Ricardi secundi in Anglia contingentibus: vnde non solum regni procures et communes tormenta passi sunt, set et ipse crudelissimus rex, suis ex demeritis ab alto corruens, in foueam quam fecit finaliter proiectus est. Nomenque voluminis huius Vox Clamantis intitulatur.

Tercius vero⁸⁰⁴ liber, qui ob reuerenciam strenuissimi domini sui domini Henrici de Lancastria, tunc Derbeie Comitis, Anglico sermone conficitur, secundum Danielis propheciam super huius mundi regnorum mutacione a tempore regis Nabugodonosor vsque nunc tempora distinguit. Tractat eciam secundum Aristotilem super hiis quibus rex Alexander tam in sui regimen quam aliter eius disciplina edoctus fuit. Principalis tamen huius

**operis materia super amorem et infatuatas Amantum
passiones fundamentum habet: nomenque sibi
appropriatum Confessio Amantis specialiter sortitus
est.**

FOOTNOTES:

[801](#) 'Quia vnusquisque' &c. *Text of S, collated with CHGF. See also* vol. iii. p. 479 f.

[802](#) 3 rationem SCH rationem, dum tempus instat, GF

[803](#) 4 ff. tres—produxit] inter labores et ocia ad aliorum noticiam tres libros
doctrine causa forma subsequenti propterea composuit GF

[804](#) 18 vero] iste F

ENEIDOS BUCOLIS ETC. [805](#)

Carmen, quod quidam Philosophus in memoriam Iohannis Gower super consummacione suorum trium librorum forma subsequenti [806](#) composuit, et eidem gratanter transmisit. [807](#)

Eneidos Bucolis que Georgica metra perhennis
Virgilio laudis sertā dedere scolis;
Hiis tribus ille libris prefertur honore poetis,
Romaque precipuis laudibus instat eis.
Gower, sicque tuis tribus est dotata libellis
Anglia, morigeris quo tua scripta seris.
Illeque Latinis tantum sua metra loquelis
Scripsit, vt Italicis sint recolenda notis;
Te tua set trinis tria scribere carmina linguis
10 Constat, vt inde viris sit scola lata magis:
Gallica lingua prius, Latina secunda, set ortus
Lingua tui pocius Anglica complet opus. [808](#)
Ille quidem vanis Romanas obstupet aures,
Ludit et in studiis musa pagana suis;
Set tua Cristicolis fulget scriptura renatis,
Quo tibi celicolis laus sit habenda locis.

FOOTNOTES:

[805](#) 'Eneidos Bucolis' &c. *Text of S, collated with CHGF*

[806](#) forma subsequenti] versificatum F

[807](#) Title Epistola cuiusdam Philosophi Iohanni Gower super consummacione suorum trium librorum, prout inferius patet, gratanter transmissa G

[808](#) 12 Anglia F

O DEUS IMMENSE ETC.[809](#)

**Carmen quod Iohannes Gower adhuc viuens
super principum regimine vltimo composuit.**[810](#)

O deus immense, sub quo dominantur in ense
Quidam morosi Reges, quidam viciosi,
Disparibus meritis sic pax sic mocio litis
Publica regnorum manifestant gesta suorum:
Quicquid delirant Reges, plectuntur Achiui,
Quo mala respirant, vbi mores sunt fugitiui.
Laus et honor Regum foret obseruacio legum,
Ad quas iurati sunt prima sorte vocati:
Vt celeste bonum puto concilium fore donum,
10 Quo prius in terris pax contulit oscula guerris:
Consilium dignum Regem facit esse benignum,
Est aliter signum quo spergitur omne malignum.
In bonitate pares sumat sibi consiliares
Rex bonus, et cuncta venient sibi prospera iuncta:
Qui regit optentum de consilio sapientum
Regnum, non ledit set ab omni labe recedit:
Consilium tortum scelus omne refundit abortum
Regis in errorem, regni quo perdit amorem.
'Ve qui predaris,' Y s a i a s clamat auaris;
20 Sic verbis claris loquitur tibi qui dominaris.
Rex qui plus aurum populi quam corda thesaurum
Computat, a mente populi cadit ipse repente.
Os vbi vulgare non audet verba sonare,
Stat magis obscura sub murmure mens loquutura:
Que stupet in villa cicius plebs murmurat illa,
Vnde malum crescit, sapiens quo sepe pauescit.
Est tibi credendum murmur satis esse timendum;
Cum sit commune, tunc te super omnia mune.[811](#)

30 Lingua nequit fari mala, cor nec premeditari,
Que parat obliquus sub fraude dolosus amicus:
Mundus erit testis, vir talis vt altera pestis
Inficit occulto regnum de crimine multo.
Blandus adulator et auarus consiliator,
Quamuis non velles, plures facit esse rebelles:
Sepius ex herbis morbus curatur acerbis,
Sepe loquela grauis iuuat et nocet illa suavis.
Qui falsum pingunt sub fraudeque vera refingunt,
Hii sunt qui blando sermone nocent aliquando:
40 Rex qui conducit tales, sibi scandala ducit,
Nomen et abducit quod nobile raro reducit:
Quod vigit mane, sibi vespere transit inane,
Dummodo creduntur que verba dolosa loquuntur.
Consilio tali regnum magis in speciali
Vndique turbatur, quo Regis honor variatur:
Nunc ita sicut heri poterit res ista videri,
Vnde magis plangit populus, quem lesio tangit.
Set premunitus non fallitur inde peritus;
Quod videt ante manum, fugit omne notabile vanum:
Cum laqueatur auis, cauet altera, sicque suavis
50 Rex pius in cura semper timet ipse futura.
Rex insensatus nullos putat esse reatus,
Quam prius ante fores casus sibi sint grauiiores;
Set qui prescire vult causas, expedit ire,
Plebis et audire voces per easque redire:
Si sit in errore Regis vel in eius honore,
Hoc de clamore populi prefertur ab ore.
Est qui morosus, Rex non erit ambiciosus,
Set sub eo tutum regni manet omne statutum:
Nomine preclarus nunquam fuit vllus auarus,
60 Larga manus nomen cum laude meretur et omen:
Nomen regale populi vox dat tibi, quale
Sit, bene siue male, deus illud habet speciale.
Rex qui tutus eris, si temet noscere Nota.
 queris,
Ad vocem plebis aures sapienter habebis:

Culpe vel laudis ex plebe creatur, vt audis,
 F a m a f e r e n s v e r b a q u e dulcia sunt et acerba.
 Fama cito crescit, subito tamen illa vanescit,
 Saltem fortuna stabilis quia non manet vna:
 Principio scire fortunam seu stabilire,
 70 Non est humanum super hoc quid ponere planum;
 Fine set expertum valet omnis dicere certum,
 Qualia sunt facta, quia tunc probat exitus acta.
 Rex qui laudari cupit et de fine beari,
 Sint sua facta bona, recoletur vt inde corona.
 Regia precedant benefacta que crimina cedant,
 Viuat vt eterno sic Rex cum Rege superno:
 Absque deo vana cum sit tibi cotidiana
 Pompa, recorderis, sine laude dei morieris.
 Rex sibi qui mundum prefert Cristumque secundum
 80 Linquit, adherebit vbi finis laude carebit:
 Regis enim vita cum sit sine laude sopita,
 Nomen erat quale, dabit vltima cronica tale.
 Et sic concludo breuiter de carmine nudo,
 Ordine quo regnant Reges, sua nomina pregnant.
 Quo caput infirmum, nichil est de corpore firmum,
 Plebs neque firmatur, vbi virtus non dominatur.
 Rex qui securam laudis vult carpere curam,
 Cristum preponat, Reges qui laude coronat:
 Nam qui presumit de se, cum plus sibi sumit,
 90 Fine carens laude stat fama retrograda caude.
 Omni viuenti scola pertinet ista regenti,
 Displicet hic genti qui non placet omnipotenti,
 Gracia succedit, meritis vbi culpa recedit:
 Qui sic non credit, sua Rex regalia ledit.
 Non ex fatali casu set iudiciali
 Pondere regali stat medicina mali.
 Plebs vt ouile gregis, mors vitaeque, regula legis,
 Sub manibus Regis sunt ea quanta legis.
 Tanta licet pronus pro tempore det tibi thronus;
 100 Sit nisi fine bonus, non honor est set onus.
 Rex igitur videat cum curru quomodo vadat,

Et sibi prouideat, ne rota versa cadat.
Celorum Regi pateant que scripta peregi,
Namque sue legi res nequit vlla tegi.

FOOTNOTES:

[809](#) 'O deus immense' &c. *Text of S, collated with CH*

[810](#) *Title* Carmen quod Iohannes Gower tempore regis Ricardi, dum vixit, vltimo composuit CHG

[811](#) 28 comune S

LAST POEMS

Hic in fine notandum est qualiter ab illa Cronica que Vox clamantis dicitur vsque in finem istius Cronice que tripertita est, Ego inter alios scribentes super hiis que medio tempore in Anglia contingebant, secundum varias rerum accidencias varia carmina, prout patet, que ad legendum necessaria sunt, notabiliter conscripsi. Sed nunc, quia vltcrius scribere non sufficio, excusacionis mee causam scriptis subsequentibus plenius declarabo.

Quicquid homo scribat, finem natura ministrat,
Que velut vmbra fugit, nec fugiendo redit;
Illa michi finem posuit, quo scribere quicquam
Vltcrius nequio, sum quia cecus ego.
Posse meum transit, quamuis michi velle remansit;
Amplius vt scribat hoc michi posse negat.
Carmina, dum potui, studiosus plurima scripsi;
Pars tenet hec mundum, pars tenet illa deum:
Vana tamen mundi mundo scribenda reliqui,
10 Scriboque mentali carmine verba dei.
Quamuis ad exterius scribendi deficit actus,
Mens tamen interius scribit et ornat opus:
Sic quia de manibus nichil amodo scribo valoris,
Scribam de precibus que nequit illa manus.
Hoc ego, vir cecus, presentibus oro diebus,
Prospera quod statuas regna futura, deus,
Daque michi sanctum lumen habere tuum. Amen.

S as above: in CHG as follows:

**Nota hic in fine qualiter a principio illius Cronice
que Vox clamantis dicitur, vna cum sequenti Cronica
que tripertita est, tam de tempore Regis Ricardi
secundi vsque in ipsius deposicionem, quam de
coronacione Illustrissimi domini Regis Henrici quarti
vsque in annum Regni sui secundum, Ego licet
indignus inter alios scribentes scriptor a diu sollicitus,
precipue super hiis que medio tempore in Anglia
contingebant, secundum varias rerum accidencias
varia carmina, que ad legendum necessaria sunt, sub
compendio breuiter conscripsi. Et nunc, quia tam
grauitate senectutis quam aliarum infirmitatum
multipliciter depressus vlterius de cronicis scribere
discrete non sufficio, excusacionem meam
necessariam, prout patet, consequenter declarare
intendo.**

Henrici Regis annus fuit ille secundus,
Scribere dum cesso, sum quia cecus ego,
Vltra posse nichil, quamuis michi velle ministrat,
Amplius vt scribam non meus actus habet.
Scribere dum potui, studiosus plurima scripsi;
Pars tenet hec mundum, pars tenet illa deum:
Vana tamen mundi mundo scribenda reliqui,
Scriboque finali carmine vado mori.
Scribat qui veniet post me discreciore alter,
10* Ammodo namque manus et mea penna silent.
Sic quia nil manibus potero conferre valoris,
Est michi de precibus ferre laboris onus.
Deprecor ergo meis lacrimis, viuens ego cecus,
Prospera quod statuas regna futura, deus,
Daque michi sanctum lumen habere tuum. Amen.

In the Trentham MS. as follows (without heading),

Henrici quarti primus Regni fuit annus,
Quo michi defecit visus ad acta mea.
Omnia tempus habent, finem natura ministrat,
Quem virtute sua frangere nemo potest.
Vltra posse nichil, quamuis michi velle remansit,
Amplius vt scribam non michi posse manet.
Dum potui scripsi, set nunc quia curua senectus
Turbauit sensus, scripta relinquo scolis.
Scribat qui veniet post me discreciior alter,
10** Ammodo namque manus et mea penna silent.
Hoc tamen in fine verborum queso meorum,
Prospera quod statuatur Regna futura deus. Amen.

Orate pro anima Iohannis Gower. Quicumque enim pro anima ipsius Iohannis deuote orauerit, tociens quociens Mille quingentos dies indulgentie ab ecclesia rite concessos misericorditer in domino possidebit.

CH as above: G as follows:

Orantibus pro anima Iohannis Gower mille quingenti dies indulgentie misericorditer in domino conceduntur.

(Shield of arms borne by two angels.)

Armigeri scutum nichil ammodo fert sibi tutum,
Reddidit immo lutum morti generale tributum.
Spiritus exutum se gaudeat esse solutum,
Est vbi virtutum regnum sine labe statutum.

(A bier, with candle at head and foot.)

10 [812](#) Vnanimis esse qui secula duxit ad esse
Nos iubet expresse, quia debet amor superesse;
Lex cum iure datur, pax gaudet, plebs gratulatur,
Regnum firmatur, vbi verus amor dominatur:
Sicut yemps florem, diuisio quassat amorem, [813](#)
Nutrit et errorem quasi pestis agitque dolorem.
Quod precessit heri docet ista pericla timeri,
Vt discant veri sapientes secula mederi.
Filius ipse dei, manet in quo spes requiei, [814](#)
Ex meritis fidei dirigat acta rei.

Diligamus invicem.

[815](#) Presul, ouile regis, vbi morbus adest macularum,
Lumina dumque tegis, tenebrescit Nota de primordiis
 Stelle Comate in
 Anglia.
pestis earum.
Mune pericla gregis, patuit quia stella
 minarum,
Vnde viam Regis turbat genus insidiarum.
Velle loco legis mundum nunc ducit auarum,
Sic vbicumque legis, nichil est nisi cordis amarum,
Quod maneat clarum, stat modo dulce parum.

Cultor in ecclesia qui deficiente sophia
Semina vana serit, Messor inanis erit.
Hii set cultores, sunt quorum semina mores
Ad messem Cristi, plura lucratur ibi. [816](#)
Qui cupit ergo bonus celorum lucra colonus,
Vnde lucrum querat, semina sancta serat.
Qui pastor Cristi iusto cupit ordine sisti,
Non sit cum Cristo Symon mediator in isto:

10

Auferet hoc nemo, quod dabis ipse deo.

818 7 Dum tua tempus habes EH

NOTES

EPISTOLA.

This Epistle, written apparently on the occasion of sending a copy of the book to the archbishop, is found only in the All Souls MS., and it is reasonable to suppose that this was the copy in question. The statement of Mr. Coxe in the Roxburghe edition, that ‘the preface to archbishop Arundel ... is also in the original hand’ of the book (Introduction, p. lix) is a surprising one, and must have been due to some deception of memory. The hand here is quite a different one from that of the text which follows, and has a distinctly later character. The piece is full of erasures, which are indicated in this edition by spaced type, but the corrections are in the same hand as the rest. Having no other copy of it, we cannot tell what the original form of the erased passages may have been, but it is noticeable that the most important of them (ll. 26-34) has reference almost entirely to the blindness of the author, and nearly every one contains something which may be regarded as alluding to this, either some mention of light and darkness, or some allusion to the fact that his only perceptions now are those of the mind. We may perhaps conclude that the Epistle was inscribed here before the author quite lost his eyesight, and that the book then remained by him for some time before it was presented. The illuminated capital S with which this composition begins is combined with a miniature painting of the archbishop.

2. *tibi scribo*, ‘I dedicate to thee.’

3. *Quod ... scriptum*: written over erasure; perhaps originally ‘*Quem ... librum*,’ altered to avoid the repetition of ‘*librum*’ from the preceding line.

4. *contempletur*: apparently in a passive impersonal sense.

17. *Cecus ego mere*. The word ‘*mere*’ alone is over erasure here, but if we suppose that the original word was ‘*fere*,’ we may regard this as referring originally to a gradual failure of the eyesight, not to complete blindness.

19. *Corpore defectus*, ‘the failure in my body,’ as subject of ‘*sinit*.’

23. *dumque*: equivalent to ‘dum’ in our author’s language; cp. i. 165, 2007, &c.

33. *morosa*: this word has a good meaning in Gower’s language; cp. ‘O deus immense,’ l. 2, where ‘morosi’ is opposed to ‘viciosi.’

VOX CLAMANTIS

CAPITULA.

LIB. I. Cap. iii. *quandam vulgi turmam*. It may be noted that these headings do not always exactly correspond with those placed at the head of the chapters afterwards. For example here the actual heading of the chapter has ‘secundam vulgi turmam,’ and for the succeeding chapters ‘terciam,’ ‘quartam,’ ‘quintam,’ &c. Usually the differences are very trifling, as ‘illius terre’ for ‘terre illius’ above, but sometimes they proceed from the fact that alterations have been made in the chapter headings, which the corrector has neglected to make in this Table of Chapters. This is the case for example as regards Lib. VI. Capp. xviii. and xix. Slight variations of the kind first mentioned will be found in Lib. III. Capp. i, v, viii, xii, xvi, xix, xx.

LIB. III. Cap. iiii. The form which we have here in D corresponds to the heading of the chapter given by LTH₂ (but not by D itself) in the text later. G has the text here after ‘loquitur’ written over an erasure.

LIB. VII. Cap. xix. Here S has lost two leaves (the sixth and seventh of the first full quire) to Lib. I. Cap. i. l. 18. The verso of the former of these leaves had no doubt the four lines ‘Ad mundum mitto’ &c. with picture, as in the Cotton MS.

LIB. I. PROLOGUS.

3 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, iv. 2921 f.,

‘Al be it so, that som men sein
That swevenes ben of no credence.’

‘propositum credulitatis’ seems to mean ‘true ground of belief.’

12. *interius mentis*: cp. i. 1361.

15. That is, 'hinc puto quod sompnia que vidi,' &c.

21 ff. We are here told to add to 'John' the first letters of 'Godfrey,' the beginning of 'Wales,' and the word 'Ter' without its head: that is, 'John Gower.'

23. *que tali*. The use of 'que' in this manner, standing independently at the beginning of the clause, is very common in Gower.

33 f. Taken from Ovid, *Tristia*, v. 1. 5 f.

36. Cp. *Tristia*, i. 1. 14, 'De lacrimis factas sentiet esse meis,' which, so far as it goes, is in favour of the reading 'senciat' here.

37 f. This couplet was originally *Tristia*, iv. 1. 95 f.,

'Saepe etiam lacrimae me sunt scribente profusae,
Humidaque est fletu litera facta meo.'

The first line however was altered so as to lose its grammatical construction, and the couplet was subsequently emended.

43 f. Cp. Ovid, *Tristia*, i. 5. 53 f.

47 f. Cp. *Pont.* iv. 2. 19, where the comparison to a spring choked with mud is more clearly brought out.

49. The original reading here was 'confracto,' but it has been altered to 'contracto' in C and G, while E gives 'contracto' from the first hand. The general meaning seems to be that as the long pilgrimage to Rome is to one with crippled knee, so is this work to the author, with his limited powers of intellect.

56. The reading 'conturbant' in all the best MSS. seems to be a mistake.

57 f. The author is about to denounce the evils of the world and proclaim the woes which are to follow, like the writer of the Apocalypse, whose name he bears. Perhaps he may also have some thought of the formula 'seint John to borwe' by which travellers committed themselves to the protection of the saint on their setting forth: cp. *Conf. Amantis*, v. 3416.

1. The fourth year of Richard II is from June 22, 1380 to the same date of 1381. The writer here speaks of the last month of that regnal year, during which the Peasants' rising occurred.

4. Cp. Ovid, *Her.* xvii. 112, 'Praevius Aurorae Lucifer ortus erat.'

7 f. Godfrey of Viterbo, *Pantheon*, p. 24 (ed. 1584), has

'Luce diem reparat, mirandaque lumina praestat,
Sic fuga dat noctem, luxque reversa diem.'

He is speaking of the Sun generally, and the second line means 'Thus his departure produces the night and his returning light the day.' As introduced here this line is meaningless.

9. Adapted from Ovid, *Metam.* ii. 110.

11. Cp. *Metam.* vii. 703, but here 'mane' is made into the object of the verb instead of an adverb.

13. Cp. *Metam.* ii. 113.

15. Cp. *Metam.* ii. 24.

17 f. From Godfrey of Viterbo, *Pantheon*, p. 24 (ed. 1584).

21 ff. Cp. *Metam.* ii. 107 ff.,

'Aureus axis erat, temo aureus, aurea summae
Curvatura rotae, radiorum argenteus ordo.
Per iuga chrysolithi positaeque ex ordine gemmae
Clara repercusso reddebant lumina Phoebos.'

'alter ab auro' seems to mean 'different from gold.'

27. Cp. *Metam.* ii. 23.

33-60. This passage is largely from Ovid: see especially *Fasti*, i. 151 ff. and iii. 235-242, iv. 429 f., v. 213 f., *Metam.* ii. 30, *Tristia*, iii. 12. 5-8.

40. In Ovid (*Fasti*, iii. 240) it is 'Fertilis occultas invenit herba vias.' The metrical fault produced by reading 'occultam ... viam' seems to have been corrected by the author, and in G the alteration has been made by erasure, apparently in the first hand.

44. *redditus*: apparently a substantive and practically equivalent to 'reditus.'

59. Ovid, *Fasti*, v. 213 f., where however we have 'Saepeque digestos.' It is difficult to say exactly what our author meant by 'O quia.'

67. Cp. *Metam.* xiii. 395.

79 f. *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 47, ll. 9 f. (ed. Wright, Rolls Series, 59, vol. i.).

81. *irriguis*. Perhaps rather 'Fontibus irriguus, fecundus,' as given by most of the MSS.

131. *ad ymum*, 'to that low place,' i.e. his bed.

135. *Non ita ... Quin magis*: cp. ll. 264 ff., 351 ff., 442 ff., 499 ff, &c. This form of sentence is a very common one with our author and appears also in his French and English: cp. *Mirour*, 18589, *Balades*, vii. 4, xviii. 2, xxx. 2, *Conf. Amantis*, i. 718, 1259, 1319, &c.

For example, *Bal.* xviii. 2,

'Tiel esperver crieis unques ne fu,
Qe jeo ne crie plus en ma maniere.'

Conf. Amantis, i. 718 ff.,

'So lowe cowthe I nevere bowe
To feigne humilite withoute,
That me ne leste betre loute
With alle the thoghtes of myn herte.'

It is most frequent in Latin, however, and the French and English forms seem to be translations of this idiom with 'quin.'

152. 'Dreams cast the soul into wanderings': 'ruunt' is transitive, as very commonly, and apparently we must take 'vaga nonnulla' together.

155. *gravis et palpebra*, &c., 'and my heavy eyelid unclosed pondered over troubles, but no help came.' This is the best translation I can give, but the explanation of 'ex oculis' as 'away from the eyes' must be regarded as doubtful.

168. That is, on a Tuesday. It would be apparently Tuesday, June 11, 1381. The festival of Corpus Christi referred to afterwards (see l. 919), when the insurgents entered London, fell on June 13.

201. *Burnellus*: a reference to the *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 13 (Rolls Series, 59, vol. i).

205 ff. Cp. *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 13, whence several of these lines are taken.

211 f. 'They care not for the tail which He who gave them their ears implanted in them, but think it a vile thing.' The former line of the couplet is from *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 15, l. 17.

213 f. *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 15, ll. 23 f.

255. *caudas similesque draconum*, 'and tails like those of dragons.'

267. *Minos taurus*, 'the bull of Minos,' sent from the sea in answer to his prayer.

271. There is some confusion here in the author's mind between different stories, and it is difficult to say exactly what he was thinking of.

277 f. Cp. Ovid, *Metam.* xi. 34 ff.

280. *capulus*. I do not know what this is, unless it is equivalent to 'capulus,' which is rather doubtfully given by D. That would mean the 'handle' of the plough, but we have 'ansa' in l. 282.

289 f. Cp. *Pont.* i. 3. 55 f.

291. *Metam.* viii. 293.

325 ff. For this passage compare *Metam.* viii. 284 ff.

335. *Metam.* viii. 285. The Digby MS. has a rubricator's note here in the margin, 'sete. a bristell.'

341. *quod*: consecutive, 'so that'; cp. 'sic ... quod,' ll. 223, 311, &c. In the next line 'pascua' seems to be singular.

351 ff. See note on l. 135.

381. *Fasti*, ii. 767.

395. *Cutte que Curre*, 'Cut and Cur,' names for mongrel dogs.

396. As a note on 'casas' the Digby MS. has 'i.e. kenell' in the margin.

402. 'Neither does he of the mill remain at home.'

405. The rubricator of the Digby MS. has written in the margin, 'i.e. threefoted dog commyng after halting.'

407. Digby MS. rubric, 'i.e. Rig þe Teydog.' Note the position of 'que,' which should properly be attached to the first word of the line: cp. l. 847.

455. As a note on 'thalia' here (for 'talía') the Digby MS. has 'Thelea i.e. dea belli' written by the rubricator. It is difficult to conjecture what he was thinking of.

457. The Digby MS. rubricator, as a note on 'Cephali canis' has in the margin, 'i.e. stella in firmamento.'

465. 'super est' is the reading of the Glasgow MS. also.

474. *artes*. This seems to be the reading of all the MSS., though in S the word might possibly be 'arces.' I take it to mean 'devices,' in the way of traps, or ingenious hiding-places.

479. 'The grey foxes determine to leave the caverns of the wood': 'vulpes' (or rather 'vulpis') is masculine in Gower.

483. 'Henceforth neither the sheep nor the poor sheepfold are anything to them.' For this use of 'quid' with a negative cp. l. 184.

492. *solet*. The present of this verb seems often to be used by our author as equivalent to the imperfect: cp. l. 541, iii. 705, 740, &c. Also 'solebat,' i. 699, iii. 1485; cp. v. 333, where 'solebant' seems to stand for 'solent.' In other cases also the present is sometimes used for the imperfect, e.g. l. 585 'quas nuper abhorret Egiptus.'

499 ff. See 1 Sam. v. The plague of mice is distinctly mentioned in the Vulgate version, while in our translation from the Hebrew it is implied in ch. vi. 5. 'Accharon' is Ekron.

541. *solent*: see note on l. 492.

545. *Coppa*: used as a familiar name for a hen in the *Speculum Stultorum*, pp. 55, 58, and evidently connected with 'Coppen' or 'Coppe,'

which is the name of one of Chantecleer's daughters in the Low-German and English *Reynard*.

557 f. 'They determine that days are lawful for those things for which the dark form of night had often given furtive ways.'

568. *quod*: equivalent to 'vt'; cp. ll. 600, 1610.

576. G reads 'perstimulant' with CED.

579 f. See Ovid, *Metam.* vi. 366 ff. Apparently 'colonum' is for 'colonorum.'

603. *Toruu oester*: cp. *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 25.

615 f. Cp. *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 24, l. 21 f.

635. Cp. *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 25, l. 15.

637 f. *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 26,

'Haec est illa dies qua nil nisi cauda iuvabit,
Vel loca quae musca tangere nulla potest.'

652. *stramine*: probably an allusion to the name of Jack Strawe, as 'tegula' in the next couplet to Wat Tyler.

Cap. ix. *Heading*, l. 3. It seems to be implied that the jay, which must often have been kept as a cage-bird and taught to talk, was commonly called 'Wat,' as the daw was called 'Jack,' and this name together with the bird's faculty of speech has suggested the transformation adopted for Wat Tyler.

716. There is no punctuation in S, but those MSS. which have stops, as CD, punctuate after 'nephas' and 'soluit.' The line is suggested by Ovid, *Fasti*, ii. 44, 'Solve nefas, dixit; solvit et ille nefas.' There it is quite intelligible, but here it is without any clear meaning.

It may be observed here that the passage of Ovid in which this line occurs, *Fasti*, ii. 35-46, is evidently one of the sources of *Confessio Amantis*, v. 2547 ff.

749. *Sicut arena maris*: cp. Rev. xx. 8, to which reference is made below, ll. 765 ff.

762. 'All that they lay upon us, they equally bear themselves.' Apparently this is the meaning, referring to the universal ruin which is likely to ensue.

765-776. These twelve lines are taken with some alterations of wording and order from Godfrey of Viterbo, *Pantheon*, p. 228 (ed. 1584). In l. 765 the reference to the Apocalypse is to Rev. xx.

774. *forum*: apparently 'law.'

783 ff: This well-known chapter was very incorrectly printed in the Roxburghe edition, owing to the fact that a leaf has here been cut out of S, and the editor followed D. Fuller, whose translation of the opening lines has often been quoted, had a better text before him, probably that of the Cotton MS.

810. It is difficult to see how this line is to be translated, unless we suppose that 'fossa' is a grammatical oversight.

821. Cp. Ovid, *Metam.* i. 211, 'Contigerat nostras infamia temporis aures.'

849 f. Adapted from *Amores*, iii. 9. 7 f., but not very happily.

855 ff. With this passage we may compare the description in Walsingham, vol. i. p. 454, 'quorum quidam tantum baculos, quidam rubigine obductos gladios, quidam bipennes solummodo, nonnulli arcus prae vetustate factos a fumo rubicundiores ebore antiquo, cum singulis sagittis, quorum plures contentae erant una pluma, ad regnum conquaerendum convenere.'

868. The reading 'de leuitate' is given also by G.

869. *limpidiores*. The epithet is evidently derived from 1 Sam. xvii. 40, where the Vulgate has 'et elegit sibi quinque limpidissimos lapides de torrente.'

876. 'These fools boast that the earth has been wetted,' &c.

871 ff. Cp. *Metam.* xi. 29 f.

879 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 37*. One of the charges against Sir Nicholas Brembre in 1388 was that he had designed to change the name of London to 'New Troy.'

891. *siluis que palustribus*, 'from the woods and marshes.'

904. Cp. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* iii. 577 f.

909. Cp. *Metam.* viii. 421.

919. Corpus Christi day, that is Thursday, June 13.

929 f. *via salua*: apparently meaning 'Savoye,' the palace of the duke of Lancaster in the Strand. In the next line 'longum castrum' looks like 'Lancaster,' but it is difficult to say exactly what the meaning is.

931. *Baptisteqe domus*. This is the Priory of St. John of Jerusalem at Clerkenwell, which was burnt by the insurgents because of their hostility to Robert Hales, the Master of the Hospital, then Treasurer of the kingdom. Walsingham says that the fire continued here for seven days.

933-936. Ovid, *Fasti*, vi. 439 ff., where the reference is to the burning of the temple of Vesta. Hence the mention of sacred fires, which is not appropriate here.

937. *Metam.* ii. 61.

939 f. *Metam.* i. 288 f.

941 ff. This accusation, which Gower brings apparently without thinking it necessary to examine into its truth ('Est nichil vt queram,' &c.), is in direct contradiction to the statements of the chroniclers, e.g. Walsingham, i. 456 f., Knighton, ii. 135; but it is certain that dishonest persons must have taken advantage of the disorder to some extent for their own private ends, however strict the commands of the leaders may have been, and it is probable that the control which was exercised at first did not long continue. The chroniclers agree with Gower as to the drunkenness.

943 f. Ovid, *Trist.* v. 6. 39 f.

951. Ovid, *Fasti*, vi. 673.

953. *Metam.* xv. 665.

955 f. That is, the deeds of Friday (dies Veneris) were more atrocious than those of Thursday.

961 f. The construction of accusative with infinitive is here used after 'Ecce,' as if it were a verb, and 'Calcas' is evidently meant for an accusative

case. It is probable that the names here given, Calchas, Antenor, Thersites, Diomede, Ulysses, as well as those which follow in ll. 985 ff., are meant to stand for general types, rather than for particular persons connected with the government. In any case we could hardly identify them.

997. *Vix Hecube thalami*, &c. This looks like an allusion to the princess of Wales, the king's mother, whose apartments in the Tower were in fact invaded by the mob. Similarly in the lines that follow 'Helenus' stands for the archbishop of Canterbury.

1019 ff. The text of these five lines, as we find it in DTH₂, that is in its earlier form, was taken for the most part from the *Aurora* of Petrus (de) Riga, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 88 v^o,

'Non rannus pungens, set oliua uirens, set odora
Ficus, set blanda uitis abhorret eos.
Anticristus enim regit hos, nam spiritus almus,
Nam lex, nam Cristus, non dominatur eis.'

He is speaking of the parable of Jotham in the Book of Judges.

1046. *Fasti*, ii. 228.

1073. *medioque*: written apparently for 'mediaque.'

1076. *posse caret*, 'is without effect.'

1081. Cp. *Tristia*, iv. 2. 5 f.

1094. Cp. *Fasti*, i. 122.

1141. *Metam.* vi. 559.

1143. Cp. *Metam.* vii. 603.

1161. *Metam.* vii. 602. Considering that the line is borrowed from Ovid, we cannot attach much importance to it as indicating what was done with the body of the archbishop.

1173. *ostia iuris*: cp. Walsingham, i. 457, 'locum qui vocatur "Temple Barre," in quo apprenticii iuris morabantur nobiliores, diruerunt.'

1188. Cp. Ovid, *Her.* iii. 4.

1189. *Metam.* v. 41.

1193 f. Cp. *Ars Amat.* ii. 373 f., where, however, we have ‘cum rotat,’ not ‘conrotat.’

1206. *Quam periturus erat*, ‘rather than that he should perish,’ apparently.

1209. Cp. *Metam.* v. 40.

1211. *Metam.* xiv. 408.

1215 f. A reference probably to the massacre of the Flemings.

1219 f. *Fasti*, iii. 509 f.

1221 f. Ovid, *Amores*, iii. 9. 11 f.

1224. Cp. *Her.* v. 68.

1253. Cp. *Metam.* vii. 599, ‘Exiguo tinxit subiectos sanguine cultros.’

1271. Perhaps ‘cessit’ is right, as in l. 1265, but the reading of C is the result of a correction, and the corrections of this manuscript are usually sound.

1279 f. If there is any construction here, it must be ‘Erumpunt lacrimae luminibus, que lumina,’ &c. For this kind of ellipse cp. l. 1501.

1283. Cp. *Her.* viii. 77.

1289. *Metam.* ix. 775.

Cap. xvi. *Heading*, l. 1. *quasi in propria persona*: cf. *Conf. Amantis*, i. 60, *margin*, ‘Hic quasi in persona aliorum quos amor alligat, fingens se auctor esse Amantem,’ &c. The author takes care to guard his readers against a too personal application of his descriptions.

1359. Cp. Ovid, *Metam.* xiv. 198. In the lines that follow our author has rather ingeniously appropriated several other expressions from the same story of Ulysses and Polyphemus.

1363 f. *Ars Amat.* iii. 723 f.

1365. *Metam.* xiv. 206.

1369. *Metam.* xiv. 200.

1379 f. Cp. *Tristia*, v. 4. 33 f.

1385 f. *Her.* xx. 91 f.

1387. Cp. *Metam.* xiv. 120.

1395. Cp. *Metam.* iv. 723.

1397 f. Cp. *Tristia*, i. 3. 53 f.

1401 f. Cp. *Fasti*, v. 315 f.

1403. Cp. *Metam.* xv. 27.

1413 f. *Pont.* i. 3. 57 f.

1420. Cp. *Her.* iii. 24, used here with a change of meaning.

1424. Cp. *Ars Amat.* ii. 88, 'Nox oculis pavidō venit oborta metu.'

1425 f. *Pont.* i. 2. 45 f.

1429 f. Cp. *Pont.* i. 2. 49 f.

1433. *Metam.* iii. 709.

1442. Cp. *Her.* v. 14, where we have 'Mixtaque' instead of 'Copula.'

1445 ff. Cp. *Metam.* xiv. 214-216.

1453. Adapted from *Metam.* iv. 263, 'Rore mero lacrimisque suis
ieiunia pavit.' The change of 'mero' to 'meo' involves a tasteless alteration
of the sense, while the sound is preserved.

1459. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 581.

1465. *Metam.* ii. 656. Our author has borrowed the line without
supplying an appropriate context, and the result is nonsense. Ovid has

'Suspirat ab imis
Pectoribus, lacrimaeque genis labuntur obortae.'

1467 f. *Pont.* i. 2. 29 f.

1469. Cp. *Metam.* xiii. 539.

1473. Ovid, *Metam.* viii. 469.

1475. *Metam.* iv. 135, borrowed without much regard to the context.

1485. From Ovid, *Her.* xiv. 37, where however we have ‘calor,’ not ‘color,’ a material difference.

1496. *Her.* v. 46.

1497. The expression ‘verbis solabar amicis’ is from Ovid (*Fasti*, v. 237), but here ‘solabar’ seems to be made passive in sense.

1501 f. i.e. ‘cessat amor eius qui prius,’ &c., with a rather harsh ellipse of the antecedent. The couplet is a parody of Ovid, *Pont.* iv. 6. 23 f.,

‘Nam cum praestiteris verum mihi semper amorem,
Hic tamen adverso tempore crevit amor.’

1503 f. Cp. *Tristia*, iii. i. 65 f.,

‘Quaerebam fratres, exceptis scilicet illis,
Quos suus optaret non genuisse pater.’

1506. *Fasti*, i. 148, not very appropriate here.

1512. *Her.* xi. 82.

1514. Cp. *Her.* xiii. 86, ‘Substitit auspicii lingua timore mali.’

1517 f. Cp. *Her.* iii. 43 f.

1519. Cp. *Pont.* iii. 4. 75.

1521. Cp. *Tristia*, i. 11. 23.

1534. Cp. *Tristia*, v. 4. 4, ‘Heu quanto melior sors tua sorte mea est.’

1535 ff. Cp. *Tristia*, iii. 3. 39 ff.

1539 f. *Tristia*, iii. 3. 29 f.

1541. *scis quia*: ‘quia’ for ‘quod,’ cp. l. 1593; ‘puto quod,’ i. Prol. 15, &c.

1549. Cp. *Fasti*, i. 483.

1564. *Her.* xiv. 52.

1565 f. Cp. *Her.* x. 113 f. The lines are not very appropriate here.

1568. See note on l. 1420.

1569. Cp. *Metam.* iii. 396.

1571. Cp. *Metam.* xiv. 210.

1573. Cp. *Metam.* vii. 614.

1575. Cp. *Metam.* ix. 583.

1581. *Obice singultu*, that is, 'Impediente singultu': cp. *Cronica Tripertita*, ii. 3.

1585. *Metam.* xiv. 217.

1589. *Tristia*, i. 5. 45.

1593. *vidi quia*: cp. l. 1541.

1609. *quid agant alii*, 'whatever others may do.'

1612. Cp. *Her.* xix. 52.

1615 f. It seems probable that this is a prayer to the Virgin Mary, whose name 'Star of the Sea' was used long before the fourteenth century, e.g.

'Praevia stella maris de mundo redde procella
Tutos: succurre, praevia stella maris,'

in an address to the Virgin by Eberhard (date 1212) in Leyser, *Poet. Med. Aevi*, p. 834, and the name occurs also in Peter Damian's hymns (xi. cent.). For Gower's use of the expression cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 29925, 'O de la mer estoille pure,' and later in this book, l. 2033, 'Stella, Maria, maris.' Here, however, we might translate, 'Be thou a star of the sea going before me,' taking it as a prayer to Christ.

1623. *Metam.* i. 265.

1627. *Extra se positus*, 'beside himself.'

1630. *Fasti*, iv. 386.

1631. Cp. *Metam.* i. 282.

1635. Cp. *Metam.* i. 269.

1637. Cp. *Metam.* i. 270.

1653 ff. From this point to the end of the chapter the description is mostly taken from Ovid, *Metam.* xi. 480-523, many hexameters being appropriated without material change, e.g. ll. 480, 482, 484, 486, 488, 491, 492, 495, 499, 501, 516, 517, 519 f.

1689. The line is taken away from its context, and consequently gives no sense. In Ovid it is,

‘Ipse pavet, nec se qui sit status ipse fatetur
Scire ratis rector.’—*Metam.* xi. 492.

1693. *Metam.* i. 292.

1695. From Peter Riga, *Aurora*, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 16 v^o.

1697-1700. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 15 v^o,

‘Fontes ingresso Noe corrumpuntur abyssi,
Et de uisceribus terra fluenta uomit.
Effundunt nubes pluuias, deciesque quaternis
Sustinet inmensas archa diebus aquas.’

1717 f. Cp. Ovid, *Metam.* iv. 689 f.

1719. Cp. *Metam.* iv. 706 f. Ovid has ‘praefixo,’ which is more satisfactory.

1721. Cp. *Metam.* iv. 690.

1727 f. *Tristia*, i. 11. 21 f.

1729. *Fasti*, iii. 593.

1735. *Metam.* xi. 539.

1739. Cp. *Metam.* xi. 515, ‘Rima patet, praebetque viam letalibus undis.’

1774. Cp. *Fasti*, ii. 98.

1775 f. Cp. *Amores*, ii. 11. 9 f.

1779 f. *Tristia*, v. 12. 5 f.

1781. *Metam.* xiv. 213.

1825. Cp. *Tristia*, ii. 179.

1832. *Tristia*, i. 5. 36.

1847 f. Cp. Ovid, *Pont.* iii. 7. 27 f. In the second line Ovid has 'tumidis,' for which there is no authority in Gower. Our author perhaps read 'timidis' in his copy of Ovid, or made the change himself, taking 'timidis' to mean 'fearful.'

1879. 'Perhaps that day would have been the last of confusion, even if,' &c. This, by the context, would seem to be the meaning.

1898. Ovid, *Fasti*, iv. 542.

1899 f. Cp. *Pont.* i. 3. 9 f.

1907 f. From Godfrey of Viterbo, *Pantheon*, p. 82 (ed. 1584).

1909. 'But he who walked upon the sea,' &c., that is, Christ.

1913. Cp. *Metam.* i. 328, 'Nubila disiecit, nimisque Aquilone remotis.'

1917. *Metam.* i. 329.

1919. Cp. *Metam.* i. 345.

1921. Cp. *Metam.* v. 286, where we have 'nubila,' as the sense requires. Here the MSS. give 'numina' without variation.

1923. Cp. *Metam.* ix. 795.

1925. *Metam.* i. 344.

1935. *Metam.* xiii. 440.

1939. *Metam.* xiii. 419.

1944. *Quam prius*: for 'prius quam,' as often.

1963 f. This alludes to the supposed reply made to Brutus (son of Silvius), when he consulted the oracle of Diana in the island of Leogecia, 'Brute, sub occasum solis,' &c., as told by Geoffrey of Monmouth.

1979 f. Ovid, *Pont.* iii. 8. 15 f.

1991 ff. Cp. *Tristia*, i. 11. 25 ff.

1997 f. *Tristia*, iii. 2. 25 f.

2001 f. Cp. *Her.* xi. 27 f.

2003 f. *Her.* xiv. 39 f.

2029 f. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 119 f.

2031 f. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 531 f.

2033 f. Cp. *Her.* ii. 123 f.

2037 f. *Pont.* iv. 3. 49 f.

2043. Cp. *Pont.* i. 4. 21. In Ovid we read ‘animus quoque pascitur illis,’ and this probably was what Gower intended to write.

2071 f. Cp. *Pont.* ii. 7. 9 f.

2074. *Pont.* ii. 7. 8.

2091. Cp. *Hist. Apollonii Tyrii*, xli, ‘Sicut rosa in spinis nescit compungi mucrone.’

2139. Cp. *Pont.* i. 5. 47.

2150. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 484.

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15. Cp. *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 11, l. 41 (Rolls Series, 59, vol. i.).

41. Deut. xxxii. 13, ‘ut sugeret mel de petra oleumque de saxo durissimo.’

49 f. Cp. *Fasti*, i. 73 f.

51. The supposed mischief-maker is compared to Sinon, who gave a signal by fire which led to the destruction of Troy: cp. *Conf. Amantis*, i. 1172. I cannot satisfactorily explain ‘Excetra.’

57 f. From Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 175 (ed. Wright, Rolls Series, 59, vol. ii.).

61. *De modicis ... modicum*: cp. *Mirour de l’Omme*, 16532.

64. Cp. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* ii. 166.

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With the general drift of what follows cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 529 ff.

1. *Incausti specie*, cp. *Conf. Amantis*, viii. 2212.

18. *nos*: meaning the people of England, as compared with those of other countries.

31 f. Cp. Ovid, *Tristia*, v. 8. 19 f.

33. *Tristia*, v. 5. 47.

41. Job v. 6, 'Nihil in terra sine causa fit': cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 26857.

59. This is the usual opposition of rose and nettle, based perhaps originally on Ovid, *Rem. Amoris*, 46: cp. *Conf. Amantis*, ii. 401 ff.

67 f. Cp. Boethius, *Consol. Phil.* 2 Pr. 4, 'in omni adversitate fortunae infelicissimum genus est infortunii fuisse felicem.' So Dante, *Inf.* v. 121 ff.,

'Nessun maggior dolore,
Che ricordarsi del tempo felice
Nella miseria.'

117 ff. Cp. Ovid, *Her.* v. 109 ff. In l. 117 'siccis' is substituted, not very happily, for 'suci.'

138. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Latin Verses after ii. 1878,

'Quod patet esse fides in eo fraus est, que politi
Principium pacti finis habere negat.'

163 f. Cp. Ovid, *Tristia*, v. 8. 15 f.

167 ff. Cp. *Tristia*, i. 5. 27 ff.

199 f. There seems to be no grammatical construction here.

239 ff. With this passage cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 27013 ff., where nearly the same examples are given. The classification is according to the nature of the things affected, first the heavenly bodies, then the elements of air, water,

fire and earth, and finally living creatures. This arrangement is more clearly brought out in the *Mirour*.

259. Cp. *Mirour*, 27031, and note.

261. 'And from the hard rocks of the desert,' the conjunction being out of its proper place, as in i. 407, 847, ii. 249, &c.

267 f. Cp. *Mirour*, 27049 ff.

281 ff. See *Mirour de l'Omme*, 27073 ff.

282. *Congelat*, 'took form.' Probably the author had in his mind the phrase 'congelat aere tacto,' Ovid, *Metam.* xv. 415.

306. 'num' is here for 'nonne'; cp. l. 320.

316. *Cumque*, for 'Cum': cp. l. 545, iii. 958, &c.

353 f. Cp. Godfrey of Viterbo, *Pantheon*, p. 9 (ed. 1584).

'Ante creaturam genitor deus et genitura,
Primaque natura, novit statuitque futura.'

357-359. These three lines are from the *Pantheon*, p. 9.

371-374. Taken with slight change from the *Pantheon*, p. 10.

377 f. From *Aurora*, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 7 v^o.

414. 'That which the new star brings argues that he is God.'

423. That is, 'Lux venit, vt obscurari possit tenebris,' &c.

485. 'Every one who thinks upon Jesus ought to resolve to lay aside,' &c.

487. The MSS. give 'benedicti,' but it seems probable that 'benedici' was meant. The verb is commonly transitive in later Latin.

495 ff. Cp. Isaiah, xliv. 9-20.

531 f. Psalms, cxiii. 8.

619 ff. Cp. Ovid, *Metam.* i. 74 ff.

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11 ff. The author characteristically takes care to point out that in his criticism of the Church he is expressing not his own private opinion, but the 'commune dictum,' the report which went abroad among the people, and the 'vox populi' has for him always a high authority. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 18445 ff., 19057 ff., and see below, l. 1267 ff, iv. 19 f., 709 f.

With what is said in this Book of the condition of the Church and the clergy we may compare the author's *Mirour de l'Omme*, 18421-20832.

25 f. Compare with this the author's note on *Mirour de l'Omme*, 21266-78.

61. Cp. Ovid, *Pont.* iv. 14. 41.

64. Cp. *Pont.* iv. 9. 10.

67 f. Cp. *Tristia*, ii. 301 f.

82. Cp. *Pont.* ii. 2. 128.

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1-28. The form of these lines which stood originally in S is given by the Trinity College, Dublin, and the Hatfield MSS. The passage has been rewritten over erasure in CHG, and it must be left doubtful what text they had originally. From the fact that the erasure in G begins with the second line, it may seem more probable that the original text of this manuscript agreed with that which we have now in S, rather than with TH₂: for in the latter case there would have been no need to begin the erasure before l. 4. In CH the whole passage has been recopied (the same hand appearing here in the two MSS.) so that we can draw no conclusion about the point where divergence actually began. EDL have the same text by first hand. It will be noted that the lines as given by TH₂ make no mention of the schism of the Papacy.

11 ff. With this we may compare *Mirour de l'Omme*, 18769 ff.

22. *nisi*, for 'nil nisi': cp. l. 32.

41. Cp. Ovid, *Amores*, iii. 8. 55.

63. *Fasti*, i. 225.

65 f. Cp. *Fasti*, i. 249 f.

85-90. Chiefly from the *Aurora* of Petrus (de) Riga, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 71,

‘Ollarum carnes, peponum fercula, porros,
Cepas pro manna turba gulosa petit.
Quosdam consimiles sinus ecclesie modo nutrit,
Qui pro diuinis terrea uana petunt.
.
.
.
.
.
Carnes ollarum carnalia facta figurant
Que uelut in nostra carne libido coquit.’

It would seem that Gower read ‘Gebas’ (which has no meaning) for ‘Cepas’ and ‘preponunt,’ as in MS. Univ. Coll. 143, for ‘peponum,’ which is the true reading, meaning ‘melons’ or ‘pumpkins.’

115. Cp. *Metam.* xv. 173.

Cap. iii. *Heading*. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 288 (margin), where this is given as a quotation from Gregory.

141 f. Cp. *Mirour de l’Omme*, 18553.

167 f. From *Aurora*, f. 37.

175. *gregis ex pietate mouetur*, ‘is moved by pity for his flock.’

193 ff. With this passage compare *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 407-413, and *Mirour de l’Omme*, 20161 ff. In all these places a distinct charge is brought against the clergy, to the effect that they encourage vice, in order to profit by it themselves in money and in influence: ‘the prostitute is more profitable to them than the nun,’ as our author significantly says in the *Mirour* (20149).

209 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l’Omme*, 20113 ff.

227 ff. For this attack on the ‘positive law’ of the Church cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 247, *Mirour*, 18469 ff. The ‘lex positiva’ is that which is enjoined not as of inherent moral obligation, but as imposed by Church discipline.

249 f. Cp. *Mirour*, 18997 ff. Apparently ‘nouo’ is an adverb, meaning ‘anew,’ ‘again’: cp. 284, 376.

265 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 18505 ff.

283 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 18637, *Conf. Amantis*, ii. 3486.

329 ff. With this chapter compare *Mirour*, 18649-18732.

375. The note which we find here in the margin of SCHGD refers to the crusade of the bishop of Norwich in Flanders in the year 1383, which probably took place soon after the completion of our author’s book. It is added in SCHG in what appears to be one and the same hand, possibly that of the author himself. If we may judge by the manner in which the campaign in question is referred to by contemporary chroniclers, it seems to have been considered a public scandal by many others besides Gower.

419. Gower uses ‘sublimo’ as an ablat. sing, in l. 701; therefore ‘sublimis’ may here be an ablative plural agreeing with ‘meritis.’

425 ff. Cp. *Aurora*, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 103,

‘Cogitat inde domum domino fundare, sed audit
A domino, “Templi non fabricator eris.
Es uir sanguineus, ideo templum mihi dignum
Non fabricare potes, filius immo tuus.”
Sanguineus uir signat eum qui, crimina carnis
Amplectens, templum non ualet esse dei.
Ecclesie sancte talis non erigit edem,
Nec sacre fidei collocat ille domum.’

508. ‘And whosoever may sound trumpets, we ought to be silent’; cp. i. 1609.

531 f. *Aurora*, f. 75 v^o.

619 f. Ovid, *Pont.* ii. 5. 61 f.

623 f. *Pont.* ii. 6. 21 f.

641. See *Ars Amat.* ii. 417, where we find ‘semine,’ a reading which is required by the sense, but not given in the Gower MSS.

651. 'The line of descent by right of his mother proclaims Christ to be heir of that land in which he was born.' The author argues for crusades to recover the Holy Land, if there must be wars, instead of wars against fellow Christians, waged by one pope against the other under the name of crusades: cp. below, 945 ff.

676. *quo foret ipse vigil*, 'where it ought to be watchful,' a common use of the imperfect subjunctive in our author's Latin: cp. 'gestaret,' 695, 'lederet,' 922, 'medicaret,' 1052.

815. What follows is spoken as in the person of the supreme pontiff: cp. *Mirour*, 18505-18792, where somewhat similar avowals are put into the mouth of a member of the Roman Court.

819 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 261,

'The hevene is ferr, the world is nyh.'

835. Ovid, *Fasti*, v. 209.

955 f. I take this concluding couplet as a remark made by the author on the sentiments which he has just heard expressed by the representative of the Pope. It practically means that 'Clemens' is not a proper name for the Pope: it is in fact a 'headless name' and should rather be 'Inclemens.' Compare the address to Innocent III at the beginning of Geoffrey de Vinsauf's *Poetria Nova*:

'Papa, stupor mundi, si dixero Papa *nocenti*,
Acephalum nomen tribuam tibi: si caput addam,
Hostis erit metri,' &c.

957 ff. It seems best to take what follows as, in part at least, a dialogue between the author and the representative of the pope, who has just spoken. Soon however the speech passes again entirely to the author. The Biblical reference here is to Revelation, xxii. 8 f. The same use is made of it in the *Mirour*, 18736 ff.

1077-1080. These four lines are from the *Aurora*, f. 44 v^o.

1113 f. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* iii. 595 f. (where we have 'sequatur'). The original application is to the effects of rivalry in stimulating the passion of

lovers. For the use of 'sequetur' here, apparently as a subjunctive, compare l. 1946, 'Inueniet tardam ne sibi lentus opem.'

1118-1124. These lines are almost entirely borrowed from the *Aurora*, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 21 v^o.

1124. In the Glasgow MS. 'Est' has been here altered to 'Et.'

1145-1150. Almost verbatim from *Aurora*, f. 93 v^o.

1169. S has here in the margin in a somewhat later hand than that of the text, 'Nota hic quattuor neccessaria episcopo.'

1171 f. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 44 v^o,

'Est olei natura triplex, lucet, cybat, unguet;
Hec tria mitratum debet habere capud.'

1183 f. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 44 v^o,

'Lux est exemplo, cibus est dum pascit egenos,
Vnctio dum populis dulcia uerba ferit.'

Gower is right in reading 'serit,' which is given in MS. Univ. Coll. 143, f. 13.

1206. Cp. l. 1376.

1213. Cp. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* iii. 655.

1215 f. Cp. *Ars Amat.* iii. 653 f.

1233. Cp. *Ars Amat.* ii. 279.

1247 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 18793 ff.

1267. *Vox populi*, &c.: cp. *Speculum Stultorum*, p. 100, l. 4, and see also the note on iii. Prol. 11.

1271. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 304 ff. and *Mirour*, 18805.

1313. With the remainder of this Book, treating of the secular clergy, we may compare *Mirour de l'Omme*, 20209-20832.

1341. Cp. *Mirour*, 18889 ff.

1342. *participaret*, 'he ought to share': see note on l. 676.

1359 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, i. 1258 ff.

1375 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 20287 ff.

1376. The reading 'vngat vt' is given by the Digby MS. and seems almost necessary: cp. l. 1206.

1405. *prece ruffi ... et albi*, 'by reason of the petition of the red and the white,' that is, presumably, by the influence of gold and silver, 'dominis' in the next line being in a loose kind of apposition to a dative case suggested by 'Annuit.'

1407. S has here in the margin, in a rather later hand, 'contra rectores Oxon.'

1417. Eccles. iv. 10, 'Vae soli, quia cum ceciderit, non habet sublevantem se.'

1432. The margin of S has here, in the same hand as at 1407, 'Nota rectores et studentes Oxon.'

1443. *formalis*, that is, 'eminent,' from 'forma' meaning 'rank' or 'dignity,' but here also opposed to 'materialis.'

1454. Originally the line was 'Dum legit, inde magis fit sibi sensus hebes,' but this was altered to 'plus sibi sensus hebes est,' with the idea apparently of taking 'magis' with 'legit.' This involves an awkward metrical licence, 'hebes est' equivalent to 'hebest,' and the original text stands in CEH as well as in TH₂. The expedient of the Roxburghe editor is quite inexcusable.

1493 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 20314. The sporting parson was quite a recognized figure in the fourteenth century. Readers of Froissart will remember how when the capture of Terry in Albigeois was effected by stratagem, the blowing of the horn to summon the company in ambush was attributed by those at the gate to a priest going out into the fields, 'Ah that is true, it was sir Francis our priest; gladly he goeth a mornings to seek for an hare.'

1498. *fugat*: used apparently as subjunctive also in l. 2078, but it is possible that 'Nec fugat' may be the true reading here.

1509 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 20313 ff.

1527. *Est sibi missa*, 'his mass is over.'

1546. Apparently a proverbial expression used of wasting valuable things.

1549. If benefices went from father to son, little or nothing would be gained by those who go to Rome to seek preferment, for an heir would seldom fail.

1555 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 20497 ff. The priests here spoken of are the 'annuelers,' who get their living by singing masses for the dead, the 'Annua seruicia' spoken of below:

'Et si n'ont autre benefice,
Chantont par auns et par quartiers
Pour la gent mort.' *Mirour*, 20499.

1559. In the *Mirour*,

'Plus que ne firont quatre ainçois' (20527).

1587-1590. Taken with slight change from *Aurora*, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 65 v^o.

1591. 'With the ancients it is possible to say "hic et hec sacerdos,"' that is, 'sacerdos' is both masculine and feminine.

1693-1700. Adapted from *Aurora*, f. 65,

'Omen in urbe malum bubo solis iubar odit,
Escam uestigat nocte, ueretur aues:
In quem forte gregis auium si lumina figant,
Et clamando uolant et laniando secant.
Incestus notat iste reos, qui corpore fed
Contra nature iura latenter agunt:
Hos iusti quasi lucis aues discerpere querunt,
Zelo succensi uerba seuera serunt.'

('Conclamando' for 'Et clamando' in MS. Univ. Coll. 143.)

1727 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 20713 ff.

1759 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 20725 ff.,

‘Ne sont pas un, je suis certains,
Ly berchiers et ly chapelleins,
Ne leur pecché n’est pas egal,
L’un poise plus et l’autre meinz,’ &c.

1775. *fierent*, ‘ought to become’: cp. l. 1789.

1791-1794 are from *Aurora*, f. 93 v^o, and the succeeding couplet is adapted from the same source, where we have,

‘De lino que fit per ephot caro munda notatur,
Nam tales seruos Cristus habere cupit.’

1797. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 46 v^o,

‘Balteus ex bysso tunicam constringit honeste.’

1799 f. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 45 v^o.

1801 f.

‘In medio tunice capitale ligat sibi presul,
Vt capitis sensus non sinat ire uagos.’ *Aurora*, f. 46.

1807 f.

‘Aurum ueste gerit presul, cum splendet in illo
Pre cunctis rutilans clara sophia patris.’ *Aurora*, f. 45.

1809 ff.

‘Ne tunice leuiter possit ruptura minari,
Illius in gyro texilis ora micat:
A grege ne presul se disrumpat, set honestus
Ad finem mores pertrahat, ista notant.’ *Aurora*, f. 46.

1813 f. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 46 v^o.

1815-1818.

‘Aaron et natis uestes texuntur, ut horum
Quisque sacerdotis possit honore frui.
Nam modo presbiteri, seu summi siue minores,
Conficiunt Cristi corpus idemque sacrant.’
Aurora, f. 45.

1823 f. *Aurora*, f. 43 v^o.

1841-1848. These eight lines are taken with insignificant changes from the *Aurora*, f. 63 v^o.

1853. The reference here given by Gower to the *Aurora* of Petrus (de) Riga has led to the tracing of a good many passages of the *Vox Clamantis*, besides the present one, to that source.

1863-1884. These lines are almost entirely from *Aurora*, ff. 66 v^o, 67. The arrangement of the couplets is somewhat different, and there are a few slight variations, which are noted below as they occur.

1866. *eius*: ‘illud,’ *Aurora*, f. 67.

1868. *tumet*: ‘timet,’ *Aurora*. (MS. Bodley 822), but Gower’s reading is doubtless the more correct.

1871. *nimio*: ‘magno,’ *Aurora*.

1872. *ipse*: ‘esse,’ *Aurora*.

1876. *ligante*: ‘trahente,’ *Aurora*, f. 66 v^o.

1878. *tardat ad omne bonum*: ‘ad bona nulla ualet,’ *Aurora*.

1880. *Lumina nec*: ‘Nec faciem,’ *Aurora*, f. 67.

1881 f.

‘Per pinguem scabiem succensa libido notatur;
Feruet vel fetet corpus utroque malo.’
Aurora, f. 67.

1885 ff. Our author still borrows from the same source, though from a different part of it. We find these lines nearly in the same form in the *Aurora*, f. 103,

‘Oza manus tendens accessit ut erigat archam,
Set mox punita est arida facta manus.
Hinc ideo dicunt meruisse necem, quia nocte
Transacta cohitu coniugis usus erat.
Declaratur in hoc quod si pollutus ad aram
Accedas, mortis uulnere dignus eris.’

1891 f.

‘Namque superiectas sordes detergere pure
Nescit nostra manus, si tenet illa lutum.’ *Aurora*, f. 103.

1905-1908. These two couplets are from *Aurora*, f. 69 v^o, where however they are separated by four lines not here given.

1911 ff. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 69 v^o,

‘Radices non extirpat rasura pilorum,
Set rasi crescunt fructificantque pyli.
Sic licet expellas omnes de pectore motus,
Non potes hinc penitus cuncta fugare tamen.
Hec de carne trahis, quia semper alit caro pugnans;
Intus habes cum quo prelia semper agas.’

Gower’s reading ‘pugnam’ in l. 1915 is probably right.

1937. Ovid, *Rem. Amoris*, 669.

1939. *Tristia*, iv. 6. 33 f.

1943 f. *Rem. Amoris*, 89 f.

1945 f. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 115 f.

1946. *Inueniet*: apparently meant for subjunctive; cp. l. 1114.

1947-1950. *Rem. Amoris*, 81-84.

1952. Cp. *Her.* xvii. 190.

1953. *Rem. Amoris*, 229.

1955 f. *Rem. Amoris*, 139 f.

1999 f.

‘Cum sale uas mittens in aquas Helyseus, easdem
Sanat, nec remanet gustus amarus aquis.’ *Aurora*, f. 140.

2001. *Aurora*, f. 60 v^o.

2017-2020. From *Aurora*, f. 8.

2035-2040. From *Aurora*, f. 15 v^o, but one couplet is omitted, and so the sense is obscured. After ‘sunt sine felle boni’ (l. 2038), the original has,

‘Cras canit hinc coruus, hodie canit inde columba;
Hec vox peruersis, congruit illa bonis.
Cras prauum cantant, dum se conuertere tardant,
Set tales tollit sepe suprema dies.’

The meaning is that the bad priests cry ‘Cras,’ like crows, and encourage men to put off repentance, while the others sing ‘Hodie,’ like doves, the words ‘cras’ and ‘hodie’ being imitations of the notes of the two birds. The expression ‘Cras primam cantant,’ in l. 2039, is not intelligible, and probably Gower missed the full sense of the passage.

2045. ‘sit’ has been altered in S from ‘fit.’

2049 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l’Omme*, 20785 ff.

2071. Cp. *Mirour*, 20798.

2078. *fugat*: cp. l. 1498.

2097 f. Cp. iv. 959 and note.

LIB. IV.

The matter of this book corresponds to that of the *Mirour de l'Omme*, ll. 20833-21780.

19 f. Cp. Lib. iii. Prol. 11.

34. 'dompnus' or 'domnus' was the form of 'dominus' which was properly applied as a title to ecclesiastical dignitaries, and it seems to have been especially used in monasteries. Ducange quotes John of Genoa as follows: 'Domnus et Domna per syncopen proprie convenit claustralibus; sed Dominus, Domina mundanis.' Cp. l. 323 of this book and also 327 ff.

57. *humeris qui ferre solebat*, 'who used to bear burdens,' as a labourer.

87. Cp. Godfrey of Viterbo, *Pantheon*, p. 74 (ed. 1584).

91. *Pantheon*, p. 74.

109 f. Cp. Ovid, *Fasti*, i. 205 f.

111. *Ars Amat.* ii. 475, but Ovid has 'cubilia.'

112. Cp. *Fasti*, iv. 396, 'Quas tellus nullo sollicitante dabat.' Gower has not improved the line by his changes.

114. *Fasti*, iv. 400.

115. *Metam.* i. 104, but Ovid has of course 'fraga.'

117. Cp. *Metam.* i. 106, 'Et quae deciderant patula Iovis arbore glandes': 'patule glandes' is nonsense.

119. Cp. *Metam.* i. 103.

128. A play on the word 'regula': 're' has been taken away and there remains only 'gula.'

145. Cp. *Metam.* viii. 830.

147. *Metam.* viii. 835.

151 ff. Cp. *Metam.* viii. 837 ff.

163. Cp. *Ars Amat.* iii. 647.

165 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 473 ff.

175. *Ars Amat.* iii. 503 f., but Ovid has 'Gorgoneo saevius,' for 'commota lenius.'

177. Cp. *Metam.* viii. 465, 'Saepe suum fervens oculis dabat ira ruborem.' The reading 'oculis' is necessary to the sense and appears in one manuscript.

179. Cp. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* iii. 509.

215. 'corrodium' (or 'corredium') is the allowance made from the funds of a religious house for the sustentation of a member of it or of someone else outside the house: see Ducange under 'conredium' and *New Engl. Dict.* 'corrody.' Gower himself perhaps had in his later life a corrody in the Priory of Saint Mary Overey, of which he was a benefactor.

302. The reference is to Ecclus. xix. 27, 'Amictus corporis et risus dentium et ingressus hominis enunciant de eo.' Cp. *Confessio Amantis*, i. 2705, margin.

305-310. *Aurora*, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 65,

'Est nigra coruus auis et predo cadaueris, illum
Quem male denigrat ceca cupido notans.

.
Sub uolucrum specie descripsit legifer illos,
Quos mundanus honos ad scelus omne trahit.
Hunc aliquem tangit qui religionis amictum
Se tegit, ut cicius possit honore frui.'

(MS. Univ. Coll. 143: 'libido' for 'cupido,' 'amictu' for 'amictum,' 'maius' for 'cicuis').

311. Cp. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* iii. 249, 'Turpe pecus mutilum,' &c. The word 'monstrum' in Gower came probably from a corruption in his copy of Ovid.

327 ff. With this chapter compare *Mirour de l'Omme*, 21133 ff. The capital letters of 'Paciens,' 'Castus,' 'Luxus,' &c. are supplied by the editor, being clearly required by the sense.

354. *Apocapata*, 'cut short': cp. 'per apocapen,' v. 820.

363 f. The habit described is that of the Canons of the order of St. Augustine.

395. Cp. Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 175 (Rolls Series, 59, vol. ii),

‘Vovistis, fratres, vovistis; vestra, rogamus,
Vivite solliciti reddere vota deo.

397. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 176.

401. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 178.

403 f. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 177.

405-430. Most of this is taken from Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 176.

425. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* ii. 465.

427. *foret*, ‘should be,’ i.e. ‘ought to be.’

431-446. Taken with slight alterations from *De Vita Monachorum*, pp. 187, 188.

442 f. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 188.

449 Cp. Ovid, *Fasti*, ii. 85,

‘Saepe sequens agnam lupus est a voce retentus.’

Our author has interchanged the sexes for the purpose of his argument, the man being represented as a helpless victim.

450. The subject to be supplied must be ‘agnus.’

451. Cp. *Ars Amat.* iii. 419.

453 f. *Tristia*, i. 6. 9 f.

461-466. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 188.

469-490. Nearly the whole of this is taken from Neckam, p. 178.

537 f. Cp. Ovid, *Rem. Amoris*, 235 f.,

‘Adspicis ut prensos urant iuga prima iuencos,
Et nova velocem cingula laedat equum?’

575. Cp. *Amores*, iii. 4. 17.

587. 'Genius' is here introduced as the priest of Venus and in l. 597 in the character of a confessor, as afterwards in the *Confessio Amantis*. The reference to the 'poets' in the marginal note can hardly be merely to the *Roman de la Rose*, where Genius is the priest and confessor of Nature, but the variation 'secundum Ouidium' of the Glasgow MS. does not seem to be justified by any passage of Ovid. The connexion with Venus obviously has to do with the classical idea of Genius as a god who presides over the begetting of children: cp. Isid. *Etym.* viii. 88. The marginal note in S is written in a hand probably different from that of the text, but contemporary.

617 f. Cp. *Ars Amat.* ii. 649 f.,

'Dum novus in viridi coalescit cortice ramus,
Concutiat tenerum quaelibet aura, cadet.'

623. *Spiritus est promptus*, &c. Gower apparently took this text to mean, 'the spirit is ready to do evil, *and* the flesh is weak': cp. *Mirour*, 14165.

624. Cp. *Mirour*, 16768.

637. For this use of 'quid' cp. that of 'numquid,' ii. Prol. 59, and v. 279.

648. Rev. xiv. 4, 'Hi sequuntur agnum ... quocunque ierit.'

657 f. Apparently referring to Rev. xii. 14.

659. Cp. the Latin Verses after *Confessio Amantis*, v. 6358.

681 f. Cp. Ovid, *Pont.* iv. 4. 3 f.

689 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 21266, margin.

699. *fore*: used here and elsewhere by our author for 'esse'; see below, l. 717, and v. 763.

715. *Acephalum*. This name was applied in early times to ecclesiastics who were exempt from the authority of the bishop: see Ducange. The word is differently used in iii. 956, and by comparison with that passage we might be led to suppose that there was some reference here to the 'inopes' and 'opem' of the next line.

723 ff. Compare with this the contemporary accounts of the controversy between FitzRalph, archbishop of Armagh, and the Mendicant Friars, who are said to have bribed the Pope to confirm their privileges (Walsingham, i. 285), and the somewhat prejudiced account of their faults in Walsingham, ii. 13. The influence of the Dominican Rushook, as the king's confessor was the subject of much jealousy in the reign of Richard II.

735 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 21469 ff.

736. *sepulta*: used elsewhere by Gower for 'funeral rites,' e.g. i. 1170. The meaning is that the friar claims to perform the funeral services for the dead bodies of those whose confessor he has been before death. Perhaps however we should take 'sepulta' here as equivalent to 'sepelienda.'

769. Hos. iv. 8: cp. *Mirour*, 21397, where the saying is attributed to Zephaniah.

777 f. Cp. Ovid, *Tristia*, i. 9. 7 f.

781. *Tristia*, i. 9. 9.

784. Cp. *Fasti*, v. 354.

788. See *Mirour*, 21625 ff. and note.

795. 'Prioris' in S, but it is evidently an adjective here.

813 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 21499 ff.

847. The wording is suggested by 1 Cor. ix. 24, 'ii qui in stadio currunt, omnes quidem currunt, sed unus accipit bravium.'

864. *Titiuillus*: see note in Dyce's edition of Skelton, vol. ii. pp. 284 f.

869. Cp. Job ii. 4, 'Pellem pro pelle, et cuncta quae habet homo, dabit pro anima sua.'

872. *vltima verba ligant*. As in a bargain the last words are those that are binding, so here the last word mentioned, namely 'demon,' is the true answer to the question.

874. 'Men sein, Old Senne newe schame,' *Conf. Amantis*, iii. 2033.

903. Cp. Ovid, *Metam.* ii. 632, 'Inter aves albas vetuit consistere corvum.' Gower's line seems to have neither accident nor syntax.

953 f. *Fasti*, ii. 219 f.

959. A reference to Ps. lxxii. 5, 'In labore hominum non sunt, et cum hominibus non flagellabuntur.' The same passage is alluded to in Walsingham's chronicle (i. 324), where reference is made to the fact that the friars were exempted from the poll-tax. The first half of this psalm seems to have been accepted in some quarters as a prophetic description of the Mendicants.

963. There is no variation of reading here in the MSS., but the metre cannot be regarded as satisfactory. A fifteenth (or sixteenth) century reader has raised a slight protest against it in the margin of S, 'at metrum quomodo fiet.'

969. Cp. Ps. lxxii. 7, 'Prodiit quasi ex adipe iniquitas eorum: transierunt in affectum cordis.'

971 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 21517 ff.,

'Mal fils ne tret son pris avant,
Par ce qant il fait son avant
Q'il ad bon piere,' &c.

981 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 21553 ff.

1059-1064. These six lines are taken without change from *Aurora*, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 65.

1072. 'lingua' was here the original reading, but was altered to 'verba' in most of the copies. H and G have 'verba' over an erasure.

1081. In G we have 'adepcio' by correction from 'adopcio.'

1090. *adheret*: meant apparently for pres. subj. as if from a verb 'adherare.'

1099 f. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 19 v^o,

'Sarra parit, discedit Agar; pariente fideles
Ecclesia populos, dat synagoga locum.'

1103. *Odium*: written thus with a capital letter in H, but not in the other MSS.

1143 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 21403 ff. and note.

1145 ff. These lines are partly from Neckam's *Vita Monachorum*, p. 192:

'Porticibus vallas operosis atria, quales
Quotque putas thalamos haec labyrinthus habet.

.
Ostia multa quidem, variae sunt mille fenestrae,
Mille columnarum est marmore fulta domus.'

Gower alters the first sentence by substituting 'valuas' for the verb 'vallas.' 'It has folding-doors, halls, and bed-chambers as various and as many as the labyrinth.'

1161. 'historia parisiensis' in the MSS. I cannot supply a reference.

1175 f. From *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 193.

1189 ff. The reference is to the *Speculum Stultorum*, where Burnel the Ass, after examining the rules of all the existing orders and finding them in various ways unsatisfactory to him, comes to the conclusion that he must found an order of his own, the rules of which shall combine the advantages of all the other orders. Members of it shall be allowed to ride easily like the Templars, to tell lies like the Hospitallers, to eat meat on Saturday like the Benedictines of Cluny, to talk freely like the brothers of Grandmont, to go to one mass a month, or at most two, like the Carthusians, to dress comfortably like the Praemonstratensians, and so on. What is said here by our author expresses the spirit of these rules rather than the letter.

1197 f. The text here gives the original reading, found in TH₂ and remaining unaltered in S. CHG have 'et si' written over an erasure, and in the next line 'Mechari cupias' is written over erasure in G, 'Mechari cupias ordine' in C, and 'ordine' alone in H. The other MSS. have no erasures.

1212. CHG have this line written over an erasure.

1214. Written over erasure in CHG, the word 'magis' being still visible in G as the last word of the line in the earlier text. The expression 'Liquo

coax ranis' is said to have been used by Serlo on his renunciation of the schools: see Leyser, *Hist. Poet.* p. 443.

1215. The word 'mundi' is over erasure in CHG.

1221*-1232*. These lines are written over erasure in CHG.

1225. *A planta capiti*, 'from foot to head': more correctly, v. 116, 'Ad caput a planta.'

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45. *Architesis*. It must be assumed that this word means 'discord,' the passage being a series of oppositions.

53. *Est amor egra salus*, &c. Compare the lines which follow our author's *Traitié*, 'Est amor in glosa pax bellica, lis pietosa,' &c., and Alanus de Insulis, *De Planctu Naturae*, p. 472 (Rolls Series, 59, vol ii).

79 ff. There is not much construction here; but we must suppose that after this loose and rambling description the general sense is resumed at l. 129.

98. *Nec patet os in eis*: cp. Chaucer, *Book of the Duchess*, 942.

104. *Nec ... vix*: cp. l. 153 and vii. 12.

121 f. Cp. Ovid, *Her.* iv. 71 f.

123 f. Cp. *Fasti*, ii. 763.

165. From *Metam.* vii. 826, but quoted without much regard to the sense. In the original there is a stop after 'est,' and 'subito collapsa dolore' is the beginning of a new sentence of the narrative.

169 f. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 691 f.

171. Cp. *Her.* iv. 161.

193. Cp. *Her.* v. 149. For 'O, quia' cp. i. 59.

209. Cp. *Metam.* x. 189.

213. Cp. *Her.* vii. 179. We have here a curious example of the manner in which our author adapts lines to his use without regard to the original sense.

221. Cp. *Her.* ii. 63.

257 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 23920, *Conf. Amantis*, iv. 1634.

280. *Numquid*. This seems to be used here and in some other passages to introduce a statement: cp. ii. Prol. 59, iv. 637. Rather perhaps it should be regarded as equivalent to 'Nonne' and the clause printed as a question: so vii. 484, 892, &c. For 'num' used instead of 'nonne' cp. ii. 306.

299. S has in the margin in a later hand, 'Nota de muliere bona.' The description is taken of course from Prov. xxxi.

333. In the margin of S, as before, 'Nota de muliere mala et eius condicionibus.'

341 ff. Cp. Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 186.

359 f. Cp. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* iii. 289, 294. Presumably 'bleso' in l. 360 is a mistake for 'iusso.'

361. Cp. *Ars Amat.* iii. 291.

367 f. *Ars Amat.* iii. 311 f.

376. Cp. *Ars Amat.* i. 598.

383 f. This reference to Ovid seems to be with regard to what follows about the art of preserving and improving beauty. Some of it is from the *Ars Amatoria*, and some from Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*. For 'tenent,' meaning 'belong,' cp. iii. 584.

399-402. Taken with slight changes from *Ars Amat.* iii. 163-166.

403. Cp. *Metam.* ii. 635.

405. Cp. *Ars Amat.* iii. 179.

407. Cp. *Ars Amat.* iii. 185.

413-416. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 186.

421-428. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 189.

450. The line (in the form 'Illa quidem fatuos,' &c.) is written over an erasure in the Glasgow MS.

454. 'interius' is written over an erasure in HG.

461. *Vt quid*, 'Why.'

501. The reading 'nos,' which is evidently right, appears in CG as a correction of 'non.'

510. 'While one that is stained with its own filth flies from the field.'

520. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 23701 ff.

556. The neglect of the burden of a charge, while the honour of it is retained, is a constant theme of denunciation by our author: cp. iii. 116, and below, ll. 655 ff.

557 ff. With this account of the labourers cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 26425 ff. It is noticeable that there is nothing here about the insurrection.

593. Cp. *Metam.* vi. 318.

597. H punctuates here 'salua. que.'

613. A quotation from *Pamphilus*: cp. *Mirour*, 14449.

659. *maioris*, 'of mayor.'

693 f. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 36,

'Dupla die sexta colleccio facta labore
Ostendit quia lux septima nescit opus.'

703. The capitals which mark the personification of 'Fraus' and 'Vsura' are due to the editor. 'Fraus' corresponds to 'Triche' in the *Mirour de l'Omme*: see ll. 25237 ff.

731. *Nonne*, used for 'Num,' as also in other passages, e.g. vi. 351, 523, vii. 619.

745 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 25741 ff.

In l. 745 SG have the reading 'foris' as a correction from 'foras.'

760 ff. Cp. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, C 472 ff.

775. See note on l. 280.

785 f. The readings 'fraus' for 'sibi' and 'surripit' for 'fraus capit' are over erasure in CG.

812. ‘Thethis,’ (‘Thetis,’ or ‘Tethis’) stands several times for ‘water’ (properly ‘Tethys’): cp. vii. 1067. The line means that the water is so abundant in the jar that it hardly admits the presence of any malt (‘Cerem’ for ‘Cererem’).

835 ff. It is difficult to say who is the bad mayor of London to whom allusion is here made. The rival leaders in City politics were Nicholas Brembre and John of Northampton. The former was lord mayor in the years 1377, 1378, and again in 1383 and 1384, when he was elected against his rival (who had held the office in 1381, 1382) in a forcible and unconstitutional manner which evoked many protests. Brembre, who belonged to the Grocers’ company, represented the interests of the greater companies and was of the Court party, a special favourite with the king, while John of Northampton, a draper, engaged himself in bitter controversy with the Fishmongers, who were supported by the Grocers, and was popular with the poorer classes. In the *Cronica Tripertita* Gower bitterly attacks Brembre (who was executed by sentence of the so-called ‘Merciless Parliament’ in 1388), and we might naturally suppose that he was the person referred to here; but that passage was written before the political events which led to that invective and in all probability not later than 1382, and the references to the low origin of the mayor in question, ll. 845-860, do not agree with the circumstances of Nicholas Brembre. Political passion in the City ran high from the year 1376 onwards, and the person referred to may have been either John of Northampton or one of the other mayors, who had in some way incurred Gower’s dislike: cp. *Mirour*, 26365 ff.

877. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, v. 7626,

‘It floureth, bot it schal not greine
Unto the fruit of rihtwisnesse.’

915 f. Ovid, *Tristia*, i. 5. 47 f.

922. Cp. Prov. xxv. 15, ‘lingua mollis confringet duritiam,’ and the verses at the beginning of the *Confessio Amantis*,

‘Ossibus ergo carens que conterit ossa loquelis Absit.’

953 f. *Ars Amat.* ii. 183 f., but Ovid has ‘Numidasque leones.’

957 f. *Rem. Amoris*, 447 f. (but 'ceratas' for 'agitatas').

965 f. *Pont.* iii. 7. 25 f.

967 f. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 97 f.

969 f. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 101 f.

971 f. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 729 f., 'Admonitus refricatur amor,' &c.

973. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 623.

975 f. Cp. *Rem. Amoris*, 731 f., 'Ut pene extinctum cinerem si sulfure tangas, Vivet,' &c. The reading 'sub' must be a mistake on the part of our author for 'si.'

979. Cp. *Ars Amat.* iii. 597.

981. *Ars Amat.* iii. 373.

983 f. *Ars Amat.* iii. 375 f., but Ovid has 'iratos et sibi quisque deos.'

985 f. Cp. *Ars Amat.* iii. 501 f.

990. *Fasti*, iii. 380, absurdly introduced here.

991 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Latin Verses before Prol. 499.

1003 f. Cp. *Tristia*, ii. 141 f.

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1-468. With this section of the work compare *Mirour*, 24181 ff.

11. Ps. xiv. 3.

89-94. From *Aurora*, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 66, where however the reading is 'sapit' in l. 94 (for 'rapit').

95-98. *Aurora*, f. 65, where we find 'in nocte' for 'in noctem' and 'reprobi' for 'legis' (l. 97).

101 f. Cp. *Aurora*, 64 f.,

'Inprouisus adest cum pullos tollere miluus
Esurit, in predam non sine fraude ruit.'

This is adapted by our author to his own purpose, but as his meaning is altogether different, some obscurity results, and he does not make it clear to us how the biter is bit.

113. *Metam.* v. 606.

115-118. Cp. *Metam.* vi. 527 ff.

133. In the Glasgow MS. 'locuplex' has been altered to the more familiar 'locuples.'

141 f. Is. v. 8, 'Vae qui coniungitis domum ad domum et agrum agro copulatis usque ad terminum loci: numquid habitabitis vos soli in medio terrae?' The same text is quoted in the *Mirour*, 24541 ff.

144. By comparison with *Mirour*, 24580 ff. we may see that the dissipation of the property by the son is here alleged as a proof that it has been ill acquired:

'Qu'ils font pourchas a la senestre
Le fin demoustre la verroure.'

176. *forum*, i.e. the market price.

188. *que foret equa*, '(the balance) which should be fair': so also 'foret' below, l. 190.

203. *Basiliscus*: cp. *Mirour*, 3748 ff.

209 f. Ovid, *Pont.* ii. 3. 39 f. (but 'lasso' for 'lapso').

217. *nam nemo dolose Mentis*, &c. 'for no man of a crafty mind can have sure speech.'

225. *tenebrescunt*, 'darken.' So other inceptives are used transitively, e.g. 'ditescere,' ii. 607, *Cron. Trip.* iii. 119.

233 f. 'And this *lex*, *legis*, from *ledo*, *ledis*, as *ius* from *iurgo*, administers justice at this present time.' It is meant that the administration of law, as we see it, suggests the above etymologies. The use of 'isto' for 'hoc' is quite regular.

241 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 24253 ff.

249 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 24349 ff., and see Pulling, *Order of the Coif*, ch. iv.

269. The reference is to Ecclus. xx. 31, 'Xenia et dona excaecant oculos iudicum.'

274. 'Fear puts to flight the discernment of justice.'

313-326. These fourteen lines are taken with some alterations (not much for the better) from Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*, pp. 180 f.

327 f. Cp. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 182,

'Sic mihi, divitibus si quando defuit hostis;
Hos terit et quassat saepe ruina gravis.'

Where, it would seem, we ought to read 'Dic mihi.'

329 ff. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 181. Most of the lines 329-348 are borrowed.

351. 'Nonne' for 'Num,' as often: cp. v. 731.

355 f. Cp. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 182,

'Iustitiae montes virtutumque ardua nullus
Scandet, dum mundi rebus onustus erit.'

357. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 190.

359-372. Most of these lines are borrowed with slight alterations from *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 191.

387 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 24733 ff.

389. Cp. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 192, 'Cur ampla aedificas busto claudendus in arcto?'

397. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 193,

'Et cecidit Babylon, cecidit quoque maxima Troia
Olim mundipotens, aspice, Roma iacet.'

419 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 24817-25176.

421 f. For the idea contained in 'vnccio' and 'vncta' cp. iii. 1376.

433. 'The word *comes* receives its beginning not from *vice* but from *viciu*.' That is, apparently, the prefix which makes 'comes' into 'vicecomes' is to be derived from 'viciu.'

439 f. Cp. *Mirour*, 25166 ff.

445 ff. With this compare the corresponding lines in the *Carmen super multiplici viciorum Pestilencia*, under the head of 'Avarice' (246 ff.),

'Vendere iusticiam nichil est nisi vendere Cristum,' &c.

463 f. Cp. *Mirour*, 24973 ff.

467 f. *Vt Crati bufo*, &c.: cp. *Mirour*, 24962 f.

498. Cp. *Mirour*, 22835 f.

522. The insertion which is found after this line in the Digby MS. (and in no other) consists of eight lines taken from the original text of the passage 545-580, which was rewritten by the author: see ll. 561*-566* and 579* f.

523 ff. 'Can a house be built without timber? But of what use is timber to the builder if it be not hewn?' 'Nonne' for 'Num,' as frequently: see note on v. 731. It seems that 'sibi' refers to the builder rather than to the house; in any case, it has no reflexive sense. Finally 'ligna' is here used as a singular feminine: all the MSS. have 'foret' in l. 524 and 'valet' in 525.

The idea of the passage seems to be that good laws are as the material, and the ruler as the builder of the house.

529 ff. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, vii. 2695 ff.

545-580. It is certain that the passage preserved to us in the Dublin and Hatfield MSS. is that which was originally written in those books which now exhibit an erasure; for in several places words are legible underneath the present text of these latter MSS. For example in S 'maior' is visible as the last word of the original l. 547, and 'locuta,' 'aula,' similarly in ll. 549, 551. The chief difference introduced is in the direction of throwing more responsibility on the king, who however is still spoken of as a boy. Thus instead of 'Stat puer immunis culpe,' we have 'Rex puer indoctus morales negligit actus' (or more strongly still 'respuit').

The text of 545*-580* follows the Dublin MS. (T) with corrections from H₂. Neither text is very correct: both omit a word in l. 549*, which I supply by conjecture, and both read 'omnes' in l. 561*. There are some obvious errors in T, as 'sinis' for 'sinit' in l. 554*, 'Tempe' for 'Tempora' in l. 559*, which have been passed over without notice.

Cap. viii. *Heading*. The ensuing Epistle to the young king, which extends as far as l. 1200, assumes a more severely moral form owing to the alteration of the preceding passage, the exclusion of all compliment ('regnaturo' in this heading for 'excellentissimo') and the substitution of 'doctrine causa' for 'in eius honore.' (The readings 'excellentissimo,' 'in eius honore' no doubt are to be found in the Hatfield MS., but I have accidentally omitted to take note of them.)

629 f. Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 185,

'Quid tibi nobilitas et clarum nomen avorum,
Si vitiis servus factus es ipse tuis?'

640. 'vix' is sometimes used by our author (apparently) in the sense of 'paene.'

696. Ovid, *Rem. Amoris*, 526.

710. *iudiciale*, 'judgement,' used as a substantive: cp. iii. 1692.

718. *culpe ... sue*, 'for their fault,' i.e. the fault of his ministers.

719-722. Cp. *Aurora*, (MS. Bodley 822) f. 65,

'Euolat ancipiter ad prede lucra, suisque
Deseruit dominis in rapiendo cybum.
Sic multi dominis famulando suis, ad eorum
Nutum pauperibus dampna ferendo nocent.'

725. *presul*, 'the bishop.'

740. The expression 'Cuius enim' for 'Eius enim' occurs more than once, e.g. l. 1238: cp. vii. 372. It is found also in the *Confessio Amantis*, Latin Verses after vii. 1984, but was there corrected in the third recension.

765. *stabiles*: apparently used in a bad sense.

793 f. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 96 v⁰,

‘Exiguus magnum vicit puer ille Golyam,
Nam virtus humilis corda superba domat.’

816. Ovid, *Amores*, i. 8. 62, ‘Crede mihi, res est ingeniosa dare.’

839 f. Cp. *Aurora*, f. 95 v⁰.

846. *Fasti*, ii. 226.

875-902. This passage of twenty-six lines is taken with few alterations from the *Aurora*, f. 76.

876. *bella*: in the original ‘corda’ (or ‘colla’ MS. Univ. Coll. 143).

883. *noctibus*: in the original ‘nutibus.’

884. *Spirant*: so in the original according to MS. Bodley 822, but ‘Spirent’ in MS. Univ. Coll. 143.

886. *acuum ferrum*: in the original ‘minitans ferrum.’ Apparently our author took ‘acus’ to mean a spear or javelin. The choice of the word in this passage is unfortunate.

887 ff. ‘vincit,’ ‘tenet’ (or ‘teret,’ MS. Univ. Coll. 143), ‘consurgit’ in the original.

891. In the original, ‘Rex hoc consilium grata bibit aure, puellas Preparat,’ &c.

892. ‘genis’ in the original.

894. ‘furit’ for ‘fugat’ is the reading of the original, and we find this in several MSS. of our text, but in the Glasgow MS. this has been corrected to ‘fugat,’ which is the reading of S.

898. In the original, ‘Vultus que geminus ridet in ore decor,’ (or ‘Vultus et geminus,’ &c., MS. Univ. Coll. 143).

907. *Aurora*, f. 100.

947-950. Taken from the description of Saul at the battle of Gilboa, *Aurora*, f. 100 v⁰.

971 ff. Cp. *Praise of Peace*, 78 ff.

985-992. From *Aurora*, f. 64 v^o,

‘Alta petens aquila uolat alite celsius omni,
Quisque potens, tumidus corde, notatur ea:
Vt sacra testantur cythariste scripta prophete,
In celum tales os posuere suum.
Pennatum griphes animal, pedibusque quaternis
Inuitos homines carpit, abhorret equos:
Designatur in his facinus crudele potentum,
Qui mortes hominum cum feritate bibunt.’

986. Our author no doubt read ‘mundus corde’ here in the *Aurora*.

987. *citharistea*: properly no doubt ‘cithariste,’ to be taken with ‘prophete,’ as in the *Aurora*.

990. ‘horret equos’ seems to represent the ‘equis vehementer infesti’ of Isidore, *Etym.* xii. 2.

1019-1024. From Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 185, with slight variations.

1037. *esse*: as substantive, ‘existence.’

1041-1050. Taken with slight changes from *Aurora*, f. 108.

1066. *fugat*: used as subjunctive; so also iii. 1498, 2078.

1085 f. From *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 184.

1107-1112. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 193.

1115 f. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 183.

1159* ff. That this was the text which stood originally in S is proved partly by the fact that the original heading of the chapter stands still as given here in the Table of Chapters, f. 5, and also by the traces of original coloured initials at ll. 1175 and 1199. A considerable part of the erased chapter reappears in the poem ‘Rex celi deus,’ &c., addressed to Henry IV: see p. 343.

1189 f. *Si tibi ... cupias conuertere ... Te*. These words appear in S as a correction of the rewritten text by a second erasure and in another hand.

Cap. xix. *Heading*. The original form, as given by DLTH₂, is still to be found in the Table of Chapters in S.

1201. Cp. Ovid, *Metam.* vii. 585 f.,

‘veluti cum putria motis
Poma cadunt ramis agitataque ilice glandes.’

1204 ff. Note the repeated use of ‘modo’ in the sense of ‘now’: cp. 1210, 1218, 1222, 1232, 1235, 1243, 1263, 1280, &c. The usual word for ‘formerly’ is ‘nuper’; see 1241, 1245, 1279, &c.

1205. *Metam.* ii. 541.

1223. *Oza*, that is Uzzah (2 Sam. vi.), who is selected as a type of carnal lust, apparently on the strength of the quite gratuitous assumption adopted in Lib. III. 1885 ff. Apparently ‘luxus’ in the next line is genitive, in spite of the metre: cp. ‘excercitus,’ i. 609, ‘ducatus,’ *Cron. Trip.* iii. 117.

1236. *Giesi*, i.e. Gehazi.

1238. *Cuius enim*: cp. note on l. 740.

1243. *Liberius*: pope from 352-366 A. D. He is mentioned here as a type of unfaithfulness to his charge, because he was induced to condemn Athanasius.

1251. *defunctis*, ‘for the dead,’ that is, to bury them charitably, as Tobit did.

1261. Cp. John xii. 24.

1267. Perhaps an allusion to Wycliffe, who seems to be referred to as a new Jovinianus in a later poem, p. 347.

1268. *dant dubitare*, ‘cause men to doubt.’

1273. *Troianus*: i.e. Trajan, whose name is so spelt regularly by our author.

1277. *Valentinianus*: cp. *Conf. Amantis*, v. 6398 ff.

1284. *Leo*: cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 739.

1286. *Tiberii*: i.e. Tiberius Constantinus; cp. *Conf. Amantis*, ii. 587 ff.

1306. *quis*, for 'quisquam': so also 'quem' in l. 1308; cp. i. 184.

1321 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, vii. 2217 ff.: 'relinquendo' is used for 'relinquens,' as i. 304, 516, &c.

1323. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, v. 6372 ff., *Mirour*, 18301 ff.

1330. *Vix si*: cp. iv. 218, *Cron. Trip.* iii. 444.

1345. Cp. Ovid, *Amores*, i. 9. 1.

1357 f. 'She is silent as a jackdaw, chaste as a pigeon, and gentle as a thorn.'

1361 f. Perhaps an allusion to the case of Edward III and Alice Perrers.

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5. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 595 ff.

9. *modo*, 'now': cp. note on vi. 1204.

12. *nec ... vix*. For this combination of 'vix' with a negative cp. v. 104, 153.

42. *dicunt ... volunt*, 'say that they wish': cp. ii. 200 f.

47 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, v. 49 ff.; so below, ll. 61 ff.

123. Rev. ii. 25, 'id quod habetis tenete, donec veniam.'

125 f. Ovid, *Tristia*, i. 8. 41 f.,

'Et tua sunt silicis circum praecordia venae,
Et rigidum ferri semina pectus habet.'

159 f. It is difficult to construe this couplet satisfactorily, and the reading 'Est' seems quite as good as 'Et.' The Glasgow MS. has 'Et status' erased, as if for correction.

163 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 8921 ff.

167. The original reading seems to have been ‘grassantur,’ for which S gives ‘grossantur’ (‘o’ written over erasure), and CG ‘crassantur,’ also by correction.

182 ff. I have no record of the readings of H₂ in this passage, but I have no doubt that it agrees with EHT.

184. No record of the reading of T.

186. *abhorret*: apparently subjunctive; so we have ‘adhero’ for ‘adhereo,’ l. 1296.

192. *habere modum*: a first-hand correction in S, whereas the others in ll. 182-192 are in a different hand.

194. *caput ancille*: an allusion to the form in which Satan is supposed to have appeared in the garden of Eden.

243. *specialis*, subst., ‘a friend.’

255 f. Cp. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* ii. 201 f.,

‘Riserit, adride; si flebit, flere memento:
Imponat leges vultibus illa tuis.’

In adapting the couplet to his purpose our author has contrived to make it unintelligible.

265. *Fuluus ... talus*: referring to the gilded spur of knighthood; gold is ‘metallum fuluum.’

273 f. Cp. *Tristia*, v. 13. 27 f.

315 f. Cp. *Metam.* i. 144 f.

323 f. Cp. *Ars Amat.* i. 761 f.

327 f. *Fasti*, iv. 717 f. The application belongs to our author.

331 f. Cp. Ovid, *Tristia*, i. 9. 5 f.

334. *Ars Amat.* iii. 436.

340. Cp. *Tristia*, i. 8. 8.

347. Cp. *Metam.* i. 141.

349. *cumque*, for ‘cum’: cp. ii. 302, &c., and l. 872, below.

361 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 26590 ff.

372. *Talis enim*, ‘such, indeed,’: for this use of ‘enim’ cp. vi. 740.

375 f. From Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 177.

379-383. Taken with slight change from *De Vita Monachorum*, pp. 183 f.

387. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 195.

389-392. Taken with slight change from *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 197, and so also 395 f.

417-420. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 196.

437 f. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 196.

440. *ne sit*, for ‘ne non sit.’

441 f. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 189.

459 f. Cp. Ovid, *Ars Amat.* iii. 65 f.

463 f. Cp. *Tristia*, v. 10. 5 f., ‘Stare putes, adeo procedunt tempora tarde,’ &c. The couplet has neither sense nor appropriateness as given here.

465 f. *Pont.* ii. 2. 37 f.

484. *Numquid*, for ‘Nonne’: cp. l. 892 and note on v. 280.

485 f. *Ars Amat.* iii. 119 f.,

‘Quae nunc sub Phoebos ducibusque Palatia fulgent,
Quid nisi araturis pascua bubus erant?’

‘Qui’ is evidently a mistake for ‘Que.’

489 f. *Fasti*, i. 203 f.

499-504. From *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 181.

509 f. Cp. *Mirour*, 26605 ff. and *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 910 ff.

519. This seems to be dependent on ‘noscat’ in the line above. The indicative in dependent question is quite usual, though not invariably found:

cp. l. 516, where subjunctive and indicative are combined.

574. *consequeretur eum*, 'should follow him,' i.e. should be subject to man.

599. *Arboribusque sitis*. There must be something wrong here, but the variant given by D does not help us.

619. *Nonne*, used for 'Num': cp. v. 731.

639 ff. This quotation from Gregory appears also in the *Mirour de l'Omme*, 26869 ff., and the *Confessio Amantis*, Prol. 945 ff.

645. *minor est mundus homo*, 'man is a microcosm': cp. *Mirour*, 26929 ff.

647 ff. *Mirour*, 26953 ff.

684. The Glasgow MS. has 'queris' written over an erasure.

685-694. From Neckam, *De Vita Monachorum*, pp. 197 f.

699-708. With slight changes from *De Vita Monachorum*, pp. 193 f.

793. *nuper* to be taken with 'auaricia,' 'the avarice of former times'; 'modo' with 'prestat.'

872. *Cumque*, for 'Cum': cp. l. 349.

892. *Numquid*, for 'Nonne': cp. l. 484, and see note on v. 280. For the idea cp. *Mirour*, 1784 ff. It is originally from Augustine.

909 f. From *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 178.

911-918. From *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 179, with slight variations.

919-924. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 180.

921. The reading 'nostre,' though it has small authority, is necessary to the sense and is given in the original passage.

929-932. *De Vita Monachorum*, p. 180.

955 f. Cp. *Mirour*, 11404 ff., where the often-quoted lines of Helinand's *Vers de Mort* are given.

990. *habet ... habitare*, used perhaps for the future, 'will inhabit': so 'habet torquere,' l. 1047. On the other hand in l. 1148 'habent regi' means

‘must be guided,’ and the same meaning of ‘must’ or ‘ought’ may be applied to all the passages.

1067. *Thetis*, used for ‘water’ or ‘sea’: cp. v. 812. All the copies here give ‘thetis’ (or ‘Thetis’) except D, which cannot be depended on to reproduce the original form in a case like this. On the other hand in the *Cronica Tripertita*, i. 80, S and H have ‘tetis.’

1079. *furor breuis, ira set*: the words are suggested by the common expression ‘ira furor breuis,’ but the sense is different. This is frequently the case with our author’s borrowings, e.g. v. 213, vi. 101.

1095. *vix si*: cp. vi. 1330; but perhaps ‘vix sit’ is the true reading here.

1106. *Quam prius*, as usual, for ‘prius quam’: cp. i. 1944.

1148. *habent*: see note on l. 990.

1185. *Que*: the antecedent must be ‘virtuti,’ in the next line: ‘solet’ is of course for ‘solebat’; see note on i. 492.

1215. *tueri*: apparently passive.

1240. *deficit vnde sciam*, ‘I do not know.’

1305 f. ‘Because justice has departed, therefore peace, who is joined with her, is also gone.’ The reference here and in the next lines is to the Psalms, lxxxiv. 11.

1342. An allusion apparently to the debasement of the coinage. The reading ‘suum’ in G is over an erasure.

1344. *Nobile que genuit*, ‘she who produced the noble,’ i.e. the gold coin of that name, called so originally because of its purity.

1356. *sine lege fera*: for this kind of play upon words cp. iv. 128, 215, 243, 509, &c.

1409 ff. It may be noted that the Harleian MS. is defective for ll. 1399-1466. Its readings here would probably agree with those of EDL, &c. SCG have the text written over erasure.

1436. *Exiguo ... tempore*: for the ablative cp. i. 1568.

1455 f. It is the galled horse that winces at the load; that which is sound feels no hurt. Thus, if the reader is not guilty of the faults spoken of, he will pass untouched by the reproof.

1470. 'Vox populi, vox dei': a sentiment repeated by our author in various forms; cp. note on iii. Prol. 11.

1479 ff. These last three lines are over erasure in SCHG. They seem to have been substituted for the original couplet in order to point more clearly the moral of the *Cronica Tripertita*, which is intended for a practical illustration of the divine punishment of sin.

Explicit, &c. It will be seen that in these later years Gower has almost brought himself to believe that the events of the earlier part of the reign were intended for a special warning to the youthful king, whom he conceives as having then already begun a course of tyrannical government. At the time, however, our author acquitted him of all responsibility, on account of his youth.

11 ff. The swan was used as a badge by the duke of Gloucester and also (perhaps not till after his death) by Henry of Lancaster. For the horse and the bear as cognizances of Arundel and Warwick see *Annales Ricardi II* (Rolls Series, 28. 3), p. 206.

CRONICA TRIPERTITA

1. *Ista tripertita*, &c. These seven lines must be regarded as a metrical preface to the Chronicle which follows. In the Hatton MS. these lines with their marginal note are placed before the prose of the preceding page (which is given in a somewhat different form) and entitled 'Prologus.'

PRIMA PARS

1. Take the first letter of 'mundus' and add to it C three times repeated and six periods of five years, plus ten times five and seven. The date thus indicated is MCCC + 30 + 57, i.e. 1387. For a similar mode of expression cp. Richard of Maidstone's poem on the *Reconciliation of Richard II* (Rolls Series, 14. 1),

'M. cape, ter quoque C. deciesque novem, duo iunge.'

4-12. These lines are written over an erasure in SCHG. The original version of them is not extant, so far as I am aware.

51. *Penna coronata*. This, as the margin tells us, is the Earl Marshall, that is Thomas Mowbray, earl of Nottingham, afterwards duke of Norfolk.

52. *Qui gerit S*: the earl of Derby, from whose badge of S, standing probably for 'Sovereign,' came the device of the well-known collar of SS. His tomb has the word 'Soverayne' repeated several times on the canopy.

55. *aquilonica luna*, 'the northern moon,' that is, the earl of Northumberland. The variation of the text in the Harleian MS., written over an erasure, arises no doubt from the later disagreement between Henry IV and Northumberland.

58. *Troie*, i.e. London.

65. The earl of Oxford, lately created duke of Ireland, whose badge was a boar's head, was Chief Justice of Chester in this year, and there raised forces for the king, with the assistance of Thomas Molyneux, Constable of Chester, 'cuius nutum tota illa provincia expectabat,' Walsingham, ii. p. 167 (Rolls Series, 28. 2).

80. *Tetis*: see note on *Vox Clamantis*, vii. 1067: *a parte* means apparently 'on one side,' or perhaps 'on the side of the victors.'

The place where this affair happened is not very well described by the authorities, but it seems clear that the first attempt of the earl of Oxford (or duke of Ireland) to cross the river was made at Radcot (Knighton, Rolls Series, ii. 253). Here he found the bridge partly broken, so that one horseman only could cross it at a time, and guarded by men-at-arms and archers set there by the earl of Derby. At the same time he was threatened with attack by the earl of Derby himself on the one side and the duke of Gloucester on the other, both apparently on the northern bank of the river. Walsingham says that he went on to another bridge, and, finding this also guarded, plunged in on horseback and escaped by swimming over the river. Knighton gives us to understand that he was prevented by the appearance of the duke of Gloucester's force from making his way along the northern bank, and at once plunged in and swam the stream, 'et sic mirabili ausu evasit ab eis.' Walsingham adds that he was not pursued, because darkness had come on (it was nearly the shortest day of the year) and they did not

know the country. This chronicler does not mention Radcot Bridge, but refers to the place vaguely as 'iuxta Burford, prope Babbelake.' It is impossible, however, that either the fight, such as it was, or the escape of the earl of Oxford can have taken place at Bablock Hythe. No doubt the lords returned to Oxford after the affair by this ferry, which was probably the shortest way. The earl of Oxford seems to have made his way to London, and after an interview with the king to have embarked at Queenborough for the Continent (Malverne, in Rolls Series, 41. 9, p. 112).

89 ff. The marginal note speaks of the 'castra, que ipse [Comes Oxonie] familie sue pro signo gestanda attribuerat.' The cognizance referred, no doubt, to the city of Chester. The same note tells us that the duke of Gloucester bore a fox-tail on his spear as an ensign: cp. Harding's Chronicle, p. 341:

'The foxe taile he bare ay on his spere,
Where so he rode in peace or elles in warre.'

103. *Noua villa Macedo*, i.e. Alexander Neville: a very bad attempt on the part of our author.

104. *maledixit*. The particular form of curse in this case was translation to the see of S. Andrew, which he could not occupy because Scotland was Clementine.

107. *Hic proceres odit*, &c. He is said to have especially urged the king to take strong measures against Warwick (Malverne, p. 105).

109. *de puteo Michaelis*, 'of Michael de la Pool.' The same view of the meaning of the name is taken in Shakspeare, 2 *Henry VI*, iv. l. 70, by the murderer of William, duke of Suffolk, son of this Michael, 'Pole, Pool, sir Pool, lord! Ay, kennel, puddle, sink.'

111 ff. This is Thomas Rushook, a Dominican, who was translated from Llandaff to Chichester by the king's special desire in 1385. He had incurred much suspicion and odium as the king's confessor and supposed private adviser. Walsingham says, 'ipse sibi conscius fugam iniit' (ii. 172); but he certainly appeared at the bar of Parliament and was sentenced to forfeiture of his goods (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 241, Malverne, p. 156).

113. *ater*: alluding to his Dominican habit.

121 ff. Cp. Knighton, ii. 255 f. All the five Appellants seem to have entered the Tower, but the three spoken of here are of course the three leaders, referred to in l. 41 and afterwards. Knighton says that the king invited the five to stay for the night, but only the earls of Derby and Nottingham accepted the invitation. The fact that Gower here assigns no political action to his hero the earl of Derby (who was under twenty years old), but gives all the credit to the three leaders, shows clearly that the young Henry played a very subordinate part.

131. *covnata*: that is, 'co-unata,' meaning 'assembled.'

133 ff. Cp. Knighton, ii. 292.

141. *senecta*. Burley was then fifty-six years old.

142. This evidently means that the queen interceded for him; cp. *Chronique de la Traïson*, p. 9. Walsingham tells us only that the earl of Derby tried to save Simon Burley and quarrelled with his uncle Gloucester on the subject. Burley had been the principal negotiator of the marriage of Richard with Anne of Bohemia.

150. Walsingham says of him that he was 'ab antiquo fallax et fraudulentus.'

152. *Pons Aquilonis*, 'Bridgenorth.' Beauchamp was keeper of Bridgenorth Castle (*Rot. Pat.*, 10 Rich. II. pt. 2. m. 15), but it does not appear from other sources that he had the title here given him by Gower of 'baron Bridgenorth.' In 1387 he was made a peer by patent (the first instance of this) under the title of lord Beauchamp of Kidderminster.

154. *Tribulus*: i.e. Nicholas Brembel (so called by Gower), called Brembul or Brembyl by Knighton, Brambre by Walsingham and Brembre or de Brembre in the Patent Rolls and Rolls of Parliament. Presumably he was of Brembre (Bramber), in the county of Sussex. He had been Mayor of London last in 1386. Knighton says of him 'quem saepius rex fecerat maiorem praeter et contra voluntatem multorum ciuium' (ii. 272), and Walsingham declares that he had planned a proscription of his opponents, with a view to making himself absolute ruler of London with the title of duke (ii. 174).

158 f. Though he was a knight, he was not dignified with the nobler form of execution, being a citizen of London.

162. *Cornubiensis*: Sir Robert Tresilian, Chief Justice.

172. *falsa sigilla*: that is, the seals set by the judges to the questions and replies submitted to them at Nottingham. 'In quorum omnium testimonium Iusticiarii et Serviens predicti sigilla sua presentibus apposuerunt' (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 233; cp. Knighton, ii. 237). They all pleaded that they had set their seals to these replies under the influence of threats from the archbishop of York, the duke of Ireland, and the earl of Suffolk.

173. *magis ansam*, 'or rather a handle' (i.e. a pretext). The reading of the MSS. is doubtful (S apparently 'ausam,' but with a stop after 'regi'). The form of expression is not unusual with our author.

174 f. 'There was no punishment which would have been sufficient,' &c.

176. *ficta pietate*: that is, what our author in the *Conf. Amantis* calls 'pite feigned,' i.e. false or misplaced clemency.

176 ff. Knighton says that the queen interceded for them with the prelates (ii. 295). For the intervention of the prelates see *Rot. Parl.* iii. 241.

178 f. For the terms of their exile see *Rot. Parl.* iii. 244, Knighton, ii. 295 f.

183. The sense of the preceding negative seems to be extended to this line also.

188 ff. I do not know of any other authority for this expulsion of friars.

200. *cantus*: apparently genitive in spite of the metre; so 'ducatus,' iii. 117, 'excercitus,' 'luxus,' *Vox Clamantis*, i. 609, vi. 1224.

215. *hirundo*: a reference to the name Arundel.

SECUNDA PARS

There is an interval of nearly ten years between the first and the second part of the Chronicle. Our author proceeds to the events of 1397. He assumes that the king carried out a long-meditated plan of vengeance, cp. ll. 23 ff., but this was of course an after-thought by way of accounting for what happened.

15. A pardon was granted to all three in the Parliament of 1387-88, 'par estatut' (see *Rot. Parl.* iii. 350), and a special charter of pardon was granted to the earl of Arundel at Windsor, April 30, 1394 (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 351; cp. *Ann. Ric. II*, p. 211). See below, ll. 259 f., where the charters of pardon are said to have been procured by archbishop Arundel who was then Chancellor. It seems to be implied that the other two had similar charters, but nothing is said of this in the Rolls of Parliament; cp. *Eulog. Hist.* iii. 374.

56. Cp. *Ann. Ric. II*, p. 202 (Rolls Series, 28. 3) 'iurans suo solito iuramento, per sanctum Iohannem Baptistam, quod nihil mali pateretur in corpore, si se pacifice reddere voluisset.'

69 f. In the *Annales Ricardi II* it is definitely stated that Warwick came to the king's banquet and was arrested after it (p. 202). According to Gower's account there was no banquet at all, and Gloucester was arrested before Warwick; and this agrees with the accounts given in the *Chronique de la Traïson*, p. 9, and by Froissart, vol. xvi. p. 73 (ed. Lettenhove).

85 ff. From this account we should gather that the king officially announced the death of the duke of Gloucester to parliament before it had occurred; but this was not so. Parliament met on Sept. 17, and on Sept. 21 a writ was sent in the king's name to Calais, ordering the earl of Nottingham to produce his prisoner. This was replied to, under date Sept. 24, with the announcement that he was dead (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 378). It is certain, however, that a report of the duke of Gloucester's death was circulated and generally believed in the month of August, and equally certain that this was done with the connivance of the king, who probably wished to try what effect the news would produce upon the public mind. Sir William Rickhill, the justice who was sent over to extract a confession from the duke of Gloucester, received on Sept. 5 a commission from the king to proceed to Calais, no purpose stated, the date of the commission being Aug. 17. On arrival he was presented by the earl of Nottingham with another commission from the king, also with date Aug. 17, directing him to examine the duke of Gloucester. He expressed surprise, saying that the duke was dead and that his death had been 'notified' to the people both at Calais and in England. On the next day he saw the duke and received his so-called confession (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 431). When this confession was communicated to parliament, the date of it was suppressed, and things were so arranged as to favour the

opinion that the interview with Rickhill took place between the 17th and 25th of August, the latter being the accepted date of Gloucester's death; cp. the article by Mr. James Tait in the *Dict. of National Biography*, vol. lvi. pp. 157 f.

It is probable enough that the duke of Gloucester was still living when parliament met, as Gower seems to imply. Unfortunately John Halle, who confessed that he was present at the murder of the duke (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 453), gave no precise date. The statement of Gower that the king waited until he had secured his condemnation, may mean only that he satisfied himself of the temper of Parliament before taking the final and irrevocable step.

101 ff. The body seems first to have been laid in the Priory of Bermondsey: then it was buried by Richard's command in Westminster Abbey, but apart from the royal burial-place. Afterwards the body was transferred by Henry IV to the place chosen by Gloucester himself, between the tomb of Edward the Confessor and that of Edward III (Adam of Usk, p. 39).

121 f. For the insults levelled against the earl of Arundel see *Ann. Ric. II*, p. 215, Adam of Usk, p. 13.

With regard to the events of this parliament generally, it is worth while here to observe that Adam of Usk must certainly be regarded as a first-hand authority and his account as a contemporary one. It has usually been assumed that, though he says himself that he was present at the parliament ('In quo parlimento omni die presensium compilator interfuit'), he actually borrowed his account of it from the Monk of Evesham. This assumption rests entirely on the statement of the editor of Adam of Usk's Chronicle, that he must have written later than 1415, a statement which is repeated without question by Potthast, Gross, and others. It may be observed, however, that the evidence adduced for this late date is absolutely worthless. It is alleged first that Adam of Usk near the beginning of his Chronicle alludes to the Lollard rising in Henry V's reign, whereas what he actually says is that the Lollards planned an attack on Convocation, but were deterred by the resolute measures of the archbishop of Canterbury, at the time of the second parliament of Henry IV, that is the year 1401, when Convocation was engaged in an endeavour to suppress the Lollards and the archbishop procured the execution of William Sawtree; secondly we are

told that the chronicler refers (p. 55) to the death of the dauphin Louis, which happened in 1415, whereas actually his reference is obviously to the death of the dauphin Charles, which took place at the beginning of the year 1402. Mr. James Tait in the *Dict. of National Biography*, vol. xlviii. p. 157, has already indicated that an earlier date than 1415 is necessary, by his reference to p. 21 of the Chronicle, where the chronicler speaks of Edmund earl of March as a boy not yet arrived at puberty, which points to a date not later than 1405. It seems probable that the Monk of Evesham had before him Adam of Usk's journal of the parliament of 1397, to which he made some slight additions from other sources, introducing into his account a political colour rather more favourable to Richard II. The close correspondence between them is confined to the proceedings of this parliament at Westminster. It may be added that the account given by Adam of Usk is full of graphic details which suggest an eye-witness.

129. The pardon pleaded by the earl of Arundel had already been revoked by parliament, therefore the plea was not accepted. From the attempts made by the king to recover Arundel's charter of pardon, even after his execution (*Rot. Claus.* 21 Ric. II. pt 2, m. 18 d.), we may perhaps gather that some scruples were felt about the revocation of it.

135 ff. Cp. *Annales Ric. II*, pp. 216 f.

155 f. *Annales Ric. II*, p. 219.

179 ff. *Rot. Parl.* iii. 380, *Annales Ric. II*, p. 220.

199 f. 'Qu'il demurerait en perpetuel prison hors du Roialme en l'isle de Man par terme de sa vie' (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 380).

201 f. By the sentence upon the earl of Warwick all his property was confiscated, but it is stated in the *Annales Ric. II* (p. 220) that a promise was made that he and his wife should have honourable maintenance from the forfeited revenues, and that this promise was not kept. Adam of Usk says that an income of 500 marks was granted to him and his wife, but was never paid (p. 16).

217 f. It seems impossible to construe this, and I suspect that a line has dropped out.

230. His sentence of death was commuted for that of exile to the isle of Jersey (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 382).

231 f. So also below, l. 280, our author expresses a hope for the safe return of the archbishop of Canterbury, who came back in company with Henry of Lancaster; cp. 330 f., where a hope is expressed for future vengeance on the king. Yet we can hardly suppose that this second part of the Chronicle was actually written before the events of the third part had come to pass. All that we can say is that the writer gives to his narrative the semblance of having been composed as the events happened. The return of Cobham is mentioned by him afterwards (iii. 262).

233 ff. Our author reserves the case of the archbishop to the last, as a climax of the evil. He was actually sentenced on Sept. 25, before the trial of the earl of Warwick (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 351). Sir John Cobham, whose sentence is mentioned above, was not put on his trial till Jan. 28, when parliament was sitting at Shrewsbury.

242. That is, the court of Rome was bribed to consent to his translation.

243. The title of his father, who was the second earl of Arundel, was used by him as a surname.

267 ff. This seems to mean that other private reasons were alleged to the Pope.

280. See note on l. 231.

326 f. An allusion to the campaign of 1380.

328 f. Referring especially to the very popular naval victory of Arundel in 1387 (Walsingham, ii. 154).

340. That is, in the twenty-first year of the reign (1397).

TERCIA PARS

17. This comparison of Richard's proceedings to the work of a mole under the ground (see also l. 12, *margin*) is appropriate enough as a description of the plot which he undoubtedly laid against the liberties of the kingdom, but the comparison is perhaps chiefly intended to suggest that Richard, and not Henry, was the 'talpa ore dei maledicta' of prophecy (Glendower's 'mould-warp'), cp. *Archaeologia*, xx. p. 258.

27 ff. This refers to the appointment of a committee with full powers to deal with the petitions and other matters left unfinished in this parliament. The committee consisted of twelve lords, of whom six should be a quorum, and six commons, three to be a quorum: see *Rot. Parl.* iii. 368, *Annales Ric. II*, p. 222⁸¹⁹. The latter authority accuses the king of altering the Rolls of Parliament ‘contra effectum concessionis praedictae.’

35 ff. Cp. *Annales Ric. II*, p. 225.

47. *Que non audiuit auris*, &c. The same expression is used by Adam of Usk about the king’s proceedings in this parliament at Shrewsbury (p. 17).

49 ff. These transactions are related, but not very intelligibly, in the continuation of the *Eulogium Historiarum*, iii. 378. It seems that the king summoned the archbishop and bishops to his Council at Nottingham, and used their influence to obtain from the city of London and the seventeen counties adjacent acknowledgements of guilt and payments of money to procure pardon. After this the king ordered that the archbishops, bishops, abbots, &c., and also the individual citizens of towns, should set their seals to blank parchments, wherein afterwards a promise to keep the statutes of the last parliament was inscribed, to which it was supposed that the king intended to add acknowledgements placing the persons in question and their property at his own disposal: cp. Monk of Evesham, p. 147. These last are the ‘blanche-chartres’ spoken of below called ‘blanke chartours’ in Gregory’s Chronicle, p. 101, where the form of submission sent in by the city of London, ‘in plesauns of the kyng and by conselle and helpe of Syr Roger Walden, Archebischope of Cauntyrbury ande Syr Robert Braybroke, Byschoppe of London,’ is given in full, pp. 98-100. See also *Rot. Parl.* iii. 426, 432, where they are referred to as ‘les Remembrances appelez Raggemans ou blanches Chartres.’

73. *pharisea*: that is, hypocritically submissive to the king.

77. *melior*: comparative for superlative; so ‘probacior,’ l. 79.

85 f. Gower attributes Henry’s exile to what was probably the true cause, namely the king’s jealousy of his popularity and fear that he might take the lead in opposition to the newly established arbitrary system of government. The very occasion of the quarrel with the duke of Norfolk, an allegation on the part of Henry that the duke of Norfolk had warned him of

danger from Richard and had said that the king could not be trusted to keep his oaths, made it difficult to take more summary measures against him at that moment. Indeed it seems probable that the conversation was reported to the king with a view to obtain a contradiction of the design imputed to him. Adam of Usk says definitely that the king's object in appointing the duel at Coventry was to get rid of Henry, and that Richard had been assured by astrologers that the duke of Norfolk would win; but that on seeing them in the lists he was convinced that Henry would be the victor, and therefore he broke off the duel and banished both, intending shortly to recall the duke of Norfolk (p. 23). It is noteworthy that Gower makes no mention whatever of the duke of Norfolk here.

128 (*margin*). It cannot of course be supposed that Henry embarked at Calais. Probably he sailed from Boulogne. Froissart says that his port of departure was Vannes in Brittany, but he expresses some uncertainty about the matter, and his whole account here is hopelessly inaccurate (xvii. 171, ed. Kervyn de Lettenhove).

137. *nepote*: that is Thomas, son of the late earl of Arundel; see l. 130, *margin*.

160 ff. The suggestion here that Richard foresaw the coming of Henry and went to Ireland through fear of it, is of course absurd. At the same time it is certain that he received warnings, and that in view of these his expedition to Ireland was very ill-timed. The statement in the margin, that he fatally wasted time in Ireland, is supported both by the English annalists and by Creton. In the *Annales Ric. II* we read that a week was wasted by Richard's hesitation as to the port from which he should sail (p. 248), and Creton says that Richard was delayed by the treacherous advice of the duke of Aumerle, who induced him to leave the levying of troops in Wales to the earl of Salisbury and to embark at his leisure at Waterford (*Archaeologia*, xx. 312). Nothing is said of unfavourable winds in any of these authorities, except that Creton observes that the news of Henry's landing was delayed by the bad weather (p. 309). Henry landed July 4, and Richard was in Wales before the end of the month.

188. There is no authority for reading 'sceleris' in this line, as the former editors have done. Presumably 'sceleres' is for 'celeres,' and this form of spelling is found occasionally elsewhere in the MSS., as conversely

‘ceptrum’ frequently for ‘sceptrum.’ It is not easy to translate the line, whatever reading we may adopt. It seems to mean ‘So in their ignorance they hesitate,’ (‘few show themselves quick in action’).

205. *mundum nec abhorruit istum*, ‘nor renounced this world’: ‘istum,’ as usual, for ‘hunc.’

244. *Augusti mensis*. Richard left Flint on Aug. 19, and arrived in London Sept. 2 (*Annales Ric. II*, p. 251).

256. *Humfredum natum*: that is Humphrey, the young son of the duke of Gloucester. Richard had taken him to Ireland, and on hearing of the landing of Henry had ordered him to be confined, together with young Henry of Lancaster, in Trim castle (Walsingham, ii. 233).

272. *transit moriens*. He died apparently on the way back from Ireland, in Anglesea according to Adam of Usk, who says that he was poisoned (p. 28). Walsingham says that he died of ‘pestilence’ (ii. 242): cp. *Annales Henrici IV*, p. 321 (Rolls Series, 28. 3).

276. *Cignus*: apparently the young duke of Gloucester is here meant, and it is not intended to state that he was killed by grief for the loss of his father, but that his mother died of grief for him: cp. *Annales Henrici IV*, p. 321.

286. *dies Martis*, Tuesday, Sept. 30. Richard’s renunciation was made on Sept. 29 (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 416 ff.).

300 ff. The demise of the crown made new writs necessary, but the same parliament met again six days later (Oct. 6).

310. *verbalis ... non iudicialis*. This appears to mean that the proceedings were confined to a recital of the circumstances connected with the deposition of Richard, and that no parliamentary business was done until after the coronation, which took place on the next Monday, Oct. 13.

332 ff. The threefold right is stated here by Gower in the same way as by Chaucer:

‘O conquerour of Brutes Albioun,
Which that by lyne and free eleccioun
Ben verray kyng,’ &c.

In the margin, however, Gower places the right by conquest last, and tempers the idea of it by the addition ‘sine sanguinis effusione.’ Henry’s challenge claimed the realm by descent through ‘right line of blood’ (that is, apparently, setting aside descent through females, cp. *Eulog. Hist. contin.* iii. 383) and by ‘that right which God of his grace hath sent me ... to recover it’ (that is, by conquest). To these was added the right conferred by parliamentary election. It is not at all necessary to suppose that he relied on the legend about Edmund Crouchback, which had been officially examined and rejected (Adam of Usk, p. 30). His reference to Henry III may have been occasioned only by the fact that he was himself of the same name, and would come to the throne as Henry IV.

324. That is Oct. 13, the Translation of Edward the Confessor.

341. *augit*. This form is given by all the MSS.

352 ff. *Rot. Parl.* iii. 426.

364 ff. *Rot. Parl.* iii. 425.

368 ff. *Rot. Parl.* iii. 430 ff.

378 ff. *Rot. Parl.* iii. 449 ff.

384 ff. This refers to the fact that the dukes of Aumerle, Surrey, and Exeter, the marquis of Dorset, and the earl of Gloucester, were condemned to lose the titles of duke, marquis, and earl respectively. The case of the earl of Salisbury was reserved for future decision by combat with lord de Morley.

388 f. This seems clearly to imply that Bagot was eventually pardoned, and this conclusion is confirmed by *Rot. Parl.* iii. 458 (overlooked by the author of Bagot’s life in the *Dict. of National Biography*), where there is record of a petition presented by the Commons for the restoration of his lands (Feb. 1401), which seems to have been granted by the king.

394 ff. This is confirmed by Walsingham, ii. 242, and *Annales Henrici IV*, p. 320.

402 f. Holland and Kent are the former dukes of Exeter and Surrey, now earls of Huntingdon and Kent. Spenser is the former earl of Gloucester.

417 f. Kent and Salisbury were put to death by the populace at Cirencester, and Despenser at Bristol. The earl of Huntingdon was captured and irregularly executed in Essex.

420 ff. For the feeling in London cp. *Chronique de la Traïson*, pp. 92, 93.

432 ff. The statement here is not that Richard deliberately starved himself to death on hearing of the failure of the rising and the death of his associates, but that he lost hope and courage and could not eat, 'quod vix si prandia sumit, Aut si sponte bibit vinum,' and that he desired the death which came to him. This is not an incredible account, and it is fairly in accordance with the best evidence. Most of the contemporary authorities give starvation as the cause, or one of the causes, of death, and the account of it given in our text agrees with that of Walsingham (ii. 245), *Annales Henrici IV*, p. 330, *Eulog. Hist. contin.* iii. 387. The Monk of Evesham mentions this commonly accepted story, but thinks it more probable that he was starved involuntarily: 'Aliter tamen dicitur et verius, quod ibidem fame miserabiliter interiit,' and this is also the assertion of the Percies' proclamation (Harding's Chronicle, ed. Ellis, p. 352). Creton says,

'Après le roy de ces nouvelles,
Qui ne furent bonnes ne belles,
En son cuer print de courroux tant,
Que depuis celle heure en avant
Oncques ne menga ne ne but,
Ains covint que la mort recut,
Comme ilz dient; maiz vrayement
Je ne croy pas ensement.'

and he proceeds to say that he rather believes that Richard is still alive in prison (*Archaeologia*, xx. p. 408). Adam of Usk (p. 41) says that Richard was brought almost to death by grief and the disappointment of his hopes, but that his death was partly caused by the scantiness of the food supplied

to him. The *Chronique de la Traïson* tells the story about Piers Exton, which was afterwards commonly accepted by historians, but this was certainly not current at the time in England.

462 ff. The epithet ‘pius,’ which Gower attaches to Henry’s name in this passage, means in his mouth ‘merciful,’ and in the margin the ‘pietas’ of the new king is contrasted with the ‘cruelty’ of Richard, the vice to which Gower chiefly attributes his fall. There is no doubt that the execution of Arundel and the murder of Gloucester (or the popular opinion that he had been murdered) produced a very sinister impression, and caused a general feeling of insecurity which was very favourable to Henry’s enterprise. It is true also that Henry showed himself scrupulously moderate at first in his dealings with political opponents. Gower expresses the state of things pretty accurately, when he says below:

‘R. proceres odit et eorum predia rodit,
H. fouet, heredesque suas restaurat in edes;
R. regnum vastat vindex et in omnibus astat,
Mulset terrorem pius H., que reducit amorem.’

486. This is a perilously near approach to the Wycliffite doctrine.

REX CELI ETC. (p. [343](#))

This piece is here connected by its heading with the *Cronica Tripertita*, but it occurs also in the Glasgow MS. independently and in the Trentham MS. as a sequel to the poem *In Praise of Peace*, with the following in place of the present heading, ‘Explicit carmen de pacis commendacione.... Et nunc sequitur epistola, in qua idem Iohannes pro statu et salute dicti domini sui apud altissimum deuocius exorat.’ The poem itself is an adaptation of the original version of *Vox Clamantis*, vi. cap. 18: see vol. iii. p. 554.

H. AQUILE PULLUS ETC. (p. [344](#))

The word ‘Prophecias’ in the margin seems to be intended to recall the supposed prophecy of Merlin about the ‘filius (or pullus) aquilae’ (*Archaeol.* xx. p. 257, Adam of Usk’s Chronicle, p. 133).

These four lines immediately follow the *Cronica Tripertita* in the Glasgow and Hatton MSS., and are themselves followed by two quotations from the Psalms (lxxxviii. 23, xl. 3):

‘Nichil proficiet inimicus in eo, et filius iniquitatis non apponet nocere ei.’

‘Dominus conseruet eum, et viuificet eum, et beatum faciat eum in terra, et non tradat cum in animam inimicorum eius.’

In the Trentham MS. we have the lines ‘H. aquile pullus,’ and the above quotations, subjoined to the first eight lines of ‘O recolende,’ as part of the dedication of the *Cinkante Balades*: see vol. i. p. 336.

1. *aquile pullus*: Henry is called so because his father was named John and used the eagle as one of his cognisances: cp. Adam of Usk, p. 24, ‘pullus aquile, quia filius Iohannis.’ The reference is to a prophecy, one form of which is quoted by the editor of Adam of Usk’s Chronicle, p. 133. For the use of the eagle by John of Gaunt see Sandford’s *Genealogical History*, p. 249.

2. *colla*. The reading of S may be supported by reference to *Vox Clamantis*, vi. 876, where our author in borrowing from the *Aurora* substitutes ‘bella’ for ‘corda’ or ‘colla.’

3. *aquile ... oleum*: this is the oil produced for Henry’s coronation, which was said to have been miraculously delivered to Thomas à Becket in a vial enclosed within an eagle of gold, and deposited by him in the church of St. Gregory at Poitiers. It was said to have been brought to England by Henry, first duke of Lancaster, and to have been delivered by him to the Black Prince. Thus it came into the possession of Richard II, who is said to have worn it constantly about his neck. He had desired to be re-anointed with this oil, but archbishop Arundel had refused to perform the ceremony (*Annales Henrici IV*, pp. 297-300, *Eulog. Hist. contin.* iii. 380).

O RECOLENDE, ETC. (p. [345](#))

The first eight lines of this appear in the Trentham MS. in combination with ‘H. aquile pullus’ as part of the dedication of the *Cinkante Balades*.

16 ff. For ‘pietas,’ ‘pius,’ see note on *Cronica Tripertita*, iii. 462.

CARMEN SUPER MULTIPLICI VICIORUM PESTILENCIA (p. [346](#))

‘Putruerunt et corrupte sunt,’ &c. This is in fact a quotation from the Psalms, ‘Putruerunt et corruptae sunt cicatrices meae a facie insipientiae meae,’ xxxvii. 6. (xxxviii. 5).

32. *quasi Ioviniani*. Already in the *Vox Clamantis* we have had reference to the ‘new Jovinian’ who is a sower of heresy (vi. 1267), and the person meant is no doubt Wycliffe. Jovinian, the opponent of Jerome on the marriage question, is taken as a type of the ecclesiastic of lax principles. Milman calls Jovinian and Vigilantius ‘premature Protestants’ (*History of Christianity*, Bk. III. ch. iv).

36. *sub grossa lana*: an allusion perhaps to the simple russet garb of Wycliffe’s poor priests.

52 ff. Cp. *Vox Clamantis*, ii. 437 ff., whence many of these lines are taken, e.g. 54-57, 60-77.

54. *mortis ymago*: that is, the mortal creature.

86. ‘time’ was probably written originally for ‘stude’ in SCH, as well as in F, but it was perceived perhaps that ‘reuereri,’ which was required for the rhyme, would not stand as an imperative. Similarly in line 88 ‘Que fantasias aliter tibi dant’ stood no doubt originally in SCH, and was altered for grammatical reasons.

181 f. This couplet is repeated from *Vox Clamantis*, vi. 861 f.

190. *quam prius*, for ‘prius quam,’ as frequently: cp. ll. 202, 292.

199. This line is from Ovid, *Metam.* vii. 826, ‘Credula res amor est,’ &c., and is quite without sense as it stands here: cp. *Vox Clamantis*, v. 165.

203 f. 1 Cor. vi. 18.

246 ff. Cp. *Vox Clamantis*, vi. 445 ff.

250. *semel nisi*, i.e. ‘once only’ for ‘non nisi semel’: cp. *Vox Clamantis*, iii. 22.

312. *bis deno Ricardi regis in anno*. The twentieth year of Richard II is from June 22, 1396 to the same date of 1397. The arrests of Arundel and Gloucester took place in the first few days of the twenty-first year.

DE LUCIS SCRUTINIO (p. [355](#))

The Ecton MS. (E) gives a different form of the marginal notes, as follows: 6. Nota de luce prelatorum et curatorum. 18. Nota de luce professorum. 30. Nota de luce regum. 44. Nota de luce procerum. 51. Nota de luce militum. 58. Nota de luce legistarum et causidicorum. 67. Nota de luce mercatorum. 79. Nota de luce vulgari in patria. 89. Nota quod Iohannes Gower auctor huius libri hic in fine tenebras deplangens pro luce optinenda deum exorat.

25 ff. See *Praise of Peace*, 225 ff.

64 f. Cp. *Vox Clamantis*, v. 703.

91 ff. The language is of course figurative: we must not assume that the author is referring to any physical blindness.

ECCE PATET TENSUS ETC. (p. [358](#))

This piece is found in the Trentham MS. f. 33 v^o, following the *Cinkante Balades*. It is probably imperfect at the end, the manuscript having lost the next leaf.

25. *que naturatur*, &c., ‘which is irresistibly disposed to that which is unlawful.’ This seems to be the meaning, but it is awkwardly expressed.

EST AMOR ETC. (p. [359](#))

This piece occurs also in combination with the *Traitié*: see vol. i. p. 392. For the substance of it cp. *Vox Clamantis*, v. 53 ff.

QUIA VNUSQUISQUE ETC. (p. [360](#))

The form given by G is practically identical with that of the Fairfax MS. That of the text, as given by SCH, varies from it in the first paragraph, where it adopts the wording found in the second recension copies, BTA. See vol. iii. pp. 479 and 550.

10. The word ‘meditantis’ is written over an erasure in G.

11 ff. This paragraph, as finally rewritten, seems intended to include the *Cronica Tripertita* as a sequel to the *Vox Clamantis*: cp. p. 313, where in the note which connects the two works language is used very similar to that which we have here. The author in his retrospective view of Richard's reign has brought himself to feel that the earlier calamities were a divine warning, by the neglect of which the later evils and the final catastrophe had been brought about. It has already been pointed out (vol. iii. p. 550) that in the Fairfax MS. this account of the author's books is completely separated from the text of the *Confessio Amantis* and is written in a later hand, the same in fact which we have here in the All Souls MS.

ENEIDOS BUCOLIS ETC. (p. [361](#))

These lines, which Gower says were kindly sent to him by 'a certain philosopher' (not 'quidam Philippus,' as printed by the Roxburghe editor) on the completion of his three books, are found also at the end of the Fairfax MS. The author is probably the same as that of the four lines 'Quam cinxere freta,' &c., appended to the *Confessio Amantis*, which are called 'Epistola super huius opusculi sui complementum Iohanni Gower a quodam philosopho transmissa.' I have ventured on the conjecture that this philosopher was in fact Ralph Strode, whom Chaucer couples with Gower in the last stanza of *Troilus* with the epithet 'philosophical,' and of whom we know by tradition that he wrote elegiac verse.

O DEUS IMMENSE ETC. (p. [362](#))

There is no reason why the heading should not be from the hand of the author, though added of course somewhat later than the date of composition. The phrase 'adhuc viuens' or 'dum vixit' does not seem to be any objection to this. It is used with a view to future generations, and occurs also in the author's account of his books (p. 360, l. 4).

2. *morosi*: opposed here to 'viciosi'; cp. l. 57 and *Epistola* (p. 1), l. 33.

7. *foret*, 'ought to be.'

19. Isaiah xxxiii. 1.

49. Cp. *Traitié*, xv. 7, &c.

62. *habet speciale*, 'keeps as a secret.'

74. *recoletur*: apparently meant for subjunctive.

QUICQUID HOMO SCRIBAT, ETC. (p. [365](#))

Of the three forms given here we must suppose that of the Trentham MS. to be the earliest. It is decidedly shorter than the others, it has no prose heading, and it names the first year of Henry IV in such a manner that we may probably assign it to that year. The poet's eyesight had then failed to such an extent that it was difficult for him any longer to write; but complete blindness probably had not yet come on, and he does not yet use the word 'cecus.' Of the other two forms it is probable that that given by S is the later, if only because the precise date is omitted and the very diffuse heading restrained within reasonable limits. S, it is true, ends with this piece, while CHG have the later pieces; but these were probably added as they were composed, and the All Souls book may have been presented to archbishop Arundel before the last poems were written.

This concluding piece is written in S in the same hand as the *Epistola* at the beginning of the book, the heading apparently over the writing of another hand, some parts as 'dicitur,' l. 2, 'tripertita—tempore,' 2, 3, being obviously over erasure. The original hand remains for 'est qualiter ab illa Cronica que,' 'in Anglia—rerum,' 'varia carmina—quia.'

ORATE PRO ANIMA ETC. (p. [367](#))

I have no doubt that this exhortation was set down by Gower himself, who had probably arranged before his death for the promised indulgence, following the principle laid down in the last poem of the collection, of being his own executor in such matters. The verses 'Armigeri scutum,' &c., which are appended in the Glasgow MS. were originally upon his tomb, and they have every appearance of being his own composition: cp. p. 352, ll. 217 ff. Berthelette after describing the tomb says, 'And there by hongeth a table, wherin appereth that who so euer praith for the soule of John Gower, he shall, so oft as he so dothe, haue a thousande and fyue hundred dayes of pardon.'

PRESUL, OUILE REGIS, ETC. (p. [368](#))

This is evidently addressed to archbishop Arundel. The comet referred to is no doubt that of March, 1402. The evils complained of are the conspiracies against the king, and we are told by the chroniclers that the appearance of this comet in the north was taken as a presage of the troubles in Wales and in Northumberland: cp. Walsingham, ii. 248. Adam of Usk, who saw it when on the Continent, says it was visible by day as well as by night, and that it probably prefigured the death of the duke of Milan, whose arms were also seen in the sky (p. 73).

DICUNT SCRIPTURE ETC. (p. [368](#))

5. The neglect complained of is of prayers for the soul of the departed. Gower seems to have followed his own precept and made arrangements for some of the prayers in his lifetime, though others are provided for by his will. Berthelette in his preface to the *Confessio Amantis* (1532) speaks of Gower's place of burial as having been prepared by himself in the church of St. Mary Overes, 'where he hath of his owne foundation a masse dayly songe. And more ouer he hath an obyte yerely done for hym within the same church, on fryday after the feaste of the blessed pope saynte Gregory.' St. Gregory's day is March 12.

FOOTNOTE:

[819](#) Dr. Stubbs says that the earls of Worcester and Wiltshire were appointed to represent the clergy on this commission, as on that mentioned *Rot. Parl.* iii. 360, which consists of the same persons; but the official record is as given above, and the commission afterwards acted on its powers without requiring the presence of either of these two lords (*Rot. Parl.* iii. 369).

GLOSSARY

The Glossary is not intended as a complete record of Gower's Latin vocabulary. It is a list of words which are unclassical in form or usage, or seem to present some difficulty, with select references and occasional explanations. Regular differences of spelling, such as *e* for *ae* and *ci* for *ti* are passed over without notice. The Roman numbers without letters prefixed indicate books of the *Vox Clamantis*, Ep. stands for the *Epistola* at the beginning of the volume, C. T. for *Cronica Tripertita*, V. P. for *Carmen super multiplici Viciorum Pestilencia*, L. S. for *Tractatus de Lucis Scrutinio*, and the other pieces are represented by their opening words. A few references only are given, and common usages are illustrated chiefly from the first book of the *Vox Clamantis*.

A

abbas, s. iii. 379.

abhominacio, s. C. T. iii. 33.

abhorreo, v. a. i. 1084, shrink from, i. 1020*, be repulsive to;

abhorret as *subj.* vii. 186.

abinde, *adv.* C. T. i. 199, iii. 4.

abintus, *adv.* i. 2056.

abissus, s. i. 345.

abortus, &c. *for* 'obortus,' &c. i. 885.

absto, v. ii. 9, cease to exist.

accidia, s. vii. 817, sloth.

accidiosus, a. iii. 2069, vii. 817 ff., slothful.

Acephalus, iii. 956, iv. 715.

acra, a. *f. sing.* and *n. pl.*, iii. 1162, C. T. ii. 27.

Acteon, i. 446.

actrix, s. i. 763.

adhero, v. vii. 1296.

aera, s. *nom. sing.*, iii. 831 (*also aer*, e.g. iii. 837).

Āgamēnon, i. 988.

agon, s. i. 1124, C. T. iii. 464, contest, action.

alba, s. iii. 1787, alb.

aliqualis, *a.* i. 486, (not) any.

aliquis, *for* 'quisquam,' i. 261.

alter (= different) i. 21.

altero, v. *a.* i. 534, change.

ambassiātor, s. C. T. iii. 107.

ammodo (amodo), *adv.* i. 196, 495, 2146, henceforth, now.

amurca, s. i. 359, scum.

ancer, *for* 'anser,' i. 518.

angelicus, *a.* iii. 283.

ab ante, *adv.* i. 1355.

Anthēnor, i. 963.

antifrasis s. vii. 507, contradiction.

antitodum, s. vi. 828, antidote.

aperculus, s. i. 305.

apex, s. vii. 746, letter, vii. 1076, crown.

āpocapatus, *a.* iv. 354, cut short.

āpocapē, s. v. 820, cutting short.

apostata, s. iv. 289, 973.

appello, v. C. T. ii. 77 ff., accuse.

approprio (aproprio), v. *a.* i. 198.

aproprio, *see* **approprio**.

aquilonicus, *a. C. T. i. 55*, northern.

ăra, *for* ‘hara,’ *i. 306, 369*.

arătrum, *s. i. 249, 283*.

archanum, *for* ‘arcanum,’ *V. P. 64*.

architesis, *s. v. 45, (?)*.

ardeo, *v. a. i. 325*.

artes, *i. 474, see Notes*.

assessus, *pp. vi. 425, prepared*.

assisa, *s. vi. 426, assise*.

asto, *v. v. 96, 100, vi. 26, be*.

Āthenis, *abl. pl. v. 1011*.

auca, *s i. 549, goose*.

augo, *v. a. C. T. iii. 341 (also augeo, as ‘Rex celi’ &c. 45)*.

Augustīnensis, *a. C. T. ii. 153*.

B

Bachus, *for* ‘Bacchus,’ *i. 949*.

bāro, *s. C. T. 152, băro, ‘O recolende’ &c. 10*.

bassus, *a. i. 523, C. T. ii. 104, low*.

bercarius, *s. iii. 1761, shepherd*.

biblea, *s. V. P. 182 (also biblia, vi. 862)*.

biceps, *a. i. 227, two-edged*.

blădum, *s. i. 318, corn-crop*.

Boētes, *for* ‘Boōtes,’ *i. 139*.

bombizo, *v. i. 811, buzz*.

botrus, *s. ii. 219, bunch of grapes*.

brauium, s. iv. 847, prize.

bruchus, s. i. 603, caterpillar.

C

Cālīsia, C. T. ii. 47, **Calisie** (*pl.*), C. T. iii. 133, Calais.

Cāmēlion, s. iv. 826.

camera, s. i. 471, chamber.

cānon, s. iv. 359, rule.

cānonicus, s. iv. 359.

Cāpanēus, i. 985.

capitale, s. iii. 1801, head-dress.

capitaneus, s. i. 921, captain.

capitatus, *a.* iv. 839, (?).

capitosus, *a.* ‘Est amor’ &c. 4, headstrong.

capitulum, s. chapter.

captiuo, v. C. T. ii. 70, arrest.

carecta, i. 285, cart.

caribdis, *for* ‘Charybdis,’ C. T. iii. 23.

carta, s. C. T. ii. 16, charter.

catallum, s. C. T. i. 144, *pl.* C. T. i. 22, property.

catasta, s. i. 682, cage.

cathena, *for* ‘catena,’ i. 400.

cātus, s. C. T. i. 25, cat.

causo, v. i. 1072.

cautela, s. vi. 29, trick.

celsithronus, i. 2068.

celsitonans, i. 26.

ceptrum, *for* 'sceptrum,' iii. 579.
Cerem, *for* 'Cererem,' v. 812.
cerpo, *for* 'serpo,' iii. 1963.
cessit, *for* 'cessat,' Ep. 11.
Chaÿm, i. 1117, Cain.
choruscho, *for* 'corusco,' i. 23.
cicius, *adv.* i. 846, iv. 207, rather.
ciclus, s. ii. 241, cycle.
Cilla, *for* 'Scylla,' i. 1951.
ciniphes, s. i. 603, (?).
citharistĕus, *a.* vii. 753, of the harp.
clamo, i. 2, iv. 1330, claim.
clarifico, v. ii. 560, C. T. i. 188.
clata, s. v. 809, pillory (?).
claustralis, s. iv. 273, 828, monk;
 a. L. S. 15.
claustrum, s. iii. 379, cloister.
clerus, s. iii. 1.
cognicior, *a. comp.* i. 1112.
colonis, s. i. 1876, vii. 1261.
comitissa, s. C. T. ii. 203, countess.
comitiua, s. C. T. iii. 139, company.
compacior, v. i. 1330, 1545, iv. 272, sympathize (with).
compotus, s. iii. 1397, account.
concerno, v. v. 127, look at.
concito, *adv.* i. 1955, quickly.

concomitor, v. vi. 786.
condignum, s. iii. 1564, desert.
condignus, a. iv. 556, suitable.
confero, v. *n.* i. 360, ii. 311, be of use;
 refl. i. 207, suit.
confrater, s. iv. 63, brother in religion.
congaudeo, i. 97, C. T. iii. 148, 245.
congradior, *for* ‘congregior,’ i. 308.
conroto, v. i. 1194, whirl about.
consiliaris, s. ‘O deus’ &c. 13.
consiliator, s. ‘O deus’ &c. 33.
constellacio, s. i. 141.
construo, iii. 998, 1237.
contemplor, v. *pass.* Ep. 4.
contritus, a. C. T. iii. 206.
coppa, s. i. 545, hen.
corditer, *adv.* C. T. iii. 315, heartily.
cordula, s. iv. 509, string (of a musical instrument).
cornuto, v. i. 245, push with horns.
corona, iii. 1763, 2104, tonsure.
corrodium, s. iv. 215, *see Notes*.
cōtīdianus, a. ii. 164.
co-vnatus, a. C. T. i. 131, assembled.
crapulus, s. i. 280, *see Notes*.
crasso, v. iii. 122, iv. 71, fatten.
Cristicola, iii. 310, Christian.

crōnica, s. i. 670, C. T. iii. 489, chronicle, record.

crucifer, s. i. 1087, cross-bearer.

cumque, *for* ‘cum,’ i. 119, iii. 545, 958, vii. 872.

cupero, v. *for* ‘recupero,’ v. 214.

cura, s. iii. 1315 ff. cure of souls.

curatus, s. iii. 1322, parish priest.

curo, v. iii. 1344, have a cure of souls.

cŷnōmia, s. i. 1603, dog-fly (κυνόμυια) (?).

D

Dauiticus, *a.* iii. 365, of David.

de, *prep.* Ep. 35, i. 14, 101, 115, 202, 230, 244, 392, 430, 523, 614, 868, 872, 1240, &c. with, by reason of, for the sake of.

decapito, v. i. 836, C. T. i. 184.

decasus, ii. 30, vii. 1242, fall.

decaudo, v. v. 819, curtail.

dēcimo, v. v. 785, take tithe.

decōro, v. vii. 595.

dedico, v. iii. 943, refuse.

dedignosus, *a.* ‘Est amor’ &c. 11.

defendo, v. v. 719, forbid.

deforis, *adv.* i. 63, outside.

deliciosus, *a.* i. 196.

demon, s. i. 301.

denārius, s. v. 760.

denaturo, v. i. 979, v. 637, degenerate, misbehave.

dentale, s. i. 283, ploughshare.

depenno, v. C. T. ii. 315.
derogo, v. vi. 29, obtain.
desuper, *adv.* i. 96, vii. 678. &c. on high.
deuiolo, v. iv. 676.
dextrarius, s. i. 639, steed.
a dextris, i. 31.
dieta, s. C. T. i. 58, iii. 157.
digito, v. *a.* iii. 1004, lay finger to.
disproprio, v. iii. 680, cast aside.
dissoluo, v. vii. 549, spread out.
distancia, s. i. 965, difference.
ditescere, v. *a.* ii. 607, C. T. iii. 119, enrich.
diuarico, v. *a.* ii. 612, vii. 474, vary.
diŭturnus, *a.* i. 219.
doleum, s. *for* ‘dolium,’ v. 777.
dominati, s. *pl.* iii. 297, ‘dominions.’
dompnus, s. iv. 34, 323 ff., *see Notes*.
dorsa, s. i. 409, back.
dubitatus, *a.* i. 1561, doubtful.
ducatus, s. C. T. iii. 117, dukedom.
ductilis, *a.* iii. 1091, guiding; cp. i. 930.
dummodo, *for* ‘dum,’ Ep. 11.
dumque, *for* ‘dum,’ Ep. 23, i. 165, 806, iii. 366, iv. 266.

E

eccho, *for* ‘echo,’ i. 376.
ecclĕsia, s. iii. 293, C. T. i. 104.

eclipsis, s. C. T. i. 60.

econtra, *adv.* i. Prol. 5, on the other hand.

econuerso, *adv.* ii. 102.

edus, *for* 'haedus,' iv. 693.

elemōsyna, s. iv. 263, alms.

elongo, v. ii. 308, v. 99.

enim, *with relat. pron.* vi. 740, 1238, cp. vii. 372, indeed.

ephot, s. i. 1080.

esse, *inf. as subst.* ii. 437, 512, 'Rex celi' &c. 7.

Ethna, C. T. ii. 207.

euinco, v. vii. 67, acquire (?).

ex, *prep.* i. 97, 156, 522, 881, 1334, because of, by means of, by, away from.

excercitus, *for* 'exercitus,' i. 609.

excetra, ii. Prol. 51, serpent (?).

executor, s. p. 368 *marg.*, executor of the dead.

exemplicor, v. vii. 925, warn by example.

exennia, s. *pl.* vi. 63, gifts.

exilium, s. i. 455, destruction.

explanto, v. C. T. iii. 255, root out.

expresse, *adv.* 'Vnanimes esse' &c. 2.

exquo, *conj.* ii. cap. xi. (*heading*), since.

extasis, s. i. 1470, v. 138.

extenta, iii. 942, (?).

exto, v. i. 421, 433, be.

F

falco, s. i. 521, C. T. ii. 51.
fatatus, *pp.* C. T. iii. 356, fated.
fāuus, s. ii. Prol. 77 (*but fǣuus*, vi. 900).
febricator, v. iv. 64, be fevered.
fero, v. i. 164, 365, 724, 1200, 1202, find, obtain, experience, direct.
fīdūcia, s. vi. 336.
figmentum, s. vii. 1139, formation.
florigeratus, *a.* vi. 1365, flowery.
forma, s. iii. 1413, dignity.
formalis, *a.* iii. 1443, dignified.
fortifico, v. ii. Prol. 81.
fortitudo, s. i. 1095.
fossum, s. i. 348, pitfall.
frǣgro, v. i. 61.
frendeo, v. i. 337, roar.
fugat, *subj. for* ‘fuget,’ iii. 1498, vi. 1066.
furiens, *for* ‘furens,’ i. 777, 843, 1190.
furo, v. *a.* i. 853, 2106, stir up, infuriate (*also v. n.* i. 245, &c.).

G

gaiolis, s. (*abl. pl.*) i. cap. vi. (*heading*), gaols.
garcio, s. vii. 264, apprentice.
geba, s. iii. 86, *see Notes*.
gehenna, s. i. 431, 1377, C. T. ii. 2.
genuflexus, *a.* ‘Rex celi’ &c. 53.
gerarchīa, s. iii. 300, hierarchy.
Gereon, *for* ‘Geryon,’ i. 447.

gibbosus, *a.* vii. 1455.

girovago, *v.* i. 124, wander about.

gladius, *pp.* iii. 366, armed with a sword.

glosa, *s.* iii. 941, 'Est amor' &c. 1, comment, explanation.

graculus, *s.* i. 681, jay.

grauo, *v. n.* vii. 1455, be an offence.

grisus, *a.* v. 797, grey.

grossor, *v. perh. for* 'grassor,' vii. 167.

grossus, *a.* i. 251, coarse.

guerra, *s.* i. 2027, ii. 76, war.

gutta, *i.* 70, gum.

H

habeo, *v.* vii. 990, 1047, 1148, must, ought.

habundo, *v. n.* i. 17, increase.

Hănibal, *vi.* 1289.

Hēlēnus, **Hēlēnus**, *i.* 1002, 1153.

Herebus, *for* 'Erebus,' *i.* 741.

herēmis, *s.* ii. 261, desert.

heremita, *s.* V. P. 300, hermit.

heresis, *s.* V. P. 32.

hēri, *adv.* i. 245, yesterday, (**hēri**, *iii.* 1379).

hic, *for* 'is' or 'ille,' *i.* 475, 501, 676.

Hispannia, *i.* 447.

holocaustum, *s.* i. 1854, sacrifice.

humerales, *s.* iii. 1799, vestment worn on the shoulders.

I

Iāsōnis, *genit.* i. 263.

idipsum, ii. 585.

igniuomus, *a.* i. 1713.

Ih̃esus, ii. 485, &c.

illiceber, *a.* vi. cap. xii. (*heading*), alluring.

illicebrum, *s. for* ‘illecebra,’ vi. 854, allurement.

illuc, *for* ‘illic,’ i. 57.

imperialis, *a.* C. T. iii. 458, royal.

incantatus, *pp.* iv. 799, C. T. ii. 13, charmed, deluded.

incaustum, *s.* ii. 1, ink.

inchola, *for* ‘incola,’ i. 1215.

incircumspectus, *a.* i. 907, incautious.

in eternum, *adv.* i. 1756, ‘Rex celi’ &c. 6.

infernus, *s.* i. 430, 748, hell.

inficio, *v.* iv. 236, unmake (*also* taint, pollute, iv. 438, &c.).

infra, *prep.* C. T. ii. 95 (*marg.*), iii. 401 (*marg.*), within:

ab infra, **ad infra**, i. 2011, v. 167.

ingluuies, *s.* i. 1907, flow, (?).

inmunis, *a.* vi. 1307, innocent.

inquiēto, *v.* vii. 892.

insulcatus, *pp.* i. 1649, (?).

interius, *comp. n. as subst.* i. Prol. 12, 1361.

interuter, *a.* ii. 188, each in turn (?).

intitulo, *v.* i. 126, vii. 158, take possession of (?).

ioco, *v. a.* ii. 188, C. T. ii. 181, mock at, greet with smiles.

iota, s. vii. 746.

ipse, *for* ‘ille,’ i. 94, 239, 754;
redundant, i. 852, 864.

irracio, s. i. 178, unreason.

iste, *for* ‘hic,’ Ep. 7, i. 357, 838, 1118.

iūbeo, v. vi. 779 (*also iūbeo*).

iubileum, s. C. T. iii. 330.

iudiciale, s. iii. 1692, vi. 710, judgement.

iugulum, s. C. T. ii. 98, murder.

iustifico, v. C. T. ii. 223.

L

laicus, *a. and* s. iii. 505, 1761.

latitanter, *adv.* i. 481, secretly.

Latōna, i. 579.

latria, s. iv. 819, service.

lauācrum, s. ii. 7, baptism.

lēgatus, s. iii. 664.

legista, s. C. T. i. 31, L. S. 61.

legius, s. vi. 581, subject.

leopardus, s. i. 232, 1757.

leuio, v. v. 662, lighter.

ligna, s. *f.* vi. 524.

limpha, *for* ‘lympa,’ ii. 255.

linquo, v. *n.* i. 1572, cease.

locuplex, *for* ‘locuples,’ vi. 133.

Londonie (*pl.*), **Londonienses**, C. T. ii. 153, iii. 244, 268, 420.

a longe, *adv.* i. 725, 1032.

lūcerna, s. iii. 1077 (*also lūcerna*, e.g. L. S. 6).

luxuracio, s. iii. 209, wantonness.

Lȳsīas, ii. 290.

M

Macēdo, vi. 1109.

maculo, v. C. T. iii. 375, blame.

madeo, v. *a.* vii. 888, make wet.

maior, s. i. 1861, mayor.

maius, *adv.* i. 2010, any longer.

malediccio, s. i. 177, curse.

maligno, v. V. P. 12.

Mammona, s. iii. 207, vii. 120, V. P. 298.

manus, *in phrases*, **ante manum**, vi. 438, 680,
pre manibus, i. 1244, iii. 227.

manutentus, *pp.* C. T. ii. 61, (of an oath) taken.

margārita, s. iv. 661.

martirīzatus, *pp.* C. T. ii. 96.

meminens, *pres. part.* ii. Prol. 2.

memor, *a.* vi. 924, vii. 1428, remembered.

memoror, v. *dep.* Ep. 18, vi. 1117, vii. 1162.

mentalis, *a.* ‘O recolende’ &c. 25.

mēřdianus, *a.* i. 737.

miles, s. i. 1067, knight.

milicia, s. v. 3, knighthood.

milicies, s. i. 1265, knighthood.

millesies, *adv.* i. 1406.

Mīnōtaurus, i. 273.

ad minus, vi. 1344, at least.

misticus, *for* ‘mysticus,’ ii. 444, iii. 1838.

mitto, v. i. 1123, commit.

mocio, s. iii. 2091, motive.

modernus, *a.* iii. Prol. 56, V. P. 33, 134, of the present time.

modo, *adv.* Ep. 40, iii. 276 ff., 1258, now, at the present time.

molendinum, s. i. 402, mill.

mollior, v. *dep.* i. 41, soften.

molosus, s. *for* ‘molossus,’ i. 400, mastiff.

mōmentum, s. i. 1405, ii. 152.

monachus, s. iii. 379.

monialis, s. iv. 553 ff., nun.

monilis, *a.* iv. 265.

mōnocus, *a.* i. 405, one-eyed.

moriger, *a.* vi. 567, vii. 1183, 1355, good.

morosus, *a.* Ep. 33, ‘O deus’ &c. 2.

mortifico, v. C. T. ii. 110, kill.

mulcēbris, *a.* v. 75, soothing.

mulier, *genit.* **muliēris**, i. 1255, iii. 1517.

multiplico, v. *n.* ii. 606.

multociens, *adv.* i. 1341, iv. 1095.

mundifico, v. *a.* vii. 627, C. T. i. 192, cleanse.

mundipotens, *a.* vi. 398.

murelegus, s. i. 463, cat.

N

nāto, v. C. T. ii. 45.

naturō, v. *a.* v. 205.

nēbula, s. i. 133, L. S. 22.

necesse, s. C. T. iii. 217, necessity.

nefrendus, s. i. 307, young pig.

nephas, **nephandus**, *for* ‘nefas,’ ‘nefandus,’ i. 446, 1318.

nequio, *for* ‘nequeo,’ Ep. 17.

nigredo, s. i. 529, C. T. i. 114.

nisi, *conj.* iii. Prol. 62, iii. 22, V. P. 250, (*used for* ‘non nisi’) only.

nisus, vii. 226, hawk.

non, *for* ‘ne,’ iii. 1152, 1434, iv. 131.

nonne, *for* ‘num,’ v. 721, vi. 523, vii. 619, *for* ‘non,’ vi. 351.

nota, s. i. 128, note of music.

nouiter, *adv.* i. 2011, anew.

nouo, v. *n.* iv. 678, be renewed.

nouo, *adv.* iii. 250, 284, 376, anew.

nullatenus, *adv.* vi. cap. v. (*heading*).

num, *for* ‘nonne,’ ii. 306, 320.

numquid, *for* ‘nonne,’ ii. Prol. 59, v. 280, vii. 484, 892, surely.

nuper, *adv.* i. 443, iii. 279 ff., formerly.

O

obaudio, v. vii. 1471, (?).

ōbex, s. C. T. ii. 3, hindrance.

occianus, *for* ‘oceanus,’ i. 1954.

occo, v. vii. 448, cut off.

őester, i. 603, gad-fly.

oppono, v. iii. 615, put questions.

organa, s. i. 103, vii. 299, musical instrument.

origo, s. i. 144, (?).

orizon, s. ii. 240, sky.

orphanus, s. v. 232.

ortus, *for* 'hortus,' i. 61.

Oxönia, C. T. i. 63.

P

păganus, s. ii. 495, iii. 307.

Pălamădes, i. 987.

palentinus, *a.* i. 915.

panellus, vii. 1455, saddle.

pannificus, *a.* v. 782, of cloth-makers.

paritas, s. i. 763.

parliamentum, s. C. T. i. 129, iii. 284.

pascua, s. *fem.* i. 342, pasture.

pauce, *adv.* v. 93.

pedito, v. iii. 1561, v. 101.

peniteo, v. *n.* V. P. 135, 250, repent.

penna, s. i. Prol. 37, pen.

perambulus, *a.* C. T. iii. 120, going about.

perante, **per ante**, *adv.* i. 135, 591, 670, 1107.

perextra, *adv.* iv. 645.

perio, *for* 'pereö,' iv. 807, C. T. ii. 145.

perpetualis, *a.* Ep. 48, 'O reöolende' &c. 25, lasting.

phariseus, *a.* iv. 936, C. T. iii. 73;
s. iv. 1013.

Philomena, i. 99.

phīlosophus, s. i. 588.

pietas, s. i. 1190, vi. 744, C. T. iii. 452, mercy, pity.

pietousus, *a.* C. T. iii. 388, merciful.

pius, *a.* i. 1264, vii. 1141, C. T. iii. 466 ff., merciful, gentle.

placenda, s. *pl.* iv. 714, acceptable offerings.

placitus, *a.* vii. 379, pleasing.

plano, v. i. 409, ii. 481, smoothe, stroke.

plasma, s. vii. 1233, creature.

plasmator, s. vii. 1233, creator.

plaudo, v. vii. 299, 753, be pleasing.

pneuma, s. iii. Prol. 106.

pōderis, s. iii. 1787, surplice *or* alb.

policīa, s. v. 670.

polimitus, *for* ‘polymitus,’ *a.* iii. 1383, closely woven.

pomposus, *a.* iii. 76, C. T. ii. 82, iii. 366, arrogant.

porcarius, s. i. 313, swineherd.

posse, *inf. as subst.* i. 1176, iii. 582, power.

posteă, *adv.* v. 1013.

(de) postfacto, iii. 562, afterwards.

practica, s. iii. 1461, practice.

prebenda, s. iii. 1323, prebend.

prelatus, s. Ep. 41.

prenosticum, s. i. Prol. 13, presage.

presbiter, s. iii. 390, 1790, priest.

presbiteralis, a. L. S. 17, of the priesthood.

presbitero, v. a. iii. 1826, 2090, ordain priest.

prestigiosus, a. ‘Est amor’ &c. 13, full of tricks.

prestimulo, v. i. 576, sting (*but read rather ‘perstimulo’*).

presto, v. v. 671, cause (*with inf.*).

presul, s. iii. 34, prelate.

preuarico, v. a. iv. 679, 806, falsify.

preuaricor, v. n. i. 740, iii. 12*, 1701, L. S. 90, transgress.

primas, s. C. T. ii. 239, primate.

prior, s. iv. 318, prior (of a monastery).

probitas, s. vi. 938, prowess.

prōfugus, a. C. T. i. 92, 108.

Progne, *for* ‘Procne,’ i. 101.

prophanus, *for* ‘profanus,’ C. T. Prol. 3.

prophecīa, s. iv. 771, prophecy.

propheta, s. iv. 767.

proprietaryus, s. iv. 897.

proprio, v. iii. 770, iv. 817, 838, appropriate.

prōsēlītus, s. iv. 1011, proselyte.

prothdolor, *for* ‘prohdolor,’ V. P. 234, C. T. ii. 1 (*also ‘prodolor,’ i. 234, &c.*).

protunc, *adv.* i. cap. xiii. (*heading*) (*also ‘pro tunc’*).

proximior, a. *comp.* i. 906, 974, nearer.

psalmista, s. V. P. 119.

Pseudo, iv. 788.

Q

quam, *for* ‘quanto,’ i. 1534.

quam prius, *for* ‘prius quam,’ i. 1944, vii. 429, 1106, V. P. 190, 202, &c.

quamuis, *conj.* i. 350.

que, *conj.* (*standing alone*) Ep. 25, i. Prol. 23, i. 54, 100, 149, 395, &c.,
(*enclitic*) i. 53, 179, 407, &c.

quia, *for* ‘quod,’ i. 1593, **O quia**, i. 59, v. 193.

quicquid, *for* ‘quicquam,’ i. 412, 885, 1346.

quid, *for* ‘quicquid,’ i. 1609, vii. 551.

quiesco, v. a. C. T. iii. 4, restrain.

quin magis (*with indic.*), i. 135, 262, 595, 994, so **quin**, i. 509, 608,
1607.

quĩrito, v. i. 804, cry out (like a boar).

quis, *for* ‘quisquam,’ i. 184, 617, 716; **quid pro quo**, iii. 1223.

quisque, *for* ‘quicunque,’ vi. 813, vii. 578.

quo, *conj.* *for* ‘qua,’ i. 500, vii. 487,
for ‘vnde,’ vii. 800, 820.

quod, *conj.* i. 223, 541, so that, i. Prol. 22, i. 568, in order that.

quōdammodo, *adv.* vii. 1323.

quodcunque, *with negative*, i. 507.

quoque, *conj.* iii. Prol. 20, and.

R

ramnus, s. i. 1019*, bramble (?).

reatus, s. vi. 432, C. T. ii. 179, L. S. 89, guilt.

rector, s. iii. 1319, rector (of a parish).

redditus, s. *for* ‘reditus,’ i. 44.

redio, *for* ‘redeo,’ i. 1190.

refor, v. ii. 505, reply.
refundo, v. i. 49, sprinkle.
rēiectus, *pp.* L. S. 6.
releuamen, s. i. 2113.
rēliquus, *a.* i. 1474.
remordeo, v. i. 1756, V. P. 175, remind, call to mind (?).
replanto, v. C. T. iii. 255.
reprobus, *a.* i. 1018, reprobate.
reptile, s. i. 36.
rěscīdo, v. (*for* ‘recīdo’), C. T. i. 93, iii. 347, L. S. 80 (*also* ‘recisa,’ vi. 423).
residiuus, *for* ‘recidiuus,’ vii. 1124, C. T. ii. 343.
responsalis, *a.* C. T. iii. 380.
rěstauro, v. V. P. 256.
retrocado, v. ii. 329, fall back.
retrogradus, *a.* i. 1311, ‘O deus’ &c. 90.
retrouersor, v. ii. 229, be reversed.
reviuus, *a.* ‘Rex celi’ &c. 22.
ribaldus, s. iii. 1472, profligate person.
Rinx, i. 407 (name of a dog).
rōbustus, *a.* C. T. i. 41.
Romipeta, iii. 1551.
rosans, *pres. part.* vi. 1358, rose-bearing.
rōta, s. ii. 61 (*but* rōta, i. 1163).
rotundo, *adv.* i. 1953, around.
rumphea, *for* ‘rumpia,’ i. 863, sword.

rusticitas, s. i. 174, 513, country-people, country.

rutilis, *a.* v. 27.

S

sanccitum, s. vi. 743, sentence.

sanguinitas, s. i. 1172, bloodiness.

saporo, *v. a.* ii. 601.

Sāturnus, iii. 923.

scansus, s. i. 1601.

sceleres, *for* ‘celeres’ (?), C. T. iii. 188.

scisma, s. L. S. 29.

scrophā, *for* ‘scrofa,’ i. 309.

scrutor, *v. pass.* iv. 369.

se, sibi, &c. *for* ‘eum,’ ‘ei,’ &c. i. 271, 322, C. T. iii. 231.

sedimen, s. i. 359, dregs.

segistrum, s. i. 359 (?).

sēmidemon, s. iv. 214.

sēmitutus, *a.* vii. 280.

sepultum, s. i. 1170, C. T. ii. 156, burial.

sēra, s. i. 882, bar.

series, s. v. 569, 812 (?).

seruītus, s. C. T. iii. 468.

sexus, s. i. 728, class.

sibulus, *a. for* ‘sibilus,’ i. 551.

sic quod, i. Prol. 32, in order that.

sicque, *for* ‘sic,’ i. 338.

significatum, s. vii. 952, meaning.

similo, *for* ‘simulo,’ iv. 4.
sinagoga, s. ii. 494, iv. 1093.
sinautem, *conj.* iii. cap. xxvii. (*heading*), otherwise.
sincopo, v. *a.* v. 819, diminish.
sinistro, v. *n.* iii. 1525, do wrong.
sintilla, *for* ‘scintilla,’ ii. 475.
sollicitas, s. iv. 112, labour.
solor, v. *pass.* i. 1497.
sophīa, s. ii. 370, wisdom.
sōpītus, *pp.* i. 151, ‘O deus’ &c. 81.
sors, s. i. 171, C. T. ii. 113, company.
sotulares, s. v. 805, shoes (?).
spācium, s. i. 1273.
spasmatus, *pp.* i. 2011, seized with convulsions.
specialis, *a.* *as* s. vii. 243, L. S. 77, friend;
 speciale, ‘O deus’ &c. 62, secret.
speculatiuum, s. iii. 1462, theory.
spera, *for* ‘sphaera,’ ii. 151.
spergo, *for* ‘spargo,’ i. 590.
spiritualis, *a.* v. 605, 668.
spiritualiter, *adv.* iii. 635.
spiro, v. i. 408, 550, v. 435, desire.
spondaicus, *a.* iv. 81, slow.
sporta, s. iii. 1961, basket.
stapula, s. v. 773, the staple (of wool).
sternutacio, s. i. 189, braying.

sternuto, v. i. 797, bray.
stragulatus, *a.* C. T. i. 140.
stringo, v. (*with inf.*) i. 130, compel.
subite, *adv.* i. 1531.
sublimus, *a.* iii. 419, 701
(**sublimis**, iii. 821).
succo, v. Ep. 36, suckle.
suffragium, *s.* Ep. 32, prayer.
suggo, v. *for* ‘sugo,’ ii. 413.
superbio, v. *a.* iv. 322, make proud.
supersum, v. iii. 16, 1298, surpass.
suus, *for* ‘eius,’ ‘eorum,’ i. 54, 189, 206, 332, 338, 634.

T

taxa, *s.* vi. 650, vii. 209, 283, C. T. iii. 469, tax, blame.
taxo, v. C. T. iii. 469, tax.
Tēgia, *for* ‘Tegeaea,’ *a.* i. 349.
temporibus, *as adv.* i. 298, after a time.
temporo, *for* ‘tempero,’ v. 213.
tenebresco, v. *n.* Ep. 11; v. *a.* vi. 225.
teneo, v. iii. 584 ff., v. 384, belong.
tener, *a. abl.* **teneri**, iv. 993, *pl.* **teneres**, iv. 583.
tenuus, *for* ‘tenuis,’ i. 551.
terreus, *a.* iii. 88, 288, earthly.
terrula, *s.* vii. 531, a little earth.
Thāmisia, C. T. i. 81.
thēologīa, *s.* iv. 821.

thēsaurus, *s.* ‘O deus’ &c. 81.

Thētis, **Thēthis**, **Tētis**, *v.* 812. *vii.* 1067, *C. T.* *i.* 80.

Tīdēus, *i.* 985.

tīmeo, *vi.* 997 (*usu.* **tīmeo**).

timidus, *a.* *i.* 1848, fearful.

tirannicus, *a.* *C. T.* *ii.* 22.

trādidit, *i.* 2128.

trībula, *s.* *i.* 863, three-pronged fork.

Troianus, *for* ‘Traianus,’ *vi.* 1273.

tueor, *v. pass.* *vii.* 1215.

V

vago, *v.* *i.* 1199, wander.

valdě, *adv.* *i.* 581, *iii.* 1594.

valedico, *v.* *v.* 766, give salutation.

vanga, *s.* *i.* 859, mattock.

vario, *v.* *iv.* 910, transgress.

vaspa, *s.* *i.* 571, wasp.

Vaspasianus, *i.* 571.

vber, *fem.* **vbera**, *vii.* 346.

vegeto, *v.* *vii.* 1033, flourish.

velle, *inf. as subst.* *i.* 235, 832, *iii.* 22, will, desire.

vendico, *v.* *vi.* 228, claim.

vector, *v. a.* *vi.* 1197.

veteratus, *a.* *v.* 784, old.

vetitur, *for* ‘vetatur,’ *iv.* 903.

vicecōmes, *s.* *vi.* 419, sheriff.

vicinium, s. iii. 991.

vīdebat, *for* ‘vīdebat,’ C. T. iii. 436.

villa, s. C. T. iii. 55 ff., town.

vitalis, a. V. P. 27, (?).

vix, *adv. with neg.* v. 104, 153, vii. 12;

vix si, iv. 218, vi. 1330;

for ‘paene,’ vi. 640.

Vluxes, i. 779, 967.

vnio, s. v. 673, unity.

voluto, *for* ‘volito,’ i. 95, 605.

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